

In the name of God most Gracious, ever Merciful!

The Beloved and I

Volume 8: Acts to Revelation

Thomas McElwain

New Jubilees Version of Sacred Scripture in
Verse

With Verse Commentaries

Revised Edition

Adams & McElwain Publishers

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First published in two volumes, The Beloved and I 2005, and Led of the Beloved, 2006.

Second edition, 2010

Third and revised edition, 2012

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Published by

Adams & McElwain Publishers

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Cover photos by Ritva and Anna Maria McElwain

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The Book of Acts of the Apostles

Acts 1

1 The former record that I made,
Theophilus, of every grade
Of what Jesus began to do
And teach, 2 until the day in which
He was raised up, after that pitch
He through the Holy Spirit gave
Commandments to apostles brave
Whom he had chosen in a crew,
3 To whom also he showed himself
Alive after his passion's shelf
By many proofs infallible,
Seen by them forty days in full,
And speaking of the things that go
Along with God's kingdom in show.

The tone historical this writer takes
Is quite enough to make me from my
shakes

Believe that he believes the thing is true,
That Jesus rose up from the grave in view.
It's not a mythic tale, a legend found
After the fact embellished on the ground.
I've seen a woman it was claimed that she
Had been dead and was raised up then to be
Alive again after lying for days
Within the casket to come and amaze.
Who am I to say none can rise from death,
As though I hold the keys of life and
breath?

Beloved, if wishful thinking plays a part,
I'm willing to give the whole a new start.

4 They came together, by command
They should not leave the town and land
Of Jerusalem, but wait till
The Father's promise should fulfil,
"Which you have heard of me at hand."

5 For John truly baptized with water,
But you'll be baptized with the slaughter
Of Holy Spirit soon as planned.

Baptism changes with the changing moon,
It takes Elisha to turn out the spoon,
Commanding Naaman seven dips in tune.
The proselyting baptism of Jews
Is now just three dips and back to the pews.
Baptism of John was really no news,
But just the miqwe publicized to choose,

And advertised for men as well as dames.
It's only here at last the Spirit's flames
Engage the victim with another care.
Baptisms in the name of John might share
With those in name of Jesus. Still I turn
Around the dergah floor for what I've
earned
To find baptism of fire has not burned.

6 When they therefore had come together,
They asked of him the which and whether,
Saying "Sir, will you at this time
Restore Israel's kingdom to climb?"

7 And he said to them, "It is not
For you to know the times and plot,
Which the Father's put in His power?
8 "But you'll receive the power an hour
After the Holy Spirit's come,
And you'll bear witness of my sum
Both in Jerusalem and in
All of Judaea, and the din
Of Samaria, and as far
As the ends of the earth/*ly star*."

Will Your restore the kingdom at this time?
And yet so long he had been in the rhyme
Without them knowing that kingdom had
come
And was among them with a busy hum.
They ask, as the true kingdom disappears,
Goes off in physical elopement's gears,
When it will first arrive. They know no
fears.

But Jesus does not stay to teach once more
What they failed to learn at the open door.
Instead he tells them that the Spirit will
Come to remind them of his teaching's fill,
And then perhaps as dreary days without
The kingdom's presence physical and stout
They will appreciate what he's about.

9 And when he had spoken these things,
While they looked on, he on his wings
Was taken up; and a cloud came
To take him from their sight in flame.

The occultation of the Christ was fine,
But it was nothing new, within the line,
He is the third so named, first Enoch went
And was not, for You took him as was sent.
Then great Elijah stepped across the flood
Of Jordan in baptisms without blood,

And entered in the chariot of fire,
Leaving his cloak and spirit with desire.
Beloved, I know not how many have sung
While rising living into the dark rung
Of stars, but if the Mahdi has not stung,
I too may hope to enter in Your heart
And be there hidden without end or start,
Riding in chariot or horse and cart.

10 And while they looked steadfastly on
Toward the sky to which he'd been drawn,
See, two men stood by them in white,
11 Who said "You men of Galilee,
Why do you stand gazing so bright
Into the sky? This same man free,
Jesus, who's taken up from you
Into the sky, shall so come too
In the same way you've seen him go
Into the heavens from below."

This promise of the second coming here
Is great and cannot help but remain dear
To every heart that glows with faith to hear
The stories of the lord Jesus appear.
This promise of the coming makes it sound
As though he shall be visible from ground,
And not return in spirit to be found
In desert places hidden all around.
Beloved, I hardly dare to think it's true
That he could rise into the air from view,
And then return as visibly to me
As on that far-off day and far degree
He passed from time into eternity.
Beloved, I stand in awe of this and You.

12 They went back to Jerusalem
From the mount called Olivet's gem,
Which is far from Jerusalem
As a Sabbath day's trip in hem.

Since after resurrection has been told,
Disciples will no longer stand so bold
To keep the Sabbath, no, the burden's gone,
At least in view of priest and paragon.
And yet, without their keeping Sabbath
day,
They still speak in such terms as Sabbath
way.
The inconsistency of human speech
Is matched only by the words that they
preach.
Beloved, though I know little of how far

I may or may not travel from the bar
On Sabbath or on Friday night, let me
Still keep enjoying Sabbath faithfully
Until I enter rest eternally,
Until I find the evening lit by star.

13 And when they had come in, they went
Up in an upper room where spent
Both Peter, James, and John, Andrew,
Philip, Thomas, Bartholomew,
And Matthew, James who was the son
Of Alphaeus, and then Simon
Zelotes, and Judas of James.

14 These all stayed there in one accord
In prayer and supplication's sword,
With the women and Mary too
Who was Jesus' mother, and crew
Of all his brothers come in view.

It seems as soon as Jesus was found dead,
His brothers rallied to his hopes outspread.
As soon as he no longer came to set
A trap and strange commotion to those met
In palace and in temple from the day
When he was twelve confounding in his
way,
His brothers took the falling flag and led
His own disciples as they broke their bread.
Beloved, though Jesus once denied, it
seems,
His mother, for obedient ones in schemes,
As soon as he is gone, her faith is high:
She will believe her son is in the sky.
Beloved, how human are we human souls
Stirred in our porcelain and mixing bowls.

15 And in those days Peter stood up
Among the disciples *like tup*,
And said among the many there
A hundred and twenty to share,
16 "Men and brothers, this Scripture must
Have been fulfilled down to the dust
Which Holy Spirit by the tongue
Of David spoke before the hung
Judas, which was guide to those who
Took Jesus. 17 "He was of our crew,
And had part in this ministry.
18 "Now this man bought a field with lot
Of wickedness, and falling got
Burst open in the middle, and
All his guts gushed out on the sand.
19 "And it was known to those who live

There in Jerusalem to give
That field the name in their own tongue
Aceldama, which means when rung
The field of blood *if not of dung*.

20 "For it is written in the book
Of Psalms, 'Let his dwelling place nook
Be desolate, and let no man
Live there, and let his service plan
Be taken by another man.'

21 "So of these men who've been with us
All the time the lord was gracious
To move among us, 22 "starting from
John's baptism and so to come
Up to the same day he was taken
Up from us, one must be ordained
To be a witness and unstained
With us of resurrection gained."

The book of Acts shows Peter in the crowd
Of those who mend the tabernacle shroud
Of David and set up the walls again.
He appeals to Davidic word to men.
I love the man for that. For David's tent
Is where I find my glory has been spent.
I too find all the universe is set
In Psalms and Judases and Christs are met
In canvasses as bright and clear below
The fair Shekinah on the golden show.
Beloved, I follow John's baptism to
The brink of Galilee and take in view
Of Nazareth, Capernaum on foot
Beyond the hills, toward where the nights
put.

23 And they appointed two, Joseph
Called Barsabas, whose surname was
Justus, and Matthias as does.

24 And they prayed and said "You, Lord
who
Know the hearts of all, now show true
Choice You have made between these two,
25 "To take part of this service and
Apostleship, from which was banned
Judas by wickedness, so he
Might go to his own place freely."
26 And they gave forth their lots, and it
Fell on Matthias, who would sit
With eleven apostles fit.

If chance is who You are, the gambler now
Loves You above all men in stern or prow.
If hazard is Your name, I beg to learn

What love the universe still has to burn.
Did You, Beloved, prefer Matthias named,
Or was it mere chance that arose
unblamed?

And if mere chance, and You are chance
untold,

The chance is not of mereness, but of gold.
Beloved, I'd rather know, beside the well
Of living water, what the secrets tell
Of Joseph, my sweet Joseph, who was left
Among the crowd forlorn, perhaps bereft.
Why not thirteen? Do the Psalms say it
must

Be twelve and only twelve to meet the
dust?

Acts 2

1 And when the day of Pentecost
Had fully come, they were all tossed
Together in one place. 2 Right off
There came a sound from heaven to doff
A rushing, mighty wind that filled
All the house where they sat and milled.
3 And there appeared on them split tongues
Like fire, and it sat in its rungs
On each of them. 4 And they were all
Filled with the Holy Spirit's call,
And began speaking foreign tongues
As Spirit gave them power in stall.

Since I got D in English in third grade,
My interests have turned to the tongues
displayed

In other lands and other families,
The Indian, European, to degrees
The Asian tongues as well ranging in
breeze.

For all my hopeful studies, I have not
Mastered a single language in the plot.
The D was accurate, no doubt, bless that
Lone teacher if alive still on her mat.
I never heard the rushing, mighty wind,
I never felt the flame on my hair pinned,
And yet I pray Your Spirit on the finned,
The winged, the footed and on me also
To keep a hope and health and homely
glow.

5 And there were staying in the town
Jerusalem Jews of renown
For their devotion from each place
Under the heavens in their trace.

6 Now when the rumours of this flew
 Around, the multitude in crew
 Came together and were amazed,
 Because each man as he was raised
 Heard them speak his own language due.
 7 They were greatly surprised and asked
 Each other, "See, are these not tasked
 To speak all Galileans masked?
 8 "And how do we each man hear our
 Own language of birth at this hour?
 9 "The Parthians, Medes, Elamites,
 The Mesopotamian wights,
 From Judaea, Cappadocia,
 From Pontus and also Asia,
 From Phrygia, and Pamphylia,
 From Egypt and parts of Libya
 About Cyrene, and strangers from
 10 "Rome, Jews and proselytes to come,
 11 "From Crete, and Arabs, we all hear
 Them speak our languages in fear
 The wondered works of God appear."
 12 And they were all amazed, in doubt,
 Saying to each other about,
 "What does this mean, and what find out?"

Knowing the difficulties that are met
 In learning any language, I have yet
 To overcome the first steps in the mire.
 I too am amazed at disciples' quire.
 A simple Cappadocian grammar would
 Lift spirits indeed as such a book should.
 The Arabic is quite beyond my task,
 If classical is the language You ask.
 Beloved, Creator of human speech, now
 I see Acts recognizes anyhow
 This divine attribute, the Christian way
 Is to ignore for praise in light of day
 This feature that Islam's willing to pay
 The due respect: speech made of breath and
 clay.

13 And others made fun and they said
 "These men are full of new wine spread."
 14 But Peter stood up with the band
 Of the eleven, raised voice and
 Said to them, "You men of Judaea,
 Those in Jerusalem to see you,
 Let this be known to you, and hear
 The words I have to say in ear.
 15 "For these are not drunk as you think,
 Since it's just nine o'clock on brink.

I'd love to taste the wine at any cost
 That made me spout ten languages and
 tossed
 In Chinese tones and Arab gutturals
 Against the ears of foes and generals.
 I guess that would teach people to respect
 Me too, instead of ignore and neglect.
 Beloved, give me the wine those ancient
 Jews
 Knew and loved in their synagogue and
 pews.
 Give me that wine and I shall not refuse,
 Despite the warning and dissenting views
 Of the prophet Muhammad that I choose.
 Beloved, give me a taste of that wine now
 Before the clock strikes nine upon my brow
 New awakened from the long sleep of the
 sow.

16 "But this is what was spoken by
 The prophet Joel to rely,
 17 "And it shall happen in last days,
 Says God, I'll pour out of the rays
 Of My Spirit upon all flesh;
 And your sons and your daughters fresh
 Shall prophesy, and your young men
 Shall see visions, your old again
 Shall dream dreams in their sleeping den.
 18 "And on my servants and handmaids
 I'll pour out in those days' cascades
 Of my Spirit to prophesy.
 19 "And I'll show wonders in the sky,
 And signs in earth beneath, and blood
 And fire and smoke in billows' flood.
 20 "The sun shall be turned into dark,
 The moon to blood before that stark
 Great day of the Lord and its mark.
 21 "And it shall happen, one who calls
 On the name that the Lord installs
 Shall be saved from both foe and thralls.
 22 "You men of Israel, hear these words:
 Jesus of Nazareth's full herds,
 A man approved of God among
 You by miracles, wonders sung
 And signs, which God did by him in
 The middle of your crew and din,
 As you yourselves know *and your kin*:

Let's stop right here, Beloved, and take a
 look
 At what Peter's said written in the book.
 He says Jesus is man, not god, approved

By those who had not and by those who
grooved.

The miracles he did proved that You gave
Him power to do, because as son and slave,
You were pleased with him, since he did
not shave.

Let Trinitarian take full note here:

Jesus is not god got in any gear,

But a man sent, approved by You to fear.

Let it be known the wonders and the signs
Gave evidence of You in Your designs
And not of his own deity at all.

Back blasphemy, Beloved, against the wall.

23 "He was delivered by the strong
Decision and foreknowledge long
Of God. You took him with your hands
Of wickedness, and killed in bands
By crucifixion. 24 "God raised him
Up from the pains of death and dim,
Because it was not possible
That he should be held by it's pull.

If Jesus had been God by definition
He could not have been killed in the
sedition.

But Acts says that he was. So that just
shows

He was a man and not God in the rows.
The facile answer that just the man died
And not the divine character applied
Is nonsense for atonement on the side.
If the man died and not the god, then that
Small sacrifice was merely human scat.
The Trinity as doctrine fast denies
The death of the divine beneath the skies,
And so denies the sacrifice that came
To conquer death and sin for every blame.
If he did not die, living's not the same.

25 "For David speaks concerning him,
'I kept YHWH always at my face,
For He's on my right hand to trace,
So I'd not be moved anyplace.

26 "And that is why my heart rejoiced,
And my tongue was glad as it voiced
The hope in which my body rests:

27 "Because You'll not leave me in hell,
Nor let Your holy one see spell
Of dissolution at death's knell

28 "You've shown to me the ways of life,
You'll make me full of joy by fife

Before Your face.' 29 "Brothers and men,
Let me freely refer again

To you of David patriarch,
That he is dead and buried, mark
His sepulchre with us today.

30 "He was a prophet in God's way,
Who'd sworn an oath to him, the fruit
Of his loins by the flesh and boot,
He would raise up the Christ to sit
Upon his throne. 31 "He saw this fit
And spoke beforehand of the time
Christ would in resurrection climb
Up from hades so that his flesh
Saw no corruption, but stayed fresh.

32 "This Jesus God raised up, of that
We all are witnesses out flat.

33 "So he's raised to right hand of God,
And had the Father's promised prod
Of Holy Spirit, which he's shared,
Which you now see and hear unspared.

34 "For David's not gone to the sky,
But he himself gives the reply,
'YHWH said to my lord, sit on my
Right hand, 35 "until I make your foes
Your footstool.' 36 "So let all the band
Of Israel know as sure as stand,
That God's made that same Jesus whom
You've crucified, both lord in room
And Christ." 37 Now when they heard this,
they

Were pricked in their heart, and they say
To Peter and apostle band,
"Brothers and men, how do we stand?"

Sweet Peter's application of the Psalm
As prophecy of resurrection's balm
Was no doubt one original and showed
That novelty is the Scriptures' abode.
The novel use of Scripture does not give
The truth in absolute or way to live,
But its surprise to hear familiar tune
Sung to a different metre in the croon
May bring the heart to a repentance boon.
Beloved, it could be that David himself
Was resurrected and taken like elf
To be with Enoch and Elijah where
Your blessings waft the grand celestial air.
How's Peter so sure the tomb is not bare?

38 Then Peter said to them, "Repent,
And be baptized each of you sent
In the name of Jesus the Christ

For the remission of sins sliced,
And you'll receive also the gift
Of the Holy Spirit to lift.

I have repented in my day and room,
I have been baptized without any gloom,
And found the promise of the Spirit's doom
Hangs ever and again upon my bloom.
If there's a Spirit blessing on my head,
I have not heard the wind or felt the dread
Flames leaping in coldness of fire instead.
But who knows whither I may yet be led?
Beloved, repentance is the only way
To Your prosperity in hopeful day,
And yet the human heart despises it
Even with promises of Spirit's fit.
The mystery cults seduce the great and fair,
While Your baptisms are reduced in ware.

39 "For the promise is made to you,
And to your children in their crew
To all afar off, even all
That the Lord our God then shall call."
40 And with many other words' rhyme
Told them to flee this evil time.
41 Then they gladly received his word,
And were baptized of those that heard
That day about three thousand men.

One might think they laid hands on those
too fast
Who were converted in the stony blast
Of Peter's sermon. But it might be well
To mind that they had heard Christ himself
tell
About the kingdom in their midst a spell
Of three years over, if John's Gospel's right.
So three years in the catechumen's light
Is plenty of time to come out of night.
Beloved, when Peter accuses the Jews
Of slaying Jesus, it's not in my views
A literal in plaint, for it was done
By Romans who were there to hold the
gun.
It's always Romans who are soon or late
The ones who jump the gun with love or
hate.

42 And they continued steadfastly
As the apostles taught decree
And fellowship, and breadding bread,
And in the kinds of prayers they said.

43 And fear came upon every man,
And many wonders and signs' span
That the apostles in God's plan
Were led to accomplish as can.
44 All who believed stayed in a group,
And had all things in common soup.
45 They sold their property and goods,
And divided them among hoods,
As every man had need again.

The communism of the Jesus crowd
Is sweet for a few weeks when praised
aloud,
But wait until some greed peeks in the
heart
Of some parishioner or leader's start,
And see how quickly retribution falls
To arouse fear instead of love in stalls.
Not many Baptists that I know are just
As ready to commune with bread and crust,
And would require a prod of fear to bring
Them into any communistic thing.
Just let them wait until the fervour's past
And kirk has settled in official cast.
Then those who keep their purses shall
arise
And shout their Christian hymns up to the
skies.

46 And they were daily with one will
In the temple and on the hill
To break bread from house to house, fill
Their meals with gladness and good will.
47 They praised God and were in the
favour
Of all the people, slave and slaver.
And the Lord added to the called
Out ones each day those who installed
To be saved from the bitter pill.

I'd like to break the bread with those of old
Who settled in Jerusalem and told
The tales of Jesus as they dipped the sop.
I'd like to live with them and never stop.
But that's to be imagined for a while,
And then's to return to the trampled mile
That opens up another world of sin,
A world of churches worshipping in din.
Beloved, whether my pride turns on the
dust
Of old Jerusalem or London fussed,
I find the sweetness of Your breath abroad,

Untrammelled by the whisperings of God,
I plough between the roses and the streams
To splash again, again celestial dreams.

Acts 3

1 Now Peter and John went together
Into the temple to see whether
The time of prayer at nine o'clock
Had started without hitch or rock.
2 A certain man lame from his birth
Was carried and laid in his berth
At the gate of the temple which
Is called the Beautiful for pitch,
To beg alms from those who came in
The temple, 3 and he saw the kin
Of Peter and John just about
To go into the temple route,
And begged a boon from them in shout.
4 And Peter casting eye on him
Along with John, said "Look here trim
At us." 5 And he gave heed to them,
Expecting to receive a gem.
6 Then Peter said "Silver and gold
Are not with me, but what I'm bold
To have I give you, in the name
Of Jesus Christ *a man of fame*
From Nazareth, get up and walk."
7 He took his right hand like a stock
And lifted him up, and right then
His feet and ankle bones again
Received their strength before all men.

That Peter was a brave one to stick out
His neck in trust for healing of the bout.
But then, why not? If the man had not been
Healed then, what matter? There would be
no sin

In having tried and failed. In such a place
Where people come and go without a trace,
There's not the village atmosphere and race,
No loss of reputation or of face
To stop in sympathy beside the gate
Of temple and pretend to heal a rate.
Why not just lay hands on all ill and lame
And pray for healing everywhere in game?
If none are healed, what loss is that to one
Who tried the word to see what might be
done?

8 And he jumped up and stood and walked
And went in with them as well stocked
Into the temple, walking there

And leaping, praising God to dare.

9 And all the people saw him walking
And praising God as they came flocking.

10 And they knew that it was the one
That sat for alms under the sun
At the gate Beautiful beside
The temple, and they did not hide
Their wonder and amazement that
Such a great thing came on his mat.

11 And as the lame man who was healed
Held on to Peter and John's yield,
All the folk ran together there
To them in the porch called in share
Of Solomon, amazed to stare.

12 When Peter saw it, he replied
To the folk, "Men of Israel's pride,
Why do you marvel, and why look
So earnestly on us in nook,
As though by our own power or stand
Of holiness had by command
Made this man walk upon the land?"

13 "The God of Abraham, Isaac
And Jacob, our ancestors' back,
Has glorified his son Jesus;
Whom you delivered with a fuss,
Denied him before Pilate's throne,
When he was set to leave alone.

14 "But you denied the holy one
And just, and chose a killer's bun
To be released to you for fun.

15 "And killed the prince of life whom God
Raised up from the dead and the sod,
Of which we're witnesses in prison.

If the man had not been healed on the spot,
Then three or four in passing might have
got

A smile to see the unsuccessful trot,
And that would end the error and the plot.
But the crowd came to see the wonder
there,

And Peter asked them why they came to
stare?

In truth all healing is effect of faith
In the life of reality, not wraith,
And there was nothing Peter there could
do,

Or John beside him waiting in the pew.
The hope of health is not in doctors' hands,
Nor in the incantation of the bands
Of drug pushers and pharmacists, but in
The silent, pushing life beyond the din.

16 "And his name through faith in his name
 Has made this man both strong and game,
 Whom you see here and recognize.
 Indeed the faith which is through him
 Has given him the health undim
 Before all of you sound and trim.
 17 "Now brothers, I expect you did
 It in the ignorance where hid
 Your rulers also. 18 "But those things,
 Which God had shown before the wings
 Of all His prophets, that Christ should
 Suffer also, He has made good.

The suffering of Messiah is not shown
 With clarity in the Hebrew lines known,
 But must be cajoled out with care that
 shone

Upon imagination for a throne
 More than on sacred pages left alone.
 Still Peter brushes to the side the share
 Of exegetic doubt where I'd beware,
 And boldly says that Christ should suffer
 too,
 And be cut off as Daniel came to view.
 Beloved, there's hardly prophecy beyond
 That one word for the crucifixion dawned.
 And yet the stair is sure, the stroke
 employed

Upon the sent one before he enjoyed
 The adoration to raised up in dew.

19 "Repent then, have a change of mind,
 So that your sins be blotted out,
 When the refreshing shall come lined
 From the Lord's presence with a shout.

The great atonement that should only rise
 After the two millennia's disguise
 When the Most Holy Place beyond the
 skies
 Should hear the sound of Jesus' tread of
 feet
 Still human on the heavenly golden street,
 Is fast predicted in Peter's complete
 Astounding message that sins obsolete
 Should be out blotted by the Saviour's hand
 Of intercession before the throne scanned.
 Beloved, I raise a cry here to rejoice
 As I concur with Peter and his voice.
 The blotting out of sin, and not mere choice
 Of faint forgiveness finds a bugle clear,

A note of triumph after fear and tear.

20 "And he shall send Jesus Christ whom
 Before was preached unto your doom;
 21 "Who must stay in the heaven until
 The time of restitution's fill,
 That God has spoken by the tongue
 Of all His holy prophets sung
 Since the world started in its rung.
 22 "For Moses truly said unto
 The ancestors, 'A prophet due
 Shall the Lord your God raise up too
 Of your brothers, and one like me,
 You shall obey him faithfully
 In all he tells you truthfully.
 23 "And it shall happen every soul
 Who will not hear that prophet's toll
 Shall be cut off from the folk's roll.'

There is no dispensation for the Jews,
 And one to follow that rejects their views.
 There is just that they ought to hear the
 word

Of one whose Jewish mama had been
 stirred
 To find him faithful to the Torah when
 So many turned to Caesar and his den.
 Peter thinks that the prophecy holds true
 For Jesus, and those who refuse his due
 Will be judged for that neglect of the brew.
 And time will tell. Until then I can say
 That those who call him God Almighty
 sway

Upon the pagan and a heathen way.
 Accept him for his calling to repent,
 Accept him for the one that You have sent.

24 "Indeed all prophets from the time
 Of Samuel and those that did climb
 After, as many as have spoken,
 Have also foretold these days' token.
 25 "You are the prophets' children and
 Of God's own covenant to stand
 With our ancestors, when He said
 To Abraham, 'In your seed bred
 Shall of the kindreds of the earth
 Be blessed and raised up in their worth.'
 26 "To you first God, when He raised up
 His son Jesus, he sent with cup
 Of blessing to you, that you may
 Turn every one from evil way."

The raising up from death inspires the hope
Of the reward for those who reject pope
And mullah and the rabbi in their scope.
That great reward is life eternal when
The son of God shall return among men,
Seen on the cloud as he departed then,
Surrounded by the glory of the gate
Of heaven that opens from his new estate.
Beloved, when You raised him from death,

You gave

The world the gift of life if they behave
Submitted to the king of life, and share
A willingness to enter kingdom there.
Beloved, the conquering of death I find
Incredible, but still I am resigned.

Acts 4

1 Now as they spoke unto the folk,
The priests, the chief of temple woke,
And Sadducees came up to them,
2 They were greatly disturbed in hem
Because they taught the folk and preached
In Jesus resurrection reached.

Note well the preaching Peter did that day
Did not disturb the Pharisees in pay.
They were content and well so that a man
Should preach the resurrection as by plan.
It was the Sadducees and those from them,
The priestly caste, who disbelieved the gem
Of resurrection and that angel wings
Cover the messengers that Your hand
brings.

This is a matter, not of church and crowd
Of Jewish synagogues among the proud,
But issue of sectarian in fine.
With one or other Peter could align.
Beloved, from that sectarian debate
In time rose up the very Christian state.

3 They grabbed them and arrested them
Until the next day, for the hem
Of evening was already there.
4 But many of those who with care
Heard the word believed for their share,
And the number of men who came
Were about five thousand's acclaim.
5 And it happened on the next day,
That their rulers, elders in sway
And scribes, 6 and Annas the high priest,
Caiaphas, John and not least
Alexander, and such as were

Of the high priest's family to stir
Were gathered in Jerusalem.
7 It happened when they had set them
In their midst, they asked, "By what power
Or by what name have you done this?"

8 Then Peter, filled as in that hour
With Holy Spirit, spoke to miss,
"Rulers of folk and senators
Of Israel: 9 "If it deplores,
We are today judged for good deeds
To a man helpless in his weeds,
And how he was cured, 10 "let it be
Known to you all, and more broadly
To all the folk of Israel,
That by the name of Jesus Christ
Of Nazareth, whom under spell
You crucified, whom God raised sliced
From the dead, by him this man stands
Here by you whole. 11 "This is the 'stone
Which was rejected on the sands
By you builders, and which alone
Has become the chief cornerstone.'

12 "Nor is there salvation to find
In any other, for to bind
There is no other name that's said
Under heaven given and bred
Among men by which we are saved."
13 Now when they saw the boldness braved
Of Peter and John, and perceived
That they were untaught and received
No education, then amazed
They knew they'd been by Jesus raised.
14 And seeing the man who'd been healed
Standing with them, they had to yield.

Those who spent years with Jesus came to
be
More civilized than those in pageantry
Of the elite in rulership and power
Of church beneath the gleaming temple
tower.

Untaught in the world's magic and the glow
Of repetitions on the standard go,
Peter and John were ready with the ray
Of hope and health to polish a new day.
Beloved, see if I stand before the test
Of barley justice and the black crow's nest
One healed of fractious pretence and the
rest.

I jump for toy and bat at least to know
That healing has a fairly way to blow
Before the bleating of the ovine show.

15 But when they had commanded them
To go outside the council hem,
They conferred among themselves, 16
saying,

“What shall we do to these men paying?
For truly a great wonder's done
Through them, and all under the sun
Of Jerusalem know it's true,
So we cannot deny the view.

17 “But so it does not spread among
The people further, let's be stung
To threaten them severely, so
From now on they don't speak the row
To anyone in this man's name.”
18 They called them and commanded them
Not to speak at all nor give gem
Of teaching in Jesus Christ's name.

Intimidation of illiterate
Is ancient as a way to make the rate,
But now intimidation finds its way
Among the ones who read the netly ray.
It's not the priest and king today who takes
Intimidation out for Sunday stakes,
But rather the gurus of glitter wear
And jives of cock and coal decked out to
spare.

Beloved, I've been called on the carpet for
The pitting of my hand against the store
Of print and putting out a leaf or two
Upon the wooden back of wooden pew.
But for my crimes I've passed the gassed
and found

The pleasures of the beaten, tethered
ground.

19 But Peter and John answered and
Said to them, “Whether it is right
To obey you here in God's sight
Than to obey God, judge you might.
20 “For we can only speak such things
As we have seen and heard in springs.”

Truth is that people everywhere I turn
Are certain to have seen the things that
burn.

They are not like dear Peter when they
learn

What You demand of every pot and urn.
A thousand ways obedience may take,
But all turn from the law You set on stake,

Pretending that true love requires a mind
That does not adhere to what You would
bind.

Beloved, let me obey no man nor fate,
Nor even my own self under my pate,
But You alone in Word spent bright and
glare,

The livid law of life lifted in air
Before the Sinai of nocturnal share.
Beloved, I stand to obey at Your gate.

21 So when they had threatened the more,
They let them go, finding no score
To punish them, because the folk
All praised God for what they'd in stroke.

22 For the man was over forty
Years old when this sign came to be
Done on him for his healing's fee.

23 They were released, went to their own,
Reported all the chief priests' tone
And what the elders said to them.

24 So when they heard that on the stem,
They lifted up their voice to God
Together and said “Lord, You're God,
Who made the heaven and the earth
And sea, and all that is in them,

25 “Who by the mouth of Your servant
David have said ‘Why did they rant,
The nations, and the people plot
Vain things? 26 “The kings of the earth's
slot

Took their stand, and the rulers came
Together against YHWH by name
And against his Christ without blame.’

27 “Indeed against the holy child
Jesus, whom You anointed royaled,
Both Herod and Pontius Pilate,
With the Gentiles and the folk's rate
Of Israel, were gathered there
28 “To do whatever Your hand spare
And Your purpose determined done.

29 “Now, Lord, look on their threats begun,
And grant Your servants that with all
Boldness they may speak Your word's call,

30 “By stretching out Your hand to heal,
And that signs and wonders may reel
Done through the name of Your holy
Child Jesus.” 31 And when they'd freely

Prayed, the place where they came to be
Was shaken, and they were all filled
With the Holy Spirit instilled,
And they spoke God's word boldly drilled.

There is advance it seems since the last
time

The Holy Spirit came to speak in rhyme
Of words incomprehensible to climb.

Instead of strange speech, now the word is
clear:

The word of God, the greater word come
near.

Instead of flames of fire upon each head,
The house is shaken as to wake the dead.
Beloved, I seek that shaking tent once more
Whether in northern forests or the door
Of far Jerusalem, and find the place
Is still filled with the mystic and the trace
Of sweetness that the new and dew release,
Is still a place infinite in its peace,
And in the wakened message to increase.

32 Now the crowd of those who believed
Were of one heart and soul reprieved,
Neither did anyone say that

Any of the things where he sat
Was his own, but they had all things
In common. 33 And with greater stings
Apostles bore witness to that

The Lord Jesus rose up from scat.
And great grace was upon them all.

34 Nor was there anyone in thrall
Among them who lacked, for all who

Had lands or houses sold the due,
And brought the profits of the sale

35 And laid them at apostles' feet,
And they distributed the mail
To each as anyone had need.

36 And Joses, who was also named
Barnabas by apostles claimed
Which means son of encouragement,

A Levite of Cyprus' land sent,
37 Having land, sold *it*, and brought in

The price laid at apostles' bin.

A short walk from the ruins of the city,
Abandoning Greek and Roman grafitti,
The theatre and baths, aesthetic mark
In marble by the sea, I turn to hark
To silent beckonings of Barnabas
Whose desert church and cloister welcome
us.

A Levite, faithful son of Torah, had
More property than he could ever add
To his necessities, and so he sold

His excess to give to the poor and old,
The orphan and the widow. As I stand
Upon this spot that the apostle's hand
May well have ploughed, Beloved, I ask of
You

To grant me too the charity he knew.

Acts 5

1 A man named Ananias and
Sapphira his wife sold some land.

2 And he kept back part of the profit,
His wife also refused to cough it.
He brought a certain part and laid
It at apostles' feet and stayed.

3 But Peter said "Ananias,
Why has Satan filled your heart's pass
To lie to the Holy Spirit
And keep back part of the price fit
Of the land for yourself a bit?

4 "While it remained, was it not yours?
And after it was sold, the stores,
Were they not under your control?
Why have you conceived this false role
In your heart? You've not lied to men
But to God from your lying den."

5 Then Ananias heard these words,
Fell down and kicked his pot of curds.
So great fear came on all those who
Heard these things sitting in their pew.

I can't help thinking, my Beloved, this tale
Was written by authoritarian pale
To keep the populace under the nail
Of fear and the subjection of the rail.
The sin was to pretend that he had given
The whole sum and not kept some there to
live in.

It seems to me few Christians in this place
Are guilty of a lesser crime in case.
All sin more morbidly and few relate
To every poor and every wealthy state
With justice born of Your law in its rate.
If it were true that such a small lie bends
The liar to the ground without amends,
Then all would be in the grave where it
sends.

6 And the young men arose and wrapped
Him up, carried him out mapped,
And buried him. 7 Now it was just
Three hours later when in trust
His wife came in, though she did not

Knowing what had happened to the sot.
8 And Peter answered her, "Tell me
Whether you sold the land in fee
For so much?" She said, "Faithfully."

9 Then Peter said to her, "How's it
That you have agreed so unfit
To tempt the good Spirit of YHWH?
Look, the feet of those who went out
To bury your husband about
The door will carry you out too."

10 Then straight off she fell down before
His feet and breathed her last for gore.
And the young men came in and found
Her lying dead upon the ground.
They carried her out and put in
A grave beside her husband's win.
11 So great fear came on all the group
Of called out ones and every look
Who heard these things amid the din.

If Peter had just kept his good mouth shut,
Sapphira might have lived upon the glut
Of hidden profits, though burnt to the cut.
That's the fault of all leaders in the crime
Of church and temple or mosque in its
time.

If they would only keep tongue bridled
when
Questions arise to trouble hearts of men,
The world would find its once lost way
again.

Instead they jump at opportunity
To set up their own great authority
By showing that they know the secrets kept
In Your heart in the sanctuary swept
By the cold of space and eternity,
By the cold of space and eternity.

12 Through the apostles' hands great signs
And wonders were done in the lines
Of the folk. And with one accord
They all stayed in the porch adored
Of Solomon. 13 Yet none of those
Others dared to join in their rows,
But the folk held in high esteem.
14 Believers continued in stream
To be added to the Lord's dream,
In crowds of men and women, 15 so
They brought the sick out in the streets
And laid them on beds and on sheets,
So at least Peter's shadow passing
By might fall on some of them massing.

16 Also a multitude came in
From the cities around in din
Into Jerusalem, to bring
The ailing and tormented sting
By unclean spirits, and all they
Were made well in a single day.

The hand of preacher that fells the lame
crowd

Today draws inspiration and allowed
From the great healings of Jesus and him
Who followed in his path in ways not dim.
I may doubt that the divine blessing shows
In din and tinsel in the modern rows,
But with the spread of time and place I fail
To have the evidence that Peter's veil
Is broken by the flush of peach and kale
Like that of Pentecostal churches' tale.
In Peter's time the Spirit was not stale.
In Peter's time the Gospel was a word
Defying the elitist way that stirred
The good and great to death before the
herd.

17 Then the high priest got up, and all
Those who were with him in the thrall
Of the sect of the Sadducees,
And they were filled with wrath's degrees,
18 And they arrested the apostles
And put them in the gaol with jostles.
19 But at night an angel of YHWH
Opened the prison doors, the crew
Brought out, and said, 20 "Go now, and
stand

In the temple and speak as planned
To the folk all these words of life."

21 And when they heard that for their
strife,

They went into the temple rife
In the morning and taught the scanned.
But the high priest and those with him
Came and called in the council dim,
With all the elders of the folk
Of Israel, and sent when woke
To the prison to have them brought.
22 But when the officers had sought
And did not find them in the gaol,
They came back to report no fail,
23 Saying, "Indeed we found the gaol
Shut tight, and the guards in their place
To stand before the doors in brace,
But when we opened them, we found

No one inside upon the ground!"

When I was just a child, this story made
Enough to keep me in its bright parade
For a whole week, and in the Sabbath class
Still wonder at the things that come to pass.
That's why I am amazed to find it here
In just a verse or two and without fear.
I'd heard excitement of the passing by
The inner and the outer guards that ply
The spear and sword on all who would
escape.

I'd heard it told at length on disk and tape.
Beloved, my childish ways give way at last
To something hardly different on the mast,
A contemplation of Your providence
By night and day for pound, shilling and
pence.

24 Now when the high priest, who was
chief

Of the temple, chief priests' relief,
Heard these things, they wondered in fact
What the outcome would be to act.

25 So one came and told them, and said
"Look, the men whom you threw instead
In gaol are standing up to teach
In the temple in the folk's reach!"

26 The captain went with officers
And brought them without strength of curs,
Because they were afraid the folk
Would stone them if they laid a stroke.

27 And when they had brought them, they
set

Them before the council when met.
And the high priest asked them, 28 and said
"Did we not straightly say instead
Not to teach in this name? And see,
You've filled Jerusalem to be
With your doctrine, and you will bring
This man's blood on our heads to sting!"

29 But Peter and the other gents
Answered and said "What now prevents
Obeying God rather than men?

30 "The God of our fathers raised up
Jesus whom you murdered like tup
By hanging on a tree. 31 "Him God
Has raised to His right hand in prod
To be both Prince and Saviour and
To give repentance to the land
Of Israel, and yet in hand
Forgiveness of sins as they stand.

32 "And we are his witnesses to
These things, and Holy Spirit too
Whom God gave to those who are true
To obey Him in all they do."

The rulers were not impressed with the tale
Of the escape of Peter from the gaol.
Such never are. They do not see what mail
It takes the prisoner to escape hale.
They're not impressed by human energy
And cunning to set him and others free.
That's why all guns of power must fall at
last.

They disdain power of human hearts to
blast

The chains of fashion and of tyranny.
Beloved, I daily escape powers that be
To find Your face in twig and leaf of tree,
In breath of wind, in the still voice and
small

That echoes in the shining, precious hall
Of my heart sighing ever up to Thee.

33 When they heard it, they had a fit
And planned to kill them in their wit.

34 Then one in the council stood up,
A Pharisee and a hard tup
Named Gamaliel, teacher of
The law and one held in the love
By all the people, and he said
To put the apostles instead
Outside for a moment of dread.

35 And he told them, "Men of Israel,
Think carefully and think a while
Of what you think that you will do
About these men set in their crew.

36 "Some time ago Theudas rose up,
Claiming to be a man and tup.
About four hundred men joined him.
Then he was killed and all the dim
Who obeyed him were scattered and
Came to naught, even the whole band.

37 "After, Judas of Galilee
Arose in the days of the fee,
Attracting many people too.
He also disappeared from view
And all who obeyed him left too.

38 "And now I say to you, refrain
From these men, and leave them to vain,
For if this plot or this work come
From men, it will end in the hum.

39 "But if it is from God, you'll not

Be able to destroy the plot,
 Lest you fight God and so be caught.”
 40 And they agreed with him, and when
 They had called for apostle men
 And beaten them, they ordered they
 Should not speak of the Jesus way,
 And let them go to work and pray.
 41 So they went out from council set
 Rejoicing that they had been met
 Worthy to suffer pain and shame
 In honour of his blessed name.
 42 And in both temple and in each
 House they continued there to teach
 Of Jesus as the Christ and preach.

The argument Gamaliel brought out
 Was one the whole council chose with a
 shout,
 And yet it was based on the holy doubt
 That Jesus was Messiah come with clout.
 What happened to the fear that preaching
 might
 Bring blame upon their heads for right and
 spite?
 It was forgotten in the sacred light
 Of justice mentioned by one man of right.
 In every hall of parliament and king
 There is an agent of the righteous thing,
 One who is there at moment opportune
 To speak a word of faith and hope and
 boon.
 Beloved, I praise You for the justice found
 In those You raise up on the barren ground.

Acts 6

1 Now in those days, when they increased,
 The disciples of the released,
 There came complaint against Hebrews
 By Hellenists among the crews,
 Because their widows were neglected
 In food distributed, selected.
 2 Then the twelve called the multitude
 Of the disciples, told the brood,
 “It's not desirable that we
 Should leave the word of God in fee
 To serve tables from the pantry.
 3 “Therefore, brothers, seek out among
 You seven men of fame and sung,
 Full of the Holy Spirit and
 Wisdom to appoint over manned.
 4 “But we will concentrate now on
 Prayer and word's ministry outdrawn.”

5 The word pleased the whole crowd and
 spawn.
 And they chose Stephen, man of faith
 And Holy Spirit, and no wraith
 Philip, Prochorus, Nicanor,
 Timon, Parmenas, and in store
 Nicolas, a proselyte from
 Antioch, from where he had come,
 6 Whom they set before the apostles,
 And when they had prayed, they with
 jostles
 Laid hands on them, ordained in sum.
 7 Then the word of God spread until
 The number of disciples fill
 Jerusalem, and many priests
 Followed the faith *and all its feasts*.

If twelve were made apostles from the right
 Of Ishmael, son of Abraham in sight,
 And Jacob's sons after that in their light,
 Then it is truly well done that those sat
 To chose out seven more to fill the flat.
 The sacred numbers are made of the three
 And four to bless time and eternity:
 The sevens and the twelves return and
 sound
 The message of Your oneness on the
 ground.
 Beloved, elect me seven words to hear
 Above the twelve I know with love and
 fear,
 And I shall follow every word that's come
 From Your mouth to the world to sing and
 hum.
 Let seven more men or angels appear.

8 And Stephen, full of faith and power,
 Did wonders great and signs to tower
 Among the people. 9 Then arose
 Some from the synagogue that chose
 To be called of the freedmen who
 Where Cyrenians, and a crew
 Of Alexandrians, and those
 From Cilicia and Asia,
 Disputing with Stephen of law.
 10 And they could not resist the way
 Of wisdom and the Spirit's sway
 By which he spoke. 11 And so then they
 In secret got some men to say
 “We've heard him speak blasphemous word
 Against Moses and God occurred.”
 12 They stirred up the folk, elders too,

And scribes and they came not a few
Arresting him, and brought him to
The council. 13 They also set up
False witnesses who said in cup,
“This man does not cease to blaspheme
Against this holy place and dream
Of the law, 14 “for we’ve heard him say
That Jesus of Nazareth’s way
Will destroy this place and change what
Moses delivered to us shut.”
15 And all who sat in council looked
Hard on him, saw his face not brooked
As the face of an angel’s ray.

Was it true that the Hellenizing man,
Stephen was representing some dire plan
To turn the temple over where he ran?
Methinks this is sectarian in plot.
When Pharisees and Sadducees could not
Agree, it spilled into the Christian lot.
Now the destruction that Hellenes have
wrought
Is the suspicion that the Hebrews caught.
No man thinks new things on the road or
land,
No one hears what the others understand,
But draws conclusions based on fear alone,
Attributing the dangers of a stone
To any who might glitter where they’re
thrown.
Beloved, be with the witness in his band.

Acts 7

1 Then the high priest said, “Is this so?”
2 And he said, “Brethren, fathers, lo,
The God of glory appeared to
Our father Abraham *on cue*
In Mesopotamia *there*,
Before he lived in Haran’s *care*,
3 “And said to him, ‘Get out of your
Country and from your family’s store,
And come to a land that I’ll show.’
4 “Then he came out *and came not slow*
Out of the land of the Chaldeans
And lived in Haran *not for eons*.
And from there, when his father died,
He moved him to this land *aside*
In which you now live. 5 “And God gave
Him no inheritance *but grave*
In it, not even *where* to set
His foot on *or his bayonet*.
But even when he had no child,

He promised to give *unbeguiled*
It to him for possession, and
To his descendants after-hand.
6 “But God spoke in this way: that his
Descendants would live *on their biz*
And in a foreign land, and that
They would bring them *from where they sat*
Into bondage and oppress *them*
For four hundred years *and condemn*.
7 ‘And the nation to whom they will
Be in bondage I’ll judge,’ said still
God, ‘and after that they shall come
Out and serve me in this place *mum*.’
8 “Then he gave him the covenant
Of circumcision *commandment*,
And so he produced Isaac and
Circumcised him *as per command*
On the eighth day, and Isaac *then*
Produced Jacob, and Jacob *then*
The twelve patriarchs *among men*.

Who’ve taken the day eight of circumcision
As token of dominical elision
To ignore Sabbath and to celebrate
Their Sundays as something of good and
great,
Are grasping straws, I say, and grasping
fast.
Such arguments are nothing here to last,
But only an excuse to disobey
The word You once pronounced in Sinai’s
way.
If eighth day means the Sunday, then I
guess
The same church disobeys in the address
Of circumcising none upon that score.
The eighth day’s the same day at the next
door
Of week that follows hard upon the birth.
Beloved, I grasp Your word, a thing of
worth.

9 “The patriarchs in envy sold
Joseph into Egypt as bold,
But God was with him 10 “and saved him
From all his troubles grave and grim,
And gave him favour and wisdom
Before Pharaoh, the king to hum
In Egypt, and he made him chief
Of Egypt and his house relief.
11 “Now famine and great trouble came
Over all the Egyptian claim

And Canaan, and our ancestors
 Found no food left in all their stores.
 12 "But when Jacob heard there was grain
 In Egypt, he sent out in main
 Our fathers first. 13 "The second time
 Joseph was made known to his prime
 Brothers, and Joseph's family showed
 Themselves to the Pharaoh who glowed.
 14 "Then Joseph sent and called his dad
 Jacob and all the kin he had,
 Seventy-five people, not bad.
 15 "So Jacob went down to Egypt,
 And he died, and our fathers' crypt.
 16 "They were carried back to Shechem
 And laid in the tomb Abraham
 Bought for a sum of money from
 The sons of Hamor, Shechem's dad.

In Stephen's day the homiletic practice
 Was telling how the ancient days impact
 us,

And how the older patriarchs were set
 To worship You wherever good men met.
 The vivid nursery tale was a thing all,
 Even the elders, were glad to recall.
 No wonder Stephen was a speaker known
 And popular from the court to the throne.
 He started with the common fund of faith
 Uniting man and woman, child and wraith,
 And so disarmed the prejudices till
 He had the listeners agreed on the bill.
 Beloved, give me too such diplomacy
 Before my execution on the tee.

17 "But when the time of promise came
 Near which God had sworn in His name
 To Abraham, the people grew
 And multiplied in Egypt too
 18 "Until another king arose
 Who did not know Joseph by nose.
 19 "This man was vile to our folk and
 Oppressed our ancestors in band,
 Forcing them to expose their spawn,
 Depriving them of life at dawn.
 20 "Then Moses was born, and was well
 Pleasing to God, and he did dwell
 In his father's house for three months.
 21 "But when he was set out, at once
 Pharaoh's daughter took him away
 And brought him up as her own son.
 22 "And Moses was learned in the ray
 Of Egypt's wisdom, and he's done

Great things in words and deeds to stay.
 23 "When he was forty years old, it
 Came into his heart to do fit
 To his brothers, to Israel's folk.
 24 "And seeing one suffer the stroke,
 He defended and avenged him
 Who was oppressed, and struck down grim
 Egyptian. 25 "For he thought his own
 Would have understood God alone
 Would save them by His hand and might,
 But they did not see him aright.

The plan of Moses was to save his folk.
 The plan of his folk was reject the bloke.
 Beloved, I ask if it had been Your way
 To save the people then that very day,
 If they had had the faith to follow then,
 Or was it Your plan to wait years again?
 The evil heart, the fearful heart, the proud
 Comes welling up to steer the wayward
 crowd,

And so it's never know what You'd have
 done
 If they had listened to Your chosen son.
 It may be that the forty years he spent
 In wilderness was futility lent,
 Merely turned to the good. Moses downcast
 Failed even circumcision in the blast.

26 "And the next day he came on two
 Of them as they were fighting too,
 And would make peace among the crew,
 Saying 'Why do you wrong each one
 The other?' 27 "But the one who'd done
 The wrong rejected him to say
 'Who made you ruler and to sway
 Over us in your judgement's pay?'
 28 "Will you kill me as yesterday
 You did the Egyptian?" 29 "At that
 Moses fled to live in the flat
 Of Midian's land, with two sons' hat.

Let me take here a lesson in the truth
 Of justice I've been loving since my youth.
 Never let me speak up for the oppressed
 Or give a hand to the lost and the guest.
 Let me stick to my own in life and deed
 And leave the downtrodden to others'
 greed.

Let me not boast of justice or of reign
 Of hope upon the golden, booted plain.
 Only the hand of power can lift the load,

Only the steeped in gold can raise the goad.
The simple soul that's from birth only
known
The gold of sunrise here before Your
throne
Can never help the helpless. Let alone,
Beloved, the burdened on a burdened road.

30 "And when forty years had passed, then
An Angel of YHWH came again
To him in a flame of fire in
A bush, in the wilderness din
Of Mount Sinai. 31 "When Moses saw,
He was amazed and stood in awe,
And as he came near to gaze, then
The voice of YHWH came once again,
32 "'I am the God of your ancestors:
The God of Abraham and questers
Isaac, and the God of Jacob.'
And Moses trembled at the rub
And so he did not dare to look.
33 'Then the LORD said to him and shook,
'Take sandals off your feet, the place
Where you stand's holy ground *and trace*.

The taking off of shoes is said to be
Mere act of cultural in its decree,
And when we who are not used to the way
Come, we need not remove our shoes to
pray.
If Moses had been just another Slav,
Or German or a Frenchman, would he have
Been still commanded to bare foot and toe?
Or would You have remembered on the go
His culture was a different sort of show?
Or what of those who are too poor to wear
A shoe at all, and must walk with feet bare?
No shoe to take off, can such come before
The holy bush and bow down at its floor
In their attire still secular, adore?

34 "I've surely seen My folk's oppression
Who are in Egypt, heard confession
Of their groaning and have come down
To save them from the wicked town.
So come now, I will send you to
Egypt to save the holy crew.'
35 "This Moses whom they had rejected,
Saying 'Who made you one selected
To rule and judge?' is the one God
Sent ruler and saviour on sod
By hand of the angel who showed

Himself upon the bush that glowed.

The men who listened to Stephen's good
word
Were not too stupid to know what they
heard.
They knew that he meant Israel in old time
Rejected Moses in his fame and prime,
And so God gave them instead of the great,
A shepherd bent with age and desert mate.
The failure now to take Christ and his hand
He makes the same as that in Canaan's
land,
And criticizes ruler man and priest
For failing to rejoice in the increased.
Beloved, I know the Scriptures are so near
And full that they can be made to appear
Supporting every argument of man.
So what of Stephen's words in Your own
plan?

36 "He brought them out, after he'd shown
Wonders and signs before the throne
Of Egypt, and in the Red Sea,
And in the wilderness to be
For forty years. 37 "This is that one
Moses who said to the folk won
Of Israel, 'The LORD your God
Will raise up for you with a prod
A Prophet like me from your kin.
Him you shall hear and you will win.'

Here Stephen tries to show that Jesus is
The one Moses predicted in his fizz,
A prophet like him, bold and brazen too,
To lead the folk of Israel, the whole crew.
But when I read the story writ of old,
Methinks the one of whom Moses had told
Was answer to his prayer for leadership,
And Joshua's that answer, and was hip
To bring the folk into Palestine's shore
And show them where to live and to adore.
Beloved, though prophecy is called around
To double service on the fainting ground,
That doubling and manipulating sound
Raises more doubt in me than any found.

38 "This is he who with desert folk
And with the angel there who spoke
To him on Mount Sinai, and with
Our own ancestors, who received
The living oracles unsleeved

To give to us, 39 "whom our ancestors
Would not obey, but left as pesters.
And in their hearts they turned around
To go back to Egyptian ground,
40 "Saying to Aaron, 'Make us gods
To go before us, as with rods
For this Moses who brought us out
Of the land of Egyptian flout,
We do not know where he has gone.'
41 "And they made a calf like a pawn
In those days, offered sacrifice
To the image, and thought them nice,
The works of their own hands and drawn.

When Stephen stated that the golden calf
Was work of human hand, I have to laugh.
When Aaron, who was there, came to
explain,
He said it just stepped out upon the plain
From the fire and the melting pot to show
The people there the fine Egyptian glow.
Work of the hand of Aaron, doubtless it
Required a pretty job to make it fit.
And yet in modesty Aaron replied
That the gold itself had given a ride.
Gold is the flesh of gods in every place,
And human hands love to touch it and trace
Eternal wealth and life beneath the row
Of handled grace upon the guilding side.

42 "God turned and gave them up to serve
The host of heaven and to swerve,
As it is written in the book
Of prophets, 'Did you ever look
To offer to Me slaughtered beast
And sacrifice during the feast
Of forty years in wilderness,
O house of Israel, confess?
43 "You also took up in your right
The tent of Moloch in My sight,
And the star of your god Remphan,
Images which you made in plan
To worship, so I'll carry you
Away beyond Babylon's view.'

The host of heaven are the gods of late
Who manage from old times the things of
state
In every empire of the ages free,
And they return to rule eternally.
The host of heaven, the sundisc of the right
In the Egyptian modes of bovine fright,

And Moloch whose firm arms with heart
allow
The burning of the sacrificial how,
Call still the fractured farms society
To war and peace beside the money tree.
Beloved, deliver not my soul to rest
Within the treasured temples of the best,
But rather in the desert burnt and still
To come before Your throne upon Your
hill.

44 "Our fathers had the tabernacle
Of testimony in debacle
Of wilderness, as He appointed,
Instructing Moses as anointed
To make it according to plan
And pattern that he came to scan,
45 "Which our ancestors, in their turn,
Inherited and brought to learn
With Joshua into the land
Possessed by the Gentiles that stand,
Whom God drove out before the face
Of our ancestors in the race
Until the days of David's grace
Before God, and asked then to find
A dwelling place for Jacob's God.
47 "But Solomon built Him aligned
A house. 48 "However, on the sod
The Most High does not live in such
Temples made with hands and to touch,
As the prophet says: 49 'Heaven's My
throne,
And earth's My footstool. What house stone
Will you build for me? says the LORD,
Or what's place of My rest restored?
50 Has My hand not made all these
stored?'

The earthly tent may seem too small for
You,
The universe itself, if I be true,
Cannot contain the fullness of You where
You pause upon the universal stair.
The sanctuary writ upon the sky,
The tattered cloth of temenos to try,
None of these things suffice to hold Your
throne,
While You rise greater than all things of
stone.
Beloved, the only temple where You dwell
With room for all Your attributes in spell
Is that heart human You created well

To bear the I-ness that spoke Israfel,
The consciousness of being God apart
From all the plasters of the falsar start.

51 "You stiffnecked and uncircumcised
In heart and ears! You always prized
Resistance to the Holy Ghost,
As did your fathers, so you boast.
52 "Which of the prophets did your dads
Not persecute? And on their pads
They killed those who foretold the coming
Of the Just One, of whom you're humming
As those who betrayed him and killed,
53 "Who have received the law fulfilled
By the hand of angels and not
Observed it on the hallowed spot."

Be not surprised that humans come to kill
The very ones who speak in Your voice
still.
You placed within the human breast the
beat
Of I-awareness on the scattered street.
It's only natural each heart with that sound
Finds blasphemous the other on the round.
For You are one and there's no other god,
And yet that fact is known upon the sod
By all the millions who participate
In that great godhead of the heathen state.
The secret knowledge is that You alone
Exist to sit upon the divine throne,
And we who fight are just reflections here
Of the divinity beyond the ear.

54 When they heard these things they were
cut
To the heart, and they gnashed in strut
Against him with their teeth in glut.
55 But he, full of the Holy Spirit,
Gazed into heaven and saw there near it
The glory of God, and Jesus
Standing at the right glorious
Hand of God, 56 and said, "Look! I see
The heavens opened and degree
Of Son of Man standing beside
God's right hand, *though these folk
deride!*"

It may be blasphemy in priestly ear
To hear that I stand as a man appear
At the right hand of Your throne to relate
The human sort of knowing of the state.

It may be blasphemy for Jesus Christ
To split the atom and raise the dead triced,
But still the vision has an hour and day
And floats upon the mellowed beacon's ray.
Beloved, the heaven's have been open since
Fair Stephen felt the blows begin to wince,
And glory has been pouring on the ground
While many wander without hearing sound
But only take the daily task and grind
Without the brightness of the gloried mind.

57 Then they cried out with a loud voice,
And stopped their ears, and took the choice
To run to his attack together,
58 And they threw him out of town
whether

They would stone him to death at last.
And witnesses laid down and cast
Their clothes at the feet of a young
Man named Saul who had a glib tongue.
59 And they stoned Stephen as he called
Out saying "Lord Jesus installed,
Receive my spirit from the walled."
60 Then he knelt down, cried with a loud
Voice, "Lord, do not leave them endowed
With this sin." And so saying he
Fell sleeping in eternity.

Lord Jesus takes my spirit day to day
And hides it with his loving sort of way
Behind the spirits seven that infest
The altars in the sky that lie the rest.
Lord Jesus has gone up into the sky
To watch the centuries in flight pass by,
But when he is not bored with what he
sees,
He bends down to remark upon the breeze.
I lay my clothes at the feet of the man
Who stands collecting shoes under the scan
Of the mosque door, and enter in by plan
To bow down nude before the minbar sore,
And find the outraged worshippers take me
And throw me from the carpet turbidly.

Acts 8

1 And Saul consented to his death.
At that time there arose the breath
Of a great persecution of
The group of called out ones in love
Which was at Jerusalem, and
They were all scattered in the land
Of Judea and Samaria,

Except for the apostles' stand.
2 And devout men carried Stephen
Away making lament again.
3 As for Saul, he made havoc of
The group of called out ones to shove
In every house, and dragging off
Both men and women by the scroff
To prison where to share their love.

The Roman Catholic Church did not invent
The Inquisition, though they may have
meant.

It was an institution known in time,
Which Saint Paul himself worked in
shameful crime.

If Saul turned from his evil way to make
His restitution for the Saviour's sake,
His heart seems not to have been in the
wake,

To judge by those who followed him to
bake.

Beloved, let me turn every coward out
Of my heart that lusts for the knot and
clout,

Until my temple is laid bare to You,
And nothing of such power comes to view.
Beloved, let me once cleansed not take the
rope

And banish other men from light and hope.

4 So those scattered went everywhere
To preach the word. 5 Then Philip's share
Was to Samarian town where
He preach Christ to them and with care.

6 The multitudes with one accord
Regarded what Philip in horde
Spoke, and heard and saw all the great
Signs and wonders he did in state.

7 For unclean spirits, crying loud,
Came out of many they had cowed,
And many who were paralysed
And lame were healed in holy guise.

8 And there was great joy in that town.

9 There was a certain man's renown
Called Simon, who before had done
His sorcery in the town's stun
And amazed the Samarian folk,
Claiming that he was a great bloke,

10 To whom they all gave heed, from least
To the greatest, saying unceased,
"This man is the great power of God."

11 They listened to him and his prod

Because he had amazed them long
With his sorceries which were strong.

12 But when they believed Philip's word
As he preached the things that they heard
Of the kingdom of God and name
Of Jesus Christ, both men that came
And women were baptised in herd.

13 Then Simon himself too believed,
And when he was baptised achieved
To stay with Philip, he was filled
With his amazement to be billed
To see the miracles and signs
That were done by Philip's designs.

If things that Philip did by Your permission
And power gained such a local recognition,
I'd think that after such a great ignition
Today all things would have turned bright
and new,

All illness would be hardly minded, few
Would suffer, and the world would be a
great

And wondered kingdom of the good in rate.
If things happened then to predict the state.

But everywhere I turn, the ones who heal
By faith turn out to be hypocrite's peel,
And charlatans alone are filled to seal
The Holy Ghost and touch the leper's pate.
Beloved, I'd love to see the cunning mate
Who can deliver on the promised reel.

14 Now when apostles who were at
Jerusalem heard that the fat
Samaria'd received the word
Of God, they sent Peter and stirred
John to them, 15 who, when they had come
Prayed for them to receive the hum
Of Holy Spirit. 16 For as yet
It had fallen upon none set.

They had only been baptized in
The name of the Lord Jesus win.

17 Then they laid hands on them, and they
Received the Holy Spirit's sway.

18 And when Simon saw that the laying
On of apostles' hands was paying
The Holy Spirit, he too offered
Them money, 19 saying "Give me
proffered

This power also, so the one
On whom I lay hands will have won
The Holy Spirit." 20 Peter said
"Your money perish with your head,

Because you thought the gift of God
Could be bought with money in pod!

21 "You've neither part nor portion here,
For your heart is not right in fear
Of God. 22 "Repent therefore of this
Your wickedness, pray God remiss
If maybe the thought of your heart
May be forgiven for your part.
23 "For I see that you're poisoned by
Bitterness and iniquity."

24 Then Simon answered and said, "Pray
To YHWH for me, that what you say
May not come on me any day."

25 So when they'd testified and preached
The word of YHWH, they came and
reached

Jerusalem, preaching the plans
In towns of the Samaritans.

For centuries the blame lies on the man
Simon for trying to buy up the ban,
For hoping he might have the power to heal
Instead of merely fooling prince appeal.
But Simon's a man after my own heart.
I'd give my fortune to just have a part
That played the good physician from the
start.

I'd touch the sick and quietly retreat,
Leaving behind me health and wealth to
eat.

I give each man and daughter by my touch
The blessings that I read about so much.
But I know that if I should find that spring
Of healing and spread quietly the thing,
Like Simon, I'd meet hatred on the wing.

26 An angel of YHWH spoke to Philip,
Saying, "Get up and go the hill up
Toward the south along the road
Down from Jerusalem to goad
Gaza." This is a desert load.

27 So he got up and went his way.
See a man of Ethiopia,
A eunuch of authority
Under Candace the queen to be
Of the Ethiopians fee,
Who had charge of her treasury,
And had come to Jerusalem
To worship there by stratagem,
28 And was returning. As he sat
In his chariot on his mat,
He read Isaiah's prophecy.

29 The Spirit said to Philip, "See,
Go near and overtake this car."

30 So Philip ran to him afar,
And heard him read the prophet star
Isaiah, and said, "Do you know
And understand the reading's show?"

31 And he said "How can I, unless
Someone guides me, except to guess?"
And he asked Philip to come up
And sit with him and share his cup.

I read Your word revealed, Beloved, and
know

That it is clear to me because I go
To heaven-sent, appointed guides instead
Of priest or mullah to find out Your will.
The Ethiopian officer that read
The prophet's script and wondered reading
still

Could not know what its meaning was until
He found a guide by whom he might be
led.

How can I know Your meaning then as I
Peruse the sacred text with whirl and cry?
The forties turn and sevens show the way,
The Master of the Age must have his say.
What spirit then will whirl him into view
To show that You are One and what to do?

32 The place in Scripture which he read
Was this: "He was as a sheep led
To slaughter, as a lamb before
Its shearer is silent in store,
So he did not open his lips.
33 In his humiliation's sips
His justice was taken away,
And who'll declare his family's day?
His life is taken from the earth."

34 The eunuch said for Philip's worth,
"I ask you, of whom does this man
The prophet say this, of himself
Or of some other man or elf?"

35 Then Philip opened up his mouth,
And starting at this Scripture south,
Preached Jesus to him. 36 Now as they
Went down the road, they came to stay
Near to some water. Eunuch said,
"See, here is water. As I'm led
What hinders me being baptised?"

37 Then Philip said "If you're apprised
Of faith with all your heart, you may."
And he answered and said that day,

“I do believe that Jesus Christ
Is Son of God [Messiah priced].”
38 So he commanded the car stopped.
And both Philip and eunuch mopped
Down in the water, he baptised
Him. 39 Now when they came up revised
Out of the water, YHWH's Spirit
Caught Philip away from the kit,
So the eunuch saw him no more,
But went on his way as before,
Rejoicing. 40 But Philip was found
At Azotus. And passing round,
He preached in all the cities till
He came to Caesarean hill.

Whether it was a word added to share
Or not, the beauty of the right to bear
The burden to the flood, to dip into
The cleansing water, is no thing to rue.
The Ethiopian can change no skin,
But You, Beloved, deliver from all sin
Those who require the word be read aright
To lead them in the good and ample light.
Beloved, baptise me now once more and
make

My life a cleaner place in waters' wake,
And I shall rise up from the flood and see
No man remaining to comfort, cheer me
Except invisibly You on Your throne,
Who are my light and love, and You alone.

Acts 9

1 Then Saul, still breathing threats and
murder

Against the Lord's disciples further,
Went to the high priest 2 and asked letters
From him to the synagogues' fetters
Of Damascus, so that if he
Found any who were of the wee
Way, whether men or women, he
Might bring them to Jerusalem.
3 As he journeyed in stratagem
He came near to Damascus, and
Suddenly a light shone round grand
From the sky. 4 He fell to the ground,
And heard a voice relaying round,
“Saul, Saul, why persecute you me?”
5 And he said “Who are you, sir, see?”
Then the lord said, “I'm Jesus, whom
You persecute. It's hard in room
For you to kick against the goads.”
6 So he, trembling, amazed for loads,

Said, “Sir, what would you have me do?”
Then the lord said to him in view,
“Get up and go into the town,
And you will be told without frown
The very thing that you must do.”

Is vision personal really a thing
Worth following in face of every fling
The public opinion may raise and flail?
I doubt the vision personal is hale.
Be true to self's truism without fail,
And yet the very tongue that fosters it,
When faced with the lone wolf, will throw
a fit.

It's leadership instead that wins the day
And praise on and off the Damascus way.
The selfish pride of leadership is sold
To public opinion, leaves in the cold
Ingenious insights, to order the troop
Of ovine followers who cough and poop,
And prance about the ring, jump through
the hoop.

7 And the men who journeyed with him
Stood speechless, hearing a sound dim
But seeing no one in their vim.

8 Then Saul got up from off the ground,
And when his eyes were opened round
He saw no one. But they led him
By the hand and also brought him
Into Damascus safe and trim.

9 And he was three days without sight,
And neither ate nor drank a bite.

The one who sees a vision on the road,
An insight of reality unstowed,
Must rise up blind to all that others see.
That is a rule of insight's minstrelsy.
Beloved, give me no visions where men
ride

Across the dusty plain here at my side.
Let me not see the angels that surround
The havens of both wall and tree and
ground.

Let me not know the glories that remain
Upon my head where laurels have not lain.
Let me stay with the mediocre crowd
In comfort, where no still small voice aloud
Can turn me from the pottage to the meat
Of the celestial nectar for a treat.

10 Now there was a certain disciple

At Damascus named Ananias,
 And to him the lord said in grieve
 And in a vision, "Ananias."
 And he said "Here I am, Lord by us."
 11 So the lord said to him, "Arise
 And go to the street called Straight prize,
 And ask at the house of Judas
 For a man called Saul of Tarsus,
 For indeed, he is praying thus.
 12 "And in a vision he has seen
 A man named Ananias deem
 To come in and put his hand on
 Him, so he might receive sight's dawn."
 13 Then Ananias answered, "Lord,
 I've heard from many and deplored
 About this man, how much harm he
 Has done to your saints in degree
 There in Jerusalem. 14 "And here
 He has authority to steer
 From the chief priests to bind all who
 Call on your name, sit in your pew."
 15 But the lord said to him, "Go, for
 He is a chosen vessel store
 Of mine to bear my name before
 Gentiles, kings, and Israel's folk more.
 16 "For I'll show him how many things
 He must suffer for my name's stings."

This Ananias is a man replete
 With the same kind of heart that is my seat.
 When You give him a word, he answers
 back
 As though the King of Universe in stack
 Could be informed by one small man in
 lack.
 He braves the infinite in power and stall,
 And questions Your commands before the
 ball.
 No reverence makes his pious pate appear
 Before You quivering with sight and fear.
 Beloved, treat me like this my brother met
 In far Damascus, when I have bone set
 To doubt Your words as human sayings
 yet.
 Be patient with me as You were with him,
 Maybe like him I shall obey with vim.

17 And Ananias went his way
 And entered the house, where he'd lay
 His hands on him, he said "Dear Saul,
 Brother, the Lord Jesus did call
 To you on the road as you came,

Though only you could see the flame,
 And sent me so you may receive
 Your sight and be filled with reprieve
 Of Holy Spirit." 18 Straight away
 There fell from his eyes like scales stay,
 And he received his sight at once,
 Got up and was baptised for stunts.
 19 So when he had received food, he
 Was strengthened. Then Saul spent freely
 Some days with the disciples at
 Damascus. 20 Straight away at that
 He preached Christ in the synagogues,
 That he's the Son of God [Messiah].
 21 Then all who heard were amazed frogs,
 And said "Is this not the pariah
 Who destroyed those who called on this
 Name in Jerusalem to kiss,
 And has come here for that purpose,
 So that he might bring them bound to
 The chief priests in hullabaloo?"
 22 But Saul increased the more in strength,
 And confounded the Jews at length
 Who lived in Damascus, and proved
 That this was the Christ he behoved.

The meaning of baptism in the book
 Of Acts is more than taking just a look
 At life eternal that's sold in the nook
 Of Jesus having been raised from the grave.
 It means to recant from being a slave
 To the establishment of priestly rave,
 And from the paid job of the temple court,
 And from the safe and human sort of port.
 The meaning of baptism here is set
 Established as for Jesus, when he met
 The dove of Your own power and spirit yet
 Descending on the head of small and true,
 By-passing all the golden temple crew.
 Baptism is a spirit thing in view.

23 Now after many days were past,
 The Jews plotted to kill at last.
 24 But their plot became known to Saul.
 And they watched the gates to appal
 Both day and night, to kill and maul.
 25 Then the disciples took him out
 By night and let him down throughout
 The wall in a large basket stout.
 26 When Saul came to Jerusalem,
 He tried to join disciples' hem,
 But they were all afraid of him,
 And did not believe he was trim.

27 But Barnabas took him and brought
Him to the apostles he sought.

Of all apostles Barnabas was most
Fearless and honourable, the perfect host.
He took Saul when rejected by the others
And held him dear and close as would be
brothers.

Musahiblik was thus confirmed by him
Who shared with Saul both food and life
and limb,
And took David's and Jonathan's example,
And gave a partner's witness true and
ample.

Let me too set aside, relinquish all
The prejudice of label and the pall
Of crass traditions that enslave the soul.
Let me look past the garment and the bowl
To see in each the one and only me
That is foundation of the Deity.

And he declared to them how he
Had seen the Lord on the road free,
And that he had spoken to him,
And how he had preached bold and trim
At Damascus and in the name
Of Jesus. 28 So he came to claim
With them at Jerusalem, and
To come and go out in the land.
29 And he spoke boldly in the name
Of the Lord Jesus just the same
Disputing with the Hellenists,
But they tried to kill him *with fists*.

30 When the brothers found out, they
brought

Him down to Caesarea sought
And sent him out to Tarsus wrought.

31 Then the groups of called out ones
through

All Judea, Galilee too,
And Samaria had peace and
Were edified upon the land.
And walking in the fear of YHWH
And in the comfort that's in view
Of Holy Spirit, so they grew.

If only ranging killers now who roam
Jerusalem in name of sacred home
Could once be pacified like good St. Paul,
Who used to satisfy the urge and call
To slaughter with a bill signed legally
To execute the lovely and lowly,

Then there could be a comfort yet around
The Palestinian towns on the ground.
It's not political or military
Solutions needed for the broom and cherry,
But rather men with vision of the wary,
The vision of the peace that can be found
When all or many have respect around
Your holy name, the holy self abound.

32 It happened now as Peter went
Through all the land, that he was sent
Down to the saints who did present
In Lydda. 33 There he found a man
Named Aeneas, who had in span
Of eight years been bedridden and
Was paralysed. 34 And Peter said
To him, "Aeneas, Jesus Christ
Heals you. Get up and make your bed."
Then he got up and in a trice.
35 So all who lived at Lydda and
Sharon saw and turned to YHWH's hand.

Beloved, I've read translating Your word
from

The first pages of Genesis in sum,
And always was familiar with the plot
Of what I read until this very spot.
How is it that in fifty years of reading,
I had missed this small story of good
breeding?

My mind was wandering at the moment
when

I read it earlier, or then forgot.
Beloved, I make my way here among men
Who go unnoticed, perhaps because I
Am caught up in the glories of the sky.
We go unhealed, both he and I and all
Who miss the meeting and familiar call
To low unknowingly within the stall.

36 At Joppa lived a certain lady
Who was a disciple not shady,
Named Tabitha, which is translated
Dorcas. This woman was elated
To do good works of charity.

37 But it occurred in those days that
She fell ill and died on her mat.
When they'd washed her, they laid her out
In a second-floor room about.

38 And since Lydda was near Joppa,
And the disciples heard with awe
That Peter was there, they sent two

Men to him, imploring not to
Delay in coming in their view.
39 Peter got up and went with them.
When he had come, they brought in hem
Of the second-floor room in crew.
And all the widows stood by him
And wept, and showed the tunics trim
And garments which Dorcas had made
While she was with them where they
stayed.

40 But Peter put them all out, and
Knelt down and prayed upon the sand.
And turning to the body said
“Tabitha, get up from your bed.”
And she opened her eyes, and when
She saw Peter, sat up again.
41 Then he gave her his hand and lifted
Her up, and when he had been gifted
To call the saints and widows, he
Presented her alive and free.
42 And it became known through the town
Of Joppa, and many a clown
Believed on the lord without frown.
43 So it was that he stayed some days
In Joppa with Simon, in praise
For being a tanner in ways.

How many ladies I have known who share
The mind of Dorcas in the way they care
For those around them! I've seen many
make
The garments for the poor, I've seen them
shake
The mills so greedily gathered to take
The chill from hovels where the orphans lie
And cough before the fire, and yet not die.
The good in this world's done by simple
folk
Who in their humble ways, stroke after
stroke,
Beat on the granite mountain heart of man,
And fail to change the world. But in their
plan,
They change the life of this poor child or
that,
And leave the rule of earth to great and fat.
Beloved, I wonder where justice is at.

Acts 10

1 There was a certain man who lived
In Caesarea called and sieved
Cornelius, centurion

Of the Italian Regiment,
As it was called and it was drawn
In every city, every tent,
2 A devout man, one who feared God
With all his household on the sod,
Who gave alms freely to the folk,
And prayed to God always and spoke.

Fasting and pilgrimage are all that's left
To make Cornelius one not bereft
Of the five virtues the first century
Called in to play, avoiding heresy.
Devout he was, and that may truly mean
He fasted twice a week as all had seen.
He may have been to visit in the court
Or Gentiles in the temple for his sport.
Beloved, if fearing You and giving alms
Unites with prayer and without any qualms
Being a man devout, let me join him,
Though he was just uncircumcised and
dim.
There's always time for bustle and for trim,
And for a rest beneath the rough-leaved
palms.

3 About the ninth hour of the day
He saw clearly in vision's sway
An angel of God coming in
And saying to him in a din,
“Cornelius!” 4 And when he saw
Him he was filled with fear and awe,
And said “What is it, sir?” So he
Said to him, “Your prayers and your alms
Have come up for a memory's palms
Before God. 5 “Now send men to Joppa,
And send for Simon Peter *hopper*,
As he is called. 6 “He's lodging there
With Simon, a tanner, whose share
Is by the sea. he'll tell you what
You must do.” 7 When the angel shut
Who spoke to him had gone away,
Cornelius called two servants' pay
And a devout soldier from those
Who waited on him there as chose.
8 So when he had explained all things
To them, he sent to Joppa's springs.

I wonder how Cornelius may have known
It was an angel came to him alone.
Perhaps it was the Pharisaic wings
That fluttered all around celestial springs

That made him know the messenger had
come
From heights above the human sort of sum.
Perhaps it was the shining of the skin
That covered face and made him think him
kin

To airy and light beings silken thin.
If I am ever taught beyond the leaf,
To see a speaking angel to my grief,
Let it be one who has a faithful word
To bring to me to make my heart one
stirred.
Then I shall shape the angel from the herd.

9 The next day, as they went their way
And came near to the city's stay,
Peter went to housetop to pray,
About the sixth hour of the day.

10 And he was hungry, he would eat,
But while they were cooking the treat,
He fell into a trance 11 and saw
The heavens opened and a thing
Like a great sheet tied up with string
At the four corners, coming down
To him toward the earth in frown.

12 In it there were all kinds of beasts,
Four-footed animals for feasts
Upon the earth, wild ones and those
That creep and birds of air in rows.

13 And a voice came to him, "Get up,
Peter, slaughter and eat like tup."

14 But Peter said "Not so, sir! I
Have never eaten on the sly
Anything common or unclean."

15 And a voice spoke to him again
The second time, "What God has cleaned
You must not call common unscreened."

16 This was done three times. And the
thing

Was taken up to the sky's ring.

The Christian sort of dummy makes this
text
Excuse for eating trash and unperplexed.
It's sure the import of the vision sweet
Was not the kind or not the kind of meat
That Peter and all later had to eat.
It had to do with verdicts that relay
That some men are too defiled in their way
To join in conversation at a meal.
There are still Muslim groupies who still
feel

That contact with a pagan sort of man
Defiles believers in the divine plan.
Beloved, let me take from the lesson taught
The right of human cleansing in the plot,
And leave dead dogs uneaten where they
rot.

17 While Peter wondered to himself
What this vision should mean on shelf,
The men sent from Cornelius came
To ask for Simon's house of fame,
And stood before the gate as tame.

18 And they called and asked whether
Simon,

Whose surname was Peter, if why, man,
He had been staying there in frame.

19 While Peter thought about the sight,
The Spirit said to him in light,
"Indeed, three men are seeking you.

20 "Get up therefore, go down in view
And go with them, and doubting nought,
For I have sent them in their lot."

This only goes to show in mystic vein
How vision as exterior and plain
Is for the mere beginner in the weal.
The true adept needs no sight at the heel,
But can remember what the Spirit speaks
In intellectual sights' hide and seeks.
Interior in vision in degree
Is also available in the spree.
Beloved, I need no angel vision nor
The Spirit teaching me beside the door.
I rather hunger for the closer kiss
Of the divine I breathe and fail to miss.
Let sight and wonder sleep beneath the
load,

But let me linger on the finer road.

21 Then Peter went down to the men
Who had been sent to him again
From Cornelius, and said, "Yes, I
Am he whom you seek. Now then why
Have you come?" 22 And they said, "The
man

Cornelius the centurion,
A just man, one who fears God and
Has good report among the brand
Of the Jews, was given the planned
Divine by a holy angel
To call you to his house a spell,
And to hear words from you as well."

If anybody comes to me to say
 An angel sent him on the holy way
 To hear the message that I might relay,
 I'll be sure not to open up my door.
 I've got enough to deal with on the shore
 Of frozen lake and lamplight I ignore.
 If anybody comes to tell me that
 An angel sent him, I'll send him out flat.
 Beloved, the angels that peck on the glass
 Of winter windows ice-flowered in the pass
 Are sprightly, it is true, but none require
 The sending to another house afire.
 The raven and the sparrow are in class
 Beyond the pigeons in their lovely mire.

23 Then he invited them inside
 And asked them there and to abide.
 On the next day Peter went off
 With them, and some brothers to doff
 From Joppa went with him to ride.
 24 And the next day they entered in
 Caesarea. Now Cornelius
 Was waiting for them, and with fuss
 Had called together all his kin
 As well as friends to hear the din.
 25 As Peter came in, Cornelius
 Met him and fell down at his feet
 And bowed before him in retreat.
 26 But Peter lifted him up, saying,
 "Stand up, I'm also a man swaying."

Though fervent and ready to join the
 church,
 These Gentiles have an attitude to smirch.
 The first thing they would do is worship
 men,
 And have to be corrected once again.
 That posture has not ended, no, not in
 The flight of centuries of Gentile sin
 Caught and taught from the pulpit and the
 din
 Of Christian worship's own hymnodic kin.
 Beloved, let me bow if I must to You,
 But not to any other in the pew,
 Not even Jesus Christ, one thought as God
 To bring the brow of faithful to the sod.
 Beloved, let me bow in the dust and view
 Of You alone among the peas in pod.

27 And as he talked with him, he went
 In and found many come as sent.

28 Then he said to them, "You know how
 Unlawful it is for the brow
 Of Jewish man to keep in crowd
 Or go around with those allowed
 From other nations. But God's shown
 Me that I should not call, condone
 Any man common or unclean.
 29 "Therefore I came as you have seen
 As soon as I was sent to lean.
 I ask then why you sent for me."
 30 Cornelius said "Four days ago
 When I was fasting at this hour,
 And at the ninth hour in my bower
 I prayed in my house, and indeed,
 A man stood before me in weed
 Of shining clothing, 31 "and he said,
 'Cornelius, your prayer has been led,
 And your alms are remembered in
 The sight of God. 32 'So send to win
 From Joppa Simon, whose surname
 Is Peter. He's lodging in same
 House of Simon, a tanner, by
 The sea. When he comes, he'll reply.'
 33 "So I sent to you straight away,
 And you've done well to come to stay.
 So now we're all here before God,
 To hear all by command of rod."

A light's about to come on in the mind
 Of Peter to see Gentiles good and kind
 Are just as ready to be taken in
 By You as Jews who have given up their
 sin.

The concept of the ummah is a thing
 Perennial among the human sting,
 And thinking that a man is unclean for
 The country that he comes from is a lore
 That is reborn in every sort of state
 Where pride awakens fast not to be late.
 Beloved, the whole humanity's unclean
 For thought and deed, though words cannot
 be seen.

Beloved, the whole humanity is here
 In pristine show of witness to the clear.

34 Then Peter opened mouth and said
 "In truth I see that God instead
 Does not show partiality.
 35 "But of each nationality
 Any who fears Him and does right,
 He is accepted in His sight.
 36 "The word He sent to Israel's folk,

Preaching peace through Jesus Christ's
stroke,
Who is the lord of every bloke,
37 "That word you know, which was
proclaimed

Throughout all Judaea and famed,
And began from Galilee when
John had preached baptism again,
38 "How God anointed Jesus then
Of Nazareth with Holy Spirit
And with power, who went round or near it
To do good and to heal all who
Were oppressed by what devils do,
For God was with him in his pew.

No doubt good Peter would have told the
truth
About the Lord Jesus Christ from his
youth,

That he is God Almighty and with ruth,
But he feared that the pagan sort of wit
Would just acknowledge him to stand or sit
With the whole pantheon of kin and kit.
No, I'm just cynical. This verse is true
To show that Jesus Christ is just not You.
He was anointed by You, he was sent
To heal and do good things that You had
meant.

And last it says that You were with the guy,
Which means You're two distinct bodies to
fly.

No doubt good Peter told the truth that he
Was not the same person as Yours truly.

39 "And we are witnesses of all
Things which he did both in the thrall
Of the Jews and Jerusalem,
Whom they killed by hanging on hem
Of a tree. 40 "Him God raised up on
The third day, and showed him to dawn,
41 "Not to all the folk, but to some
Witnesses chosen by God's hum,
Even to us who ate and drank
With him after he rose from dank
Tomb of the dead. 42 "And he commanded
Us to preach to the people landed,
And to bear witness that it's he
Who was ordained by God to be
Judge of the living and the dead.
43 "To him all the prophets have said
That through his name, those who believe
In him will forgiveness receive."

The scandal of the cross is not so much
The fact they killed an innocent to touch,
Nor that it was a painful death and charged
With lies compounded falsely and
enlarged.

The scandal was not so much that the way
Was a betrayal of both land and day,
And even of one of the twelve for pay.
The scandal of the cross was more to find
In the fact that those who looked on were
blind

To the love that the dying man looked on,
Finding in every face around, both pawn
And soldier and haughty centurion on,
Reflection of Your face. Each human face
Looked with Your eyes, and yet the fatal
trace.

44 While Peter was still speaking these,
The Holy Spirit fell with ease
Upon all those who heard the word.

45 And those of the circumcised herd
Who believed were amazed and stirred,
All those who came in Peter's crew,
Because of the gift come in view
Of the Holy Spirit poured out
On the Gentiles also to flout.

46 For they heard them speak with tongues
and

Magnify God upon the land.

Then Peter answered, 47 "Can a man
Forbid water, that these in span
Should not be baptized who have got
The Holy Spirit like our plot?"

48 And he commanded them to be
Baptized in the Lord's name in fee.
Then they asked him to stay freely
A few days in their home and lot.

Baptism seems to have been in the thought
Of some and sundry privilege when sought
By Jew and circumcised. The wonder got
An upper hand when spirit graced the band
And spoke with every tongue found in the
land.

I speak in tongues as many as the rank
And guile around me, in both mart and
bank,

And yet baptisms fail on sunny days,
And I find myself trucked in humble praise,

The smaller speech of wind and bumble
bee,
The twitter of the fowl and crickety
About the dooryard. Let no god hear me
And half-grant half-request and let me fall
Into my own well with roof but not wall.

Acts 11

1 Now the apostles and the brothers
Who were in Judaea like others
Heard that the Gentiles had also
Received the word of God in show.
2 When Peter sought Jerusalem,
The circumcised crew, all of them,
Contended with him, 3 as they said
“You went with uncircumcised bred
And even ate with them instead!”

I do confess this gross sin on my part
Of eating bread with uncircumcised heart.
Uncircumcision is the local bill,
And hardly any others come to fill
Their baskets at my table, nor do I
Find circumcised at table though I try.
The last laugh is that knives today are not
So sharp as old flint ones of ancient plot,
And so I ask if any stone unspurned
Is better than the steel blades I have
learned.

The letter of the paw falls back upon
The piercing and the slicing of the dawn,
And when all's done and said, the race is
drawn

For what some have not bled and others
earned.

4 But Peter explained it to them
As it had happened from the start,
Saying 5 “I was in town apart
In Joppa praying, and in trance
I saw a vision and a dance
Of something coming like a sheet
Down from the sky, corners in pleat,
And it arrived beside my seat.
6 “I looked at it and thought about it,
I saw four-footed beasts to rout it,
Wild things, and creeping things and birds
Of the air. 7 “And I heard like herds
A voice that said to me, ‘Get up,
Peter, and slaughter, fill your cup.’
8 “But I said, ‘Not so, Lord! For naught
Of common or unclean in time

Has entered in my mouth for crime.’
9 “But the voice answered me again
From heaven, ‘What God has now then
Cleansed you must not call common men.’
10 “Now this was done three times, and all
Were drawn up once more in heaven's hall.
11 “At that very moment, three men
Stood before the house of my den,
Being sent from Caesarea
To me. 12 “The Spirit then of awe
Told me to go with them, nor doubt.
Moreover these six brothers stout
Went with me and we came into
The man's house, I and all the crew.
13 “And he told us how he had seen
An angel standing in between
His house, who said to him, ‘Send men
To Joppa, and call for Simon
Whose surname's Peter, 14 ‘who will tell
You words by which you and all then
Of your household will be saved well.’
15 “As I began to speak, the Holy
Spirit fell upon them, as rolly
As on us at the start, by golly.
16 “Then I remembered the Lord's word,
How he said ‘John indeed was stirred
To baptize with water, but you
Shall be baptized with sacred dew
Of Holy Spirit.’ 17 “If therefore
God gave them the same gift in store
As to us when we believed in
The Lord Christ Jesus, who could win
Against God, for it would be sin?”
18 When they heard these things they shut
up,
And then they glorified the cup
Of God, and said “Then God's also
Granted to the Gentiles in row
Repentance to life in the show.”

The vision of the divine in each man,
No matter where the cut of face may scan,
That is the sign of gratitude I find,
And is the mark that was on Peter's mind.
Baptism of the Holy Spirit's not
The foreign speech that's uttered by
untaught,
But rather that in the beholder's eye
It is not human pool alone to spy,
But the eternal vision of divine,
Your face instead to be seen in what's mine
And what's the face of every man and child

That looks toward the woman reconciled.
I see You, my Beloved, where I may turn,
And yet my heart with longing learns to
burn.

19 Now those who were scattered about
After the persecution rout
That came up with Stephen in doubt
Travelled as far as Phoenicia,
Cyprus, and Antioch in awe
To preach the word to no one but
The Jews only. 20 But some unshut
Were men from Cyprus and Cyrene,
Who, when they had come to the scene
Of Antioch, told Hellenists,
Preaching the Lord Jesus in lists.
21 And the hand of YHWH was with them,
And a great number believed them
And turned to the Lord and His fear.
22 Then news of these things came to ear
Of the group of called out ones near
And in Jerusalem, and they
Sent out Barnabas in the way
To go as far as Antioch,
To be a light, rampart and rock.

When persecution drove believers far
To every Roman port and Greek bazaar,
Some Cypriots came up to Antioch
And stood upon the Roman bridge of rock
That some years past still spanned the
golden stream,
And preached the word of God as if in
dream,
Which woke the men in Quds to what took
place.
So they sent Barnabas to see them face
To face, since he had known them all since
youth
And could better than any judge the truth
Of number and of rumour. So Your hand
Was with the earnest Cypriot band.
Beloved, give me that Antiochan power,
Reciting Your name at the present hour.

23 When he came and had seen the grace
Of God, he was glad, and to trace
Encouragement that they should stand
Firm in their purpose to stay manned
With the Lord in all that they planned.
24 For he was a good man, filled by
The holy Spirit and not shy

Of faith. And a great crowd of folk
Were added to the Lord who spoke.
25 Then Barnabas departed for
Tarsus to seek Saul at the door.
26 And when he found him he brought him
Back to Antioch neat and trim.
So it was that for a whole year
They gathered with the group and gear
Of called out ones and taught a crowd.
And the disciples were allowed
To be called Christians the first time
In Antioch and in that clime.

Full of faith and the holy spirit, he
Was a good man, though Christians now
don't see
That any man is good, but destitute
Without blood and a Christian's good
repute.
Would that all so-called Christians had
remained
Like Barnabas and those that he
maintained.
But Barnabas would not enjoy the fruit
Of faith and labour on his own, made suit
To find his partner as a loyal friend
And brought him to the city for that end.
This good man, full of faith and full of
spirit
Brought all in whirling up to heaven or
near it
And did not stop till partner and by-stander
Made You, Beloved, both Loved One and
commander.

27 And in these days prophets came from
Jerusalem down to beat drum
In Antioch. 28 Then one of them,
Named Agabus, stood up with hem
And showed by the Spirit that there
Would be a famine and make bare
The whole world, and that happened too
In Claudius Caesar's review.
29 Then the disciples, each according
To his ability rewarding,
Determined to send help to those
Brothers living in famine's throes
In Judaea. 30 And so they did,
And sent it by the elders bid
At hand of Barnabas and Saul
To help their brothers in the stall.

When anyone lacked meat the one to turn
 To was Barnabas, one who did not spurn
 The poor and graceless, and who always
 gave
 Of what he had to feed both free and slave.
 There was no one to trust in all the land
 Like Barnabas for charity in hand.
 And so he took the alms of everyone
 In hand with Saul until the dearth was
 done.
 Beloved, make me trustworthy too as he
 And keep my hand and eye on charity.
 The gauge of truth is not the faithful sum
 Of philosophic views and their expression
 In theological symposium,
 But charity, Beloved, in Your confession.

Acts 12

1 About that time Herod the king
 Stretched out his hand to harm the ring
 Of called out ones. 2 Then he killed James
 The brother of John with sword's claims.
 3 And because he saw that it pleased
 The Jews, he went further and seized
 Peter also. This was in days
 Of the unleavened bread to raise.
 4 So when he had arrested him,
 He put him in a prison grim,
 And turned him over to four squads
 Of soldiers to keep him with prods,
 Intending to bring him before
 The people after Passover.

Beloved, why did Your angel not come
 sing
 For James to keep him safe under Your
 wing?

Perennial belief and doubt must fling
 About the human heart for such a thing.
 The pain of righteousness is not just show.
 It's no reply that rice Christians would go
 About the world in riot, if it made
 A visible distinction on parade
 To follow You, Beloved. Because You
 know
 The hearts in any case. The worldly glow
 Suffices for the eyes of universe.
 We do not need in evidence the curse
 Of innocents in agony or worse.
 Save here and now, and I'll believe the
 purse.

5 Peter was therefore kept in gaol,
 But constant prayer and in avail
 Was offered up to God for him
 By the group of called out ones grim.
 6 When Herod was about to bring
 Him out, that night Peter in sling
 Was sleeping, bound with two chains to
 Two soldiers, and the guards in view
 Before the door kept watch in crew.
 7 Now see, an angel of YHWH stood
 Nearby, and a light filled with good
 The prison, and he struck the man
 Peter on the side, raised in span,
 Saying "Get up fast as you can!"
 And his chains fell from his wrists then.
 8 The angel said to him, "Again
 Put on your belt and tie your shoes,"
 And so he did, not to refuse.
 And he said to him, "Put coat on
 And follow me before the dawn."
 9 So he went out and followed him,
 And did not know that what was trim
 Done by the angel was no dream,
 But thought he saw a vision's gleam.
 10 When they had passed the first and next
 Guard posts, they came out unperplexed
 To the iron gate that leads to town.
 Which opened by itself to them,
 And they went out and they went down
 One street, and straight away the gem
 Of angel left him. 11 And when Peter
 Had come to himself, he said *fleeter*,
 "Now I know for sure YHWH has sent
 His angel, and saved me and rent
 Me from the hand of Herod's power
 And from the Jewish hopes *that glower*."

That's what I said, Beloved. A hand of
 power
 Stretched out to the imprisoned for an hour
 Is proof enough. And yet You give no
 tongue
 To tell the death of James, a man still
 young.
 The angel strikes the side and raises one,
 And leaves the other sleeping on his bun.
 Methinks that Calvin's thought was right
 when done,
 Or at least Beza out to hit and stun.
 I sleep within the prison house of fate,
 The numb mind all entempled by the great
 White education fostered by the state.

Wake me or not, Beloved, I'm in Your
hand,
If You've a hand to lend upon the sand
Where for a moment I rise up and stand.

12 So, when he had considered this,
He came to Mary's house, no miss,
The mother of John whose surname
Was Mark, where many others came
To pray. 13 And as Peter knocked at
The door of the gate, tit for tat,
A girl named Rhoda came to see.

14 When she recognized Peter's wee
Voice, because of joy she did not
Open the gate, but ran and sought
To tell them that Peter outside
Was standing at the gate and cried.

15 But they said "You're out of your
mind!"

Still she kept saying "I'm not blind!"
So they said "It's his angel kind."

16 And Peter kept on knocking there,
And when they opened, saw his share,
They were astonished. 17 Lifting hand
To keep them silent, he declared
To them how YHWH by angel planned
Had brought him out of prison band.
And he said then, "Go, tell these shared
Things to James and the brothers bared."
He left and hid somewhere near.

18 As soon as the day would appear,
There was no small stir nor small fear
Among the soldiers for what came
Of Peter. 19 But in Herod's name
When search was done and him not found,
Herod examined the guards' ground
And ordered them to death uncrowned.
Then he went from Judaea to
Caesarea, and stayed there too.

The king it was gave orders to his men
To keep good Peter locked up in a pen.
If they had disobeyed, they would have
paid
With life. And yet the angel hand was
stayed
From helping them escape the wrath of
king.

Some soldiers were mere children suffering
In contract to the Roman state: no choice,
But stolen from their mothers without
voice.

Beloved, why did You not give them the
chance

Of knowing and of loving divine dance
Before Your throne? Commanded on the
floor,

Their start and end was meting out the
gore.

Beloved, kidnap me from the human fate
Of loving You before I learn to hate.

20 Now Herod had been in great wrath
Against the folk of Tyre and path
Of Sidon, but they came to him
Together, and made Blastus grim,
The king's aide their friend, they appealed
For peace, because their country's yield
Of food was supplied by the king.

21 On a set day Herod, dressing
In royal garb, sat on his throne
And gave a speech to them in tone.

22 The people kept shouting, "The voice
Of a god and not of man's choice!"

23 Then straightway an angel of YHWH
Struck him, because he gave no due
Glory to God. And he was eaten
By worms and died, king at last beaten.

24 But the word of Alohim grew
And multiplied, for it was true.

25 And Barnabas and Saul returned
From Jerusalem when they'd earned
Reward of their service, and they
Also took with them without pay
John whose surname was Mark discerned.

I see the coming of dissent and faction
When John Mark comes upon the field of
action.

The partnership of Barnabas and Saul
Is stressed by righteous Barnabas's gall
In taking in another. So he did
Once with rejected Saul, the invalid.
No one could match, not even Saul, his
humble

And quiet generosity. Saul's grumble
Will soon be heard. Take warning, Saul,
from fate

Of Herod, and before it is too late
Give God all glory. You, Beloved, strike
down

All in mankind that would place mace and
crown

Before the humble glory of Creator.

Let me, like Barnabas, be abdicator.

Acts 13

1 Now in the group of called out ones
That was at Antioch by tons
There were certain prophets and teachers:
Barnabas, Simeon for preachers
Who was called Niger, Lucius
Of Cyrene, Manaen studious
With Herod the tetrarch, and Saul.
2 As they served YHWH and fasted all,
The holy Spirit gave the call,
“Separate to me Barnabas
And Saul for the work come to pass
To which I’ve called them *in their class*.”
3 Then, having fasted and prayed well,
And laid hands on them in farewell,
They sent *them away for a spell*.

Among the college of the prophets and
The teachers, two were called by You to
stand.
A prophet here is one who cantillates
The Scriptures of Your name and
celebrates
Your praises in the melodies long past
That faithful Moses and that David cast.
A teacher here is one come to explain
How word and law apply in present reign,
And what Your will today is and its true
Root in the Book and Tablet giving clue.
Beloved, though not called out perhaps to
be
The visible in teaching’s prophecy,
Let my life cantillate Your name today
And teach in silent doing the right way.

4 Sent by the holy Spirit they
Went down to Seleucia to stay,
And then from there they sailed away
To Cyprus. 5 And when they arrived
In Salamis, they preached and strived
For the word of God in the place
Of synagogues of Jewish race.
They also had John to help them.
6 When they’d gone through the island gem
To Paphos, they found there a man
A certain sorcerer by plan,
A false prophet, a Jew whose name
Was Bar-Jesus, a man of fame,
7 Who was with the proconsul there,
Sergius Paulus, man smart and fair.

This man called for Barnabas and
Saul and sought to hear the command
Of God’s word. 8 But Elymas as
His name means, interfered with jazz,
Trying to turn the consul back
Away from faith and into lack.
9 Then Saul, who also is called Paul,
Filled with the holy Spirit’s gall,
Looked straight at him 10 and said, “O man
Full of all deceit and all fan
Of fraud, you son of devil’s dam,
You enemy of righteousness,
Will you not stop the vain address
Against the ways of YHWH for mess?
11 “And now, indeed, the hand of YHWH
Is upon you, and you’ll have due
In blindness, not to see the sun
For some time.” And right then a run
Of dark mist fell on him, and he
Went around seeking someone free
To lead him by the hand and see.
12 Then the proconsul when he saw
What happened believed in his awe
At the doctrine of the Lord done.
13 When Paul and his mates set sail from
The port of Paphos, they had come
To Perga in Pamphylia,
When John left them in lurch and law,
Back to Jerusalem like straw.

They went to Cyprus first because that’s
where
The home of Barnabas was. Have no care,
He is a man to answer every question
That trick or demon can bring as
suggestion.
It matters not that his clear word and
thinking
And generosity caught ruler winking.
So Paul steps in to make the seeing blind,
The opposite of miracle and kind
That Jesus always did, but never mind,
The governor believed and Paul came out
Triumphant over Barnabas, no doubt.
Search, my Beloved, for me but never find
That I work miracle or sleight of hand.
I have no faith because I see Your land.

14 When they departed from Perga,
For Antioch in Pisidia,
They went into the synagogue
On Sabbath day and sat agog.

15 After Torah and Haftara

The chiefs of the synagogue saw
To them and said "O Men and brothers,
If you have a message for others
Speak on." 16 Then Paul stood up, and
signed

With his hand saying in this kind,
"Men of Israel, you who fear God,
Listen: 17 "The God of this folk's prod
Of Israel chose our ancestors,
And raised the folk above sequesters
When they lived as sojourners in
The land of Egypt, land of sin,
And with an upraised arm He brought
Them out of it as they has sought.

What hand signals does Paul show to the
blind?

Don't tell me the sign of the cross designed.
I know the phallic symbol knows few
bounds,
And even Jews in ancient times and
grounds
Remembered to make crosses on their
rounds,
But it is not attested for the Christian
Till centuries later, unless I have missed
one.

I reckon that the story can be told
Of how You entered Egypt and were bold
To bring the people out of slavery then,
Without a hand raised in a cross and wen.
Beloved, I stand and speak, and leave my
hands

Down at my sides. I do not need the stands
Of gestures to relate to heavenly lands.

18 "Now for the space of forty years
He put up with their ways and tears
In the desert. 19 "When he had done
To destruction seven nations won
In Canaan's land, He gave them land
By lots. 20 "After that by command
He gave them judges for about
Four hundred and fifty years' route,
Until Samuel the prophet came.
21 "But after that they asked for fame
In a king, so God gave them Saul
The son of Kish, a man and tall
Of the tribe of Benjamin small,
To rule them forty years in all.

Samaritans look back with longing eyes
To the reign of Saul and without disguise
Shed tears that he and his were shunted out
Of capital and throne with fervid shout.
The quarrel with the Jews is very like
That between Shi'a and the good Sunnite:
They both would disagree on Ali's right
To harvest of the people without spite.
Beloved, when Samuel came anointing
kings,

There was the need to champion wars and
things,
But forty years of reign gave grace enough
For some to mind that Saul was gracious
stuff.

His fault was in the saving of some lives
Instead of killing everything that thrives.

22 "And when He had removed him, He
Raised up for them David's decree,
To whom also He gave witness,
'I've found David the son of Jess,
A man after My own heart, who
Will do all My will and be true.'
23 "From this man's seed, according to
The promise, God raised for Israel
A Saviour, Jesus, 24 "after spell
Of John's preaching, before he came
Baptism of repentance' fame
To all the folk of Israel.

Though Saul was not the killer in the land
That David was, I still come take my stand
For blessing David and his progeny,
The promise of salvation from the spree.
Though Saul was not obedient in all things,
David was not much better among kings:
He too found room to disobey Your will,
And yet You set him high on Zion's hill.
Beloved, the prophecies are dark with
doubt,

The centuries have dimmed, I hear no shout
Before the donkey in Jerusalem,
I see no palms and scattered flaxen hem.
And yet I find the hope of what is past
Is still a gleam in heart for things that last.

25 "As John was finishing his course,
He said, 'Who do you think I am?
I am not he, I'm not his horse.
But indeed, there comes One like ram
After me, whose shoes I am not

Worthy to tie or untie knot.'

26 "Men and brothers, sons of the clan
Of Abraham, and those in span
Among you who fear God, to you
The word of this salvation due
Has been sent. 27 "For those who live in
Jerusalem, and their chiefs' kin,
Because they did not know him, nor
Even the voice of prophets more
Which are read every Sabbath day,
Fulfilled them in condemning way.

Fact is the prophecies most earnestly
Brought forward in their evidence to see
That Jesus was Messiah for the free
Are found in haftarah that in that time
Was read along with Torah for its rhyme.
The seed of this hope anti-Roman in
The face of the establishment and din
Is found declared upon the Sabbath day
In every sort of synagogue in sway.
Beloved, today the readings still run wide
Upon the air of the church and inside
Their halls, but ears are just as dim to hear
The matchless hopes that fail not to appear
In passages prophetic to the ear.

28 "And though they found no cause for
death

In him, they asked Pilate for death.
29 "Now when they had fulfilled all that
Was written about him out flat,
They took him down from the tree and
Laid him in a tomb. 30 "But God's hand
Raised him from the dead and to stand.
31 "He was seen for many days by
Those who came up with him to spy
From Galilee and back again
Into Jerusalem, of men
Who are his witnesses to folk.

32 "And we declare to you glad tidings,
That promise, our fathers' confidings.

33 "God has fulfilled this for us their
Children, in raising Jesus fair.
As it's written in Psalm two too,
'You are my son, today I do
Come having generated you.'

34 "And that he raised him from the dead,
No more to return to the spread
Of such corruption, so he spoke,
'I'll give you David's mercies' stroke.'

35 "That's why he also says again

In quite another Psalm to men,
'You'll not allow Your Holy One
To see corruption under sun.'

36 "For David, after he had served
His own generation preferred
By God's will, fell asleep, and then
Was buried with his fathers' men,
And saw corruption, 37 "but he whom
God raised up saw no failing doom.

The arguments are full and faithfully
Presented by the tongue of David wee,
And all is the fulfilled and of the word
That You addressed to David when You
spurred

Him to the right with promises conferred.
If David sleeps still in the heavy dust
And drowns with the saints beneath the
rust,

The message is that Jesus rose into
The sky to meet the angels in their crew
And fellowship in love with blessed You.
Beloved, no arguments suffice to make
Me know fulfilments appear at the stake.
But I still trust in Your reality:
The sun by day, the moonlit symmetry.

38 "Therefore let it be known to you,
Brothers, that through this man in view
Is preached to you forgiveness of
Sins, 39 "and by him each one above
Who has faith is justified from
All thing from which you could in sum
Not be justified by the law
That came through Moses and his claw.
40 "Beware therefore, lest what has been
Spoken in the prophets for sin
Come upon you: 41 "Indeed, you ones
Who despise, marvel, perish guns!
For I work a work in your days,
A work which you will by no ways
Believe, though one gave you its praise.'" 42
So when the Jews from synagogue
Went out, the Gentiles begged incog
That these words might be preached to
them

The next Sabbath. 43 Now when the hem
Of congregation had dispersed,
Many Jews and devout and versed
Proselytes followed Paul as well
As Barnabas, who spoke to tell
Them with persuasion to keep on

In the grace of God till the dawn.
44 On the next Sabbath almost all
The city gather at the call
To hear the word of God in stall.

The gospel written in the famous name
Of Barnabas may well have valid claim
To truth, but surely there are marks within
The book itself to bring to light the sin
Of tampering and changing divine word.
At least two things in it have both
concurred

To show a false thing and abuse the writer.
The first is wooden barrel, an indicter
That something medieval is interposed.
The second is the eighth day is disclosed,
The pagan sun-god's stamp of Christian
loss.

But Barnabas still takes You as his boss.
He keeps the Sabbath holy by
commandment
And in Your grace continues, no
remandment.

45 But when the Jews saw all the crowds,
They were filled up with envy's shrouds,
And contradicting and blaspheming,
They opposed the things Paul was
scheming.

46 Then Paul and Barnabas grew bold
And said, "It was needful and told
The word of God should be first spoken
To you, but you reject the token,
And judge yourselves unworthy of
Its life eternal wrought in love,
So we turn to the Gentiles' shove.

47 "For so the Lord's commanded us:
'I have set you a luminous
Light to the Gentiles, so you should
Be for salvation to the good
Ends of the earth and without fuss.'"

48 Now when the Gentiles heard this word,
They were glad glorifying, stirred
By the word of YHWH. And as many
As had been appointed to life
Eternal believed at the fife.

49 And the word of YHWH was with any
Spread all through the land for a penny.

50 But the Jews stirred up the devout
And prominent women and stout
Men of the city, and raised up
Persecution against the cup

Of Paul and Barnabas, expelled
Them from their region that excelled.
51 They shook off the dust from their feet
Against them, and came to retreat
At Iconium. 52 There were filled
The disciples with joy instilled
And with the Holy Spirit billed.

Filled with the holy spirit and with joy,
I hear of Barnabas and his employ
To glorify Your word in cantillation
As witness to the crowds in their elation
That You accept both Gentile and the Jew.
Indeed on earth today there are but few
Who do not love the one and hate the other,
And kill if possible another's brother.
Sectarian religious jealousy
Is root of casting out the true and free
Who cantillate Your word. I too shake off
The dust upon my feet until I cough,
And exit mosque and synagogue and
church.
Beloved, You will not leave me in the
lurch.

Acts 14

1 It happened in Iconium
That they went together to come
In the synagogue of the Jews,
And spoke so a great crowd would choose
To believe of both Jews and Greeks.

2 But unbelieving Jews and geeks
Stirred up the Gentiles turning minds
Against the brothers in their kinds.

3 That is they stayed there a long time,
Speaking boldly in the lord's clime,
Who bore witness to his word's grace,
Granting signs and wonders to trace
By their hands. 4 But the multitude
Of the city was so construed
That some supported Jews and some
Supported the apostles come.

5 And when a violent attempt
Was made by both Gentiles' contempt
And Jews, with their rulers, to cause
Abuse of them and stone their paws,
6 They heard about it and they fled
To Lystra and Derbe, the spread
Cities of Lycaonia,
And the surrounding area.

7 And so they preached the Gospel too
In that country and in that view.

The Gospel is supposed to be good news,
But from the start it startles heathen views,
And the result is stoning men to death,
Before they get their final gospel breath.
The violent attempt to do away
With Paul and Barnabas is just a ray
Of what men face who once proclaim You
way.

No wonder every church in sight reveals
Another gospel from the one Paul feels.
The good news that the death of Your dear
Son
Relieves from consequences of what's done
Is always welcome. But the writing on
The heart of the same old law once
withdrawn
Is met with smacks upon the pate and bun.

8 And in Lystra a certain man
Without strength in his feet to span
Was sitting, a cripple from birth,
Who'd never walked for all his worth.
9 This man heard Paul speak. And Paul too
Watched him intently and the view
Showed he had faith there to be healed,
10 And so said with loud voice to yield,
"Stand right up on your feet!" And he
Jumped up and walked around the tee.
11 And when the people saw what Paul
Had done, they raised their voice to call,
Saying in the Lycaonian,
"The gods have come down to our span
In likeness and in form of man!"
12 And Barnabas they called Zeus then,
And Paul was Hermes in their den,
Because he talked more in the glen.
13 The priest of Zeus, whose temple sat
Before their city on the flat,
Brought oxen and strings of flowers round
To the gates, for offerings on ground
With the crowds. 14 But it came back to
Ears of Barnabas and Paul too
Who were apostles on their cue,
They tore their clothes and ran among
The multitude, shouting 15 as sung,
"Men, why are you doing these things?
We also are men with same springs
Of nature as you, and preach to
You to turn from these useless things
To the God living, who made sky
The earth, the sea, and all things dry,

16 "Who in the generations past
Allowed all nations to walk last
In their own ways. 17 "But He did not
Leave Himself without witness taught,
But He did well to give us rain
From the sky and the fruitful plain
To fill our hearts with food and gain."
18 And with these words they hardly could
Keep the crowd from offerings they would.

They took poor Barnabas for Zeus and
brought
A sacrifice to honour what they thought
Was God above all gods, while Paul stood
by
A lesser god. One wonders if that's why
In time Paul found his mate too much too
take.
He was so like You that good men mistake
Him for the true, while none took Paul to
be
More than a flowery speaker and lackey.
So two who give a witness to Your oneness
In jealousy may wreck upon undoneness.
Make me like Barnabas in doing well,
And keep me quietly from evil spell
Of leaders of religion who come by
And are not humble, generous or shy.

19 The Jews from Antioch came there
And from Iconium to share,
And they also persuaded all
The folk to come and to stone Paul
And drag him out the city wall,
Thinking that he was dead to fall.
20 But when the followers came round,
He got up and went safe and sound
Into the city. The next day
He left with Barnabas to stay
In Derbe in another way.

The fickle crowds that shout in grand
acclaim
The next day will forget the idol's name.
So those who one day did Paul all the
honours
The next forgot they all had been Paul's
fawners.
Who claim great faith are first to cast a
stone,
And first to break a righteous man's leg
bone,

And drag him out and falsely smear his
fame.

For such faith is a profit and a game.
Beloved, let me take both the laud and
cross

For what they are, ill profit and a loss.
I flee to You from glory and from pain
Of accusation and of the inane
Abuse of evil men decked out in power.
I'll meet You in Derbe within the hour.

21 And when they'd preached the gospel
there

To that city and made a share
Of many followers, they went
Back to Lystra from which they lent
Steps to Iconium and to
Antioch, 22 strengthening the crew
Of the disciples, telling them
To continue in the faith's gem,
"We must through tribulations' score
Come in the kingdom of God's store."

23 When they'd appointed elders in
Every group of called out ones' din,
And prayed with fasting, they'd commend
Them to the Lord whose faith they'd tend.

24 And after they had once passed through
Pisidia, they came unto

Pamphylia. 25 Now when they'd preached
The word in Perga, they had reached
Down to Attalia. 26 From there they
Sailed to Antioch, where they'd stayed
Commended to the grace of God
For the work in which they had trod.

27 Now when they'd come and gathered in
The group of called out ones in bin,
They reported all God had done
With them, and that He'd opened won
The door of faith to the Gentile.

28 So they stayed there for a long while
With the disciples without guile.

The elders were appointed by the hand
Of Paul and Barnabas in every land,
Instead of by election of the crowd
Upon the pews of churches singing loud.
It is unbaptist and undemocratic,
And so deserves my critic's higher static.
Appoint me, my Beloved, what elders You
Release upon my painted door and pew,
And I shall welcome them or not in view.
But with appointment or with empty air,

Let me rest in the presence of Your fair
Resounding word still trembling on Your
breath:

Perhaps I shall not falter even at death,
But joy the rather to find You still there.

Acts 15

1 And there were certain men came down
From old Judaea and the town
To teach the brothers, "Unless you
Are circumcised according to
The custom of Moses, you'll not
Be saved, instead you will be caught."

2 Therefore, when Paul and Barnabas
Had no small argument and gas
With them, they determined that Paul
And Barnabas and others fall
Up to Jerusalem, and to
The apostles and elders' crew,
About this question come in view.

Now even Paul and Barnabas could not
Suffice to counteract what teachers taught,
That grown men, when they turn to You to
claim

The glories and the powers within Your
name,

Must have their adult members drawn and
cut

And circumcised like Abraham in glut.
The custom of Moses they gave and no
Clear word of Scripture as the sayings go.
Too bad it is that old dissension now
Gives those who would leave child uncut
somehow

The argument that Barnabas approves.
The matter of the children it behoves
Us to remember was not brought to mind.
I flee to You, Beloved, let men be blind.

3 And they were sent on their way by
The group of called out ones to spy
Through Phoenicia, Samaria,
Describing the conversion's paw
Of the Gentiles, and they caused great
Joy to all the brothers of late.

4 And so when they had come up to
Jerusalem, they got their due
By the group of called out ones and
The apostles and elders' band,
And they reported all that God
Had done with them upon the sod.

5 But some of Pharisean sect
Who believed rose up as select,
Saying "It's necessary they
Be circumcised, and in their way
To keep the law of Moses' stay."
6 So apostles and elders came
Together to consider same.

Beloved, if I understand this aright,
The question posed that has come into sight
Is whether salvation depends upon
A thing that human hands can do at dawn,
Or whether it depends solely on how
You the divine and sovereign act and bow.
Some Pharisees believing came to say
That circumcision had a part to play
In the salvation that is spread abroad
By Your divine decree as sovereign God.
Paul and Barnabas took the other view,
And said salvation's just the act of You.
Let's see how the church at Jerusalem
Comes to crack this nut and polish this
gem.

7 And when there had been much dispute,
Peter rose up and took the boot
And said to them "Men, brothers mine,
You know that a good while ago
God chose among us on the vine,
That by my mouth the Gentiles know
To hear the Gospel word and show.
8 "So God, who knows the heart, was quick
To give them Holy Spirit's kick
Just as He did to us, as slick
9 "And made no difference between
Us and them, purifying keen
Their hearts by faith. 10 "Now therefore,
why
Do you test God by putting by
A yoke on the neck of the crew
Of the disciples which as due
Neither our fathers nor we were
Able to bear? 11 "But we concur
That through Lord Jesus Christ in grace
We shall be saved just like their face."

Let's get the matter straight, Beloved, and
see
How Paul supports the five-point doctrine
wee
By saying that both Jew and Gentile free,
Without a difference between or degree,

All are saved by the act of grace alone
Through Jesus Christ, so nothing can atone
Which is the work of man, not even faith
Preached as the duty to both jinn and
wraith.

Beloved, I praise You for this knowledge
set,
That all men are in need and some men get
Grace without merit by Your own decree,
Redeemed by Christ by grace that won't let
go,
So that the saints are kept till heaven's
show.
Beloved, I praise You that You are not
slow.

12 Then all the crowd was quiet and
Listened to Barnabas in band
And Paul declaring how such signs
And wonders God had worked in lines
Through them among the Gentiles' mines.

When Barnabas and Paul declared what
You
Could do in way of miracles on cue
Among such Gentile men as had not been
Cut in the vital member when still green,
It was a work of praise. I stop to ask
A question not raised here, but is a task
That must be duly faced. I doubt not that
In Your divine grace and power where
You're at
You can work miracles on uncut men.
I only wonder if such men again
Who have enjoyed Your grace will not be
first
To follow Abraham, not of the worst,
Who cut himself in dottering old age
To obey You, Beloved. I'm not a sage.

13 When they had settled down, then James
Replied and said, "Men without blames,
And brothers, hear my words and claims.
14 "Simon has declared how God first
Came to the Gentiles as uncursed
To take from them a folk for fames.
15 "And with this prophets' *inspired* words,
Just as it is written to be:
16 'After this I'll return and will
Rebuild David's tent on the hill,
Which fell down, I'll set up again,
And I'll establish it 17 for men

To seek the Lord, all Gentiles who
 Are called by my name, so says YHWH
 Who does all these things in their due.’
 18 “Known to God from eternity
 Are all his works. 19 “Therefore I see
 That we should not trouble those from
 Among the Gentiles those who come
 Repenting to God, 20 “but that we
 Write to them to abstain and be
 From things polluted by the way
 Of idols, and from the foul sway
 Of fornication, from things strangled,
 And from blood. 21 “For Moses has
 dangled
 Throughout the ages those who preach
 Him in every city to reach,
 Being read in the synagogues
 Every Sabbath by demagogues.”

It is strange to my mind, yet par for course,
 That the church of the Acts recited hoarse
 The Torah every Sabbath day, and yet
 Required no action on the words they met.
 By the same token Revelation's church
 Met to read Revelation's words on perch,
 And yet required all to keep to the law,
 And act according to it hand and claw.
 Beloved, let me take both good counsels
 shared
 And read each Sabbath from the Torah
 bared,
 And keep the words in act and word and
 deed,
 Always remembering to hear and heed.
 Inspire me with that law writ on the heart,
 And I shall stay to do my humble part.

Let's be clear on this issue and state fair
 That Your salvation's a thing that You bare,
 And nothing men can do comes in to share,
 Not even the four points here write with
 care.

The church is defined by the gathering
 Upon the Sabbath day to hear the ring
 Of Moses read. The act of worship bides
 Where the four-pointed law among them
 hides:

No idols, fornication and no blood
 In diet of the strangled in the mud.
 But point of worship is a different thing
 Than the salvation of Your divine wing.
 That is Your act alone, Beloved, for those

Not in conformity, but those You chose.

22 Then it was pleasing to those men,
 Apostles and elders again,
 With the whole group of called out ones,
 To send chosen men from their guns
 To Antioch along with Paul
 And Barnabas: Judas by call
 Also named Barsabas by all,
 And Silas, leading men among
 The brothers, the both old and young.
 23 They wrote this by them: The apostles,
 The elders, and the brothers' jostles,
 To the brothers who are around
 The Syrian and Cilician ground,
 Our greetings. 24 Since we have heard
 some

Who went out from us like a bum
 Have troubled you with words and left
 Your souls unsettled by the theft,
 Saying “Be circumcised and keep
 The law” to whom we gave no steep
 Command to do so, 25 it seemed good
 To us assembled in one wood,
 To send selected men to you
 With our beloved Barnabas true
 And Paul, 26 men who have risked their
 lives

For the name of our Lord who thrives
 Called Jesus Christ. 27 We have therefore
 Sent Judas and Silas in score,
 Who will also report the same
 Things by word of mouth in their claims.
 28 For it seemed good to us and to
 The Holy Spirit, to lay you
 No greater burden than these things
 Most necessary in your wings:
 29 That you abstain from offerings made
 To idols, from blood, on parade
 Things strangled and from fornication.
 If you keep yourselves from this ration,
 You will do well. Farewell's elation.

Who keep themselves from temple
 prostitute,
 Idolatry, and idols' meat, and fruit
 Not slaughtered in the proper, halal way,
 Will not in other matters go astray.
 Such was the word that Barnabas with care
 Took to the converts who were waiting
 there.

No doubt to concentrate on foreskin does

Distract from weighty matters on the fuzz.
I hold with Barnabas idolatry
And what concerns it is more like to be
A matter of importance to avoid.
I sit alone upon this asteroid
Neglecting worship and its fornication,
And giving Your name only acclamation.

30 So when they were sent off, they came
To Antioch, and when they came
Together in a crowd they read
The letter to hear what they said.
31 When they'd read it, they rejoiced at
Its encouraging words where they sat.

There is a reason for rejoicing here
Among the crowd of those joined in Your
fear,
Those who are defined by their coming to
Read Torah on the Sabbath in Your view,
And that is that though they have things to
do,
Those things do not contribute to salvation,
But are only response in heart's elation.
Not even faith is mentioned in this writ
As something necessary for the fit.
But duty faith's become in Christian nation
The circumcision revised in it's station.
I am cut and I have faith, at least grain
Of custard seed, but I consider vain
The both as avenues I might attain.

32 Now Judas and Silas, themselves
Being prophets also, not elves,
Exhorted and strengthened the brothers
With many words as though in smothers.
33 And after they had stayed some time,
There were sent back with greetings prime
From the brother to the apostles.
34 But Silas in midst of the jostles
Decided to stay in that clime.
35 Paul and Barnabas also stayed
In Antioch, teaching the grade
And preaching the word of YHWH too,
With many others in their pew.

I hear the breath of Barnabas call Huu
With many others also. Let me do,
Beloved, this same remembrance where I
wait.
I care not for reward nor fiery fate
Since I have seen the empty world go by,

While I disdain both hell and pie in sky.
I enter both as I repeat Your name
In melodies of passion and of flame.
Let Paul and Barnabas remain for me
The teachers of my own eternity,
Who greet the brothers, forty and the seven,
And ride on lions and on stones to heaven,
And bring to earth the messages of peace
That nowhere shall heart circumcision
cease.

36 Then after some days Paul said to
Barnabas, "Let us go back too
And visit our brothers in each
City where we have come to preach
The word of YHWH, and see how they
Are doing." 37 Now Barnabas would
Not budge without John Mark for good.
38 But Paul insisted they should not
Take with them the one who in lot
Departed from them in Pamphylia,
And had not gone with them the hillier.
39 Then the quarrel became so sharp
That they parted from each one's harp.
So Barnabas took Mark and sailed
To Cyprus, 40 but Paul chose unveiled
Silas and went his way in love
Of the brothers by God's grace shove.

Contention is the best way to increase
The number of tents where there does not
cease

To be proclaimed Your name in
cantillation.

Contention spreads the word to every
nation.

So Barnabas took Mark and Paul took one
Who might not even ever have begun
To propagate to bird and beast and all
The glories of Your whirling and its call.
Let every loving pair of friends depart
From comfort in old friendships of the
heart

And take in hand the newer generation
To share in sorrows and in loud elation.
Though You, Beloved, are one eternally,
The human walk is done in two or three.

41 And he went through Syria and
Cilicia, strengthening the hand
Of the groups of called out ones planned.

Acts 16

1 Then he came to Derbe and Lystra.
And indeed, there a certain mister a
Man named Timothy, the son
Of a certain Jewish woman
Who had believed, but his dad done
Was Greek, 2 He was well spoken of
By the brothers from push to shove
Who were at Lystra and the town
Iconium without a frown.
3 Paul wanted to have him go on
With him. And he took him withdrawn
And circumcised him, for the Jews
Who were in that region to choose,
For they all knew his dad was Greek.
4 And as they went through towns to seek,
They gave them the decrees to keep,
Which were determined by the folk,
Apostles and elders in stroke
There in Jerusalem for broke.
5 So the groups of called out ones were
Strengthened in the faith for a spur
Increasing daily under yoke.

I have some trouble to conceive that Paul
Would circumcise fair Timothy and all
With what he wrote to the Galatians' stall.
It may have been another at the brawl.
I have some trouble with the centralized
Ecclesiastic order that they prized
Enough for Paul to bring the word around
To everyone upon the Asian ground.
They go about to tell the men that they
Need not be circumcised in Jewish way,
And at the same time Timothy is clipped.
It's hypocritical if not tight-lipped.
Beloved, I take no knife, I take no shipped,
And yet I find a place with You to stay.

6 Now when they had gone through
Phrygia
And the region of Galatia,
They were forbidden by the Holy
Spirit to preach the word by trolley
In Asia. 7 After they had come
To Mysia, they tried to play dumb
In Bithynia, but the Spirit
Did not permit them or make fit.
8 So passing by Mysia, they
Came down to Troas, where to stay.
9 A vision came to Paul at night.
A man of Macedonian sight

Stood and pleaded with him, saying,
“Come to Macedonia ring
And help us.” 10 Now after he'd seen
The vision, straight away in bean
We tried to go to Macedonia,
Since we thought the Lord to condone you
Had called us to preach Gospel there.
11 That's why we sailed from Troas bare
And ran a straight course to the share
Of Samothrace, and the next day
Came to Neapolis in sway.
12 From there we went to Philippi,
Which is the main city and sty
Of that part of Macedonia,
A colony. And we in crew
Stayed in that city for some days.
13 And on the Sabbath day of praise
We went out of the town to find
The riverside, where they had mind
To gather for prayer, and we sat
Down and spoke to the women flat
Who met there. 14 Now a certain one,
A woman named Lydia for fun
Heard us. She was a seller there
Of purple from the city lair
Of Thyatira, who was fair
To worship God. The Lord opened
Her heart to heed the things to send
Spoken by Paul. 15 When she and her
Household were baptized, she begged stir
Saying, “If you consider me
To be faithful to YHWH, come be
At my house.” She convinced us, see.
16 It happened, as we went to prayer,
A certain slave girl possessed there
With a spirit of divination
Met us, who brought her masters ration
Of much profit by fortune-telling.
17 This girl followed Paul and us swelling
The cry to say, “These men are slaves
Of Most High God, whose message saves.”

The whole of Europe in the butt-shell here
Reveals its tawdry grace without a fear.
Astrology is wedded with the game
Of economics without fan or shame.
The church is just a place where women
meet
Outside the course of marketry and treat,
And cities by the rivers Seine and Thames
And Danube fight for Tiber in the hems.
Beloved, give me the grace to love as well

As criticize the neighbours in their spell:
And so I shall be European too,
Contrasting with the Asian sort of crew.
Beloved, give me the Macedonian wit
To sail a boat in straight without a fit.

18 And she did this for many days.
But Paul was aggravated then,
Turned telling the spirit again,
And said "I command you in name
Of Jesus Christ to leave her claim."
And he came out that very hour.
19 But when her masters saw the power
Of profit was gone, they seized Paul
And Silas and dragged in the hall
Of marketplace to magistrates.
20 And they brought them to rulers rates,
And said "These men, who are Jews, came
To cause our town trouble and blame,
21 "And they teach customs which are not
Lawful for us in Roman slot
To have or keep within our plot,"

If anyone, even a queen, should rise
Condemning prostitution or the prize
Of profit taken by the men who own
The female body groomed and up to tone,
Then magistrates in any land I know
Would come against such persons in a
show.

The market-place is full, the internet
Contains the advertizing of each pet.
Beloved, as I return to whirl again
About the dwelling places of mere men,
I flee the cries of pimps and whores and
turn
And cast my spells on all the ones I spurn.
If they are freed by curse or blessing
taught,
It is more than I hoped for or than sought.

22 The crowd rose up then against them,
The rulers tore off their clothes' hem
And ordered them beaten with rods.
23 And when they had made stripes with
prods,
They threw them in gaol in their pods,
And ordered the keeper to keep
Them in security and deep.
24 Having received such a charge, he
Put them in the inner degree
Of prison and fastened their feet

In the stocks to stay without treat.

Today perhaps before removing clothes
And torturing the bodies hung in rows,
No doubt they take a look at passport first,
And then proceed to perpetrate the worst.
It's just extension of the Roman crime
Known from the days of Caesar's in their
prime
And kept in fine traditions all the time
Until the Inquisition turned back stale
And Vatican make USA prevail
In torture schemes in every sort of gaol.
The fastening of feet in stocks is still
The way they lead the prisoners to fill
The gates from good Guantanamo until
The western desert's hidden rank and pill.

25 But at midnight Paul and Silas
Were praying and singing to pass
The time hymns to God, and the men
Incarcerated heard again.

The hymns that Paul and Silas stopped to
sing
Where not the one that Fanny Crosby's ring
Poured out in innocence or not to sting.
The hymns they sang were not the Latin
rage
Of Capuchin or other sort of page
Where Ambrose or good Gregory in stage
Set up the choirs cathedrals came to flaunt.
The hymns were nothing in such kinds of
want.
The hymns that Paul and Silas sang were
those
That David with his harp once came and
chose,
The hymn gathered at last in first siddur,
The Psalms of David set in Hebrew pure.
Paul may have sung in Greek, but in that
case,
It was translated from Davidic face.

26 Right off there was a great earthquake,
So that the foundations in stake
Of the prison were shaken, and
Immediately all the doors stand
Open and broke off every band.
27 The keeper of the prison, who
Woke up from sleep then had a view
Of prison doors wide open too,

And thought the prisoners all fled,
Drew his sword to kill himself bled.

I reckon the guards military who
Retain the radical Islamic crew
Would also draw a gun and shoot their
head
If they found out their prisoners had fled.
There's nothing changes here beneath the
sun:

The man of earth must always flee or run
After his prey, there is no sitting still
Beneath the vesper hymns heard on the hill.
Beloved, if ever I hear keeper's voice
Lifted to give himself the fatal choice,
I hope that I shall be like Paul and stay
The hand that's lifted up about to slay.
But if not, let the traitor to Your staff
Live to repent and make the angels laugh.

28 But Paul called with loud voice to say
"Do yourself no harm, we all stay."
29 Then he called for a light, ran in,
And fell down trembling rank and thin
Before Paul and Silas to win.
30 And he brought them out and he said,
"Sirs, how must I be saved instead?"
31 So they said "Believe on the Lord
Jesus Christ, and you will be stored,
You and your household, saved, implored."
32 Then they spoke the word of the Lord
To him and to all in his house.
33 He took them the same hour in blouse
In the night and washed their wounds, and
Straight off he and his family band
Were all baptized, *all who could stand*.

Debate about baptism takes this verse
And tries to show that infants under curse
Must feel the cool of holy water's purse.
But those who were baptized where those
who heard
The preaching of the Gospel's glowing
word.
The infants slept in mother's arms and did
Not make the choice until their faith that
hid
Became apparent in the voice and bid.
Though I reject the grasping at the straw,
I still think that the question in the craw
Is just distraction from the true that men
And women have in duty here again.

Let me and everyone who hears the call
Obey the Decalogue upon the wall.

34 Now when he had brought them into
His house, he set food in their view,
And he rejoiced, as he believed
In God, all his household reprieved.

The preacher must preach long and then
baptize
Before he's made a guest, before his eyes
The table set, and bread and meat brought
out.
The preacher must first raise a holy shout.
Though ox is never muzzled in the tune
Of the prophetic Gospel taught at noon,
Still everyone who works must wait the
time
When provender appears and juice of lime.
Beloved, I preach to none, I've learned long
since
That all hearts beckon to their one hope's
wince,
And nothing I can say will change the
mood
And heart of modern, heathen multitude.
The only preaching that avails or not
Is what I say to my own heart in plot.

35 When it was day, the magistrates
Sent officers, saying in rates,
"Let those men go to their estates."
36 The prison keeper told this thing
To Paul at last in his saying
"The rulers have sent word to let
You go. So leave in peace well set."
37 But Paul said to them, "They have
beaten
Us openly, uncondemned meeting
Of Romans, and thrown us in gaol.
And now they'd put us out to hale
In secret? Not by a long sight.
Let them come themselves in our right
And take us out." 38 The officers
Told these words to the ruling fers,
And they feared when they heard that they
Were Romans and Romans to stay.
39 Then they came and pleaded with them
And brought them out, by stratagem
Asked them to leave from the town's hem.
40 So they went out of gaol and came
Into Lydia's place and game,

And when they'd see the brothers there,
They strengthened them and left their
share.

Apologies by those who wield the sword
Are only made when caught, embarrassed,
floored.

The fear of their superior alone
Will tempt them to apologize, atone.
I've found that giving quick apologies
Embarrasses the rulers on their knees,
And makes the common clerk blush in
degrees.

It is a thing to laugh about, not groan.
Beloved, I stand apologizing now
That I'm so slow to see Your hand and
brow

Upon the silent countenance to wakes
Beneath the hill in birchen, aspen stakes.
In winter I apologize again
For having no leaves standing on my den.

Acts 17

1 When they'd passed through Amphipolis
And Apollonia not to miss
Coming to Thessalonica,
Where there was a synagogue's draw
For the Jews, 2 then Paul in his way
Went in to them and for the sway
Of three Sabbaths reason with them
From the Scriptures, 3 explaining gem
And showing that the Christ must come
To suffer and rise up in sum
From the dead: "This one that I preach
To you is the Christ, *he's a peach*."

4 Some of them were convinced at that,
A great crowd from the Greeks that sat
In the faith, and not few among
The leading women, joined the rung
Of Paul and Silas who had sung.
5 But the Jews who were not persuaded,
Were jealous and they took paraded
Some wicked men from marketplace,
And gathered a crowd set in trace
Of all the city in a roar,
Attacked the house of Jason sore,
And tried to bring them out to see
The folk. 6 But when they did not find
Them, they dragged Jason and some free
Brothers to the magistrates wined
Shouting, "These who have turned the
world

Upside down came here too uncured.

7 "Jason has harboured them, and these
Are all acting against decrees
Of Caesar, saying there's another
King, Jesus, reigning *with his mother*."

8 They troubled the crowd and the rulers
Of the city when they heard foolers
Of these things. 9 So when they had taken
Security from Jason's bacon
And the rest, then they let them go,
And in their acting were not slow.

The world's been spinning upside down
since they
Went out defending all the world one day
From the oppression of the royal crowd:
Since Rome spoke with the dragon words
aloud.

Another king? May Your dear heart forbid,
Beloved, we keep another under lid,
While David chafes in the tomb where he
hid

To spend the centuries with his dead kid.
It's envy always breeds the magistrates
Involvement in the neighbour's loves and
hates.

They always demand bail, and post a fine
Before they go back home to drink and
dine.

I'll bet on resurrections if I may,
Despite the darkened streets and lonely
way.

10 Then the brothers immediately
Sent Paul and Silas by decree
Away in the night to Berea.
When they arrived, they went into
The synagogue there of the Jew.

Berea is the place I long to be,
Where Scriptures are read, re-read readily,
And taught and sought and thought about
daily.

Berea is the place and the degree.
The sea, the cliffs, the mountains where the
sky
Comes down to touch the earth both sweet
and dry,

All catch my waiting ear and roving eye,
All worry at the start and to comply.
Beloved, set sail with me to that far place
Under the eye of modern, ancient Thrace,

And I will turn beneath the sail to trace
The lines of love that make Your noble
face.

The last time we went sailing for a dove
A raven entered in upon our love.

11 These were more fair-minded than those
In the Thessalonican rows,
For they received the word right fast,
And searched the Scriptures in the cast
Of every day whether these things
Were so. 12 Therefore many in rings
Believed, and also not a few
Of the Greeks, and the women too
As well as men. 13 But when the Jew
Crowd from Thessalonica knew
The word of God was preached by Paul
At Berea, they came to fall
There also and stirred up the crowd.
14 Then straight off the brothers allowed
Sent Paul away, to go to sea,
But both Silas and Timothy
Stayed there. 15 So those who guided Paul
Brought him to Athens to install,
And getting a command for Silas
And Timothy to come to guyless
As fast as can, they both set off.
16 While Paul waited for them to scoff
At Athens, his heart was provoked
Within him when he saw invoked
In that city idols uncloaked.
17 And so he argued with the Jews
There in the synagogue, abused
The worshipers, and in the mart
Each day with those who came to start.

I'm silent at the market place, I find
It is illegal to raise voice unwined
Without a paper duly sought and signed
By magistrates that I have not combined
With the subversive ways of the unblind.
So I am silent in the market place,
Though I look on, and I search every face
To see if there is anywhere the trace
Of love and light, obedience to You
Revealed in lineaments of roving crew.
I daily walk the margin of the town,
I daily drink the hostile smile and frown,
And know the doors are shut that in a
stroke
Might have been opened underneath the
smoke.

18 Then some philosophers met him,
Epicurean and Stoics grim.
Some said "What does this babbler say?"
Others replied, "he seems to pay
Attention to some foreign gods,"
Because he preached them on the sods
From which Jesus rose up with clods.
19 And so they took him and brought him
To the Areopagus trim,
Saying, "May we know what this new
Doctrine is which you speak of true?
20 "For you bring strange things to our
ears.
So we want to know what appears."
21 All the Athenians and all
The foreigners there on the wall
Did nothing but relate and hear
Anything new that would appear.

Ask me, fine friend and stranger in the
way,
Ask me if I've an answer for the day
And for the struggle to find in the fray
The peace that all men need beneath the ray
Of sun and moon, beneath the guiding stars
That drip their incense from a reddened
Mars.
Or if you will not ask, I shall repeat
The note I've spoken from desert retreat:
The answer to all ills and the reply
To praise and joy unravelled from the sky,
Is Decalogue alone, one God to be
A haven and a Sabbath of the free,
A harbour for the parent and the bride,
A place of refuge and a room to hide.

22 So Paul stood up there in the place,
The Areopagus to trace
And said "Men of Athens, I see
In all things your religious spree,
23 "For as I was passing through and
Looking at your altars that stand,
I even found an altar there
With this inscription, and I share:
To the unknown God lying bare.
Therefore, the One you worship though
You do not know him in the show,
That one I proclaim to your row.
24 "God, who made the world and all
things,
Since He's Lord of both heavenly rings

And earth, does not live in the fair
Temples made with human hands' care.

25 "Nor is He worshipped with men's
hands,

As though He needed any lands,
Since He gives to all life and breath,
And all things from their birth to death.

26 "And he has made from one blood each
Nation of men to live and reach
All the face of the earth, and set
Their times and boundaries where they're
met.

27 "So that they should seek YHWH, in
hope

That they might grope for Him, *not pope*,
And find Him, though He is not far
From each of us, failure or star,

28 "For in him we live and we move
And have our being, as would prove
Some of your own poets who said,
'For we're also his offspring bred.'

29 "Therefore, since we are the offspring
Of God, we ought not think the thing
That the Divine Nature is like
Gold or silver or stone, or spike
Shaped by art and human hand's strike.

Beloved, You are unknown to me, though I
Have daily traced Your image on the sky,
And found Your footprints ranging on my
heart

In infinite safaris from the start.

Beloved, You are unknown, all I address
Are certain You're a spirit to confess,
Above, beyond material in mess.

If so, as every true man must believe,
You are a nothingness that I retrieve.

You are not gold nor any metal rare,
That what are You, still thinner than the
air?

You leave tracks like the crow's tracks on
the sod,

Well frozen where the rattling of the pod
Still whispers to the wind of the true God.

30 "True these times of ignorance God
Overlooked, but now He commands

All men everywhere to repent,

31 "Because He has set a day spent
On judging the world in justice,
By the man he's ordained to kiss.
He's given assurance of this

To all by raising him up from
The dead and made alive in sum."

If You are in a place beyond the trace
Of fond Orion as the teacher race
In my childhood was fast to make embrace,
You are too far from me to see my face.

If you are in a place too close to me
To meet my eye across the table's tea,
Then you cannot reveal to hand and heart
The truth of Your own being and Your part.
I taste the crumb, I drink the wine, the tart
Seduces tongue, I scramble for the cart.
Is there life for the turkey after thanks?
Or for the porker after Christmas banks?
If You can resurrect the tasty meal,
I will believe in everything I feel.

32 When they heard of the resurrection
Of the dead, some mocked in rejection,
While others said, "Let's hear you later."

33 So Paul just left them there to cater.

34 Yet some men joined him and believed,
Among them Dionysius sleeved
The Areopagite to miss,
And a woman named Damaris,
And others with them in their bliss.

There's always an excuse to send the guy
Who tells the truth away, and make him
fly.

The only word that's popular to hear
Is when the eye is blind, and deaf the tear.
Damaris is a lady that I know
Who came to save the world and save the
show,

And so I search the world from every turn
To find that lady come in what I earn.
Dionysius is named for that great god
Who clambered over death beneath the sod
To find the light of mystery to glow
On everyone who lays hand on the row.
There's always an excuse to follow blind
The wind that pretends it is sweet and kind.

Acts 18

1 After these things Paul went away
From Athens to find Corinth's day.

2 And there he found a certain Jew
Named Aquila, born in the view
Of Pontus, who had recently
Come with his wife from Italy,

Priscilla was her name, because
 Claudius had made Jewish laws,
 That they should leave Rome, and he came
 To them in Corinth with his dame.
 3 So because he did the same work,
 He stayed with them and did not shirk,
 They were tentmakers, both the same.
 4 He discoursed in the synagogue
 Every Sabbath, in dialogue
 With both Jews and the Gentile frog.
 5 When Silas and Timothy came
 From Macedonia, the flame
 Of the Spirit compelled Paul too
 To testify before the Jew
 That Jesus is the Christ in view.
 6 But when they had opposed him and
 Blasphemed, he shook garments in hand
 And said to them, "Your blood be on
 Your own heads, I'm clean. From now on
 I will go to the Gentiles' pawn."

Tentmaker preachers are the best, I know,
 Ed Elwall if no other told me so.
 If there's a creed behind the arm of church
 That pays the need in kind from harm of

perch,
 Then there's a belly of a pope to seal
 The tongue and message by the turn of

heel.
 Tentmaker preachers have the best appeal.
 Beloved, I preach to wall and stony path,
 To pine and birch beneath celestial wrath,
 And some may hear and some may turn

away,
 And even crickets only stop a day.
 But where I open heart to joy and gloom,
 I preach the word of coming cloud and
 doom,
 And rest my soul on Your bed in Your

room.
 7 And he departed from there and
 Entered a certain house, one manned
 By one named Justus, who served God,
 Whose house was next door to the broad
 Synagogue. 8 Then Crispus, the chief
 Of the synagogue, had belief
 In the Lord with all his house too.
 And many Corinthians too,
 Heard, believed, were baptized in crew.
 9 Now the Lord spoke to Paul at night
 By a vision, "Do not take fright,

But speak now, and do not keep still,
 10 "For I am with you, at the kill
 No one will attack you or hurt,
 For I have many folk alert
 In this town." 11 And he stayed a year
 And six months, teaching without fear
 The word of God to them to steer.

Some hear Your voice, or say they do, but I
 Doubt in the audience beneath the sky.
 I hear the twitter and the rustle come
 In still small voices, and I hear the sum
 Of nature speaking in the mystic voice
 Of the wood voices speaking to rejoice,
 But never do I hear the words take shape
 In meaning human and come in to drape
 Across my dreams of light or darker

choice.
 Beloved, I am no St. Paul, no, nor saint,
 But You might speak to smaller men and

faint
 Who in the crowd of come and go reside
 In hope beneath the greater human pride.
 Speak to the woollen-garbed, one without

cape.
 12 When Gallio in Achaia sat
 As proconsul, the Jews in spat
 With one accord rose to attack
 Paul and brought him to judgement whack,
 13 Saying "This fellow persuades men
 To worship God against the slack
 Of the law." 14 And when Paul would

speak
 Gallio told the Jews with cheek,
 "If it were issue of wrongdoing
 Or wicked crimes of him ensuing,
 O Jews, there would be reason why
 I should bear with you, or I'd try.
 15 "But if it's to do with the words
 And names and your own laws and herds,
 Look to it yourselves, for I do
 Not want to be a judge in pew."

16 And he drove them from judgment seat.
 17 Then all the Greeks took Sosthenes,
 The ruler of the synagogue,
 And beat him before judgment seat.
 But Gallio took no note in fog.

Good Gallio one without harms or disgrace
 Invented separation in this place

Between the state and church and sent the
clerics
All packing with their intrigues and their
lyrics.
That would be well enough, except the man
Turned a blind eye upon the priestly plan
To beat Sosthenes at the judgement seat:
Distinction between church and market
street
Brings justice only if without defeat
The anti-Semite is not free to act
Against the law and against peace in fact.
Beloved, since Rome arose there's been no
change
As humankind burns kind eye on the range
Of sales and profits, gaining what they
lacked.

18 So Paul still stayed there a long time.
Then he departed from his prime
Brothers and sailed for Syria,
And Priscilla and Aquila
Were with him. And he had his hair
Cut off at Cenchrea in share
Of a vow he had taken there.

Paul is a Pharisee under the law
And always will agree in humble awe
With Your commands. But see here, what's
this thing?

The vow requires no razor nor the sting
Of cutting hair at all. So why does Paul
Cut off his hair when he's against the wall?
I fear to guess, Beloved, because I know
He's made it so his keeping law won't
show.

If he starts out his vow with hair cut short,
It won't have time to grow before the sport
Has run through the time of his vow, and
none

Will realize at all what Paul has done.
I disapprove of circumvention of
The law to save the Romans' faith and love.

19 And he came to Ephesus, and
Left them there, but he came to stand
In synagogue to dialogue
With the Jews. 20 They begged him to stay
A longer time with them in sway,
But he would not, 21 but took his leave
Of them, saying "I must receive
This near feast in Jerusalem,

But I'll come back to you again,
In sha Allah." He joined the men
To sail from Ephesus. 22 And when
He had landed at Caesarea,
And gone up and greeted the freer
Group of called out ones, he went down
To Antioch into the town.
23 After he had spent some time there,
He left and went over the share
Of the Galatian, Phrygian stair,
To strengthen all disciples there.

Despite the fact that Paul rejected all
The works of the law by the sacred pall
Of Protestant in harried market ball,
He rushes to the feast of ancient time
As though to miss it would have been a
crime.

He could have stayed to preach to those
with ear
Bent to his words this time without the fear
That some would take him to the
judgement bar.
He could have stayed and been a preaching
star.

Instead he went on pilgrimage to find
The holy places to the Jewish mind.
Beloved, I too have hurried on a day
Toward Jerusalem, mere hope my pay,
To find the temple mount and stop to pray.

24 Now a certain Jew named Apollos,
Born in Alexandrian town,
An eloquent man of renown,
And mighty in Scriptures to stall us,
Came up to Ephesus. 25 This man
Had been instructed in the plan
Of the Lord, and in spirit strong,
He spoke and taught right things along
Of the Lord, though he only knew
The baptism of John and crew.
26 So he began to speak up bold
There in the synagogue and told.
When Aquila and Priscilla
Heard him, they took him by the claw
Aside and explained him the way
Of God in detailed light of day.
27 And when he wanted to cross to
Achaia, the brothers in crew
Wrote to exhort disciples there
To receive him and keep in care,
And when he got there, he became

A great help to those in the name
Believing through grace, 28 for he spoke
Unsparringly to Jewish folk
In refutation publicly,
Avowing from Scriptures' decree
That Jesus is the Christ to be.

While Paul went off to keep the yearly
feast
And left the willing synagogue decreased,
Apollos came to fill the void and tell
The story of repentance loud and well.
No man is indispensable for grace,
You always have another in his place
To right the song and run the frugal race.
The truth is known by great down to the
least.

Beloved, I barely touch my lyre and then
My lips are hushed in presence of all men.
As the word is increased in heart the tongue
Is turned aside where youthful bells had
rung.

I wake the torrent of my task and touch
The flowers of memory that I still clutch.

Acts 19

1 It happened, while Apollos stayed
At Corinth, that Paul, on parade
By upper regions, came down to
The town of Ephesus in view.
And finding some disciples there
2 He said to them, "Did you take care
To get the Holy Spirit when
You first believed?" They said again
To him, "We have not so much heard
The Holy Spirit in a word."
3 And he said to them, "Into what
Then were you baptized to the cut?"
They said, "The baptism of John."
4 Then Paul said "John indeed was drawn
To baptize with repentance' brawn
A baptism, telling the folk
They should believe upon the bloke
Who would come after him, in stroke,
On Christ Jesus." 5 When they heard this,
They were baptized in name to kiss
The Lord Jesus. 6 And when Paul laid
Hands on them, Holy Spirit made
Them speak in tongues and prophesy.
7 The men were about twelve come by.

The verse says they were baptized in the
name
Of the Lord Jesus. Ellen White would
claim

The Father, Son and Holy Ghost in fame
Was formula known in the Gospel days
And caused a rift from John's disciples'
ways.

If Paul baptized them in the blessed three,
(Without the mention of a trinity),
Then they would hear the Holy Spirit
spoken

As they were dipped to be a sign and token.
Beloved, the formula of words with care
Divides the human faith and heavenly
share.

I leave the argument and I lay bare
My heart before Your eye, my spirit broken
To know avenging power at last awoken.

8 He went into the synagogue
And spoke boldly in dialogue
For three months, to persuade about
The things of God's kingdom with shout.

9 But when some were hard in their doubt,
Spoke badly of the way before
The crowd, he left them on that score
And took his disciples apart
To study each day from the start
In the school of Tyrannus' art.

10 And this continued for two years,
So all who lived in Asian tiers
Heard the word of the Lord Jesus,
Both Jews and Greeks and without fuss.

11 Now God did strange signs at the hands
Of Paul, 12 so that even linen bands
Or smocks were brought that he had
touched

To the sick, and the sickness clutched
Would leave them and each evil spirit
Went back to hell or at least near it.

With three years here and two years there,
Paul was no nomad of the fair,
But tried to find a place to stay,
Not gallivanting round that way.
A sorcerer is more like to my mind,
One laying healing cloths upon the blind.
If I could find Tyrannus' school I'd go
And listen to the teaching in a row
Of other pupils not tired of the show.
So are men. They will always long to sit

Among the great and have a gloried fit.
Beloved, You have deprived me of the
crowd,
And I sit here alone, though head's
unbowed,
With rarely more than my own family's kit.

13 Some wandering Jewish exorcists
Dared take the name upon their fists
Of the lord Jesus over all
Those in the evil spirits' thrall,
Saying "We exorcise you by
The Jesus whom Paul preaches by."
14 Also there were seven sons of Sceva,
A Jewish chief priest, to receive her.
15 The evil spirit answered then
And said "Jesus I know again,
And Paul I know, but who are you?"
16 Then the man in whom evil grew
Jumped on them and he brought them down
And beat them so they fled the town
Naked and wounded, the whole crew.
17 This became known both to all Jews
And Greeks in the Ephesian mews,
And fear fell on them all, and so
The Lord Jesus' fame came to grow.
18 And many who had believed came
Confessing of their deeds of shame.
19 Also, many of those who had
Been doing magic that was bad
Brought their books in a pile to burn
In sight of all to give and earn.
They counted up the cost of them,
More than fifty thousand in gem.
20 So the Lord's word grew mightily
Prevailing over land and sea.

When sorcery backfires the naked few
Run out upon the town to see the view.
In all the courts and lanes where men have
met

Attractions in the things that they can get,
The evil spirits hide or then appear
To make the guilty ride on their own fear.
Some think occult is spirit without dress
Of matter or of body to confess,
But everywhere I find it, I see where
It is a moneyed profit and a ware.
The fifty thousand bits of silver grace
Are what attracts the fits of human race.
Beloved, I stand untried before Your face,
Acknowledging the coupled human share.

21 When these things were done, Paul
decided
And in the Spirit he confided,
When he'd gone through Macedonia
And throughout also Achaia,
To find Jerusalem and say
"After I've been there, I must stray
Also to see Rome in a day."
22 He sent into Macedonia
Two of those who served him in awe,
Timothy and Erastus, but
He himself stayed in Asia shut.
23 About then there arose a great
Commotion about the way straight.

I added straight here so the reader'd know
How close the text is to Qur'anic show,
Where the right faith is the straight way to
go,
According to the first words in a row.
Commotion there may be at times about
The straight way, and a hue, a sigh, or
shout,
But mostly market men on the highway
Do not stop to note it or go astray
Upon the rugged foot-path and the bill
That takes the soul on the celestial hill.
Beloved, I stay in Asia in my mind,
And look toward the east, if it were kind,
The emptiness beneath the rolling sky,
The dusty hills and cities on the cry.

24 A certain man named Demetrius,
A silversmith, who made a fuss
Of silver shrines of Diana,
Brought no small profit to the crew
Of craftsmen. 25 He called them to meet
With other workers in their street,
And said "Men, you know that our treat
Is by this trade. 26 "You see and hear
Not only in Ephesian gear,
But throughout almost all the land
Of Asia, this Paul gives command
To turn the folk away and say
That they are not gods whom to pray
That are made by our hands for pay.
27 "So not only this trade of ours
Is like to fail of fame and powers,
But also the great temple of
The great goddess Diana's love
May be despised, her greatness fall,

Whom all Asia, the world in thrall,
Come to worship for house and stall."

Demetrius had fear the craft to make
The silver image to worship at stake.
He was too optimistic of the crowd
Who claimed to follow Jesus and his
shroud.

If icons were too difficult to paint,
They could all move to Rome where
imaged saint

Is still the object of Ephesian prayer,
The hope of everyone upon the stair.
Beloved, the world You made is quick to
think

That evil that supports us on the brink
Is like to fall before the onslaught of
The good, the true, the beautiful for love,
And yet the comic images remain
As though the human lot were to be sane.

28 Now when they heard, their wrath arose,
And they shouted out in their throes,
To say "Great is Diana of
Ephesians!" 29 The whole town in shove
Was filled with the confusion, and
Rushed to the theatre to stand
Together, having seized Gaius
As well as one Aristarchus,
Both Macedonians and friends
Of Paul in travel to those ends.
30 And when Paul wanted to go in
To the folk to allay the din,
The disciples would not permit.
31 Then some of the officials fit
Of Asia, who were his friends, sent
To him begging not to prevent
Into the theatre. 32 Some then
Shouted one thing, and then again
Another, for the crowd was sot,
And most of them outside the plot
Of why they had come in the lot.
33 And they drew Alexander out
Of the crowd, the Jews set with clout.
And Alexander beckoned so
With his hand he might have a go
To defend the folk from the show.
34 But when they knew he was a Jew,
All with one voice cried out for two
Hours, "Great is Diana of the
Ephesians to eternity!"
35 And when the city clerk had come

To silence the crowd to a hum,
He said "Men of Ephesus, who
Is there who does not know it's true
That the Ephesians' town is set
To guard the temple that is let
To the great goddess Diana,
And to the image which fell down
From Zeus to grace our grateful town?
36 "So since these things are not denied,
You should be quiet and go hide.
37 "For you have brought these men here
who

Are neither robbers of the crew
Of temples nor blasphemers of
Your goddess Diana you love.
38 "So if Demetrius and those
Of his craftsmen have come and chose
A case against anyone here,
The courts are open to appear
Before proconsuls. Let them bring
Their charges against any ring.
39 "But if you have a question more,
It shall be settled on the score
Of lawful gathering in store.
40 "For we are liable to be
Called to account for the uproar
Of this day's tumult that you see,
Since there's no reason we can give
To explain this uproar and live."
41 And when he had said all these things,
He sent the crowd away on wings.

The institutions of most blessed Rome
Have become so entrenched that they seem
home.

The mob prevails, it is the arm of strife
The state must use instead of gun and knife.
The pinched claws are mob and its
control

To keep the laboured oppressed on the dole
And foster usury of toll and goal.
The better way and day seems just a tale,
Imagination rioting in gaol,
And with no outlet but to shout and sing
Until the controls fall upon the thing.
Beloved, I'd be snowbound a winter's day,
And feel the frost creep in the feeble ray,
Before I'd kiss Ephesian temple's sway.

Acts 20

1 After the uproar stopped, Paul called
The disciples, kissed, and installed

To go back to Macedonia.
 2 Now when he had gone over all
 That region and encouraged them
 With many messages in gem,
 He came to Greece 3 and stayed there three
 Months. And when the Jews plotted spree
 Against him on the point to sail
 To Syria, he changed his tale,
 Went back to Macedonia.
 4 And Sopater of Berea
 Went along with him to Asia,
 And also Aristarchus and
 Secundus of the hardy band
 Of the Thessalonians, and
 Gaius of Derbe, Timothy,
 And Tychicus and one to see,
 Trophimus of Asian degree.
 5 These men went ahead, stopped to wait
 For us at Troas. 6 But in rate
 We sailed away from Philippi
 After Days of Unleavened Bread,
 And in five days joined them to spy
 At Troas, where for seven days' spread
 We stayed with them as we were led.

As soon as all was quiet on that shore,
 And Ephesus lay under charm and spell
 Of goddess gleaming from the temple door,
 Paul found a reason to escape the knell.
 Some men are satisfied to live in peace,
 While others seek the tumult of the way,
 The market and the mob in its release,
 The open struggle under light of day.
 Beloved, I seek the yeastless loaf again
 As spring retards the winter's life for men.
 I seek the silent air of forest plot,
 The hope of summer and forget-me-not.
 Let Paul look out for trouble in his spot:
 I keep me to the wonders of my den.

7 Now on the first day of the week,
 When the disciples came to seek
 To break bread, Paul, ready to go
 On the next day, preached there in stow,
 Continued his words till midnight.

The evening after the blessed Sabbath past
 Was still a time of breaking bread to last
 Throughout the night till Sunday morning
 dawn
 When Paul would leave for the next place
 he's drawn.

If I could hear Paul preaching on that score,
 I doubt he could keep interest at my door
 Till midnight. I would surely find it hard
 To understand the Greek of such a pard.
 Beloved, I meet the coming of the eve
 With prayers upon my lips that I receive
 From Paul in what he wrote a message
 better
 Than what the Christians would find in his
 letter,
 That Paul releases one and all from fetter
 Of law that protects lowly ones who grieve.

8 There were many lamps in their sight
 In the high room where they sat bright.
 9 And in a window there sat one
 Young man named Eutychus when done,
 Who slumbered instead on the run.
 And being overcome by sleep,
 And Paul kept preaching to the sheep,
 He fell down from the third floor and
 Was taken up dead where they stand.
 10 But Paul went down and fell on him,
 Embracing him said fast and trim,
 "Don't worry, his life's still in him."
 11 When he'd come up, and broken bread
 And eaten, and talked on instead
 Until the dawn, at last he went.
 12 And they brought the young man
 present
 Alive, and sat in comfort sent.

Paul preached the young crowd into
 slumbered dream
 Until one fell down from the window's
 team.
 He ought to have known from the start the
 way
 To get a young man going not astray
 Is to have a band playing with trap-set
 To beat the band with all the power they
 get.
 This droning on of elders through the years
 Brought the good faith near to the ground
 in tears.
 But fortunately heathen tunes arose
 In time to save the pious from their pose,
 And get them waving arms in their gustos
 To wag a tail in time with all their peers.
 Beloved, no one today can fall asleep
 In the disco churches thrown in a heap.

13 Then we went on to the ship and
 Sailed to Assos, there to take stand
 Of Paul on board, for so he'd said,
 Planning to go on foot instead.
 14 And when he met us at Assos,
 We took him on board with a toss
 And came to Mitylene across.
 15 We sailed from there, and the next day
 Came opposite Chios in weigh.
 The following day we arrived
 At Samos and stayed as contrived
 At Trogyllium. The next day we
 Came to Miletus in degree.
 16 For Paul decided to sail past
 Ephesus, so that he at last
 Would not have to spend time in Asia,
 For he was in haste for the pleasure
 Of being in Jerusalem,
 If he could, on the day in hem
 Of Pentecost and no outcast.

Paul is a Pharisee, I see, from start
 To finish by both words and playing part.
 Instead of going back to meet the crowd
 Of the Ephesians to preach on aloud,
 He wants to rush down to Jerusalem
 To keep the Jewish feasts with Jewish gem.
 That ought to be proof in my book that he
 Did not despise the law eternally.
 Beloved, they see I am not a Pharisee,
 Nor any other sort of Jewish bloke,
 I like him better as with honest folk
 He shows his colours with a lawful stroke.
 Though I fail to go down to join the feast,
 I still applaud the efforts of the least.

17 From Miletus he sent on to
 Ephesus and called for the crew
 Of elders of the group of those
 Called out ones to be on their toes.
 18 And when they'd come to him, he said
 To them "You know, from the first spread
 When I came to Asia, how I
 Always lived among you, as spry
 19 "To serve YHWH with humility,
 With many tears and trials on me
 By the plotting of the Jews, 20 "how I
 Kept back nothing of my supply,
 But declared all of it to you,
 And taught you publicly in view
 And from house to house, 21 "and to bear
 Witness to Jews, and to Greeks there,

Repentance toward God and the way
 Of faith in our Lord Jesus Christ.
 22 "And see, now I go bound today
 In spirit to Jerusalem,
 Not knowing what things have sufficed
 To happen to me in that den,
 23 "Except the Holy Spirit's word
 In every city, I have heard
 Saying chains and troubles wait me.
 24 "But none of these things have moved
 me,
 Nor do I count my life's degree
 So dear to myself, so that I
 May finish my race and with joy,
 And the service which I received
 From the Lord Jesus undeceived,
 To testify in Gospel way
 Of grace of God and without pay.

You sent Your spirit to reveal the fate
 Of Paul if he went in the city's gate,
 And still he runs toward the temple scene,
 With conscience paved, untrummeled,
 conscience clean.
 You sent Your spirit telling Paul the day
 He stepped into the town of David's sway,
 He would be taken up in chains and find
 A task among the fettered and the blind.
 Beloved, I follow unseen in the way
 That Paul went looking for a loving ray,
 And see the temple towers gleam from the
 height
 Of hope in Rome against all heathen spite.
 The hope is vain for temple, Paul and all:
 The grave has long consumed them at the
 wall.

25 "And indeed, now I know you all,
 Among whom I've gone at the call
 Of preaching the kingdom of God,
 Will see my face no more on sod.
 26 "Therefore I bear witness to you
 Today that I'm innocent too
 Of the blood of all men in crew.
 27 "For I have not shunned to declare
 To you God's whole counsel in share.
 28 "Therefore take heed to yourselves and
 To all the flock, among which planned
 The Holy Spirit to appoint
 You overseers, and anoint
 To shepherd the group of called out
 Ones of God which He bought about

With the blood of His own and stout.
 29 "For I know this, after I've gone
 Bloodthirsty wolves will come in drawn
 Among you, not sparing the flock.
 30 "Also from among your own stock
 Men will rise up, and speak false things,
 To draw away disciples' rings.
 31 "So watch, and mind that for three years
 I did not cease to warn with tears
 Everyone night and day of fears.

The wolves indeed came in as Paul
 proposed,
 They tore the message from fingers
 unclosed,
 And made a pagan suit of arms to wear
 Before the emperor with all the fair.
 They took Paul's name and word to raise a
 flag
 Against the Sabbath queen, to crown the
 hag
 Of Tammuz with a Trinity and fire
 Upon an altar gilded with the dire.
 Beloved, if Paul had written not a word,
 Could the result in this world that's
 unstirred
 By the truth faith be in a worse appeal?
 Your plan's behind the roll of wait and
 weal.
 Though church may be cast in the lowest
 hell,
 You see and say Apostle Paul did well.

32 "So now, brothers, I commend you
 To God and to the word that's true
 Of His grace, which can build you up
 And give you heritage in cup
 Among all those who're sanctified.
 33 "I have coveted no one's pride
 Of silver or gold or clothing.
 34 "Yes, you yourselves know everything
 That these hands have provided for
 My needs, and for those who in store
 Were with me. 35 "I have shown you how
 By labouring by sweat of brow,
 That you must take care of the weak.
 And mind words Lord Jesus would speak,
 That he said 'It is blessed more
 To give than to receive in store.'"

Traditions oral of the things Christ said
 That did not enter in the Gospel spread,

Are found upon the tongue of those who're
 led
 Into assemblies of the better read.
 So Paul, whose hand provides his meals
 and coat,
 As well of those of them to whom he
 wrote,
 Remembers the good word a gift to him
 Of what Christ said among the former dim.
 Beloved, no word falls empty to the wind
 Or on the ground where humankind have
 sinned,
 But that upon the day that You make true
 It rises phoenix-like above the dew.
 I wait in Your eternity and view
 To find the treasures You've gathered and
 binned.

36 And when he had said all these things,
 He knelt down and prayed in their rings.
 37 Then they all wept freely, and fell
 On Paul's neck and they kissed him well,
 38 And grieved most for the words he said,
 That they would never more be led
 To see his face. And so they went
 With him down to the ship he meant.

The centuries pass with the ache and tears
 Of great theologies beyond our years,
 And wrangling if the Pauline Gospel's
 gears
 Are right or wrong or anything but fears.
 The letter kills indeed, and what he wrote
 Is often more a curse some Christian smote
 Than spirit and the life he hoped to lay
 Upon the heart by night and loving day.
 But turning from the tide of dogma's gain
 Into the spring of welcome coming rain
 To see how those who knew him wept that
 they
 Might never see him more, I stop to pray
 In pity for myself I never knew
 The living hand and warm of Paul in view.

Acts 21

1 Now it came to pass, that when we
 Had departed from them, set free
 Sail, running a straight course, then we
 Came to Cos, the next day to Rhodes,
 And from there to Patara's loads.
 2 And finding a ship sailing over
 To Phoenicia, we like a rover

Went on board and set sail for clover.
 3 When we had sighted Cyprus, we
 Passed it upon the left-hand lee,
 Sailed to Syria, landed at Tyre,
 For there the ship was by her hire
 To unload cargo piled up higher.
 4 And finding some disciples' ways,
 We remained there for seven days.
 They told Paul through the Spirit not
 To go to Jerusalem's plot.
 5 When we'd come to those days' end, we
 Departed, went on our way, see,
 And they all went with us, with wives
 And children, till we left the hives
 Out of the city. And we knelt
 Down on the shore, prayed as we felt.
 6 When we had taken our leave there
 Of one another, for our share
 We boarded the ship, and they went
 Back to their homes and were content.
 7 When we'd finished the trip from Tyre,
 We came to Ptolemais on fire
 To greet the brothers, and to stay
 With them there the space of a day.

It all sounds so romantically inclined
 That the disciples met were so designed
 To give the sense the spirit taught them
 well,
 And give a message and a word to tell.
 The distance in both time and place perhaps
 Prevents belief in me from its collapse.
 But if I heard that someone near my stall
 Thought the divine word had met in the
 thrall,
 I should have doubted. Maybe that's why
 Paul
 Has no regard in practice for the word,
 The message given by the saintly herd.
 Beloved, I pass Your whispers though not
 faint,
 I think them narrow if not rather quaint,
 And so miss revelations of a saint.

8 On the next day we who were Paul's
 Companions departed the stalls
 And came to Caesarea, and
 Went in Philip's house and to stand,
 Who was evangelist among
 The seven, and stayed with his young.
 9 For this man had four virgin daughters
 Who prophesied of coming *slaughters*.

10 And as we stayed there many days,
 A certain prophet named for praise
 Agabus came down from Judea.
 11 When he had come to us, the seer
 Took Paul's belt, bound his own hands and
 His feet, and said "So is the stand
 Of Holy Spirit, 'So shall those
 Jews at Jerusalem for shows
 Bind the man who owns this belt, and
 Deliver him into the hand
 Of Gentiles.'" 12 Now when we heard
 these
 Things, both we and those from those lees
 Pleaded with him not to go up
 Into Jerusalem *like tup*.
 13 Then Paul replied, "What do you mean
 By weeping and breaking my spleen?
 For I am ready not to be
 Just bound, but also to die free
 At Jerusalem for the name
 Of the Lord Jesus in acclaim."
 14 So when he would not change his mind,
 We stopped our trying and resigned
 Said "Let the will of YHWH be done."

The seven daughters beautiful that claimed
 Descent from the evangelist and famed
 Philip failed to report the coming tide
 Against Paul on the Zionitic side.
 It seems a man, a single man, was better
 Than any female prophet since he met her.
 Beloved, I do protest the implication
 A man is better by multiplication.
 What seven women could not do, he came
 And set on end. Beloved, it is a shame.
 Paul clutches at the wrong straw in the
 wind.
 If he'd said that he listened and not sinned
 To follow the advice of Philip's daughters,
 He might have kept my pleasure in his
 waters.

15 And after those days we packed and
 Went up to Jerusalem's strand.
 16 Some disciples from Caesarea
 Also went with us and made freer
 To bring with them a certain Mnason
 Of Cyprus, one who'd early hasten
 To be a disciple, with whom
 We were to lodge and find our room.
 17 When we'd come to Jerusalem,
 The brothers welcomed us in hem.

18 On the next day Paul went with us
To James, and all the omnibus
Of elders were gathered. 19 And when
He'd greeted them, he told again
In detail those things which God did
Among the Gentiles through his bid.
20 When they heard, they glorified
YHWH.

And they said to him, "You see true,
Brother, how many of the Jew
There are who have believed, and they
Are zealous all for the law's sway,
21 "But they have been informed of you
That you teach all the Jews who stay
Among the Gentiles to give way
Forsaking Moses, saying that
They ought not to circumcise flat
Their children nor to follow fat.
22 "So now, the crowd will surely meet,
For they'll hear that you've come in seat.
23 "So do what we tell you: We've got
Four men who've taken a vow's plot.
24 "Take them and be cleansed with them
too,

And pay their way so they may too
Shave heads, and so all may know that
The things they heard about your scat
Are empty, but that you yourself
Walk lawfully upon your shelf.

25 "But of the Gentiles who believe,
We've written to give them reprieve
From doing such a thing, but they
Should keep themselves from things they
slay
To idols, from blood and from things
Strangled and fornication's flings."

It seems that even those who follow You,
Beloved, and know Your sent one is the
true,

May have exaggeration in the crew.
Paul does not lag behind the other Jew
In his regard for Pharisean due.
Is any act done for the saints to see
A thing to grasp and contemplate and be
It's executioner? I doubt indeed,
Beloved that I should join the doubtless
creed.

Let me seek only Your desire for me
And let no man impede my love's
stampede.

Then when the harvest of the foreskins
done

Is gathered in beneath the purple sun,
I'll have another game that I have won.

26 Then Paul took the men, and next day,
Being purified in their way,
Went to the temple to proclaim
The end of the cleansing in aim,
To make an offering for each one.

For trying Paul cannot come satisfy
All men, though he may live in ways to try.
A Greek to Greeks, a Jew to Jews, gives
way

To anger on the part of every dray.
What Christian now is happy to read here
That Paul went in the temple with his gear
To sacrifice a sheep or goat to bring
Its blood into the holy temple's ring?
It stands to be a problem theologic,
Embarrassment before the bishop's dogic.
But then if he'd refused to do the rite,
The holy church would squelch him from
their sight.

Beloved, I am a hermit in this crowd
Of saints who seem to serve You as
allowed.

27 Near the end of the seven days,
The Jews from Asia saw the phase
Of him inside the temple, and
Stirred up the whole crowd in a band
And in their violence laid hand
On him, 28 and shouted out aloud,
"Men of Israel, stand and be proud
To aid! This is the man who teaches
All men in every country's reaches
Against the people, and the law,
And this place that we hold in awe,
And furthermore he also brought
Greeks into the temple in plot
Defiling this holy place sought."
29 For they had earlier caught sight
Of Trophimus, Ephesian wight
With him in the town, and they thought
That Paul had come with him and brought
Him in the temple. 30 All the town
Was troubled, and the folk ran riot
And seized Paul and dragged him unquiet
Out of the temple, and straight off
They shut the doors against such scroff.

The truth is Paul had taught a greater sight,
 The heavenly temple to replace the might
 Of earthly crowns caught in Jerusalem,
 The heavenly sanctuary and the gem
 That once was opened to the dying eye
 Of Stephen as he cried aloud with sigh.
 The truth is Paul, though bringing sacrifice,
 Looked to the heavenly ministry and nice
 Of resurrected Christ, that figure who
 Affirmed his Pharisean sort of view
 That death leads to the resurrection true.
 But beside truth the notion of the crowd
 Is always false and violent to shroud
 The interests of the state, unholy cloud.

31 Now as they tried to kill him, news
 Came to the commander of crews
 In garrison that all the town
 Jerusalem from head to crown
 Was in an uproar. 32 He straight off
 Took soldiers and centurions,
 And ran down to them in their tonnes.
 And when they saw the officer
 And soldiers, they stopped beating cur.
 33 The officer came near and took
 Him and commanded him and shook
 His with two chains, and he asked who
 He was and what he'd come to do.
 34 And some among the multitude
 Cried one thing, some another shrewd.
 So when he could not ascertain
 The truth because of riot's reign,
 He ordered him brought back inside
 The barracks so he could decide.
 35 When he reached the stairs, he must be
 Borne by the soldiers for the spree
 Of the crowd. 36 For the multitude
 Of folk had followed harsh and rude
 To shout out "Be he done away!"
 37 As Paul was at the door in sway,
 He asked the officer, "Now may
 I speak to you?" And he replied,
 "Can you speak Greek? 38 Are you decried
 Egyptian who some time ago
 Stirred up rebellion and led four
 Thousand assassins on the sand?"
 39 But Paul said "I'm a Jew to stand
 From Tarsus, in Cilicia, and
 A citizen of no mean town,
 And beg you let me speak now down
 To the folk." 40 So he gave him leave,

And Paul stood on the stairs in sleeve,
 And motioned to the folk. And when
 There was a greater silence, then
 He spoke to them in Hebrew tongue,
 Speaking the truth he'd always sung.

There are two kinds of folk alive today,
 I swear, Beloved, of those come out to
 play.

There is the mob that's ready at the kill,
 There is the guard established by the will
 Of those who farm the rabble not with hate,
 But merely in the greed their fires create.
 If I could find one man or woman too
 Whose eyes were wholly fixed in love on
 you,

Then I would change my tune about the
 view.

The optimism of Paul on the stairs,
 Who thought a word of truth despoiled of
 cares

Might turn to love and life, is more than I
 Can muster as I turn about the sty.
 Beloved, I raise my hat at Pauline shares.

Acts 22

1 "Brothers and fathers, hear the word
 Of my defence, and so be stirred."
 2 And when they heard him speak to them
 In Hebrew language, they kept hem
 The more in silence. Then he said:
 3 "I am indeed a Jew and bred
 In Tarsus *town* of Cilicia,
 But brought up in this town of awe
 At the feet of Gamaliel,
 Taught by the strictness and taught well
 In our ancestors' law, and I
 Was zealous toward God as you cry
 Also today. 4 "I came to slay
 Those who followed this very way,
 And bound them and brought them into
 Custody, men and women's crew,
 5 "As the high priest bears witness to,
 The elders' council all in view,
 From whom I also received script
 To the brothers, and went equipped
 Down to Damascus to bring back
 In chains those who were there in slack
 Up to Jerusalem to be
 Punished all for their heresy.

The arm of justice is a heavy arm

When spread about to do us woe and harm.
 The heresy of faith in Christ who came
 Opposing every state as though in blame,
 Without an act of violence and shame,
 Cannot be tolerated in the game.
 The violence is assumed at the vest,
 And perpetrated with a legal zest.
 But those who fail in loyalty to fear,
 Are apprehended with pacific gear.
 Beloved, I am a heretic, I know,
 Among the purple-plumed who rise a go
 Before the pageantry of pope and state.
 I stand before Your throne, Beloved, and
 wait.

6 "And so it happened as I went
 And came near Damascus not spent
 Beyond noon, suddenly a great
 Light from the sky shone round in state.
 7 "And I fell to the ground and heard
 A voice that said to me and stirred,
 'Saul, Saul, why persecute thou me?'
 8 "And so I answered, 'Who now be
 You, sir?' And so he said to me,
 'I'm Jesus of Nazareth, whom
 You persecute and to your doom.'
 9 "And those who were with me indeed
 Saw the light, were afraid, *and peed*,
 But they did not hear his voice who
 Spoke to me. 10 "I said, 'What to do,
 Sir?' And the lord said to me, 'Rise
 And go into Damascus wise,
 And there you will be told all things
 Which are determined for your springs.'
 11 "And since I could not see the way
 For the glory of that light's sway,
 I was led by the hand of those
 Who were with me, until my toes
 Came to Damascus, as I chose.

When will men learn to know and see the
 truth
 That standing before glory in their youth
 Is what makes them blind to all faith and
 ruth?
 The vision personal and glory met
 Are not the gate to seeing the well set,
 But keep the eye from every way that's
 true,
 So that an executioner and crew
 Can lead better than priest or president.

When will men learn to know the way You
 sent?
 Beloved, I too, before the gloried sight
 Remain impressed by power, and by the
 might.
 And yet I know to wait till that is past,
 And for the scales to fall from leaguered
 mast.
 The still room is the place of divine cast.

12 "A certain Ananias there,
 A devout man and by the share
 Of the law, with a good witness
 Of all the Jews who would confess,
 13 "Came to me, and he stood and said
 To me, 'Brother Saul, come instead
 To have your sight.' And at that same
 Hour I looked up at him from flame.
 14 "So he said 'Our ancestors' God
 Has chosen you to know His rod,
 And see the Just One, and to hear
 The message of his mouth in fear.
 15 'For you will be his witness here
 To all men of what you have seen
 And what you heard beyond the screen.
 16 'And now why are you waiting? Rise
 And take the way that will baptize
 And wash away your sins, and call
 Upon the name of YHWH withal.'

The goal of every vision and the sight
 Of glories on the hill and road for spite,
 Is always to return repenting where
 The soul must call upon You for its share.
 To call upon Your name is all the prayer
 That any may assume with humble care.
 The brighter celebrations on the air,
 The pageants and parades of guilded wear,
 Are mereness of hypocrisy, I swear.
 Beloved, I stop upon the dergah floor
 And call upon Your names before the four
 Gates of obedience and burning love,
 Awareness and the truth of hand in glove,
 The treasures unlocked in abundant store.

17 "It happened, when I came back to
 Jerusalem and prayed as due
 Within the temple, I was in
 A trance 18 "and saw him there to win
 Me saying to me, 'Make haste and
 Get out of Jerusalem's stand
 And quickly, for they'll not receive

Your testimony that I grieve.’
 19 “So I said ‘Sir, they know that in
 Every synagogue I made din
 To imprison and beat those who
 Had come to believe upon you.
 20 ‘When the blood of Your martyr
 Stephen
 Was shed, I also would get even
 By standing to consent to death,
 And guarded the coats with my breath
 Of those who slew him unreprieved.’
 21 “Then he said to me, ‘Go your way,
 For I will send you far to stray
 From here to the Gentiles in sway.’”

The Jewish crowd would listen and be still
 Until the man said something of a pill:
 That he would rather the uncircumcised
 Were at his table than the well-apprised.
 If anyone could give the matter thought,
 He should acknowledge that his life has
 taught
 Him such means are the way to come to
 grief.
 Why did Paul sabotage his own belief?
 Beloved, he should have listened to the bill
 Of what You said by Spirit to the fill.
 Instead he went head-long into the gate
 Of blind Jerusalem to find his fate.
 Keep me, Beloved, from every mosque and
 church,
 And I will remain on Your divine perch.

22 They listened to him till he said
 That, and then they raised cry instead,
 “Away with such a fellow spread
 From the earth, for he is not fit
 To live!” 23 Then, as they cried to wit
 And tore off their clothes and threw dust
 Into the air, 24 commander must
 Order him to be brought into
 The barracks, and said he should do
 With scourging to say what is true,
 So he might know why they cried out
 Against him, and not be in doubt.
 25 And as they bound him with ropes there,
 Paul said to the centurion's share
 Who stood by, “Is it lawful for
 You to scourge a man and make sore
 Who is a Roman, uncondemned?”
 26 When the centurion heard that stemmed,
 He went to tell the commander,

And said “Take care what you would stir,
 For this man's a Roman, *no cur.*”
 27 Then the commander came and said
 To him, “Say, are you Roman bred?”
 He said “Yes.” 28 The commander said
 “With a large sum I got this spread.”
 And Paul said “I was born and bred.”
 29 Then straight off those who were about
 To torture him withdrew their snout,
 And the commander too was scared
 To find out he was Roman fared,
 Because he'd bound him *unimpaired*.
 30 The next day, since he wished to know
 For sure why Jews accused him so,
 He brought him from the prison stow,
 And ordered the chief priests to show
 And all their council to appear,
 And brought Paul down and set to hear.

The work of law and order since the day
 That Paul was saved by Romans set in
 sway,
 Has weakened and diminished at the fray.
 In those days a passport of citizen
 Could save one from the torture-chamber's
 den.
 But now Guantanamo comes in the list
 Of places where the innocent are hissed,
 From which the guilty are set free and
 missed
 To kill again, because they have been
 kissed
 By those who hold the oil and turn the gold
 From cave to cave where children are still
 sold.
 If I were caught today, nothing could save
 Me from the water torture and the grave,
 No word that I am free, waste to be brave.

Acts 23

1 And Paul looked earnestly about
 At the council in the redoubt,
 And said “Men and brothers, I've spent
 My life in all good conscience meant
 Before God until this day lent.”
 2 And the high priest Ananias
 Commanded those who stood in class
 By him to strike him on the mouth.
 3 Then Paul said to him, north and south,
 “God will strike you, you whitewashed
 wall!
 For you sit to judge me in thrall

According to the law, and do
You command me to be struck too
Contrary to the law in view?"

4 And those who stood by said "Do you
Reville God's high priest?" 5 Then Paul
said

"I did not know, brothers and bred,
That he was the high priest, for it
Is written, 'You shall not speak shit
Of your people's ruler and fit.'"

The fact is that the priest did act in view
Of the law in a way that is not true.
The fact that he was the high priest did not
Excuse his acting in the wayward plot.
Did Paul sincerely take authority
Of the same sinner who condemned the
free

Jesus as divine under sovereignty?
I think not. But the *taqiyya* he used
Was how to avoid being more abused.
The stroke upon the jaw set him to think
How to step back from falling off the brink.
Beloved, I speak the word to swim or sink,
Not by the truth You hold, but by the sway
Of how to survive and to get away.

6 But when Paul noticed that one part
Were Sadducees, while the upstart
Of others were the Pharisees,
He cried out in the council sees,
"Men and brothers, and if you please,
I am a Pharisee, the son
Of Pharisee, for the hope won
And resurrection of the dead
I'm being judged with all this dread!"

7 When he said this, a fury broke
Out between Pharisees and yoke
Of Sadducees, the council room
Was in division to its doom.

8 For Sadducees say there is no
Form resurrecting, and there's no
Angel or spirit, but the both
Are confessed by Pharisees' quoth.

9 So there arose a loud outcry.
And the scribes of the Pharisees'
Party arose protesting why,
Saying, "We find no evil in
This man, but if a spirit's din
Or angel has spoken to him,
Let us not fight against God's vim."

10 When there arose a great dissension,

The officer, fearing to mention
That Paul might be pulled clear apart,
Commanded the soldiers to start
Down and take him by force from them,
And bring him in the barracks' hem.

11 But the next night the Lord stood by
Him and said, "Be of good cheer's tie,
Paul, for you've testified for me
Here in Jerusalem finely,
So you must also bear witness
At Rome where you will give address."

I start to understand the way of Paul,
Who followed Jesus in his lowly call
To quiet insubordination's wall.
And yet it is a Roman sort of creed
That martyrdom amounts to the faith's seed.
I'd rather live in peace with my own greed
Of Your love on the hill, upon the mead.
I'd rather live in peace in my own stall.
Beloved, I too stand where the corners
meet,

The Christians grope, the Muslims shout
their feat,

The Jews remain a nation and complete.
White martyrdom instead of crosses keep
Me safe beneath my winter sort of sleep,
Although I still hear the saints rise and
weep.

12 When it was day, some of the Jews
Banded together to abuse
An oath, saying that they would not
Eat or drink till they'd done the plot
To kill Paul. 13 Now there were more than
Forty who plotted to a man.

14 They came to the chief priests and
elders,

And said *like brick-layers and welders*,
"We've bound ourselves under a great
Oath that we will eat nothing late
Until we've killed Paul the ingrate.

15 "So you together with the crowd
Of councillors suggest aloud
To the commander that he be
Brought down to you tomorrow, see,
As though you would question the more,
But we are ready at the door
To kill him before he comes near."

As soon as congregations grow to be
Greater than just the promised two or three,

Then there arises some late jealousy,
 And hate requires the action of the free.
 It may be just the pecking order met
 In farmyard fowl and human sort of pet,
 But in time will grow to the plot to kill,
 For hate is murder in the heavenly bill.
 Beloved, I flee from congregations here,
 The twelves and twenties standing without
 tear
 Beside the slain, beside the green and bier.
 I flee to You from every human pride,
 The building and the offering in the slide
 From hope of height to earthen gate and
 weir.

16 So when Paul's sister's son heard that
 Ambush was plotted under fat,
 He went to the barracks and told
 Paul. 17 Then Paul called one of the bold
 Centurions to him and said,
 "Take this young man now to the head
 Commander, let him speak as led."
 18 So he took him and brought him to
 The commander and said in view,
 "Paul the prisoner called me to
 Him and asked me to bring this young
 Man to you. He has word on tongue."
 19 Then the commander took him by
 The hand, went aside for reply,
 "What is it you have to tell me?"
 20 And he said "The Jews would agree
 To ask to bring Paul down into
 The council for tomorrow's crew,
 As though they would inquire anew.
 21 "But do not yield to them, for more
 Than forty of them lie in store
 For him, men who have bound themselves
 By an oath that they will like elves
 Neither eat nor drink till they've killed,
 And now they're ready where they've
 swilled
 To wait the promise from you billed."
 22 So the commander let the young
 Man go, commanding, "Hold your tongue
 From telling you've revealed these things
 To me." 23 And he called from the wings
 For two centurions, and said
 "Prepare two hundred soldiers fed,
 And seventy horsemen to be led,
 And two hundred spearmen to go
 To Caesarea at the third
 Hour of the night when none have heard,

24 "And provide mounts to set Paul on,
 And bring him safely at the dawn
 To Felix who is governor."

There are things one can count on in the
 fest
 Of government among the ruling vest.
 They do protect the prisoner at best
 From those who would endanger him in
 zest.

A dog will ran from master with a bone,
 At least one not trained in the law of stone.
 A hawk will stand beside her kill to keep
 It from the buzzard hoping for the heap.
 Beloved, I too play at the game to find
 A refuge from the fruited and the wined,
 And so rely on guns and swords that make
 The other thugs turn back and in the wake
 Of harm and hope beneath the glories' take.
 I am aware, Beloved, of what You signed.

25 He wrote a letter on this score:
 26 Claudius Lysias, unto
 The most excellent of the crew
 Felix: Greetings. 27 This man was seized
 By the Jews and they unappeased
 Were out to kill him. But I came
 With troops and rescued him from blame,
 Since I learned he was Roman flame.
 28 And when I wanted to know why
 They had accused him on the sly
 I brought him to their council try.
 29 I found out he was blamed about
 Questions of their law, but without
 Charges deserving death or chains.
 30 And when it was told me the Jews
 Lay in wait for the man in crews,
 I sent him straight way off to you,
 And also commanded his crew
 Of such accusers to tell you
 The charges against him. Adieu.
 31 Then the soldiers, as they were told,
 Took Paul and brought him by night cold
 To Antipatris. 32 The next day
 They left the horsemen go away
 With him, and returned to the fort.
 33 When they came near the town for sport
 Called Caesarea and had brought
 The letter to governor sought,
 They also presented to him
 Paul. 34 And when the governor grim
 Had read it, he asked what province

He was from. And when he said since
That he was from Cilicia, 35 he
Said, "I will hear you in degree
When your accusers also come."
And he commanded him to be
Kept in Herod's Praetorium.

The letter of a civil servant may
Be accurate in sum, in sultry way
The facts are set in such helpful array
That shows between the signs how great
the man

Is who remembered to keep to the plan
Of building up his own career from ban.
So Claudius take full advantage of
The accidents of tricks in hand and glove
To tell how faithfully he serves the state,
While in fact he looks to his own bright
pate.

Beloved, the more the change, the more the
rate

Of the same courage to embrace the fate.
I turn from love of self and from self-hate
And find You and Your own eternal love.

Acts 24

1 Now after five days Ananias
The high priest came down there to try us
With the elders and with a man
To speak named Tertullus in clan.
These gave their evidence in blame
To the governor against Paul.

2 And when he was called to the game
Tertullus began words in blame,
Saying "Seeing that through you we
Enjoy great peace, prosperity
Is brought to this nation to see
By your foresight, 3 "we take it aye
And in all places like sweet pie,
Most noble Felix, with all thanks.

4 "Yet not to bore you with our ranks,
I beg you hear by courtesy,
A few words from us. 5 "For now we
Have found this man a plague, a maker
Of great dissension and a staker
Among all Jews throughout the world,
And a ringleader of unfurled
Sect of the Nazarenes. 6 "And he
Even tried to profane in spree
The temple, and we seized him, and
Wanted to judge him by our stand.
7 "But the commander Lysias

Came by and with great gust and gas
Took him out of our hands and pew,
8 "Commanding us to come to you.
By examining him yourself
You may find out these things on shelf
Of which we accuse him like elf."
9 And the Jews all agreed with him,
Maintaining these things were so dim.

No Gentile seems to realize how great
Defiling of the temple is in state,
How sensitive a matter in the plot
It is to those who worship You a lot.
The pagan goes for crosses and for sex
In song and wisdom's dogmas to perplex,
The spiritual and non-existent rex.
But the Jew in the old times knew the way
That You had promised to cleanse temple's
sway.

The temple cleansed, the city rebuilt is
The catalyst upon which faith makes fizz
In voices heard from You above and Spirit
Come down in form of dove or at least near
it.

And so the accusations stand at bay.

10 Then Paul, after the governor
Had given sign to speak his score
Replied: "Since I know you have been
For many years a judge to win
This nations, I am glad to make
Appeal before you for my sake,
11 Because you may find out that it
Is not more than twelve days to wit
Since I went to Jerusalem
To worship and not to condemn.

12 "And they did not find me within
The temple disputing of sin
With anyone nor making row
Among the crowd, nor anyhow
In the town synagogues to bow.

13 "Nor can they prove the things of which
They now accuse me at a pitch.

14 "But this I confess to you, that
According to the way out flat
They call a sect, so worship I
My ancestors' God on the fly,
Believing all things that are writ
In law and prophets where I sit.

15 "I have hope in the God, which they
Themselves also accept in sway,
That there will be a resurrection

Of the dead, and not insurrection,
 Both of the just and the unjust.
 16 "This being so, I myself strive
 Always to have my conscience thrive
 Without offence toward God and men.
 17 "Now after many years in gust
 I came to bring alms and again
 Offerings to my nation in den,
 18 "In the midst of which some Jews from
 Asia found me cleansed and to come
 In the temple, but without mob
 And without riot there to rob.
 19 "They ought to have been here before
 You to object if they in store
 Had anything against my score.
 20 "Or else let those who are here say
 If they found any wrong in sway
 In me while I stood on that day
 Before the council, 21 "unless it
 Is for this one statement which in fit
 I cried out, standing among them,
 'Concerning resurrection's gem
 Of the dead I am being judged
 By you this day by those who smudged."

Unlike all others, Paul reports in brief
 Exactly how things are for weal or grief.
 How can he be so accurate and fair?
 It's simply that his actions to beware
 Are all done in Your view, and so he hides
 No secrets from the trying human eyes.
 He can say what did happen, because he
 Is innocent from the start of the spree.
 Beloved, let me live my life in this tomb
 So that without temptation to my doom
 I can bare every secret to the sky
 Without apology and without sigh.
 But then I trow that churchmen will find
 room
 To clamour for my life with hopeful lie.

See here, Beloved, Paul clearly states the
 truth
 That Jesus' men in no false tongue or ruth
 Believed in the same God precisely that
 Was known to the Jews of that time out
 flat.
 He makes appeal to no philosophy
 Denying Your form and reality
 With bodiless, formless non-entity,
 Nor does he trick Messiah out to be
 A second god set in a Trinity.

Beloved, I take the faith of Paul and see
 That You are One who sent down Christ to
 find
 The lowly and oppressed, the hopeful blind
 And bring them to the temple of Your light
 Set on the heavenly shores before their
 sight.

22 But when Felix had heard these things,
 Having more right knowledge in wings
 About the way, he took a break
 And said "When Lysias in wake,
 The officer, comes down, I'll make
 A fatwa for your case in stake."
 23 So he ordered centurion
 To keep Paul and to give him run
 Of the place and told him to let
 His friends provide for him and get
 To visit him. 24 After some days,
 When Felix came with his wife's praise,
 Drusilla, who was Jewish, he
 Sent for Paul and heard him freely
 About the faith in Christ to raise.
 25 And so he reasoned about right,
 And self-control, judgement in sight,
 Till Felix feared and so replied,
 "Go hence for now, come back to bide
 At more convenient time beside."
 26 At the same time he also thought
 Maybe Paul would pay him a slot
 To set him free from temple plot.
 That's why he sent for him quite oft
 To talk with him. 27 After two years
 Porcius Festus it appears
 Succeeded Felix, and Felix,
 Wanting to do the Jews no tricks,
 Left Paul bound and in the same fix.

Unless a man would be bound in the store
 Of politicians and the civil servant,
 Both of whom are regretfully most fervent
 In doing everything to up their score
 Despite the knocks of justice at the door,
 He will find every way he can and
 swervant
 Avoiding government's eyes still observant.
 The innocent once caught is seen no more.
 Beloved, when Master Happy left his plot
 To the Lord Celebration, see what spot
 Of fickle Paul was left in. He became
 A pawn and present to policy's game.

All things are sweetly done and in Your name.

Acts 25

1 When Festus had come to the place,
After three days he went apace
Up from Caesarea into
Jerusalem. 2 The high priest too
And the chief rulers of the Jew
Informed him against Paul, and they
Petitioned him, 3 to do away,
Summoning to Jerusalem,
While they were in ambush to slay
Along the road to kill in hem.
4 But Festus answered that Paul should
Be kept at Caesarea's hood,
And he would soon go there for good.
5 "Therefore," he said "let those who've got
Authority among your lot
Go down with me and so accuse
This man, to see if in his views
There is any fault in his plot."
6 And when he had remained among
Them more than ten days, he unsung
Went down to Caesarea. And
The next day, sitting as he planned
On judgment seat, he gave command
That Paul to be brought to him in hand.
7 When he appeared, the Jews arrived
Down from Jerusalem contrived
To stand about and lay on him
Complaints both serious and grim,
Against Paul, which they could not prove,
8 While he answered for his own groove,
"Neither against law of the Jews,
Nor against temple, nor the views
Of Caesar have I given offence
In anything at all for sense."
9 But Festus, wanting to remain
In good graces of Jews and sane,
Replied to Paul and said "Are you
Willing to go up to the crew
There in Jerusalem and be
Judged there before me in these things?"
10 Then Paul said "I stand in the rings
Of Caesar's judgment seat, where I
Ought to be judged and not set by.
To the Jews I have done no wrong,
As you well know, despite the song.
11 "If I'm an offender, or done
Anything to deserve the gun,
I make no objection to die,

But if there is nothing to try
In what these men accuse me by,
No one may set them loose on me.
So I appeal to Caesar's see."

12 Then Festus, when he had conferred
With the council, answered this word,
"You have appealed to Caesar so?
To Caesar then you'll surely go!"

The vacillating weakness of the man
Festus, who might have justly and by plan
Set Paul free, made him stop to see and scan

What those around him might remark and do.

And so he tried manipulating too.
He forced good Paul's appeal to Caesar and
Was then surprised to see that what he planned

In pleasing Jews was foiled by Paul's command.

There is a door however small it be
In every corner of eternity
Where the soul may arise and may go free.
Beloved, as I keep heart and eye on Thee,
I find that hope and rope in every place,
Because all places are before Your face.

13 And after some days King Agrippa
And Bernice came in shoe and slipper
To Caesarea to greet Festus.

14 When they had been there and confessed us

For many days, Festus laid case
Of Paul before the king in mace,
Saying "There is a certain man
Left prisoner by Felix' plan,

15 "About whom the chief priests and those
Elders of the Jews would impose
When I was in Jerusalem,
Asking for judgment to condemn.

16 "To them I answered, 'It is not
The custom of the Romans' plot
To deliver up any man
To destruction before the ban
Accused meets the accusers face
To face, and has a chance and grace
To answer for himself concerning
The charges laid against him burning.'

17 "Therefore when they had come
together,
Without any delay, if whether

The next day I sat on the seat
 Of judgment and ordered the man
 To be brought in for me to scan.
 18 "When the accusers had stood up,
 They brought no complaint of the tup
 As I supposed, 19 "but had some thought
 Against him in their own faith wrought
 About a certain Jesus sought,
 Who had died, whom Paul claimed to be
 Alive. 20 "And because I was not
 Sure of such questions and their plot,
 I asked whether he wished to go
 Back to Jerusalem and show
 Concerning these matters below.
 21 "But when Paul appealed to be sent
 For judgement to Augustus lent,
 I ordered him kept till I could
 Send him to Caesar and for good."

These men cannot speak truth, not for a
 nail.

Festus pretends he could not judge the pale
 Whether a dead man was alive or not,
 And whether such an argument in plot
 Deserved of death. The wicked will to do
 According to the best career and view
 Instead of keeping justice in the pew
 Is evident in all that such men say.
 Beloved, preserve me from that heathen
 way.

The man himself forced Paul in his appeal,
 And yet he pretends always at the heel
 That Paul's own choice is made at his
 regret.

Again, I say, look on the human met
 And cast Your judgement far and wide and
 set

The feet to snares that would tread stars
 and get.

22 Then Agrippa said to Festus,
 "I'd like to hear this man's own fuss
 For myself." "Tomorrow," he said
 "You'll hear him." 23 So the next day
 spread,
 When Agrippa and Bernice came
 With great ceremony and fame,
 And had come in audience hall
 With the commanders and with all
 The great men in the city's thrall,
 At Festus' command then was Paul
 Brought in. 24 And Festus said again,

"King Agrippa and all the men
 Who are here present with us, you
 See this man about whom the crew
 Of Jews petitioned me, both at
 Jerusalem and here that sat,
 Shouting out that he was not fit
 To live any longer or sit.
 25 "When I found him not to commit
 Anything that deserved his death,
 And that he himself in one breath
 Had called on Augustus, I planned
 To send him. 26 "I have nothing scanned
 To write to my lord about him.
 Therefore I have brought him out trim
 Before you, and especially grim
 Before you, King Agrippa, so
 That after the trial at a go
 I may have aught to write or show.
 27 "For it does not to me seem right
 To send a prisoner on sight
 With no specific charge in light."

Does it not seem right to condemn a man
 To judgement without accusation's plan?
 In that case set him free! But no, the game
 Of perpetrators is always the same.
 Once the claw of the magistrate is caught
 In the flesh of the innocent unsought,
 There is no way to extricate the bill
 Until the glutton's craw has had its fill,
 And that is only when no gain can come
 More from the torture of the man in sum.
 Only when sated cruelty and power
 Lie down to rest upon the wonted hour
 Can the bird flee. But such are infinite
 And without bound and without place to
 sit.

Acts 26

1 Agrippa said to Paul, "You are
 Allowed to defend your own bar."
 So Paul stretched out his hand to give
 An answer for himself and live.
 2 "I think myself happy, O King
 Agrippa, since today I sing
 For myself before you about
 All the things of which I'm in doubt
 Accused by the Jews, 3 "especially
 Because you are expert to see
 The customs and questions concerning
 The Jews. Therefore I beg your learning
 To hear me patiently, heart burning,

4 "Of my manner of life from youth,
Which was spent from the start in truth
In my own folk's Jerusalem,
All the Jews know the stratagem.
5 "They knew me from the first, if they
Were willing to bear witness' sway,
How by the strictest sect and stay
Of our faith I lived Pharisee.
6 "And now I stand here as you see
Judged for the hope of promise we
Made by God to our fathers' fee.
7 "To this our twelve tribes, earnestly
Worshipping night and day still hope
To attain without king or pope.
For this hope's sake, Agrippa king,
I am accused by the Jews' ring.
8 "Why should it be thought strange by you
That God raises the dead to view?

Paul himself sees no break in his belief
From Pharisean times to the relief
Of hope in resurrection of the Lord.
It's all one fabric of the One adored.
Paul sees himself in persecution's vale
As much for being Pharisee in pale
As for the way of Christ sent to avail.
The twelve tribes are for him safe and well
stored.
But since that day the Romanized faith rose
To say that You were three gods and they
chose
To follow such Mithraic fancies and
Osiris from the gold Egyptian sand.
But since those days Muhammad showed
the way
Back to the faith of Abraham in sway.

9 "Indeed, I myself thought I must
Do many things against the trust
Of name of Jesus Nazarene.
10 "This I too in Jerusalem
Did, and many saints behind screen
I shut in prison, at the hem
Of power from the chief priests, and when
They were put to death I cast then
My vote for executing them.
11 "I punished them often in each
Synagogue and forced them to reach
Blasphemy in my pile of rage,
Pursuing to foreign rampage.

Some men in golden mean of Buddhist
lark,
Of Hellenistic wisdom, or the spark
Of the Confucian constancy to park,
Do nothing all their lives but balanced
mark.

But others with the passion of the free,
The Moseses, Muhammads, and the wee
Boy David with his sling of destiny,
Rush into love and hate vehemently.
Beloved, as You look on the hearts of men
And see my striving over once again,
Give me the balance of Confucian trust
As well as fire to rise and spread the dust
Of frantic hale across the plain and ride.
Give me both harmony and high song's
pride.

12 "In such pursuit I journeyed to
Damascus with the power to do
From the chief priests, 13 until at noon,
O king, along the road and soon
I saw a light from heaven, more bright
Than sun itself, shining in sight
Around me and each travelling wight.
14 "And when we all fell to the ground,
I heard a voice speaking in sound
To me and saying in the tongue
Of Hebrews, 'Saul, Saul, why've you stung
Me? Hard for you to kick among
The pricks of conscience.' 15 "So I said
'Who are you, sir?' And he took head
To say 'I'm Jesus, whom you stick.
16 "But rise and stand on your feet slick,
For I have appeared to you for this,
To make you a servant witness
Both of the things which you have seen
And of the things which I'll unscreen
The more for you. 17 "I'll save you from
The folk as well as Gentile's bum,
To whom I send you now in sum.
18 "To open up their eyes to turn
From darkness to the light to burn,
And from the power of Satan to
God, so that they may get the true
Forgiveness of sins and estate
Among those sanctified of late
By faith in me.' 19 "Therefore, O King
Agrippa, I not forfeiting
Obedience to the heavenly sight,
20 "Declared first to those in the height
Of Damascus, Jerusalem,

And all around Judaea's hem,
And to the Gentiles, that they should
Repent, turn to God and do good
Works fitting penance. 21 "For these
reasons

The Jews seized me in temple seasons
And tried to kill me. 22 "Therefore, then
Getting help from God for these men,
To this day I stand witnessing
Both to the small and great saying
No other things than those of old
Which prophets and Moses have told
To come, 23 "that the Christ would bear
pain,
That he would first rise from the dead,
And would proclaim the light instead
To the folk and the Gentiles bred."

If Paul had been a Sadducee, the vision
Would have been held by him in pure
derision.

The training of the Pharisee made him
Ready to see and hear the revealed rim
And take it with both saving faith and vim.
And yet the Sadducee has some small hope
Of faithfulness before the law in scope.
They both accommodate to Roman pope.
Beloved, I see no vision on the road
Beyond the iridescence in abode
Of humming-bird and bunting with their
load
Of beauty in the place of prayer and goad.
And yet the light and sound convince again
That You reveal a thing to mortal men.

The visionary is left to himself
Communicating with bird, beast and elf,
Except when he claims that the executed
Political for criminal's saluted
By resurrection on a morning fair.
The claims do not fall on deaf dears and
air.

That more than hope the Scriptures bear
things out
In prophecy to soothe the mounting doubt
Will place the noose on neck of priest and
scout.

Beloved, the danger that arises from
Such motivation's not to bring kingdom
Of life eternal into human care.
Those resurrected inspire evil share,
Providing killers for more hopes to bare.

24 Now as he thus made his defence,
Festus said with a loud voice tense,
"Paul, you're beside yourself! Too much
Reading has made you mad to touch!"

25 But he said "I'm not mad, most great
And noble Festus, but speak late
The words of truth and reason's state.

26 "For the king, before whom I too
Speak freely, knows these things in due,
For I'm convinced that none of these
Things escapes his notice to please,
Since this thing was not done to hide
And in a corner dark to bide.

27 "Agrippa king, do you believe
The prophets? I know you receive."

28 Agrippa said to Paul, "Almost
You have persuaded me to boast
Myself a Christian with my host."

29 And Paul said "I would to God you
And also all who hear my view
Today, might be almost as I
Except for these bonds on my thigh."

30 When he had said these things, the king
Stood up, as well as ruling ring
And Bernice and those who sat there,

31 And when they'd gone aside to share
Among themselves, they said "This man
Is doing nothing that he can
Deserve death or the chains in span."

32 Agrippa told Festus, "This geezer
Might go free but for call to Caesar."

Good Festus with his charity in mind
Gave Paul excuses for the way he whined.
The truth is reading heavy books by night
Can turn the mind to madness in daylight.
Good Festus hears the passion and the wail,
And with a vision of the lettered male,
Considers that vehemence only can
Arise in mad or in unlettered man.
Beloved, give me such passion for Your
word

And for Your truth that when my heart is
stirred
To shout aloud in rhyme before the herd,
The listener will turn back in wicked pride
And say that I've gone mad upon the ride,
Beside myself for reading in my stride.

Acts 27

1 And when it was decided we

Should sail at last to Italy,
 They gave Paul over with a gang
 Of other prisoners that sang
 Under one Julius, who served
 As a centurion unswerved
 In the Augustan Regiment,
 A faithful Roman soldier sent.
 2 So entering into a ship
 Of Adramyttium, when hip
 We put to sea, meaning to sail
 By Asian coasts and without fail.
 Aristarchus, Macedonian,
 Who was Thessalonican man,
 Was with us. 3 And the next day we
 Landed at Sidon. And the wee
 Julius treated Paul most kindly
 And gave to him his liberty
 To go to friends and receive care.
 4 When we had put to sea from there,
 We sailed under lee of Cyprus,
 Because the winds were contrary.
 5 When we had sailed over the sea
 Which is off Cilicia and thus
 Off Pamphylia, we came up to
 Myra, a town in Lycia's view.

Though I too live in thrall of Auschwitz
 and
 See clouds of smoke of sacrificial band
 Arising from where Roman altars stand
 Beneath the Trinity and crucifix,
 I know the bag of those seductive tricks.
 The officer may be sweet and so fix
 My liberty to go out in the sticks,
 But when I speak Your word, just wait and
 see
 If anyone gives me the time to be.
 Beloved, the hand of Jonah cannot save
 A man from sin and every watery grave,
 Nor can the Roman officer and priest,
 No matter how kind and with love
 increased.
 I flee to You from churches of the fleeced.

6 There the centurion acquired
 An Alexandrian ship hired
 To sail to Italy, and he
 Put us on board. 7 And so when we
 Had sailed slowly for many days,
 Come with difficulty in haze
 Off Cnidus, the wind did not let
 Us go on, we sailed then to get

In lee of Crete off Salmone.
 8 Passing it laboured under weigh,
 We came to a place called Fair Havens,
 Near the town of Lasea's brave ones.
 9 Now when much time had been spent,
 and
 Sailing was now in danger scanned,
 Because the fast was past, then Paul
 Advised them, 10 saying "Men in stall,
 I see that this voyage will end
 Disastrous and in loss to spend,
 Not only of cargo and ship,
 But also our lives in the clip."
 11 Yet the centurion believed
 The helmsman and ship-owner sleeved,
 And not Paul's warnings unreprieved.

The wisdom small acquired by miss and
 chance
 Upon the cave wall where the shadows
 dance
 Is greater in the sight of men to prance
 Than revelation and the light revealed
 Upon the mountain of the thousands sealed.
 When faced with any choice today, the
 crowd
 Will take advice of fools spoken aloud
 Rather than still small voice spoke in the
 room
 Of inspiration, though it speak of doom.
 Beloved, let me turn from the awful tongue
 That gives voice to the common tale and
 hung,
 To find Your Word, Your grace, Your
 saving power
 Is still heard, had and willing at this hour
 To grant the two or three where thousands
 cower.

12 Because the harbour was not great
 To winter in, the larger rate
 Advised to set sail from there too,
 If they could reach Phoenix in view,
 A harbour of Crete facing back
 Towards the southwest and track
 Of northwest, and winter in slack.
 13 When the south wind blew softly, they
 Supposed they had obtained their way,
 And put to sea, they sailed close by
 The Cretan shore. 14 But give a sigh,
 Soon a headwind arose in power,
 Called Euroclydon come to glower.

15 So when the ship was caught, and could
 Not head into the wind, for good
 We let her drive. 16 And running near
 An island called Clauda, in fear
 We tied skiff with difficulty.
 17 When they had taken it in fee,
 They cabled fast the under-ship,
 Fearing to run aground in clip
 Against the sandbars of Syrtis,
 They struck sail and drove before this.
 18 Because we were so tempest-tossed
 The next day they lightened for lost
 The ship. 19 On the third day we threw
 The tackle overboard in crew.
 20 Now when neither the sun nor stars
 Appeared for many days, and bars
 Of no small tempest beat on us,
 All lost hope we'd be saved from fuss.
 21 But after long fasting from food,
 Paul stood among them and he cooed,
 "Men, you should have listened to me,
 And not have sailed from Crete by sea
 And brought this harm and loss to be.

It's easy in the wake of evil task
 To say I told you so, and so to bask
 In being right. The servant that you sent
 To save his shipmates could not turn from
 bent
 Accusing on that score. And yet his word
 Is one that is renewed and always heard.
 I lighten ship, Beloved, I throw away
 The riches I have gathered on a day,
 The tinsel and the glory in the sway
 Of trial and store before the faithless way.
 I throw the tackle and the saving line
 Upon the sea and turn me back to dine,
 Assured that Your eye and Your hand
 divine
 Will take me to a better shore's incline.

22 "And now I urge you to take heart,
 For there will be no loss to start
 Of life among you, but the ship.
 23 "For there stood by me at the hip
 Last night an angel of the God
 To whom I belong on the sod
 And whom I serve, 24 "saying to me,
 'Do not fear, Paul, you must now be
 Brought before Caesar, and indeed
 God has granted you in your greed
 All those who sail with you in speed.'

25 "So take heart, men, for I believe
 God that it will be just reprieve
 As it was told me not to grieve.
 26 "However, we must run aground
 Upon a certain island found."

Paul never swerves from his early
 upbringing,
 But always serve the Pharisees' own
 stinging,
 And harps upon the same old way of
 singing.
 He sees an angel or he thinks to see,
 And that's enough to override in glee
 The helps and hopes of rationality.
 I too take heart, Beloved, though angel
 voice
 Is rarely one I hear upon my choice,
 Except the twitter of the bunting and
 The grosbeak flying in to seed and land.
 The angels that I hear and see apart
 Are angels not of sight, but of the heart,
 And they return on tiny wing to beat
 The billows rising on my fair retreat.

27 Now when the fourteenth night had
 come,
 As we were driven up and rum
 Upon the Adriatic Sea,
 About midnight the sailors see
 That they were drawing near some land.
 28 And they took soundings and at hand
 Found twenty fathoms, and when they
 Had gone a little farther way,
 They took soundings again and found
 It fifteen fathoms to the ground.
 29 Then, fearing lest we run aground
 On rocks, they dropped four anchors round
 From the stern, praying day to come.
 30 And as the sailors sought to hum
 In secret from the ship like bum,
 When they'd let down the skiff in sea,
 Pretending to set anchors wee
 From the prow, 31 Paul said to the manned
 Centurion and the soldiers' band,
 "Unless these men stay in the ship,
 You cannot be saved from the clip."
 32 And so the soldiers cut away
 The skiff ropes so it fell astray.

The soldiers foil the sailors' plan to take
 A skiff to safety in the stormy wake

And leave the ship and passengers at stake.
See what a horrid clatter they will make.
And yet when they take thought for their
 own sake,
They too will make a plot to murder all
The prisoners still tied up in the stall.
Beloved, I try my guns and find the soil
Is cut beneath my feet to coil my toil.
But do I learn a lesson at the boil?
Not on Your life, Beloved, and still I stand
Repenting and rejoicing at Your hand,
As ready to obey Your first command,
As ready once again to fail Your planned.

33 And as day was about to dawn,
Paul begged all to eat some food drawn,
Saying "Today's the fourteenth day
You've waited fasting without pay
And eaten nothing in the fray.
34 "That's why I urge you to take meat,
For your survival with this treat,
Since not a hair of head will fall
From any of you in the squall."
35 And when he had said these things, he
Took bread and gave thanks gratefully
To God before them all, when he
Had broken it he ate freely.
36 Then all took heart and ate a wee.

I wonder if the leaven of Pharisee
Was in the loaf that Paul took and broke
 wee.
From bread of hypocrite to cup of wine
Of Babylon, the choice is overfine.
I taste the crumb of righteousness once
 blessed
And broken by the Saviour's hand and best,
And find it sticks in craw without the vest
Of doctored wine. That's why so many fail
To reject that gold cup encrusted hale
With gems of Vatican and Papal grail.
I trust the promise that no hair shall fall
From my head in the coming faithless ball,
Not only since Your hand protects the
 small,
But since my hair's long since thinned at
 the mael.

37 In all we were two hundred and
Seventy-six persons in band
On the ship. 38 So when they had eaten
Enough, they lightened the ship beaten

And threw out grain into the sea.
39 When it was day, they did not see
A land they knew, but they observed
A bay with a beach, where they swerved
To save the ship aground as meet.
40 And they let go the anchors' seat
And left them in the sea, meanwhile
Loosing the rudder ropes in style,
They hoisted the mainsail to blow
And made for shore and were not slow.
41 But running in a place where met
Two currents, they ran the ship set
Aground, and the prow stuck fast and
Remained stuck, but the stern by sand
Was being broken up there by
The strength of the waves and the sky.

The ship of faith or faithless ship that I
And all the world around me under sky
Rides in the Roman waters passing by,
Is caught aground upon the fatal sand
Of trust in human wisdom, human hand.
The stern is battered by the waves that
 pound
The mythic winds that rattle and abound
In magic books and secret mutterings
Of priest and witch in batting their black
 wings.
Beloved, as I abandon ship and store
Of church and government caught at the
 door
Of disobeying You, rebellion's core,
I jump into a raging sea of love
Whipped by the breath of life blown from
 above.

42 The soldiers planned to kill the lot
Of prisoners, lest any plot
By swimming to escape uncaught.
43 But the centurion to save
Paul, kept them from their purpose grave,
Commanding those swimming a brave
To jump first and get to the land,
44 And the rest, some on lumber and
Some on parts of the ship to stand.
And so it was that they all landed
Safe and aground, both free and branded.

I told You that the soldiers in their plot,
Despite their pretence at the sailors' plot,
Were ready with their weapons at the slot.

They are no different from those today
taught

To point a gun at anyone who takes
A rightful step out of the common stakes.
There's rarely any captain at the guns
To give a better order for the runs.
The miracle of life goes on by just
The single thread that rises from the dust
To speak against the failure of good trust.
The soldiers knew if they lost any man
That they would pay with their own lives in
span.
So law corrupts the good in every plan.

Acts 28

1 Now when they had escaped, they found
The island called Malta aground.
2 The natives showed us kindness too
Beyond the usual in view,
For they built a fire and they made
Us welcome, for the rain unstayed
And for the cold. 3 But when Paul took
A bundle of sticks and laid crook
Upon the fire, a viper came
Out because of the heat and flame,
And fastened on his hand in claim.
4 So when the natives saw the thing
Hanging from his hand and to sting,
They said to one another, "See
No doubt this man murdered freely,
And so though he's escaped the sea,
Yet justice takes his life to be."
5 But he just shook the creature off
Into the fire and lived to scoff.
6 But they waited for him to swell
Or suddenly fall dead pell-mell,
But after they watched a long time
And saw no harm come to his rhyme,
They changed their minds and said that he
Must be a god to live and see.

The fortune and the fate of every man,
The luckless stroke, the whipping by the
plan,
Determine how the crowd sees in the scan.
Success makes gods of men, but failure sets
The same flesh and blood in the thirsty nets
Of criminal disdain. The round goes on
From fortune's noon to one more victory's
dawn,
From destiny of doom to the sword drawn.
Beloved, I turn and turn in whirling state,

Sometimes in sun and moon, some times in
rate

Of faster stars that fall upon my fate,
And through the passing gloom of year on
year
I follow in the room and in Your fear
Unmoved the blessings of Your time and
gear.

7 In that place there was an estate
Of leading citizen in rate
Upon the island, and whose name
Was Publius, who in acclaim
Received us and did entertain
Us courteously for three days' gain.
8 It happened Publius' father lay
Sick of a fever and in sway
Of dysentery. Paul went in
To him and laid his hands to win
And healed him. 9 So when this was done,
The rest of those under the sun
On the island who had diseases
Also came and were healed as eases.
10 They honoured us too every way,
And when we left, gave such in stay
As what we needed every day.

The fortune of that island in the sea
Has been recorded for posterity.
Of all the sick and infirm in the land
Made well by You and by the Pauline hand,
A number had to repent, surely some
Small number came into heavenly
kingdom.

My own recourse before the onslaught of
Cures seen miraculous, cures from above,
Entails no other than the grateful glove,
Love fired by thanks to You for blessings
sent

With hand plied by the serpent where he
went

Against the fire and air, the rainy shore
Increased by stinging sand and earthly
score.

Nothing is lost, Beloved, from heavenly
store.

11 After three months we sailed again
In Alexandrian ship in den
Whose figurehead was the Twin Brothers,
Which had wintered by Malta's mothers.
12 We landed at Syracuse, where

We stayed three days. 13 And then from there

We circled round to Rhegium.

After one day the south wind come

Blew, and next day we came in view

Of Puteoli, 14 where we found

Brothers, and were invited round

To stay with them for seven days.

And so we went toward Rome to gaze.

15 And from there, when the brothers heard

About us, they came out as stirred

To meet us as far as the bins

Of Appii Forum and Three Inns.

When Paul saw them, he thanked God and

Took courage. 16 Now when we in band

Came to Rome, the centurion

Delivered the prisoners won

To the captain of the guard, but

Paul was allowed to live unshut

By himself with the soldier who

Guarded him as it was his due.

How Auschwitz has remained the same
today

As when it was under the Roman sway!

The good Paul has rewards for his
behaviour

As he's polite to emperor and saviour.

The difference between the living space

Of the subservient to Roman face

And those who show their minds in what
they trace

Is like that of the kapos who eat better

Than those retained in barracks under
fetter.

Thank You, I may, Beloved, for this and
that,

For day and night, and for the lean and fat,

But in the end, whether in cell or flat,

And guarded by a soldier or a cat,

I shall come before You where judgement's
at.

17 And it occurred after three days

That Paul called the leaders to raise

Of the Jews together. So when

They had come together in den,

He said to them "Brothers and men,

Though I have done nothing in wrong

Against our people or the song

Of our ancestors' customs strong,

Yet I was made a prisoner

Back in Jerusalem to stir

Into the hands of Roman cur,

18 "Who, when they had examined me,

Wanted to let me go and free,

Because there was no cause to put

Me to the slaughter under foot.

19 "But when the Jews spoke against it,

I was compelled as it was fit

To appeal to Caesar, not that

I had anything that out flat

I would accuse my folk as rat.

20 "That's why therefore I've called for
you,

To see you and to speak the true,

Since for the hope of Israel

I'm bound with this chain in a well."

21 Then they said to him, "We did not

Get letters from Judaeen plot

Concerning you, nor have any

Of the brothers who came to see

Reported or spoken in fee

Any evil of you to see.

22 "But we desire to hear from you

What you think, for about this crew,

We know it's accused in each pew."

It seems the matter of exaggeration

Determined earlier in this relation.

The plot against sweet Paul is done,

And there are no accusers in the fun.

The ones who had arrived to bring the news

Of fair Jerusalem sat in the pews

Of Rome without a word against dear Paul.

No one remembers his sins in the stall.

The wicked word fails from the mouth at
last

And only victims, after time has passed,

Bring up the tale, the tattered and the worn.

And yet it is a rightness that is born

When injured rail against the things once
sworn

And still accuse those who've mangled and
torn.

23 So when they had appointed him

A day, many came back to him

At his room, to whom he explained

And solemnly witnessed unfeigned

Of the kingdom of God, persuading

Them about Jesus from both wading

In Moses' law, Prophets parading,

From early until late in trading.

24 Some were convinced by what he said,
 And some did not believe instead.
 25 When they did not agree among
 Themselves, they left after Paul sung
 One word: "The Holy Spirit spoke
 Right through Isaiah, prophet bloke,
 To our ancestors, 26 "saying, 'Go
 To this people and say and show:
 "Hearing you'll hear, and not bestow
 An understanding, seeing you
 Will see, and not perceive the view,
 27 "For the hearts of this people grew
 Dull, and their ears hard to hear too,
 And their eyes they have closed, lest they
 Should see with their eyes the best way
 And hear with their ears, that they might
 Understand with their hearts of spite
 And so repent, that I should heal."
 28 "Therefore let it be known in seal
 That God's salvation has been sent
 To the Gentiles, they's hear unbent!"
 29 When he had said these words, the Jews
 Went off and argued of these views.
 30 Paul lived two whole years in his own
 Rented house, and received alone
 All who came to him. 31 And he preached
 God's kingdom in the things he reached
 Concerning the Lord Jesus Christ,
 With confidence and all sufficed,
 And no one forbade him his loan.

See now the Jewish way of doing things:
 Without the force of power or other stings
 Each man makes up his own mind and
 returns

The judgement that he studies out and
 learns.

Beloved, the Inquisition that Rome hopes
 To lay on unsuspecting from the popes,
 Has no place in the figures and the ropes
 Of synagogue, no, not even that copes
 With Rome itself, abiding in its street.

Beloved, as I recoil before the heat
 Of Inquisition now in noble fame,
 I raise a voice, though humble and in
 blame,

To show the melody that You acclaim
 In word and ruth on Sinai's glowing flame.

**Acts 29 (versified from the Sonnini
 manuscript as translated by Dr.
 Ken Johnson)**

1 Paul was filled with blessings of Christ,
 And in the spirit he sufficed,
 When he left Rome planning to go
 To Spain, as he'd been wanting slow,
 And from there to Britain to show.
 He'd heard in Phoenicia that some
 Of Israel's folk had not been glum
 At time of the Assyrian bum
 To flee by sea to islands far
 As spoken by the prophet's car,
 Place called by Romans Britain's *star*.
 2 The Lord commanded that the good
 News be preached everywhere it could,
 To Gentiles and the lost sheep in
 Israel's house. And no man came in
 To stop Paul, for he testified
 With boldness about Jesus' side
 Before the rulers and the folk.
 He took along brothers who woke
 With him in Rome, and they got on
 A ship at Ostium withdrawn
 With fair winds to shelter in Spain.
 3 And many people came together
 From towns and villages in weather
 Of the hill country, for they'd heard
 Of the discourses and the word
 Of the apostle and were stirred
 By miracles that had occurred.
 And Paul preached mightily in Spain
 And great crowds accepted the strain,
 For they could see that he was sent
 By God to bring them the present.

Indeed, Beloved, the Jewish presence in
 Far Andalus is certain and has been
 Through centuries a witness to the way
 The grape and olive in that land bear sway.
 I too long for the Andalusian soil,
 The sun and sky, the vagrant donkey toil,
 And lovingly hear the Ladino words
 In heart and mind vie with my whey and
 curds.

Paul preached in Spain I do not doubt,
 though this
 Report of it is falsified to kiss,
 I trow. And still it has no word to miss.
 The miracles You gave by Paul's hand
 there

Still echo in the breeze, upon the air
 That comes up from the seaside without
 care.

4 When he left Spain, Paul and his band
 Found a ship in Armorica,
 Which was sailing to Britain's land,
 And they sailed by the south coast's claw
 Until they reached a port by name
 Raphinus. Now when all the fame
 Of the apostle showed he came
 To their coast, great crowds of the folk
 Met him, and they treated the bloke
 Paul politely and he went in
 At their town's eastern gate to win,
 And stayed in the house of one of
 His own nation, a Hebrew's love.
 5 The next day he came to mount Lud,
 And the folk thronged the gate for good,
 Assembling in the Broadway too,
 And he preached Christ to them in view,
 And they believed the word was true
 And witness of Jesus to do.
 6 At evening then the Holy Ghost
 Fell upon Paul, and he was host
 To prophesy, saying "Behold,
 In the last days the God of peace
 Shall dwell upon cities untold,
 And the inhabitants increase.
 In the folk's seventh census their
 Eyes shall be opened to the fair,
 And glory of inheritance
 Shine forth before them at a glance.
 The nations shall come up to bow
 In worship on the mount and how
 It testifies of patience seen
 And the longsuffering in between
 Of the servant of the Lord there.
 And in the latter days in share
 Shall new things of the gospel shine
 Out of Jerusalem's combine,
 And hearts of the folk shall rejoice,
 And see the fountains' opened choice,
 And their shall be no more plague's voice.
 In those days shall be wars and fame
 Of war; and a king shall raise up,
 And his sword, shall be like a cup
 Of healing of the nations, and
 His peace shall abide in the land,
 And glory of his kingdom stand
 A wonder among princes' band.
 7 It happened certain Druids came
 To Paul in private, and showed claim
 By their rites and ceremonies
 They were descended from the breeze
 Of Jews who escaped from the chains

In the land of Egyptian plains,
 And the apostle believed them,
 And gave them kiss of peace in hem.
 And Paul stayed in his room for three
 Months to confirm the faith to be
 In Christ preaching continually.
 After these things Paul and his own
 Brothers departed from the loan
 Of Raphinus and sailed up to
 Atium in Gaul. Paul in crew
 Preached to the Roman garrison
 And among the people, and won
 Exhorting all men to repent
 Confessing their sins as he went.

This hidden chapter added once in guile
 Is really here to raise a doubting smile
 From any who are not of Celtic file.
 But since my Druid forefathers remain
 Somehow within my troubled sort of brain,
 I doubt not that Paul landed here for gain.
 For centuries the hopes and seers in train
 Have given the wilder slopes the sound of
 Psalm

Without the need of frankincense or palm.
 The fishing boats glide out upon the sea,
 The fisherwives await the coming glee
 Of catch at dawn before the Sabbath spree.
 I turn back to an eager century
 When Latin Psalms gave way to poetry.

8 And certain of the Belgae came
 To ask of the new doctrine's fame,
 And of the man Jesus in claim.
 Paul opened his heart to them and
 Told them all things he's suffered planned,
 And how Christ Jesus came into
 The world to save sinners in crew;
 And they left thinking in their hearts
 About the things they'd heard for starts.
 9 And after much preaching and toil,
 Paul and his fellows reached the soil
 Of Helvetia, and came there to
 Mount Pontius Pilate in view,
 Where he who had condemned the Lord
 Jesus dashed himself down and gored
 Himself to death. And straight away
 A torrent gushed and washed away
 His body from the mountain's sway,
 Broken and torn in a lake's bay.
 10 And Paul stretched forth his hands upon
 The water, and prayed the Lord drawn,

Saying "O Lord God, give a sign
To all the nations that confine
Here Pontius Pilate who condemned
Your only-begotten Son hemmed,
Plunged down headlong into the pit,
And so he met his judgement fit."

11 And while Paul was still speaking, see
There came a great earthquake to be,
The surface of the waters changed,
And the form of the lake arranged
Like the Son of Man hanging in
Agony on the cross of sin.
And there came a voice from the sky
Saying "Even Pilate is nigh
Escaping now the wrath to come,
Because he washed his hands in sum
Before the crowd that came to shed
The blood of our Lord Jesus Christ."
When, therefore, Paul and those ones led
With him saw the earthquake sufficed,
And heard the angel's voice, they raised
Their voices up to God and praised,
And strengthened in the spirit dazed.

It was a Campbell sure invented this
Word at the end of Acts, hoping to miss
The provocation of such men as I,
Who come from other clans and come to
vie

And blame on Campbells still the
crucifixion

Of Christ was perpetrated in the diction
Of Pilate's mother's people on the lie.
Of Pilate's role the Campbell's can't deny,
But if reprieve can be made for the cross,
Then they can get over their brazen loss.
Like he who prayed within the temple court
So long ago to justify his sort,
I thank You that You made of me no
Campbell.

I've got enough in strikes here where I
amble.

12 They journeyed and came to the mount
Called Julius where stood in count
Two pillars, one on the right hand
And one upon the left hand, and
Erected by Caesar in band
Augustus. Paul, filled up with power
Of the Holy Spirit that hour,
Stood up between the pillars two,
And said "Men and brethren these two

Stones which you see this day shall bear
Witness of my journeying there.

Truly I say, they shall remain
Until out pouring of the reign
Of the spirit upon all folks,
Neither shall the way under yokes
Be hindered when all time invokes."

13 Then they travelled to Iltricum,
Intending to go by the hum
Of Macedonia into Asia,
And grace was found as well as pleasure
In all the groups of called out ones,
To prosper in peace without guns.

It so appears that Paul was reconciled
To those in Asia after travelling wild
And rugged runes of Druids and cairns
piled.

He has complained that Asia left him out
Of the saints' list and called the man a lout.
The news of making peace is sweet no
doubt.

I do not know myself, although I've been
In all these ports with and without my sin,
Which is the sweetest country. I love east
As well as west, Beloved. Perhaps the feast
In Scotland would be worthy of my heart,
Despite white martyrdom for chosen part.
Beloved, the Acts are done, the tale is told,
And none is dross, but all is favoured gold.

The Epistle of Paul to the Romans

On his third journey to bring out the word
Of Gospel to the folk who have not heard,
Paul writes a note to Rome to those who
share

Your worship, my Beloved, on Nero's stair.
His message is how are men set right with
You, their Creator and not god of myth.
It's not by faithfulness or doing well,
But by Your act alone, the truth to tell.
The same power that breathed life into the
clay

Breathes life eternal on the slumbered day.
You choose Your own and with creating
power

Make them atone the stricken heart an
hour,
And raise up from total depravity

The saints that You set on the glassy sea.

Romans 1

1 Paul, a servant of Jesus Christ,
Called an apostle, *not enticed*,
But separated to *the work*
Of God's gospel and not to shirk,
2 Which he had promised before through
His prophets in the Books of YHWH,
3 Concerning Jesus Christ His son
Or servant as the word's best done,
Who is our lord and master, who
Was born of David's seed and stock
According to the flesh *and rock*,
4 *And* declared son of God, *Messiah*,
With power and without pariah
According to the Spirit of
Holiness, *grace and divine love*,
By resurrection from the dead,
As Paul's Damascus vision said.

It's true, Beloved, there is a word in Greek
For servant and another when we seek
To say son, but Semitic thought confuses
Both concepts in the waled, boy, it uses
Sometimes for offspring and at other times
For underling. Since there's no God the
Mother
Mentioned in Scripture, son must mean the
other.
Expression Son of God is clearly used
To mean Christ, so I need not be confused.
Paul's vision of him made him think he
was
Raised from the dead, but visionary clause
Shows nothing more than that the master
lives,
Occulted and within the grace God gives.
I take his promises for all my rhymes.

It was his escape from the grave that made
Jesus the Son of God or Christ, not shade
Of cosmic or eternal pre-existence.
The gospel's in escape from the insistence
Of knuckling under Rome despite the cross
And all the machinations and their loss.
Declared son by escape from death is
greater
Than being primordial god and creator.
Let me, Beloved, participate in that
Great gospel promise, that where I am at
I may escape the consequence of death

At the hands of Rome's gaunt authorities,
As I rely on You from breath to breath
And tread down visions of both earth and
seas.

O my Beloved, Your blessed Messiah's
born
Into a stock both royal, without scorn,
Descendant of David whose reign is free
Beneath the heavens on earth eternally,
Who sought refuge and solace in the tent
Of Kedar, and left there blessed descent
Joining the stocks of Abraham in one
And making prophets all brothers when
done.
Brotherhood of the flesh, though right and
true,
Is not all that You've meant in faith to do.
The promised ones speak by the holy word
Of Your grace and Your spirit undeterred.
Beloved, keep me in love and loyalty
To David's holy sons and family.

5 Through him we have received grace and
Apostleship *in the command*
To obey the faith in all nations
For his name *and his name's elations*,
6 Among whom you too are the called
Of Jesus Christ, *be not appalled*,
7 To all who are beloved of God,
In Rome, called *to be saints and shod*:
Grace to you and peace from our Father
God, and from Jesus who is rather
Lord and Christ, *not Almighty God*.

Before Jesus all prophets came alone
To their own kin and family as shown
In Balaam's inability to curse
Another righteous nation for the worse,
And Jonah's flight to avoid being sent
To Nineveh to preach repentance lent.
Jesus himself came to Israel's lost sheep,
But when he escaped death his were to
keep
All nations who came to the one to save
From power of sin and Rome and from the
grave.
Since Jesus now all prophets come to bear
On men and women of faith everywhere.
His victory is witness You are one,
Beloved, who sees humanity as done.

8 First, I thank my God through Christ
Jesus,
(*"Through" means he's not my God as
pleases*),

For all of you, since your faith is
Well-spoken in the whole world *whiz*.
9 For God's my witness, whom I serve
With my spirit *and not to swerve*
From His son-*servant's* gospel, that
I never cease to mention at
My prayers your *case*, 10 making request
If, by some means, and now at *best*
And last I may find in God's will
A way to come to you *with quill*.
11 For I long to see you, that I
May impart to you some gift by
The spirit, so that you may be
Established *in the gospel free*,
12 That is, that I may take comfort
Together with you *by report*
Of common faith we have *in short*.

Sweet Paul retracts his words unless they
seem

Too egotistical for Roman dream.
Instead of benefactor after all,
He is content to be equals in stall,
Not teaching or pretending to teach others,
He's willing to take comfort in his brothers.
I trust this is said in sincerity
And not mere clerical diplomacy.
Ach, I am touched by priestcraft in the state
Of modern ecclesiast's reprobate.
Forgive, Beloved, suspicions I might raise
Against sweet Paul's sincerity in ways.
Make me as sweet as he is for my hope,
And equal as he is to priest and pope.

13 Now I do not want you to be
Unconscious of the fixity
Of my plan to come to you, brothers,
But until now hindered *by others*,
That I might have some fruit among
You too, as with Gentiles of tongue.
14 I am a debtor both to Greeks
And to barbarians, *who seeks*
Both wise and unwise. 15 So, as much
As is in me, ready to touch
The gospel preaching to you who
Are living in *far-off* Rome too.

Such good news this! That even Rome can
hide

Some barbarians in whom hopes abide
That faith like candles in a darkened cave
Burn on though pagan banners taller wave
Above the city of eternity.

That Rome like heathen Babylon of old
Has ten of faith more than in Sodom told,
To whom Paul turns a loving eye and pen.
There is no place where there are no good
men,

And even Nazareth produced our lord.
Therefore let all men bare and break the
sword,

Since there's no city to attack where all
Are fully depraved not to hear You call
To obey You, Beloved, in unity.

16 For I am not ashamed of Christ
And his gospel, it's power *and priced*
Of God to the salvation of
Everyone who believes *with love*,
For the Jew first, also the Greek,
Or any other that may seek.

17 For in it's seen God's righteousness
From faith to faith, as is witness
In Scripture, "The just shall live by
Faithfulness." 18 For the wrath thereby,
God's, is revealed from heaven against
All men's ungodliness and more
Their unrighteousness, who suppress
The truth for unrighteousness' score,
19 Because what may of God be known
Is clear in them, for God has shown
It to them. 20 For since the creation
Of the world there's a demonstration
Of his invisible *virtues*,

Being grasped by the things *and views*
That are *created here to be*,
Eternal power, divinity,

So that they are without excuse,
21 Because that, although they knew God,
They did not glorify as God,
Nor were they thankful, but became
Futile in their thoughts, *to their shame*,
And their foolish hearts were darkened.
22 Professing to be wise, *by end*
They became fools, 23 and changed the
glory

Of incorruptible God to
An image made like mortal man
In fabled legend, mythic story

Of birds, *dove, eagle and emu*,
And the four-footed beast *that ran*,
And creeping things *instead of glory*.

Whatever gospel is in Paul's clear sight,
It's not a tale of gods made in man's plight,
And being born, and dying and some day
Reviving corn and sighing on the way.
Oh no, the God of Paul's Gospel's One that
Is in eternal power, divinity,
In every manifest appearance sat
Upon the throne of His own sovereignty.
Their foolish hearts are darkened to relate
That one man above others is in state
Of God Almighty while the rest resign
To role of servants to the divine kine.
I thank You, my Beloved, You're not a
man
Or even woman, for no human can.

24 Therefore God also gave them up
To uncleanness, *and the filled cup*
Of lusts in their hearts, to dishonour
Their own bodies themselves, *a goner*,
25 Who exchanged the truth of God for
The lie, and prostrated before
And served the creature rather than
Creator, ever blessed. Amen.
26 For this reason God gave them up
To the vile passions *of their cup*.
For even their women exchanged
The natural for what is estranged.
27 Likewise also the men, leaving
The natural use of women, fling
Their burning lust on one another,
Men with men *and brother with brother*
Committing what is shameful *act*,
And having in themselves the due
Penalty that their errors *drew*.

Who serve the local gods by rite and
dream,
Find that their punishment is worth a
scream.
Who turn gods into men and mythic tale
Find that their own bodies against them
flail.
What can be worse in judgement for a man,
Who is a wench in the tavern span,
Suddenly to burn in lust for the male
After his constant seeking female tale?
The ones who used to laugh deriding gays

And bash them for their pride and for their
ways
Are driven in a bloody, lusty haze
To rock with one another, plunge and pitch,
And welter in the caudal ground and ditch.
The punishment You mete out, Lord, is
rich.

28 And even as they did not wish
To retain God in *heathenish*
Knowledge, God gave them over to
Debased mind, those things that they do
Are not fitting, 29 but being filled
With all unrighteousness *self-willed*,
And sexual immorality,
And wickedness *abundantly*,
Covetousness, maliciousness,
Full of envy, murder, and strife,
Deceit, and evil-mindedness,
Whisperers, 30 backbiters, haters
Of God, violent, proud, boasters,
Inventors of things evil, and
To parents disobedient,
31 And undiscerning *in the land*,
And untrustworthy *where they went*,
Unloving, unforgiving, and
Unmerciful, 32 who, knowing that
God's judgement's righteous, knowing that
Those who practice such things deserve
Death, not only do the same but
Also approve practice of smut.

Beloved, cleanse me today in mind and
soul,
The body temple that I still hold whole,
And show me greater visions from on high
That raise me from debasing earthly cry.
I lift my eyes like the disciples past
From Olivet and see the rising mast
Of ship upon the crystal sea, I cast
My anchors on the heavenly shore and fast.
I follow in the veil before Your throne,
I see the Son of God weigh there alone
The prayers of those whose sins he can
atone,
And give myself in sacrifice to You,
A living sacrifice in heavenly view,
In humble toil upon the earthly dew.

Romans 2

1 Therefore you're inexcusable,
O man, whoever you are full

Of judgement for others, for you
Who judge, practice the same things too.

The question I ask Paul if whether it
Would be appropriate or even fit
To judge another for the things that I
Do not do seeking ever to comply
With the divine law that You one time bit.
Fact is all men judge others and give blame
Whether they do or not sins just the same.
My own goal has been only to judge others
By the ten rules you gave to human
brothers,
And leave the judging of all other things
To You alone, though in my surmisings,
It seems You judge no one for great or
small
Apart from the ten words writ on the wall.
The divine judgement takes a lot of gall.

2 But we know that God's judgement
comes
According to truth against bums
Who practice such things. 3 Do you think
This, O man, you who judge (*and drink*)
Those practising such things, yet do
The same, that you'll escape then too
The judgement of God? 4 Or do you
Despise the riches of His grace,
Forbearance, and longsuffering *face*,
Not knowing that God's goodness leads
You to repentance? 5 But that feeds,
With your hard, unrepentant heart,
The storing up for your own part
Of wrath for the *soon coming* day
Of wrath and revelation of
The righteous judgement of God's *love*,
6 Who "will render to each one *well*
According to his deeds": 7 a *spell*
Of life eternal to those who
By patient well-doing are true
In seeking glory, honour, and
Their immortality to *stand*,
8 But to those who're self-seeking and
Don't obey the truth, but obey
Unrighteousness, lie in *their way*
Indignation and wrath *that day*,
9 Tribulation and anguish, on
Each soul of man who does evil,
Of the Jew first, also *the bill*
Of the Greek, 10 but glory, honour,
And peace to everyone confer

Who works what is good, at first to
The Jew and also to the Greek.
11 For there's no partiality
With God. 12 For as many as seek
Sin without law's *knowledge to do*
Will also perish in the sea
Of lawlessness, and as many
As have sinned in the law will be
Judged by the law 13 (for not who hear
The law *are* just before God's fear,
But those who do are justified,
14 For when Gentiles, who do not side
With the law, by nature abide
In the things in the law, these, though
Not having the law, are a law
To themselves, 15 and are such as show
The work of the law writ in awe
In their hearts, their conscience also
Bearing witness, and so between
Themselves *their* thoughts are *fairly* seen
Accusing or excusing *them*)
16 In the day when God will judge them,
Men's secrets by Jesus Christ, by
My gospel *and my alibi*.

You've given me a year or two, it seems,
Beyond the decade that anyone's dreams
Could expect needful for repentance work.
There must have been times here when I
would shirk.
Still as I daily repent of my past
And present lack of adherence aghast,
Give me the grace to live above the line
Of sin and lust that often will combine
In human heart to blind the soul in fine.
A pagan I may be, indeed, I trow,
Unless my Celtic ancestry somehow
Is Jewish enough by the holy cow.
The ten commandments written on my
heart
Give me repentance now to make a start.

17 Indeed you may be called a Jew,
And rest on the law, and make you
Your boast in God, 18 and know *his* will,
And approve the things that are *still*
Excellent, instructed out of
The law, 19 and are confident of
Yourself to be guide to the blind,
A light to those who are *resigned*
In darkness, 20 an instructor of
The foolish, a teacher of babes,

Having the forms *and astrolabes*
 Of knowledge and truth in the law.
 21 You, therefore, who another's maw
 Fill, do you not teach yourself awe?
 You who preach that a man should not
 Steal, do you steal? 22 And you who taught
 "Do not commit adultery,"
 Do you commit adultery?
 You who abhor idols, do you
 Rob temples *of their idols*? 23 You
 Who make your boast in the law, do
 You dishonour God as you break
 The law? 24 For "God's name for your
 sake
 Is blasphemed in the Gentiles' wake,"
 As it is written. 25 For indeed
 Is circumcision profit's seed
 If you keep the law, but if you
 Are a breaker of the law true,
 Your circumcision has become
 Uncircumcision *in its sum*.

Beloved, I rob no temples in my way,
 I leave their images to set astray.
 I only raise a humble voice today
 Or yesterday, or rarely to remark
 That images for worship mar the park.
 But every time my word is heard by those
 Who enter the high places that they chose,
 They scorn the message placed beneath
 their nose.
 That's why, Beloved, I keep myself apart,
 And speak to you, the sparrows, and the
 tart
 Or two that stop a moment where I stay.
 And then I go back to the way I pray.
 Irreverence I lay on the church of stone,
 My reverence is such for You alone.

26 Therefore, if an uncircumcised
 Man keeps righteous *and well-advised*
 Requirements of the law, will not
 His uncircumcision be aught
 But counted as circumcision?
 27 Will not the uncircumcised one
 In the flesh, if he keeps the law,
 Judge you who, with *your* written *caw*
 And circumcision, *still* transgress
 The law? 28 For he is not a Jew
 Who's *one* outwardly *with ado*,
 Nor *is* circumcision that which
Is outward in the flesh *for switch*,

29 But *he's* a Jew who's *one* inside,
 And circumcision *to abide*
 Within the heart, and in the spirit,
 Not in the letter *somewhat near it*,
 Whose praise *is* not from men but from
 The God *who takes in count the sum*.
 My circumcision is no work at large
 To keep me on the holy Jewish barge.
 That act is mentioned not at all I see
 Among the big ten for their liberty.
 I'm not sure how the circumcision laid
 Upon the heart and spirit in parade
 Should manifest in anything I've made.
 I'm not sure. Maybe when I take the tome
 Of Decalogue and try to bring it home,
 The circumcision of the hand and foot
 Is there to see where such a thing is put.
 I'll be a Jew inside if that's enough,
 Despite my circumcision in the rough,
 And love and keep Your law, it is not
 tough.

Romans 3

1 What advantage then has the Jew,
 What profit circumcision's due?
 2 Much then in every way! Chiefly
 Because to them were set in fee
 The oracles of God. 3 For what
 If some did not believe *clear-cut*?
 Will unbelieving on their part
 Make faithfulness of God depart?
 4 Most certainly not! Indeed, let
 God be true but every man set
 A liar. As it's written "That
 You may be justified out flat
 In Your words, and may overcome
 When You are judged *and by the sum*."

Advantage of the Jew is that in school
 He learns to read the Hebrew as a rule,
 And so pronounces out the holy word,
 Whether or not he understands what's
 heard.
 My profit is no smaller when I take
 The ten commandments for Your own
 sweet sake
 And for my love of life and peace to make
 A platform free of dangers at the stake
 Where life and love may come to play the
 game
 Successfully upon the sword in flame.

Some may believe and some may play a
part,
And some may drive the donkey after cart,
But let all men lie, if they choose, but I
Cling to Your word, Beloved, until I die.

5 But if our unrighteousness shows
The righteousness of God, what goes
For us to say? *Is* God unjust
Who inflicts wrath? (I speak as must
A man.) 6 Certainly not! For then
How will God judge the world *of men*?
7 For if the truth of God increased
Through my lie to His glory *feast*,
Why am I still judged sinner too?
8 And *why* not *say*, “Then let us do
Evil that good may come *and true*”?
As we are slandered to have said,
And some affirm against our stead.
Such ones’ condemnation is just.
9 What then? Are we better *than dust*?
Not at all. We’ve already charged
Both Jews and Greeks and so enlarged
That all of them are under sin.
10 As it is written “There’s none in
Righteousness, no, not one at all,
11 “There’s none who understands *the call*,
There’s none who seeks after his God.
12 “They have all turned aside *to plod*,
Become unprofitable all,
There’s none who does good, none at all.”
13 “Their throat’s an open tomb, With
tongue
They have practised deceit *where they’ve
sung*”,
“Asps poison *is* under their lips”,
14 “Whose mouth *is* full of cursing *sips*
And bitterness.” 15 “Their feet *are* swift
To shed blood, 16 Destruction *will lift*
To misery *are* in their ways,
17 And the way of peace *their days*
Have not known.” 18 “And there is no fear
Of God before their eyes *appear*.”

The fact that You will judge the world does
not
Proof that You’re qualified to fill the slot.
Paul’s logic is deficient here and there.
And yet perhaps my own logic is bare:
At least what is justified by many,
And just because it does not cost a penny.

The change that’s purposeful implies the
rate
That what exists may not be the best state.
But that’s not all of my complaint: the text
He quotes from Psalms that all sin when
perplexed
Ignores the Psalmist’s note that righteous
men
Still call upon Your name in faith again.
If nothing David knows two groups exist:
The tsadiqim and resha’im persist.

19 Now we know that whatever things
The law says, it says to their stings
Who’re under law, so every mouth
May be stopped shut, *from north to south*
The whole world may be in guilt found
Before God *and upon the ground*.

There have been sinless men, and some
may be
As sinless now as in eternity.
I think of Job and the one man born blind,
And even the man’s parents, to be kind.
The reason Christians want all men to find
Their guilt is so they can be steeped and
wined.
And yet today, if guilt is true and black,
One must not mention it, nor see the stack.
Only the innocent are blamed for lack,
Only the innocent stabbed in the back
With fair impunity. Good Lord, look here
And see the church and state as they
appear.
The law’s a slight protection from insane,
But Paul’s words merely fire the wicked
gain.

20 Therefore by the deeds of the law
There shall no flesh by might of claw
Be justified in His sight: for
By the law’s knowledge of sin’s *store*.
21 But now the righteousness of God
Without the law appears on sod,
Witnessed by the law and the prophets;
22 Even the righteousness and softs
Of God by faith of Jesus Christ
To all and on all them sufficed
Who are faithful, for there is no
Distinction: 23 for all in the show
Have sinned, and come short of the glory
Of God; 24 so being in their story

Justified freely by His grace
 Through the redemption that we trace
 In Christ Jesus: 25 whom God's set out
 Propitiation through faith's clout
 In his blood, to declare his right
 For the forgiveness of sins' blight
 That are past, through forbearance by
 God; 26 to declare at this time why
 He is righteous: that He might be
 Just and the justifier free
 Of faithful ones to Jesus wee.

The deeds of the law are not here to pay
 The way to Canaan's land with heavenly
 ray.

It's not to get to heaven I'd obey,
 But simply to create a space of peace
 Where one can grow a garden and release
 The children from the house in safety's
 hope.

It's not for pie in sky commandments' rope
 Is set, but for the here and now in scope.
 It's basic human rights I wish to see:
 Freedom from fear of any killing spree,
 Freedom from fear of robbers at the door,
 Freedom from rapists and the lying store.
 Those who look to the future reward are
 Detached from gross reality and star.

27 Where's boasting then? It's surely out.
 By what law? Of works? By no clout,
 But by the law of faith, *no doubt*.

28 Therefore we conclude that a man
 Is justified by faith in span
 Without deeds of the law to scan.

29 *Is He* God of the Jews alone?
Is He not also Gentiles' stone?

Yes, of the Gentiles too *in loan*.

30 Seeing *it is* one God, who must
 Justify circumcision's dust
 By faith, uncircumcision too

Through faithfulness *in what they do*,

31 Do we then make the law void through
 Faith? God forbid: indeed we do
 Establish the law, *it is true*.

The principle that You are one is not
 Proposed to generate a war unsought,
 But to reveal that all of humankind
 Are under one God, both seeing and blind.
 We're all in the same boat, so temple walls
 That separate in multi-pleasing stalls

Are just idolatry and nothing more.
 The law is one for all on every score.
 Beloved, the many churches seem to pride
 Themselves on social class more than the
 hide

Of faith in You. I swim against the tide.
 The faithfulness that justifies the man
 Reflects from the commandment in the can.
 The black is black, the white white, tan is
 tan.

Romans 4

1 What shall we say then our ancestor
 Abraham, in his flesh as quester,
 Has found? 2 For if Abraham be
 Justified by works, so then he
 Has cause to boast, but not before
 God *and before His holy store*.

3 For what says Scripture? Abraham
 Believed God, and it was *by dram*
 Counted to him for righteousness.

4 Now to him who works is reward
 Not counted by grace, but due scored.

5 But to the one who is not working,
 But believes in Him without shirking
 Who justifies the wicked ones,
 His faith counts for righteousness' tonnes.

6 Even as David also showed
 The blessedness of the man glowed,
 To whom God counts righteousness well
 Without the works *done as a spell*,

7 "Blessed *are* they whose iniquities
 Remain forgiven, and whose *knees*
Of sin are covered. 8 "Blessed *is*
 The man to whom the Lord *in whizz*
 Will not impute sin *for his biz*."

Let's just get this straight from King
 David's mouth

Before we enter in the gate at south
 Of circumcision and find reason's quit
 The head of Paul and me too where I sit.
 I love and follow David's faith as true,
 And take forgiveness coming down from
 You,

And find that blessedness after the law
 (Where blessedness is mentioned at the
 draw

Only in the last chapters) in the craw
 Is sweet, so sweet, I straightway open maw
 To lap the honey down and then return
 To law as well to find Your love to burn.

I give no whit for anything I earn,
But only for the blessedness in stern.

9 Does this blessedness come just on
The circumcision, or upon
Uncircumcision too in spawn?

For we say that faith was accounted
To Abraham righteousness mounted.

10 How was it then accounted? When
He was in circumcision then,
Or in uncircumcision's thrall?

Not in the circumcision, but
In the uncircumcision shut.

11 And he got circumcision's sign,
A seal of faithful righteousness
Which in uncircumcision's line
He had, so that he in address
Might be the father of all those
That believe, though they *sitting in rows*
Are not of circumcision's *throes*,

That righteousness might be imputed
To them also, when they're recruited;

12 And father of the circumcized
To those who are not circumcized
Alone, but also walk revised
In that faith of our father guised
Abraham, still uncircumcised.

13 For promise he should be the heir
Of the world was not give fair
To Abraham, or to his seed,
Through the law, but through faith indeed
Of righteousness *and not of greed*.

Paul fails to take consideration of
The fact that Abraham in rate of love
Before and after circumcision met
Was always the obedient one set.
He never young or old refused the sign
That You gave him, not for a day of wine
Put off the circumcision as commanded,
But on the very day that it was handed,
Took to the knife though in his old age
caught.

Example of Abraham to be sought
Is that his faith and righteousness were
taught

In his obedience to perfect plot.
Beloved, no matter what You tell me here,
Let me obey the word come to my ear.

14 For if those who are of the law
Are heirs, then faith is void in claw,

The promise without power in craw.
15 For the law perpetrates its wrath:

For where there is no law on path,
There's no transgression in the math.

16 That's why it is of faith by grace;
So that the promise might find trace
To all the seed; not just to what
Is of the law, but to the gut

Too of what is Abraham's faith;
Who's our father, *of every wraith*;

17 As it is written, I have made
You father of nations' parade,
Before the One whom he believed,
God who raises the dead reprieved,
And calls those things which are not so
As though they were set in a row;

18 Who against hope believed in hope,
To become dad of a wide scope,
According to the promise made,
So shall your seed be in parade.

When Abraham becomes the father of
So many nations come after in love,
They are adopted to share in the feel
Of Abrahamic faith for woe and weal.
Yet poor servant that was the Damascene,
And kept accounts of Abram's wealth as
dean

Was not accepted as an heir though he
Was favoured by Abram with jealousy.
When Paul takes early patriarchs to be
Prediction of salvation by decree,
Reflection on the scene fails in perfection,
Some ancient people lived through the
selection

Without a trace of unction of prophetic
Or any other saving herb emetic.

19 And being not weak in faith, he
Considered not his own body
Now dead, when he was up in age
Near one hundred years old in stage,
Nor did he think of Sarah's womb,
20 He did not doubt God's promise room
But was strong in faith, giving God
The glory to heaven on the sod;
21 He was sure that what promise He
Had made, in His capacity
He might perform it faithfully.

22 That's why it was counted to him
For righteousness, it was not dim.

23 It was not written for his sake

Alone, that it was counted stake;
24 But for us also, to whom it
Shall be imputed, if we fit
Believe on Him who came to raise
Up Jesus our Lord from the ways
Of the dead; 25 Who was delivered
For our offences, and was stirred
Up again and for our right stays.

There was some doubt about the body dead
Or near dead when the trio came and said
His wife would give birth on the bridal bed
Despite their ages and the way they fed.
Paul does exaggerate in failing to
Remember that Abram as well as crew
Laughed to hear what You promised You
would do.

Paul's purpose was to make a point in state.
The wavering of faith when at the draw
Is something human and in human crawl,
And all the writing and the rhetoric
Does not diminish the fact in the thick
Of life faith is a tiny flame when set.
It's great in retrospect when as is met.

Romans 5

1 Therefore being set right by faith,
We have peace with God through *the rate*
Of our Lord Jesus Christ *in state*:
2 By whom also we have access
By faith into this grace address
Wherein we stand, and rejoice in
Hope of glory of God *to win*.

Islam is peace with God by every name
That's spoken to that great faith's greater
fame.

And yet adherents that I still could name
Deny that You raised from the deadly game
Your Sent One after the cross and its
shame.

That's why, no doubt, so many of that gate
Fail to achieve obedience in state.
But Christians are no better, they are worse,
For they deny the blessing, cling to curse,
Remain in their sins vaunting they are
saved,

When being justified among the laved
Entails the godly life lived to the hilt,
The life lived without sin and without guilt,
The life raised from the level of blood spilt.

3 And not only so, but we raise
Glory in tribulations phase
Also: knowing that tribulation
Works patience *before an elation*;
4 And patience makes experience; and
Experience brings in hope to stand:
5 And hope will never make ashamed;
Because the love of God unblamed
Is shed abroad in our hearts by
The Holy Spirit from on high.

The tribulation is a thing and time
Sweet Christians now avoid for secret
crime.

They think the rapture's there to save
backside

And take them up to glory in a tide.
But patience in adversity brings in
The glory to rise above others' sin.
The tribulation is the fruit of that
Man of sin who denies Your law in scat
To change both times and laws upon the
mat.

He teaches that the Saviour's death entails
The change in law that every command
fails,

And none need keep divine law, only what
The Church reveals to open and to shut.
Patience, my Love, before the wicked butt.

6 For when we were yet without strength,
In due time Christ died and at length
For the ungodly. 7 For hardly
For a righteous man will one see
A man die, yet perhaps for some
Good man some would even succumb.

8 But God commends His love toward us,
In that, while we were yet in fuss
Of sin, Christ died for us freely.

9 Much more then, being now in fee
Justified by his blood, we'll be
Saved from the *awful* wrath through him.

10 For if, when we were enemies,
We were reconciled to God *trim*
By His Son's death, much more in fees,
As reconciled, we shall be saved
By his life *and the things he braved*.

Reconciled by his death, indeed, no doubt,
But saved only by his life raised and stout
To stand in sanctuary up above
In ministry of faith and prayers and love,

I praise Your name, Beloved, without a
pout.
I'm not saved by a human sacrifice,
I'm not saved by a death that is not nice,
I'm not saved by a god upon a cross,
I'm not saved by my own works and their
dross,
But by the intercession made above
By one who lives in glory hand in glove,
By living and not by the dead in tomb,
By heavenly brightness and not by the
gloom
Of crucifix in Roman Catholic room.

11 Not only so, but we also
Joy in God through our Lord to show
Jesus Christ, by whom we have now
Received atonement. 12 Wherefore how
As by one man sin entered in
The world, and death by sin *to win*;
And so death passed upon all men,
For all have sinned *and sinned again*:
13 For until the law sin was in
The world: but sin's no count in bin
When there is no law, 14 and yet death
Reigned from Adam to Moses' breath,
Even over them who'd not sinned
Like Adam's transgression and kinned,
Who is the figure of the one
That was to come for what he'd done.

The only time the word atonement shows
In the King James V English like a rose
Is in this verse that tells me Jesus makes
Atonement by his life and not the fakes
In wood and metal crucifix in wakes.
Atonement is the life that Jesus gives
Before Your throne, Beloved, there where
he lives.

Atonement is not setting law aside
And saying I need no longer abide
In Your obedience. Oh no, I ride
In the good life imparted to my hide.
I thank and praise You for the grace to
meet
All trials and every temptation on feet
Well planted in Most Holy Place and seat.

15 But not as the offence, so too
Is the free gift. For then if through
Offence of one are many dead,
So much more God's grace by one led,

Jesus Christ, in abundance shed.
16 Not as it was by one that sinned,
So is the gift: for judgement's wind
Is by one to the sentencing,
But the free gift is *of the swing*
Of many offences *to ring*
To justification *in wing*.
17 For if by one man's offence death
Reigned by one; much more those whose
breath
Received abundant grace and gift
Of righteousness shall live to lift
By one, Jesus Christ, *without shift*.
18 Therefore as by offence of one
Judgment came upon every bum
In condemnation; even so
By righteousness of one to show
The free gift came upon all men
To justifying life again.
19 For as by one man's disobeying
Were many turned to sinners swaying,
So by obeying of the one
Shall many be made righteous, hun.
20 Moreover the law entered, that
The offence might abound out flat.
But where sin abounded, grace did
Much more abound: 21 That as sin's *lid*
Has reigned to death, so might grace reign
Through righteousness unto the plain
Of the eternal life that's scored
By Jesus Christ who is our Lord.

The point of exercise is simply that
We may attain to the life that like cat
Of nine or more is the eternal score,
And so not meet the second death on shore
Of lake of fire, when the city comes down
To be upon the earth capital town.
There is no life, no immortality
Outside Christ's death to win the victory
Over the grave, outside the righteousness
That he lays on each faithful one's address.
Beloved, I touch in faith immortal crown,
And count the glories of the royal frown
That takes the sting of sin and death from
me
And shouts aloud songs of eternity.

Romans 6

1 What shall we say then? Shall we keep
On sinning for grace in a heap?
2 May God forbid. How shall we, who

Are dead to sin live in that view?
 3 Do you not know that all of us
 Who were baptized *in glorious*
 Jesus Christ were baptized into
 His death? 4 That's why we're buried too
 Into his death, so like Christ came
 To be raised up from deathly claim
 By glory of the Father's *fame*,
 So we too should walk in new life.
 5 For if we have been planted rife
 Together in what's like his death,
 We shall also in the same breath
 Be at his resurrection's rife.
 6 We know our old man's crucified
 With him, so may be liquefied
 That body of sin, so from now
 On we should not serve sin somehow.

All prophecies peripheral and teachings
 Are set out for the purposes and reachings
 Of keeping humankind from sinful ways.
 But humans do not wish to find the maze.
 Instead they prefer to argue the right
 Way to baptize than enter in the fight
 Against transgression of commandments'
 light.

The theologian often seems to take
 Position that Paul himself for his sake
 Would have us all sin in his joyful wake.
 Beloved, in love keep me from sinful stake,
 Abiding in obedience to You,
 No matter what baptism came to do,
 No matter where the splash and cry and
 hue.

7 For the dead man is freed from sin.
 8 Now if we are dead in the bin
 With Christ, we believe we'll too live
 With him. 9 We know that at the sieve
 Christ raised from the dead dies no more,
 Death has no power on that shore.
 10 For in that he died, so he died
 To sin once, but in living stride
 He lives to God *on every score*.
 11 So count yourselves to be dead too
 To sin, but alive to God's *view*
 Through Jesus Christ our Lord *in pew*.
 12 So don't let sin reign in your mortal
 Body, obeying at the portal
 Its lusts. 13 Do not yield up your members
 As instruments of vile Novembers,
 But yield yourselves to God, as those

Who are alive from the dead throes,
 And your members as instruments
 Of righteousness in God's presence.
 14 For sin shall not have power on you,
 For you're not under the law's hue,
 But under grace *to live and do*.
 15 So what? Shall we sin because we
 Are not under the law but free
 Under grace? God forbid the spree.

I never met paid preacher but he said
 The law could not be kept even in bed,
 But every soul must sin and sin instead
 Of living in the grace of hope when led.
 The law in fact converts the heart to be
 Obedient to You, not to Trinity.
 Paul fights against the rugged Pharisee
 Who depends on law to come set him free
 From Roman victor in the hostelry.
 Paul fights against the Sadducean rate
 Who denies the Messiah's role and fate.
 The rule of love in the divine to wait,
 In the sent one that frees men's souls from
 hate,
 Abides above the wicked heart in bate.

16 Don't you know that to whom you yield
 Yourselves as servants in his field
 You must obey, whether of sin
 To death, or of obeying's bin
 To righteousness *and not to sin*?
 17 But God be thanked, you who were
 slaves
 Of sin, but you've come from the graves
 To obeying and from the heart
 That form of doctrine from the start
 Which was delivered to your part.
 18 Since you've been made free from your
 sin,
 You became slaves of righteous din.
 19 I speak after manner of men
 Because of the weakness again
 Of your flesh, for as you have yielded
 Your members as slaves to unfielded
 Uncleanliness and to wickedness,
 To wickedness, now then impress
 Yourself to yield your members slaves
 To righteousness in holy waves.
 20 For when you were servants of sin,
 You were free from righteousness' bin.
 21 What fruit did you have in those things
 Of which you're now ashamed for stings?

For the end of those things is death.
22 But now you're made free from the
breath

And have become servants to God,
You have your fruit from holy sod,
Ending in life eternal's prod.

23 For the wages of sin *is* death,
But the gift of God *is the breath*
Of life eternal in Christ Jesus
Our Lord *who is not here to tease us.*

The concept of death for a simple sin
Is ancient, no doubt, if the prize to win
Equates the ancient and the primitive
In the way the Australians used to live.
Intrusion on the site where things were kept
For ritual initiations ept,
Churingas and vanigas of adept,
Was most oft death, and may indeed
remain

An action of the primitive insane.
Death for sin as a fair exchange comes
round

In every Christian kind of churchly bound,
As though reason and law could not be
found

And anyway were not sufficient sound
As guide and hedge of life at least in main.

Romans 7

1 Do you not know, brothers, for I
Speak to them who know the law's sky,
How the law has power over man
As long as he lives under span?

2 For a wife's bound to husband by
Law as long as he lives to sigh,
But if the husband comes to die,
She's free from the law of her man.

3 So then if, while her husband's span
Of life remains, she goes to get
Another husband for a pet,

She shall be called adulteress:
But if her husband's in the dress
Of the dead, she's free from that law;
So that she is not in the claw
Of her adultery, though she
Be married to another man.

4 And so, my brothers, in degree
You're also dead to the law's pan
By the body of Christ; so you
Should be married to each in view,
To him who is raised from the dead,

So we should bring forth God's fruit
spread.

I wonder Paul takes marriage in his sight
As allegory of the deed that's right.
He does not mention for himself a wife,
But glories more in his own single life.
He thinks solution of all problems sit
In getting married to the right and fit,
But does not realize that life's begun
In work and sorrows in the wedding's sun.
And yet, Beloved, my marriage to Your son
Raised from the dead without sin in the run
Brings fruit perhaps as web of life is spun.
I see the leading of divine plan in
The past and so I know that it must win
Before the onslaught of a braver kin.

5 For when we were still in the flesh,
The motions of sins by law fresh,
Worked in our members to bring out
Fruit unto death *and without doubt.*

6 But now we are saved from the law,
Which is dead that held us in claw,
So we should serve in spirit new,
Not in the old letter of shrew.

7 What shall we say then? Is law sin?
May God forbid. No, in the din
I should never have known of sin,
But by the law; for I would not
Have known lust except the law sought
To say not to covet in plot.

8 But sin took the commandment's chance,
And call all things in me to dance,
For without law sin's a dead *prance.*

9 I was alive without law once:
But when the commandment *in stunts*
Came, sin revived, I died *a dunce.*

10 And the commandment once ordained
To life, I found to be death gained.

The human spirit takes the law in place
Of the divine in guidance for a trace,
Abuses it to conform to the race
And expectation of his Roman grace.
So Pharisee and Sadducee appeared
To conform to the situation geared,
Thinking to save the people from the
feared.

They praised the law till Caesar was
assured

No king messiah threatened his health
 cured,
 And all were happy to obey the law
 Rather than to bow to justice in paw.
 Beloved, today the opposite in swine
 Makes Jesus king of women, song and
 wine,
 His flesh a banquet where the lawless dine.

Sin took advantage of command,
 Told me lies and killed out of hand.
 12 The law in fact is holy and
 The commandment holy and grand
 In justice and in goodness' stand.
 13 Was then the good made death to me?
 May God forbid. But sin to see
 As sin working its death in me
 By what is good, that sin should be
 By the commandment might become
 Exceeding sinful *in its rum*.
 14 For we know law is spiritual:
 But I'm carnal, sold under wall
 Of sin. 15 For the things that I do
 I don't allow; the good in view
 That I would do, that I don't do;
 But what I hate I come to rue.
 16 If then I do what I would not,
 I admit the law's a good plot.
 17 So it's no longer I who work,
 But the sin in me does not shirk.

The devil made me do it's no excuse,
 If that is what Paul speaks here in abuse.
 The cosmic warfare between right and
 wrong
 Has been the theme of Persian dance and
 song
 For centuries, and yet if it runs long
 Within the human soul in microchip
 Or microcosmos in my floundered ship,
 I trust that where I drift beneath Your care
 Will be the haven of a better share.
 Beloved, the things I want to do in time
 I tend to achieve in both prose and rhyme.
 Perhaps the hopelessness of Paul in clime
 Is higher standards in the things to bear.
 Let me not set a goal beyond my lair.

18 For I know in me, in my flesh
 There is no good thing, *nothing fresh*,
 For the desire is with me still,
 But how to do the good I will

I do not find *beneath the hill*.
 19 For the good that I want to do
 I do not do; but evil things
 That I don't want to do *for stings*
 Are just what I do *in my wings*.
 20 Now if I do what I would not,
 It's no more I who work the plot,
 But sin that dwells in me for slot.
 21 So I find a law, that, when I
 Would do good, evil comes in sly.
 22 For I delight in law of God
 After the inward man *in pod*:
 23 But I see another law in
 My members, warring in its sin
 Against the law of my mind, and
 Bringing me into captive stand
 To the law of sin which is in
 My members *causing such a din*.
 24 O wretched man that I've become!
 Who shall deliver me in sum
 From this death of body *and rum*?
 25 *But* I thank God through Jesus Christ
 Our Lord. So then with mind sufficed
 I myself serve the law of God;
 But with flesh sin's law *on the sod*.

The faces turn to pots when I know that
 Paul makes here no excuse for sin out flat,
 But shows it foreign to both life and song,
 Simply because no man wants to do wrong.
 There is no true depravity, says he,
 But if the flesh is weak to join the spree,
 Desire for good is still within the wee.
 That may not be enough to turn the wheel
 From wrong to right, and head upon the
 heel,
 But does suffice to show a better law
 Is still stuck in the man and woman's craw.
 Beloved, I flee to You from the warfare
 In cosmos and in heart that I may bare,
 And find the path to life becomes my share.

Romans 8

1 Therefore now no judgement falls on
 Those in Christ Jesus, who *from dawn*
 Do not act as flesh *demands* but
 As spirit. 2 For the law *unshut*
 Of spirit of life in the Christ
 Jesus has made me free *enticed*
 From the law of sin and *its* death.

Beloved, all men and women too are set

Beneath some law, the law that all have met
 In what the neighbour says or what the state,
 Or even what the biologic fate
 Of everyone would insist on to mate.
 Beloved, law follows all determinate
 Even in law to breathe air and to wait.
 Give me the law to live freely without
 The weight of following the crowd about,
 The weight of doing only what the need
 Of food and drink and drug come up to deed.
 The Christ who leads me to the Decalogue
 Shows path of freedom from the pond and frog.
 I'm free to choose to do what I would flout.

3 For what law could not do in that
 It was weak because where flesh sat,
 God sending His own Son to be
 In likeness of sinful flesh *wee*,
 And as for sin, condemned *freely*
 Sin in the flesh, 4 that righteousness
 Of the law might be fulfilled *dress*
 In us who act not after flesh
 But after spirit *out of mesh*.
 5 For those who are according to
 Flesh consider fleshly things in due,
 But those who are according to
 Spirit the spiritual view.

Indeed, I read the ten commandments here
 With spirit's eye, and find that what I fear
 Is but deluded pride, opinion of
 Those who seek power instead of divine love.
 The flesh reads "Thou shalt not" and sees
 the bands
 Of tyranny upon the silver sands.
 The spirit reads the same words to find
 there
 The promise of a life that's fine and fair
 And free from peer pressure and body wear.
 The flesh sees the law as a foul restraint,
 Under which one may live but always faint.
 The spirit sees it guardian of the free
 Who come up out of the Egyptian spree.
 Beloved, I bow to You and Your decree.

6 For to be fleshly minded's death,

But spiritually minded's *breath*
 Of life and peace. 7 Because the mind
 Of flesh is enmity to find
 Against God, for it is not set
 Beneath the law of God, nor yet
 Can it be *whenever it is met*.
 8 So those who *act* by flesh cannot
 Please God *with anything they've wrought*.
 9 But you do not bide by the flesh
 But by the spirit *and as fresh*,
 If so be God's spirit keeps house
 Among you. Now if any *louse*
 Does not have Christ's spirit, he's not
 One of his. 10 And if Christ's among
 You, then the body's dead by sin,
 But the spirit is a life sung
 Because of righteousness *you're in*.

I've seen the body forget self a day
 When art or concert comes around to sway
 The senses and to capture one for pay.
 I've seen the body sunk into small death
 When slumber creeps over the sleeper's
 breath
 Forgetful of every known shibboleth.
 I've seen the body turn to deeds as fine
 And great as ever, when a hero's wine
 Took over mind and captured the soul's
 shrine.
 Beloved, I find in You my rapture and
 My rest and loyalty, and so I stand
 In the throng of Your sent one's loving
 band.
 Invisible as You Yourself Your Christ
 Draws from my heart a love emparadised.

11 But if the spirit of the One
 Who raised up Jesus from those done
 To death is keeping house among
 You, then the raising up *that's sung*
 Of Christ from among dead ones shall
 Also making you lively *in mall*
 Of mortal bodies through *the pal*
 Of his spirit in your corral.

Some bear witness to seeing a Christ form
 Torn from the garden, and under the storm
 Of hate dressed in mock royal clothes and
 crown
 To traipse under a cross about the town.
 Some bear witness to seeing Christ nailed
 down

And thrust between the darkened sky a
 clown
 Of suffering. Some came to the grave to
 seek
 Christ dead among the silent and the meek.
 Beloved, he was not there, since he was
 raised
 By prayers miraculous among the praised.
 He left the dead to dry bones and the sod
 And went to stand my You, his Lord and
 God.
 Beloved, may the same prayer of power
 raise me
 To be one with You too eternally.

12 That's why, brothers, we're debtors all,
 Not to the flesh live to its call.
 13 For if you live according to
 Flesh, you must die, but then if you
 By spirit put fleshly deeds to
 Death, then you'll live *by the life due*.
 14 Whoever then are led by that
 Spirit of God, then *where they sat*
 They are the sons of God *for that*.
 15 For you did not receive again
 Spirit of bondage feared in vain,
 But you've received the spirit of
 Adoption, by which we *in love*
 Shout "Father, Father!" 16 And itself
 The spirit bears witness to self
 In our spirit that we are *none*
 But children of God *who is One*.

Some deny that he was the son of God,
 And truly he is not a pea from pod.
 What makes him Your child's not the flesh
 and blood
 But spirit that raises above the mud
 To works the Decalogue, once shadow
 bone,
 Raised to life in his hand before Your
 throne.
 As spirit vivifies Your word and promise,
 I too turn from being a doubting Thomas
 To call You Father as well as Beloved.
 Like Christ, all who do so return well-
 gloved
 As sons and daughters rather than the
 slaves
 Of flesh that goes down to the silent graves.
 Beloved, that's why so many words rise up
 To fill with praise my alabaster cup.

17 And if children, then heirs indeed
 Of God, joint-heirs with Christ *His seed*,
 So if we suffer with his need,
 We may also be glorified
 Together *standing by his side*.

Some bear witness that You are made in
 sum
 Of three by Christ and Spirit once more
 come.
 But surely the joint-heirs as well come take
 Their share in glory and in well-done steak.
 There is indeed a Trinity of three,
 I'll not cry that down in some blasphemy,
 But only say that no limits can be
 On Your shared grace in our divinity.
 As Christ is heir of God, so I shall be
 Who flee to Your law of grace' liberty.
 And that makes four, but then quadernity
 Is multiplied thousands by Your decree.
 Beloved, three in One, yes, but much, much
 more,
 All may share in the divine I in store.

18 For I reckon this present time
 Of sufferings are not worth the climb
 Compared with the glory which shall
 Be revealed in us *capital*.
 19 For the earnest expectations
 Of the creature waits for the stuns
 Of the appearing of God's sons.
 20 Then the creature was set beneath
 The authority of the thief
 Not by its will but by the One
 Who also in hope set *the sun*,
 21 Because the creature itself shall
 Be delivered from arsenal
 Of corruption's bondage *and thrall*
 Into glorious freedom's *hall*
 Of God's children *at trumpet call*.

The spirit truly wins the day as it
 Sees through the veils to a new glory fit.
 Truly You are the One who wove and knit
 The screen of néant on eternity
 And cast the shadows that move in the play
 That calls creation from the night and day.
 Yet spirit is ephemeral to touch
 And stone and steel speak to the soul as
 much.
 The spirit that leads in the vital go

To life eternally within the show
Of Decalogue, leads on above to know
Deliverance from death's seed in the bone
And blood to find life here before Your
throne.
Beloved, I wait and prosper, I shall grow.

22 For we know that all of creation
Groans and labours in the pangs' ration
Together until this *summation*.
23 And not only, but ourselves too,
Who have the first-fruits of things due
From the spirit, even ourselves
We groan with as *upon the shelves*
Waiting to the adoption and
Redemption of body *and hand*.
24 For we are saved by hope, but hope
That is seen is not hope *but pope*,
For what a person sees, why does
He still hope for it *in the buzz*?

All things created here below the sun
Groan for deliverance from weight like
tonne
Of principalities seen on the run.
The State may be just an idea, the Church
An empty dream to leave one in the lurch,
But to depend on pope or priest or king
Is to release faith and hope for the thing.
All things deceive, all things betray, and all
That sit on golden thrones have missed
Your call.
Though all hold sceptre by Your sovereign
will,
And wield the sword for punishment
wrecked still
Upon the unjust when they fit the bill,
Their names for usurpation must arise
When You, Beloved, tear down the
columned skies.

25 But if we hope for what we don't
See, we wait for it patiently.
26 In the same way the spirit too
Helps our weaknesses, *not a few*,
For we do not know how we ought
To pray for what cannot be bought,
Then the spirit itself gives voice
For us with groanings *without choice*
Not to be spoken to *rejoice*.
27 And He who searches hearts knows
what

Is the mind of the spirit *cut*,
Because he speaks up for the saints
According to God's own *complaints*.

Indeed, the human heart cannot invent
The truth obvious, visible, and sent
Once heard on Sinai to invoke, present
What things the spirit groans within the
breast.

Indeed, humankind cannot find its rest
Outside the spirit's leading to the stone
Whereon You once wrote love letters in
loan.

Your promises remain the spirit's voice,
And in their cantillation soul finds choice,
A door to break determination's zeal
And the bands and bars of what human's
feel.

The spirit speaks within always those
words

That flew from Sinai like black signal birds
Turned iridescent with lightning's appeal.

28 We know God makes all things turn out
Good for those who love God *devout*,
To those who are called by *His will*
To His purpose and to fulfil.
29 For those he knew beforehand He
Also beforehand planned to be
Conformed to His Son's likeness, that
He might be the prince where there sat
Many brothers *in habitat*.

All things, indeed, turn to the best for those
Who follow in the promises of rose
Couched in the Decalogue with singing
tones

That sparkle in the breastplate high priest
owns,
That crinkle with their brightnesses my
eyes

Who seek in them Your voice to my
surprise.

All things, indeed, Beloved, turn to the fair
For those who take their hands away from
wear

And power to lay hold on Your statutes
there.

Beloved, I wrest my life away from that
Tortured, determined, lock-step march on
flat

To enter the exquisite liberty

Of choice Your Decalogue gives to the
free,
Conformed to likeness of Your son's esprit.

30 Moreover those He did preplan
He also called and those in scan
He called He also justified,
Whom justified He glorified.
31 What shall we then say to these things?
If God's for us, who carries stings?
32 The One who did not spare His own
Son, but gave him up *to atone*
For all of us, how shall He not
Along with him also in plot
Freely give to us all the lot?

Obedience of Your Christ opens the way
For my obedience in the narrow day,
Your planning, calling, justifying him
Results in my glory too and not dim.
My glory is a thing that still is found
Despite the simple life and low around
The modest state I fill upon the ground.
My glory is not in position held
Above mankind, nor when the coffers
swelled
With wealth, but in the well-taught deed to
do
According to Your command to be true.
So is Your plan, Your calling from the
mount,
Your justifying word and deed in count,
To glorify me too by glinting fount.

33 Who'll lay a charge against the one
Elected by God *under sun*?
God is the justifying One.
34 So who condemns? It's Christ who died,
Yet rather who's risen to bide,
Who is at God's right hand to stand
To speak up for us *in the land*.
35 Who'll separate us from Christ's love?
Shall tribulation or the shove
Of distress, persecution or
Famine, nakedness *on the shore*,
Or peril or sword *what is more*?
36 As it is written, "For your sake
We're killed all the day long in wake,
We're seen as sheep at slaughter's stake."
37 But in all these things we are more
Than victors through him who *in store*
Loved us. 38 For I'm persuaded that

Neither death nor life lean or fat,
Nor angels, principalities,
Nor powers, nor things present one sees
Nor things to come, any of these,
39 Nor height, nor depth nor any thing
Created can rise to the sting
To separate us from the love
Of God which is in Christ above,
Jesus our Lord *from push to shove*.

I look down from the heights that frighten
me
And find below the depths of all things
free,
And see upon horizons all the length
That piles upon the piles of divine strength,
And still find in the still small voice within
The witness that Your love comes without
sin
To every soul that buries heart to find
Your Christ in word and deed of the
resigned.
Beloved, I am resigned to find as fair
Your footsteps where I struggle well as
where
I rest in peace and wait the star-filled stair.
Beloved, I'm up in arms to gain the gate
And storm the battlements where demons
wait,
Break through the barbican and take my
rate.

Romans 9

1 I tell the truth in Christ and not
A lie, my conscious bearing sought
Witness in holy spirit got,
2 That I have grief and sorrow great
Continuing in my heart's *state*.
3 For I could wish myself accursed
From Christ for my brothers and *nursed*
Kinsmen according to the flesh
(*But not the spirit to be fresh*),
4 Who're Israelites to whom is given
Adoption and the glory striven,
And covenants and the law heard,
And service and promising word,
5 Whose are the fathers and from whom
Christ came living in flesh *for room*.
Blessed be God who is over all
Till the ages amen *enthral*.

The fact is Israelites Paul knew back then

Were not present by Sinai's foot back when
You spoke the law with thunder and with
light.

They did not hear the words or see the
sight.

So what they got, they got not with their
genes

But by the reading of what intervenes
On scroll and on lip singing from the heart.
Without their race I have as much a part
In Scripture in my own tongue for a start.
Beloved, You gave the covenant of old
To those who obey Your word in the fold.
I come with the intention to obey
All ten of the promises that You say.
I covet no one's forefathers today.

6 It's not as if the word of God
Had taken no effect *slipshod*.

For they're not all of Israel's *race*
Who show in Israel *their face*.

7 Neither because they are the seed
Of Abraham, children indeed,
But "In Isaac your seed be called."

8 That is, they who are sons of flesh
Are not the sons of God *from crèche*,
But the children of promise are
Counted for the seed *from afar*.

9 For this is the word of promise,
"At this time I will come and kiss
Sarah with a son *not to miss*."

10 And not only, but Rebecca
When she also conceived in crawl
By one man who's Isaac our pa,

11 For not yet being born nor yet
Having done right or wrong to set,
That God's purpose according to
His calling might stand, not in view
Of any good things that they do
But of Him who has called *them true*,

12 One said to her, "The older shall
Serve the younger *without cabal*."

13 As it is written, "Jacob I
Have respected, but Esau's cry
I have *not heard but* hate *awry*."

14 What shall we say then? And with God
Unrighteousness? Not on the sod.

You may have predicted the thing from
womb

Of Rebecca, but as I read the tomb
And its inscription, I find Esau had

A choice in what he chose of doing bad.
And yet each choice was harder than the
last

Until his sons forced him to meet the blast
Of treachery against Jacob and fast.

I too find circumstances fit the bill
And seem to force my hand for good and
ill.

And yet in my experience I find
The patient intention to break the bind
Has its reward, and despite the ensigned
Who cast upon me evil they've enshrined,
Your hand bears up my conscience for the
kind.

15 For he says to Moses "I will
Have mercy on my own choice still
And have compassion on the one
On whom I will have compassion.

16 So it's not from one who desires
Nor from the one who runs like fires,
But from God who shows mercy's *spires*.

17 The Scripture says to Pharaoh too
That even for this same in view
I have raised you up that I might
Show my power in you that the sight
Might publish through all earth My name.

18 That's why He has mercy in claim
On whomever he wants, and whom
He wills He hardens *to their doom*.

19 You'll say to me then, "Why does He
Still find to blame *in you and me*,
Since neither has resisted *nor*
Disobeyed His will *at the door*?"

20 No, but, O man, who are you that
Reply against God *where He sat*?
Can what is formed say to the one
Who made it, "What is this you've done?"

21 Does not the potter have his power
Over the clay, and in an hour
From the same lump to make a bowl
Of beauty or a piss-pot roll?

Indeed, Beloved, though I find Your hand
still

To be loving and kind, though I've had fill
Of human discomfort from those who chill,
Even if I must bend beneath the weight
Of punishment of Your wrath and Your
hate,

I have no justified complaint to make.

All things work behind scenes for Your
own sake.

As I look at the broken shards that trace
My life from every nook and hiding place,
I find the scattered pieces patterned yet
In unexpected vessels on the set.
Beloved, the worthless facets I reject
In Your love turn to jewels circumspect,
To mirror the One true and to reflect.

22 If God, willing to show His wrath
And make His power known *in Gath*,
Was patient with the pots of wrath
Fit only for destruction's path,
23 And that He might make known the
wealth

Of His glory on pots in stealth
Of mercy, that He had prepared
Beforehand to *His* glory *shared*,
24 Even us whom He's called to be
Not of Jews only but the free
Gentiles also? 25 As He says too
In Hosea, "I'll call them true
My people, who were not My folk,
And her beloved, who was a soak.
26 "And it shall happen in the place
Where it was said to them in trace,
'You're not my people,' there shall they
Be called God's sons, *who holds the sway*."

I heard the church tell me to take a swim
And not come back to chatter or to hymn.
Though I may not be son of priest and bell,
And have no place in pew of Israel,
Still You, Beloved, look on the one whose
knell

Was preached in treachery and sent to hell,
And say that I'm a child divine as well.
I may not have a place among the just
And righteous, among the well-dressed to
trust,

But I still have a place graded in Your
heart,

And I still have a song to sing and part
To play, if only on the edge of noon.
Beloved, You call me still Your child and
soon
In comfort I take hold of that bright boon.

27 Isaiah also cried about
Israel, "Though the number of stout
Sons of Israel be as the sand

Of the sea, a remnant shall stand.

28 For He will finish up the work
And cut it short right without shirk,
Because YHWH will make a short work
Upon the earth, *not stand and lurk*."

29 And as Isaiah said before,
"Except YHWH of hosts had in store
A seed left to us, we had been
As Sodom, Gomorrah in sin."

30 What shall we say then, that Gentiles
Who followed in no righteous miles
Have achieved to fair righteousness,
Right which is born of faith's address?

31 But Israel, who followed the law
Of righteousness has not in awe
Achieved the law of righteousness.

32 And why? Because not by faith, but
As it were by the works that strut
Of the law, for they stumbled at
That stumbling stone where it was at.

33 As it is written, "Behold I
Lay in Zion a stone to shy
And a rock of offence thereby,
And whoever believes on Him
Will not be put to a shame *dim*."

Indeed, though congregations may relate
To Your law with obedience to state,
And perfectly reflect Your truth and will,
When they reject a stone You've set on hill,
And treat unloving Your son fit to kill,
Then their obedience is all for naught.
Their steeple has become a barren lot.
Like Your Messiah I too have once been
Or even twice I can say without sin
The stumbling block that brought the
righteous down.

My role has ever been about the town
To inspire good people to show their frown
And reveal the black heart beneath the coat
Of crass hypocrisy. They've missed the
boat.

Beloved, as I see the last swimmers sink
Beneath the waters at the church's brink,
And know the lack of charity that made
Them sinners on the devil's vast parade
Was directed to me, I have two prayers.
The first is not to take them unawares,
But forgive when they stabbed me on the
stairs.

The second is that I who am but small

Compared to the great and fat in the stall,
 Who have neither gift nor the good deed
 done
 Shall win upon the long race when it's
 done.
 Surely if any sign can rise to show
 That grace and grace alone's the way to go,
 It would be that I stand in judgement's
 glow.

Romans 10

1 Brothers, my heart's desire and prayer
 To God for Israel to share,
 Is that they might be saved *with care*.
 2 For I testify to them that
 They have the zeal of God thereat,
 But not according to *the fat*
Of knowledge. 3 Ignorant of God's
 Righteousness, going on with pods
 To set up their own righteousness,
 They have not submitted to bless
 Themselves to their God's righteousness.
 4 Messiah is the goal of law
 For righteousness to every jaw
 That is faithful. 5 For Moses shows
 Righteousness from the law *that goes*,
 That the man who does things *like* those
 Shall live by them *before his foes*.
 6 But the righteousness come by faith
 Speaks in this way and not like wraith,
 "Do not say in your heart, 'Who'll go
 Up in to heaven *at a blow*
 To bring Messiah *down to show?*'"
 7 Or, 'Who shall descend in the deep
 To bring Christ from the dead *to peep?*'"
 8 But what does it say? 'Word is near
 To you, in your mouth and your ear,
 And in your heart,'" that is the word
 Of faith that we preach *undeterred*,
 9 That if you confess with your mouth
 The lord Jesus, and *with no drouth*
 Believe in your heart that God raised
 Him from among the dead, *be praised*,
 You shall be saved, *even if dazed*.

Two strands of revelation do appear
 In the Old Testament of wrath and fear
 As some say it must be who raise a cheer.
 Two strands of light rise to wake up a tear.
 The word made flesh in the Messiah dear,
 The word made audible for all to hear
 In Sinai's law: these are the two in spear.

Never was a salvation once made clear
 Beside that of these two for hope and gear.
 The ten commandments and appointed man
 Have always been the centre of your plan.
 Let righteousness flood into me and mine,
 Into the land I live in to be fine,
 And cover all with Your Word and its
 brine.

10 For with the heart a man believes
 To righteousness *that he receives*;
 And with the mouth confession's made
 Unto salvation *in heart stayed*.
 11 For the scripture says "Who indeed
 Believes on Him shall be one freed
 From shame *both in the fruit and seed*."
 12 For there's no difference between
 The Jew and the Greek *on the scene*:
 For the same Lord over all's rich
 To all who call Him from the ditch.
 13 For whosoever shall call on
 The name of YHWH shall be saved drawn.
 14 How then shall they call on Him in
 Whom they have not believed *for sin?*
 And how shall they believe in him
 Of whom they have not heard *for dim?*
 And how shall they hear without some
 Preacher *to preach to them when come?*

The calling on the name, the blessed name,
 Has always been the way to heavenly fame.
 When Seth called on the name then men
 were proud
 To turn from civilized and the unbowed
 To walk with You, Beloved, beneath the
 cloud
 Of hope and fratricide that's here allowed.
 I call upon the name of YHWH and find
 A greater banquet than among the wined,
 A greater consolation than the kind.
 The service of remembrance Of Your flame,
 The whirling as a sacrifice in game,
 The recitation of Your name's the same
 Today as in the days of Enoch and
 The days when David walked upon the
 land.

15 And how shall they preach, except they
 Be sent? As it's written in sway,
 "How beautiful the feet of those
 Who preach the gospel that peace chose,
 And bring glad tidings of good things!"

16 But they've not all obeyed the true
 Gospel. For Esaias in due
 Says "Lord, who hath believed the springs
 Of our report?" 17 So then faith sings
 By hearing, hearing by God's word.
 18 But I say Have they not heard stirred?
 Yes truly, their message went to
 All the earth, and their words unto
 The ends of all the world in view.
 19 But I say "Did not Israel know?
 First Moses says, 'I will now show
 You jealousy by those who're no
 People and by the foolish glow
 Of a nation I'll make you mad.'
 20 "But Esaias is very glad
 To say 'I was found by those who
 Were not out looking for the true,
 I was made manifest to them
 Who were not asking for My gem.'
 21 " But to Israel He says 'All day
 I've stretched out My hands in this way
 To a folk disobedient and
 A people who deny My stand.'"

Beloved, I know Your hands still stretch
 above
 The world where few turn to You in Your
 love,
 Where all run here and there and none
 repent
 Beneath the cloistered flowers in Your tent.
 Remind me on a day when prayer turns
 bleak
 To whirl about to find the thing I seek
 In You alone, Beloved, and in Your way.
 Remind me, my Beloved, upon a day.
 I am a jealous sort, and though I flee
 From You, I'd turn about, if I should see
 You take another hand out of the spree
 And leave me headlong in iniquity.
 I am a jealous sort, after Your heart
 That foils the fables of the fish-god's dart.

Romans 11

1 I say then, "Hath God cast away
 His people? God forbid, I say.
 For I'm also an Israelite,
 Of the seed of Abraham's *light*,
 Of the tribe of Benjamin's *right*.
 2 God has not cast away His folk
 That He knew beforehand in stroke.
 Do you not know what Scripture tells

About Elias *in the dells*?
 How he made intercession to
 God against the Israelite crew,
 Saying 3 "Lord, they have killed the true
 Prophets, and dug Your altars down,
 And I am left alone to frown,
 And they seek my life around town."
 4 But what did the reply of God
 Tell him? "I have reserved in pod
 To myself seven thousand men,
 Who have not bowed the knee again
 To images of Baal in den."
 5 So then at this present time too
 There's a remnant according to
 Election of grace *promise true*.
 6 And if by grace, then it's no more
 Of works, otherwise grace in store
 Is no more grace *than once before*.
 But if it's of works, then there's no
 More work. 7 What then? Of Israel's show
 He has not got where he would go,
 But the election has found fit,
 And the rest are blind where they sit.

The chosen race is still Your own, I see,
 And I rejoice that such a thing should be.
 That remnant that is secret does not bow
 The knee to Baal, they are my own
 somehow.

Beloved, I praise You that behind the scene
 Of wickedness and holocausts where keen
 The naked and the woe-begone, I find
 The living remnant hidden from the blind.
 The lovely race of those obedient
 Be my own people though a mere remnant,
 And so let me find from my beggar's road
 And vagabond's reproach and better load.
 Join me to the elect in hidden vale,
 And I shall live to see the world grow pale.

8 According as it once was writ,
 "God's given them sleep in spirit,
 Eyes that they should not see, and fit
 Ears that they should not hear the wit
 Until this very day and kit.

9 And David says "Their table be
 Made a snare, and a trap to see,
 A stumblingblock, and recompense
 To them: 10 "Let their eyes and *their sense*
 Be darkened that they may not see,
 And bow down their back *futilely*."

11 I say then, "Have they stumbled that

They should fall?" God forbid *out flat*:
But rather through their fall salvation
Has come upon the Gentile nation,
Provoking them to jealous ration.
12 Now if their fall makes the world rich,
The Gentiles wealthy by their pitch,
How much more their Fullness to stitch?

I thank you that some Jewish men and
wenches
Fell from holy estate and holy benches
To leave a place for me to take a share
In promises that I could hardly wear,
If left to my devices once laid bare.
But if creation was meant only for
The progeny of Abraham in store,
And others were meant for the chips that
fall
Discarded by the sculptor's leaning wall,
My sense of justice grates against the gore.
So much for human sense of justice here:
The artist only has the right to tear
Or joy that any piece of marble laid
May catch the glint of sun in the parade.

13 For I speak to you Gentiles, since
I'm Gentiles' apostle to wince,
I magnify my office stints,
14 If any way I can provoke
To emulation my own folk,
And save some of them at a stroke.
15 For if their casting away be
The reconciling of earth's fee,
What then shall their receiving be,
But life from the dead *earnestly*?
16 For if the firstfruit's holy, then
The lump is also holy yea,
And if the root is holy, so
Are all the branches in their show.
17 And if some branches break away,
And you, a wild olive in sway,
Are grafted in among their pay,
And nourished by the root that way
And fatness of the olive tree;
18 Don't boast against the branches wee.
But if you boast, it is not you
Who bears the root, but the root you.

Semitic tents shade me and mine to sing
The Psalms of David on unholy wing,
While all the great and small in temenos
Bow to the din of Baal and Baalite boss.

The root is good enough for me to give
The nourishment that I may need to live,
And so I take the Hebrew strains aloud
And turn my back from the gyrating crowd.
Beloved, I've seen the grafting in my day
Once when I lived and studied a long way
From here. The orchard was a place remote
Where I could learn the ways of carry tote.
I know the thing takes time, and so I sing
The Psalm each evening when I fold my
wing.

19 You'll say the branches were cut off
To give the grafted place to scoff.
20 That's good enough. For unbelief
They were cut off, and *without grief*
You stand by faith. So do not boast,
But stand in fear *to make your toast*.
21 For if God did not spare the true
And natural branches in His view,
Be careful what He'll do to you.
22 So see the good and harshness too
Of God: on those who fell, the harsh,
But toward you goodness *from the marsh*,
If you continue in his good:
Else you'll be cut off as you should.

Long since the wild olive was cast aside
For disobedience along the ride.
When Sabbath disappeared from Christian
church,
The wild folk were all left there in the lurch
Of grace imaginary though in style.
The way was taught in enmity and guile,
And in such lack of wit to win a smile
From angel and from gods, if it had been
Less reason to weep for unholy sin.
Beloved, I brace myself against the sway
Of branches that return upon the day
And cast away the freedom of Your law,
Relying on the rule of tooth and claw,
Survival of the fittest for decay.

23 And they too, if they do not stay
In their old unbelieving way,
Will be grafted back in, for God
Can graft them in again *with prod*.
24 For if you were cut from the tree
Of wild olive's nature's degree
And were grafted by contrary
Nature into good olive tree,
How much more then shall these, which be

The natural branches, grafted be
 Back into their own olive tree?
 25 For, brothers, I don't want you to
 Be ignorant of mystery true,
 For fear that you pretend to be
 Wise in your own conceit to see:
 Such blindness in part's Israel's fee,
 Until all the Gentiles who'll be
 Saved come into *the olive tree*.
 26 And so all Israel shall be saved:
 As it is written on script paved,
 "There shall come out of Sion the Saviour,
 Turn away ungodly behaviour
 From Jacob: 27 For this is my pact
 To them, when I rise up to act
 And take away their sins all stacked.

The story book unfolds from day to day
 As I read how old Israel went astray,
 And followed other gods along the way.
 That was a long time since. Now as I pray,
 I find the Jews as staunch as any who
 Reject the wickedness of wicked crew.
 No longer do they bow to Baal and think
 The scientific ardour of that stink
 Essential to the human on the brink.
 Instead they read the Torah and each week
 Turn to the one and true God that they
 seek.

Salvation falls upon the ones who know
 The better ways that angels came to show.
 I follow in the faithful way they go.

28 As concerning the gospel, they
 Are enemies for your sakes' sway:
 But touching the election day,
 They're beloved for their father's way.
 29 For the gifts and calling of God
 Cannot be broken on the sod.
 30 For as you in times past did not
 Believe God, and yet have now sought
 Mercy through their unbelief wrought:
 31 Even so have these also now
 Not believed, that it may allow
 Through your mercy they also may
 Obtain mercy *and in one day*.
 32 For God has concluded them all
 In unbelief, that He might call
 Mercy upon all *in their stall*.

The unbelief that scattered out the Jew
 Was their unfaithfulness, Beloved, to You,

And not refusal to admit the fair
 Jesus was David's son and lawful heir.
 All blasphemy against the Son's forgiven,
 But not against the Spirit when we've
 striven.

That's why return to keep You law again
 Sets all back under faithful grace to men.
 Beloved, my day of mercy comes at last
 Announcing the new wine and the repast,
 The windows on a holy place in store,
 A throne behind the opened, golden door.
 The nights and days I spent before Your
 face

Reveal to me the glories of this place.

33 Oh the depth of the riches of
 Wisdom and knowledge of God's *love!*
 How unsearchable are His ways
 Of judgments, and His ways in *praise*
 Past finding out! 34 For who has known
 The mind of the Lord *as it's shown?*
 Or who has been His counsellor?
 35 Or who has first given His score,
 To turn around, receive again?
 36 For of him, and through him, and to
 Him, are all things: to whom in due
 Be glory for ever. Amen.

Plan of redemption in the mind of God,
 Incomprehensible upon the sod,
 Is best left without words of explanation
 To breach the time and place of its
 vocation.

The follies that men preach of cross and
 crown
 Are trotted out before the crowd and town,
 While You in wisdom and love still look
 down.
 Beloved, in silence I avoid Your frown.
 With every speech about atonement I
 Hear only heathen voices on the sky,
 And so I turn away from those who die,
 And learn my business on the awful brink.
 For me to obey is my bread and drink,
 For You to save any manner You think.

Romans 12

1 That's why I beg you, brothers by
 The mercies of God, don't deny
 Your bodies in a living offering,
 Both holy and received when proffering
 To God, which is your reasonable

Service as liturgy in full.

2 And don't be conformed to this world:
But be transformed by the unfurled
Renewing of your mind, so you
May prove what's good, acceptable,
And perfect will of God in view.

The living human sacrifice in view,
And not the decide corrects the rue.
Salvation's not the crucifix to ride,
But daily doing right beneath the guide.
The transformation that comes from Your
Word,

Both in the script and in the things I've
heard,

As well as in the flesh and blood to make
A life both faithful and without mistake,
Is where salvation hides from wicked stake.
Beloved, I take hold of the Gospel crown
And wield it at the grace Your throne sends
down

Upon my head. See where the silver slips
About the corridors of phantom ships
Upon a sea of glass before the street
Of gold undampened by the shadowed
sleet.

3 For I say, through the grace given me,
To every man among you free,
Not to think of himself highly
More than he ought to soberly,
According as God to every
Man's dealt faith's measure *faithfully*.

4 For as we have members many
Of diverse roles in one body,
5 So we're many in one body
In Christ, and every one to be
Members one of another, see.
6 Having then gifts diverse by grace
That's given to us: if by trace
Of prophecy, by measure of
The faith *we hold and hold in love*;

7 Or ministry to minister;

Or he that teaches, teach to stir,

8 Or the exhorter, as it were,

To exhort; he who gives a rate,

To do so in a simple state;

And he who would administrate,

To do so with diligent gait;

And he who shows mercy, to wait
With cheerfulness *and not be late*.

Diversity of gifts was never taken

As the ideal in a church unshaken.

The pews are set in rows so all should
know

That not only equality in show
Requires the lopping off of heads that grow
Above the level of the painful slow,
But that conformity is divine law
In the church of the devil's tooth and claw.
Diversity of gifts, oh yes, I feel
The hope of Paul before the cutting steel,
But sense upon my skin the blacken heel
Of Rome and daughters in unbroken zeal.
Beloved, diversity's a song to sing,
But no one seems to love the very thing.

9 Let love be without hiding face.

Detest the evil, hold the chase

Of what is good *in every trace*.

10 Deal kindly with each other in
Affection, and prefer to win

Honour for others than yourself.

11 Do not be lazy *as an elf*

In your affairs, but with a mind

Of eager service, serve resigned

The Lord. 12 Rejoice in hope to find

Patience in trials *of every kind*,

Steadfast in prayer, *be so inclined*.

13 Hand out necessities to saints

In hospitality's restraints.

14 Bless those who persecute you, bless,

And never curse *on their address*.

The truth is that the Psalms from day to day
Lay blessings and lay cursings in the way
They treat the enemy, the saint, the fray.
Does this conflict with what Paul's here to
say?

I think not. But the sweet Christian in life's
Uncomfortable with the curse in strifes,
And must repent, perhaps, if penance still
Remains a part of his religious thrill.
More like he sees with judgement any frill
Of cursing. Sweet talk always fits his bill
As he slips the sharp knife into the grill
Of brother. My Beloved, let me remain
In David's catharsis and so be sane,
Unhypnotized by rhetoric in vain.

15 Rejoice with those who do rejoice,
And weep with weepers *in loud voice*.

16 Agree with one another's cheer.

Don't fly too high and out of gear,
But condescend to low estate.
Don't be too wise in your own rate.
17 Repay no one for evil done
With evil *poured out in a tonne*.
Provide things honest in the sight
Of everyone, *both wench and wight*.

The word in politic is passive and
Aggressive in one fell group on the land.
Repay no evil for the evil done
Is still advice worth silver in a tonne.
And yet the way to world's success is set
In hopeful hidden aggressions unmet.
That's why I hug the fringes of the fray
And spend my hours in countryside to play
Among the firs and pines and birches still
Perched on the edges of my outer hill.
Beloved, with what do You repay my fill
Of sorcery in binding my last kill?
No doubt the morning that renews my gold
Is punishment enough for what I've sold.

18 If it is possible, as much
As depends on you and your touch,
Live in peace with all men *in clutch*.
19 Do not avenge, dearly beloved,
But let wrath die before it's gloved.
For it is written: "Vengeance here
Is mine, I will repay the dear,"
Says YHWH. 20 Therefore if your foe lies
In hunger, feed him; if he cries
In thirst, give him a drink, for in
So doing you shall come to win
By heaping coals of fire in din
Upon his head, *and still not sin*.
21 Do not succumb to evil's way,
But conquer evil with good's ray.

I like the vengeance St. Paul in his way
Pours on my head, it's worth what I must
pay
In shouting down the will to lose the fray.
I have no enemy without the rate
Of food and drink beside the well-filled
plate.
I have no enemy without a cloak,
Or at least jeans to cover up his poke.
But there are ways and scenes that I can
take
To burn the scalp of my foes for Your sake.
The bark scoop at the fireside is still filled

With coals and ashes of the elder tilled,
And I may lift it up again to strike
My neighbour with the sort of things I like,
Despite the call of pigeon and of shriek.

Romans 13

1 Let every one be subject to
The higher powers set in their due.
For there's no power but God allowed,
The rulers ordained by God *proud*.
2 Whoever then resists their power
Resists what God set up an hour,
And those who do resist will wake
To find themselves losers in stake.
3 For magistrates are not to fear
For those who do good works in mere,
But for the wicked in their gear.
Will you then not respect their peer?
Do what is good, and you'll have praise
From them *now and all of your days*.
4 For he's the minister of God
To you for your good on the sod.
But if you do the wicked thing,
Then be afraid of ruler's sting.
For he bears not the sword in vain,
But is the hand of God to strain
Avenging wrath on wicked fane.

The usefulness of magistrate to keep
The peace is something I accept in sleep,
Still knowing that predestinations keep
Your judgement here unsullied where I
peep.
The one who bears the sword may have
mandate
From Your eternity to stay up late,
But every act of violence will find
Its recompense upon the ruling blind.
Beloved, the pure church is and always will
Be made up of the humble on the hill,
The swordless and the scattered from the
sill
Who serve You only with the hand and
tongue
Kept innocent as babes and other young
By Your law and Your grace forever sung.

5 That's why you'll be subject, not just
Because of wrath, but also trust
For conscience sake, *as all men must*.
6 For this reason pay taxes too,
For they are God's own servants due,

Attending to their duties' view.
7 Return to all their own, the tax
To whom the tax is due, the axe
To whom it does belong, fear those
Whom you must fear, be on your toes
To honour such as in it rose.

The taxes of the Roman guild are made
Upon the church of God in their parade,
And used to feed more soldiers that have
 stayed
To terrorize the populace unpaid.
There's nothing changed in two millennia
When it comes to the Roman greedy claw.
The budget of the gun dries up the earth
And makes the city sparkle with no worth,
And yet you tell the meek to pay out still
The taxes without complaint of the bill.
Truth is it's suicide to make complaint,
It's decide to sacrifice a saint,
And so men live in poverty as quaint
Today as when Paul wrote to those who
 faint.

8 Be not in debt to any one,
But love each other when you've done,
For he who loves fulfilled the law.
9 For this: You shall not put forth claw
To do adultery, you shall not
Kill anybody in a plot,
You'll not bear false witness, and you
Shall not covet the neighbour crew;
And if there is another rule,
It's comprehended in brief school
To love your neighbour as your due.
10 Love works no ill in neighbour's pew,
That's why love fulfils the law's due.

When St. Paul shows the keeping of the
 law
Is love to neighbour, he takes not in paw
To deny letter of the law is binding.
To keep the letter is love in unwinding.
No one who kills his neighbour does for
 love,
No one who steals his silver in the shove
Is motivated by his charity.
To break the Sabbath must deprive the ass
Of rest, which is not loving at the pass.
Beloved, let me love keeping Your law
 still,
Despite Your grace to break it if I will

According to the sermons spoken late
By preachers rude of habit at Your gate.

11 And so as you perceive the age,
That it's time to wake on the stage
And out of sleep: for now has come
Our salvation nearer in sum
Than on the day we heard the drum.
12 The night is far spent, and the day
Is at hand, so let's cast away
The works of darkness, and let's put
On armour of light *head to foot*.
13 Let us walk honestly, as in
The day; not in riot and sin
Of drunkenness, not in the spin
Of wenching and of wantonness,
Not in strife and envy's address.
14 But put on the Lord Jesus Christ,
And don't provide for the flesh sliced
To carry out its lusts in mess.

The fleshly lusts are those (after the wine
Not mentioned in the ten commandments'
 sign),

That ignore Your commands upon the hill
When Moses told the folk to listen still.
On what basis St. Paul is here to add
A burden to obedience I'm glad
To search out from the text and mind I've
 had.

Both riot and its drunkenness run risk
Of causing awful accidents to disc
Amounting to a murder at the worst
Or at the least a moment to be cursed.
Beloved, I put on Christ indeed, but hope
That putting on of gracious golden rope
Will leave me with the rules I need to cope.

Romans 14

1 The one who's weak in faith receive,
But not to doubtful talk in sleeve.
2 For one believes that he may eat
All things *that the law gives in treat*;
Another who is weak will take
Only the herbs for his health's sake.
3 Let not the eater then despise
The one who refrains from his guise;
And let not him who does not eat
Judge eaters from his judgement seat,
For God's received him *at His feet*.
4 Who are you to judge one who is
Another's servant for his biz?

He stands or fall and by the whiz
 Of his own master and his fizz.
 Indeed, he shall be held up high,
 For God can do so and not lie.
 5 One man considers that one day
 Is over every other's sway;
 Another takes days as they come.
 Let everyone follow the sum
 Of his own mind *or be a bum*.
 6 The one who celebrates the day
 Does so to the Lord if he'll pray;
 And the one who does not do so,
 Is still below the Lord's own show.
 The one who eats, eats to the Lord,
 For he gives God thanks once restored;
 And he who does not eat, he stays
 To fast before the Lord in praise.
 7 For none of us lives to himself,
 And no man dies alone on shelf.

You may have been wise to inspire the lay,
 And St. Paul may have been wise in his
 way
 When he wrote down the things he had to
 say.
 And yet I have to meet the man or wench
 Who takes these word in any sort of stench
 Except to excuse gluttony on bench
 And Sabbath-breaking in his greedy sway.
 The use of text or rather its abuse
 Gives reason to be critically abuse.
 Omniscience should have given You the
 power
 To see how the text would be used one
 hour,
 And that You did not stop St. Paul in hand
 Implies You are too careless in Your stand,
 Unless You meant to give rope to the
 manned.

8 For if we live, we live unto
 The Lord; and if we die, then too
 We die unto the Lord: and so
 Whether we live therefore, or go,
 We are the Lord's, *who is not slow*.
 9 That's why Christ died and rose again
 Revived to be the Lord of men,
 Both dead and living in *their den*.

I've heard a hundred reasons for the death
 Of Christ upon the cross to lose his breath.

Some say to pay for the worlds sin's, some
 say
 To buy the sinner off from his just stay,
 But St. Paul's explanation beats the cake.
 He died because men live and die to make
 You their Creator by their living's sake
 And You their sovereign by their death in
 stake.

Try as I might, I find no reason here,
 Or even rhetoric to beat the gear,
 Unless Christ lived and died so to partake
 Of common lot of men that does appear
 To lie in ambush of all those who fear.
 Love will participate in joy and tear.

10 But why do you come out to judge
 Your brother? Or why do you fudge
 Against your brother? We shall all
 Stand before Christ in judgement hall.
 11 For it is written, "As I live,
 Says YHWH, every knee once shall give
 Obeisance to me, and each tongue
 Shall confess to God *from the lung*."
 12 So every one of us shall give
 Account to God in how to live.
 13 So let us not judge anymore
 Each other, but judge rather store
 Not to put stumblingblocks before
 His brother to make him fall sore.

The call of justice in the single heart,
 Though rare today, still has a playing part.
 The lonely prophet may lift up a voice
 Of judgement on the planet of his choice
 When he sees that the law is soiled and
 spoiled
 Beneath the feet of those who have not
 toiled
 But still take up the profit and the gold.
 There's time for judgement here and now
 I'm told.
 The words of good St. Paul have their
 address
 Before reality, I do confess,
 And in the same breath hold aloft the right
 Of every man to take sides in the fight.
 And so I judge aloud those who oppress
 Me and my peers gone out in woollen
 mess.

14 I know, and am persuaded by
 The Lord Jesus, that there's no cry

Of thing unclean in essence nigh,
 But to the one who thinks it is
 Unclean, to him it is true biz.
 15 But if your brother's grieved the way
 You eat, you haven't keep the ray
 Of charity toward his stay.
 Do not destroy him with your meat
 For whom Christ died *by judgement's seat*.
 16 Do not let anyone reproach
 The good you do by foot or coach.
 17 For the kingdom of God is not
 In meat and drink as for things sought,
 But righteousness and peace and joy
 In the Holy Spirit's employ.
 18 For he who in these things serves Christ
 Is pleasing to God and sufficed
 For men's approval *on the die*.
 19 Let us then follow after things
 That make for peace, and in the springs
 That edify each other's wings.
 20 For meat destroys no work of God.
 All things indeed are pure on sod;
 But it is wicked for a man
 To eat in an offensive span.

I don't suppose St. Paul here means to say
 That eating pork in any sort of way
 Promotes peace on earth from eternal fray.
 Fact is pig farming has some effect on
 The epidemics to which men are drawn,
 And swine flu still attacks the Muslim child
 As well as the Jew in his cap and mild.
 The Christian right to eat just anything,
 Appealing to St. Paul upon the wing,
 Required the lives of some who are still
 true
 To Your law in the things they eat and do.
 But freedom to eat ham is greater than
 Protection of the lives that others can
 Dispense with for their creedal loss of span.

21 It's good neither to eat flesh or
 To drink wine or anything's store
 Whereby your brother stumbles more,
 Or is offended or made weak.
 22 Do you have faith? Then keep it so
 Before God for yourself in show.
 Blessed is the man not to condemn
 Himself in what he keeps in hem.
 23 And he that doubts is damned if he
 Eats, since he does not by decree
 Of faith act, for what's not of faith

Is of sin *or a sinful wraith*.

The faithful rhetoric of St. Paul tells
 Us that if you doubt a thing when it swells
 It is a sin. Subjective in approval
 Of what is sin and not for its removal
 Is likely to result in chaos when
 It's taken as a guideline among men.
 No doubt this word contributes to the loss
 Of unity that Christians with their boss
 Cannot find in the Protestant wing standing
 Beneath the Roman flag, generic handing.
 Beloved, I am a doubter, that is true,
 But I trow it is no sin in Your view,
 Since Thou shalt not doubt is no rule in
 pew.

Romans 15

1 So we who are strong ought to bear
 The weakness of the weak and share
 Not just to please ourselves to dare.
 2 Let each of us take neighbour's part
 For his good to build up his heart.
 3 For even Christ pleased not himself;
 But, as it's written on the shelf,
 "Reproaches of those who reviled
 You fell on me *irreconciled*."
 4 For whatsoever things were writ
 In times past were for learning fit,
 That we through patience and comfort
 Of the scriptures might have hope's *court*.
 5 Now the God of patience and plea
 Of consolation grant you be
 Agreeable to each the other
 According to Christ Jesus, *brother*,
 6 So that you might with one mind and
 One mouth glorify God to stand
 As Father of Lord Jesus Christ.
 7 And so receive each other spliced,
 As Christ also received us to
 God's glory *for the things we do*.

Both Baptist and the Christian sort of man
 Say that no creeds are contained in Your
 plan.
 And yet if we with one mouth come to rant
 A rate of creedal joys from plant to plant,
 Then Baptist and the Christian fail to see
 The truth of St. Paul spouting on his spree.
 I too wish that all men with one mind might
 Rejoice with one mouth at the blessed
 sight,

With the condition that all did agree
With what I think I know, agree with me.
Perhaps You too have one foot in the mire,
And have a secret wish and fine desire
That all agree with You when they come
round
To dance their rings of joy upon the
ground.

8 For I say Jesus Christ would bide
Servant to circumcision's ride
For the truth of God, to confirm
The promises fathers affirm;
9 And that the Gentiles glorify
God for His mercy once come nigh;
As it is written, "For this reason
I shall confess to You in season
Among the Gentiles and so sing
Praises to Your name *on the wing*."
10 He says again, "Gentiles, rejoice,
And with His people *lift up voice*."
11 And once again, "Now praise the Lord,
You Gentiles all; laud Him adored,
All you the people *not abhorred*."
12 And once more good Esaias said
"There shall be a root come outspread
From Jesse, and he who shall rise
To reign over the Gentile skies,
The Gentiles shall trust in his guise.

After such proofs that You, Beloved,
should take
The Gentiles under wing for grace's sake,
I ought to have faith in that prophecy
And stop to laud Your justice and mercy.
I wait to see the Gentiles in accord
Come to the worship of their sovereign
Lord.
Instead I see the idols still stand high
Before the altars under Roman sky,
And hear the din of pagan worship sound
And gyrating make tremble all the ground.
Beloved, I plead the prophecy as Paul
That Gentiles too might come within the
wall,
Since I'm a Gentile of each noble race
That You created all around the place.

13 Now God of hope fill you with joy
And peace in faith, so you'll employ
Hope through the power of Holy Ghost.
14 And I myself make certain boast

Of you, my brothers, that you too
Are full of goodness come in view,
Filled with all knowledge, able too
To give advice each other due.

15 Still brothers, I have written more
Boldly to you in sort and score
To put you in mind of the grace
That's given to me from God's place,
16 That I should be the servant made
Of Jesus Christ to the parade
Of Gentiles, serving gospel stayed
Of God, that the offering displayed
Of the Gentiles might meet the grade,
As set apart by Holy Ghost.
17 So have had something I may boast
Through Jesus the Christ in those here
Which are of God and so kept near.
18 For I will not dare speak of such
Things which Christ has not come to touch
In me, to make the Gentiles heed
The law in every word and deed.
19 Through mighty signs and wonders, by
The power of God's Spirit come nigh;
So from Jerusalem, and round
About Illyricum to sound,
I've fully preached Christ's gospel ground.

I too have preached a bit and here and
there,
No doubt I've preached the Gospel for my
share
Despite the fact I've let the crucifix
Stay on the wall behind my other tricks.
I too can boast a bit, an empty thing,
For having gadded through the world to
sing
The Hebrew Scriptures loud and shrill or
just
A whisper from my lips upon the dust.
Beloved, the servant class that Paul reports
Is now the patron of both prayers and
sports,
And I am at a loss for what to do,
Not fitting in among the sacred crew.
I leave the palaces and ranging courts
And find my faith and solace still in You.

20 Indeed I have striven and preached
The gospel, not where Christ was reached,
Lest I should build upon the breached
Of some other man's work impeached.

21 But it is written, "To whom he
 Was not spoken of, they shall see:
 And those who have not heard shall know."
 22 For which cause also I've been slow
 To come to you, though on the go.
 23 But now having no more place here,
 And having great desire and dear
 To come to you year after year;
 24 Whenever I start out for Spain,
 I'll come to you, for not in vain
 Do I trust to see you as I
 Take journeying, and to come nigh
 On my way to be there by you,
 To take joy in your presence too.

My own excursion off to Spain was not
 A missionary journey in the plot,
 But just two cars of students out to find
 A southern scenery for the Christmas bind.
 Lyon, Marseille, Nice, Perpignan until
 The Spanish border guards stepped on the
 sill.

So many years have passed and memory
 dims,
 But like a gem still shines and sounds like
 hymns

The image of Gaudi's church standing tall
 Among the bare steel scaffolds at the wall,
 Unfinished then, unfinished now, as must
 Be any work of art above the dust.
 Beloved, let my prayers too rise up to You,
 Unfinished like good Gaudi's in the dew.

25 Now I go to Jerusalem
 To serve the saints *with gathered gem*.

26 For it has please them who live in
 Macedonia and the din
 Of Achaia to make a sum
 Up for poor saints until they come
 Up to Jerusalem *to win*.

27 It has pleased them indeed, and they
 Are debtors to them to this day.
 For if the Gentiles have been made
 Partakers of spirit waylaid,
 Their duty is also repaid
 To serve them carnal things when stayed.
 28 When therefore I have performed this,
 And have sealed to them this fruit's kiss,
 I will come by you into Spain.

Like Paul, I turned my pilgrims way to go
 Into Jerusalem and to bestow

The honour of my prayers beneath the
 dome
 Of temple that aspires still there as home.
 Like Paul, I ran aground of rulers too,
 And found the gun pointed at heart and
 shoe
 Prevented my from entering at the gate
 That leads into the temple mount of late.
 I may be one of many too cheap to
 Shell out the entrance fee too great to chew.
 Instead I wanted to go in and pray
 Beside my brother Muslims in their way.
 Reciting the Qur'an may have convinced
 The guards to let me in, although they
 winced.

29 And I am sure that, when I come
 To you, I shall come in the rum
 Fullness of blessing that's sufficed
 Indeed of the gospel of Christ.

30 Now I beg you, brothers, and for
 The Lord Jesus Christ's sake in store,
 And for the love the Spirit shed,
 To join me in my prayers as led
 To God for me, for me instead,

31 That I may be saved from the lot
 Of faithless in Judaeian plot;
 And that my service which I've done
 Jerusalem may then be won
 To the saints; 32 So I'll come to you
 With joy by God's will kept in view,
 And be refreshed and rest with you.
 33 And so the God of peace again
 Remain with all of you. Amen.

St. Paul is like a preacher I have known
 Who ended sermons on a leaving tone
 Full twenty minutes before he had done.
 Parishioners sat stony-faced and prayed
 That he would finish what he had waylaid.
 But he went blithely on in hum and drone
 While some dozed and some merely sat and
 stayed.

At this point good St. Paul might call a
 stop,

But if he had, we'd never have known drop
 To follow, namely that Phoebe was called
 To be a deacon of a place appalled
 That women were ordained of God and
 men

To do a thing for holiness again.
 The battle still continues though ribald.

Romans 16

1 I recommend to you Phoebe
Our sister, who has come to be
The deacon of the group called out
At Cenchrea: 2 Keep her about
In the Lord, as becomes such saints,
And so assist her in her plaints
Wherever she has need of you:
For she has been a help in view
Of many and of myself too.
3 Greet Priscilla, Aquila too,
My helpers in Christ Jesus' pew,
4 Who have for my life laid down their
Own necks, to whom I truly bear
Thanks, but also to all the ones
Of the called out of Gentile runs.
5 Likewise *greet* the called out that be
In their house. Greet my loved friendly
Epaenetus, who's the firstfruit
Of Achaia to Christ *in root*.
6 Greet Mary, who gave us so much.
7 Greet Andronicus and as such
Junia, my kinsmen, and my mates
In prisonhouse and its estates,
Who are of note among those sent
Before me and in Christ too bent.
8 Greet Amplias who is my dear
In the Lord. 9 Greet Urbane sincere,
Our helper in Christ *without fear*,
And Stachys my beloved *with tear*.
10 Greet Apelles approved in Christ.
Salute them which are there sufficed
Of Aristobulus' *house spliced*.
11 Salute Herodion my kin.
Greet those who are of house and bin
Of Narcissus, those in the Lord.
12 Salute Tryphena and adored
Tryphosa, who work in the Lord.
Greet the beloved Persis, which stayed
To work much in the Lord *and prayed*.
13 Greet Rufus chosen in the Lord,
And his mother and mine *implored*.
14 Salute Asyncritus, Phlegon,
Hermas, Patrobas, Hermes drawn,
And the brothers with them *restored*.
15 Greet Philologus, and Julia,
Nereus, and his sister's *paw*,
Olympas, and all the saints there.
16 Salute each other with a fair
And holy kiss. The groups of those
Called out in Christ greet you in rows.

The salutation of the holy kiss
Was something held in Zion not to miss,
When Ephrata was active in its bliss.
Today the Baptists join the Protestants
In keeping only two things in their rants:
Baptism and the supper without dance.
In fact the washing of feet should be taken
Along with blessing infants, and unshaken
Agape meal, anointing of the sick, in all to
count

The seven holy acts in their amount.
I'm just a Dunkard preacher, pay no mind
To me, though I'm nor dined, bedded, nor
wined.

I wait with hat in hand beside the door
To see if anyone steps on the floor.

17 Now I beg you, brothers, mark them
Who cause divisions against hem
Of doctrine that you've learned about;
And avoid those *who come to doubt*.

How can a man avoid divisions now?
There's not a faith but separates somehow.
The Romans separated from the east,
The Protestants departed from the beast.
The Baptists never did but cleave away,
With four opinions for each three in sway.
The Adventists divided just as soon
As Ellen White lay down with silver spoon,
And argued for the right to rise and kill
Or at the least break Sabbath to their fill
If Kaiser or if Führer called the bill.
Beloved, if not the later thing then see
Samaritan divided from degree
Of Judaism kept on faithfully.

18 Because they're such as do not serve
Our Lord Jesus the Christ, but swerve
To serve their own belly *and curve*,
By good words and fair speeches make
Lies to the simple in heart's sake.
19 For your obedience has come
Abroad to all. I'm glad in sum
On your behalf: but still I would
Have you wise to that which is good,
And simple of what wicked could.
20 The God of peace shall shortly bruise
Satan under your feet in dues.
Our Lord Jesus Christ's grace again
Remain with all of you. Amen.

Paul should have quit again when he had
chance

To storm the souls of Romans with a dance.
His last word here supports obedience,
Which most who follow him think
something dense.

I'm glad he kept on preaching though,
because

Beside his praising of eternal laws,
He promises that You will shortly take
Revenge on Satan for Your servants' sake.
Beloved, Your law and vengeance is at last
My joy as I see my life going past.
How many trample it and never know,
Ignoring that my presence made a show.
Let me, Beloved, trample down no man
here,

And if I do, Beloved, I shed a tear.

21 Timotheus worker and mate,

And Lucius, Jason in state,
And Sosipater, who's my kin,
Salute you *all as they begin*.

22 I Tertius, who wrote this note,
Salute you in the Lord *by rote*.

23 Gaius my host, and that of all
The group of called out ones in thrall,
Greets you. Erastus who by call
Is city chamberlain greets you,
And Quartus a brother *in pew*.

24 Our Lord Jesus Christ's grace again
Remain with all of you. Amen.

25 Now unto Him who is of power
To set you firm by gospel's hour,
And by the preaching of the word
Of Jesus Christ, which has been heard

In mystery revealed but kept
In secret since the world was swept,
26 But now is made both manifest,
And by the prophets' scriptures blessed,
According to commandment of
The everlasting God above,
Made known to all nations and for
Obedience of faith in store:

27 To only wise God, glory's den
Through Jesus Christ ever. Amen.

I love, Beloved, Your servant Paul at last,
After the wordy ways have gone and
passed,

He makes an affirmation that will cast

A judgement on all Christian sort of men.
He speaks of You, Beloved, and speaks
again

Of You as only wise God in this den
Of thieves and idols standing in the blast.
The declaration of Your unity
Is the first of commandments in decree
Of Sinai and the law writ on the heart.
So bless St. Paul for unitarian part.
The ride to Rome is paved with lies in
store,

With idols, trinities, and gods galore,
But in the end there's just One to adore.

The First Epistle of Paul to the Corinthians

Paul was the first to preach the Gospel
where

Corinth beside the sea laid her sins bare.
Aquila and Priscilla came to share
His love and faith upon the silver stair.
The second journey found the city bright
To cover sinfulness from all men's sight,
The most debauched of all cities in right,
No wonder those who sought Your faithful
son

In that town did the evil things they've
done.

The trend of wicked men around the house
Leaves spots upon the character of spouse
And all within. Beloved, I turn with plea
That I too live in Corinthian glee,
And must find refuge in this Pauline fun.

1 Corinthians 1

1 Paul, called *to be* a messenger
Of Jesus Christ through God's will's stir,
And Sosthenes *our* brother too,
2 To the group of called out ones *true*
Of God which is at Corinth's *town*,
To those of sanctified renown
In Christ Jesus, *who are* called saints,
With everyone *without restraints*
Everywhere who call on the name
Of Jesus Christ our Lord *of fame*,
Both theirs and ours: 3 Grace be to you
And peace from God our Father too
And the Lord Jesus Christ *who's true*.

Now Paul I know, and Jesus Christ I know,

But Sosthenes is unknown in my show,
Unless he's one mentioned in Acts
eighteen.

I'm glad he sends me greetings kind and
keen.

If he's a brother and a saint I guess
He also must call on the name's address
Of Jesus Christ our Lord. I too do so
In this age of faith's darkened afterglow
That jangles in the din of saintless tone.
My hymn's to call his name as I've been
shown.

It's that according to Sosthenes and
Paul that makes saints on Corinth's sunny
strand.

Beloved, I accept grace and peace from
You

And from the Lord Jesus Christ in Your
crew.

4 I thank my God always for you,
For the grace of God given you
By Christ Jesus, 5 you were enriched
In everything by him *unhitched*
In everything you say and know,
6 Even as Christ affirmed was sure
In you, 7 so that you lacked no gift,
Awaiting eagerly the *drift*
Of the appearing of our Lord
Jesus Christ, 8 who will *without sword*
Also confirm you to the end,
That you may be blameless a friend
In our Lord Jesus Christ's *last day*.
9 God's faithful, by whom *in the way*
You were called into fellowship
Of His Son, Jesus Christ our skip.

Beloved, Paul thanks for those he's writing
to,

Folk invisible, no longer in view.
As I look at the multitude of trees
From my window seat where one rarely
sees

A passer-by, and then I'm often hidden,
I also thank for unseen humans bidden.
Divinity found in Your Christ glows yet
In the face and form human where You set
Your word and grace in every hearer of
Paul's preaching and my comments on his
love.

You're faithful and call into fellowship
With the Skipper Jesus, his hand on hip,

And so the hermitage becomes a church,
Though only peopled by the fir and birch.

Who lack no gift no doubt await the time
When Your Son Jesus might appear in
rhyme

Or in the loving heart, or in the cloud
To be seen by the belligerent crowd.
But some of us have little gift to show,
We only on the sidelines cheer the row
Of football players rushing at the foe.
May Your Christ to ungifted also come
To affirm grace at least to tidy sum.
I see myself without wealth, without fame
And without anything to make a claim.
And yet, Beloved, Your word burns in my
heart

That I too might have with Your Son a part
At his appearing at the end or start.

10 Now I plead with you, brothers, by
The name of our Lord Jesus Christ,
That you all speak the same (*or try*),
And there be no divisions *spliced*
Among you, but *that* you be joined
Perfectly together and coined
In the same mind and in the same
Judgement. 11 For it is set in claim
To me concerning you, my brothers,
By those of Chloe's *household and others*,
That you are full of arguments.
12 Now I say this, each one *with sense*
Says "I am of Paul," or "I'm of
Apollos," or "For Cephas' love,"
Or "I am of Christ." 13 Is Christ rent?
Was Paul crucified for you *sent*?
Or were you baptised in the name
Of Paul *so you could bear his fame*?

I doubt, Beloved, Paul meant that all should
think

And be alike in choice of food and drink.
If that were so, then Pepsi'd be on brink
Of destitution or then otherwise
The only thing to taste in all men's eyes.
No, Paul was talking of sects' evil power
To divide Your image in humans sour.
Paul and Apollos, Cephas and Your Christ
Were all men agreed on the gospel priced.
I've lived to learn opinions stated fast
Will get a man more enemies at last.

Teach me, Beloved, to know what's true
and then
What's needed to state to suspicious men.
The label divides, but faith's anchor's cast.

I wonder how poor Chloe felt to find
That Paul revealed her tattling out her mind
To Paul as soon as any back was turned.
She may have written an epistle burned
And did not think her neighbours might
have learned

That she was who let kitten out of pouch.
I'd think after this she'd take careful vouch
Of what she told to whom. I'd think she
would.

But that's not how folk function, though
they should.

She probably lived on to bear a tale
Or two to the enjoyment of the ale.
Beloved, bridle my tongue before the
church,

Before the neighbour, let me not besmirch
The guilty or the guiltless from my perch.

14 I thank God that I baptised none
Of you except Crispus and one
Gaius, 15 lest anyone should say
I'd baptised in my name *and way*.
16 I also baptised the household
Of Stephanas. Besides all told,
I don't know whom I baptised cold.

I too have baptised some, like Paul a few,
And like him I still hope that they are true
To You, Beloved, and not to any name
That may be cause upon them to their
shame

Or any man or angel's lasting fame.
The holy Qur'an says that You indeed
Are the best of baptisers in Your creed.
Baptise me, my Beloved, today again
In secret or before the eyes of men,
Not of the water only, but the power
Of purifying spirit in an hour.
Who is not pure within by Your fell grace
No matter how he washes dirty face
Will come before You at last in disgrace.

17 For Christ did not send me to put
People under water a foot,
But to preach the gospel, and not
With wisdom of words, lest the plot

Of Christ's cross lose *at once* what's
sought.

18 The message of the cross is just
Foolishness to perishing dust,
But to us who are being saved
It is God's power *and what we craved*.

Paul talks about the cross though he was
not

There to see if the deed was really wrought.
But that is not the question that I sought.

I don't care what happened so long ago,
But what happens now in this fatal show.
Who think to crucify a man that's caught
Somewhere in Middle East will cure what
ails

The world and humankind, will live to
learn

That killing people does not solve concern.
It's God's power in the stories and
commands

That brings the gospel peace to human
lands

And hearts and makes men's action turn to
good.

Beloved, teach me to see things as I should
And not preach or whistle here in the wood.

19 For it is written, "I'll destroy
The wisdom that the wise *employ*,
And bring to nothing what the bright
Have in their understanding's sight."

20 Where is the wise? Where is the scribe?
Where's this age's disputer *bribe*?
Has not God made craft of this world
A foolish thing *when it's unfurled*?

21 For since, in God's wisdom, the world
Through wisdom did not know God, it
Pleased God through foolishness, *though*
fit,

Of preaching to save those who sit
In faith. 22 For Jews request a sign,
And Greeks seek after wisdom's *wine*,
23 But we preach Christ was crucified,
To Jews a stumbling block to hide
And to the Greeks a foolishness,
24 But to those who are called *address*,
Both Jews and Greeks, Christ is the power
Of God and God's wisdom *this hour*.

Indeed, that's just what I was saying here.
Focusing on a cross that did appear

Two thousand years ago is just nonsense.
But Christ's power to save from sin in the
tents

Of wickedness is what I want to grab.
His spirit fills the law's commands once
drab

With power and life to live the victory.
And so I flee for peace to You who stand
Above the universe to give command,
To give the loving spirit and the will
To crucify the ego and stand still.
Who daily died gave us Your dying word
That comes again to bring life to the stirred.
Beloved, let me live to live and not kill.

25 Because the foolishness of God
Is wiser than men *on the sod*,
And the weakness of God is yet
Stronger than what men *want to bet*.
26 Brothers, you see your calling, that
Not many wise by standard at
Public opinion, and few great
And noble *are called to the gate*.

Paul braves the wealthy and takes refuge in
The poor and lowly, humble without sin.
He did not know that times were changing
and
That soon the rabble crowd in every land
Would be disposed to faith in what was
said

By high and mighty on the tv spread.
The wealthy are as frequent now as then
To scratch the world for profit from all
men,

But now the poor, unlike the Russian serf,
Is likely to protect the wealthy turf,
And lift a cry for freedom and for power
Despite the biting of the scorpion hour.
The lowly and the weak are gullible
Now that the world of knowledge has come
full.

27 But God has chosen foolish things
Of the world to put to shame wings
Of the wise, and God's chosen weak
Things of the world to put to shame
The things which are mighty *for fame*,
28 And the base things of the world and
The things despised *in every land*
God has chosen, and the things which
Are not, to bring into the ditch

The things that are, 29 that no flesh should
Glory in His presence *or could*.

30 But of Him you're in Jesus Christ,
Who became for us wisdom *sliced*
From God, and righteousness and yet
Sanctification until set
Redemption 31 that, as it is writ
"He who glories, let him be fit
To glory in YHWH's *benefit*."

I don't know where Paul gets it that the
weak

In the world show how kings who're at
their peak

Fail in their work and love in what they
seek.

It seems to me the Church has wedded
throne

And both fulfil one power and chew one
bone.

It may be in Corinth those called apart
To praise Your name were poor and weak
to start,

But life's a game that changes with the
round

Of seasons and brings new crops to the
ground.

There's flesh a-plenty now that glories and
That claims both You and Paul from where
they stand.

Give me the hopeless poverty that fired
Paul to speak to the soon game and retired.
Then I shall be, Beloved, at last unmired.

1 Corinthians 2

1 And I, brothers, when I arrived
At your place, not with speech contrived
In wisdom did I speak to you
The testimony of God *true*.

2 For I firmly decided that
I'd not show any where you sat
But Jesus Christ the crucified.

3 And I was in weakness and in
Fear and in much trembling *for sin*
With you. 4 And my speech and my
preaching

Was not with fair words of man's teaching,
But showing of the spirit and

The power of spirit *in my hand*,

5 That your faith should not stand on sod
Of men's wisdom, but power of God.

Paul knew both Greek mythology and word
 Of the Rabbinic verdicts when he stirred
 A student at Gamaliel's bare feet.
 No other human wisdom was his treat.
 He looked to the events of cross and rood
 As power of God most manifest and crude,
 And thus he brought not words but power
 of God
 To set folks apart from peas in the pod.
 Beloved, I also come to You alone
 And turn my back on royal church and
 throne,
 The verdict of the Rabbi and the dream
 Of Greek mythology, chocolate and cream.
 Let my faith turn to You and let my doubt
 Shut every priest and priestcraft's wailings
 out.

6 And yet we speak a wisdom sought
 Among the perfect ones *and taught*,
 But not the wisdom of this world,
 Nor of the princes *it uncurled*,
 Both of which only come to nought.
 7 But we speak of God's wisdom in
 A secret, the hidden within
 God's ordaining before the world
 Unto our glory *once unfurled*
 8 Which none of this world's rulers knew,
 For if they had had but a view,
 They would not have nailed to the cross
 The Lord of glory *to their loss*.

The secret hidden from the depths of time
 Within Your bosom is a word sublime
 That You in giving life and love to men
 Gave of Yourself to live in each again.
 To kill another human being who
 Is aware of being I is to do
 Of all sins greatest, for it must erase
 Your image shining on the human face.
 Beloved each man has choice in this dark
 vale
 Either to crucify You at the pale
 Or crucify the ego that would rise
 Against the other in blindness of eyes.
 All men who do not see You in the other
 Slay Lords of glory, every son of mother.

9 But as it's written, "Eye has not
 Seen, nor ear heard, neither have got
 Into the heart of man, the things
 That God's prepared for those heart-strings

That love Him *in their earthly plot*."

Indeed, Beloved, Your art's beyond my
 ken,
 And even what I see, I look again
 And find my heart knows not the half, no
 not
 Beginning of the glories You have
 wrought.

So how can I whose blindness cannot show
 The here and now, begin to find the glow
 Of things yet unheard and unspoken that
 Shall come on the horizon's habitat?
 Beloved, though in You I move, have my
 being,
 All that You are and do's beyond my
 seeing

But in the barest hint of power and line.
 Your colours reach beyond my spectrum's
 wine.
 Yet what You have prepared by me I take
 And from its greatness my own smallness
 make.

10 But to us God's revealed *as much*
 By His spirit, for spirit's such
 To search all things, even the deep
 Thing of Alohim *and the steep*.

Though my senses and wisdom cannot find
 The limits of Your arches and Your mind,
 You live to bend to earth and in that
 bending

Reveal the glories of heavens unending.
 Your breezes blow upon the putrid still
 Of my depths and with perfumes my airs
 fill,

And send the wavelets of my turtle pond
 To move caressing the shore's fern and
 frond.

The truth of ocean's depths, its currents
 sealed,

Is in my way to born tadpole revealed.
 Beloved, the microcosmos of my cramped
 And humbled soul is sprinkled and come
 damped

With the winds of Yourself that You
 bestow

Upon the darkened depths found here
 below.

11 For who knows human things but what

Human spirit that's in him caught?
So divine things no man can know,
But *only* God's spirit *can* show.

Since my life teaches me that I don't know
Even myself in all the pageant show
Of living creatures on the vernal sand,
How can such a one ever understand
The divine things beyond the cloud and
skin?

My ignorance is surely not a sin.
But that's not what You said through Paul's
insight.

You said only a man can know men right.
I see myself go wrong in knowing me,
And every other go wrong in the spree
Of vain attempting some psychology.
Don't You agree, Beloved, the Feudian
scope

Is a one-sided way of seeing hope?
Sight, might, and right's a fatal trinity.

12 Now we've received, not the world's
mind,

But the spirit which is the kind
Of God, so we might know the things
That God has freely given us *wings*.

13 Which things too we speak, not in words
Which human wisdom makes like curds,
But which the holy spirit shows
Comparing spirit's things with those.

14 But natural man does not receive
The things of God's spirit *to grieve*,
For they are foolishness to him,
And neither can he know *them dim*,
Because they are by spirit seen.

15 But one who's spiritual can judge
All things, yet he himself won't budge
Before any man *worth his fudge*.

16 For "who knows YHWH's mind so he
might

Instruct Him?" But we do delight
In the mind of Christ *for the right*.

It's small comfort to flee to mind of Christ
Since human mind can never be sufficed
For viewing Your mind in its entity.
Though Christ may well reveal Your mind
freely,

The fatal flaw is that the spirit's free
To budge and wail with winds of every
kind

Of thought that makes humanity one blind.
If Christ is Christ, then he's embodiment
Of the divine word that was one time sent
To Adam, Noah, Abraham and cast
On Sinai for a covenant to last.

I too delight in what Christ must have
heard

From his own mother's lips when
undeterred

She sang the Torah notes sweet like a bird.

1 Corinthians 3

1 And I, brothers, could not speak to
You as to the spiritual few,
But as to carnal, as to babes

In Christ *and without astrolabes*.

2 I have fed you with milk, and not
With meat, since till now you were not
Able, nor are you even yet.

3 For you are carnal, since where set
Envy, strife, and divisions met,
Are you not carnal, walk as men?

4 For while one says and says again
"I am of Paul" another's word
"I'm of Apollos" undeterred,
Are you not carnal and absurd?

Carnal, Beloved, has to do with bare meat,
As chile con carne's a thing we eat.

So why then are the folk yet on their milk
Who do not eat meat or such other ilk
Called carnal by Paul, while the meaty diet
Is recommended by him without riot?

Forgive my jokes, Beloved, I understand
The carnal here means envy, strife and
band

Of divisions across the faithful land.
I guess I'm carnal more than most since I
Do not fit in a single sect to vie,
But here alone stand before spirit's wind
To listen to the message if I've sinned.
I lift a prayer toward the empty sky.

5 Who then is Paul, Apollos who,
But ministers and by whom you
Believed clear-cut even as true
The Lord has given to every man?

6 I've planted, Apollos with can
Has watered, but God gave increase.

7 So then neither has he a fleece
Who planted anything, nor he
That watered, but God gave freely.

8 Now he that plants and he that waters
Are one, and all *both sons and daughters*
Shall receive of his own reward
According to his labour *scored*.

9 For we're workers working with God,
And you are God's pasture and sod,
God's building *beneath measure-rod*.

10 According to the grace of God
Which is given to me to plod
As a wise master builder, I
Have laid the firm foundation by,
And some other builds on the place.
But let each one take heed in race
How he builds there, *not to disgrace*.

Paul's one who plants in faith a firm
foundation,
Apollos waters the stones for sensation,
But You, Beloved, are Master of the site,
Yours is the building and the bud in light.
Mine is to scratch graffiti on the wall
That You built up through Apollos and
Paul.

I do not plant, water, increase or reap,
I only come to joke and laugh a heap,
And with the humbled stop perhaps to
weep.

Though I add nothing to the edifice
Of faith, I pray my building's not amiss.
Beloved, I do take heed to how I lay
A stanza and a verse in sinners' way.
I do not come to You, Beloved, for pay.

11 For other foundation can none
Lay than what is laid under sun,
Which is Jesus Christ *when all's done*.

12 Now if any man build upon
This foundation in gold at dawn,
Or silver, precious stones or wood,
Or hay or stubble as he could,

13 Every man's work shall be made plain
For the day shall declare the gain,
Because it shall be seen by fire,
And fire shall try each man's desire
Of work to see or to admire.

14 If any man's work here abide
Which he has built and put inside,
He'll have reward *once he is tried*.

15 If any man's work shall be burned,
He'll suffer loss for what he earned,
But he himself shall just be saved,
Yet so as by fire *that he braved*.

Beloved, be kind to those of us who bring
The stubble to Your temple while they sing
Who can, be kind to silent ones whose
voice

Is not of the most lovely or the choice.

Some are gold and some are silver in
worth,

And some are precious stones dug from the
earth,

And some are fine wood, though
combustible,

And some are merely stubble under wool.

Beloved, remember the Egyptian cross
That took the stubble for the people's loss.

Sometimes the stubble is commodity

More valued than the gold for symmetry.

Since straw burns by the fire of trial set,
Beloved, reward my empty hand and debt.

16 Do you not know that you are set
As temple of God, where is met
God's spirit living in you yet?

17 If anyone defiles *the place*
Of God's temple, before His face
God shall destroy him *from the race*,
For God's temple's a holy place,
Which temple you are, *don't forget*.

The temple Paul speaks of is not one built
Within the human heart of breath and silt.
It is the temple of those joined to be
Your worshippers in body faithfully.
Your spirit is not said to be within
The human heart for righteousness or sin,
But among those gathered once in Your
name

To render You Your own without a claim.
Beloved, I do believe Your spirit rests
Within the burning love of human breasts.
But Paul does not say that here as he writes
To foster individual delights.
The you is plural and the "in" in Greek
Well means "among". Your spirit thus I
seek.

18 Let no man here deceive himself.

If anyone there on your shelf

Seems to be wise in this world's *claim*,

Let him become a fool *for fame*,

That he may be wise *in the game*.

19 For this world's wisdom's foolishness

With God. For it's written to bless,
"He takes the wise in their own coils."
20 And once again, "The Lord knows *toils*
Of thought among the wise that they
Are vain *and empty in their way*.

St. Paul's a victim too of his illusion,
For all wisdom that seems is but delusion.
Who studies anything knows well enough
The more one learns the more the going's
tough,
And what one knows is just a drop upon
The ocean of unknowing in the dawn.
But he's right that the self-deceived will
rise

To claim before the world that they are
wise.
There are fools who do not know they are
fools,
Who differ from the wise beside the pools
Of ignorance in that the wise alone
Know that their knowledge is a broken
bone.
Beloved, bless me and Paul and everyone
Who knows he is a fool beneath the sun.

21 Therefore let no one take pride in
The human *way to work in sin*.
For all things are your own in bin.
22 Whether Paul or Apollo win,
Or Cephas, or the world, or life,
Or death or things present *in strife*,
Or things to come, all these are yours.
23 And you belong to Christ whose stores
Are God's, the God whom Christ *adores*.

The four-tiered ownership of things is new
To perceptions decked out upon the few.
You are the One who owns Your Christ,
and he
Owns all the people in Your armoury.
And we to whom Paul writes own
everything
From life to death, the world and the
striving
Of Paul and Cephas and Apollo set
For planting and cultivating us yet.
Beloved, hegemony's a thing profound
For likes of me upon terrestrial ground,
And so I leave angelic choirs to You
And pray the spires resound upon their cue,

While I own naught at all, but am all
owned
By You, Beloved, well-tuned and as well
toned.

1 Corinthians 4

1 May people think of us as servants
Of Christ, and stewards in observance
Of God's secrets. 2 Yet it's required
That one be faithful *once inspired*.
3 But with me it's a tiny thing
That I should be judged by your sting,
Or by human judgement at all,
Indeed, I save myself the call.

Paul claims he does not judge even himself.
Now that's impossible for any man or elf.
All men judge others, not to speak of those
Who find themselves dressed up in
women's clothes.
All judge both consciously and without
knowing,
And that's not always in fact a bad
showing.
If You, Beloved, judge humankind just by
The ten small words You once said on
Sinai,
Then You judge less than anyone I know.
Most liberal of churches on the go
Put more pressure than that on every
member,
And do so from New Year's Day to
December.
Judge not, not to be judged was Jesus'
word,
Thing far harder than what's on Sinai
heard.

4 For I know nothing by myself,
But that does not put me on shelf
Of the exonerated, but
He that judges me *in the gut*
Is the Lord. 5 So don't judge a thing
Before the time of questioning,
Until the Lord come who will bring
To light the dark secrets in praise
Of God. 6 And these things, brothers, raise
I in a figure transferred to
Myself and Apollos in due
For your sakes, that you might learn well
In us not to think over spell
Of what is written, that no one

Of you be proudful when you're done.

Beloved, I know of no church or its crew
Or even individual in stew
That does not go beyond the written word
Found in the Decalogue by beast and bird.
The human heart apparently cannot
Be satisfied with that wisdom You've
wrought.

A poker club has more rules to be broken
Than those ten You gave once and for
love's token.

I flee the proudful, my Beloved, and stay
Within the limits of Your statutes' way,
And touch the stony earth with head to pray
That You might guard me from going
astray.

The proud find reason for dogma to speak,
But let me contemplate Your word and
seek.

7 Who is it makes your difference?
And what have you got, pounds and pence,
That you did not receive? Now if
You did receive, that why stand stiff
In pride, as if you were the source?
8 Now you have plenty and of course
Are rich, you've reigned like kings without
Us, and I wish to God your clout
As kings were true that we also
Might reign ourselves *and in your glow*.

Is the question that St. Paul asks quite fair?
Indeed, if one must answer anywhere,
The fact is that created ones have got
Everything they have from the source and
pot.

Does the fact that I am created mean
That I must be humble before the stream
Of all creation else? Beloved, I doubt,
I doubt the word of Paul with all his clout.
And yet, Beloved, I recognize the name,
Admitting that those people to their shame
Split up infinitives and without cause.
They deserved scolding from St. Paul in
claws.

Preserve me, my Beloved from every sect,
From myself, from my foe, and the elect.

For I reckon God has set up
Us as apostles last in cup,
As it were appointed to death,

For we are made *at every breath*
A spectacle before the world
And angels, before men *uncurled*.
10 We're fools for Christ's sake, but you
are
Wise in Christ *like a shining star*,
We're weak, but you are strong, you are
Honoured, but we're despised *afar*.

Does St. Paul feel despised that he is left
To the apostleship, friendless, bereft?
Then let him try the status of the poet
Who interprets his word and what's below
it.

He'd then see to be apostle among
Corinthians is better than unsung
Rhymer stranded upon a foreign shore.
Then he would stop his whining evermore.
Beloved, let me not whine like blessed St.
Paul.

I live and breathe in the best horse's stall,
And take my pleasure in the rain and sun
That streams upon my coat of white and
dun,
And wonder what wind broke the alder
down
That was between my window and the
town.

11 Even to this very day we
Are hungry, thirsty, naked be,
And buffeted and have no place
We know of where we can take space.
12 We earn our bread by our own hands,
Reviled we bless, driven from lands
We're patient with it. 13 When defamed
We appeal to the one who blamed,
We're made as this world's refuse and
The rubbish of all things in hand.
14 I don't write this to shame your band,
But as loved children warn to stand.
For though you have ten thousand who
Teach you in Christ, fathers are few,
For in Christ Jesus I have spawned
You through the gospel *when it dawned*.
16 That's why I beg you, follow me.

My bread's been barely earned by my own
hands,
And if my wife had not stepped in the
bands
And made a buck or two, I'd have been lost

Among the poor majority and tossed.
 Few men admit their fate, but it is true
 The world has always been dependent too
 On what the women did in toil and sale
 Besides the running of the house and flail
 Of children on the run and on the come.
 St. Paul's a man, so what does he know of
 The labour for a pittance and for love?
 Beloved, though I may seem to disdain
 Your
 Apostles by my plaint on every score,
 I still think his words worth a mountain
 more.

17 So that is why I've sent to You
 Timothy who is my son true
 Beloved and faithful in the Lord,
 Who'll bring you in remembrance' *ward*
 Of my ways, ways which are in Christ
 And everywhere I've taught *sufficed*
 To every group of called out ones.
 18 Now some are proudful in their buns
 As though I'd not appear to you.
 19 But I'll come soon into your view,
 In sha Allah, and will know then
 Not the speech that's prideful of men,
 But the power *and authority*.
 20 For God's kingdom's not in the fee
 Of word but in authority.
 21 What do you want? Shall I come to
 You with a stick or in love *true*,
 And in spirit of meekness *due*?

The coming of Apostle Paul most sounds
 Like threat with a big stick upon his
 rounds.
 He sends in Timothy who will prepare
 The way for what he claims that he will
 dare.
 I like a man like Paul, one who knows well
 What's in the cast before he shows the
 spell.

I like a man like Timothy because
 He knows two sides of life and both their
 laws.
 Two heads are better than one like two legs
 Are better than one or for hopping pegs.
 Beloved, do you send to my heart a man
 With a big stick or with love in the can?
 In a meek spirit few go out today.
 The preachers I've heard tend to flail and
 flay.

I know what Paul is talking of when he
 Speaks of the prideful in their prideful glee.
 I've caught a few of those who're sure to
 be
 Full of knowledge profound and repartee.
 I've learned to deal with pride in self and
 other
 By reference to the ten commandments,
 mother
 Of wisdom that You've sprinkled on men's
 hearts
 At least since Sinai shoots out fiery darts.
 Beloved, I have nothing to support pride
 But that word of Yours on which I've
 relied.
 The hand and tongue without that surely
 find
 Enough to say and do, although they're
 blind.
 Pride falls before my eyes' evaluation
 As I see all planted by Sinai's station.

See now, Beloved, the word that Paul
 writes here,
 Ecclesia, or church, it would appear,
 And yet the Grecian word means nothing
 like
 A group of people gathered for the strike,
 Or even less a building shaped in steeple.
 The word's no institution, not of people
 Or stone or light, or music or of preaching,
 Not of dogma, not even of right teaching.
 The word means nothing more than called
 out ones,
 Called out I guess of synagogue and sun's
 Temple to follow Your will alone and
 Know the grace of Your Christ, and live to
 stand.
 Call me out, my Beloved, and let me be
 Yours alone and from all other bands free.

1 Corinthians 5

1 It's commonly said you maintain
 Immorality in domain,
 And such as is not even named
 Among the Gentiles to be blamed,
 That one should have his father's wife.
 2 And you are proud and without strife
 With him that his deed might be shunned
 Away from you *among the stunned*.
 3 For truly I absent in flesh

But present in spirit and fresh
Have judged already as though I
Were right there with you for this guy
Who's done such a deed *on the sly*.

It seems, Beloved, that Paul's also appalled
At what a man did for lust and enthralled.
It's always so, and everyone looks scant
At those whose lusts are different from the
rant

Of the majority. In fact I plead
That all men are as guilty in the seed.
Who is there that does not act from his lust
In doing even what those think he must
Who bear the burden of society?
Beloved, let me act rather by the trust
That You assigned on Sinai's colloquy,
And leave both scandalized remarks unsaid
As well as following lust to the bed.
Let each one have his legal partner free.

4 In name of our lord Jesus Christ,
When you come together enticed,
And my spirit, authority
Of our lord Jesus Christ *in fee*,

5 To hand over such a one to
Satan for slaying of flesh due,
That the spirit may be saved in
The day lord Jesus comes to win.

I'm not sure how the spirit can survive
Once taken into Satan's great beehive,
And after once the flesh is torn apart
And all the bones are bleached by devilish
art.

But I trust it is so. So I shall take
Repentance for the best way to the steak.
Today the Baptist church is not about
The sense of sin and sorrow for the rout,
But more to realize that You love us
With unconditional love's blunderbuss.
I guess Corinth was modern Baptist crew
In accepting the fornicating few.

6 Your boasting's not good, don't you
know

A little yeast makes the whole glow?

7 So put out the old yeast so you
May be a dough batch of the new,
As being without yeast *to do*.
For even our passover Christ
For us *one time* is sacrificed.

8 So now let us keep up the feast
Not with the old and spoiled yeast,
The yeast of malice, wickedness,
But with yeastless bread's truthfulness.

Some think these words refer to Jesus
dying
On the cross with the weight of sins a-lying
On forehead and on heart and reconciled
To making an atonement for the wild.
Indeed it is not so, instead the word
Is all about the yeastless bread interred
In passover loaf when the thing occurred
That Jesus lifted sop and dipped the curd
And with that sign sent Judas out and
cursed.

The message is the thing we fear the worst:
To put a brother out of pew and state
Just because he approached unmarried
mate.

Thank goodness there are still churches
around
Where sinful membership can still be
found.

O my Beloved, what mercy You give me
Who see the fatal yeast in every place
Where men may enter either face to face
Or in an unjust anonymity!
The fearful, lonely, love-spent heart is free
To cast its vile vituperation's space
On every fleeting blossom, every race
From lady's mantle and the greenery
Of broad-leaved plantain by the step and
door.

I flee to You, Beloved, from every shore
Where such hypocrisy arises gaunt
To fool the living blind and stand and
flaunt.

Beloved, Beloved, You are enough for me.

9 I wrote you one letter to say
Not to have fornicators stay
With you, 10 But I did not mean that
Not with any in this world sat
As fornicators, covetous,
Or extortioners or the *muss*
Idolaters make, for then you
Would have to leave the world *in crew*.

The truth is Paul does not say we must not
Carouse with fornicators on the spot

Of bar and dance-floor, since for that we
 would
 Have to leave the town centre and for good.
 No, he just does not want us to shake hands
 With fornicators in the pews and stands
 Of Your house under steeple and on
 Sunday.
 Acceptance of the ill's all right on Monday.
 Beloved, forgive my cynical approach
 To Paul and church and world, I don't
 encroach
 On Your authority nor on Your glory,
 But with repentance come amend my story.
 Let everyone look to his own expenses
 And drop the holiness of false pretences.

1 Corinthians 6

1 Do any of you dare, when you
 Have a case against others due,
 Go to law before the unjust,
 And not before the saints *in trust*?
 2 Do you not know the saints will judge
 The world? And if the world *like fudge*
 Shall be judged by you, are you yet
 Not worth to judge smallest set?
 3 Do you not know that we shall judge
 Angels? How much more then *the smudge*
Of things in this life? 4 If you then
 Have cases of judgement for men
 In this life, set them to judge who
 Are least esteemed by the church *crew*.
 5 I speak to your shame. Is it so
 That there's not a wise man to go
 Among you? No, not one to be
 Able to judge his brothers' fee?

My practice, my Beloved, has always been
 To bring complaint before the one in sin
 Against my pride and store, and if he fail
 To do me justice, then I haste to sail
 To his friends and present the turgid case
 To see if they can save his hopeful face.
 Never yet have I gone to law to get
 My rights, instead I simply strive to set
 My belt a bit tighter and stay to taste
 What kale and turnips remain without
 waste.

Remainder that You leave to me in store
 So far has met my needs and far, far more.
 I only wonder that I do so well
 In this world where the wicked rule the
 spell.

To judge the cases of the quarrelsome
 It seems the ones esteemed least by the rum
 Are to be chosen. What the man admits
 Is that the ones called out where St. Paul
 sits
 Hold some in great esteem and others
 small.
 What can one then expect when good St.
 Paul
 Has gone to rest and emperors require
 The seating of the bishops on the wire
 Of councils ecumenical and bright?
 We can expect an even darker night.
 The least may judge indeed as may the
 great,
 But judgement's likely to fall on the pate
 Of the least guilty not to say the true
 And righteous ones, if such are in Your
 view.

6 But brother goes to law with his
 Own brother and that before quiz
 Of unbelievers. 7 Now therefore
 There's utterly a fault at core
 Among you, because you make suit
 One with another. Why refute,
 Instead of taking the wrong? Why
 Do you not rather suffer lie?
 8 Instead you do wrong and defraud
 You own brothers *like any clod*.

There may be somewhere Baptist church
 where all
 Have always been loving under the pall,
 But I've got doubts. I know a plenty where
 Lawsuits have risen to set out a snare.
 But now I see I've done right on my own
 To appear only before Your own throne
 And not the bench where lawyers beat the
 bush
 The find a fee over, beyond the push.
 My virtue is forgotten as I putter
 About the garden and the lazy gutter.
 I rather look at the vine and the flower
 While I am living in this world an hour,
 Or better yet, the beetle that was last
 To face the autumn torrents failing fast.

9 Don't you know the unrighteous will
 Not inherit God's holy hill?
 Don't be deceived, nor fornicators,

Idolaters nor wedlock breakers,
The spineless, nor the male priests who
Serve in fertility cult's pew,
10 Thieves, nor the covetous, nor yet
Abusers of alcohol's *bet*,
Revilers nor extortioners,
Shall inherit God's harbingers.

There is an inconsistency I trow
In those who take this text to preach
 somehow
To those adults consenting in their way
Of privacy and out of light of day,
And yet themselves participate to praise
The resurrecting god in raucous lays
Just like the ones heard in the awful days
Of Baal and Ashtoreth. Beloved, keep me
Away from the temples where Trinity
Is served with sensual rhythm and the share
Of sex no matter whether it is there
Between men or between the opposite.
I scorn the sacred prostitute that sings
And sways his hips while counterpart takes
 wings.

11 And such were some of you, but you
Are cleansed and sanctified now too
In Lord Jesus' name and by our
God's spirit. 12 All things in their hour
Are lawful to me, but not all
Things are expedient *in their call*,
All things are lawful for me, but
I'll not be brought to them and shut.

It seems that justification and more,
Both cleaning and the greater treasure store
Of sanctification comes in fell swoop:
It's not a work of lifetime in the coop.
It's not gained by the human sacrifice,
Nor by the sex trade in the temple slice,
But by the Lord Jesus' name and by our
God's spirit. My Beloved, I thank the hour
When I saw You within the self with
 power,
Not to be overthrown by any deed,
But intimately wedded to the need
Of human breath and life, the sovereign
 Lord
Who orders my obedience to Adored,
Whose word is like a burning fire and
 sword.

13 Food for the stomach and the belly
For food, but God destroys the jelly
Of both of them together. Now
The body's not for fornication,
But for the Lord, the Lord somehow
Is for the body. 14 In his station
God's raised up the Lord, and will raise
Us also by His own power's *praise*.
15 Don't you know that your bodies are
The members of Christ? Shall I mar
The members of Christ and make them
The members of a harlot's hem?
May God forbid such stratagem.
16 What? Don't you know the one who's
 joined
To a prostitute is purloined
In one body? For two, says He,
Will be joined in one flesh to be.
17 But one that joined unto the Lord
Is one spirit *with the adored*.

O my Beloved, if anything I know,
It is that there are not two in the show,
There's only One, You in all things and
 over
All things the Sovereign and no longer
 rover
As I might in my blindness and illusion
Think to my detriment and my confusion.
The self and Self are joined in One to be
One now and ever to eternity.
There is no I of me, but only I
That is the truth of Your reality.
Beloved, I turn from others and join me
To You in one and see from earth to sky
The rising flame of sacrifice, the spark
Of light that rises on surrounding dark.

18 Flee fornication. Every sin
That a man does is without din
Of body, but the fornicator
Sins against his own body later.
19 What? Don't you know your body's
 room
Of the holy spirit abloom
Among you, which you have from God,
And you're not your own *on the sod*?
20 For you're bought with a price, that's
 why
To glorify God in the ply
Of your body, in spirit too,
Both of which are God's *to be true*.

Let me, Beloved, flee fornication and
The spirit of unfaithfulness to stand
In prayer in temples of the sun and rain,
In temples of Baal where the lights remain
In fables caught in art beneath the strain
Of splintered rainbows crowned with stone
and glass.

Beloved, let me see those temples and pass
Into the greater temple made of light
And air and love and sovereign bidding
bright.

My worship is obedience to Your word
Like every soul that's feathered and that's
furred.

As though without will and in innocence
Let me sweep out the refuse from Your
tents

And do Your will until my breath relents.

1 Corinthians 7

1 As for the things of which you wrote
To me, it's good for a man smote
Not to touch a woman *at all*.

2 But because fornication's call
Let every man have his own wife,
And let every woman save strife
From her own husband. 3 Let the man
Give his wife due kindness in span,
Likewise also the wife unto
Husband *let her always be true*.

4 The wife does not have power upon
Her own body, but husband drawn,
And likewise also the man's not
Got power over his body's plot,
But that belongs to wife alone.

5 Do not defraud each of his own,
Except with consent for a time,
That you may give yourselves to climb
Fasting with prayer, then come again
Together, that Satan in den
Not tempt you to weak acts of slime.

The true fast includes more than food and
drink,

It also means to pray and not to think
Of pleasures of the flesh in those brief
hours

Of daylight were the body leans and cowers
While spirit rises to the skies to set
The soul alight with blessing there well
met.

Beloved, St Paul reveals he knows the air
At least if not the time when fasting's fair.
Your revelation's always everywhere
The same no matter which book men may
share.

I fast from flesh these days not so much for
The sanctity I have behind the door,
But simply because with the passing years
The body does not know the former fears.

6 But I speak this by leave and not
Commanded *by the Lord as taught*.

7 For I wish all men were like me.
But every man has his own fee
In gift of God, one set one way,
Another for a different ray.

The good St. Paul is not alone in wishing
All other men were just like him in fishing.
Few and far between love the difference
Of others on the other side of fence.
Irrational desire to be secure
Makes foolish people think the only sure
Would be if all shared thought and action
to

Accommodate everything all men do.
But vive la difference is still a word
To be more general for whey and curd,
The more the difference the more exciting
I find the other, and especially biting
Is difference in thought. I do not care
For colour of the skin and length of hair.

8 I say therefore to those who are
Unmarried and widows, it's far
Better for them if they abide
As I do *then they will not slide*.

9 But if they can't control themselves,
Let them marry, *humans or elves*,
For it's a better thing that they
Marry than burn *in hellish way*.

10 And to the married I command,
Not I, but the Lord, let not married
Wife leave her husband *in the land*.

11 But and if she does leave, then let
Her stay unmarried or then get
Reconciled to her husband, let
Not husband put away his wife.

12 But as for the rest of the strife,
It's I who speaks and not the Lord.
If any brother's wife adored
Does not believe, and she's content

To live with him resilient,
 Then let him not divorce *or vent*.
 13 And the woman who's got a man
 That does not believe, if he can
 Be pleased to live with her, then let
 Her not leave him *to place a bet*.
 14 The unbelieving man is set
 Apart as holy by the wife,
 The unbelieving wife gets life
 Of holiness by husband's fife,
 If not, your children were unclean,
 But now they're holy, it is seen.

St. Paul is ready to make fatwa here,
 Despite the fact that nothing in his ear
 Speaks from Your Word for him to know
 and fear.

The proposition that he makes is this:
 That children of one faithful do not miss
 But are clean in the pasture that they kiss.
 If they are clean, then so must be the
 spouse
 That is an unbeliever in the house.
 Result is that since faith in one makes two
 Clean, then the faithful one must not give
 shoe,
 Divorcing the unfaithful man or shrew.
 The logic is a convolution true,
 And Paul does well not to attribute that
 To You, Beloved, but to his own mind's fat.

15 But if the unbelieving leave,
 Let him leave *and not have reprieve*.
 A brother or a sister's not
 In bondage in such cases' plot,
 But God's called us to Islam's lot.

Or then to Peace, Beloved. What do You
 want?
 Religious in identity is gaunt,
 And hardly anything for You to grumble,
 Although it's one where humans always
 stumble.
 Peace or Islam, I care not any whit,
 As long as from the bondage of the fit
 In Roman yoke I come away to sit.
 But like the pincers that set squeeze on nut,
 The other half of Rome, that makes it shut,
 Is doubtless the great caliphate that claimed
 Jerusalem between the crusades blamed.
 The one allows no divorce and eschews
 The marriage bed at least for priestly cues.

The other binds four wives under its
 screws.

16 Who knows, O wife, if you will save
 Your husband from the sinful grave?
 Who knows, O man, if you will get
Inheritance for your wife yet?
 17 But as God's given to every man,
 As the Lord's called, let all who can
 So walk. And so I order all
 The called out ones *to keep the call*.
 18 Is any man once circumcised
 Called? Let him not become as guised
 Uncircumcised. Is any called
 Uncircumcised? Leave him unthralled.
 19 The circumcision's naught at all,
 Nor is uncircumcision's call,
 But keeping the commandments of
 God *under His eternal love*.

But fact is Abraham was called before
 He caught his circumcision and the gore.
 But fact is whether called or not, the rate
 Of Your commandment is out there to state
 That every male should go under the knife
 Upon the eighth day or then meet the strife.
 Uncircumcision is not consonant
 With keeping of commandments on the
 slant.

What Paul says makes no sense at all to
 me,
 But is in conflict with itself to see.
 The walls You make in artificial spree,
 Given men's rue, are not necessary.
 At least there is no doubt a child must be
 Cut open with the best of sorcery.

20 Let every man stay in the same
 Calling where he's called without blame.
 21 Are you called as a servant come?
 Care nothing for it, but stay rum,
 Yet if you may become free, then
 Take advantage of that again.
 22 Because the one called in the Lord,
 Though he's a servant, in the Lord
 He is the Lord's freeman, likewise
 Also the one that's free *to rise*
 By calling, is Christ's servant *wise*.
 23 You're bought with a price, do not be
 The servants of men, *but be free*.
 24 Brothers, let every man in calling
 Stay in it with God, *without brawling*.

The death of Christ and payment made in
blood
Makes sense at least before the awful flood
Of those who would make me servant of
men

To follow every custom and each yen.
I'm bought and paid for from the surfeit of
Political correctness in the glove,
Of neighbour's expectations at the shove,
And from the right thing to do in earth's
den.

I'm bought and paid for, so I need not
search

A place in any henhouse for a perch.
I am the property of one who paid
For me with his own life when once
waylaid.

I praise You I am free from all that those
Who claim the priestcraft would on me
impose.

25 Concerning virgins, I receive
No command of the Lord to grieve,
Yet I give my own judgement being
One who's obtained mercy and seeing
To be faithful to Lord's decreeing.

26 So this is a good thing, I guess,
To answer in present distress,
That it's good for a man to be.

27 Are you bound to a wife? Then see
You don't try to get a divorce.

Are you divorced from a wife? Then
Don't look for a wife *among men*.

28 But and if you marry again,
You do not commit any sin,
And if a virgin marries, she
Has not sinned, *because she was free*.

But such people will in the flesh
Have trouble, I would not enmesh.

29 But this I say, brothers, the time
Is short, and there will come the chime
When those who have wives will be like
Those who had no *car nor a bike*.

The Advent sort of spirit that I knew
When I was young and sitting in the pew
Suggested time was short and there were
few

Who should live to marry or study too.
Now I have a grandchild after the fact,
The time was short, but I had time to act.

What shall we say of those in Paul's day
who

Did not marry at all because they thought
There was not time for such things in the
plot?

Two thousand years suffices in my mind
For householder to marry someone kind.
And yet the time is shorter now than then,
And nearer to the coming once again
Of Christ than when Paul wrote and when I
pined.

30 And those who weep as though they'd
not,

And those rejoicing as though shot,
And those that buy as those who had
Nothing *in wealth of good or bad*.

31 And those that use this world, as not
Abusing it, for fashion taught
Of this world passes from the plot.

32 But I would have you be without
Care. He that's unmarried is stout
To care for what belongs to *Christ* (the
Lord),

How he may please the Lord *sufficed*.

33 The married one, the other way,
Cares for the things of the world's sway,
And how he may please his own wife.

34 A difference lies between the rife
Virgin and wife. Unmarried girl
Cares for the things of the Lord's *curl*,
So she may be holy both in
Body and spirit *without sin*,
But she that's married has a care
For the things of the world *in share*,
How she may please her husband *there*.

When celibate in Ephrata looked out
Upon the wilderness with mug and stout,
He saw the rigours of the married life
Too great for where he had to live in strife.
The celibate may take the easy way,
The time to read and work and fast and
pray,

But virtue to be true in hermitage
Needs writing on the bustle of the page,
Needs exercise to muscle in the wage.
Beloved, the immature in mind in me
May long for peace and some security,
But faith in arm and surer poetry
Is carved out of the living at the boot,
The wear and care of loving at the root.

35 And this I speak for your own gain,
 Not to cast a snare on your mane,
 For the seemly thing, and so that
 You may attend where the Lord sat
 Without distractions *lean or fat*.
 36 But if anyone thinks he is
 Behaving uncoothly towards his
 Virgin, if she's passed flower of youth,
 And there seems to be need in truth,
 Let him do what he will and not
 Sin, let them marry *as they ought*.
 37 But he who stands steadfast in heart,
 Without necessity to start,
 But has control over his will,
 And has decided not to spill
 Virginity, he does well still.
 38 So he who gives away the bride
 Is doing well, but he beside
 Who does not give such ones away
 Is doing better in his way.
 39 The wife is bound by law as long
 As her husband lives in the throng
 But if her husband dies, then she
 Is left with her full liberty
 To be married to whom she will,
 But only in the Lord's way still.
 40 But she's happier if she abides
 According as my judgement rides,
 And I think also that in me
 There's working God's spirit to see.

Methinks St. Paul speaks over much about
 A thing he has not practiced up to doubt.
 His wordiness is typical of those
 Who try to show and try to make a pose
 Of knowledge, but know nothing of the
 shows.

He does well to admit he speaks his mind
 And not the revelation that You signed.
 According as his judgement rides indeed,
 Let ancient wisdom ripen, go to seed,
 But long as male and female feel the need,
 His words will fall on deaf ears of the
 steed.

But You, Beloved, are wiser in Your bill,
 And more human than humans at the till,
 For humans love to climb celestial hill.

1 Corinthians 8

1 Now as for offerings made to idols,
 We know we all have knowledge bridles.

Knowledge makes proud, but charity
 Builds up *the soul in unity*.

2 If any one thinks that he knows
 He knows nothing yet to dispose
 As he should. 3 But if any man
 Love God, the same is within scan.

4 So as for eating of those things
 That are set in idols' offerings,
 We know an idol's naught at all,
 And there's no God but One *in hall*.

5 For though many are called gods in
 The sky or in the earth for sin,
 As there are gods and lords galore,

6 But there is but one God in store,
 The Father of whom are all things,
 And we in him. And *star of kings*
 Is one Lord Jesus Christ by whom
 Are all things *till the day of doom*
 And we have in him *too our room*.

Beloved, there is no God but You I know.
 All idols are vain emptiness and show.
 One God alone You send in every age
 Divine guides who apply the sacred page
 Of revelation. This I know and yet
 None in this world and life have knowledge
 set,

But only glimmerings and peekings at
 The glories of Your throne where You have
 sat

Eternities beyond imagination.
 For Your sent one You hold a coronation
 Beyond the water dippings and the meals
 Where the elite in scorn says what he feels,
 Beyond the crosses and the resurrections.
 In Your name and in his I eat confections.

7 But such knowledge there is not found
 In every man upon the ground,
 For some up to this time aware
 Of the idol therefore forbear
 To eat a thing offered in air
 To an idol, and for that care
 Their conscience being weak finds snare.

8 But food does not recommend us
 To God, for neither if we fuss
 To eat we are the better then
 If we don't eat, then we're worse men.

9 But take care not to abuse this
 Liberty of yours and not miss
 Being a stumblingblock to those
 Who are weak by the thing you chose.

10 For if anyone see you which
 Have knowledge sit eating in ditch
 Of idol's temple, will he not
 Be stricken in his conscience caught
 In weakness and be bold to eat
 Those things that are the idol's treat,
 11 And through your knowledge shall the
 weak
 Brother be destroyed by your cheek,
 For whom Christ died, *or so they speak?*
 12 When you sin so against the brothers,
 And wound their weak conscience with
 smotherers,
 You sin against Christ. 13 So if food
 Makes my brother offend as prude,
 I'll eat no meat while the world stands,
 So's not to break my brother's bands.

Three things are uppermost in slaughter
 site:
 The species must be clean there to be right,
 The blood must not fail to gush into might,
 And the name of the true God must prevail.
 The later is a conceit of the pale.
 St. Paul is like his Saviour in the way
 He slices off traditions from his prey
 And sticks tenaciously to letter of
 The law that You once sent down here in
 love.
 But think how many have the wit to read
 The words with care to make them out with
 speed.
 Most people use the words and an excuse
 For eating pork and drinking blood's refuse.
 Think before You inspire a whammed
 recluse.

1 Corinthians 9

1 Am I not an apostle too?
 Am I not free? Have I not seen
 Jesus Christ our Lord *in his due?*
 Are you not my work in the Lord?
 2 Though I'm not apostle adored
 To others, yet doubtless I mean
 To be one to you, for the sheen
 And seal of my apostleship
 Is you yourselves set in the Lord.

It all depends on how a man defines
 Apostle in view of some false combines.
 Apostles are those sent to testify
 Of Your Son's resurrection on the sly.

But Paul just saw a vision in the light,
 And those around him could witness no
 fight,
 And gave no recognition to his call.
 The doubts are valid when applied to Paul.
 Just anyone at all may claim that he
 Met Your Son on the road on one Friday,
 But if there is no witness of the spree,
 He only speaks of it to cause to be
 Division in his hearers' company.
 Beloved, keep You invisible in stall.

3 I answer those who question me
 By this unanswerable decree,
 4 Have we not power to eat and drink?
 5 Are we not able at the brink
 To lead about a sister, wife
 As well as others in the life
 Of apostolate, and as those
 Brothers of the Lord, whom he chose
 Also to call Cephas, *suppose?*
 6 Or I only and Barnabas,
 Can we not then turn off the gas?
 7 Who goes to battle any time
 At his own charges for the grime?
 Who plants a vineyard not to eat
 The fruit it bears him for a treat?
 Who feeds a flock not to consume
 The milk of the flock *in his room?*
 8 Am I speaking as a man speaks?
 Does not the law too make such creaks?
 9 For it's in law of Moses written,
 You must not muzzle the mouth smitten
 Of the ox that treads out the corn.
 Does God leave even ox forlorn?
 10 Or does He say it for our sakes?
 For our sakes, no doubt, are these stakes
 Written, that he that ploughs should plough
 In hope, and he that threshes now
 In hope to be partaker of
 His hope *to eat all of above.*
 11 If we've sown for you spiritual things,
 Is it great if we reap such things
 As carnal *and material things?*
 12 Of others have this power on you,
 Do not we have much more in view?
 Yet we have never used this right,
 But suffer everything for spite,
 So's not to hinder Christ's word's light.

Contention lasts a winter night and goes.
 Now Paul takes Barnabas again and shows

Abiding love to one near and like kin.
They share the spirit and the bread within
As well as grain to fill the paunch withal.
The two of them obey the single call.
To justify their lack of sale and trade
Paul takes the Torah law that once was
made

For grain and oxen and the right to tasting
A bit in hunger while at work not wasting
The kernels that fall by the trough though
fat.

In this I hope that Paul's not guilty at
Attempting to compare for his own gain.
With You, Beloved, comparing is in vain.

13 Do you not know that those who serve
With holy things live in the curve
Of the temple? And those who wait
At the altar from it take plate?

14 So has the Lord ordained that they
Who preach the gospel have their way
Of living from the gospel pay.

15 But I have used none of these things,
Neither have I written these things,
That it should be so done to me,
For I would rather die than see
That some should set my boasting free.

16 For though I preach the gospel, I
Have nothing to take glory by,
For need is laid upon me, and
Woe is to me if I don't stand
To preach the gospel *to this band*.

17 For I do this thing willingly,
I have reward *you do not see*,
But if it is against my will
A dispensation's to my bill.

18 What is my reward then? That when
I preach the gospel unto men,
I may make the gospel of Christ
Without charge, that I not abuse,
My right in the gospel confuse.

I see the truth of what Paul has to say
About the yoke placed in the Gospel pay.
I too made the mistake to be ordained
By such as had no plan but leave me
pained,

Without support of any kind to preach,
Without encouragement that I should teach.
Long has the burden been upon my heart
As one responsible, ordained in cart,

But without horse and without house to
pray.

I was ordained and then sent out to hay.
Beloved, the meadow where I wander free
Is sweet with presence of Your trinity
Of love and faith and at last charity.
I look over the fences where I pray.

19 For though I'm free of every man,
Still I've made myself under ban
To serve all, that I may gain more.

20 Unto the Jews I am a Jew,
That I might gain the Jews a few,
To them under the law as one
Under the law, shall I have won
Them who are under the law *spun*.

21 To them who are without the law,
As without law, not without awe
Of law to God, but under law
To Christ, that I might gain them that
Are without the law *where they sat*.

22 To the weak I became as weak,
That I might at last with the weak,
I'm made all things to all, that I
Might by all means save some *that cry*.

23 And this I do for gospel's sake
That I might of you too partake.
24 Don't you know that those who run in
A race all run, but one to win?

So run, so you may win the bin.
25 And everyone that strives to take
Control of self sets temperate stake
In everything. Now they do so
To get a fading crown in show,
But we an eternal prize *know*.

26 That's why I run like this and not
Uncertainly, and so I've fought
Not as one that just beats the air.

27 But keep under my body's care,
And bring into subjection there,
So that by any means when I
Have preached to others, then should I
Myself not be cast out to die.

If anyone, I understand what Paul
Says when he says he's backed against the
wall

To be a Jew to Jew and Greek to Greek.
I too am anthropologist to seek
The temporary suspension of peek.
I too conform to cultures in the wake
Of every place I go to take a stake.

But I have never been a Jew to Jew,
Even when travelling in that holy view,
And never have I been a Greek to share
The tongue of Homer and of Hesiod's ware.
Beloved, let me be godly when with You,
And when I find myself in cosmic pew,
Godly with God who never speaks but true.

1 Corinthians 10

1 Moreover, brothers, I would not
Have you be ignorant *and sot*,
Since all our fathers passed beneath
The cloud and crossed the sea's bequeath,
2 All baptised by Moses in cloud
And in the sea *to sing aloud*,
3 They ate the same blessed food *in crowd*,
4 And all drank the same blessed drink,
For they drank from the sacred brink
Of the Rock that followed them there,
That Rock was Christ *and of his share*.
5 But with many of them was God
Not well pleased, but threw *on the sod*
In the desert. 6 Now these things were
Our examples by which infer
That we should not lust after things
Evil as they lusted *in rings*.
7 Be not idolaters as some
Of them were as was written rum,
"The folk sat down to eat and drink
And rose up to dance *in the rink*."

The dance itself is not a pagan thing,
For David danced before You and to sing.
But dancing for a golden calf is such
A sin that I should never hope to touch.
The passing of the waters in the flood
Was baptism indeed but in the bud.
It made no Christian of the throng until
They fed upon the Rock from Sinai's hill.
Beloved, I sing and dance and so I make
A pilgrimage to waters for Your sake,
Across the Red Sea waves in pile on pile
While seagulls turn and shout and dip the
while,
And flee from Egypt and the Pharaoh's
crew
To find my solace is alone in You.

8 Let's not commit uncleanness then
As committed some of those men,
And feel in one day twenty-three
Thousand *of them unfaithfully*.

9 Let's not tempt Christ, as some of them
Also tempted, and to condemn
Were struck by serpents' *requiem*.

The Christ or the Messiah in that day
They tempted before serpents got their pay
Was not the Jesus of first century,
But Moses bringing from Egyptian spree.
The Christ is the one sent, adorned,
appointed
Divine guide by the head and heart
anointed.

The many Christs that You have sent reveal
The character of Jesus at the meal.
Beloved, I lay my hand on every one
And vow my vows to You when I have
done.
There is an image bought by time and
place,
And though that image may shadow Your
face,
The glory of eternal wonders stand
Above temptations in the desert land.

10 And don't complain as some
complained,
And were destroyed by the disdained.
11 Now all these things happened to them
For examples written on hem
For warning to us on whom come
The ends of the world *and its sum*.
12 Whoever thinks he stands take heed
Not to fall down *upon the mead*.
13 No tempting's taken you but such
As is a common, human touch.
But God is faithful who will not
Let you be tempted above what
You can bear, but will with the trial
Also make an escape *a mile*,
So you can bear *and not be caught*.
14 So flee, my dearly loved, from that
Idolatry *where you have sat*.
15 I'm talking as though to wise men,
So consider what I say then.

If Paul is really one to bring the news
Of Gospel abrogating law from views,
Then why does he pretend that You provide
The grace to keep the law from side to
side?
And if the law is kept in any way,

The flight from the unclean, the idol's
 sway,
 Then it is kept at least at the big ten
 That sound resounding from Sinai again.
 And if the ten are couth and sure then I
 Must stop upon the Sabbath day and vie
 With every priest upon the crutch and sill
 Of church who denies Sabbath with a will.
 Beloved, I know Sabbath cannot be kept,
 Since priests say so, but grace alone has
 swept.

16 The cup of blessing that we bless,
 Is it the communion, I guess,
 Of the blood of Christ? The bread we
 Break, is it not communion free
 Of the body of Christ? 17 For we
 Though many are one bread and one
 Body, eaters of one bread done.
 18 Look at Israel after the flesh,
 Are they not who eat what is fresh
 From the sacrifices also
 Partakers of the altar's glow?
 19 What do I say then? Is the stone
 Idol any thing or what's shown
 In sacrifice to idols flown
 Any thing *at all of what's grown?*
 20 But I know what the Gentiles bring
 In sacrifice offered to sing
 Is done to devils and not God,
 And I don't want you by the prod
 To have fellowship with such things
 As devils *hanging on their strings.*
 21 You can't drink the cup of the Lord,
 And the cup of devils abhorred,
 You can't partake of the Lord's gift
 And of the devils' table's shift.
 22 Do we provoke the Lord to be
 Jealous, are we stronger than He?
 23 All things are legal in my way,
 But not all of expedient sway.
 All things are legal as I fly,
 But not all things here edify.
 24 Let no man further his own part
 But every man the other's cart.

Occasional conformity is meant
 No doubt in what St Paul here wrote and
 sent.
 One cannot taste the wondered flesh of
 Christ
 In bread and wine as validly sufficed

And then return to pagan table set
 With crucifix and bell where flesh is met
 With Jesus cookie complete with the sign
 Of Osiris and Horus to resign.
 Dionysos in Greece remains to pine
 When the lance at the altar comes to pierce
 The loaf intact that centuries make fierce.
 Beloved, I sit me down beside the board
 Of heavenly sanctuary with the horde
 Of shewbread for the Sabbath in accord.

25 What's sold in the butcher's shop eat,
 And ask no questions of the meat.
 26 Because the earth is the Lord's and
 Everything in it's by His hand.
 27 If someone who does not believe
 Invites you to a feast, don't grieve
 But go, and what is offered you
 Eat without question of its due.
 28 But if someone says to you, "This
 Was offered in sacrifice' bliss
 To idols," don't eat it because
 Of him who showed you it by laws,
 Because the earth is the Lord's and
 Everything in it's by His hand.

No doubt the Jewish butcher shop is meant,
 Since mouse and pork are of the other bent,
 And clearly take the pagan idol's rent.
 It's only the ambiguous in view,
 The mutton and the goat-meat to say true
 That may be eaten without question of
 The sacrifice to idols hand in glove.
 The matter's of no consequence today,
 And so there is no lesson had for pay.
 It's an abuse to take this word that meets
 The situation of idolic treats
 And make of it excuse to drink the blood
 Of pig and eat abominations' flood.
 But such sweet Christians do when come in
 heats.

29 Take conscience, I say, not your own
 But that of your brother alone,
 For why is my freedom judged by
 Another man's conscience to buy?
 30 For if I live by gift of God,
 Why am I slandered by the prod
 For what I take in gratitude?
 31 Whether it be you eat your food
 Or drink your drink, or what you do,
 Do all to God's glory in view.

There are some who proclaim that they are
here

To partake of the idol's form and gear
With motivation of both joy and tear
To worship You alone in all they steer.
The pagan dance, the din of music's sound,
Gyrations of Baal's hips upon the ground,
Are all in evidence the Spirit's found,
And You are named with idol's perfect
round.

Beloved, keep me from every temple's woe,
The whirling dance, the bowing deep and
slow,
That shouts Allah, Jehovah in the row,
But in truth has no master but the glow
Of idol standing in the temple square,
Idolatry of great and good and fair.

32 Don't give offence, not to the Jews,
Nor to the Gentiles, don't abuse
The called out ones of God accuse.

33 I try to please all in all things,
Not seeking my own profitings,
But that of many, so they may
Be saved and brought in the right way.

Paul visits temenos and temple gate,
The court of pagans where the doomed
await,

The synagogue and place in nature's room
Where wait the curious to pray in gloom.
He stands among them all in hope that he
May bring them gospel light eternally.
But what he writes is taken in a spree,
Excuse to worship falsehood's trinity,
Excuse to eat the unclean and excuse
To neglect circumcision for abuse.
Beloved, have mercy on poor Paul and me
Who battle with the faithful under tree
Where lust creates a new world running
free.

Have pity on poor St. Paul and turn loose.

1 Corinthians 11

1 Just follow my example as
I also *follow* what Christ *has*.

How can Paul say to follow what he does?
I'd think for shame! Yet that's the word
that was

On Paul's lips. Glory be that he went
straight

In Christ's example on from gate to gate.
To follow Paul is just to follow Christ
And not depart obedience enticed.
To follow Christ is just to walk within
Your word, Beloved, made flesh and
without sin.

Let me follow the one who follows You
And find the footsteps leading to what's
true.

Let me walk in the footprints left to lead,
Let me battle, and then march in all speed
To rest and table in Your hidden room
Where candlesticks dispel all earthly
gloom.

2 Now I praise you, brothers, that you
Remember me in all *you do*
And keep the ordinances I
Gave you *to do and to comply*.

Is there praise that I keep the ordinance
That Paul or any man gave and to dance
To every tune of human intervention?
Oh no, Beloved, send me a clear
prevention.

Paul gives no ordinance for me to keep
Except what You have given first to peep
To Adam, Abraham, and all the saints.
In those there's praise and not any
complaints.

Paul gives such things again not to dismiss
The holy law and its glories, to miss
The lovely lovesong of Sinai, but still
Because remembering is such a pill.
Let me remember You, Beloved, today
And take no praise but in the words You
say.

3 But I want you to know the head
Of every man is Christ, the head
Of woman *is the* man, while God
Is head of Christ, *which is not odd*.

Does Paul mean here he wants hierarchy's
weight

To bring the universe into the late
Great order in which men and women are
Not equal before sun and moon and star?
If so, he flies against creation's story
Where men and women are of equal glory,

Two sides of one creation, split apart
In trance and dark sleep by the divine art.
If so, he fails to see Sabbath commandment
Lists all subordinates with gay
disbandment,
But does not set the wife or husband under
The other, only children before wonder,
The worker, guest and cattle in the gate.
He must mean something else not to be
late.

Paul sets the woman under man and man
Beneath Christ who himself is set by plan
Beneath God. It seems strange indeed to
me

That some make both God and Christ
equally
Persons of great and holy Trinity,
And yet continue to demand the state
Of woman is beneath man's. Let's relate.
If God and Christ are equal, so are man
And woman. Following consistent plan,
Then so are man and Christ, which surely
makes

The woman equal to God in her stakes.
I've seen such women, sitting in a pew,
With painted faces and bespangled shoe.
Gold turns all flesh to deity for shakes.

4 Praying or prophesying each
Man with head covered *in his speech*,
Dishonours his *own* head *by breach*.

Has Paul not read the law in which is said
That Aaron wore a mitre on his head?
Or does the priest not pray and prophesy,
Reciting the divine words by and by?
Both Muslim and the Jew cover their heads
In prayers and everywhere outside their
beds

Despite their being male and right or
wrong.
With head uncovered I replay my song,
My slender psalms in praise of You and
yours,
And quash complaint that Paul's word still
outpours
More questions than he answers quill and
pen.

It is no comfort Peter complains when
He reads Paul's words since he too is
awake

To write in oracles dark and opaque.

5 But every woman *then* who prays
Or prophesies *by nights or days*
With *her* head uncovered allows
Dishonour on her head *and bows*,
For that is even all the same
As if her head were shaved *in shame*.

Or perhaps it's not shame to shave the head
Of woman, despite many things I've read.
Paul sets the woman up like the high priest
Who has a mitre on at divine feast.
Who does not pray or prophesy in word,
In cantillation sweet though not absurd
For being in the sacred Hebrew tongue,
It seems may sit uncovered on the rung.
Her only dishonour with head bared so
Is if she prays or prophesies below.
Dishonour rather I find to forget
To murmur day and night Your law and get
Its blessings poured out on uncovered pate,
Both male and female know how to be late.

6 For if a woman is not covered,
Let her also be shorn *uncovered*.
But if it be a woman's shame
To be shorn or shaved, *for the claim*,
Let her be covered *without blame*.

The woman who does not wear cover on
Her unshorn head's a disgrace to the dawn.
Two ways there be to step around the trap.
To right one covers all one's hair in wrap,
To left one cuts it off and curls and dyes.
Two ways lie equally before my eyes,
But one leads to the left and one the right.
There may be some left-handed in Your
sight,
Beloved, who choose the road untravelled
by
The thoughtless and the dreary and the shy.
Beloved, two women sit beneath my roof,
Both loved and neither one of the aloof,
Though one bears scarf and one bears shorn
off curls.
May both be taken up as gems and pearls.

7 A man indeed ought not to put
A cover *on his head or foot*,
Since he's God's image and his glory,
But woman is *indeed* man's glory.

The feminist Paul states surprising story,
That without woman man has not a glory,
A single glory to his meagre name.
Without a woman every man's a shame.
This is a bitter pill to take for us
Who always thought that women in the bus
Were lesser creatures and the weaker sex.
The only glories a man's got perplex.
Let me learn now, Beloved, the humble
way

That there's no pride in man to have his
say,

But all a man has to be prideful in
Is just a wife whose lovely, without sin.
And knowing so the man too can become
In God's image Your glory and its sum.

8 For man is not from woman, but
Woman from man, *and then flesh shut*.
9 Nor was *the* man created for
The woman, but the woman for
The man, *it seems there's more in store*.

The being before You divided it
Was called the man, Adam, and they were
fit

For being both the male and female sides
As stated in the verse that coincides
With Genesis one and verse twenty-seven.
That ought to be enough to open heaven.
But no, Adam sees all the animals
Have mates, where he has none and that
appals.

And so You split the Adam into two,
The one a human and the other too,
And closed the flesh against the coming
night.

The woman was from Adam, that is right.
But Adam was the both before the sleep,
And men today have only half to keep.

10 For this reason the woman ought
To have authority *she's got*
Upon *her* head, because *there are*
Around her angels on a par.

Paul here talks of the angels who, it's said,
In Jubilees took some women to bed.
It's not that shining hair distracts the
prayers
Of human beings on the heavenly stairs,

But rather, it seems, that the angels find
Uncovered woman too seductive kind
To go about angelic tasks unmoved.
Beloved, this is a theory yet unproved,
But I take Paul's word for it and submit,
That women ought to cover and keep fit
Because the beauty of their heads entices
The unaccustomed angels to new vices.
Such power is given to womankind
That would make even good angels go
blind.

11 Nevertheless, neither *is* man
Without the woman, nor woman
Without the man, in the Lord's *plan*.

12 For as woman *came* from the man,
Even so too man through woman,
But all things *here* from God *began*.

The human was once one, and split in two,
And now has two names and two things to
do,

One male and one female, one Adam and
The other Eve, the mother of the land.
So You too, my Beloved, show dual name,
To be not lesser than humans for shame,
But like the male, You are exalted in
The name of Alohim, for foot and fin,
The highest and supreme, but also known
More often by the secrets dark and grown
In the essential being, You're called
YHWH.

Thus You are the original that knew
The plan of making all things pairs and
shares
Reflected in the universe that dares.

13 Think for yourselves if it's decent
For a woman, *though eloquent*,
To pray uncovered *before God*?
Such praying is not worth a pod.

Not only are the angels sorely tried
By seeing women's hair bare and untied,
But You Yourself, it seems, in Paul's
relation

Get flustered by a woman's coiffeuration.
So much so, it seems everyone can know
This truth even without the slightest show
Of revelation to enforce the fact.
It's something pure reason attains by act.
Paul's view of the reality seems strange

To me, who am so humble in my range.
But I rejoice that Paul at once reveals
That there is meaning in what thinks and
feels
An ordinary person on the go.
He tells me to judge for myself below.

14 Does not nature itself teach you
That long hair on a man is true
Dishonour to him? 15 But long hair
For women is her glory there,
For her hair was given to *hide*
And cover any shame beside.

The ancient Semites it seems had long hair.
Perhaps it was a shame they had to bear.
And even Absalom, so proud and bold,
Fell prey to his long hair that stopped him
cold.

My hair was also fairly long one time,
I keep it short now not for shame or clime,
But just because I am too lazy to
Use a comb for what combs were made to
do.

If You did not want men to have long hair,
Why did You create it in the same share
As women have? Ah, yes, I had forgotten
That men go bald, and what they have is
boughten.

That's proof enough that the external
shame
Is still a thing of universal blame.

16 But if anyone seems to be
Contentious, we have no such way,
Nor *do* those called out in God's way.

Paul's worldview is almost mythology,
At least as regards hair and coiffeury,
But his last principle is surely best.
It may indeed matter how well one's
dressed,

But by the same token, there is a need
To drop contention along with my greed.
To cover her hair in her modesty
May be the woman's glory and may be
The glory of both man and Deity,
Praised by the angels from their lust set
free

By every humble Eve's untrumpery,
Yet greater glory still arises when
Contentious spirits fly away from men.

Beloved, in sweetness let my heart agree.

17 In giving these instructions I
Do not praise *you*, since you come by
Together not for better but
For the worse. 18 And I hear it cut
First of all when you come together
With the called out ones, you see whether
There are division among you,
And I almost believe it's true.

19 For there must also be among
You heresies in what you've sung,
Such as approved appear in rung.
20 When you gather into one place,
It's not to eat Lord's meal in grace.

21 For when you eat everyone takes
First before others and their sakes
His own meal, and one's hungry while
Another's drunken *by his guile.*

22 Don't you have houses where to eat
And drink? Or do you want to treat
The called out ones of God with shame
And so humiliate by name?
What shall I say to you? Shall I
Praise you for this? I'd rather die.

The heresies that separate the crowd
Of called out ones St. Paul repeats aloud.
They are the heresies of common meal
That crystallize and separate the keel
Of Christian churches to this day and heel.
The Transubstantiation meets the note
Of Consubstantiation in the vote,
While the Reformed, though symbol, is the
real.

Beloved, I hie me from the better way,
The churchly roach and churchly sort of
day,
And temper at the mosque and synagogue,
Though I'm not more welcome there than
the frog.
The Eucharist I eat, I eat alone
In secret with You here before Your throne.

23 For what I've received of the Lord
That I also give as reward
To you, so that Sir Jesus that
Same night when he was betrayed sat
And took bread. 24 And when he gave
grace,
He broke it and said "Take a trace
And eat it, this is my body

Which is broken for you to see,
 Do this in remembrance of me.
 25 In the same way also the cup
 When he had finished with the sup,
 Saying "This cup is the new pact
 In my blood, this is how to act,
 As often as you drink it do
 It in remembrance of me too.
 26 Because as often as you eat
 This bread and drink this cup for treat,
 You mind the Lord's death till he come.
 27 Therefore who eats this bread in sum
 And drinks this cup of the Lord not
 Worthily, shall be guilty caught
 Of the Lord's body and his blood.
 28 Let a man examine himself
 And so let him eat from the shelf
 That bread and drink that cup *of delf*.
 29 The unworthy one who will eat
 And drink, eats and drinks to defeat
 Of himself and not seeing there
 The Lord's body and the Lord's share.
 30 That's why many are weak and sick
 Among you, and some sleep in trick.
 31 For if we'd judge ourselves, then we
 Will not be judged *in time of fee*.
 33 Therefore, my brothers, when you come
 Together to eat, wait in sum
 For one another *on the run*.
 34 If any one is hungry let
 Him eat at home, and do not set
 For condemnation when you get.

Beloved, I am a hungry one, so I
 In greed take at home the celestial pie.
 Like Zeus upon his rape, I cannot wait
 To get to church and hear the priestly rate,
 But must in trembling eagerness avail
 Myself of flesh and blood hung in the pail
 Beside my porch and on the flowered rail.
 Beloved, I am a hungry sort of mate.
 Judge me not that I find no priest to give
 The word of life to me so I shall live,
 But take it quickly from the Psalter cast
 Upon my sleep before the night to last,
 And with Your judgement or its lack I run
 Into the heavenly meadows full of fun.

1 Corinthians 12

1As for things of the spirit now,
 Brothers, I don't want anyhow
 For you to be ignorant now.

2 You know you were Gentiles and caught
 Away with these dumb idols' rot
 Even as you were led by naught.
 3 That's why I'd have you understand
 That no man speaking by the hand
 Of God's spirit calls Jesus cursed,
 And no man can speak to say first
 That Jesus is Lord, but by leading
 Of the holy spirit and heeding.

It seems St. Paul was never faced by this
 Idolatry of the sweet Christian bliss.
 There are today the millions who call
 Christ
 The Lord and mean by Lord the second
 spliced
 In person of the blessed Trinity.
 So they both engage in idolatry
 And in admission that Jesus born free
 Is Lord. Beloved, "forgive our fevered
 ways"

And lead us back from Soma and its praise.
 But then to reconsider, is it not
 The greatest of all curses to be wrought
 To blasphemously make of Jesus god,
 When he bows to his Father on the sod?
 Let holy spirit be born in the pod.

4 Now there are many kinds of gifts,
 But the same spirit *when it lifts*.
 5 And there are different offices,
 But the same Lord that owns as His.
 6 And there are many kinds of tasks,
 But it's the same God in all baskets.
 7 But the spirits appearing comes
 To every man for profit's sums.

Like every leaf upon the tree of life
 Is different and sings to a different fife,
 So every person born into the world
 Is a unique flag of creation furled.
 But in each heart lies one spirit alone,
 The greatest of divine gifts on the stone,
 The consciousness of being I, the string
 That is the direct tie to divine thing.
 You speak directly, my Beloved, to each
 Within the consciousness that You must
 teach

To everyone directly on the peach:
 I am that I am both beyond the reach
 Of all things made, and yet most intimate
 Being of humankind and of God's rate.

8 To one by the spirit the word
Of wisdom is given and conferred,
Another gets the word of knowledge
By the same spirit *and not college*.

9 Another gets faith by the same
Spirit, to another the gifts
Of healing by same spirit's shifts,
10 Another gets the power to work
Miracles, another to irk
With prophecy, another knows
Discerning of spirits that chose,
Another different kinds of tongues,
Another to translate such rungs,
11 But all of these work for the one
And selfsame spirit when it's done
Dividing to each man his own
Different gifts as it wills alone.

Beloved, I have no gift of spirit here
That called by knowledge or by faith in
fear,

Nor healing (when I pray the man gets
worse),

Nor miracles to pronounce, bless or curse,
Nor prophecy, discerning spirits' choice,
Nor speaking in tongues with a human
voice,

Nor translating for others (see how I
Have mutilated Your words from the sky).
Beloved, my only gift's to babble more
Rhymes out in love and love's hate and to
pour

On You my hopes and fears and sometimes
joy:

My gift is just to appear a bad boy.

And yet with all my heart and breath I hope
To partake of Your spirit and not rope.

12 For as the body is one, and
Has many members and all stand
As members of that body as
Many and so also Christ has
One body. 13 By one spirit we
Are all baptised into the spe
Of one body, whether we be
Jews or Gentiles, whether we be
Slave or free and have all been made
To drink into one spirit stayed.

14 The body's not a member one,
But many *members under sun*.

15 If the foot says "Because I'm not

The hand, I'm not of body wrought,"

Is it thereby not of the same?

16 And if the ear shall say "Because

I'm not the eye, so under laws

I'm not of the body, is it

Therefore not of the body fit?

17 If the whole body were an eye,

Then what of hearing, not to spy?

If the whole were just ears where were

The sense of smelling *like a cur*?

18 But now God has set every one

Of the members in body done

As it has pleased Him *on the run*.

I always wondered why the dog could
smell

Much better than the human in the dell.

I always wondered why the eagle goes

In paths of sight beyond what human
knows.

And now I see that You, Beloved, give
gifts

To each one in creation that uplifts.

There's always something better in the
other

Than what I find in my own heart and
brother.

To recognize the spirit in its ways

Is just to give to You Your due in praise.

It's sure that I am better than a dog

In some way undiscovered in the fog,

And so by faith I grasp my higher estate,

Although it seems I always have to wait.

19 If they were all one member then

Where would the body be *of men*?

20 But now they're many members, yet

They are in just one body set.

21 The eye cannot say to the hand,

I have no need of you in band,

Nor again the head to the feet,

I have no need of you *to seat*.

22 No, all the more for body parts

That seem to be weak in their arts,

Are the more needful *in their hearts*.

23 Such body parts that we think less

In honour, on these we confess

More honour, and uncomely set

Will more abundant beauty get.

24 That's because our fine features need

Nothing, but God has set indeed

The body well to give more grace

Of honour to what lacks in place.
25 So there should be no breach in all
The body, but the members call
The same care for them each and all.

St. Paul who speaks of foreskin openly
When angry with the party who freely
Would cut it off from all sons and sundry,
At last becomes too coy to speak the name,
But covers it with terms of blushing shame.
Because he sees the hidden body parts
As each having a gift of spirit arts,
He makes perhaps the judgement that the
penis

Is also great in every part to wean us
From looking down on those in the
assembly

Who come to evoke You in voices trembly.
Beloved, if that is what good many hopes,
I leave him in my admiration's ropes,
And flee to You from St. Paul's saintly
scopes.

26 And if one member suffer pain,
All the members will feel amain,
Or if one member's honoured then
All members will rejoice *as men*.
27 Now you are Christ's body as such
Members in particular touch.

28 And God has set some there among
The called out ones and those who've sung
First the apostles and to come
The prophets, thirdly teachers hum,
After that miracles and then
Gifts of healings, and helps of men,
Administrations, and then tongues.

29 Are all apostles? And are all
Prophets? Are all teachers to call?
Do all work miracles? 30 Do all
Have gifts of healing? Do all call
With tongues? Do all interpret drawl?

31 But covet earnestly the best
Gifts and yet I show you the rest
Of a more excellent way's *test*.

Since the divine I's in each heart and mind,
St. Paul thinks that we all ought to be kind.
The same I is hurt by the body's pain
In every creature bum or with the reign
Of reason, all are equally in part
Of pain, and so all ought to share the dart.
Beloved, at times I feel the pain the seers

The other with its spikes and sordid spears,
But still do not think that the height of
power

In spirit is perfection in an hour
To feel the pain of everyone on earth.
Those who seek advance spirituality
Are ignorant of the great price and fee.
Give me, Beloved, a humbler sort of berth.

1 Corinthians 13

1 Though I speak with the tongues of men
And angels and have no love then,
I've become merely sounding brass
Or tinkling cymbal *that will pass*.

2 And though I have the prophecy,
And understand all mystery,
And have all knowledge and though I
Have all faith even so that I
Could remove mountains, but not love,
I'm nothing *for all the above*.

3 Though I give all my goods to feed,
And though I give my body's weed
To be burned, but have no love, then
It is no profit *among men*.

St. Paul thinks it's a better way to speak
Of love, rather than knowing at the peak
That all who are aware of being I
Share in one divine spirit on the sly.
Indeed, the concept is a simpler one:

Just love everyone and go and have fun.
But fact is every time I hear the word
To love I find that soon or late they're
stirred

To slip a knife into my back, and that
Is why I always run away from cat
Who talks of love while sitting on my mat.
I'd rather have the empty angel's tongue,
And clamour of the cymbals when they've
rung,

Than all the Christian lovers with their
dung.

4 Love's patient, kind, love envies not,
Love does not vaunt itself big shot,
Is not puffed up, does not conduct
Itself unmannerly when chucked,
It does not seek its own in fame,
It's not quickly provoked to flame,
It thinks no evil of the claim.

6 It does not joy in wickedness,
Rejoicing in truth to confess,

7 It bears all things, believes all things,
It hopes all things, endures all things.
8 Love never fails, but if there are
Prophecies they shall not go far,
And if there are tongues, they shall cease,
And if there is knowledge increase,
It will vanish *like falling star*.
9 We know in part and prophesy
In part. 10 But when what's perfect's nigh,
Then what's in part is done away.

In fact, after the pretty words are spoken,
And the bread and wine given for a token,
All fails, both faith and knowledge when
awoken,

And certainly the love of a life broken.
After the fainting trials St. Paul awards,
I merely go back to the trusted swords
Of cantillating Psalms no matter how
Much hate they express for enemies now.
Cathartic, hateful liturgy of Psalm,
Avoided by the Christian for the bomb,
Remains the best I find to release all
Aggressions from the heart and hand in
thrall.

Give me the sword of David and the tongue
To sing his deprecations on the strung.

11 When I was a child, then I spoke
As a child, understood awoke
As a child, I thought as a child,
But when I grew up reconciled,
I put away things of a child.
12 For now we see things through a glass,
Obscurely, but then in the pass
As face to face, and now I know
In part, but then I'll come to know
Even as also I am known.
13 And now here abide three alone,
Faith, hope, and love, but of these three
The greatest of them's charity.

St. Paul himself goes back to seeing
straight,
Reality barked in the mart of fate:
The realizing that the I I know
Is but the tip of the divine in show.
And so I leave the childish praise of love,
And get back to the job with hand in glove,
Reminding heart and eye that every man
Shares in the being of Your I by plan,
And should I harm the other on the shelf,

I harm as much or more my own dear self.
One cannot love the neighbour as one
should
Love self until the Self is known for good.
That way alone Paul's love can still abide,
After the children run away and hide.

1 Corinthians 14

1 Pursue the charitous, desire
The spiritual, with greater fire
That you may come to prophesy.

Saint Paul is talking to the folks he's got
To believe in the Christ that he has taught.
So what does he mean here by prophecy?
He does not want to turn them into great
Leaders to represent humanity
Like Moses or like Abraham in state.
I doubt he wants to turn them into such
Tale-bearing palm-readers some use as
crutch.

If producing Torahs and crystal ball
Scams is not what he's talking of at all,
Then what is prophecy? It's clear he takes
A Scripture meaning for the work he
makes:

A prophet's simply one with harp or not
Who cantillates the Scripture as it's taught.

2 For who speaks his own tongue, he
speaks

Not to men but the God he seeks,
For no one understands him, yet
In spirit speaks secrets to get.

3 But who prophesies speaks to men
In edification again,
In exhortation and comfort.

4 One speaking his own tongue's resort
Edifies himself, but he who
Prophesies edifies the crew.

The recitation of Torah and Psalm
Is prophecy beneath both fir and palm,
And that is edifying to those who
Hear what the Scripture says for them to
do.

But from old time there have been those
who don't

Have skill or knowledge to recite, or won't.
They want to squeal a melancholy tune
Of their own thoughts and feelings to the
moon.

The Pentecostal church is filled with those,
But they're not the only ones out who
chose

The text and thoughts of individual pose,
Such as of Fanny Crosby or the priest
Who writes collects of Anglicans at least.
The choice is Your Word or some sloppy
prose.

5 I wish that all of you could speak
As many languages a week,
But rather that you prophesied,
Because it's greater on the ride
To prophesy than speak with tongues,
Except in a translation's rungs,
So called out ones are edified.

On day of Pentecost You gave the skill
To speak in languages run of the mill
As listed in the Acts, and these were not
The mystic utterance of foolish sot.
They were true languages to preach the
word
That Jews from all around the world once
heard.

But speaking languages for motives grand
In teaching and in preaching round the land
Is not so great and worthy a command
As cantillating Torah and Psalm with
The melody transmitted without myth.
The public recitation of the line
Of Hebrew songs sent down by the divine
Is better than skill in ten tongues that shine.

6 Now, brothers, if I come to you
Speaking in *foreign* tongues *on cue*
What shall I profit you, except
I speak to you by an adept
Revealing or knowledge or yet
By prophecy, or doctrine get?
7 And even things without life giving
Voice whether pipe or harp unliving,
Unless they make distinctive sounds
How can it be known on their rounds
What is piped or harped in *their bounds*?
8 For if the trumpet gives unclear
Sound, who will prepare for war here?
9 So too are you, unless you speak
By the tongue words easy to keep,
How shall it be known what you speak?
Your words are just a breeze to sweep.
10 There are perhaps so many kinds

Of voices in the world of minds,
And none of them is without sense.

11 But if I do not know the sense
Of the voice, I shall just commence
To be barbaric to the speaker,
And he himself will appear weaker
To me. 12 So you too, since you are
Zealous for spiritual things' star,
Seek to excel in edifying
The group of called out ones not vying.
13 That's why the one who gives his own
Personal witness to atone,
Let him pray to make better known.

Who wants to bear a tongue in witness to
What he's experienced of love and You
Ought to pray that he learn to cantillate
Your Word in order to bring to relate
Something of value to the hearer's life.
But too often laziness is more rife.
Prayer's not enough, indeed, it takes some
will

To learn to read and sing the Torah's bill
And touch the harp of Psalm with artful
tongue

In lays that for centuries have been sung.
Who cry aloud that You love and forgive
Should rather stop to learn a man may live
Not by bread and by crooning to the moon
But by cantillating Your Word right soon.

14 For if I pray in my own words
My spirit's praying like the birds,
But my understanding is nil.

15 How is it then? So now I will
Pray with the spirit and I will
Pray with the understanding too,
I'll sing with the spirit in view,
I'll sing with understanding too.

16 If you bless in spirit alone,
How shall another in the room
Who has no knowledge of your boom
Be able to agree abloom
Not understanding what you say?

17 Indeed your giving thanks there may
Be good, but the other as should
Receives no edifying good.

18 I thank God for languages I
Speak more of them than any vie
Of all of you *there who may try*.

19 Yet among the called out ones I
Had rather speak five words reply

With understanding that I might
 Teach others also for the right,
 And ten thousand words in a tongue
Giving personal witness sung.
 20 Brothers, don't be in understanding
 Mere children, but in malice standing
 Be immature, in understanding
 Be grown-ups. 21 In the Torah stands
 "With other tongues of other lands
 Of lips I'll speak to this folk's bands,
 And yet for all that they will not
 Hear me," says YHWH *and not forgot.*
 22 That's why foreign languages are
 For a sign, not to faithful star,
 But to those who do not believe,
 But prophesying's not for them
 That don't believe the diadem,
 But for the ones that do believe.

I can believe indeed, Beloved, the song
 Of prophesying Scripture all along
 In cantillation is not for the weak
 In hesitating faith who do not seek.
 And yet I find many who claim to be
 Full of faith in Your Word and grace and
 see
 No difficulty in promoting wrong
 In every kind of music or in strong
 Witness of personal wit and emotion.
 They rather take the sweet and sun-tan
 lotion
 Than the hard meat of reading Torah in
 The very language it's set to begin.
 They prefer the tongue of Wesley to that
 Declaimed on Sinai the one time You sat.

23 If therefore the whole body of
 The called out ones gather in love
 In lone place, and all speak in tongues
 Foreign and there come in the rungs
 Unlearned or unfaithful ones,
 Will they not say upon their buns
 That you're insane *to vent such lungs?*
 24 But if everyone prophesies,
 And unbelievers come to rise,
 Or one unlearned, he is convinced
 Of everything for words not minced.
 25 So are his heart secrets revealed,
 And falling on his face he'll yield
 Worship to God and tell abroad
 That truly among you is God.
 26 How is it then, brothers, when you

Come together, then each of you
 Has a psalm, teaching, tongue and yet
 A revelation and to get
 Interpretation. And so let
 All things be done to edifying.

The service Paul envisages is set
 Upon the basis of the Psalm well met.
 And so I try my own grandmother's way,
 And try to recite at least every day
 A Psalm of teaching, tongue and revelation
 Interpreting Your nourishment and ration.
 The formula is good for me alone,
 Or for a crowd come in before the throne,
 It serves for one and all, which is why I
 Wonder why any on the churchly sly
 Must take a Siddur or a mass made up
 Of other texts beside Davidic cup.
 I come with two or three and do not fail
 To raise a Psalm of David and a wail.

27 If someone give personal note
 In witness, let it be by rote
 Of two or at the most of three,
 And that in turn, and let there be
Interpretation of the fee.
 28 If there is none to interpret,
 Let him keep quiet where they're set
 Among the called out ones, and let
 Him speak to himself and to God.
 29 But let the prophets two or three
Utter the Scriptures faithfully,
 And let the others judge *and see.*
 30 If revelation come upon
 Another sitting by and drawn,
 Then let the first one hold his peace.
 31 For you may all there in increase
 Prophecy one by one that all
 May learn *to cantillate the call*
 And all be comforted *in stall.*
 32 The spirits of the prophets are
 Subjected to the prophets' *star.*
 33 God's not for confusion but peace
 Among all groups called out release.

St. Paul in inspiration here predicts
 The coming of peace or Islam's relicts
 To replace the confusion that arose
 Not only when the Jews Christians oppose,
 But when the Christians divided in store
 Of Christologic battles hard and sore.
 But if Islam arose to meet confusion,

The result as been just more sects'
 profusion.
 Where seventy-one were not enough to
 show
 The Jewish way in straight and narrow go,
 The Christian seventy-two rose up to glow.
 Islam was worse than all those come before
 In making seventy-three on Makkah's
 shore,
 And all before the Protestant intrusion.

34 Let your women keep quiet in
 The groups of called out ones *from sin*,
 It's not permitted they should speak,
 But in obedience to seek
 As also Torah says a peek.
 35 And if they will learn any thing,
 Let them ask their husband to sing
 At home, for it's a shame for them
 As women to speak in the stem
 Of the called out ones' *diadem*.

The called out ones may have been well
 called out
 Into new faith, new works, new words no
 doubt,
 But they were called out from a thing or
 two
 That suggests why Saint Paul puts gals in
 stew.
 The synagogues that I have seen around
 Keep women high sequestered from the
 ground
 Where they can hear the hum of Scripture
 read
 Over familiar words not to be led.
 But when they started to preach new things
 there
 Was every reason to dip in the share,
 And ladies calling down to husbands for
 An explanation for what's on the floor
 Was like to cause disorder at the door.
 Ask at home rather than increase the care.

36 What? Did the word of God come out
 From you? Or do you wish to doubt
 And say it came only to you?
 37 If any man thinks that he is
 A prophet or a spirit's whiz,
 Let him acknowledge what I write
 To you is from the Lord in sight
 Commanding you to do what's right.

38 If any man is ignorant,
 Let him remain as ignorant.
 39 That's why, brothers, covet the best
 To prophesy, allow the rest
 To speak in languages *of test*.
 40 Let everything be done the way
 Decency shows in order's way.

Both decent and in order's a tall order
 To give to merely a small church recorder.
 To keep things in order requires the sale
 Of violence upon some victim's tail.
 But violence is not a decent thing.
 I wonder if the New Testament ring
 Is possible to put to test at all.
 It's too conflicting from the starting wall.
 Beloved, I pray that I at least might be
 Both decent in behaviour orderly,
 Although my nature is to cause a spill
 And run a racket from the nearest hill.
 But above all I'll try to prophesy
 In Psalms in Hebrew yet and still defy.

1 Corinthians 15

1 Moreover, brothers, I declare
 To you the gospel which I preach
 To you, which also you took fair
 And in which you stand, *all and each*,
 2 And by which also you are saved,
 If you hold fast that word, *not waived*,
 Which I have preached to you for fear
 You had believed vain, *insincere*.
 3 For I delivered to you first
 Of all that which was *not the worst*
 What I also received: that Christ
 Died for the sins *we were enticed*
 According to the Scriptures, 4 and
 That he was buried *in the sand*,
 And that he rose again the third
 Day according to Scriptures' word,
 5 And that he was seen by Cephas,
 Then by the twelve, *witness to us*.
 6 After that he was seen by more
 Than five hundred brothers *in corps*,
 Of whom the most remain till now,
 But some sleep *beneath the grave's bough*.
 7 After that he was seen by James,
 Then by all the apostles' *claims*.
 8 Then last of all he was seen by
 Me also, as by one born *dry*
 Out of due time. 9 For I'm the least
 Of the apostles, not increased

As worthy to be called as such,
Because I persecuted much
The group of called out ones of God.
10 But I am by the grace of God
What I am, and His grace toward me
Was not in vain, abundantly
I laboured more than all of them,
Yet not I, but the diadem
Of God *which was* with me. 11 Therefore,
Whether *it was* I or their store,
So we preach and so you believed.

Some doubt that Jesus died at all, and yet
It is affirmed in Scriptures that are set.
But for what sins did Jesus die by Paul?
It cannot be for every sin and all,
Since some sins were forgiven and were
purg'd

By divine grace at Sinai when they dirged
The worship of the golden calf. Some sins
Had not been done yet, such as gains and
wins
When Paul himself fought and flayed a just
folk.

The sins are clearly those known at a stroke
Complying with Rome for survival when
You had sent Christ into a world of men.
Let me not comply with Rome here today
And so bear no sin for the cross's sway.

12 Now if Christ is preached *unrelieved*
That he has been raised from the dead,
How have some among you there said
There's no resurrection of dead?

13 But if there is no resurrection
Of the dead, then Christ *has not won*,
Is not risen. 14 And if Christ's not
Risen, then our preaching *is* nought
And so your faith *is* also nought.

15 Yes, and we *all* are found to be
False witnesses for God *to see*,
Because we have borne witness of
God that He raised up Christ *for love*,
Whom He did not raise up, if so
In fact the dead do not do so.

16 For if *the* dead do not rise, then
Christ is not risen *for all men*.

17 And if Christ is not risen, your
Faith *is* futile, still in sins' *store!*

18 Then also those who are asleep
In Christ have perished *from the sweep*.

19 If in this life only we've hope

In Christ, we, of all men, must grope.

The argument of Sadducee for death
Against the Pharisee for life and breath
Still rages in the followers of Paul.
That shows that they are not a Gentile call,
But still turn on the Jewish thought to date.
Anachronism takes Paul for the hate
The Christian bears to faith and truth and
life.

Paul settles for his own party and strife
That risen Christ proves resurrection's true.
He also shows that sin and death and cross
Could not turn the Imamate into dross.
Therefore, Beloved, I still come back to
You

With praise for those that You have given
me

To show the way to life's eternity.

20 But Christ is risen from the dead,
Of death's firstfruits become the head.

21 For since by man *came* death, by man
Also the resurrection can

Come for the dead. 22 As in Adam
All die, so too in Christ *the lamb*
All shall be made alive *again*.

Paul flattens out the Sadducee's vain hope
That this life on the earth's the only dope.
Thus he shows himself here to be a great
Proponent of the Pharisee's last fate.
He uses Christ and resurrection not
To prove the Christian church's evil plot,
But rather to maintain the doctrine that
He learned in Jewish seminar and sat
At feet of loved Gamaliel to spin
A line against the Sadducees and sin.
Alright, he says, to rise up from the dead
Is not a doctrine that is surely spread
In Torah, but Christ proves it once for all
By rising from the gravestone at Your call.

23 But each one *as a citizen*

In his own order: Christ the head
Of firstfruits, afterward those said
To be Christ's at his coming. 24 Then
Comes the end, when he renders God
The Father the kingdom, when he
Makes end of all authority
And all rule and all power to be
In heaven and upon the sod.

25 For he must reign till he has put
All enemies under his foot.
26 The last enemy *that* will be
Destroyed *is* death. 27 For “He has put
All things *that be* under his foot.”

But when He says “all things are put
Under *him*,” *it is* evident
That He who put all things to be
Under him is excepted free.
28 Now when all these things are made fast
Subject to him, the Son at last
Himself will also be subjected
To Him who put all things *selected*
Under him, that God may be all
In all *always without recall*.

The best description of Imamate comes
When Paul brings out his verses and his
sums.

Imamate is authority and true
That’s sent to men, established here by
You.
All things indeed You put under the foot
Of the Imam You give, and so You put
Christ as ruler of all, but You as God
Are an exception to his rule on sod.
And even death is subject to the rule
Of the one sent by You to stay the fool.
The great last goal of the Imamate is
To give up all authority not his
To You and lead me to proclaim Your
name
Over all things, over each human claim.

29 Otherwise, what will they do who
Are baptised for the dead *on cue*,
If the dead do not rise at all?
Why then are they baptised at all
For the dead? 30 And why do we stand
In jeopardy on every hand?

Paul takes each argument that he can find
To make the Sadducee both deaf and blind.
He sees them bathe the dead and wrap in
shroud

And then go to the miqwe and uncowed
Return washed from defilement of the dead
As says the law that all should bathe the
head

To toe when having touched in hope and
honour

The ones departed. So Paul laughs upon her

Who follows the Torah, the Sadducee.
If there is no rising from death to be,
Then why have funerals at all, says he.
That argument is vain, I say, because
What Sadducee does from the divine laws
Proves nothing of life and reality.

31 I affirm, by boasting in you
Which I have in Christ Jesus too,
Our Lord, I die daily. 32 If, in
The manner of men, I could win
The fight with beasts at Ephesus,
What advantage *is it* to me?

If *the* dead do not rise, what fuss?
“Let us eat and drink *now freely*,
For then tomorrow we shall die!”

33 Do not be deceived *by the by*:
“Evil companions corrupt good
Habits.” 34 Awake to righteousness,
And do not sin, for some *who should*
Do not have the knowledge of God,
I speak to your shame on the sod.

Paul calls the former Sadducee in Christ
A latent hedonist whose earth sufficed.
I understand his argument and yet
I think it is not fair. There’s more regret
In Sadducean thought, but this is right
That Sadducean reduction of night
And day to what the surface words of law
Repeat is only a vain and weak straw
Thrown to the Romans. Paul still does not
see

The same can be said of the Pharisee.
Yet he is right again that Christ is much
And is the thorn in Caesar’s side as such.
Beloved, I take Your Christ, but pray strip
me
Of cloak and baggage of my human scree.

35 But some might say “How are the dead
Raised up? And with what body *bred*
Do they come?” 36 Foolish one, what you
Sow is not made alive *and true*
Unless it dies. 37 And what you sow,

You do not sow body to grow,
But mere grain, perhaps wheat or some
Other *seed*. 38 But God gives it done
A body as He pleases, and
To each seed its own body *spanned*.

39 All flesh *is* not the same flesh, but
One flesh of men, another gut

Of animals, another of
 Fish, another of birds above.
 40 Also celestial bodies run
 And earthy bodies *under sun*,
 But the glory of that above
 Is different from the earthly *glove*.
 41 *There is* one glory of the sun,
 Another glory of the moon,
 Another glory of the stars,
 For star differs from star in boon
 And glory. 42 So particulars
 Also in resurrection of
 The dead. *The body's sown in love*
Though by corruption, it is raised
 In incorruption *to be praised*.
 43 It is sown in dishonour and
 It is raised in glory *to stand*.
 It is sown in weakness, but raised
 In power. 44 It is sown a *phased*
And natural body, it is raised
 A spiritual body; there
 Is a natural body *fair*,
 And there's spiritual body *rare*.
 45 And so it is written, "The first
 Man Adam became *not the worst*
 A living being," while the last
 Adam life-giving spirit *fast*.
 46 But the spiritual is not first,
 But *first* the natural, afterward
 The spiritual *comes at His word*.
 47 The first man *was made* of the earth,
 Of dust, the second man *of worth*
Is the lord from heaven. 48 As of dust,
 So also those *who're made* of dust,
 And as the heavenly, so also
 Those heavenly *in the heavenly glow*.
 49 And as we have borne image of
 The dust, we'll bear image above
 Of the celestial. 50 Now I say,
 Brothers, that flesh and blood cannot
 Inherit God's kingdom *as taught*,
 Nor does corruption become heir
 Of incorruption *and the fair*.

Paul answers Christian Sadducee who asks
 How can the body rise from earth to tasks
 Of heaven, once the body's dead and gone?
 Paul's word's a masterpiece of balance
 drawn.

The gauge of resurrection is the act
 Of making Adam of clay into fact.
 The resurrection of the Christ makes true

The possibility of raising stew.
 As Adam once of clay brought for all men,
 So Christ in waking once wakes all again.
 Not logic but structure makes argument
 And Paul is most modern in his dissent.
 Beloved, I care not for the future state.
 Awaken from sleep and death as I wait.

51 Indeed, I tell you mystery:
 We shall not all sleep, but go free,
 We shall be all changed 52 in a trice,
 The twinkling of an eye *suffice*,
 At the last trumpet. For the trump
 Will sound, and the dead *hear the bump*
And be raised incorruptible,
 And we shall be changed *to the full*.

53 For this corruptible must put
 On incorruption *head to foot*,
 And this mortal *also* put on
 Immortality *at dawn*.
 54 So when corruptible has put
 On incorruption, and this mortal
 Has put on *at the dawning's portal*
Its immortality, then shall
 Be brought to pass the *pivotal*
 Word written: "Death is swallowed up
 In victory." 55 "O Death, *speak up*,
 Where *is* your sting? O Hades, where
Is your victory *on the fair*?"

56 The sting of death *is* sin, the strength
 Of sin *lies in* the law *at length*.
 57 But thanks to God, who gives *sufficed*
 The victory through Jesus Christ
 Our Lord *in all his power and strength*.
 58 Therefore, my beloved brothers, be
 Steadfast, immovable, to see
 Always abounding in the work
 Of the Lord, knowing *not to shirk*
 That your labour is not in vain
 In the Lord *whether sun or rain*.

The sum of all the argument that stands
 Among the sects under Roman commands
 Is that all labour done for Your sweet name
 And for Your glory on earth just the same
 Is not vain, despite petty griefs and words,
 The veils of darkness that prevent the
 sherds
 From being visible to traveller's eye.
 The arguments are phantoms passing by.
 Yet stones there be, both concrete and the
 sharp

That injure foot and make me play my harp
 A sour note among all the heavenly joys.
 Beloved, look not on human toys and
 ploys.
 Steadfast, immovable, I stand beneath Your
 rain
 And count my meagre losses and my gain.

1 Corinthians 16

1 About collecting money for
 The saints, as I have said before
 In orders to the groups of called
 Out ones of Galatia *installed*,
 So *I say* you must do also:
 2 On the first of the week *or so*
 Let each one of you lay aside
 Something, storing up *to divide*
 As he may prosper, that there be
 No collections when *presently*
 I shall arrive. 3 And when I come,
 Whomever you approve *in sum*
 By letters I will send to bear
 Your gift unto Jerusalem.
 4 But if it is fitting that I
 Go also, they will go with me.

The laying aside must take place at home,
 And not in church under steeple or dome.
 There is no evidence, least of all here,
 That taking up an offering of the gear
 Is part of Pauline liturgy and dear.
 The laying aside takes place on the first
 Day of the week, after the Sabbath burst
 Has celebrated and been paid for, so
 Collection will not detract from the show
 Of Sabbath celebration, but be drawn
 From what is left after the first day dawn.
 Beloved, I leave a gift here once again
 In mind only, since I'm not in the den,
 For the poor of Jerusalem now gone.

5 Now I will come to you when I
 Pass through Macedonia (for I
 Am passing through Macedonia).
 6 And it may be that I'll remain,
 Or even spend the winter *rain*
 With you, that you may send me on
 The journey that I set upon.
 7 For I do not wish to see you
 Now on the way, but I hope *true*
 To stay a little while with you,
 If the Lord permits *me to do*.

8 But I will stay in Ephesus
 Until the Pentecost *hits us*.
 9 For a great and effective door
 Has opened to me, *on the floor*
 Are many adversaries' *fuss*.

It seems that St. Paul remembers the date
 Of Pentecost if not to celebrate.
 He could not follow calendar of Rome,
 Because there was no Julian at home.
 He could not follow that of good Hillel,
 Because he was not found in Israel.
 He may have counted by the Jubilees,
 Or by that of the cunning Pharisees
 In calculations round the moon in store.
 One just does not know what he did before.
 Beloved, my choice is Jubilees, since I
 Have taken that book from Axumic sky,
 And it above all shows the Sabbath day
 To be central in everything You say.

10 Now if Timothy comes, see that
 He may be with you without fear,
 For he does the work of the Lord,
 As I also *did where I sat*.

11 Therefore let no one despise *here*
Who girds him with the Lord God's sword.
 But send him on his way in peace,
 That he may come to me, *surcease*,
 For I expect him with the brothers.
 12 Now about Apollos, *for others*
 I strongly urged him to come to
 You with the brothers *or a few*,
 But he was unwilling to come
 At this time, but he will in sum,
 When he has a convenient time
Unfettered by my prose and rhyme.

13 Watch, stand fast in the faith, be brave,
 Be strong. 14 Let all you *do or crave*
 Be done with love. 15 And I urge you,
 Brothers, you know the household of
 Stephanas, that it is the first love
 Of Achaia, and *that* they have
 Devoted themselves all to serve
 The saints, 16 that you also not *swerve*
 Submitting to such, and to all
 Who work with labour *on the ball*
 17 I'm glad about Stephanas' coming,
 Fortunatus, and Achaicus *rumming*,
 For what was lacking on your part
 They supplied *with a loving heart*.
 18 For they refreshed my spirit and

Yours *also*, therefore recognize
All such men's *working as a prize*.

The four gates Paul expresses here are law,
And loving way, awareness, and the paw
Of truth. For law he would be watchful and
Faithful and brave and strong upon the
land.

For tariqat he follows that all should
Be done in love, each action kind and good.
For ma'rifat he praises those who serve
The faithful in all hospitable verve,
Submitting to each other being ware
Of the divine I that is each one's share.
For haqiqat he brings us down to earth
To give alms to the needy, alms of worth.
Beloved, I follow St. Paul in the way
Of loving You and Yours from day to day.

19 The groups of called out ones of Asia
Greet you. Aquila, *not to phase you*,
Priscilla greet you heartily
In the Lord, with the *artily*
Group of called out ones that is in
Their house *where they meet without sin*.

20 All the brothers greet you. Greet one
Another with holy kiss *done*.

21 Greetings in my own hand, from Paul.
22 If anyone loves not at all

The Lord Christ Jesus, let him be
Accursed. O Lord, come, *set us free!*

23 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ
Be with you, 24 and with my love *spiced*
Remain you all in Jesus Christ. Amen.

The master of the age was Jesus Christ,
And lord indeed upon the earth surpliced,
Despite the fact that earthly powers of late
Have usurped government in house and
gate.

Rome ruled its centuries and after that
Ten kingdoms in its seat and place have sat.
But through it all the master of the age
That You, Beloved, appointed has been
sage,

And each in his own time and place reigned
well

To teach the true child if not infidel.

Though masters of the age in occultation
May seem to leave the world without a
ration,

It still remains that all are cursed who say

Invisible is gone and passed away.

The Second Epistle of Paul to the Corinthians

St. Paul lays his soul bare before the crowd
That's listened to newcomers and the proud
Who claim a better place upon the cloud
Than Paul. He's strong to make a strong
defence

Of his authority for the more dense,
And to attach it to the Gospel light,
As though to reject Paul beneath Your
sight,

Beloved, is to reject the Gospel might.
I do not doubt the message, I say true:
The one who stands opposing in the pew
The underdog, will find on closer view
That he neglects the very sight of You,
Who peer out from the eye and brain of
each

Man, woman, child and slave or freeman's
peach.

2 Corinthians 1

1 Paul, apostle of Jesus Christ
And by the will of God sufficed,
And Timothy *our* brother, to
The group of called out ones of YHWH,
Which is at Corinth, with all saints
Who are in Achaia's constraints.

2 Grace be to you and peace from God
Our Father, and from the Lord's nod
In Jesus Christ. 3 Blessed be God who

Is the Father of our Lord too,
Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies,
And God of all comfort sans surcease,

4 Who comforts us in all our trials
So that we may be there with smiles

To comfort those in any mess
Of trouble, by the blessedness
Of comfort we ourselves confess
In comfort from our God's address.

5 Just as Christ's sufferings do abound

In us, so consolation's found
Also by Christ. 6 And if we are

Afflicted, it's so we may star
In your consoling and salvation,
Which is effected in the station
Of enduring the same afflictions
That we too suffer *for convictions*,

Or if we're comforted it's for
Your consolation and to pour
Salvation on you *at the door*.
7 Our hope for you is steadfast, knowing,
That since you share in sufferings'
showing,
You'll also share in comfort's *glowing*.

I share the many hopes of Paul to be
Steadfast knowing You through eternity.
I take my consolation without grief
In the greatness of Your salvation brief.
Afflicted I may be, or in my state,
Protected safely and secure with mate,
And yet through all enduring the same fate,
Whether in pain or pleasure at the gate.
Beloved, the painful letter of St. Paul
Begins to touch my heart, I taste the gall,
And yet know that compassion and relief
Continues to be poured out on the leaf
And branch and root of my life where I
stand
Before Your throne upon the silver sand.

8 For we would not, brothers, let you
Be ignorant of our hot stew
Of trouble that came to us in
Asia, so we were pressed in bin,
More than we could bear so that we
Gave up hope of life *in the spree*.
9 We'd in ourselves sentence of death,
So we did not trust our own breath,
But rather in God who can raise
One from the dead *even to praise*.
10 Who saved us from so great a death,
And still saves, and in whom we trust
That He will raise us *from the dust*.
11 You too working in prayer for us
So that thanks may be given for us
By many for the gift on us.
12 For our rejoicing is this one
Thing, the witness of our own sun
Of conscience, whose simplicity
And whose godly sincerity,
Not with wisdom born of the flesh,
But by the grace of God enmesh,
We've behaved in the world as due,
And more abundantly to you.
13 For we don't write you other things
Than what you read or know that sings,
And I trust you will admit to
The end *that what we say is true*.

14 As also you've acknowledged us
In part, so we make you joyous,
Just as you also are to us
In the day of the Lord Jesus.

Paul does not seem to be in favour great
With those in Asia, for his witness' state.
He crouches like a Pharisee to wait
On resurrection, and no other fate
Is in his mind: and he forgets the law,
Security blanket of those in awe.
The faith of Jesus grew from Paul's mistake
That Pharisean doctrine is the lake
Of wisdom. Yet he was right after all
In seeking life beyond the eager pall
Of death, in resurrection instead of
The soul immortal of Hellenic shove.
Beloved, though I am not a Pharisee,
But only reader, look in grace on me.

15 And in this confidence I meant
To come to you before as sent
So you might a second time spent
Benefit *from what I have lent*.
16 Then into Macedonia
I meant to pass from you on paw,
And come again out of the land
Of Macedonia to stand
With you, and from you to be brought
On my way towards Judaea *sought*.
18 But as God's true, our word toward you
Was not a yes or no *in view*.
19 For God's son *or servant as sent*,
Jesus Christ, preached within your tent
By us, by me and Silvanus
As well as by Timotheus,
Was not yes and no, but in him
Was *a big yes not to be dim*.
20 For all the promises of God
In him are positive *on sod*,
And in him amen may it be,
To God we give *all* the glory.

The lord Christ himself preaches in the
mouth
Of Paul, Silvanus, and man from the south
Of Greece, good Timothy, for our increase.
That does not mean that Paul is Christ
himself,
Or that Silvanus, sitting on his shelf,
Is Jesus or that Timothy like elf
Is word of God incarnate, but it means

The message was the same as like two
beans.

The working of the spirit in release
Can give each man a sign as by a fleece
That what You say is true for swans and
geese.

Let the lord Jesus speak in me today,
If only for the mingled words I pray,
If only in the closet where I stay.

21 Now the One who establishes
Us with you in Christ, God it is
Who has anointed us *truly*.

22 Who's also sealed us and has given
The guarantee of spirit to live in
Our hearts. 23 Moreover I call God
To witness on my soul, my rod
To spare you I refrained from coming
Till now to you in Corinth's *humming*.
24 Not because we have power on you
For your faith, but because we're true
Helpers of your joy, by faith you
Stand up and appear in full view.

You sealed and gave the guarantee
Of the Spirit to live freely
In my heart, but by what does that
Holy Spirit come where He sat?
I run the corridors of days
And find each morning in Your praise
The ways of life and truth and hope,
But find no spirit there to cope
Until the rest of Sabbath dawn
To seal my days with what is drawn
Of spirit to grasp truth above
What darkened soul with untouched glove
Requires to live in doubt alone.
I come sealed here before Your throne.

2 Corinthians 2

1 But I promised myself that I
Would not come again on the fly
To you to make you sad. 2 For if
I make you sad, what hippogriff
Is there to make me glad but that
One I made sorry *by my prat*?
3 And I wrote this to you so I
When I arrive should not thereby
Have sadness from the ones whereby
I ought to rejoice, trusting you
All that what makes me glad makes you
All glad as well, *and the whole crew*.

4 For with much anguish and with tears
Of heart I wrote to you my fears,
Not to make you sad but to show
My love to you great to bestow.
5 But if anyone has caused grief,
He's not grieved me to his relief
But in part only, that I may
Not overload you *on the way*.
6 This punishment's enough for such
That was set on by all your *touch*.
7 So rather you should forgive him,
And comfort so that sadness dim
Does not come to swallow up him.
8 That's why I beg you to confirm
Your love towards him, *not make him*
squirm.

I've said before human relations are
A waste of time upon this fleeting star.
No need to spend the moment to repair
The wounds imaginary on the stair.
Forget the great offence, forget the blow,
Go on to find what joy the wells bestow,
For in a moment darkness shall descend,
And there shall be but silence for the mend.
Beloved, I turn to You from all I find
To battle with, to comfort on the bind,
And set my hopes and fears aside to be
Within the glory of Your company.
The soul is just a spark before the throne,
A fleeting one upon the altar grown.

9 Another reason made me write,
So I might test you under light
To see if you're obedient
In all the things *that have been sent*.
10 Anyone you forgive, I too
Forgive, for if I leave as due
Anything to whom I forgave,
It's for your sakes *who came to save*
In the person of Christ, *God's slave*.
11 Otherwise Satan might come take
Advantage over us at state,
For we are not ignorant of
His device *hidden under glove*.

If Muggleton is right the surly guest
Is just the workings of the human breast.
There is no Satan with his burning crest,
His pitchfork and the cloven toe to rest.
Paul seems to disagree, but what of that?

Both men are dead, while Satan where they
sat

Lives on the ridicule the human view
That there is no one in Satanic crew.
Beloved, my faith is not in flesh and crease
Of wonder in some Satan with his piece
Of violence upon the golden shore.
My faith is in You only and Your store.
And so I meet the devil if by chance
Before Your very throne and where I
dance.

12 When I came to Troas to preach
Christ's gospel and I came to reach
An open door and of the Lord,
13 I had no rest in spirit since
I did not find my brother *quince*,
Titus, but when I said good-bye,
I entered Macedonian sky.
14 Now thanks to God who always makes
Us triumph in Christ and who makes
Appear the savour of his wit
By us in every place *we sit*.
15 For we are unto God a sweet
Smell of the Christ and in the treat
Of those who are saved, and in those
That perish *in their sinful woes*.
16 To one we're a scent of death to
Death, and to the other a hue
Of life to life. And who in crew
Suffices for these things in view?

I too am scent of death to death to those
Who stray into consulting of my rose
On any topic of faith that they chose.
If I inspire not doubt in every mind
I come to discuss heaven with and the kind,
I do inspire such opposition that
The man destroys his own soul and his mat.
Beloved, let me choose words with care so
I

Am not responsible here on the fly
For all the degradation that I see
Resulting from my dancing and my spree.
The soul that hears my word, the rare and
sweet,
Who plucks at it and digests it as treat,
I pray may ever live beside Your feet.

17 For we are not like those who twist
The word of God, but we have kissed
Sincerity and come from God

In whose sight we preach Christ *to prod*.

Beloved, each man who loves the Trinity
Is here to say I twist the words I see.
But I think I have kissed instead the tree
Of life and taken Your serenity
In faith that what You say's for me to do,
From unity of God through Sabbath's view,
Down to the latest nail that coveting
My neighbour's gifts prevents the heart to
sting.

If I twist Your words when I say You
meant

What You said on fair Sinai when You sent
The Decalogue on men, then let me burn
In hell for all the evil that I earn.
But if not, my Beloved, then set me free
To praise in wonder Your eternity.

2 Corinthians 3

1 Do we start to commend ourselves?
Or do we need, as other *elves*,
Letters of recommendation
To you or from you *for our fun*?
2 You are yourselves our witness borne
In recommendation, not scorn,
In our hearts, known and read of all.
3 An open letter of Christ sent
By us, written not with ink spent,
But with the spirit of God living,
Not in tables of stone as giving,
But in the fleshly tables of
The heart. 4 And such is trust in love
We have through Christ to God above.

I thank You, my Beloved, that if the pact
That Jeremiah saw was without act,
The covenant grown old through disrepair
And failure to obey among the fair,
Could not avail, there is one come to set
The tabled law on hearts of flesh well met.
The law upon the heart can then shine out
In actions of obedience without doubt,
And so contrive fulfilment that no shout
Of striving for the stones alone would let.
Beloved, let me too be letter of Christ
With ten commandments on my heart
enspiced,

And then my trust in love is justified
Above the days of failure of the tried.

5 Not that we to ourselves suffice

To think of ourselves something nice,
But we have all we need in God,
6 Who also put us on the sod
Transmitting the new covenant,
Not of the letter *and forspent*,
But of the spirit *where it went*,
Because the letter kills *in strife*,
But the spirit *of God* gives life.

When Jeremiah saw the spirit fall
Upon the hearts of flesh instead of wall
Of stone, he must have joyed to have stood
tall.

The covenant was torn by wicked vent,
The disobeying spirit as it went.
The new pact was a better way to go,
One written with no ink nor sign of show,
But with the divine spirit on the flow.
Beloved, how many still today remain
Within the covenant of ancient pain
I do not know. But I have trampled free
To find the wind is bracing on the lee.
The sharpened flint that bruised the heart
and head
Is gone, the fleshly tables spirit fed.

7 But if the service of death writ
And graved in stones was glory fit,
So that Israel's folk could not stand
To look straight that the face at hand
Of Moses for the glory of
His features, which went down with shove,
8 How can it be the service of
The spirit should not rather be
Glorious? 9 For even the fee
That was made glorious to see
Had no glory in this respect,
Another glory's in prospect.
11 For if what has been done away
Was glorious at least a day,
Much more what abides is to be
Glorious *and for all to see*.

I'm not sure that the Sabbath where I rest
Has glory greater than the day oppressed
When one who gathered sticks was called a
pest.
The same sun glories in the Sabbath morn.
The same noon hovers brightly and
unshorn
Above the new-born sprouting of the corn.
The same Psalms sound in Hebrew melody,

At least upon my Sabbaths here set free.
Beloved, the glory that has gone before
And sunk into the wrath and path and shore
Of passing tides that shall return no more
Show still the manna must be plucked anew
Each day until the Sabbath day's in view.
I spin upon Your glories for a cue.

12 So then if we have such a hope,
We use great plainness of speech *scope*.
13 And not as Moses veiling face,
So Israel's folk could not in place
Look at because of what was left
Abolished. 14 But their minds bereft
Of sight were till this day the same
Until the veil lost all its claim
In reading of old covenant
Unveiled in Christ *with a veil scant*.
15 But even to this day as when
Moses is read the veil is then
Upon their heart. 16 And yet it turns
To the Lord, veil for what it earns
To be removed and thrown away,
To follow in a brighter day.

Though covenant was always old and new,
And men tried to dispense with spirit due
As long as men have been, and others true
Have felt the spirit's pen on heart and
mind,
The first of centuries for Jewish kind
Was one of an accommodating blind.
The Pharisees dispensed with promised
hope
By scholarly in their Rabbinic scope,
And Sadducees also deflected fear
Of emperor by limiting their gear.
And so in bowing to the king they made
A veil of loss between them and the grade
Divine. Beloved, let me take no veils now
Upon my heart nor yet upon my brow.

17 Now the Lord is that spirit and
Where the Lord's spirit is to stand
There is liberty *in the land*.
18 But we all now with open face
Look as in a mirror to trace
The glory of the Lord in grace
Are changed into the image wrought
From glory to glory *and taught*
By the spirit of the Lord *sought*.

Whether I look upon the polished stone
 From Sinai set beneath Your sovereign
 throne,
 Or in the face of Your Messiah grown,
 I find just one image of grace to share,
 The divine image of creation fair,
 Of covenant and of salvation there.
 The freedom from offence is without fence
 To privatize the fields and golden tents.
 Beloved, I wander on the meadow grass
 And leave the half-score of pits in the pass,
 The stone walls crumbling from another
 day,
 Another power, another breath and way,
 And find the image of Your face the same
 No matter where I turn in whirling flame.

2 Corinthians 4

1 So seeing this service is ours,
 As we've received mercy's *new powers*,
 We do not faint *beneath the towers*,
 2 But have renounced the hidden things
 Of dishonesty and walkings
 In craftiness, and the handlings
 Of God's word with deceitful *wings*.
 3 But if our gospel's hidden, it
 Is gone from those lost and unfit,
 4 In whom the god of this world's come
 To blind the minds of them in sum
 Who do not believe, lest the light
 Of the glorious gospel in sight
 Of Christ who is God's image here,
 Should shine to them *and so appear*.
 5 For we don't preach ourselves, but Christ
 Jesus the Lord, ourselves sufficed
 To be your servants for the sake
 Of Jesus. 6 For God who did make
 The light shine out of darkness' wake
 Has shined in our hearts to give light
 Of knowledge of God's glory right
 In the face of Jesus Christ's *might*.
 7 But we have this treasure in pots
 Of earth so that the power in lots
 Of excellence may be of God
 And not of us *upon the sod*.

If image, then Christ is not God Himself:
 The image is one sitting on the shelf
 While the horse prances in the meadow and
 Chomps oats in stall beneath the jockey's
 hand.
 If image, then You rise above the stone,

The marble and the flesh in blood and
 bone.

If image, then You too are something real
 Subject, if so be, to the hand to feel.
 Beloved, I live among the mirrors here,
 Among the flames and shadows some men
 fear,
 But while the wights run wide in full
 career,
 I stop to see behind the image dear
 The object of my love, worship, and hope
 While many find their pleasure where they
 grope.

8 We're troubled now on every side,
 Yet not distressed; perplexed abide,
 But not in despair *for the ride*.
 9 Though persecuted not forsaken,
 Cast down but not destroyed *when taken*,
 10 Always carrying in the flesh
 The dying of Lord Jesus fresh,
 So that Jesus' life also might
 Be in our flesh revealed to sight.
 11 For we who live are always given
 Up to death for Jesus' sake striven,
 So that Jesus' life also might
 In our mortal flesh come to light.

The death of Jesus, what a tragedy
 That evil worked its worst on Calvary's
 tree!
 And yet each time the wicked score is
 made,
 Your grace and power bring victory from
 the grade.
 The evil one would kill the purist man,
 And by that action brought life in Your
 plan
 To all who will appropriate such grace.
 Beloved, I thank you that all harm in trace
 Is overshadowed by the power that You
 Bring to the world of shadows and my
 view.
 As I see awful snares of untold grief,
 I lay my hopes wide open to belief
 In victory of the good in every feoff.
 Upon the dark of night comes morning
 dew.

12 So then death works in us, but life
 In you *to raise you without strife*.
 13 We have the same spirit of faith

As it is written without wraith,
 I have believed and that is why
 I have spoken, we also vie
 To believe and therefore we speak.
 14 We know the One that He's not weak
 Who raised up the Lord Jesus, so
 He'll also raise us up to go
 By Jesus, and present with you.
 15 For all things for your sakes appear
 So that abundant grace might veer
 Through the thanksgiving of a lot
 Abundant to God's glory's view.
 16 That's why we do not faint, but though
 Our outward body perish so,
 The inward renews daily *glow*.
 17 For our small trouble that endures
 For only a moment assures
 For us a far greater eternal
 Weight of glory *in the external*.
 18 We do not trust in the things seen
 But in what things truly convene,
 For visible things fail in time,
 But invisible things sublime
 Are eternally *on the scene*.

The weight of glory be my burden here
 To outweigh every thing I hope and fear!
 The glory of the morning on the lake,
 The brightness of the coltsfoot I mistake
 For dandelion till I come to take
 My spectacles in hand for glory's sake,
 The silent light that patches stone and
 wood,
 All speak to me as heavenly glories should.
 Beloved, touch my brief moments with the
 trace
 Of Your eternity above my place,
 And as I live and move beneath Your care
 And step by step ascend the golden stair,
 I shall meet things invisible by sight
 Of faith after the wandering of the night.

2 Corinthians 5

1 We know that if our earthly dwelling
 Of this tent were lost in the swelling,
 We have a building made by God,
 A house not made with hands or pod,
 Eternal in the heavenly *telling*.
 2 We groan for this, ardently wish
 To be clothed with our house *and dish*
 That has come from the heaven excelling.
 3 If we are so clothed then we'll not

Be found naked *upon the plot*.
 4 We in this tent groan burdened down,
 Not that we are unclothed with frown,
 But that we might be clad and rife
 Mortality swallowed in life.
 5 So He who made us for this thing
 Is God, who also gives us wing
 Guaranteed to make spirit sing.

This earthly body is a temple too,
 The dwelling of Your spirit and the pew.
 But as the earthly tabernacle's view
 Was from the heavenly sanctuary's lieu,
 So earthly dust one day shall be
 transformed
 Into the heavenly body newly formed.
 The mortal body shall be then exchanged
 For the celestial and immortal ranged.
 Beloved, though some look for the future
 told
 In spirit immaterial and cold,
 I know that all that's real is like the gold
 Of heavenly street, and so I have not sold
 My faith for emptiness among the bold.
 You are a God not just to have but hold.

6 That's why we're always confident,
 Knowing that while we're in the tent
 Of flesh we are also absent
 From the Lord. 7 For we walk by faith
 And not by sight *of any wraith*.
 8 We're certain to be pleased to be
 Absent from the body and free
 With the Lord. 9 Then we work hard so,
 Whether present or absent, know
 We're accepted by Him. 10 For we
 Must all appear before the seat
 Of judgement of Christ and to meet
 Each one the things done in the flesh,
 Whatever he has done in mesh
 Whether a good or bad *thing fresh*.

I sat at the feet of professors who
 Taught me theology of what to do,
 And when I said that Christ is judge in
 view,
 Both they and all their students laughed me
 down
 And turned me out an outcast on the town.
 That's why I ride around with outcast Paul,
 Who has faith in the judgement seat and
 wall

Of Christ who stands behind the altar now
Before the cherubim who come to bow
Above the ark that houses Your great law
Destroying law of jungle and of claw.
Beloved, I come into Most Holy Place
By faith and find Christ standing in the
trace,
Working Atonement and judgement with
mace.

11 Knowing thus terror of the Lord
We persuade men with word like sword,
But we appear to God, and I
Trust too as your consciences try
On us you also can rely.

12 For we do not commend ourselves
Again to you like other elves,
But give you opportunity

To glory for our part and see
You may have what to give account
To those who seem a glory fount
But are not in heart. 13 If we are
Out of our minds, it's God's guitar,
But if we're sober, it's your *star*.

14 For Christ's love forces us to see
That if one died for all, then we
Are all dead, 15 and he died for all,
So the living should not install
From then on to live for themselves,
But to him who died *on the shelves*
For them and rose again *from stall*.

Contagious magic of the death on cross,
Or on the torture stake to pleasure boss,
Suggests that all are dead for whom he
died,

All who on earth and now still must reside.
The implication Paul takes from that room
Is that we should then live under that doom,
Not to ourselves but to the one who gave
His life and then again rose from the grave.
Beloved, the touch is much for me to crave
With my own ration of reason to see.
But if I must trust Paul's soliloquy,
I'll let You do Your own by Your decree.
But do not lead me in the minstrelsy
Of pagan faith. I stand beneath Your tree.

16 That's why from now on we do not
Know anyone after the rot
Of the flesh, indeed, though we've known
Christ in the body, yet now shown

We do not know him more *alone*.

Let not Paul deny Christ from in the flesh
Or he shall meet the accusation fresh
Of John who may be the one on the breast
Who loved the master when his sweat
smelled best.

The new in creaturely is good enough,
And with such no one lingers for the tough.
The transformation Paul desires is now
And not upon the future saving bough.
In that I too agree, and take Your touch
As did the ones that Jesus healed in clutch
When he was walking on the lower strand
Of Galilee and in Judaeon band.
The body must be here or there's no soul
According to Your word and human goal.

17 That's why if anyone's in Christ,
He's a new creature, old things spliced
Have passed away, and see, all things
Have appeared in their renewings.

18 And all things are of God the One
Who's reconciled us to His run
By Jesus Christ, and given us
The service of ceasefire *from fuss*.

19 That is, that God was in Christ to
Reconcile the world to the true,
Not laying to their own account
Their trespasses in their amount,
And so committed to us here
The message of a ceasefire near.

20 Now then we're Christ's ambassadors
As though God begged through us to yours,
And so we beg you in Christ's stead,
Be reconciled to God *and led*.

21 He treated him like sin for us
Though he did not know sin and fuss,
So that we might be treated as
God's righteousness in his pazaz.

The new comes on the old, the fashioned
store

Is still made up of matter on the floor.
The spirit is no wondered where and why,
But is the power to do under the sky.
By spirit of Christ caught in real death
You reconcile the world from mortal breath
And justify commandments out to gain
The happiness that reconciles the pain.
I do not war against the good that makes
The evil shrink into its wonted stakes,

But as I turn about with all my shakes
I sorrow that the treatment Jesus found
Is still upon the dance and slaughter
ground.

Treat me instead with his own righteous
sound.

2 Corinthians 6

1 As fellow workers we beseech
Also you do not in vain reach
God's grace. 2 For He says "I've heard you
At an accepted time in view
And in salvation's day have I
Helped you, behold, now is the time
Accepted, seen now is the day
Of your salvation. 3 But do try
Not to offend in any rhyme,
So that the ministry, it may
Not be blamed. 4 But in every way
Approving ourselves as God's slaves
In great patience, afflictions' *waves*,
In need and in distresses' *caves*,
5 In lashes, prison sentences,
In tumults, labours at a whiz,
In wakefulness and fasting sore,
6 By pureness, and knowledge in store,
By patience, kindness, holiness
Of spirit, and by love's sincereness,
7 By word of truth, by power of God,
By armour of righteousness' rod
On the right hand and on the left,
8 By honour, dishonour bereft,
By evil rumour and by good,
As deceivers, and true as should,
9 As unknown, and yet as well known,
As dying and see, living shown,
As chastened and not killed, 10 as sad
Yet always making glad,
As poor, yet making many rich,
As having nothing in a pitch,
Yet possessing all things in stitch.

I'd think the slaves of God should have
more sweet
Upon the noble hall and golden street,
And not dishonour, lashing and retreat.
But that's Your business, when You take
the man
To serve You, he must succumb to Your
plan.
Chastened but not killed is for time alone,
A temporary stay before Your throne,

But in the end, Your servants can't atone,
But are cast in the grave with those who
wait

The punishment for what they came to
grate.

Beloved, I'm glad that You possess all
things,
And that You have Your power above the
stings

To turn the lead to gold, and all the slings
To shreds before the wicked in their rings.

11 O folk of Corinth, our mouth is
Open to you, our heart a whiz.

12 You're not restricted in us, but
Restrained in your own mercies shut.

13 Now in return for the same thing,
I speak as to my children's wing,
Be also generous *to sing*.

14 Don't be in an illegal yoke
With unbelievers, for what stroke
Does righteousness have with the bad?

And what counsel light with the sad
In darkness? 15 What agreement is
Between Christ and Belial's fiz?

What part does a believer know
Along with the infidel's show?

16 And what agreement in there in
God's temple with idols of sin?

For you're the living God's fair room,
As God has said "I shall illumine
Them with My presence, I shall walk
Among them, and I'll be their *stalk*
As God and they will be my flock.

17 "So come out from among them, be
Separate, says the Lord, and see,
Don't touch the unclean thing, and I
Shall receive you *and by and by*,

18 "And I shall be a dad to you,
And you will be my children too,"
So says the Lord Almighty *YHWH*.

The fact that You are father of a man
Does not make him the one true God in
span

As priest and Evangelical in plan
Speak lies before communal garbage can.
The fatherhood follows the one who takes
No unclean thing upon his lips nor makes
An idol and abomination's stakes.
Not all are Your sons, but who takes the
cakes.

Beloved, make me a son or not as You
Find in Your heart to show to know and do,
And I shall lie beneath the chisel where
You sculpt the marble into chips to share
The flames of hell, but leave the body there
In beauty on the height of golden stair.

2 Corinthians 7

1 Since we have these promises, dear
Beloved ones, let us come to clear
Ourselves from all filthiness in
The flesh and spirit, *from all sin*,
Perfecting holy in God's fear.
2 Receive us, we have wronged no man,
And we have corrupted no man,
Nor have we cheated any man.
3 I don't say this in condemnation,
For I've said before in my station,
That you are in our hearts to die
And live with *you and not to vie*.
4 I'm greatly bold of speech toward you,
Also greatly glorify you,
I'm fully comforted my ration
Of joy is great in tribulation.
5 For when we'd come into the land
Of Macedonia in band,
Our flesh had no rest, but we found
Trouble on every side unbound,
On the outside was violence,
And on the inside fears' *offence*.
6 Nonetheless God who comforts those
Who are thrown down, He also chose
To comfort us by Titus coming,
7 And not just by his coming humming,
But by the comfort he gave you,
When he told us your great desire,
Your sorrow and your fervent fire
Of mind toward me, so I rejoiced
The more because of what he voiced.

St. Paul's a hardy sort, not sensitive.
He'd make a poor vicar where some folks
live.
Or maybe not. It takes a bit of acid
To keep the job and still appear so placid
And unctuous. Comfort has come into hand
From every vicar in the stifling land
When kinfolk die, when others have been
born.

St. Paul and every vicar are foresworn.
Beloved, I too would joy to see arrive
This Titus fellow, hale, sound and alive

And not a wraith or ghost about the hive.
Someone has told the bees the man is dead,
I'm almost sure of that, though in the spread
Of centuries the hat may be forlorn.

8 Though I had hurt your feelings by
A letter, I do not repent,
And though I did repent with sigh,
For I see the same letter made
You sorry for a short time stayed.
9 Now I rejoice, not in your sorrow,
But that your sorrow came to borrow
Repentance, for your sadness came
In a godly and burning flame,
So you might get damage by us
In nothing *but in righteous*.
10 For godly sadness makes repentance
Unto salvation from the sentence,
But worldly sadness works for death.
11 So see this very thing, when you
Were sad in godly sort and view,
What carefulness in formed in you,
Indeed what clearing of your due,
Indeed what indignation too,
And fear and vehement desire,
And zeal and what revengeful fire!
In everything you prove to be
Clear of the matter and its fee.
12 So when I wrote I did not write
Because of the one who for spite
Did wrong nor for the victim's grace,
But so that our care by the face
Of God toward you might take its place.
13 So we were comforted in that
You were comforted, indeed sat
In greater joy for Titus' joy
Who was refreshed at your employ.
14 For if I've boasted anything
To him of you, I do not sing
In shame, but as we spoke each thing
To you in truth, so boasting too
Before Titus too turns out true.
15 And his inward affection's more
Abundant toward you, while in score
He minds all your obedience,
How with fear and in trembling sense
You received him *come at the door*.
16 So I rejoice that I can trust
In all *things as well as I must*.

St. Paul has just made the point that the rate
Of wickedness is overturned of late

By Your grace, so that everything the devil
 Tries to do to destroy the common weal
 Is turned to victory beneath Your heal.
 Now he appears to justify his pose
 Of having hurt their feelings by his prose
 By the fact that their sorrow made them
 stop
 To repent from their sins before the cop.
 Beloved, the argument will not hold up
 Before the judgement seat of my mind's
 tup.
 Let all the world go down the gospel drain,
 But I cling to Aristotelian vein
 Of logic and demand Paul takes the rein.

2 Corinthians 8

1 Moreover, brothers, we make you
 Know God's grace that has come in view
 Of the groups of the called out ones
 Of Macedonia in tonnes;
 2 How that in a great trial of pain
 Abundance of their joy to gain
 From their deep poverty abounds
 Unto the riches of their grounds
 Of generosity *in sounds*.
 3 For to their power I bear witness,
 Indeed, beyond their power's address
 They gave of themselves without guess.
 4 They begged us with entreaties that
 We might receive the gift out flat,
 And take the job to serve the saints.
 5 And they did so, not by our plaints,
 But first gave from their own restraints
 To the Lord, and to us as by
 The will of God *up in the sky*.
 6 For that we wished that Titus too
 As he had started in the pew,
 So he also finish in you
 The same grace that you had in view.
 7 That's why as you abound in all
 Things of faith, utterance and call
 Of knowledge and in diligence,
 And in your love to us with sense
 Abound in this grace too *to fall*.
 8 I don't speak by command, but by
 The chance others give on the sly
 To prove your love's sincerity.

I'm glad to see Paul's honest at the whip,
 When he says he did not make such a quip
 By Your command, but it was just his
 rough

Way to wound everyone he saw as tough
 With his mismatching of words at the heel.
 I'm glad he does not make it divine deal.
 But every institution that instates
 A church must run roughshod across the
 gates
 Of inner temple, inner light, the grail,
 And crush the true and sweet beneath the
 mail.
 No kingdom, even David's, can rely
 On love alone and tenderness to try.
 The violence controlled teaches men why
 The earth is earth and only sky is sky.

9 For you know the grace in degree
 Of our Lord Jesus Christ, that he,
 Though he was rich, yet for your sakes
 Became poor and you through his shakes
 Of poverty might take rich stakes.
 10 And so I give my advice here:
 This is expedient in gear
 For you, who have begun before,
 Not only to do on that score,
 But also be forward last year.
 11 So now carry out the first plan,
 Just as there's a desire to man,
 So be there readiness to do
 Out of what you came to accrue.
 12 For if there be first willing mind,
 It's approved by what's in the bind,
 And not by what he lacks in kind.
 13 For *I mean* not that other men
 Be eased, and you burdened again:
 14 But rather by equality,
 That now at this time you freely
 Of your abundance may supply
 Their want, that their bounding supply
 May also your want by and by
 Fulfil, that equally you lie.
 15 As it is written, "He that had
 Gathered much had nothing to gad
 Over; and he who took up few
 Had no lack in the residue."

St. Paul knows well that institutions need
 To raise the money to feed others' greed,
 And churches thrive where badgered
 people take
 From pockets word a farthing for the sake
 Of those who serve with lifeblood to
 acquire
 The church steps and the altar and the fire.

The hand that washes others must return
 To find the chaffing reddened there to burn,
 But can console the moles with what they
 earn
 To know the tables may be turned to spurn.
 A first tithe and a second, then the alms
 Are gathered in the chest under the palms.
 Beloved, the reason I stand here alone
 Is simply as I vic, I have no bone.

16 But thanks to God, who put the same
 Earnest care in the heart that came
 Of Titus for you *without blame*.
 17 For he indeed was glad to take
 The exhortation, but the shake
 On his own account went to you.
 8 And we have sent with him in crew
 The brother, the one whose praise true
 Is in the gospel throughout all
 The groups of called out ones in stall;
 19 And not that only, but who too
 Was chosen of the called out crew
 To travel with us with this grace,
 Which is administered in trace
 By us to the same Lord's acclaim,
 And of your ready mind in frame:
 20 Avoiding so no man should blame
 Us in this wealth we treat in fame,
 21 Providing for honest things, not
 Only in the sight and the plot
 Of the Lord, but also in sight
 Of men. 22 And we have sent out right
 With them our brother, whom we've shown
 Diligent in many things grown,
 But now much more diligent by
 The great confidence with which I
 Regard you *there beneath the sky*.
 23 As for Titus, he is my mate,
 My fellow helper in your state,
 As for our brothers, they remain
 The messengers of called out fane,
 The glory of Christ without stain.
 24 So show them in the sight of all
 The groups of called out ones in stall
 The proof of your love and the rate
 Of our boasting about your state.

The paragraph, though beautiful in word
 And sentiment hardly ever so stirred,
 Has but the motive to get those who heard
 To show proof of their love and what is
 said

In boast of them in apostolic thread.
 The Bible has within its folds the mate
 Of every human sort of love and hate
 And rhetoric set out upon the plate.
 Beloved, I turn the dial, I turn the switch
 And search for something other than the
 twitch
 Of human pride and false humility.
 I look for blinding glory on my spree,
 And as I search I find in my degree
 The inner temple, inner throne's decree.

2 Corinthians 9

1 As for the service to the saints,
 There's no need I should write complaints,
 2 For I know of your attitude
 To come forward, so I was lewd
 In boasting of you to the men
 Of Macedonia again,
 That Achaia was ready then
 A year ago; and so your zeal
 Has provoked many to take heel.
 3 Still I sent the brothers to be
 Sure our boasting of you freely
 Should not be vain to bear the tree,
 As I said you may be ready;
 4 Lest it take place that some from there
 In Macedonia come to share
 With me and find you unprepared,
 So we or you be shamed we dared
 To boast of you with confidence.
 5 So I thought needful to exhort
 The brothers to go in good sport
 Before to you, and gather there
 The bounty that you had to share
 To have it ready and with care,
 And not in covetousness' pence.
 6 But so: The one who sows a bit
 Shall reap a small crop from his wit;
 And one who sows a lot shall reap
 A harvest counting up a heap.
 7 Each one, as he in heart decides,
 Not grudgingly, or pushed from prides,
 God love a cheerful giver's tides.
 8 God's able to make all gifts great
 For you, so you always in grate
 Will have enough, and so abound
 In all well doing *on the ground*.
 9 (As it is written, He's dispersed
 Abroad; He's given to the versed
 In poverty, His righteousness
 Remains for ever *in the press*.)

10 Now He who ministers the seed
 To sow, serves bread to your need,
 And multiplies your seed when sown
 To increase your righteous fruits grown.
 11 Being enriched in everything
 To all bountifulness in ring,
 Which causes all of us to sing
 To God with greater thanksgiving.
 12 The working of this service not
 Only supplies the saints in plot,
 But is abundant also by
 Many thanksgivings to God high;
 13 Experiencing this service they
 Glorify God because the way
 You submit to Christ's gospel sway
 Brings liberal hope where they stay
 And to all men *out there to stray*.
 14 And by their prayer for you, which long
 After you for God's grace in song,
 15 Thanks be to God for what He gave
 Unspeakable *from cross to glaive*.

2 Corinthians 10

1 Now I Paul myself beg of you
 By the meekness of Christ in view
 And gentleness, that I who am
 Held vile among you in the ham,
 But bold when I get off the cam,
 2 I beg you, so I'll not be bold
 When I come in there from the cold
 In confidence, with which I think
 To be bold against some on brink,
 Who think of us as if we walked
 According to the flesh *and balked*.
 3 For though we walk in the flesh, we
 Do not war after the flesh, see:
 4 The weapons of our warfare are
 Not carnal, but mighty in star
 Through God to pull down holds' strong
 bar;
 5 To throw down what assumptions mar,
 And every high thing raised in car
 Against the knowledge of God's way,
 And bring every thought in sway
 Of Christ; 6 and being at the point
 To take vengeance on every joint
 Of disobedience, when your
 Obedience fulfils its store.
 7 Do you look on the outward peels?
 If any man trusts what he feels
 As being Christ's, let him rethink,
 Just as he is Christ's on the brink,

Just so are we Christ's other link.

The first time that a saw the preaching jack,
 And peered within the painted, spotted
 crack

Of pulpit, I had fulfilled three-score years
 Allotted to mankind, as it appears.
 In wonder I gazed at the sight and thought
 Whether I'd live to see another sought.
 I looked upon both outward and the in,
 The covering and the secret in bin,
 And then turned back to run my life's last
 win.

But see! Instead of being at the spoil
 Of sixty years to meet another coil,
 Just twenty steps beyond I saw the face
 Of jack-in-pulpit in more sacred place.
 The years may or may not be ones of grace.

8 Even if I boasted some more
 Of our authority to score,
 Which the Lord's given us to show
 In edification *in glow*,
 And not for your destruction's show,
 I'd not be ashamed *that I tore*.
 9 But I'd not want to appear to
 Terrify you by letters' view.
 10 For his letters, they say, are true
 In weight and power, but he in view
 When bodily, is weak, and too
 His speech is contemptible cue.
 11 Let such a one think this, that, such
 As we are in word by the touch
 Of letters when we are absent,
 Such will be too when we're present.
 12 For we dare not make ourselves of
 The elite, or compare above
 With some that commend themselves: but
 In measuring themselves by strut
 Among themselves, they are not wise.
 13 But we will not boast of things that
 Have no measure, but by the mat
 Of the rule which God gave to us,
 Which reaches you and omnibus.
 14 For we stretch not ourselves beyond,
 As though we reached not to your frond:
 For we have come as far as to you
 Also in Christ's gospel in view:
 15 Not boasting things outside our bound,
 Of other men's work on the ground,
 But having hope, your faith increased,
 We'll be improved by your released

By our rule abundantly creased,
 16 To preach the gospel in those places
 Beyond you, not boasting in races
 Of other men brought to our traces.
 17 But the one who glories, let him
 Glory in the Lord *to his brim*.
 18 For not one who commends himself
 Is approved, but the one *on shelf*
 Whom the Lord commends *at the rim*.

The fact is self-praise is not taken by
 The rabble for their own reasons to spy.
 The truth about a man is truth no matter
 Who says it, self or any one the fatter.
 Who as well as what depends on the choice
 Of dignity the crowd gives to the voice.
 In fact Your commendation on the spot
 Of any man is rather to be got
 To detriment and loss in marketplace
 Or in the factory or churchly space.
 Beloved, praise me or not, I fit the bill
 To praise You whether you are on the hill
 Of Zion or of Sinai. Arafat
 Is just another place where I've been at.

2 Corinthians 11

1 I wish to God you'd bear with me
 A little in my own folly,
 And you indeed put up with me.
 2 For I am jealous over you
 With godly jealousy as due:
 For I've engaged you to a man,
 So I may present you *in span*
 As a chaste virgin to Christ's *plan*.
 3 But I fear, lest by any means,
 As the serpent deceived Eve's *spleens*
 Through his own subtilty, you your
 Minds should be corrupted before
 Simplicity that is in Christ.
 4 For if the one who comes is preaching
 Another Jesus we're not teaching,
 Or if you get another spirit,
 One you've not got *from us or near it*,
 Or yet another Gospel taught
 Which you've not heard that has been
 wrought,
 You might well bear with him in plot.
 5 For I suppose I was no whit
 Behind the chieftest men that sit
 As the apostles *some deemed fit*.
 6 But though I may be rude in speech,
 Yet not in knowledge *of the peach*;

But we have been made fully known
 Among you in all things as shown.
 7 Have I committed an offence
 In abasing myself as dense
 That you might be exalted, since
 I've preached to you freely *like prince*
 The gospel of God *in my stints*?
 8 I robbed other groups of called out,
 Took wages from them for my bout
 Of service to you *without doubt*.

Though rude in speech and knowledge, I
 take no
 Other Christ, Spirit, or a Gospel show
 Besides the one I find first in the row.
 There is no other Christ than in the flesh,
 Material and tangible and fresh.
 There is no other Spirit that that made
 To bring his presence and Yours on parade,
 And there's no Gospel but fear You alone,
 And praise You who sits on the judgement
 throne,
 The call to bow to You who made all
 things.
 And so I turn from other sports and rings.
 Beloved, let my rude speech and
 knowledge reach
 As far as the path beneath firs that teach
 The rosy morning and the evening peach.

9 And when I was present with you,
 And was in need, no man in pew
 Took charge of me, for what I lacked
 The Macedonian brothers backed;
 I've kept myself from being here
 A burden to you, so I'll steer.
 10 As the truth of Christ is in me,
 No man shall stop me by decree
 Of boasting this in Achaia.
 11 Why so? Because I don't love you?
 God knows the truth of *such a stew*.

The worst crimes of both word and deed
 are done,
 Beloved, from motives of love on the run.
 Hardly a man or woman is alive
 But think that with love in the heart and
 hive
 Just anything done is excused to strive.
 The one who loves can shove the dagger in
 Without a qualm, because it is no sin,
 For love, true love, has sanctified the way.

When I hear the word spoken on a day,
I know before the night has closed a ray,
That I will feel the pain of one to stay
Who for my own good and in loving pay
Destroys my mountain, opens me to grief,
Robs me blind and then smiles beyond
belief.

12 But what I do, that I will do
To stop those with a trap in view,
So their boasting like ours will strew.
13 For such are false apostles, and
Deceitful workers, changing hand
Into apostles of Christ manned.
14 No marvel; for Satan himself
Is turned to light's angel and elf.
15 So it's no great thing that his slaves
Pretend to come out on the waves
As ministers of righteousness;
Whose end shall be at the address
Of the works that they do possess.
16 I say again, Let no man think
Me a fool; yet if so then link
Me as a fool, so I can boast
A little more myself in toast.
17 What I say, I don't say by word
Of the Lord, but by foolish herd,
As boastingly when it occurred.

I'm glad that good St. Paul refuses flat
To justify his words upon his mat
With claims they come from You and
where You sat.
His all too human slight and boast is great
Enough without that hope and dying fate.
Though cynic in the thought that fools are
best
Received in every congregation's test,
His cynicism bests reality.
So it seems under every flaming tree.
Beloved, the one who says fool is in danger
Of hell-fire according to spirit's ranger,
So good St. Paul may meet his client there
Beyond the shores of brimstone and the
fair,
Beside the banquet table where they dare.

18 Since many glory in the flesh,
I'll also glory as afresh.
19 For you're glad to put up with fools,
Since you find yourselves wise in schools.
20 For you are hurt if someone comes

To bind you or devour your sums,
Or steal, or lord it over you,
Or strike you in the face *for rue*.
21 I speak as of reproach, as though
We had been weak and brought in tow.
But if anyone here is bold,
A fool, I say I'm bold as told.
22 Are they Hebrews? Then so am I.
Are they Israelites? I can try.
Are they the seed of Abraham?
So am I too, it's not a scam.
23 Are they the ministers of Christ?
I make a foolish question spliced.
I am more than they are sufficed:
In labours more abundant, and
In stripes above measure to stand,
In prisons more frequent than planned,
In threat of death more often scanned.
24 Of the Jews five times I received
Forty save one *as though reprieved*.
25 Three times I was beaten with rods,
Once I was stoned, and without sods
Three times shipwrecked, a night and day
I've been upon the ocean's sway.
26 I've been on longer trips more times,
In perils of waters in rimes,
In danger of my countrymen,
In danger of heathen again,
In perils of the town and glen,
The sea and false brethren of men.
27 I've been in weariness and pain,
In hunger and in thirst, in reign
Of fasting often, and in cold
And in my nakedness untold.

It is a human thing to boast about
The trials and temptations of a scout.
At age of sixty some still brag that they
Walked three miles to the schoolhouse
every day,
Both rain and shine and through the drifts
of snow.
Bragging about the cold and heat and show
Of weather is so common of address
That Paul does not keep me here more to
guess.
If his trials had been beyond power to bear
He would not be now bragging of his share.
True grief is deeper than the quest to speak,
And those who have seen horrors in the
creek,
If they survive at all, it's with a tongue

Fast sealed against the powers of the lung.

28 Beside those things that are without,
I bear the daily burden's rout
From care of all groups of called out.

29 Who's weak, and am I not weak too?
Who is offended, and in due
Do I not burn in offence too?

30 If I need glory, I will stand
In glory of the things in hand
Of my infirmities in brand.

31 The God and Father of our Lord
Jesus Christ, who's blessed and adored
For evermore, knows now that I
Do not and never tell a lie.

32 In Damascus the governor
Under Aretas the king's shore,
Kept the city of Damascenes
With a fort, wanting *from his spleens*
To take me and arrest *my beans*.

33 And through a window once let down
In wicker-basket from the town
Outside the wall, outside its bands
I then escaped out of his hands.

I see. Our Lord Jesus Christ has a God.
He has a Father smiting with a rod.
The Father part I suppose cannot be
A literal thing, for of progeny
Only the heathen gods are capable and
sound.

But if our Lord has any God that's found,
That sets him off from Catholic Trinity
As well as Baptist One out on a spree.
Beloved, You are my God and the God too
Of Jesus and of St. Paul in his pew.

You are my Father of a sort, since You
Created me from dust and breath and dew.
Beloved, let me down in Your baskets
when

I find I have to flee Trinity's men.

2 Corinthians 12

1 It is not expedient for me
To boast, I guess. I will make free
To speak of visions and unstored
Of revelations of the Lord.

2 I knew a man in Christ above
Fourteen years ago, if in shove
Of the body, I cannot tell;
Or whether out of body well,
I cannot say: God knows the spell;

He was caught up to third heaven's swell.

3 And I knew such a man, if he
In body or out of body,
I cannot tell, God knows decree;

4 How he was swept in paradise,
Heard unspeakable words' device,
Which it is not lawful for man
To utter. 5 Of such ones will I
Boast, yet of my own self will I
Not glory, except in the fly
Of my infirmities to try.

6 For though I would desire to glory,
I shall not be a fool for story;
For I will say the truth: but I
Refrain myself, lest any guy
Should think of me above that which
He sees me to be in the pitch.

It seems that Paul was led and taught by
one

Who trod the golden paths of star and sun,
Who opened secrets treasures of the snow
And saw the wheels of universe turn slow.
It seems the Enoch came in search of him
And brought him to the world's uttermost
rim

And there gave him the view of secrets met
Only beneath the noonday tents well set
When You, Beloved, and Your companions
file

Across the desert sands a weary mile.
Beloved, I sometimes peek beneath the veil
Of truth set round the earth and like a sail
To find the footsteps of the truly great
Still mounting on the furnace and the rate.

7 And lest I should be raised above
The measure through abundance of
The revelations, there was given
To me a thorn in flesh to live in,
The messenger of Satan to
Buffet me, lest I should undue
Be exalted above the true.

8 For this thing I besought the Lord
Three times, that it might be restored.

9 And he said to me, "My grace be
Sufficient for thee: for my strength
Is made perfect in weakness, see."
Most gladly therefore I at length
Would rather glory in my loss,
That power of Christ may rest on me.

10 So I take pleasure in weakness,

Reproaches, and in need's address,
 In persecution and distress
 For Christ's sake, for when I am weak
 Then I am strong *and at my peak*.
 11 I have become a fool in boasting;
 You made me do it with your coasting:
 Because you should be praising me
 Instead, for I'm of same degree
 As the greatest apostles tree,
 Though I am nothing you can see.
 12 The signs of an apostle true
 Were patiently wrought among you,
 In signs and wonders, mighty deeds.
 13 For in what were you kept in need
 Behind the other called out breed,
 Except that I myself with speed
 Was not a burden to your greed?
 Forgive me for this wrong *decreed*.
 14 Behold, the third time I am ready
 To come to you; and will be steady,
 No burden to you: for I seek
 Not what is yours, but you to speak:
 For the children ought not to lay
 Up for the parents, but the way
 Is for parents in children's pay.

The signs of an apostle seem to be
 Not only miracles worked faithfully,
 But also rantings against every man,
 Reproaches couched in boastings of a span.
 The sign of an apostle seems to take
 For granted that such must put out a stake
 Of gain for those who listen to his words,
 Instead of getting profit from the herds.
 Beloved, I come and go among such men
 As have no message to speak in the glen,
 As have no ear to hear a word well-taught,
 But vaunt themselves above each human
 plot.
 Beloved, I come and go, and yet I know
 You stand above the movement and the
 show.

15 And I will very gladly spend
 And be spent for you on the mend;
 Though the more abundantly I
 Love you, the less I'm loved thereby.
 16 I did not burden you, it's true,
 But being crafty I caught you
 With guile. 17 Did I make gain of you
 By any of them I sent you?
 18 I desired Titus, and with him

I sent a brother, *brave and trim*.
 Did Titus take profit from you?
 Are we not just alike, we two?
 Did we not take same steps in view?
 19 Again, do you think we excuse
 Ourselves to you? We may accuse
 Before God in Christ, but we do
 Everything, darlings, for your due.

It is perverse to plague unwilling heart
 By saying the more one takes hated's part
 The more love pours from apostolic cart.
 That is perverse in every sense I know.
 It is perversion of the human show.
 If Paul took not a cent from those who
 heard
 His preaching of the Gospel's sacred word,
 Does that give him the right to guile? Say
 no,
 Beloved, make reproach against his row.
 With Titus Paul deigns now to make a pair,
 Though he was often out to change his
 share,
 And one after another in disgust
 Left him to wallow in his lust and dust.
 Beware, Beloved, the human sort of crust.

20 I am afraid, lest when I come,
 I shall not find you but a bum,
 The kind of people you'd not be,
 Debating, envying, in wrath,
 Strifes, backbitings, and in the path
 Of whisperings, pride, and confusion:
 21 And lest when I come in intrusion,
 My God will humble me by you,
 And I'll take sorrow in the crew
 Of sinners who have not repented
 On uncleanness and unrelented
 Fornication and vice which they
 Have been committing *every day*.

Beloved, give me the faith that turns to You
 Repenting of the many things I do
 To satisfy my lust and greed and too
 The cruelty of heart that veils make true.
 Beloved, give me the faith that Paul would
 see
 Upon the folk of Corinth running free,
 Repentance of the unclean thing and more,
 The vice that is so common in this store.
 Beloved, I grasp the vision now and then
 I turn to whirl about the earthly den,

The inner temple where Your faith is taught
Until I find my step on fertile plot.
Commission of the great and small behind
Me lies the glowing of the sun and mind.

2 Corinthians 13

1 This is the third time I am coming
To you. In the mouth of two humming
Or three witnesses shall each word
Be established among the heard.

2 I told you before, and foretell
You, as if I were present well,
The second time; and being gone,
Now I write to them who are drawn
To sin, and to all others, that,
If I come again on the mat,
I will not spare, *I say out flat*:

3 Since you seek proof of Christ in me
Speaking to you not words weakly,
But among you and mightily.

4 Though he was crucified as weak,
Yet he lives by God's power to speak.
For we are also weak in him,
But we shall live with him *and trim*
By the power of God toward your rim.

5 Examine yourselves, whether you
Are in the faith; prove yourselves true.
Do you not know yourselves how that
Jesus the Christ is in your *flat*,
Unless you're reprobates *at that*?

6 But I trust that you'll know that we
Are not reprobate *in degree*.

Though Paul pretends to take the law to
task

In what's to follow in the Gospel bask,
The truth is he is steeped in fortitude
Of Torah and of Tanakh as his brood.
It does not fail. For witnesses he takes
The mouth of two or three, make no
mistakes,

That is the Torah rule. And so he makes
Of none effect protests in grace's wakes.
Beloved, write on my heart as You did then
Your law on heart of Paul and other men,
So that when I intend to do the ill,
Rejecting letter of the law and bill,
I turn around in inconsistent will
And bind my word to Your commandments
still.

7 Now I pray to God you will do

No evil; not that we should view
As though approved, but that you too
Do what is honest, though we were
As reprobates. 8 To so occur,
We can do nothing against truth,
But only for the truth *with ruth*.

9 For we are glad, when we are weak,
And you are strong: and this we seek,
Even your perfection *at peak*.

10 That's why I write these things, though
gone,

Lest being present, I'd be drawn
To use sharp words according to
The power which the Lord gave in view
To me to edify, not to
Destruction *of those in the pew*.

11 At last, brothers, good-bye. And be
Perfect, of good comfort, and be
Agreed, and live there peacefully.
And the God of love and peace be
Among you *now and faithfully*.

12 Greet each other with holy kiss.

13 All the saints greet you none to miss.

14 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ,
And the love of God unsufficed,
And communion of Holy Ghost,
Be with you each and every host. Amen.

Ah, here at last is proof the Trinity
Is the way You are manifest and free!
We've got at least here the favoured in
three.

Of course the order's wrong, that makes no
mind.

It does not say all three are God and blind.
It does not say all three are equal in
Eternity and in deity's din.

It does not say all three in substance take
The same drought of homousian mistake.
At least these small faults do not dim the
faith

Of those who hold to Trinity and wraith.
Beloved, though You were three or four or
more,
Or any number to sit on the floor,
I praise You from the throne and from the
door.

The Epistle of Paul to the Galatians

Most primitive of Baptists, I lay down

The dogma of Predestination's crown,
 Affirming that the path of righteousness
 Is not in doing but just to confess
 The act of grace that You perform in me
 By showing my total depravity
 To my dark heart, and in that act of grace
 Giving me life eternal and a place.
 But when Galatians is quoted to make
 Your blessed Sabbath keeping a mistake,
 I rise in wrath and sacred joy to say
 The return that's exposed in pagan way,
 And not rejection of the Sabbath day.
 Raise once again Your mighty arm in sway.

Galatians 1

1 Paul, an apostle (not from men
 Nor through man, but by *the great yen*
Of Jesus Christ and God the Father
 Who raised him up from the dead rather),
 2 And all the brothers here with me,
 To the groups of called out ones *free*
 Of Galatia: 3 Grace to you, peace
 From God the Father and *increase*
From our Lord Jesus Christ, 4 who gave
 Himself for our sins, that *from grave*
 To save us from this wicked world,
 According to the will *unfurled*
 Of our God and Father, 5 to whom
Be glory ever and amen.

It's not yet clear, Beloved, how sending
 Christ

Saves from our sins and wicked world
 sufficed.

But it is clear that You alone are God
 And Jesus Christ is a man on the sod.
 They have not one nature nor substance
 shared

In secret and apart from what is bared,
 But You remain the sovereign of all things,
 While Jesus Christ came in rival of kings.
 Maybe the question of such power is what
 Confuses minds that philosophy's shut.
 You will that I be saved from wicked
 thought

And act of this age and the world untaught,
 And for this sweet Paul gives glory and
 praise

To You alone for everlasting days.

6 I marvel that you turn so soon
 From Him who called you to the *room*

Of grace in Christ to seek a *new*
 And different gospel *that's not true*,
 7 Which is not other, but the word
 Of some who troubled you and blurred
 The gospel of Christ *as occurred*.
 8 But even if we, or one sent
 From heaven, preach any gospel *bent*
 To you besides the one we meant
 Let him be cursed *without relent*.
 9 As we have said before, so now
 I say again, if *anyhow*
 Or anyone preaches to you
 Another gospel but the true
 That you've received, let him be cursed
Because he spoke and did the worst.

I do not marvel that the people turn
 Away from truth as soon as they can learn
 A false way and a vision they should spurn.
 That's just the way of every heart I know.
 I too turn from the deathly gospel show
 Of Your own preaching on the mountain
 peak.

I too leave off the bread of truth and seek
 The empty husks as soon as silence breaks
 The tinkling melodies that Your word
 makes.

But what amazes me is that the sweet
 Apostle lays a curse before the feet
 Of preachers and of priests, not only those,
 But popes and bishops and uncovered toes
 Of mullah and rabbi, all set in rows.

10 For am I arguing with men
 Or with God? Or do I try then
 To satisfy men? For if I
 Still satisfied men, then would I
 Not be a slave of Christ, *would I?*

11 But I reveal a thing to you,
 Brothers, that the gospel which you
 Heard preached by me is not of man.

12 For I did not receive the plan
 From man, nor was I taught, but *it*
Came through the revelation *fit*
 Of Jesus Christ. 13 For you have heard
 Of my former doings when stirred
 In Judaism, how I drove
 Out ruthlessly called out and strove
 For God to destroy that group's *grove*.

14 And I went in the Jewish pay
 Beyond many of my own day
 And in my own nation's array,

More zealous for ancestors' way.

Beloved, You too have shown the better way

To me, a humble servant where I stay,
And given me the heavenly vision's light
To hear the Gospel of Sinai in sight.
Beloved, I too like Paul have been around
The fathers and the mothers in the sound
Of screech and caw of every Christian hymn,

And turned aside from everything so dim.
Beloved, I turn from everything I've kept
Holy apart from You, all things I've wept
To lose upon the shore of revelation.

I stand with emptied hand in heart for ration

And find my zeal unbaked until the true
Overwhelms everything I thought I knew.

15 But when it pleased God, who brought me

From my mother's womb and called *me*
By His grace, 16 to reveal His Son
In me, so I'd proclaim when done
Among the Gentiles, I did not
Straight off take counsel to be taught
By flesh and blood, 17 nor did I go
Up to Jerusalem to show
To those apostles before me,
But I went into Araby,
Then came back to Damascus *free*.

18 After three years I went up to
Jerusalem to interview
Peter, staying there two weeks' time.

19 I saw none of the other men
Of the apostles except *when*
I spoke with James, the Lord's brother.

20 As for the things I here infer
To you, indeed before God *great*
I simply don't prevaricate.

21 After that I went to the lands
Of Syria and Cilicia's *strands*.

22 I was unknown by face to those
Called out ones of Judaea's rows
Who *were* in Christ. 23 But they just heard
"The one who used to kick our turd
Now preaches the faith that he once
Destroyed in *every place he hunts*."

24 They glorified God in my *stunts*.

It may be just the problem with the child,

That he went off into the desert wild
To contemplate his vision of the light
Instead of sitting at the feet in sight
Of Peter and of James to get it right.
I'll not complain, for I too make my way
Among the claimants of the light of day
And turn aside to seek Your face alone
And come before You on Your sovereign throne.

I too am untaught by the inclement
Hand of the churchly justice on a bent.
But few there be who glorify the fact
That I turn from tradition in the act
And meet You in the desert to make pact.

Galatians 2

1 Then after fourteen years I went
Up to Jerusalem in vent
With Barnabas, and also took
Titus with *me to have a look*.

2 And I went up by revelation,
Declaring to them of the ration
Of that gospel which I preach to
The Gentiles, but privately to
Those who were of good name, lest I
In any way might run or fry
In vain. 3 Yet not even Titus
Who *was* with me, Greek without fuss,
Was forced into circumcised muss.
4 And because of some brothers false
Secretly brought in where you waltz
To spy on the freedom that we
Have in Christ Jesus, to decree
Our slavery, 5 to whom we did not
Submit for even one hour's slot,
So that the gospel truth might stay
With you. 6 But from those who in pay
Seemed to be great, whatever they
Were makes no difference to me,
God gives no man monopoly,
For those raised high add nothing to
The gospel that I share with you.

There are those visible in church and state
That seem to be appointed to Your rate
Today who do not agree with the word
That You once gave to Peter and the stirred
Apostle Paul. And yet in that time past
It seems there was a disagreement fast,
Despite the presence of renowned to cast
Authority about them everywhere
That light and love shown on the unaware.

Beloved, if in that lovely time of youth
The called out ones could not resolve on
truth,
Then how can any now appear to find
The way among the leading of the blind?
I flee to You and Your commandments
kind.

7 On the contrary, when they saw
The gospel for uncircumcised
Had been remitted to my paw,
As was that gospel recognized
By circumcised to Peter lent,
8 For He who made effective in
Peter apostleship to win
The circumcised also in me
Favoured the Gentiles to be free,
9 And when James, Cephas, and John, who
Seemed to be pillars, took in view
The grace that had been given me,
They gave me and Barnabas free
Right hand of fellowship, that we
Should go to the Gentiles and they
To the circumcised in the way,
10 Only on condition that we
Should remember the poor in fee,
Which we also did eagerly.

Though James and Peter strove to teach the
right
To every faithful Jewess' son in sight,
The others, Paul and Barnabas, were sent
To teach the Gentiles everywhere they
went.
Perhaps the different views these men
maintained
Were rooted in the fact Paul was not
stained
With imitation of another's action.
Such independence would result in faction.
Let all men be as enemies together,
Or be at one in any kind of weather,
The thing I choose is not the one or other,
To be or not to be somebody's brother,
But to submit myself in all to You
Until there is no self but what is true.

11 When Peter came to Antioch,
I came opposing face like rock
Because he was guilty, 12 when he,
Before some men came from James' See,
He'd eat with Gentiles, but when they

Came, he stopped that and stood apart,
Fearing the circumcised ones' dart.
13 The other Jews were hypocrites
With him, even Barnabas' fits
Were carried with their hypocrites.
14 But when I saw that they were not
Honest about the gospel taught,
I told Peter before *them* all,
"If you, being a Jew in thrall,
Live like the Gentiles and not like
The Jews, why do you want to strike
The Gentiles to live as Jews hike?

Paul, who's himself a Jew to Jew and yet
A Roman to the Roman when he's met,
Tells his side of the story as though all
Were in the wrong, he only on the ball.
That in itself makes me suspect his vice
Is he can't get along since he's not nice.
A Jew to Jew and Roman to such ones
Ought to mind that Peter kept to his guns
When he was willing to eat with unclean
When with unclean, and when the Jews
arrived
Was willing not to offend the survived.
Paul here refuses to accept the truth
That here's a clash of persons both in ruth,
And not a matter of heresy's booth.

15 "We Jews by nature born and bred,
Not sinners of the Gentiles' spread,
16 "Knowing that man's not justified
By works of the law *to deride*,
But by the faith in Jesus Christ,
Even we have believed in Christ
Jesus, so we'd be justified
By faith in Christ and not by deeds
Of the law, for by the works' seeds
Of the law's no flesh justified.
17 "But if, while we seek to be set
Right by Christ, we ourselves are met
Also as sinners, *is* Christ then
A minister of sin *to men*?
Not on your life! 18 "For if I build
Again what I've destroyed and stilled,
I turn into transgressor filled.
19 "For I through the law died to law
That I might live to God in awe.
20 "I have been crucified with Christ,
It is no longer I surplined
Who live, but that Christ lives in me,
And the *life* which I now live free

In the flesh I live by faith in
 The Son of God [Messiah's win],
 Who loved me and gave Himself for
 Me *to keep me within His door*.
 21 I do not set aside the grace
 Of God, for if righteousness' place
 Is by the law, then the dear Christ
 Died in vain *when he sacrificed*.

Indeed, Christ died in vain, as dear Paul
 thought,
 If by some dying any could be taught
 Obedience to You, Beloved, could be
 Set to one side and sinners left as free
 To fornicate and eat blood without blame.
 But why accuse of playing double game,
 Denying gospel, and whatever bad?
 The one who disagrees with Paul is sad.
 The issue was not this or that but whether
 The Gentile who believes, though of a
 feather
 Uncircumcised, is thereby found unclean,
 And with such ones unlawful to be seen.
 Without rejecting law or gospel many
 A scholar now says all are clean or any.

Galatians 3

1 Foolish Galatians! Who's bewitched you
 Not to obey the truth that stitched you,
 Before whose eyes Jesus Christ clearly
 Was shown crucified with you dearly?
 2 Just one thing I would have you tell me:
 Did you acquire spirit to spell me
 By deeds of the law or by hearing
 Of the faith *preached to you endearing*?
 3 Are you so foolish? Once begun
 In the spirit, will you have fun
 Becoming perfect in the flesh?
 4 Did you go through in vain *the mesh*
Of suffering, if indeed in vain?
 5 So He who gives you spirit's gain
 And works among you wonders' *share*,
 Does He accomplish it by deeds
 Of the law or hearing faith's *seeds*?

I must be a fool too, since by my name
 I am Galatian or of Celtic fame.
 Yet I do not deride the fleshly way
 Of moving toward the law in all I say.
 What of those men who pull foreskins
 today
 To try and undo circumcision's sway?

The attitude of flesh comes in a coin
 Of two sides, surely, and the twain must
 join.

Beloved, I see no wonders done in me,
 Not by obedience nor by degree
 Of spirit poured out on fraternity.
 My salvation is not reward nor care,
 But only constantly finding You there,
 My vision of Your single love's decree.

6 Just as Abraham "believed God,
 And it was counted him *in pod*
 For righteousness." 7 Therefore know that
 Those who are of faith *on the mat*
 Are sons of Abraham *out flat*.
 8 The Scripture, foreseeing that God
 Would put the Gentiles right by faith,
 Preached beforehand the gospel *wraith*
 To Abraham, *saying*, "In you
 All nations shall be blessed *in crew*."
 9 So those of faith are truly blessed
 With faithful Abraham confessed.
 10 As many as are from law's works
 Are under a curse for their quirks.
 For it's been written "Cursed is each
 Who does not continue to reach
 All the things written in the book
 Of the law, to do them *like crook*."

Alright, I added the word "crook", but see,
 Only a crook thinks he can readily
 Gain all things by obeying selfishly
 The letter of the law, as though set free
 From the one You sent to rule faithfully.
 The crooks in the established church to be
 In Palestine in the first century
 Praised the law, it is true, and kept decree,
 And yet they did it in abuse to set
 Aside Your rule and be the Caesar's pet.
 The law became for them a trap and net,
 That should have been a letter of love lost
 Not on the ones that You, Beloved, had
 bossed.
 The law alone leaves the soul tempest-
 tossed.

11 So no one's justified by law
 Before God, that is clear *with awe*
 Because the just shall live by faith,
Or faithfulness to sent one's wraith.
 12 But law is not of faith, but, "He
 Who does these things shall live *freely*

In them.” 13 Christ redeemed us from curse
Of the law, having become worse
For us; for see it has been written,
“Cursed is everyone who’s been *bitten*
Having been hung on a tree *fitting*;
14 That the blessing of Abraham
Might be to the nations in Christ
Jesus, that we might *without scam*
Receive the promise that’s *sufficed*
The spirit through faith *unenticed*.

Justified is by faith and by faith more
No doubt is sanctification in store.
The issue’s not obedience at all,
But the inheritance upon the ball.
The blessing does not depend on the rate
Of doing well before the golden gate.
But it were a perversity to state
That for that reason disobedience
Is order of the day in Gospel tents.
Beloved, I doubt the hand that takes the
 plough
And leave no furrow in the field somehow,
And yet the furrow that I leave, I trow,
Is crooked like a dog’s hind leg to see.
Plant spirals of corn to grow up from me.

15 Brothers, I speak as a man might,
A covenant being set right,
Even among folk, no one lays
Aside or adds to it in maze.
16 Now to Abraham and his seed
Were the promises made indeed.
He does not say to seeds as though
To many, but as one to show,
And to your seed, that is to Christ.
17 And I say this, the covenant
That was confirmed by God in Christ,
Beforehand, law, which is extant
Four hundred thirty years in cant
Afterwards, cannot disannul,
That it should make the promise dull.
18 For if inheritance comes in
By law, it’s no longer the bin
Of promise, but God gave it then
To Abraham by promise yea.
19 Why then the law? It came to be
Added because transgressions’ fee,
Till the seed should come in degree
To whom the promise first was made,
Ordained by angels *in parade*
Of mediation *to be stayed*.

20 Now mediator’s not for one,
But God is one *alone when done*.
21 Is law against God’s promise, then?
May God forbid, if there had been
A law revealed that could give life,
Truly righteousness in the strife
Should have been by the law *and knife*.

Paul shows himself a Pharisee at last
In that he would choose law in the last cast
If by that choice he could gain in the blast
Of death the life that he hopes for at mast.
If there had been such a law, he tells me,
That could give life beneath a greener tree,
He would have taken that instead of one
Who tried and failed to make the kingdom
 done,
As Schweitzer claimed in reading out of
 Mark.
We might as well all go and storm the park.
Beloved, in love or law, in Gospel tune,
I stand to mark my own marking in rune,
And find the way to sing as well as do
Is still revealed in visions here of You.

22 But Scripture puts all under sin,
So that the promise by faith’s bin
Of Jesus Christ might be revealed
Their heritage by faith *they wield*.
23 But before faith came, we were kept
Under the law, enclosed and swept
Into the faith that should in time
Become apparent *to our climb*.
24 That’s why the law was our
 schoolmaster
Toward Christ, so that we might faster
Be put right by faith *for our crime*.

Not true, except in local sphere that Paul
Experienced from the Romans at the wall
And from the Pharisees that make his call.
Many there be without sin at the check
Besides good Job and a man born a wreck,
And his two parents. Many more there be.
Perhaps even Joseph is one to see.
Before faith came to Paul, faith had
 brought clear
To Abraham and Moses every cheer,
So we were kept under the law before
Only by Sadducean priests in store.
But it is true that law brings to the Christ,
The one to implement what had sufficed.

25 But after faith has come we are
 No longer under teacher's bar.
 26 For all of you a God's own spawn
 By faith in Christ Jesus *when drawn*.
 27 For every one of you baptized
 In Christ have put on Christ devised.
 28 There's neither Jew nor Greek *at all*,
 There's neither bond nor free *to fall*,
 Neither be male nor female, for
 You're all one in Christ Jesus' *store*.
 29 And if you're Christ's then you've
 become

The seed of Abraham in sum,
 Heirs by the promise *set before*.

If Christ is Your son and all who join him
 In dunking in the river to be dim
 Have put on Christ, and so are one and trim
 In him, without distinction grey and grim,
 Then all are heirs of Abraham and take
 Eternal life or at least in its wake
 A share in the inheritance You make.
 The most that I see though are still about
 As man or woman despite unishout,
 So I guess just the trans is given the lot,
 Inheritance in what Your heaven has
 taught.

The others wait an operation still
 Perhaps because no one would foot the bill.
 Paul in his guile in his own words is
 caught.

Galatians 4

1 Now I say that the heir, as long
 As he's a child can sing no song
 More than a servant, though he be
 The master of all *he can see*.
 2 But he's set under teachers and
 Masters until the time to stand
 Appointed at his father's hand.
 3 Even so we, when we were small,
 Were in the bondage under thrall
 Of this world's elements withal.
 4 But when Fullness of time had come,
 God sent out His son made in sum
 Of a woman, under the law,
 5 Redeeming those under the law
 To get adoption as sons' awe.
 6 And since you're sons, God has sent out
 The Spirit of His son about
 Into your hearts come out to cry,

"Abba, Father, *don't pass my by*."

7 That's why you are no more a slave,
 But a son, and if son, behave
 As an heir of God through Christ's *wave*.

The sons who are heirs of a great estate
 Today as any day have as their fate
 The bondage to take care of what they hold
 In property to come in from the cold.
 There are some sons who dissipate the
 whole

In drink, dames, gambling on their dice of
 coal.

But such sons are by many fathers sent
 Out without their inheritance unlent.
 Beloved, let me obey the house rules where
 I take adoption on the golden stair,
 And in my gratitude or love to share
 Not entertain the thought that I might leave
 Your law to blow my nose upon my sleeve
 Or touch the ten commands to make You
 grieve.

8 But when you did not know God, you
 Did service to those that in view
 Are not gods at all *in the pew*.

9 But now, after you've come to know
 God, or rather stand up to show
 Before God, how can you turn back
 To weak and beggarly in stack,
 Wishing their bondage on your track?
 10 You observe days and months and times
 And years. 11 I fear for you *by mimes*,
 Lest I've worked in vain for your *crimes*.

Some friends of mine are sure Paul means
 to say

That You no longer keep the Sabbath day.
 But the days mentioned here are the days
 met

When those Galatians of old time were set
 To worship idols, to which they return
 By their regard for the days that You spurn.
 If any day that's kept today is one
 Of those referred to by Paul on the run,
 It has to be a day of pagan rites
 Such as Sunday, Easter or Christmas
 nights.

Beloved, though I may not know You, You
 ken
 Me and the works of all my brither men.
 Let me take neither idol nor the play

Of celebration other than Your sway.

12 Brothers, I beg you, be as I,
For I'm as you are, your reply
Did not hurt me at all, that's why.
13 You know how through infirmity
Of flesh I preached the gospel free
To you at the first faithfully.
14 And my trial in my flesh you did
Not despise nor reject, but bid
Me welcome as angel of God,
As Christ Jesus *upon the sod*.
15 Then where's the happiness you claim?
For I bear witness of the same,
That if you could have, you'd have plucked
Our your own eyes to save me trucked.
16 Have I then so become your foe,
Because I tell you straight what's so?
17 They zealously affected you,
But not well, see they'd exclude you,
So you might affect them in view.
18 But it's good to be strongly touched
Always in a good thing that's clutched,
And not just when I'm there with you.
19 My little children, of whom I
Labour in birth again till by
You is formed Christ in you come nigh,
20 I wish to be now there with you,
And change my voice, for I'm in doubt
About you *whether in the rout*.
21 Tell me, you want to be submitted
To the law, don't you hear law quitted?

What is the image then of Christ that Paul
Wishes to be written on the heart's wall?
Is it a different writing that the law
Writ on the tables of the flesh with claw?
I trow not, since the ten commandments
came
As the sound on Your tongue, Beloved, in
fame,
And Christ is said to be the word made
flesh,
And so Christ and the law must now
enmesh.
But every priest I find would take the two
And separate them from each other's view,
As though Paul prayed that law be laid to
rest
And only Christ by contrast be the best.
If Christ is contrast, he's imposter's vest,
And I am here among the devil's crew.

22 For it is written Abraham
Had two sons, one a bondmaid's lamb,
The other by a free wife's cam.
23 But the one of bondwoman born
Was after the flesh *there to scorn*;
But the one born of free wife came
By promise *and one without shame*.
24 This is an allegory too:
For these are covenants of two;
The one from Sinai's mount in view
Which genders to bondage in pew,
Which is Hagar. 25 For Hagar true
Is Mount Sinai in Arabia,
And corresponds *with tooth and claw*
To Jerusalem which now is,
And is in bondage with her biz.
26 But the Jerusalem on high
Is free, and mother of each guy.
27 For it is written, "Rejoice now
You barren who bears not in trough,
Break out and shout, you who do not
Labour, for desolate in plot
Has many more offspring that she
Who has a husband *she can see*."

The allegory that good St. Paul makes
Between Isaac and Ishmael in the stakes
May have a point to show that Israel then
Had abused law before the Roman den,
But as a guide to Jew in Palestine
It lacks the lustre of the better shine.
Fact is that Palestinian in fate
Is just as much a child of the estate
Of Abraham, and due place under sun.
Faith and the politics upon the run
Are two distinct and clever things in rate.
Beloved, save Jew and Muslim for their
brave
Witness that You are One, not in the grave,
And give the Christian too a hand to wave.

28 Now we, brothers, as Isaac then,
Are children of promise again.
29 But as then, the one who was born
After the flesh came then to scorn
The one born after spirit's bourne,
Even so it is now *forlorn*.
30 Yet what does the Scripture now say?
Cast out the bondmaid and her stray,
For the son of the bondmaid may
Not be heir with the free wife's stay.

31 So then, brothers we're not the spawn
Of the bondmaid, but of free drawn.

Truth is both sons were born in flesh to be
The answer to a promise made freely
By You, Beloved, You promised both to
come

As fathers of great nations for a crumb.
So one is not a spirit or a wraith,
The other one's not lacking in his faith.
Of one flesh are the two, one spirit made
The worshippers of One God on parade.
Beloved, though I am neither Isaac's seed
Nor Arab on a faster sort of steed,
Still I take You, the God of both, in need,
And ply the Negev with a motor till
I see the hope of Dead Sea's higher hill,
And come to rest somewhere to foot the
bill.

Galatians 5

1 Stand fast therefore in liberty
By which Christ has made us all free,
And do not be entangled in
The yoke of bondage *which is sin*.

By Christian liberty we mean today
Not to be bound by the yoke of Your sway,
Obedience to Your will expressed in law
And in the conscience of men in Your awe.
By Christian liberty today we mean
That we can eat anything on the scene,
No matter how revolting it may be,
The mouse, the serpent and the gross piggy.
Beloved, all Christians praise Your holy
name

That You sent Your Son to bear cruel
shame
So they could be released from burdens that
Prevent them from eating the good fried
rat,

And so permit them to lay obligation
On Sabbath day on every tongue and
nation.

2 Behold, I Paul say to you, if
You get circumcised for a chaff
Christ cannot benefit your skiff.

3 For I testify once again
To every man who's in the den
Of circumcision, that he's just
A debtor to the whole law's must.

4 Christ has become useless to you,
Who are justified by the due
Of the law; you've fallen from grace.
5 For we through the Spirit in place
Wait for the hope of righteousness
By faith. 6 For in Jesus Christ's dress
Neither circumcision avails
Nor uncircumcision entails,
But faith which acts of love *in sails*.

I guess I fell from grace before the time
That I started to speak in metered rhyme.
I fell from grace when just a baby born,
Hardly a week old in the winter's scorn,
When I was circumcised and thus set out
Of bounds of the saved in Christian
redoubt.

I'd rather, for my place, take all the law,
Including the small shovel held in claw
To bury excrements, than to join in
The law of jungle and Methodist din
Of pagan worship taught by pagan drum
To shout Your praises out instead of hum.
Beloved, forgive my great rebellion here
As I cling to the Word that I hold dear.

7 You did run well, who hindered you
From obeying the thing that's true?
8 This persuasion does not come from
Him who calls you *where you should come*.

9 A little yeast leavens the whole.
10 I trust you through the Lord in toll
That you will not intend a goal
Other than this, but the one who
Troubles you shall bear his blame too,
Whoever he may be in view.

11 And I, brothers, if I still preach
Circumcision, why do I reach
Pain of the persecutor's screech?
Then is the offence of the cross
Ended and it has come to loss.

12 I wish that they were cut off who
Come in to trouble all your crew.

I guess that Paul desires his foes to be
Circumcised once more and this time's
degree

To take six inches instead of just bit
Of the foreskin between the legs that sit.
He wants to cut off everyone who chides
The freedom of his hopes and hopeful
sides.

Beloved, I know You do love Paul as well
 As all apostles You've not sent to hell,
 And so I let them at it for a spell
 To quarrel among themselves while I reap
 The benefit of Your Word in a heap.
 The circumcision has no weight with me,
 Who merely come on Sabbath from the
 spree
 Reciting Psalms and Torah faithfully.

13 For brothers, you've been called to be
 Free, only don't use liberty
 For an occasion to the flesh,
 But by love serve each other *fresh*.
 14 For all the law's fulfilled in one
 Word, this: you'll love your neighbour done
 As you love yourself *on the run*.
 15 But if you bite and eat each other,
 Be careful you're devoured by brother.
 16 I say then, "Walk in Spirit's way,
 Not to fulfil flesh-lust in sway."
 17 For flesh lusts against Spirit's sway,
 And Spirit against fleshly way,
 And these are in conflict, so that
 You cannot do the good you're at.

Serve or be served, I think the liberty
 Not to take chances of the fleshly spree
 Is one so rare in modern company
 That any who refrains from sin must keep
 It secret from the church or learn to weep.
 Beloved, let me not serve the flesh, and I
 Will serve Your sanctuary writ on high,
 And in that service find the smoke and
 scent
 A blessing on a life though fleshly meant.
 But when love folds the course of golden
 days
 And takes the carriage out for divine praise,
 I'll kneel myself before the quandered
 maze,
 Until the song of liberty rings down
 And silence of the darkness quijs the town.

18 But if you're led by Spirit, you
 Are not under the law *to stew*.
 19 Now the works of the flesh are clear:
 Adultery, fornication dear,
 Uncleaness, lasciviousness too,
 20 Idolatry, witchcraft in view,
 Hatred and variance to do,
 And emulations, wrath, and strife,

Seditions, heresies as rife,
 21 Envy, murders, and drunkenness,
 And revellings and like address:
 Of which I tell you as I've told
 You in times past, that those who're bold
 To do these things shall not for rod
 Inherit the kingdom of God.
 22 But fruit of the Spirit is love,
 Joy, peace, longsuffering, gentle shove,
 Goodness, and faith, meekness in claw,
 Temperance, against such is no law.
 24 And those who're Christ's have crucified
 The flesh with its attractions wide
 And its lusts *taken on the side*.
 25 If we live in the Spirit, let's
 Also walk where the Spirit sets.
 26 Let's not hope for vain glory then,
 Provoking one another's *wen*,
 And envying each other's *den*.

Paul says we are not under any law,
 And then goes on denying it in paw.
 He says that those who break the law shall
 not
 Enter into the heavenly sort of plot.
 He then describes the fruit of Spirit done,
 And says no law prohibits such a run.
 In so doing Paul makes appeal two times
 To law belaboured for both joy and crimes.
 Beloved, I flee the arguments of men,
 Of Jews of the first century, again
 Of Romans out to conquer every glen.
 Instead, Beloved, I take Your Word as true
 And telling me the things I ought to do
 Whether or not I sit upon a pew.

Galatians 6

1 Brothers, if a man's caught in fault,
 You who are spiritual in malt,
 Restore that one in meek *result*,
 Minding you too *in some Gestalt*
 May be tempted *to fall or halt*.
 2 So bear each other's burdens, and
 In that way fulfil Christ's command.
 3 For if a man thinks he is great
 When he is nothing, blind's his state.
 4 But let each man test his own work,
 And so rejoice he does not shirk.
 5 For every man shall bear his own
 Burden *of life here and alone*.
 6 Let him that is taught in the word
 Provide his teacher from the herd.

7 Don't be deceived, God is not mocked:
For what a man sows, he'll reap chocked.

I've had a teacher or two that prevailed
To teach me something of Your Word well-
scaled.

But the most valuable of such I met
With only thanks and no provisions set.
By the same token, I've taught many here
In this dark world and full of grief and fear
Who benefited from the things I said
About the revelation here outspread.
I've taught with and without a cent in pay,
And given where there was a hope of ray,
Until the coming of the better day.
Beloved, I sit at Your feet now and then,
More than I sit at feet of any men,
And find Your teaching free in forest glen.

8 For he who sows to his flesh must
Of the flesh reap corruption's dust;
But he who sows to Spirit's way
Shall of the Spirit reap the sway
Of everlasting life *to play*.

9 And let us not be weary in
Well doing; for in due season
We shall reap, if we do not spin.

10 As often as we have the chance,
Let us do good to all who dance,
Especially of household of faith.

11 You see how big letters in wraith
I've written with my own hand's lance.

Well-doing is not something Paul rejects,
Although I get that thought from the
suspects

Who claim to be the bishops of the church.
They tell me that the only thing on perch
Is faith in blood of Christ, Tammuz or
Baal,

Dionysos before the holy grail.

I let them spout for all they're muddy worth
Until they choke upon their sunken dearth.
Beloved, the spirit and the spirit's way
Is performed in the flesh, let Jesus say,
Since he came in the flesh to make men
gay.

No wonder Paul writes big when he makes
clear

That doing well is not a thing to fear
But rather reasoned way to go and steer.

12 As many as desire to make
A fair show in the flesh, they take
You to be circumcised; unless
They should suffer at your address
Some persecution for the cross
Of Christ, as though they were at loss.

13 For neither they themselves who are
Circumcised stay to keep the law;
But wish to have you circumcised
To glory in your flesh revised.

14 But God forbid that I should boast,
Except just in the cross at most
Of our Lord Jesus Christ, by whom
The world is crucified in room
To me, and I to the world's doom.

15 For in Christ Jesus there avails
Neither circumcision in sales,
Nor uncircumcision, but just
A new creature *rose from the dust*.

16 And all who're acting by this rule,
Peace be to them, and mercy's *school*,
And on God's Israel *as must*.

17 From now on do not bother me,
For I bear marks in my body
Of the Lord Jesus, *set me free*.

18 Brothers, the grace come down again
Of our Lord Jesus Christ to men
Be with your spirit, and amen.

Paul lashes out with hurt pride and with
flesh

Bruised by the persecutions he finds fresh
Amid the Pharisees of his own ilk
Who will not eat the meat while drinking
milk.

He lashes out, and then he calls a truce,
Refuses to response to drinking juice.
So I shall let him bear his marks in peace.
The truth is resolution for his fleece
Was never found, the stalemate set the
course

For everything in that century's divorce.
It's only later that Paul wins the day
By being taken in the canon's sway,
Despite abuse of exegete and priest,
The ones who pretend flesh is now
released.

The Epistle of Paul to the Ephesians

Ephesians writ in prison for the sake

Of showing that Your "church" beside the
lake

Of fire is not a papal crown or crutch
Held by the bishop for as less or much,
Or yet a body not seen in the fair
But unsubstantial for excuse to wear
Another habit and another crown
Made by the great reformers of renown,
But that body of those called out to be
Under Your Christ's current authority.
Beloved, I leave the church and synagogue
And mosque to join with two or three
incog,

And find reciting Your Word that You send
Again Your Christ among the tethered end.

Ephesians 1

1 Paul, apostle of Jesus Christ
By the will of God, and sufficed
To the saints in Ephesian town,
And to the faithful *light and brown*
In Christ Jesus. 2 Grace be to you,
And peace, from God our Father true,
And from the Lord Jesus Christ too.
3 Blessed be the God and Father dear
Of our Lord Jesus Christ come near
To bless us with all spiritual things,
Blessings celestial in the rings
Of Christ: 4 According as He chose
Us in him before the world rose,
That we be holy and without
Blame before him in love's redoubt:
5 Having *kindly* predestined us
Unto adoption without fuss
Of children by Jesus Christ to
Himself, according to the due
Good pleasure of His will in view,
6 To the praise of the glory in
His grace, wherein He's put in bin
Acceptance of us in love's *grin*,
7 In whom we have redemption through
His blood, forgiveness of sins, too,
According to wealth of his grace
8 He's multiplied towards our face
In all wisdom and prudence found;
9 Having made known to us the ground
In mystery of his will, and by
His good pleasure he has brought nigh:

I'll interrupt the common flow of thought,
The words most welcome that St. Paul has
brought,

Congratulating his apostle's lot
To mention that You are, Beloved, both
God

And Father of Christ sent in earthly pod.
If You are both his father and the great
God set above the man in glorious state,
Then I can rest assured that he's the mate
I need to know that You are one and not
Three or four in a wicked sort of plot.
Beloved, both God and Father of each man
And woman born on earth by divine plan,
Your pleasure be my pleasure, if You can,
In every way and borough where I ran.

10 In dispensation of the full
Times he might gather in one pull
All things in Christ, both which are in
The sky and on earth, in his bin:
11 In whom also we have obtained
Inheritance, as fore-ordained
According to his purpose who
Works out all things by his will true:
12 That we should be his glory's praise
Who first trusted in Christ's *own ways*.
13 In whom you also, when you heard
The word of truth, and so were stirred
By gospel of your salvation:
In whom too after you had done
Believed, you were sealed by the run
Of Holy Spirit's promised fun,
14 Which is the guarantee that we
Inherit until faithfully
The purchased gain is so redeemed
To the praise of His glory deemed.
15 That's why I too, after I heard
Of your faith in Lord Jesus stirred,
And your love to all the saints' herd,
16 Do not stop giving thanks for you,
As I mention you in prayers' pew;
17 That the God of our Lord Jesus
Christ, the Father of glory does
Give you the spirit of wisdom
And revelation that shall come
In the knowledge of Him in sum.

Beloved, I'm glad to know that You are
God
Of our Lord Jesus Christ come on the sod.
Some teachers and some preachers try to
tell
Me that Jesus himself just out of hell
Is God instead of You. So ring a bell.

Beloved, I'm glad to show that You remain
A God above all saints and sinners' gain.
Some reachers and some screachers try to
say

That Jesus is both God the Son in sway
And man on cross to put my sin away.
Beloved, I'm sad that falsehood graces
church

And meeting place where good and wise
still perch,

But glad to find when I look round for You,
That You are one in throne, in heart, in
pew.

18 So may your understanding's eyes
Be lightened, so you may apprise
The hope of His calling and wealth
Of the glory in saints with stealth
Of His inheritance, 19 and what
The very greatness comes to strut
Of His power towards us who believe,
According as the work receive
Of His great power *come to relieve*,
20 Which He accomplished in Christ, when
He raised him from the dead again,
And set him at His own right hand
In heavenly places *there to stand*,
21 Far above principality,
And power and might, dominion's sea,
And every name that's named to be,
Not only in this world, but in
That one also to come in bin.
22 He's put all things under his feet,
And set him head over complete
Group of the called out ones for treat,
Which is his body *and soul's seat*,
So his Fullness fills all *you meet*.

You did some wonders for Jesus the Christ.
You raised him from the dead. If that
sufficed,

You set him over all the other guys
And made him chief of staff before Your
eyes.

There are some ingrates who pretend that
he

Did everything by his own power and fee,
And give You not slightest credit's degree.
I'd think he'd be embarrassed by such tries.
Beloved, I'm sure the man's grateful at that.
He did not tell folk to call him out flat
A God the Son, a second person of

The Trinity upon the throne above.
So overlook the error on his part,
He certainly refuses all the art.

Ephesians 2

1 You too, who were dead in trespass
And sin, 2 wherein you paced morass
According to this world's compass,
According to prince of air's power,
The spirit that works at this hour
In spawn of disobedience.

3 Among them also we once strayed
In times past in flesh lusts betrayed,
Fulfilling the desires of flesh
And of the mind, being in mesh
Of the children of wrath's *suspense*.

4 But God, who is rich in mercy,
For His great love to us freely,

5 Even when we were dead in sins,
Enlivened us to be in *bins*
Of Christ, by grace saved in decree;

6 And raised us up together, and
Made us sit along in *the band*
Of heavenly in Christ Jesus' *stand*:

7 That in the ages to come he
Might show the great wealth *there's to see*
In his grace in his kindness set
Towards us through Christ Jesus *when met*.

Not by death but by resurrection we
Join in the life of sanctified and free.
Not on the earthly mat but heavenly,
Within the sanctuary by the sea
Of glass I find the riches laid in store,
The silver sands, the shining golden shore.
Not by death but by resurrection wrought
To stand with Christ within the temple
sought,

The inner altar barren of all pride,
Celestial vision of the sanctified.
Beloved, upon the throne You look abroad
With sight and insight known only to God,
And find above the incense of new prayers
The throng of saved who clamber up the
stairs.

8 For by grace are you saved through faith;
And that not of yourselves or wraith,
But gift of God. 9 Not of works so
Anybody'd boast of his show.

10 For we're His workmanship, created
In Christ Jesus to works elated,

Which God's ordained before that we
Should walk in them *and faithfully*.
11 Wherefore remember that you were
In times past Gentiles in flesh blur,
Who are called uncircumcised by
Those who are circumcised to try,
In the flesh made by hands *that die*.
12 At that time you were without Christ,
As strangers from Israel unspliced,
Unknown to pacts of promise and
Without a hope or God to stand.

I'm saved by works indeed, but not my
own,
As I am one created by Your loan,
So am I entered in salvation's share,
To stand upon a green and silver stair.
I'm saved by no faith in my power to grieve
Nor in the power creation must receive,
But as Your workmanship upon the bench,
Shoemaker, if You will in wielding
wrench.
Beloved, though I may be a stranger here,
Or I may be one born or one made dear,
My flesh replies to spirit where You steer,
And I know hopes beyond the fatal fear.
Beloved, though I may be clasped close to
You,
I may or may not sit upon the pew.

13 But now in Christ Jesus you who
Before were far away in crew
Are brought near by Christ's blood *in view*.
14 For he's our peace, who's made both
one,
And broken down the wall once done
Between; 15 Abolishing in flesh
The enmity, which is the mesh
Of statute law in ordinance;
To make in himself of two's dance
One new man, so peace *in expanse*,
16 So he might reconcile them both
To God in one body *of growth*
By the cross having slain thereby
The enmity *of every guy*.
17 He came and preached Islam to you,
Or peace, when you were distant crew,
And to those nearby *in his view*.
18 For through him we both have access
By one Spirit Father's address.
19 So then you are strangers no more
And foreigners, but of the store

Of citizens among the saints,
Of God's own household *and restraints*.
20 You're built upon foundation of
Apostles, prophets, and the love
Of Jesus Christ himself to be
The head corner stone in degree.
21 In him all the building fitly
Is framed together growing to
A holy temple in Lord's due,
22 In whom you too are built together
For a dwelling of God and whether
Through the Spirit *come into view*.

He is our peace, he has become Islam,
According to the Pauline words of balm.
It's true that Christ is the one grateful link
Between the Christian and the Muslim
blink.
They both believe in Christ, though both
will stare
With odd suspicion of what each might
wear,
They both believe in the last day and share
Most of their prophets and books in the
glare
Of angels landing beside them both there.
Partitioners still stand, let reader beware
To find a lash instead of comfort's care.
Beloved, see how the silences reveal
Better than shouts and bombs the things we
feel
Who come before You without name to
heal.

Ephesians 3

1 That's why I Paul am caught in chains
Of Jesus Christ for all your fanes
Of Gentiles, 2 for if you have heard
Of God's grace dispensation stirred,
Which is given me to give to you,
3 How by that revelation true
He showed me the mysterious view;
As I wrote before in words few,
4 By which, when you read, then you may
Understand my knowledge in sway
Of the secret of Christ, his way,
5 Which in other times was not made
Known to the sons of men *afraid*,
As it is now revealed unto
His holy apostles in crew
And prophets by the Spirit due;
6 That the Gentiles should be heirs too,

And of the same body, to take
Part of His promise in the wake
Of Christ by his Gospel, 7 of which
I was made minister in stitch,
According to the gift of grace
Of God vouchsafed me by the pace
Of His power working *in this place*.

Paul claims the way of Christ was secret
when
The books of Tanakh were read among
men,
And is but now revealed as he writes down
The lovely words to everyone in town.
He claims the great message that Gentiles
are
Co-heirs with Israel and also star
Is something new. And yet I myself wake
To so slight glimmers in prophetic stake.
Beloved, if Gospel hope is new and met
In secrets told at last to stranger pet,
Then those who find the Trinity is set
In early Scripture find themselves all wet;
And those who bow to solar gods raised up
Are just rebellious like a jumping tup.

8 To me, less than the least of all
The saints, is this grace given tall,
That I should preach among the men
Of Gentile extraction again
Unsearchable riches of Christ;
9 And to make all see what in tide
Is fellowship's secret to bide,
Which from the start of the world lay
Hidden in God, who made to stay
All things by Jesus Christ sufficed:
10 To the purpose that now unto
The principalities in view
And powers in heavenly places' pew
Might be known by the called out crew
Many-splendoured wisdom of God,
11 According to eternal prod
Which He purposed in Christ Jesus
Our Lord: 12 in whom we have boldness
And access with confident trust
By faith in him *upon this dust*.

Unsearchable the riches of the way
That Christ rode on a donkey and a bay
No doubt Paul means. The sun is hot to
stay
On old Jerusalem, and donkey's feet

Give rest to those who've had too much to
eat.

Unsearchable the riches and renown
Of Jesus, who rode the waves under crown
Of Caesar till the fishermen had set
The ripples with a hopeful sort of net,
No doubt are ready for the fish they get
Once broiled upon the shore by Jesus' hand.
Beloved, I too find riches where I stand,
The dogwood past the bloom, the milkweed
met,
The locust in the pod, and all You've
planned.

13 So I hope that you do not faint
At my trials for you *each saint*
Which is your glory. 14 For this cause
I bow my knees weakened like straws
Before the Father of our Lord
Jesus the Christ *and one adored*,
15 Of whom the wholly family in heaven
And earth is named *in weeks' days seven*,
16 That He would surely grant to you,
According to His glory's stew,
To be made stronger with the might
Come from His Spirit, inner light;
17 That Christ may dwell in your hearts by
Faith; that you being made thereby
Rooted and grounded in love's eye,
18 May be able to comprehend
With all saints what is the breadth's end,
And length, and depth, as well as height;
19 And know the love of Christ in sight,
Which passes knowledge, so you might
Be filled with all God's Fullness right.
20 At last to the One who can do
Much greater than we ask and view,
According to the power that acts
Among us *to reveal the facts*,
21 To Him *be* glory in the group
Of called out ones who have the scoop
By Christ Jesus to generations
Among people of all the nations,
Forever and ever. Amen.

I have the scoop on You, Beloved, and
thank
You for the things You do for me point-
blank.
What is the percentage of what You give
That I'm aware of down here where I live
To that I do not see or mind or know?

It's like an iceberg with a tip to show.
I'd give You glory for the unseen too
If I had any way to follow through.
But fact is though I give my all, I find
I've given only what You left behind.
And so I bring my empty hand and heart
For You to fill again to do my part
In thanks and service where I fail to earn
My keep, but ever live to love and learn.

Ephesians 4

1 I therefore, prisoner of the Lord,
Beg you to walk worthy restored
Of the calling by which you're called,
2 With all lowliness, meekness thrall'd,
With patience, putting up each one
With every other till you've done;
3 Trying to keep the unity
Of Spirit in peace bond's degree.
4 One body and one Spirit free
As you are called in one hope's fee
Of your vocation; 5 and one Lord,
One faith, one baptism restored,
6 One God and Father over all,
Who's above all, by all and tall
Among you every one *adored*.
7 But unto every one of us
Is given grace by fist and fuss
By the gift of Christ in accord.

The secret of the ages that was kept
Until the coming of Messiah swept
St. Paul up in its glory and its flame:
That one God implies that men are the
same
In every time and place, all one beneath
The fatherhood of God, encircling wreath.
The cry of debate on the Trinity,
The Arian sword, the Muslim Unity,
All raise the veils so none of them can see.
But when the veil is broken in the flesh
Of the word that You sent, Beloved, as
fresh
In Jesus' Gospel that all men are One
Alone reveals Your unity well spun
Beneath the rolling of the somber sun.

8 That's why he says, when he went high
He led captivity thereby
Captive, and gave his gifts to men.
9 Now that he is ascended, then
What is it but that he also

Descended first into the low
Parts of the earth? 10 He who went down
Is the same too that met the crown
Gone up above all heavens' renown,
To fill all things. 11 And he gave some
Apostles, and some prophets, some
Evangelists, some pastors come
And teachers, 12 for perfecting saints,
For work of service, no complaints
In building the body of Christ:
13 Till we all come in unity
Of faith, and in knowledge sufficed
Of God's Son, and to full degree
Of a man, to the measures more
Of the height of Christ's full rapport.

Beloved, when Your Christ went above to
sit

Upon the throne of glory as was fit,
He sent on men the gifts of spirit made
To give perfection to human parade.
I stand imperfect, not by what You gave
To me in life and love, but as a slave
Unfitted by distrustful doubt unbrave.
Work out perfection on Your chip of
knave.

Then I may be one with the great and small
Who make up those answering to Your call
And find within that answering the power
To be one perfect in Your heavenly bower
Till full degree of man's eternity
Beneath the life and under the life's tree.

14 So we are children no more tossed
Back and forth, and carried and lost
About with every teaching's wind,
By sleight of men and cunning sinned,
Lying in wait where to deceive;
15 But speaking the truth in reprieve,
May grow up into him in all,
Who is the chief, Christ *on the ball*;
16 From whom the whole body is joined
Together rightly and closed coined
By what supplies each joint and by
The fine working in measure high
Of every part, he makes increase
Of the body to build in peace
Itself in love *never to cease*.

The winds of doctrine cause disunity
Of the body of those called to be free

In Christ. Such winds are from tradition's
sands,
Not from the failure of the Bible lands.
I lay aside the things I see to be
Important and true in futility,
And take the simple creed of Decalogue,
And leave the wranglings of matters in fog
To those who wish to find a greater will
Beyond the lovely words, Beloved, You
spill.
But when I take that word alone, I find,
Despite the calling of the deaf and blind,
That I must stand alone without the help
Of body united upon the whelp.

17 So I say this and testify
In the Lord, that you walk thereby
Not as the other Gentiles walk,
In vanity of mind and talk,
18 With understanding darkened, and
Separated from God's life's hand
Through ignorance that is in them,
Because of their heart's blindness' hem:
19 Who are past feeling and turn out
Into their lustfulness in rout
To work all uncleanness with greed.
20 You've not learned such from Christ to
heed;
21 If it be that you've heard him, and
Have been taught by him, as the band
Of truth is in Jesus' command:
22 So put off the old way to act
Of the old man, corruptions' pact
According to deceitful lusts,
23 Renewing your mind's spirit's crusts;
24 So you can put on the new man,
Which according to God in plan
Is created in righteousness
And set up in true holiness.
25 So putting away lies and speak
Each one truth with neighbour to peek:
For we are each other's to seek.
26 Be angry, but refuse to sin,
Let not the sunset see the din
Of your wrath; 27 and do not back down
Before the devil *or his frown*.
27 The one that stole, let him no more
Steal anything from neighbour's store;
But rather let him work the more
With his hands in what things are good,
That he may give alms as he should.
29 Let no corrupt words proceed out

Of your mouth, but that which is stout
To use of edifying, that
It may serve grace to those who hear.
30 Don't grieve God's holy Spirit near,
By which you're sealed to the day at
Which your redemption shall appear.
31 Let all bitterness, anger, wrath,
Clamour and evil speaking's path
Be put away from you, with all
Malice: 32 And be you kind withal
To one another, tenderhearted,
Forgiving one another parted,
Just as God for Christ's sake in due
Has deigned here and forgiven you.

So Peter Grimes is proof that folk today
Know what they do, but don't care anyway.
The prayer of Christ for ignorance when
due
Upon the cross no longer is in view.
It is not with hate that we kill the few,
No hate kills the unwieldy, but distraction,
A slighter irritation for exaction
Of moments from the entertainment that
Informs the cultivation of the cat.
Beloved, the Christ forgives the ignorant
Who just obey their orders on the scant
And barren ground beside Jerusalem.
Does that forgiveness extend to the hem
Of the clear knowledge that some men
must die
To keep oil prices arched against the sky?

Ephesians 5

1 So be you followers of God,
As dear children; 2 walk on the sod
In love, as Christ also loved us,
And gave himself offering for us
And sacrifice to God to be
In a sweet-smelling savoury.

I do not doubt that Christ gave himself then
An offering for the good of earth and men.
What I doubt is the sweetness of the smell
That rose up from the cross and from its
hell.

If Christ is Your Son smitten on the sod,
The smiting can bring no joy to his God,
But only horror at the sound and clank,
The swelling and the burning and the dank.
Beloved, I offer naught of self to You,
Nor any sacrifice of what is due,

But only pray the pain of offering set
Upon the cross may never more be met
My flesh of man nor heart of God, and yet
Find life eternal still come into view.

3 But fornication, all uncleanness,
Or covetousness in its meanness,
Let it not be named among you
As it becomes saints *in their pew*.

I think I know perhaps in clarity
What fornication may be, and I see
What coveting may fill a heart freely;
But I'm not sure which uncleanness is
meant

By Paul to the Ephesians when he sent.
Uncleanness of the lack of alms in way
Of the Islamic thought, or unclean pay,
Or the unclean without ablutions' stay,
Or unclean of uncircumcised ninth day,
Or unclean of the slaughtered with the
blood,
The carcass of the swine and mouse in
flood,
Of all these which does Paul mean here to
find?

Perhaps he takes uncleanness of the blind,
The leprous or the mildew on the grind.

4 Neither engage in filthiness,
Nor foolish talking nor address
Of jesting, which are not wholesome:
But rather give thanks *on the hum*.

Beloved, forgive my jesting in the name
Of health and hope, and even for my fame.
I swear, or would if scruple did not take
Me off the oath to set me at the stake,
That all my jokes are meant not in some
fun

Or entertainment while sitting on bun,
But show the barest heart reality
Burns on my soul and eye eternally.
Beloved, my jests return on my own pate,
Because they strike the welkin of my fate,
Where You are caught betimes and
unawares.

It's You who set my jokes down and with
flares

Illuminate the gold and silver stairs,
Reveal the starkness of some men's pale
glares.

5 For you know no whoremonger nor
Unclean person, nor covetous,
Who is idolatrous the more,
Has any inheritance in
The kingdom of Christ and God's bin.
6 Let no one deceive with vain word:
For because of these things come stirred
The wrath of God upon the spawn
Of disobedience outdrawn.
7 Don't be partakers with them then.
8 For you were sometimes in the den
Of darkness, but now in the light
Of the Lord: so walk as light's men.
9 For the fruit of the Spirit's in
All goodness and righteousness' bin
And truth; 10 Prove what's acceptable
To the Lord. 11 Do not feel the pull
Of darkness' unfruitful works, but
Rather reprove them *to the gut*.
12 For it's a shame even to speak
Of those things which are done to peek
Of them in secret. 13 But all things
That are reprov'd are appearances
In the light: for what makes appear
Is the light *all around and clear*.

What is acceptable, Beloved, to You?
I need no thick book to say what to do.
Ten words alone suffice, and without Paul.
The message is clear in my bin and stall.
The law of that vast kingdom of the tall
Christ and his God suffices at the call.
I enter in, Beloved, though I am small.
The light and dark are known from the start
here:

They show creation set out on my ear
In Hebrew syllables that I sing clear
At morn and eve, at eve and morn appear.
The fruitful faith and unfruitful in works
Sets out where arm or eye without faith
shirks.

In light or dark, Beloved, teach me to steer.

14 That's why he says "Wake you from
sleep,
Rise up from the dead, Christ shall keep
Giving you light. 15 See then that you
Walk circumspectly, not in view
As fools, but as the wise in crew,
16 Redeeming here the time, because
The days are caught in evil claws.

17 So don't be unwise, but remain
In mind that the Lord's will is plain.
18 Do not be drunk with wine, which is
Exaggeration in the fizz,
But be filled with the Spirit's biz;

The problem with the Armstrong people
and
The ones who've left them all on sea and
land,
Is that their whiskey is not contraband,
But sought and bought and loved and held
in hand.
The problem with such people is that those
Who fail to drink a drop they will suppose
Are evil in the dock, in rows on rows.
I've felt the hand of Armstrong's power
pose.
It is a heresy that's hard to leave,
And even those who pray for their reprieve
A score of years are still caught in the net,
The web of scorn that Herbert Armstrong
set.
Beloved, have mercy on the lovely crew
That Herbert called away from life and
You.

19 Speak to yourselves in psalm and hymn,
Songs spiritual, singing not dim
In heart melody to the Lord;

Some think these words repeat the titles
writ
At head of Psalms to show that each one's
fit.
Some think these words give carte blanche
to the wit
Inventing ditties and hymns for the kit
Of celebration in rock, pop, and hit.
Myself, I daily and at night repeat
The same Psalm in its Hebrew words for
treat,
And wake to find the words swim in my
head
And hear them also when I go to bed.
Beloved, I tell myself alone the word
Of David that I've seen and touched and
heard,
But I have yet to spend it on the way
Repeated to another on a day
To see another heart lightened and stirred.

20 Give thanks always for all things stored
To God and Father in the name
Of our Lord Jesus Christ of fame;

Paul's prayer is scant, compared to David's
here.

He surely means I should fall on my ear
And pray the Psalms as tehilim and stay
To thank You always for the things You
say.

Paul's prayer is rant, like David's to appear
Before my going in and out with gear,
But he remembers that You're God today
And in Lord Jesus' name I ought to pray.
Beloved, I pray or not, who's here to tell
My Quakerly in silence without bell.
And whether in the name of Jesus Christ
Or in the name of Abraham blessed twicet.
I do give thanks when I find all things
stored

And ready for the coming of the Lord.

21 Submit yourselves one to another
In fear of God *instead of brother*.
22 Wives, submit to your own spouse then
As to the Lord of all earth's men.
23 The husband is head of the wife,
Even as Christ is head of rife
Called out ones, and he's saviour still
Of *both* the body *and* the will.
24 So as the called out ones submit
To Christ, so may the wives be fit
To their own spouse in everything.

I shall not say a word about the wife,
It is not my place to stir up the strife,
Nor is it burden of my race in life.
Let those who think they know say who
must fall
Down in submission in the outer stall,
And come and go before another's call.
The husband is the head of wife for thrall
Perhaps of for the greater of the small,
But let them find their own in power's
ploy,
While I turn back to You, back to my joy.
Beloved, let those called out of synagogue
And church and mosque to wander in the
fog
Find every head and tail on polliwog
Grows into greater things, if only frog.

25 Husbands, love your wives, even as
Christ

Also loved the called out sufficed
And gave himself for it *loving*;
26 That he might make holy and clean
With water washing by the word,
So he might give himself unblurred
The called out glorious and not seen
With spot or wrinkle, any such,
But holy, blemishless to touch.
28 So men should love their wives as they
Love their own bodies. Those today
Who love their wives love their own stay.
29 For no man ever hated yet
His own flesh, but nourished the set
To cherish it, just as the Lord
The called out ones to him restored.
30 For we're members of his body,
Of his flesh and his bones' degree.
31 That's why a man shall leave his dad
And mother and be joined not sad
To his wife and those two shall be
One flesh *together constantly*.

32 And this is a great mystery:
I speak of Christ and those called out.
33 Still let every one of you stout
So love his wife as himself too,
And the wife that she pay her due
In respect of her husband too.

From Genesis to letter to Ephesians
The patriarchate is lost in its lesions.
The man must leave his mum and dad to
take
A turn at living on no bread but cake.
The mystery remains indeed to show:
The helping of the foot, ankle, and toe.
The head, the head alone remains to glow.
The rest of life and being is a wake.
Beloved, let the man love his wife for me,
And let him walk about among the free,
And let Christ love the church and mosque
and see
The blessings on the synagogue's degree.
The head, the head, and leave the tail to be
A splasher in the sea if not the lake.

Ephesians 6

1 Children, obey your parents in
The Lord; for this is right *as tin*.
2 Honour your father and your mum;
Which is the first command to hum

With promise; 3 that it may be well
With you, and you live long to dwell
On earth. 4 And you father, provoke
Not your children to wrath and smoke:
But raise them in the nurture and
The admonition where to stand
Before the Lord on every hand.
5 Servants, obey those who are set
To be your masters in flesh met,
With fear and trembling, motive caught
In single heart, as of Christ taught;
6 Not just in what is seen as those
Who merely try to please men's rows,
But as the ministers of Christ,
Doing God's will from heart surpliced;
7 With good will doing work, as to
The Lord and not to men as due:
8 Knowing that whatever good thing
Any man does, the same shall ring
In his account from the Lord's spring,
Whether he's captive or freeing.

There is no other command with a promise
But honouring your parents, so says
Thomas.

No blessing is imposed on those who fail
To kill, commit adultery, or to flail
The neighbour's wheat and take it into bin.
There is no other righteous deed or sin
That carries promise of long life to win.
Beloved, how do the angels up above
Receive a blessing to obey with love,
Since they are without parent's pedigree?
This is Your law for all eternity.
I honour both my parents to the fill
And listen to the music on the hill
And wonder when I'll die and foot the bill.

9 You masters, do the same things to
Them, not with threats harshly undue:
Knowing your Master's in heaven too;
Neither does he make difference due
Between persons of any hue.
10 At last, my brothers, do be strong
In the Lord, and in His power long.

St. Paul accepts, like Moses and his kin
The practice of slaveholding, which is sin.
He only asks that masters be benign,
While those who chose to follow his design
May make life better for the bought and
sold.

But how many of them would still be bold
To strike in anger or in petty grief
The slaves that work and come to their
relief?

I'd just as soon be poor and in my house
A free man and a poacher of dumb grouse
As be the slave of the benign and true.
Let St. Paul himself live with his own due.
Beloved, I am a slave to You alone,
Without a brazen bank, without a loan.

11 Put on the whole armour of God,
So you can stand against the prod
Of the devil. 12 For we fight not
Against flesh and blood, but the plot
Of principalities, and yet
Against powers and the rulers set
Of darkness in this world, and more
Against spiritual wicked store
In places elevated more.

Against no flesh and blood, aye, that I
know,
But that does not mean that spirit in show
Is entity of immaterial glow.
The ones who trust that there exists in life
Something that is not matter on the rife
Had better smell the spirits and then find
That substance is abuse to make one blind.
The devil either is not there at all,
Or else he is a being that is tall.
Don't tell me in such mournful mien for
true
That devils are just plots of derring do.
I prance before the devil in my way
To see if he is still in wicked pay,
And let the deil go on in sightless spray.

13 Wherefore take unto you the whole
Armour of God, to reach the goal
Against the evil day, and so
Having done all, stand in the show.
14 So stand with your belt on in truth,
And with the breastplate just in ruth;
15 And on your feet the preparation
Of the gospel of peace in ration;
16 Above all, take the shield of faith,
With which to quench both fire and wraith
Of wicked darts. 17 The helmet take
Of your salvation for his sake,
And the sword of the Spirit, which
Is God's word *to reveal the ditch*:

18 Praying always with all prayer and
The Spirit's supplication stand
And watch in patience and to pray
For all the saints on every day;
19 Pray for me, that I'll know to speak,
And open mouth boldly, not weak,
To make known gospel secrets' way.

They say the Spirit is nothing at all,
No matter, and no substance at the call
Of bird or beast or man in earthly thrall.
They say the Spirit is unlike the flesh,
And only flesh is matter in the flesh.
They say the Spirit's immaterial naught
Without an atom of divinely taught.
Beloved, the naughty sword You set aside
Ought to be sharp on those who try to hide.
That may be why they hope that nothing's
there
When You prick with Your sword their
empty air.
Your sword may not be steel, but Spirit
meant,
And with it You can make a mighty rent
Upon the seat of carnal hearts unspent.

20 That's why I'm an ambassador
In chains: so I may speak the store
With boldness, as I ought to speak.
21 But you too may know my affairs,
And how I do, for Tychicus,
A loved brother, faithful to us
As servant of the Lord, now bears
To you the news of all our cares.
22 I've sent him to you for that reason,
So you may know our due and season,
And he may comfort you your hearts.
23 Peace to the brothers *for their parts*
And love with faith from God *above*
The father and the Lord *of love*
Jesus Christ. 24 Grace be with all who
Love our Lord Jesus Christ as true. Amen.

The Father sends both peace and love with
faith.
The Christ does too, and perhaps also
wraith
They call the Holy Ghost, who wait to bake
Three in a pie and call Trinity's sake.
I love the Lord Jesus Christ, it is true,
Because he was an anarchist in pew,

And turned the tables on the money-
 changers
 And spoke a word of warning to the
 rangers.
 Does that mean grace is with me? Do not
 tell
 The neighbour in his pew, he thinks that
 hell
 Has fastened teeth on me. But grace I hope
 Frees me from rabbi, mullah, priest and
 pope
 Until I find the way to heaven above,
 And possibly at last a breath of love.

The Epistle of Paul to the Philippians

St Paul is not always in the employ
 Of writing doctrine, sometimes he takes joy
 As theme and rises to take the good bait
 Of happiness to be in his estate.
 His joy does not depend, it seems, upon
 The fact that Paul's life and work meet the
 dawn
 Of peace and success on the royal gate.
 His joy is in despite of every late
 Imprisonment, discouragement and rate
 Of teachers false to his view of good hate.
 Beloved, if I could live in some old town
 Where Paul sent letters to read in renown,
 I'd try for Philippi on Europe's shore,
 Or in the West Virginian mountains' lore.

Philippians 1

1 Paul and Timotheus, the slaves
 Of Jesus Christ, to all the braves
 In Christ Jesus at Philippi,
 With bishops and the deacons *wry*:
 2 Grace to you, and peace, from our God
 The Father, and *upon the rod*
 From the Lord Jesus Christ *on sod*.

If grace is Christianity to see
 And peace is Islam to the bond and free,
 Then what is the word of the Jewish pale,
 The utterance of the first in avail?
 The law of love I think is found behind
 The words of Moses to the fair and blind,
 That love of neighbour will fulfil the law
 Until great prophets come to seize the paw.
 Beloved, let me be a true Jew to stay
 Within obedience to Your own way,

And let me be a Christian of the kind
 That knows Your grace above the silver-
 lined,
 And let me be a Muslim in both life
 And death submitted to You without strife.

3 I thank my God each time I think
 About you *there upon the brink*,
 4 Always in every prayer of mine
 For you all making *at the vine*
 Request with joy, 5 for your part in
 The Gospel from first day in bin
 Till now; 6 being confident of
 This very thing, that He above
 Who has begun in you a good
 Work will complete it all in view
 Of the day of Jesus the Christ,
When he appears and it sufficed.

Beloved, the good work You've begun in
 me

Is not apparent to those who would see
 Among the men in synagogue and street
 Of church and mosque who think they are
 complete.

Oh no, Beloved, all men see me to be
 An awful sore beneath their fair degree.
 By faith I trust, despite the cruel word,
 That You've begun in me a work and
 stirred.

Beloved, what You've begun in me I pray
 You will complete before the better day.
 I trust, despite the horrors of my will,
 That You are guiding me and my life still.
 The evidence is hidden by the hill
 Of such events that swirl with ray on ray.

7 Even as it is meet for me
 To think this of you all in fee,
 Because I have you in my heart,
 For both in my chains and defence
 And affirmation of the part
 You have in the Gospel, your bents
 Are to receive my grace in art.
 8 For God's my witness, how much I
 Long for you all in mercy's cry
 Of Jesus Christ. 9 And this I pray,
 That your love may abound in sway
 Greatly in knowledge and all way
 Of judgement: 10 So you may approve
 Things that are excellent *in groove*,
 That you may be sincere, without

Offence till the day Christ comes out;
11 Filled with the fruits of righteousness,
Which are by Jesus Christ's address,
To glory and praise of God's *clout*.

True truly I have little righteousness,
And even that evaporates in dress
Of smoke and mist as soon as time turns
on.

There is no goodness in my flight of dawn
Except the goodness of Your own hand's
way,

The lighting of a coming, better day.
I look forward to my sincerity
When Christ's new day and coming by
decree

Shall find me filled with righteousness
abounding

From You alone in everything I'm
sounding.

Then I shall waken to the joy I find
In the appearance from behind the blind
Of Christ come in the flesh and You
behind,

Beloved, unmoored from throne and temple
grounding.

12 But I want you to understand,
Brothers, the things on me that land
Further the Gospel *though not planned*.

13 So my chains in Christ well appear
In all the palace front to rear,
And everywhere all around here.

14 And many brothers in the Lord,
Inspired to confidence restored
Are much more bold to speak the word
Without fear *of the king or herd*.

15 Indeed some preach Christ in envy
And strife, and some too in degree
Of good will. 16 The one preach Christ for
Contention, not sincere in store,
Hoping to add affliction to
My chains. 17 But the other in due
Love, know that I am set up for
Defending of the Gospel store.

18 What then? Not withstanding, each way,
Whether in pretence, or in sway
Of truth, Christ is preached; I thereby
Rejoice, rejoice, no wonder why.

19 For I know this shall turn to my
Salvation through your prayer's supply
Of Jesus Christ's spirit *to fly*,

20 According to my earnest hope
And expectation *without pope*,
That in nothing shall I be shamed,
But that with all boldness *unblamed*,
As always, now also Christ may
Be magnified in my bod's sway,
Whether by life or death *to stay*.

The evil that men do to me must last
Be turned to benefit before the blast.
That is the grand frustration of the world
And universe before Satan's flag furred.
Each wicked thing attempted, each thing
won

Adds only to the fuel and glory done
When Christ shall put all things beneath his
feet

And hand the universe to You as sweet.
Beneath the veils of darkness I may plough
With mists about my furrowed, worried
brow,

But at the end of the row where the vines
Bear the tart berries on which bruin dines,
The sun bursts forth, no longer as a god,
But servant to Your precious blooming sod.

21 For unto me to live is Christ,
And to die is but gain *sufficed*.

22 But if I live in the flesh here,
The fruits of my labour appear:
What to choose I know not to steer.

23 For I'm in a strait twixt the two,
Having a wish to leave the pew
And be with Christ, the better view;
24 But to stay in the flesh, it's true
Would be a better thing for you.

25 And having this confidence, I
Know that I shall abide and try
To stay with you for benefit
To you and joy of faith to sit;
26 That your rejoicing may be full
In Jesus Christ for me to pull
By my coming to you again.

Say no more, my Beloved! Let Paul remain
Upon the earth like wandering Jew to gain
The centuries of benefit in store
For every eastern Christian at the door
Of hermit's cave and cabin in the gloom
Of Russia's wild spread out before the
doom.

If it is gain to us, then send him back

From his sweet resting place to fill the lack
His going has imposed. I say in fact
He's needed to correct the wily woes
That priest and theologian as it goes
Have perpetrated in his blessed name.
Send him back to redeem his awful shame
Of trinities and atonements for blame.

27 Only let your behaviour be
As becomes Christ's gospel's degree;
That whether I come and see you,
Or else be absent from your view,
I may hear of your happenings,
That you stand fast and in the springs
Of one spirit, and with one mind
Together striving for the kind
Of faith that's in the gospel *find*;
28 And in nothing scared by your foes:
Which is to them a sign of throes,
But to you of salvation and
A sign that God *is here to stand*.
29 To you it's vouchsafed in behalf
Of Christ, not only of the staff
Who do believe in him, but too
That they suffer for his sake's view;
30 Having the same conflict that you
Saw in me, and now hear it's true.

Paul cares for nothing really in the end
But for the good behaviour men should
lend.
The faith and justifying all in proof
Of wranglings and of danglings of aloof.
The last word's always do right and appear
In saintly walk before You and in fear.
He says at least act right. I'll do my best,
But in the Pauline way, I do invest,
Not in accomplishment of family
Or of my own achievements caught in spe,
But in the humble dress of Christ alone
Who lives beyond the azure pavement's
stone
Before the heavenly sanctuary's throne
To intercede and then at last atone.

Philippians 2

1 So if there's any consolation
In Christ, or comfort in love's station,
Or fellowship of spirit, or
Any bowels or mercies in store,
2 Fulfil my joy, to be agreed,
Having the same love, in one seed

And in one mind, *as you have need*.
3 Do nothing through strife or to get
The credit for the things you've set,
But in meek mind let each esteem
The other better than they seem.
4 Don't take pride each one in his own,
But hold the other man's in tone.

The value of the Son of God is found
In contemplation of the sacred ground
That makes humility before the crowd
And tries to give the glory if allowed
To others rather than to take to self,
Crowned with an elf upon a golden shelf.
That value is fulfilling of some joy
Of being of like mind in the employ
Of truth and faithfulness before the throne
Of Your great justice and mercy alone.
Beloved, my pride has run its course again
And whirled about the dwelling place of
men

And at its last return holds what is seen
As but a veil of everything between.

5 Let this mind be in you, which too
Christ Jesus always kept in view.
6 He was in the form of God true,
Did not intend to rob God's pew
To be just like Him, 7 but he made
Himself of no repute's parade,
And took on a slave's form and made
In likeness of men, 8 and so found
In fashion of a man, to ground
He humbled himself and became
Obedient to death, and the same
Of the cross. 9 And that is why God
Has raised him high above the sod,
And given him a name above
Each name: 10 so that at the name of
Jesus each knee should bend, of all
Things in the sky and in the thrall
Of earth, and under the earth's wall;
11 And every tongue confess indeed
That Jesus Christ is Lord decreed,
To God the Father's glory freed.

The purpose of these verses was to give
Example to the human how to live
Without the pride that binds the hand and
eye,
And teaches the best way up to the sky.
Instead of learning that humility,

The theologue and priest would come to
 see
 The words to prove that You are three of
 three.
 Perverse are they in their perversity.
 Beloved, let such mind be in me as in
 The Lord Jesus, who fled from every sin,
 And would not make himself to be a God.
 If he would not, then who am I on sod
 To claim divinity for him below?
 I do not step beyond his love and show.

12 So, my beloved, as you've obeyed
 Always, not as presence displayed
 Before me only, but much more
 Now in my absence, work the store
 Of your own saving out with fear
 And trembling *as it would appear*.

The implication of that grasping hand
 Laid on or not upon the divine stand,
 Is not the doctrine of the Trinity,
 Nor justifying anything in spree,
 But that those Paul loved and who loved
 him too
 Should now and then obey commands from
 You.

They should obey when Paul is there to see.
 They should obey when Paul's behind a
 tree.

They should obey when Paul is far away
 Where others faint and follow paths astray.
 Beloved, let me please Paul by what I do
 According to Your own commandments
 true,
 And not hear every word claimed to be
 true,
 That You no longer mean for us to brew.

13 For it is God who works in you
 For both the willing and to do
 Of His good pleasure *come in view*.

I've noticed, my Beloved, when I have
 tried
 My best to work things out against the tide,
 And failed or if not failed, made somewhat
 mess,
 Then You step in to pretty the address.
 You work in me, I see, when all goes well,
 And when my patience stands up to the
 bell,

And when my walk is straight after I fell.
 The will to do the right comes from Your
 heart,
 The doing is Your pleasure from the start.
 The veils that now confound the way I go
 Part and I see the glory of Your show
 Behind the mists of forests where they
 grow.
 Your pleasure is a dawn and is a night,
 A singing on the simple candlelight.

14 Do all things without murmurings
 And without dispute, 15 that your wings
 May be blameless and harmless things,
 Children of God, without rebuke,
 Among a crooked folk to nuke
 For their perversity, by whom
 You shine as lights on the world's doom;
 16 Holding abroad the word of life;
 So I rejoice *to sound of fife*
 In Christ's day, not having in vain
 Run nor laboured. 17 So if I've lain
 Down as a sacrifice in store
 Of your faith, I rejoice the more
 And with you all. 18 For the same cause
 You too rejoice between my paws.

Paul's always impressed by the fact that he
 Has made a sacrifice in faithfully
 Doing the task You set him in the spree.
 He's fine impressed that without thanks or
 pay
 He's taught the saints the righteous, narrow
 way.
 He's sure of Your thanks for his work
 undue,
 And for his labours and his pains in view.
 How human is our Paul, how like a man,
 Deserving credit and with hope in span
 That others might take note in act and plan.
 Beloved, I've had my thanks and found it
 stale,
 The telling of an sordid evening tale.
 The diligence is lost. The sleep is sweet
 Despite the failure of the crowd to bleat.

19 But I trust Lord Jesus to send
 Timothy shortly to your end,
 So I too may be of good cheer
 To know how things with you appear.
 20 For I have no like-minded man
 Who will do to care for your span.

21 For all seek their own, not the things
Which are Jesus Christ's *harbourings*.
22 But you know his proof, as a son
With the father, he has begun
To serve the Gospel with me run.
23 So he's the one I hope to send
In a short time, soon as I bend
To see how it goes on my end.

Paul has his favourites among the saints.
The reading of his letters well acquaints
The hopeful with his views. I might be led
To think that Timothy was better bred
Than Epaphroditus, whose greater worth
Appears that he's been ill upon the earth.
I too have favourites, as did Jesus Christ,
Who let the happy John lie unsurpiced
Upon his chest when the sop had been set
And every sort of traitor had been met.
Beloved, since You are also one
Set on a throne without support of gun,
I doubt You have Your favourites on the
run.
I wonder who is left here to regret.

24 But I trust in the Lord that I
Myself also shall soon come by.
25 Yet I suppose I have to send
Epaphroditus to your end,
My brother and companion in
Labour and fellow soldier win,
But your messenger, and the one
Who served my needs when he had done.
26 For he was missing all of you,
And he was sad you'd heard he grew
Sick. 27 And indeed he was so sick
That he was near to death's door slick.
But God had mercy on his way;
And not him only, but to stay
With me too, lest I should be sad
After everything else was bad.
28 And I sent him with all my care
So that when you see him come there
So may rejoice and I may be
Less sorrowful *in my degree*.
29 Receive him therefore in the Lord
With all joy and hold such adored.
30 Because for Christ's work he had come
Almost to death, and at the drum
Did not spare his own life to make
Up your lack of help for my sake.

It's good for an excuse the man was
missing
Philippians and wanted to be kissing
Them in his greeting in the Lord to say
How much he loved them in his own sweet
way.
It's good for an excuse to send him out
To do the bidding of Paul without shout,
And hope that everyone is satisfied,
After the way the man had almost died.
Beloved, I share the hopes and fears of
those
Who send and summon on the churchly
rows,
And as I see them speed from place to
place,
Perhaps a lesser breed with a plain face,
I reckon on my own, who must stand still,
That I am satisfied upon my hill.

Philippians 3

1 At last, my brothers, find your joy
In the Lord. And as I employ
My pen to write the same to you,
To me indeed is no grief due,
But for you it's a safer pew.
2 Beware of dogs, beware of men
Who work the evil thing again,
Beware of mutilators' wen.
3 For we're the circumcision, who
Worship God in the spirit due,
And rejoice in Christ Jesus too,
And have no confidence in flesh.

Who knows what Paul may mean by dogs,
when he
Sets out to warn the holy company?
The mutilators are those who come in
To circumcise the proselytes and win
Reward for introducing them into
The congregation of the holy crew.
I fail to follow Paul's great logic here,
That circumcision of the heart in fear
Precludes the flint upon the fleshly tier.
One without other may well be indeed
A possibility and without greed,
And both may be, I trow, in any need,
But why the one excludes the other I
Fail to perceive no matter how I try.

4 Though I could also sit in mesh
Of fleshly confidence. If some

One else might think he has a crumb
By which to trust in the flesh, I
Have more: 5 circumcised with a cry
On the eight day, and of the stock
Of Israel, Benjamin's dock,
A Hebrew of the Hebrew's clock,
A Pharisee by the law's crock,
6 Concerning zeal, persecuting
The called out ones *with awful sting*,
In regard to the righteousness
That comes by law's doing, blameless.

No doubt the century of Paul was fraught
With Jews who really sat down then and
thought
That their accommodation to the taught
Of Rome was not a sin, because they
sought
Their compromise to save life and limb got.
They must have been consoling conscience
by
The hope that circumcision on the sly
Would make up for the way they had to try
To satisfy the royal issue by
Admission of no messianic boy
As long as law and Scripture would employ
Their tongues and wags well-cut and set
with joy.
Beloved, the history of men's increased
Above the villainy of any beast.

7 But what things were gain to me, those
I just considered loss in rows
For Christ. 8 Indeed, without doubt I
Count all things loss for what I spy
Of excellency of the knowing
Of Christ Jesus my Lord and glowing:
For whom I've suffered all things' loss,
Consider them but shit, so I
May win Christ, 9 and be by and by
Found in him, not having my own
Righteousness, which is of law's loan,
But what which is through faith in Christ,
The righteousness of God sufficed
By faith: 10 so I may know him and
The power of resurrection's stand,
Participation in what he
Suffered, conformed to his death's fee;
11 If by any means I might get
The resurrection from death set.
12 Not as though I'd already got,
Or were already perfect lot:

But I follow after, so I
May apprehend what for also
I'm apprehended at the go
Of Christ Jesus. 13 So brothers, I
Do not consider at all I
Have apprehended, but one thing
I do, forgetting every sting
Of what is past, reach out to those
Things coming *and the things I chose*.

The kind of language Paul uses, I say,
Goes a bit far in what comes out to play.
Myself, I try avoiding that word much
Used by the ones too delicate to touch.
But is it not a saying in the crowd
About the inner sea, and said aloud,
That silver and the coin on market place
Is excrement exchanged in any case?
Paul may be nothing more than simple brat
Among the throngs of Italy who sat
And taunted one another so the girls
Would take note of the boisterous and the
churls.
Beloved, let my tongue be pure at the slat
To taunt each rogue dog and every fat cat..

14 I press toward the mark in prize
Of the high calling of God wise
In Jesus Christ. 15 So let us then
Who are among the perfect men,
Agree, and if in anything
You disagree, God shall reveal
Even this to you *and so heal*.
16 Nevertheless, in what we've got,
Let us walk by the same rule's slot,
Let us mind the same thing in plot.
17 Brother, be followers of me,
And take note of those in degree
Who follow the example we
Have left you *in act and decree*.

The same rule to walk by is that presented
At Sinai, though by Christians now
resented.
Resentment's justified by all such men
On basis of St. Paul who wrote again.
Yet Paul hopes that a single rule set up
My You, Beloved, might rule unruly tup.
Beloved, I do agree and love all men
Who follow in the wake of the big ten.
Can any say example left by Paul
Was to escape the narrow way and all

Outlined in simple life obeying You
In doing here what You once told us to?
Give me the chapter and the verse where he
Stole bread or then committed adultery.

18 For many act, of whom I've told
You often, and now tell you bold
With tears, they are the enemies
Of the cross of Christ in degrees
19 Who'll just end up being destroyed,
Whose god's their belly they've enjoyed,
Whose glory is their shame employed
In earthly thoughts *of things that cloyed*.

The enemy of the cross is not one
Who fails to bow before the crucifix
Or at the icon set before the sun
To cover men's hands with shadow of
sticks.

The enemy of the cross is no man
Who rules the symbol pagan in its span,
But rather he who disobeys Your law
To work on Sabbath days or extend paw
To property of neighbour and by plan.
The hater of the cross is the man set
To worship his own belly and to get
His pleasure from the satisfying flesh:
He crucifies his Lord again, afresh
Beside the laden table where he's met.

20 For our behaviour's in the sky,
From where we too look by and by
For the Saviour, Lord Jesus Christ,
21 Who'll change our vile body unspliced
To make it like his glorious own
According to his actions shown
By which he can subdue all things
Under himself *and in his wings*.

The body beyond death, beyond the grave,
Received at resurrection to unstave,
Is not one immaterial and brave
In nothingness of being not to shave.
The vile form is not changed to
nothingness,
But to one glorious in its address.
Beloved, I praise You that Your world is
real,

And that there's nothing empty here to feel,
But all You make is heavy with a song,
And everything is brighter than a gong.

The hope of those who find that matter's
wrong
Is empty hope, no matter nirvana,
No matter for the scratch of plastic claw
In holographic helplessness and awe.

Philippians 4

1 Therefore, my brother, dearly loved
And longed for, my joy and unshoved
Crown, so stand fast in the Lord, too,
My dear and ever beloved crew.

2 I beg Euodias, and beseech
Syntyche, that they be of each
The same mind in the Lord *to teach*.

3 And I entreat you also, true
Yokefellow, help those women too
Who laboured with me in the view
Of gospel, with Clement also,
And with my other fellows' row,
Whose names in the book of life grow.

It seems that Paul must beg two men to
preach

The same Gospel that he set out to teach.
If he must beg, that means that early day
Saw many sorts of faith along the way.
It seems that Paul must mention women
too,

Though he gives no name from that worthy
crew

Of workers in the Gospel way and pew.
In all it seems that nothing here has
changed

Since Paul set out his epistles arranged.
The men are vying still for place and
power.

The women do the work at every hour.
Beloved, take me to heaven where I'll see
The last be first, and the first faithfully
Sunk in the crystal sea or under bower.

4 Rejoice in the Lord every day,
Again I say, Rejoice *and play*.

5 And let your moderation show
Before all men. The Lord's at hand.

6 Don't worry about any planned,
But in all things by prayer and stand
In supplication to give thanks,

So your requests be *like the planks*
Made known to God *to fill His tanks*.

If Paul had realized two thousand years

Would pass before the Lord who's in arrears,
 Though he says is at hand, would really come,
 I think he might have been slower a bum
 To write encouragement for all and some.
 And yet if second coming in that day
 Was matter for rejoicing where they pray,
 How much more now, after the centuries
 Have laid their havoc on the hearts they tease!
 Beloved, send in Your promised one again
 To stave off clutches of women and men
 Who still in round of Noah's generation
 Forget to worship You upon their station.
 Among rejoicing ones there might be ten.

7 The peace of God, (*some call Islam*)
 Which passes understanding's balm,
 Shall keep your hearts and minds through
 Christ

Jesus, *and that's a thing sufficed.*
 8 At last, my brothers, what things be
 Both true and honest, just to see,
 The pure, the lovely, well believed,
 If there be virtue, praise believed,
 Just think about these things *reprieved.*
 9 Those things that you've learned and received,
 And heard, and seen in me, such do,
 The God of peace shall be with you.

St Paul was writer in Your sacred book
 Worthy of honour and grace as I look
 Upon these lovely words. So I forgive
 The many times his words sound like a sieve.
 The peace of God beyond the mind to know,
 The Christ that never fails to keep the glow,
 The true and honest, pure, lovely still show
 That praise and virtue are things worth the row.
 Beloved, I bask in all the glory met
 In these two verses slight and at last set,
 An afterword perhaps, a waving back,
 A good-bye from apostle shown not slack,
 And as I bask, I wonder all the while
 That there is so much beauty in the smile.

10 But I rejoiced greatly in YHWH,
 That now at last your care of me

Has flourished once more and greatly
 In what you cared about, but you
 Did not have the chance to come through.
 11 Not that I complain of my lack,
 For I have learned, and I'm not slack,
 Whatever conditions I'm in,
 To be content *and without sin.*
 12 I know both how to be abased,
 I know how to abound when chased:
 Everywhere and in all things I
 Am taught both to be full and try
 To be hungry, both to abound
 And to suffer lack *on the ground.*
 13 I can do all things through Christ who
 Comes in to strengthen what I do.

After Paul's backhand complaint of the style
 Of meeting his needs and belly's poor guile,
 He once more rises to the task at hand
 Of showing glory come from where You stand.
 I can do all things through Christ at the call,
 Who comes to strengthen me, though I am small.
 I can do all. Beloved, the message creeps
 Around the cold heart where the hopeless sleeps
 And kindles fires again, and finds the way
 Illumined by a new and brighter day.
 I waken from the weakened bed and night,
 I find the morning made of a new light,
 And new strength breaks the window of my sight
 With warming courage and with ray on ray.

14 Nevertheless, you have done well
 To send me help in my bad spell.
 15 Now you Philippians too know,
 That in the start of Gospel show,
 When I left for Macedonia,
 No group of called out ones in awe
 Gave me a cent, but you in paw.

I guess the rate of giving relieves Paul
 Of his thanksgiving backed against the wall,
 If only one church had the care to give
 Him anything at all to help him live.
 Tent-maker ministers are famous still,

And probably the better of the mill.
 I too have seen life pass without a bill
 And often salary as been at nil.
 Beloved, like Paul, I look back at the stroke
 And see that while I often have been broke,
 Still You have given bounties for my share
 And kept me hungerless beneath Your care.
 Though Philippi is rarely in my way,
 I still find cities shimmering with day.

16 Even in Thessalonica
 You sent me help twice *in the thaw*.
 17 Not because I desire a gift:
 But I desire fruit that may lift
 To your account *and not short shrift*.
 18 But I have everything I need,
 And I am full and without greed
 Received from Epaphroditus
 The things that you sent without fuss,
 An odour of a sweet smell, and
 A sacrifice well set to stand
 Before God pleased with you in hand.
 19 But my God shall supply your need
 In all according to the speed
 Of His riches in glory by
 Christ Jesus *standing in the sky*.
 20 Now unto God our Father be
 Glory now and eternally. Amen.
 21 Greet every saint in Jesus Christ.
 The brothers with me greet your heist.
 22 All the saints greet you, chiefly those
 Who are of Caesar's household rows.
 23 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ
 Be with all of you *that he chose*. Amen.

That far off day when packages arrived
 In Thessalonica where St Paul strived
 To bear the burden of both life and toil
 Upon the harrowed streets with coil on coil
 Seems further off than anything when I
 Remember what's occurred beneath that
 sky.

The holocaust came silently to town
 And silently stole off with hardly frown
 From any Christian in that hollowed place.
 Beloved, let Paul redeem himself and race.
 If Paul had been eating care package then,
 Would he have been taken among those
 men?

I trow he would. So let no man mistake
 His circumcision for a Christian rake.

The Epistle of Paul to the Colossians

This writing of Paul is one sought out well
 By those who would destroy Your law and
 bell

And show the blessed Sabbath day to be
 An empty old Jewish ceremony.
 The rudiments of Gnostic thought combine
 With excesses unknown to modern wine,
 And so each reader who's not caught divine
 Act of grace finds a place of stumbling
 fine.

I follow Paul in his example here
 To keep the Sabbath day with heart and ear,
 And still recite my Psalms with faithful
 cheer

And let no man decry or judge my fear.
 I judge no man, but turn to find Your grace
 Sufficient to reward the human race.

Colossians 1

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus
 By will of God, *and not to please us*,
 And Timothy our brother, 2 to
 The saints and faithful brothers who
 Are in Christ and in Colosse:
 Grace to you and peace *in the way*
 From God our Father and the Lord
 Jesus Christ. 3 We give thanks *outpoured*
 To the God and Father of our
 Lord Jesus Christ, *a man of power*,
 Praying always for you, 4 since we
 Heard of your faithfulness to be
 In Christ Jesus and of your love
 For all the saints, 5 and because of
 The hope which is laid up for you
 In heaven, of which you heard that's true
 Before and in the gospel word,
 6 Which has come to you, also heard
 In all the world, and brings forth fruit,
 As also among you *to boot*
 Since the day that you heard and knew
 The grace of God in what is true,
 7 As you too learned from Epaphras,
 Our dear fellow servant to pass
 A faithful minister of Christ
 On your behalf, 8 who has sufficed
 Also to declare to us all
 Your charity in spirit's thrall.

I doubt that any group of Christians can

In fact be charitable where I scan
The group dynamics that always come in
To play in lieu of wickedness and sin.
The pecking hoarder of the boost is best
Seen in the perch of churchly sort of rest.
But tongue in cheek I trow wee Paul is
crest

Arisen to inspire the folk to win.
Beloved, the faithful minister of Christ
Is often among those who chose and sliced
The bread too thin for meals that had
sufficed.

Let me be servant of both all and none,
A slave to hope and let my course well run
Find You still basking here under the sun.

9 For this reason we also, since
The day we heard it, do not wince
To pray for you, and ask that you
May be filled with the knowledge true
Of his will in all wisdom and
Understanding at spirit's hand,
10 That you walk worthy of the Lord,
In all pleasing *him*, and restored
In every good work and increased
In knowledge of God, 11 and released
Strong in all power, according to
His glorious power, and come in view
For patience all and so employ
Always longsuffering with joy.

Let Paul's sweet prayer be sounded in my
life

As I step out into the Christian strife,
Condemning actions that I think are rife,
Against the ten commandments by my fife.
Let Paul's neat stair be rounded on my way,
As I think of the knowledge in my sway,
And find the right to do and sue a day
Beneath the glowing of other sun's ray.
Beloved, I join my heart with pagan Paul,
Or Pharisee, or visionary stall,
And place my hand and hope within Your
will,
And beg that what I do may rise up still
In motives pure, unwed with hopeful crime,
Seasoned with malt or with the prickly
lime.

12 Thanks be to the Father who's made
Us to be partakers and paid
With the inheritance of saints

In the light. 13 He's saved without taints
Us from the power of darkness and
Brought *us* into kingdom to stand
With the Son of His love, 14 in hand
We have redemption through his blood,
Forgiveness of sins *in the bud*.

I do thank You, loved Father of the best
And worst of men, among whom I've
confessed
To standing in the crowd with yellow vest.
I thank You for inheritance I find
Cake-like upon the wings of those unwined
Who enter in the halls of heaven aboon,
Where I too may go in, though late or soon.
I thank You and Your obedient Son too
Whose blood scattered the Roman army's
crew,
And wish above all things it might still do.
Forgive for that or for some other thing
My slight sins and my greater on the wing,
And I shall enter in the divine sting.

15 He's image of invisible
God, the firstborn over in full
Creation. 16 For by him all things
Were made that are in heavenly rings
And that are on the earth, to see
And not to see, whether they be
Thrones or dominions or the seat
Of principalities or treat.
All things were created through him
And for him *and set out in trim*.
17 And he's before all things, and in
Him all things consist *without sin*.
18 And he's the body's head, of that
Group of called out ones, who once sat
At the beginning, the firstborn
From the dead, that in all things sworn
He may have the pre-eminence.
19 For it pleased *the Father with sense*
That in him all the fullness dwell,
20 And by him to reconcile well
All things to Himself, by him, though
They be things on the earthly row
Or things in heaven, having made
Peace through the blood of his cross laid.

I trust the cosmic message that the words
Of Paul lay on the ears of flocks and herds:
That Jesus is before all things in deed,
Or in Word rather, as a divine seed

To be beginning, head, and then decreed
 Pre-eminent in reconciling creed.
 The peace of his blood makes me stand
 aghast,
 Which was the purpose no doubt at the
 mast
 For coming under fire of Roman blast.
 Rome still stands up to shoot at one and all
 Who represent Your law beneath the pall
 Of power, the necessary evil's state,
 As the generic sort of Catholic rate.
 Let blood here reconcile me and the mate.

21 And you, who once were set apart
 And enemies in mind and heart
 By wicked works, yet now he's made
 22 You one in the body *displayed*
 Of his flesh through death, to present
 You holy, blameless, in consent
 Above reproach in his sight meant,
 23 If indeed you stay in the faith,
 Grounded and steadfast, not by wraith
 Moved away from the hope that's sin
 The gospel heard to save from sin,
 Which was preached to each living thing
 Under the sky, of which I, Paul,
 Became a minister *to sing*.
 24 I now rejoice in suffering all
 For you, and fill up in my flesh
 What's lacking in afflictions' mesh
 Of Christ, for the sake of his body,
 Which is the group of called out proddy,
 25 Of which I became minister
 According to stewardship stir
 From God which was given to me
 For you, to fulfil God's word free,
 26 The mystery which has been kept
 Hidden from ages and where slept
 The generations, but now shows
 Itself to His saints *in their rows*.

Though I may here rejoice, here in the
 swell
 Of suffering for myself or others' jell,
 I do not praise You that the pain is found
 Upon the gentle dew of human ground.
 In pain I praise perhaps, but not for pain,
 Not even for the princely sort of stain
 That touches torture stake of Your dear
 Son.
 I am beyond the tracks that he had won.
 I touch instead the secret of the times

That overshadowed all my greater crimes,
 The ages hidden by the firs and birches
 Instead of parchment creeds of creedal
 churches.
 Reality, I trow, is better meat
 Than blind faith at the idol's golden feet.

27 To them God willed to make known
 what
 Are riches of the glory shut
 In this mystery among Gentiles:
 Which is Christ among you, the hope
 Of glory. 28 Him we preach in scope,
 Warning each man and teaching all
 Men in all wisdom, that we call
 Each man perfect in Jesus Christ.
 29 To this *end* I also surpliced
 Labour, striving according to
 His work which works in me to do
 Mightily *for the good and true*.

The only glory I hope for now in
 The afternoon of margin and my sin
 Is that drawn from the gentle robe of Christ
 Spread on the shore of Galilee and diced
 Invisibly upon the rated head
 That You forgive for gaining daily bread.
 Perfection in Christ is a thing I peek
 At with my shame, in consternation seek
 To avoid such words in the things I speak.
 Perfection in Christ! Whisper if you must
 The words to me, but let the liver trust
 More in the tale to keep to wicked rust.
 So all may live in peace without the mace
 Of judgement falling daily in this place.

Colossians 2

1 For I want you to know what great
 Conflict I have for you and those
 There in Laodicea's *state*,
 And *for* as many as *it goes*
 Who have not seen my face in flesh,
 2 That their hearts may be comforted,
 Knit together, and in love *fed*,
 Attaining to all riches of
 The full assurances of *love*
 And understanding, to the proof
 Of God's mystery, *though not aloof*,
 Both of the Father and of Christ,
 3 In whom are hidden *and sufficed*
 All treasures of wisdom and proof.
 4 Now this I say lest anyone

Should deceive you, *through guile or fun*,
With words persuasive. 5 For though I
Am absent in the flesh, yet I
Am with you in spirit, rejoicing
To see your *good* order and *voicing*
Your faith's steadfastness in the Christ.

I thank You, my Beloved, that You have
hidden

The treasures that I seek, and seek
unbidden,

Of wisdom and of knowledge in a place
That You have told me of and given face.
This human hide and seek that gives no
hint

Is too hard for my powers and legs in
splint.

But You, when You hide treasures You are
so

Excited that You tell me where to go.
In that You're like a three-year-old, a child
That hides and then cannot be still for wild
And splendid bursts of giggling there
behind

The chair. If You have hidden wisdom and
Divine proof in Your Christ, then I in kind
Return the gift and bring my heart in hand.

6 As you have therefore received Christ
Jesus the Lord, so walk in him,

7 Rooted and built up, *and not dim*,
In him in faith established *too*,
As you have been taught, always *true*
Abounding in it with thanksgiving,
Expressed in word and how you're living.

8 Beware lest anyone rob you
Philosophizing vain deceit,
According to human tradition
By worldly rudiments' conceit,
And not by *beloved* Christ's *submission*.

9 For in him sits all fullness of
Divinity *sent from above*,
And bodily, 10 and you're complete
In him, who is head *and not feet*
Of power and principality.

The self would be God in Your place
indeed

And take both power and principedom in its
greed.

How vain such aspirations seem to be
When Christ has all power and divinity

In fullness and for comfort bodily.

Instead of looking for place to control,
As I look deep within my own struck soul,
I find, Beloved, the great I AM speaks
there,

Repeating the inspired words bright and
fair,

And writing on my heart the Decalogue
In flesh and body, and not smoke and fog
Of Sinai, nor in sapphire tablets' stone.
The Word made flesh is Christ's, but not
alone.

He shares his fullness with me from the
bone.

11 You were circumcised in him too,
With handleless circumcision true,
By putting off the body of
Sins of the flesh, *also their love*,

By the circumcision of Christ,
12 Buried with him *by what sufficed*
In baptism, in which you too
Were raised with *him* through faith in true
Working of God, who raised him up
From the dead *and destruction's cup*.

If I am indeed baptised in Christ's dunking,
What need is there of one more water
plunking?

And if there's need, then there is also need
Of circumcision made with hands in deed
As was with Christ. I may put off the sins
Of flesh and still stop to count up my wins,
With or without the cutting or the wetting.
And if raised up through faith to life, I'm
betting,

I need not die at all, instead live on,
Safe from the cut, the damp, the grave at
dawn.

But chances are that I shall die, and so
Along with grave, I take the knife and wet,
Beloved, and since Christ had a body, show
That I too can obey and still not fret.

13 And you, though dead in your trespasses
And your flesh's uncircumcision,
He's made you *all alive in masses*
Together with him *by decision*,

Forgiving you all your trespasses,
14 Having wiped out handwriting of
Ordinances from push to shove
That was against us, and which was

Contrary to us. And he's taken
It out of the way, all forsaken
Nailed to the cross for what it does.
15 Having disarmed princedoms and
powers,

He made an open show *for vowers,*
A public spectacle of them
Triumphing in his stratagem.

16 So let no one judge you in food
Offerings or drink offerings that *should*
Be offered on an annual feast,
Or first day of the month *by priest,*
Or Sabbath *days,* 17 which *offerings* are
A shadow of things that should come,
But substance is of Christ and sum.

These words provide a good excuse to
show

The worker less good faith than donkeys
know

Who happen to be owned by pious Jew.
Such have their Sabbath rest which is their
due.

But since I am no donkey but a man,
The words of Paul deprive me at a scan
Of rights to rest upon the Sabbath day,
Negotiated out and cast away
By Roman crosses set on hill at will
Of those who love the hand of power here
still.

Beloved, I stand rebuked upon the week
I had reserved in service to the meek,
And find in seven days of work I seek
Each day the Sabbath blessing that You
speak.

It makes but little sense, Paul would aver,
To keep the Sabbath, and yet not appear
To offer fond obedience to that
One You set in the throne where David sat.
The letter of the law has always been
A shadow of the one upon the scene
That You set up as king and ruler here.
Beloved, I obey not the stony coil,
Nor hope to gratify with my hard toil,
But I obey for love of You and him
Who is the hope of righteousness undim,
The Master of the Age, appointed trim.
Let my Sabbaths awaken with the light
Of love to Christ and Mahdi in the right.

18 Let no one cheat you of reward,

Taking delight in *false adored*
Humility and worship of
Angels, intruding in above
Things which he has not seen, in vain
Proud through his fleshly mind *to stain,*
19 And not holding fast to the head,
From whom all of the body's *wed,*
Nourished and knit together by
Joints and ligaments *on the sly,*
Grows with the increase *that's* from God.
20 Therefore, if you died *on the sod*
With Christ from the basic things of
The world, why, as *though in its shove*
To live, do you subject yourselves
To regulations *and like elves,*
21 "Don't touch, don't taste, don't handle
yet,"

22 Which all concern things which pass by
With use, according to what's met
In rules and doctrines of men *sly?*
23 These things indeed may seem to be
Of wisdom in self's faith's degree,
While false humility *in spree,*
And neglect of the *soul's* body,
Are of no use against the pale
Of living in the fleshly gale.

I understand the rules that men have made
In regulating touch and taste parade
Are not to be grasped as the truth waylaid.
But what about the touch and taste You
sent
By hand of Moses to preserve well meant
The Hebrew faithful from the wickedness
That crowns with foul diseases in the dress
Of pork and lobster set in well-done mess?
Does death of Christ make healthful meals
of all

That formerly had been made to appal?
The swine flu and the swine flesh at the
wall
Are just as evil now as when the call
Was first sent for Egyptian dogs to crawl.
The Christian sort does not stop here to
guess.

Colossians 3

1 If then you were raised up with Christ,
Seek those things which above *sufficed,*
Where Christ is, sitting at the right
Hand of God. 2 Set your mind *with might*
On things above, not things on earth.

3 For you died, and your life *of worth*
Is hidden with Christ in God's *berth*.
4 When Christ *who is* our life appears,
Then you'll come too in glory's *spheres*.

I am raised up at last with Christ to be
Within the sanctuary that I see
In gloried rays before the crystal lee.
I sit down to the banquet and I fall
To eating ham and eggs sent from the stall
Of the celestial mess and so I praise
You that You sent Your Son to die with
flays

So that I might without sin raise the cup
And toast the porker upon which I sup.
Without that death atoning, I should find
It sinful to eat bacon with the rind.
But now that freedom's beams are slivered
bare

To kindling, I can broil my wicked share
With more impunity than wit and care.

5 So put to death your members which
Are on the earth *and in the ditch*:
Both fornication, uncleanness,
Passion, evil desire's address,
And covetousness, which is made
Idolatry *in such displayed*.

6 Because of these things God's wrath falls
Upon the sons within the walls
Of disobedience, 7 in which
You yourselves once walked in your pitch
Among them living in their stitch.

I thought that I was free, Beloved, to make
An end of legal rules before the cake
Of sweet rebellion for Your Son's dear
sake.

Now You forbid, after the awful wake
Of blood atoning, fornication and
Abominations falling on the land.
I covet still the recipes of old
And see no wrong in what Your servant
told

By Sinai to avoid. Beloved, I hold
My freedom to resent the royal bold.
In vain Your Son has died, if still I must
Conform to the obedience of trust,
Instead of going out in my own way
To live and let live for a briefer day.

8 But now you yourselves are to put

Off all of these: anger, wrath's foot,
Malice and blasphemy, and yet
The filthy talk from your mouth set.
9 Do not lie to each other, since
You have put off the old man's quince,
10 And have put on the new *man* who
Is renewed in such knowledge true
To the image of the one who
Created him, 11 where there is not
Greek or Jew, circumcised in plot
Or uncut, barbarian or
Scythian, slave or free, what's more,
But Christ all and in every store.

The new man of Christ also held a whip
Before the temple moneyed to the quip.
But if I stand in any place to say
Excesses are redeemed for what they play,
I find my words are hailed into the fray.
The circumcision is a sweeter touch
Than what I find church members give in
clutch.

Beloved, save me from the wiles of the
free,

And I'll be glad to serve the Jewish spree
Of vast obedience in peace beneath
The skies of dun, the fading, flowered
wreath.

I'll remove filth from lip and tongue when
You,

Beloved, remove filth from the favoured
pew.

Until then I bear witness of the true.

12 Therefore, as *the* elect of God,
Holy, beloved, put on to prod
With tender mercies, kindness, and
Humility, meekness, to stand
In patience, 13 bearing with each one,
Forgiving one another's run,
If anyone has a complaint
Against another, how so quaint,
Even as Christ forgave you, so
You also *must do in your row*.

I'll bear, Beloved, in silence patiently
With all the wickedness around I see
In church and synagogue and mosque
spree,

If they will bear in meekness little me.
I shall forgive the unforgiving just
As I receive forgiveness in my dust:

For what I do confess, Beloved, I take
Your mercy and Your grace beyond the
stake.

For what I hold in my rebellious heart,
I don't require forgiveness on Your part.
Let those confess the wrong, and I'll be
swift

To grant forgiveness in as free a gift.
But while the din of pagan worship sounds,
I'll raise a warning voice on all the rounds.

14 But above all these things put on
Love, which is the bond that is drawn
Of *sound* perfection. 15 And let peace
Of God rule in your hearts' *increase*,
To which also you were called in
One body, be thankful *to win*.
16 Let the word of Christ live in you
Richly in all wisdom, in view
Of teaching and admonishing
Each other in psalms and the spring
Of hymns and songs of spirit, sing
With grace in your hearts and to YHWH.
17 And *whatsoever* you may do
In word or deed, *do* all in name
Of the Lord Jesus, *without shame*
Giving your thanks to God the Father
Through him, *and do not fear to bother*.

The Psalm is written in David's sweet
word,

The hymn is also in that Scripture heard,
And songs of spirit also find their way
As titles of those things in David's pay.
This word cannot be blanket licence here
That anything goes in the sacred ear.

Three phrases all refer to one great task,
The singing of the Psalms is all I ask.
Beloved, let me teach and learn from that
spring

And bring no strange fire to my lips to sing,
But only from the altar that sent out
Isaiah's song upon the thin and stout.
With blessing and with curse inspired to
treat

I come to give You thanks before Your
seat.

18 Wives, submit to your husbands dear,
As fitting in the Lord *to hear*.

19 Husbands, love your wives and do not
Be bitter to them *on the spot*.

20 Children, obey your parents in
All things, for this is without sin
Well pleasing to YHWH *on a spin*.

21 Fathers, do not provoke your spawn,
Lest they're in discouragement drawn.

22 Bond servants, obey in all things
Your masters by the flesh in rings,
Not with eye service, as those who
Work to please men, but in the true
Sincerity of heart, God-fearing.

23 And whatever you do *endearing*,
Do it with all your strength, as to
The Lord and not to human crew.

24 You know that from YHWH you'll
receive

Inheritance, reward *in sleeve*,

For you serve the Lord Christ, *believe*.

25 But he who does wrong will be paid
For what he's done, no one is stayed.

After the hint of Gnostic tears and woe,
After the Jewish ways that men might go,
After idolatry and pagan show,
Paul ends his letter with Confucian glow.
The husband and the wife, the child and
rate

Of servant caught upon the silver plate,
The role of every ruler and the state,
Subjection of the hopeful to their fate,
All tend at last to make the golden pass
Of Paul's experiment upon the grass.
Beloved, I take Confucius well in hand
If that is what You want after the stand
Of failing Christian vice and cross demand.
But leave me still a voice on rocky strand.

Colossians 4

1 Masters, give your bond servants what
Is just and fair, knowing in glut
That you too have a Master in
The heavens *to keep you from sin*.

2 Continue earnestly in prayer,
Be vigilant in it with share
Of gratitude, 3 meanwhile pray too
For us, that God would open to
Us a door for the word, to speak
The mystery of Christ *we seek*,
For which I am also in chains,

4 That I may make it clear from stains,
As I ought to speak *without gains*.

The prayers that my heart pours out here to
You

Are sometimes without reverence for the
crew

Of faithful priests that still earn of their
due.

The prayers that my lips utter at the task
Are blasphemous to some ears I could ask.
And yet each day I come before Your word
Complaining of the sort of things I heard,
In vigilance and earnestly I make
Confession of my prayerful act's mistake.
The chains and mysteries about my cot
Are just accessories of my poor lot.
Who knows what truth may yet enlighten
me

And come after my prayers to set me free
And brighten my horizon faithfully?

5 Walk in wisdom toward those outside,
Redeeming the time *from the pride*.

6 *Let* your speech always *be* with grace,
Seasoned with salt, that you may face
Each one with the right answer's pace.

My speech is seasoned with both salt and
grace,

And no one can deny my rightful place
In keeping up extensively such speech.
To some the bitter nut, to some the peach.
Beloved, as I stand in my tattered way
Before Your simple law's redeeming ray,
Aghast at what I've said and done today,
At least I can rely on this fair tune:
I have obeyed You in one thing in rune.
My speech is seasoned with both grace and
salt:

The grace of wit and word despite my fault
In every other rule from night till noon.
So I rejoice today that I succeed
In my obeying You through all my greed.

7 Tychicus, a loved brother and
A faithful minister in hand,
And fellow servant in the Lord,
Will tell you all the news I've scored.

8 I'm sending him to you for this
Very purpose, that he not miss
Your circumstance and comfort your
Hearts, 9 with Onesimus in store,
A faithful brother and beloved,
Who's *one* of you, *though once ungloved*.

They will make known to you all things
Which *are happening here for stings*.

10 Aristarchus my fellow chained
Greets you, with Mark cousin arraigned
Of Barnabas, about whom you
Received instructions, may find you,
If he comes to you, welcome him,
11 And Jesus called Justus in trim.
These *are all I have as a friend*,
Workers for God's kingdom to tend
Who are of circumcision's bend,
They've been my comfort without end.

Though Paul would always disagree with
others,

Sooner or later he would call them
brothers.

The one he argued sharply for was Mark,
And left both cousins there to disembark
With Silas in the opposite direction.
Now Paul takes Mark on friendlier
inspection,
And calls him comfort and a fellow worker
Who once he condemned only as a shirker.
The stone that's cast aside becomes the
corner,

The early joy and love turns into mourner,
Because illusion covers what is real.
Let me not like Paul take the veil and seal
And trample them in anger and disdain.
What seems like fire may turn out
freshening rain.

12 Epaphras, who is *one* of you,
A bond servant of Christ *and true*,
Greets you, always and fervently
Working for you in prayers' degree,
That you may stand perfect, complete
In all God's will *without retreat*.
13 For I bear him witness that he
Has a great zeal for you, and see
Those who are in Laodicee,
And those in Hierapolis' *street*.

14 Luke the beloved physician and
Demas greet you *and out of hand*.

15 Greet the brothers all who may be
In Laodicea's degree,
And Nymphas and the group called out
That *is* in his house *and redoubt*.

16 Now when this letter has been read
Among you, see that it is read
Also in the group of called out

Ones of Laodiceans' spout,
And that you likewise read the note
From Laodicea *remote*.

17 And say to Archippus, "Take heed
To ministry which you with speed
Have received in the Lord, that you
May fulfil it *in what you do*."

18 This is my salutation writ
By my own hand: Paul where I sit.
Remember my chains *once again*.
And so grace *be* with you. Amen.

Nobody thought to save the letter sent
To Laodicea's people You meant
To lighten with the load of Pauline bent.
In waywardness I fall upon the fact
And wonder what he wrote for word and
act,
Despite neglecting what things have been
kept.
The soul is slumberful, that's why I've
slept.
Give me a second chance, Beloved, and I
Will read the words I do find on the sly,
And when I've sipped them to the dregs at
last

Then I can show dissatisfactions past.
But until then, I shall kiss every word
Of Paul that I have read and I have heard,
And catalogue the gems that I've amassed.

First Epistle of Paul to the Thessalonians

This letter in a simpler, early day
Shows how the church should be guided by
ray

Of such simplicity without a crown
And without crozier set upon the town.
Paul shows believers in the coming Christ
That there is always work to do sufficed,
And that though some may die before the
sweet,
Yet they too will arise to eat the treat.
Beloved, the future state's too much in glee
To calculate beneath my willow tree:
The present, like a mouse, just touches me.
I may rejoice, a doubting Thomas, see,
And then return to Your law and Your

Word

To see if I'm still with repentance stirred.

1 Thessalonians 1

1 Paul and Silvanus, and the man
Timotheus, unto the span
Of called out ones of those ones called
Thessalonians which are installed
In God the Father and the Lord
Jesus the Christ, *the one adored*,
Grace be to you, and peace from God
Our Father, and Lord Jesus Christ.

Theology of Paul at early date
Seems not to measure up to the pure state
Of orthodoxy, since pneumatic power
Is lacking in this first epistle's bower.
He mentions God the Father and the Lord
Jesus Christ, but the Spirit stays unscored.
I reckon Paul was dead before the time
That Constantine called everyone to climb
Into Iznik and write the Trinity
Into the creed and for eternity.
Beloved, if Paul had only known the Three,
I could have turned from You to save the
day
For those in Thessalonica who pray
That purity of faith might be their way.

2 We give thanks to God *on the sod*
Always for all of you sufficed,
Making mention of you in prayer;
3 Constantly minding in your care
The work of faith, the work of love,
And patience of hope *from above*
In our Lord Jesus Christ, in sight
Of God and our Father *of light*;
4 Knowing, beloved brothers, that your
Election is of God *and sure*.

Paul did it once again. He needs to learn
The formula of Roman Catholic urn:
The Pater and the Filius to turn
Into progression of the Spirit's fern
Unfurling from both Father and the Son
To lie in its immaterial fun
Upon a world no innocent of Rome,
That calls the Vatican its hearth and home.
Beloved, I turn to You alone and pray
That I might be led on the straighter way,
Where those who bear no wrath from You
may pray
And day and night are never led astray.
For that I too call on Your name of grace
And mercy in this earthly sort of place.

5 For our gospel, it did not come
To you in word only in sum,
But also in might, and in state
Of Holy Spirit; you can relate
What kind of men who were among
You for your sake *in act and tongue*.

6 And you became our followers,
And of the Lord, as it occurs
Having received the word in pain,
With joy of Holy Spirit's vein.

Too late the good Paul makes final appeal
To Spirit in the gospel come to heal.
The formula is twice set without it,
And so the Spirit's out when others sit.
The gospel of sweet Paul is one run rife
Against the Jewish hopes in Roman strife,
Against accommodation to the dust
Of Roman temple and the arms of trust.
Beloved, I take Your Spirit well where I
Am treading on an iron earth to spy
A brazen dome above my head, or try.
Beloved, Your Spirit is still sweet to me,
Despite denial of the Trinity
That rests upon my lips eternally.

7 So you became examples to
All those who believe in the pew
Of Macedonia as well
As Achaia, *the truth to tell*.
8 For from you sounded out the word
Of the Lord not only those stirred
In Macedonia as well
As in Achaia *where they dwell*,
But also in every place your
Faith toward God is spread out *in store*;
So that we do not need to speak
Anything *of the things you seek*.
9 For they themselves show about us
What kind of entrance without fuss
We had to you, and how you turned
To God from idols at last spurned
To serve the living God and true;
10 To wait for His Son from the sky,
Whom He raised from the dead to view,
Jesus, who delivered thereby
Us from the wrath to come *to fry*.

I turn from idols to Your blessed throne
Set on the heavens where You reign alone
As the Almighty God, I turn from stone.

I turn to You, the living God and true
With the same faith that rocked the folk
upon

The Thessalonian beaches and lawn.

I turn to You, Beloved, with my prayer too.
The reason is, I've sounded out the word,
I've drawn the bath and kept the baby
stirred,

And so I leave the bleating, babbling herd
And turn my back on lovely Babylon,
Its hanging gardens, the veils overdrawn,
And take the desert way where Ahmed
stood

To worship You, Beloved, if any could.

1 Thessalonians 2

1 For you yourselves, brothers, know our
Coming in to you, that with power
It was not vain. 2 But even then
After we'd suffered in our den
And were treated so shamefully,
As you know, there at Philippi,
We were bold in our God, you see,
To speak to you the gospel of
God with much strife *as well as love*.
3 For our exhorting was now drawn
In some deceit, nor unclean spawn,
Nor in guile: 4 But as we were given
Permission from God and were driven
To be put in trust with the word
Of gospel, even so we stirred
To speak; not as for pleasing men,
But God, who tries our hearts again.
5 For neither at any time did
We use flattery under bid,
As you know, nor a cloak to hide
Covetousness; there is to bide
God's witness *for such things in stride*.
6 Nor did we seek glory of men,
Neither of you, nor yet again
Of others, when we might have been
A burden, as apostles win
Of Christ. 7 But we were gentle there
Among you, even as in care
A nurse holds her children *in lair*.

The gentleness of those in den and lair
May be proverbial and taught with care,
But I have seen the bear cub at the door
Not knowing where the mother kept her
store,
And had to chase Your chosen from the lot,

When it was so attracted to the spot
By smell of breakfast frying and the pot
Of tea for two or three upon the floor.
I trust the books of revelation here,
Both of the word and nature without fear,
And yet prefer some distance from the
game,
And peace beside the stuttering of flame.
Keep Yours in their own place and me in
mine,
And we shall strive to get along just fine.

8 Since we appreciated you
So much, we were willing in due
To give you not just Gospel true
Of God alone, but render too
Our very souls, because that you
Were dear to us *among the few*.
9 For you remember, brothers, our
Labour and work, done in the hour
Of night as well as day, because
We did not want to stain our paws
With debtedness to you at all,
But preached to you the gospel call
Of God. 10 You are witnesses, and
God too, how holy, justly and
Unblamably we came to stand
Among you who believed *the band*.
As you know how we preached and sought
To comfort and exhort the lot
Of you as does father his spawn,
12 That you would act worthy as drawn
Of God, who has called you into
His kingdom and His glory due.

The gospel and the call are God's alone,
Paul does not mention Jesus on the throne.
That may be proof enough this letter's old,
And written before the time of the bold,
Before the time when Christ was elevated
To Deity eternal and elated.
If so, Beloved, I grasp the early plot
And honour You alone for what You've
got,
But still wait for the judgement to be filled
And for the Christ to return and unkill
Rise in the resurrection or the light
Of glorified in body and in sight.
In all I keep You only One and true,
The God of everything I have in view.

13 That's why we also constantly

Thank God, because when *by decree*
You got the word of God which you
Heard from us, you did not take view
Of it as the mere word of men,
But as it is in truth again
The word of God, which succeeds in
The work it does in you to win
By what you have believed *in bin*.
14 For you, brothers, followed at last
The called out ones of God to cast
Which in Judaea are in Christ
Jesus: for you also surplined
Suffered the same thing at the hand
Of those living in your own land,
Just as they have by the Jews' band,
15 Who killed the Lord Jesus and their
Own prophets too, and have in share
Been persecuting us; and they
Did not please God, but are in sway
Contrary to all men *today*:
16 Forbidding us to speak aloud
To the Gentiles that they in cloud
Might be saved, to fill up their sins
At all times: for the wrath that wins
Has come upon them in full bins.
17 But we, brothers, once taken from
You for a short time in space done,
But not in heart, tried all the more
To see your face great hopes in store.
18 So we would have come to you then,
I Paul too, once and once again,
But Satan hindered us *like men*.
19 For what's our hope, or joy, or crown
Of our rejoicing *in the town*?
Are not you in the presence of
Our Lord Jesus the Christ *in love*
Of his return *from heaven above*?
20 For you remain our glory here
And joy *in what you shall appear*.

If Satan hinders Paul, Beloved, just see
What he can do to hinder little me.
When some do evil things and wicked
deeds,
Satan comes in to justify their needs.
While I do not support others in claim,
I might justify my own self from blame.
That's normal for the human sort of race,
Beloved, but You just keep me in my place.
Despite Satanic wonders and excuse,
Beloved, let me bask in the wise abuse
Of the presence of the Lord Jesus Christ

If that is not in cornered conflict diced
In waiting for the second coming when
He shall appear again before all men.

1 Thessalonians 3

1 So when we could no longer bear,
We thought best Athens to stay there,
2 Sent Timothy, our brother and
Slave of God, and our helping hand
In the good news of Christ to set
You firm, courageous, faithful yet,
3 So no one might in faintness fall
Through these afflictions *on the ball*,
Since you yourselves know it's our call.
4 Indeed we told you early on
When we were there that there would dawn
On us a tribulation, so
It did happen as you well know.
5 That's why, when I could bear no more,
I sent to find out of the store
Of your faith, if the tempter had
Seduced you to do something bad,
And our work might be vainly sad.

There's always something hard to bear
alone,
Or even with a friend or two like stone,
But Paul is right to look for reasons for
Rejoicing on the Parthenon's dry shore.
He sends out Timothy to find a thing
To bring him joy and happiness in ring
Of sorrow, and with good news on the wing
His spirits soar above his questioning.
Beloved, I too turn from the daily mess
That would confront me with dose of
distress,
And take wing like a seagull on the lake
Above the choppy waters for Your sake.
No Timothy brings me the news, I make
Your love alone My hope and song and
guess.

6 But now when Timotheus came
From you to us, and brought in claim
To us good news of your faith and
Your charity, and that your hand
Holds good remembrance of our stand
Always, desiring with demand
To see us, as we also hope
To see you *in a briefer scope*:
7 So brothers, we were comforted
Over you in all that we hid

Of our affliction and distress
By your faith *and noble address*:
8 For now we live, if you stand fast
In the Lord and *not as outcast*.
9 For what thanks can we render God
Again for you, for all the prod
Of our joy wherein we rejoice
For your sakes before our God's *choice*;
10 Night and day praying earnestly
That we might see your face *freely*,
And might perfect that which may be
Lacking in your faith's *symmetry*.
11 Now God Himself, our Father too,
And our Lord Jesus Christ, to you
Direct our way. 12 And the Lord make
You to increase and abound in
Love one toward another's stake:
13 To the end he may come to win
Your hearts unblamable and in
Holiness before God, who is
Even our Father, at the whiz
Of our lord Jesus Christ's arrival
With all his saints *for our survival*.

Twice Paul might have increased the load
of sense
From God and Christ to include Spirit's
tents
And failed again to affirm what is true
According to the creedal point of view.
Twice Paul calls You our Father, but he
fails
To recognize the Lord Jesus Christ's sails
Beyond what he does for the cherished
ones
That all remain before You as Your sons.
Beloved, let me believe in You alone,
The Father, God of all, upon Your throne,
And follow Jesus to abound in love
Toward all others coming from Your glove,
Until the day when Christ shall once more
come
To fill the earth with glory, end the sum.

1 Thessalonians 4

1 As for the rest, now brothers, we
Beg you and exhort earnestly
By the Lord Jesus, just as you
Received from us how you should do
To please God, keep up the work due.

My fine and friendly foes by Luther's name

Used to confess that there is naught of
 blame
 In anything a man can do or gain,
 But only grace to make one just and vain.
 Yet here the great apostle of that crew,
 St. Paul says that there's something we can
 do
 To please You, my Beloved. If that is true,
 Then churchly manners are alas a stain.
 Beloved, let me please You in what I am,
 And what I say and do without a sham.
 And if I do not keep up the good show
 That makes You happy in a divine glow,
 Then work in me a better weal and woe
 Where I am busy or not, where I go.

2 For you know what injunctions we
 Gave you through the Lord Jesus, see.

3 For this is God's will, that you be
 Sanctified, so that you abstain
 From fornication, *an act vain*.

4 Each one of you knows how to keep
 His body holy, in the sweep
 Of honour, 5 not in passion's lust,
 Even as do nations of dust
 Who do not know God as they must.

6 Also not to cheat other folk
 In business, because all the stroke
 Of vengeance for it is the Lord's,
 Just as we told you in accords
 Of solemn witness of rewards.

I read the ten commandments front to back
 And round again to see what thing I lack.
 You got your good man Paul to leave a
 track

Of fine injunctions beyond the ten stack.
 Not only prohibition in the whack
 Of gross adultery, but here I find
 That fornication too will make one blind.
 Beyond the prohibition I should steal
 He makes it crooked also in the weal
 Of chance at business not to drive a bargain
 Unfair to friend and neighbour or foe's
 noggin.

With twelve commandments now instead
 of ten,

I go out to encounter fellow men,
 And still find I'm hit in the head again.

7 For God did not call us to be
 Impure, but live in purity.

8 That's why despisers despise not
 Man, but God, even in His plot
 To give us holy spirit's lot.
 9 Now as for brotherly love, you
 Have no need that I write to you,
 For you yourselves are taught by God
 To love each other *on the sod*.

10 For you also do so toward
 The Macedonian brothers ward.
 But brothers, we exhort you now
 To do it with a stronger plough.
 11 Earnestly strive to quietness,
 And mind your own business and dress
 The work of your own hands as we
 Enjoined you, 12 that becomingly
 You act toward strangers, and that you
 May lack for nothing of the due.

St. Paul's a Quaker, that I see full well,
 When he ignores the ringing of church bell,
 The sound of shophar and the call in spell
 Of muezzin from the minaret and tell.
 St. Paul would have the congregation strive
 To be in silence, though they're still alive.
 I say that silence in the grave will do
 For length, now let me raise a wry and hue.
 That's not to say I've never found the hour
 Of Quakerdom in silence without power,
 Or that the social gospel at its best
 Is of a colour not to fit my vest.
 The Quaker silence is fine enough if
 It harbours keeping Your law to the stiff.

13 I do not want you ignorant,
 Brothers, of those who sleep *in plant*,
 So that you do not grieve as those
 Who have no hope *from head to toes*.

14 For if we believe Jesus died
 And rose again, just so beside
 God will also bring with him all
 Those who fell asleep in the thrall
 Of Jesus. 15 For we say this to
 You in the Word of the Lord *true*,
 That we the living who remain
 At the Lord's coming not in vain
 Will not rise up before those who
 Have fallen asleep *in the dew*.
 16 Because the Lord Himself shall come
 Down from the sky with shout and hum
 Of the archangel's voice, and by
 God's trumpet. and the dead who lie
 In Christ will rise up again first.

17 We who remain alive *uncursed*
Will be caught up on the cloudburst
With them to meet with the Lord there
And riding far upon the air.
We'll always with the Lord take share.
18 So, then, comfort each other now
With these words *spoken anyhow*.

The coming of Christ is set forth here
nearly
As premillennial, visible clearly.
Paul also makes the point that the dead
sleep
And are caught up together with the sweep
Of living to meet Jesus in the air.
A flying saucer cult, the first to share
The page of history, perhaps this is.
It sounds to me like an exciting whiz.
Beloved, I do not argue for the trumps,
Nor for the resurrection nor the humps
Of angels against Sadducean bumps.
I only care that Your kingdom in sway
Is not put off for ever in this way
Of tribulation, but is a hope's ray.

1 Thessalonians 5

1 But of the times and seasons yet,
Brother, you have no need I set
Down in writing such things to you.
2 For you yourselves know perfectly
That the day of the Lord's decree
Comes like a thief in the night's lee.
3 For when they'll say "Peace and safety",
Then sudden destruction shall be
On them, as labour pains upon
A woman with a child in spawn,
And they shall not escape *outdrawn*.
4 But you, brothers, are not in dark,
But that the day should come in stark
To overtake you like a thief.
5 You are all children of belief
In light, and children of the day:
We are not of the night in sway,
Nor of the darkness *far away*.
6 So let us not sleep as some do;
But let us watch, sober and true.
7 For they that sleep sleep in the night;
And those who are drunken *in sight*
Are drunken lying in the night.
8 But let us, who are of the day,
Be sober, putting on *in sway*
The breastplate of faith and of love;

And for a helmet *worn above*,
The hope of salvation *to stay*.

The way to prepare for the coming tide
Is clear: do not sleep on the other side;
Do not drink of the cup of drunken sweat,
The wine of wrath and of false doctrine
met.

Let me be sober rather, without taint
Of any toxic thing for my complaint,
With breastplate of both faith and love to
know

That You are the one guiding all the show.
Give me the helmet of the hope I bear
Toward salvation coming from Your care,
And I shall hope indeed beneath the air,
Upon the gate of earth that all men share.
Let me creep through the open gate by light
And see behind me only the dark night.

9 For God has not appointed wrath
To us, but to obtain the path
Of salvation by him our Lord
Jesus the Christ, *the one adored*,
10 Who died for us, that, whether we
Wake or sleep, we should come to be
Alive together in his fee.
11 So comfort yourselves everyone,
And edify each other won,
Even too as you've always done.
12 And we beseech you, brothers, know
Those who labour among you, so
They are over you in the Lord,
And so admonish you restored;
13 And to esteem them highly praised
In love for the work that they've raised.
And be at peace among yourselves.
14 Now we exhort you, brother *elves*,
Warn the unruly, comfort those
In feeble mind, support the rows
Of the weak, be patient toward all,
Even to Tom McElwain's stall.

Esteem the ministers of gospel power
Is one thing to exhort, but at this hour
Those who claim to be ministers of life
Are really just the harbingers of strife.
The creedal power is broken in the heart
Of those who seek You only and Your part,
But lives indeed in hand of every priest
And every one who takes the tainted yeast.
There is no labourer now in the field,

No sweeter angel at the altar's yield,
But every one takes on the papal crown
And offers bread and wine to all the town.
So I esteem not one of them as true,
And turn from every church, Beloved, to
You.

15 See that none render evil for
Evil to any; but restore
What's good, both among you, and to
All. 16 And so rejoice evermore.
17 Pray constantly *in what you do*.
18 In every situation give
Thanks: for this is the way to live
According to the will of God
In Christ Jesus *upon your sod*.
19 Do not extinguish Spirit's rod.
20 Do not despise the prophet's word.
21 Prove all things; hold fast what *you've*
heard
Of good. 22 Abstain from what appears
To be of evil and of tears.

Hold what is good and turn quickly away
From what appears in evil or its sway.
Such advice may sound good, Beloved, and
yet

It must assume criterion be set.
What is the measure of the good that I
Should hold when proven here beneath the
sky?
What is the mark that tells the human heart
Whether the thing is evil for its part?
The heart is one deceitful, so it seems,
And this advice goes only on in dreams.
Unless, Beloved, You have a better way,
I must rely on the ten words You say
To tell me what is right and wrong and why
To hold and how to abstain on the sly.

23 And may the very God of peace
(Or of Islam in its increase)
Make you entirely holy too,
And may your whole spirit in view
And soul and body be preserved
Blameless indeed and so unswerved
Until the coming of our Lord
Jesus the Christ, *the one adored*.
24 Faithful is He who summons you,
Who also will remain to do.
25 And so, brothers, pray for us too.
26 Greet all the brothers with a kiss

Of holiness *and not to miss*.
27 I command you by the Lord that
This letter be read where you sat
Where all holy brothers are at.
28 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ
Be with you *all and be sufficed*. Amen.

The sweet Christian and Jew perhaps who
strays
Thus far to read or listen to my lays
May take offence that I translate the peace
You give as Islam to provoke the fleece.
Islam means peace with You, submission to
Your will alone among the creedal crew.
The fact that Muslims who do so are few
Does not mean that the words given are
untrue.
Give peace in Islam to my soul and all
Men here upon the drunken earthly ball
That we may leave the mosque and church
to call
On You alone. The greeting at the gate
Of truth is still mistaken for Your hate,
And sky mistaken for the earth of late.

Second Epistle of Paul to the Thessalonians

Some thought that Your Christ would now
reappear
Before the turning of another year,
And so Paul writes again to set them
straight.
And yet with my regret I see the gate
Of that faith simple and credulous wait
Myself for cataclysmic fires in state.
When Paul wrote, despite troubles in the
church,
There still were peaceful moments on his
perch.
Today the man of sin has ruled so long
That he's the most ancient of every song,
And everyone around thinks that he's
strong.
Beloved, I turn from strength and power to
You,
And know the sword's a paper one in view,
While quietly You work, but then will sue.

2 Thessalonians 1

1 Paul, and Silvanus, Timotheus,

To the group of called out to see us
 Of Thessalonians in God
 Our Father and Lord Jesus Christ:
 2 Grace to you and peace too from God
 Our Father and Lord Jesus Christ.
 3 We're bound to thank God always for
 You, brothers, as is meet in store,
 Since your faith grows exceedingly,
 And charity of each of you
 Abounds towards each other in view.
 4 So that we ourselves glory in
 You in the called out from the din
 To God, for your patience and faith
 In all your persecutions' wraith,
 And tribulations you endure:
 5 Which is apparent token sure
 Of righteous judgement of God, so
 You might be counted worthy show
 In the kingdom of God, for which
 You also suffer at the pitch:
 6 Seeing it is righteous with God
 To punish tribulation's prod
 Of those who trouble you on sod.

When Paul writes these first letters, I am
 glad
 To find him clear about things I find sad,
 That You are one of three and three in one,
 A polyglot when things are said and done.
 He makes sure twice in this passage to
 show
 That You are God the Father on the go,
 And that our Lord and Master is Your
 Christ,
 Jesus the sweet and sword-bearing that
 diced
 The heresies of every century
 And rose to reign in heaven eternally.
 Beloved, Your righteousness is here to
 stay,
 Your kingdom crashes in on earth
 someday,
 And when that happens those who call You
 three
 Will all be punished for their ministry.

7 To you who're troubled now then rest
 With us, when the Lord Jesus best
 Shall be revealed from heaven with his
 Mighty angels to come with whiz
 8 Of flaming fire to get back at
 Those who do not know God out flat,

And who do not obey at all
 Our Lord Jesus Christ's gospel call;
 9 Who'll be punished eternally
 With such destruction by decree
 Of the presence of the Lord, and
 From the glory of his power's *hand*,
 10 When he shall come as glorified
 In his saints, and to be admired
 Among all who believe, because
 Our witness among you in clause
 Was credible in that day's *straws*.
 11 That's why we always pray too for
 You, that our God would count your score
 As worthy of this calling, and
 Fulfil all the good pleasure's stand
 Of His goodness, and work of faith
 With power, *not merely as in wraith*;
 12 That our Lord Jesus Christ's name may
 Be glorified in you today,
 And you in him, according to
 The grace of our God and the view
 Of the Lord Jesus Christ *in sway*.

Beloved, the fond belief that time goes on
 Through the millennium of spawn on
 spawn
 Without a hitch or ditch to fall upon,
 Must be impediment to minds that fawn
 On fair religion, but do not repent.
 It is a human ploy, unwarranted,
 But true, that the immediacy when led
 Is necessary for repentance bed.
 That's why, despite the centuries You've
 lent,
 You do require that we believe You meant
 That time should end upon a day come
 soon,
 And Christ must come down with a shout
 at noon
 And in the glory of a day unspent,
 And not in centuries of peace in boon.

2 Thessalonians 2

1 Now we beseech you, brothers, by
 The coming of our Lord (that's nigh),
 Of Jesus Christ, and that we come
 Together unto him in sum,
 2 That you not be soon shaken in
 Mind, or be troubled by the din
 Of spirit or by word, nor yet
 By letter coming from our set,
 Worried that Christ's day is at hand.

3 Let no man deceive you in band
 By any means: for unless stand
 The falling away first in land,
 And the appearing of the man
 Of sin, perdition's son by plan,
 4 Who shall oppose, exalting self
 Above all that upon the shelf
 Is called God, or worshipped at all;
 So that he's like God in the stall
 Sitting in God's temple, to show
 That he himself's God *on the go*,
The day of Christ must turn out slow.

Beloved, though human psycho-babble
 makes
 Exception not at all before the stakes,
 And we must think the day of judgement
 breaks

At any moment on our heads in flakes,
 In order to repent and thoroughly,
 Still fact was when Paul wrote in century,
 Christ could not come back till apostasy
 Had given ground and risen Papacy.
 But now since popes have reigned upon the
 throne

And claimed for generations at the groan
 To be the vicar of the Son of God,
 It's high time You should show Your arm
 and rod.

I turn from the throne filled on earth to find
 Your heavenly throne untouched by human
 blind.

5 Don't you remember when I was
 Still with you, I told you these laws?
 6 And now you know what keeps the day
 Of his revealing from his sway.
 7 For the secret of wickedness
 Already works *in his address*,
 Only the one who does allow
 Will keep on till he's gone somehow.
 8 And then the evil one appear,
 Whom the Lord shall consume with gear
 By the breath of his mouth, and he
 Destroy with his coming's glory:
 9 That one who comes by the decree
 Of Satan, with all power and signs
 And lying wonders by designs,
 10 With all deceit of wickedness
 In those that perish to confess;
 Because they did not receive love
 Of truth, to be saved *hand in glove*.

How well these verses here describe the
 way
 That Satan shall send out demon in sway
 Impersonating John Paul come to stay,
 Raised as it were from the tomb to the day!
 That evil wraith shall take the form and
 flesh
 Of that one human You had loved afresh
 And falsely claim to be what he is not,
 And stand to rule the world's appointed lot.
 Beloved, the attempt shall then fail indeed,
 And all the glory of the saints in lead
 Shall slay that wicked monster clothed in
 light
 And cast him down into abysmal night.
 Let me love truth, Beloved, until that time
 When evil rises to die in its crime.

11 And for this reason God will send
 Them strong delusion, so they'll end
 By their believing in a lie:
 12 So they may all be damned thereby
 Who did not believe in the truth,
 But had pleasure in the uncouth.
 13 But we're bound to give thanks always
 To God for you, brothers who stay
 Loved of the Lord, because God chose
 From the start you to save *from foes*
 Through Spirit's sanctification
 And belief of the truth *when done*:
 14 To that he called you by our *word*
Of gospel, to obtain *unblurred*
 Our Lord Jesus Christ's glory *stirred*.
 15 So, brothers, stand fast, and hold well
 Traditions you've been taught to spell,
 Whether by voice or writing's swell.
 16 Now our Lord Jesus Christ himself,
 And God, even our Father's *shelf*,
 Who has loved us and given more
 Eternal consolation's store
 And good hope through grace, 17 comfort
 more
 Your hearts, and stablish you in each
 Good word and work *of which we preach*.

Again, Beloved, St. Paul forgets to state
 That Father and Son come on scenes not
 late
 Are well accompanied by Spirit's thrust.
 The formula is lacking for our trust.

Again, Beloved, St. Paul turns things
 around
 And makes the Son first person on the
 ground,
 And Father second. Perhaps he would
 spread
 The tale that they are of one substance bled.
 If St. Paul himself can't get Trinity
 In the right order and in number three,
 Beloved, I turn from such idolatry,
 And grasp eternal consolation's fee,
 Good hope through grace, and set my heart
 to see
 Good word and work You accomplish in
 me.

2 Thessalonians 3

1 At last now, brothers, pray for us,
 That the Lord's word in omnibus
 May fill us and be glorified,
 Just as it is in you beside;
 2 And that we may be saved at last
 From the irrational in cast
 And wicked men: for not all men
 Are imbued with such faith again.
 3 But the Lord's faithful, who shall come
 Establishing you and in sum
 For keeping you from evil scum.
 4 We're certain the Lord in your way
 Will keep you doing now today
 And always the things we command.
 5 And may the Lord direct your hearts
 Into God's love, and for your parts
 Into the patient waiting for
 The coming of Christ at the door.

Beloved, create in me the will to do
 As well as doing of the good and true,
 That I may not fail to escape the pall
 Of evil ones who cry the siren call.
 Beloved, fill me with that salvation's store
 That flees the wicked deed and those in
 store
 Who would encourage such in me and
 mine.
 Beloved, come enter in, and sit, and dine.
 Direct my heart into Your love indeed,
 And keep my eye in patience on the steed
 That nears and bears Your Christ sent to
 my need.
 Beloved, I seek that coming now and still
 While darkness creeps above the lonely hill

That guards my path and roof, apple and
 dill.

6 Now we command you, brothers, in
 The name of our Lord Jesus Christ,
 That ye withdraw yourselves from din
 Of every brother that is diced
 To act disorderly, and not
 After the tradition as taught
 Him from us in our preaching's plot.
 7 For yourselves know how you should be
 To follow after our decree,
 We did not act disorderly
 Among you *to any degree*.
 8 Nor did we eat any man's bread
 For nothing; but we worked instead
 By day and night, so we might not
 Be any burden in your lot;
 9 Not that we lack authority,
 But to be an example free.
 10 For even when we were with you,
 We did command you this to do,
 That if anyone would not work
 Neither then should he eat and shirk.
 11 For we hear that there are some which
 Act disorderly in your hitch,
 Who do not work at all, but they
 Are busybodies every day.
 12 Now such ones we command and say
 By our Lord Jesus Christ, that they
 Work calmly and eat their own hay.

Beloved, what happened to those who must
 stand
 And wait and Milton spoke upon the land
 Of providence in commonwealth and king?
 What happened the service without wing?
 Beloved, remember Whittier who saw
 The oriflamme of hope beneath the claw
 Of Yankee soldiers streaming on the hill,
 And yet could not go out to meet the kill.
 Some work and some retire, and that is still
 The law of life, let St. Paul foot the bill.
 I work today and rest here when I must,
 I wear out now, but later I may rust.
 Beloved, accept the will to do as much
 As action of the heavy ones who clutch.

13 But you, brother, do not give way
 As weary in well doing's *play*.
 14 If anyone does not obey
 Our work by this letter, then stay

To note that man, and do not bide
 With him, but shame him *for his pride*.
 15 But counsel him, not as a foe,
 Admonishing like brother's row.
 16 Now the Lord of peace *or Islam*
 Himself give you peace and such calm
 Always by every means *and balm*.
 And may the Lord be with you all.
 17 The greetings of Paul with my own
 Hand, written like a sign in stone
 In every letter, so I write.
 Our Lord Jesus Christ's grace in call
 Be with you every one and all. Amen.

I swear, Beloved, if swearing is allowed
 By such as me beneath the Brethren cloud,
 The spawn of Quakers who speak not
 aloud,
 That Islam is the faith of peace with You,
 And not the quarrelsome terrorist crew.
 Let me be a true Christian if that means
 I'm not a Protestant in Catholic scenes,
 But follower of Christ alone before
 The shutting of the golden temple door.
 Let me be a true Muslim if the score
 Is peace in keeping Your law well in reach,
 And following in silence what some
 preach.
 Let me be true to You, Beloved, and not
 The fool of names, on any book a blot.

First Epistle of Paul to Timothy

The three-part rondo form repeated thrice
 To Timothy is something more than nice.
 If I were Trinitarian, I'd make
 An issue of the structure here at stake
 And claim, like music of the Middle Age,
 The structure in three parts is shining page
 To prove the Trinity caught in a cage.
 Instead I still deny that piece of cake.
 Beloved, I take the lesson that sir Paul
 Goes further than Your Christ to make
 church wall.
 Instead of two or three come in his name,
 I find a deacon and elder in flame.
 Let no one come to me, Beloved, in blame,
 If I submit with Timmy to Paul's claim.

1 Timothy 1

1 Paul, an apostle of Jesus

Christ, by commandment *without fuss*
 Of God our Saviour and the Lord
 Jesus Christ, our hope *of reward*,
 2 To Timothy, a true son in
 The faith: Grace, mercy, *and peace win*
 From God our Father and Jesus
 Christ our Lord, *the felicitous*.
 3 As I urged you when I went to
 Macedonia, remain true
 In Ephesus that you may charge
 Some that they teach *or teach at large*
 No other doctrine, 4 nor give heed
 To fables and endless in speed
 Genealogies, which must cause
 Disputes rather than godly laws
 For edifying for faith's cause.

No doubt, Beloved, the genealogy
 Is valid form of prayer and strategy
 Since it's included in the Torah book
 That comes first, as well as in many a nook
 Of Chronicles, and even gospels too,
 At least in two recensions, take the view
 That genealogies are here to stay
 The doubts rather than enter in the fray.
 And yet, Beloved, I have no pedigree
 Despite my famous genealogy
 And silsilas like all such improvised
 To bind in chains who still are ill-advised.
 The Sufi blinds himself with veils to match
 The genealogies that he can catch.

Beloved, I'm glad to see that You alone
 Remain my saviour to marrow and bone.
 There are some who think that I must be
 saved
 From You by Your appointed to enslaved.
 That my will be enslaved to You is just,
 I beg no liberation from the trust,
 But know that freedom exists only where
 The will is united with Yours to share
 The glories of creating universe
 In ways that further joy instead of curse.
 You break, Beloved, the chains of my own
 will,
 Blinded by illusion and the brief mill
 Of limitations to give me the fill
 Of love and joy and pain to stand aside
 From ant meal posturings of human pride.
 Be You alone, Beloved, my faithful guide.

5 Now the purpose of commandment

Is love from a pure heart *that's sent*,
 From a good conscience, *from* sincere
 Faith, 6 from which some, and without
 fear,
 Having strayed, turned aside to vain
 Talk, 7 hoping to teach law for gain
 Understanding not what they say
 Nor the things which they would display.
 8 But we know that the law *is* good
 If one use the law as one should,
 9 Knowing this: that the law's not made
 To condemn one who has not strayed,
 But for lawless, rebellious ones,
 For the ungodly, sinners' sons,
 For unholy *users of Name*,
 Profaners *of the Sabbath's claim*,
 For murderers of fathers and
 Murderers of mothers *in band*,
 For manslayers *despite the law*,
 10 For fornicators *in their crawl*,
 For sodomites, and those who steal
 A man or child for woe or weal,
 For liars, for perjurers, and
 For other things that by command
 Are contrary to sound teaching,
 11 According to the glorious *spring*
 Of the gospel of blessed God
 Committed to my trust *and rod*.

It's sweet to know, Beloved, the Pauline
 show
 Of gospel is set out in tenfold row
 That takes the Decalogue to quote straight
 out
 In the same order it was sent about.
 He condemns heathen faith's idolatry,
 Misuse of Your name and the making free
 To ignore and profane Your Sabbath day,
 To dishonour parents, in brief, the way
 You spoke on Sinai is Paul's gospel say.
 I too join faithful Paul in his announcing
 Of Your eternal gospel in the bouncing
 Of Sinai's glorious trumpet sounds and
 clear.
 Beloved, Your loving heart is always near
 To the honeyed words You would have me
 hear.

12 And I thank Christ Jesus our Lord
 Who has enabled me *with hoard*,
 Because he had considered me
 Faithful to be in ministry,

13 Although I had been formerly
 A blasphemer, persecutor,
 And an insolent matador,
 But I obtained mercy because
 I had ignorantly of laws
 Done so in my own disbelief.
 14 And the grace of our Lord was great
 And abundant *in my estate*,
 With faith and love which are in Christ
 Jesus. 15 This *is* a faithful priced
 Saying and worthy to be had,
 That Christ Jesus to save the bad
 Came into the world, and I am
 The chief as a rebellious *ram*.
 16 However, for this reason I
 Obtained mercy, that in my eye
 First Jesus Christ might show the guy
 All longsuffering, as an example
 To those to believe in his ample
 Provision of eternal life.
 17 Now to the King eternal *rife*,
 Immortal and invisible,
 To the God who alone is full
 Of wisdom, *be* honour and yea
 Forever and ever. Amen.

Some people are consistent in desire
 To be chief that anything might inspire,
 As long as they are chief. That attitude
 Comes from the realization the dude
 Is divine I without the knowing that
 The divine is in every single vat.
 Since I am god I must therefore be true
 To be the chief of sinners in my crew.
 Beloved, may Jesus Christ save me also
 From the thing that Paul pretends not to
 know.
 And I too shall give praise and honour to
 You, King eternal and invisible,
 Who are alone God, who alone are full
 Of wisdom among the many and few.

18 This charge I commit to your way,
 Son Timothy, by light of day
 According to the prophecies
 Which went before predicting ease
 Of you, that you should battle well;
 19 And hold the faith, good conscience
 spell;
 Which some have set aside and so
 Made shipwreck of their faith in tow;
 20 Some such are Hymenaeus and

That Alexander; whom I hand
To Satan, that they might learn not
To blaspheme after they've been taught.

Beloved, if Paul can curse the ones who
take

Another view of what's gospel in stake,
No doubt merely about the circumcision
Or other formal issue with derision,
Then may I not condemn the pagan brood
That sets Your law aside as old and crude?
Instead of no gods but You on the stair,
They bow to trinities in the thin air.
Instead of Sabbath day, they go abroad
To market and to work upon the sod.
If Hymenaeus disagreed with Paul,
It's certain that He kept You one from all.
If Alexander argued on some point,
At least he kept the Sabbath in his joint.

1 Timothy 2

1 So I exhort that first of all
Supplications and prayers install,
And intercessions, and thanksgiving,
Be made for all men *where they're living*,
2 For kings and for all those in power,
That we may lead a quiet hour
And peaceful life in godliness
And honesty in every dress.
3 For this is good, acceptable
In sight of God our Saviour full,
4 Who will have all men to be saved,
Come to truth's knowing *and engraved*.

The Muslim's have three kinds of prayer:
Canonical five times beware,
The supplication on the air,
Remembrance of lovely and fair.
But Paul's a Christian sort, and he
Has four words on eternity:
The first two are the same, it seems,
But he divides remembrance dreams
Into the intercession's beams
And in thanksgiving's further rate.
Beloved, for three or four in state,
Or even five, my powers elate
To find that prayer finds You at home
Wherever my poor soul may roam.

5 For there's one God, and one between
As mediator on the scene
Of God and men, the man I ween

Christ Jesus *one baith snell and keen*
6 To give himself ransom for all,
To be testified in due call,
7 To whom I am ordained a preacher,
And an apostle, my words reach her
In truth and not in lie, a teacher
Of Gentiles in faith and truth's bleacher.

Paul wants his reader to be certain sure
That there is only one God, You the pure.
When that is settled like the firmest creed,
Then he remarks upon the further need
Of mediator between men and You.
That one is Jesus Christ in heavenly crew.
Whatever Christ may be in origin,
In essence or in flesh without a sin,
He wants us to think of him as a man,
And so he writes that word as by his plan.
Beloved, You are my God alone and I
Come to Your throne with Christ and so
rely

On one who's sinless where I only try,
And that is why I find I too can fly.

8 And so I want men everywhere
To pray, lifting hands in the air
In holiness, and without wrath
And doubting *on the narrow path*.

I did not see one in the synagogue
Lift up his hands in prayer before the grog,
But that may be the case, experience
Is limited in synagogal sense.

I did see in the mosque when all cried out
Allahu akbar with a common shout
Hands raised in adulation all about.
I did see in the Pentecostal church
Hands swaying high and everywhere to
lurch.

Beloved, if I do not raise above ear
My palms set forward and thrown out of
gear,

Remember me for love and purity,
As I say You are greater than the spree
Of common faith around me that I see.

9 In the same way, the women too
Should adorn themselves in the view
Of modesty, shamefacedness
And sober countenance to bless,
And not with plated hair with gold
Or pearls or costly garments sold,

10 But with what becomes women who
 Profess to godliness in crew
 Of good works. 11 Let the woman learn
 In silence, no subjection spurn.
 12 But I do not let women teach
 Or take authority to preach
 Over the man, but to keep mum.
 13 For Adam was formed first, the bum,
 And then Eve. 14 And Adam was not
 Deceived, but the woman in plot,
 Being deceived fell to disgrace.
 15 Nevertheless she shall be saved
 In bearing children, so unstaved,
 If they continue in the faith
 And charity and without wraith
 In holiness, and sober face.

They say these words were spoke in time of
 grief,
 When synagogue was church for unbelief,
 And ladies had a place behind the veil
 And upstairs from which they with hearty
 hale
 Might call down to their husbands to tell
 them
 What preaching went on for a pretty gem.
 That would explain the reason they should
 be
 More silent and stayed in their charity.
 But I doubt that is right. I do expect
 That Paul was misogynic to neglect.
 He really thinks a woman's saved by pain
 And childbirth to keep her in from the rein.
 His concept of Genesis two and three
 Is also a bit much. I disagree.

1 Timothy 3

1 This is a saying true, if one
 Desire the office to be won
 Of overseer, he desires
 A good work *in which work he tires*.
 2 An overseer must then be blameless,
 The husband of one wife as nameless,
 And vigilant, and sober too,
 Of good behaviour in the pew,
 Hospitable, and apt to teach;
 3 Not given to wine, and not to reach
 Out hand to strike to take in store
 The filthy lucre *at the door*,
 But patient, not a brawler where
 There are things to covet laid bare,
 4 One who rules his own house with care,

His children in subjection all
 With gravity in home and hall.
 5 For if a man does not know how
 To rule his own house and his plough,
 How shall he take care of those called
 Out by God from the stony walled?
 6 He's not to be a novice, lest
 In pride he's lifted up to best
 To fall into the condemnation
 The devil spreads out *with elation*.
 7 His reputation ought to be
 Good among those outside degree,
 Lest he fall in reproach and see
 The snares of Satan on his knee.

How can a priest not be given to wine?
 The Eucharist alone without the brine
 Will bring the alcohol along to dine.
 St. Paul was not considering man's state.
 How can a priest not drink himself to sleep
 When everything he cherishes is deep
 In the monastic art of bright moonshine?
 St. Paul was not writing for those of late.
 Beloved, I'm not a priest unless the view
 That I participate among the crew
 Of Revelation's kingly sort of stew
 Is taken in consideration here.
 I'm just a humble catechist to cheer
 And warm the bench and look without a
 blear.

8 The deacons too as servants grave,
 Not double-tongued, not set to lave
 With wine and filthy lucre's stave;
 9 Holding the mystery of faith
 In a pure conscience *without wraith*.
 10 And let these also first be tried,
 Then let them serve as deacons plied
 When they're found blameless *on their
 side*.
 11 Their wives should be grave too, and not
 Engage in slander or in plot,
 Be sober, faithful in all things.
 12 Let deacons have one spouse and rule
 Their children and their own house school.
 13 Those who work well as deacons make
 For their own selves a lovely stake,
 And great boldness in faith that is
 In Christ Jesus in work and whiz.
 14 I write these things to you in hope
 Of coming to you soon in lope.
 15 But if I don't come soon, then you

Must know how to behave as true
In God's house, which is those called out
By the God living without doubt,
The pillar and ground of truth's spout.

Both bishops and the deacons I have known
Of Baptist provenance I have to own
Did not rule house and home as well as
church.

Without the wife, they would be in the
lurch.

It's mostly preacher's wives that set the
pace

And treat among the stealthy human race
Come to confession or in Baptist way
Into the gossip circle without pay.

The Roman rite is wise to keep the priest
Without a wife, and that's to say the least.
In that case priests have no excuse at all
To taste the wine within the holy stall.
Beloved, St. Paul treats of a church of
stone,

Utopia, a place that's never grown.

16 To be confessed a thing most great,
The mystery of godly state
Which appeared in the flesh and yet
Was justified in spirit met,
Was seen by angels and proclaimed
Among the nations, and was aimed
In faith in the world, taken up
In glory *both to drink and sup*.

This is a creed if called confession first,
And is not really of the very worst.
The godly state appears a mystery,
Born in the flesh and spirit angels see,
Proclaimed the master of faith in the world,
And then taken to glory when unfurled.
That is enough for faith, no Trinity,
No deathly cross on the atoning tree,
No pagan resurrections, but the might
Of angels and the following for right,
And last the heavenly path beneath his feet.
Beloved, give me such creeds and for my
treat

I'll sing them in the congregation meet
And when I get home once more, so repeat.

1 Timothy 4

1 The Spirit now speaks outright that
In the last times some shall in spat

Depart from the faith, giving heed
To such seducing spirits' *greed*,
And doctrines of devils *in need*;
2 Speaking hypocritical lies;
Having their conscience seared with cries
Of a hot iron. 3 Such forbid
To marry, but then standing hid
From meats which God created good
To be received with thanks as should
By those of faith who know the truth.
4 For every creature of God's good,
And nothing's to be refused couth,
If it's received with thanks forsooth.
5 For it is sanctified by word
Of God and prayer *when prayer is heard*.
6 If you remind the brothers of
These things, you'll be a *son of love*,
Good minister of Jesus Christ,
Nourished up in the word sufficed
Of faith and of good doctrine too,
In which you have attained the true.

I search in vain for the false faith that states
No man may marry but must meet his fates
A vegetarian. Of course that rule
Is found in some Buddhistic sort of school,
But that is hardly mark of the end time
Where there are many other sorts of crime.
Tibetan exercises do maintain
That life eternal is the gift in pain
Of celibacy on condition that
The right movements keep body from the
fat.

Beloved, if ever I find that rare meeting
To mark the end of time with padded
seating,
I'll know to run away and find Your word
Is still above the things that have occurred.

7 But refuse profane old wives' tales,
And strive for godliness *in sails*.

8 For bodily exercise does
Not profit much, but godliness
Is beneficial to a buzz,
Of promise in this life's address,
And in the coming one confess.

8 This is a faithful saying and
Worthy to get and understand.

10 That's why we work and suffer yet
Reproach, because we trust we've set
The living God before, who is
The Saviour of all men, that is

Of those who believe in the biz.

11 These things command and teach *with*
fizz.

12 But let no man despise your youth;
But be a witness to the truth

In word, in action, and in love,

In spirit, faith and purity,

13 Till I come read well the above,

And keep exhorting and still see

To doctrine *in its purity*.

No doubt young Timothy liked to work out

And so the old St. Paul, though he was
stout,

Remarked how little good such things can
do.

It may have been just sour grapes in view.

Today the sects and cults maintain the truth

That working out or jogging in one's youth

Should keep the old man healthy for his
part

At least if he is careful of his heart.

And even Catholic young men come
together

To enjoy more than bingo and fair weather.

Beloved, I find my sedentary ways

In conflict with my active younger days,

In conflict with my roaming in the past

Around the mountains as long as days last.

14 Do not neglect the gift in you,

Which was given you by prophecy,

With laying on of hands in crew.

15 Think then about these things and give

Yourself to them as so you live,

So benefit is seen by all.

16 Watch out so that you do not fall

From doctrine, but keep in the stall,

For in so doing you will save

Yourself and those who hear *from grave*.

If Timothy's in danger in his time

Of falling from right doctrine as a crime,

Then I should think that no one's safe here
now,

Since we've had time to spin a royal row

Of heresy and faithless gaps that show

The secular the better way to go.

If Timothy's in danger of his faith,

Then what about the modern sort of waif

That follows just what his own preacher
states?

Shall anyone come in the pearlish gates?

Beloved, no hand of prophecy guides me

More than another in the fatal spree,

And yet the light that Your word sheds
abroad

Is like enough to lead me to my God.

1 Timothy 5

1 Do not rebuke an elder, but

Entreat him as a father's gut,

And younger men as brothers, and

2 The elder women as they stand

In place of mothers, and the young

As sisters, with all purity.

3 Honour the widows not in tongue

But those who are widows to see.

This verse is an excuse for the young priest

Obeying the establishment increased,

The rule of old men who have been
released

From obligations of life here and now

By memories still cool upon the brow.

Fact is, when any man stands up to say

The Decalogue no longer is in sway,

He may and must then be rebuked by all

And any, even young men on the sprawl.

Beloved, I've heard the argument again

And seen results among the sweetest men,

And found them living in comfort and fine.

Beloved, I seek to toe the humble line,

But will berate my elders for their wine.

4 But if any widow indeed

Has children or nephews in need,

Let then learn first the godly way

And home and be their parents' stay:

For that's good and acceptable

Before God *to bring to the full*.

5 Now she that is widowed indeed,

And desolate, trusts in God's seed,

And keeps on begging night and day

By prayer in supplication's way.

6 But she who lives in pleasure's dead

As long as she so lives instead.

7 And give these commands to them so

They may live in a blameless show.

8 If anyone does not provide

For his own, his own house to bide,

He's denied the faith and he's worse

Than any infidel *to curse*.

9 Let no widow be taken in

The number of those in the bin
Under sixty years of age, if
Only having been one man's stiff.
10 She must have a good reputation
For good works, raised her spawn in ration,
Lodged guests and washed the feet of
saints,

Relieved afflicted ones' restraints,
Been diligent in good works' *station*.

11 But younger widows then refuse,
For when they get their hots in fuse,
Despite Christ, they'll marry and choose.

12 They're lost, in fact, since they've cast
off

Their first faith *as a thing to scoff*.

13 Besides that they learn to be lazy,
And go from house to house like crazy,
Not only idle but to tell

The truth, they're gossips come to swell
With busybodied fortunes where
They speak things that they should not
share.

Beloved, if You had just thought long ago,
When You inspired St. Paul to write and
show

Such thoughts as these about the female
glow,

How it would sound today, You would
have stopped

To reconsider the word St. Paul popped.
The less said about this the better fed,
The less replied, the better what You said.
There is no angel message in this stead.
You should have quelled the problem at the
start

By making androgens with double heart
Instead of men and women with a dart.
Perhaps you did, and St. Paul and the rest
Are victims of illusions of the best,
Who find too many ripples on the chest.

14 That's why I want the younger wenches
To marry, bear children *in trenches*,
Do their housework and give no room
For Satan to accuse for doom.

15 For some already turned aside
After their Satan to abide.

A woman's good enough for marriage if
She's still young and the man can still get
stiff.

If not, then let her be caged with the free
Enjoying suppers' holy strategy.
A woman has no mind to find a place
On earth besides her bearing of the race,
Is St. Paul's mind. He'd make a better trace
Upon another planet and with grace.
Beloved, I doubt that You Yourself can
read

These lines without a rueful smile untreed.
If You can fathom St. Paul's thoughts set
free

Upon the hopeless, helpless in degree,
Then You are doing much better than me.
I return to the page from which I feed.

16 If any man or woman here
Who believes have widows to steer,
Let them relieve them and not let
The church be burdened where they're set,
So it may use fund where they're met.

17 Let elders ruling well be counted
As worthy of double grace mounted,
Especially those who labour in
The word and doctrine *without sin*.

18 For Scripture says "You shall not
muzzle

The ox that treads out corn to guzzle,"
And "Every worker must receive
His salary *and so relieve*."

The paying of the pastorate is fine
In theory, but just see results decline.
The one who pays the salary at best
Determines what is truth beneath the vest.
Beloved, if You would have Your elders be
Both truthful and both faithful in degree,
Then You Yourself must pay their salary.
The muzzled ox is better than the cow
That never unveils untruths anyhow,
And better than the farrowing fat sow,
The norm in preachers is no better now.
The double grace to those who hold the
keys

Of heaven and Rome is greater wine and
cheese,
Nepotism, corruption, if You please.

19 Do not believe an accusation
Against an elder with elation,
But only when it is affirmed
Before two or three witness termed.

You would protect officials in their greed,
The elders who comb Your church as for
seed
To find a farthing dropped as for some
need.

I bring an accusation on them all,
And everyone particular in stall.
I bring no witness to my plain but that
Of truth and justice where the fat cats sat.
If that is not enough, Beloved, then scat.
You know that mosque and church and
synagogue
Are all in pay of privateers in cog,
And governments out to increase the log.
You know, so make no demands on my
pale,
Requiring witnesses to beat the bail.
Priests are fair game from everywhere I
hail.

20 Rebuke those who sin before all,
So others learn to fear the squall.
21 I command you before God and
The Lord Jesus Christ and to stand
Before the elect angels to
Observe these things without a view
To favouritism's partial cue.
22 Do not be quick to ordain men,
Do not participate again
In other men's sins, but keep pure.
23 Don't drink just water, but be sure
To add a little wine to it
And so to keep your stomach fit,
And keep you healthy every bit.
24 Some men's sins lie open before,
Going into the judgement's door,
And other's sins follow the shore.
25 By the same token the good works
Of some are plain to see for quirks,
And otherwise none can be hidden
Who are called and also are bidden.

The public scandal of rebuke today
Is neither politic nor comfort's way.
It is not a thing effective at all
To cry aloud like prophet in a brawl.
St. Paul makes appeal to impartial point,
But in the end he stays to smoke a joint.
The only rebuke public that he'll take
Is that made to the laymen at the stake.
The elders must not be accused at all,
Unless their sins are performed at the call

Of public and parade instead of stall.
So much for such impartial judgement set.
I see results in everyone I've met.
The clergy get away with murder's pet.

1 Timothy 6

1 Let those who're slaves under the yoke
Consider their masters in stroke
As worthy of respect of all,
So that the name of God in stall
And His doctrine not be blasphemed.
2 And those with masters as it seemed
With faith, let them not be despised,
Because they're brothers as devised,
But rather work for them, because
They're faithful and beloved, in paws
Partakers of the benefit.
These things teach and exhort as fit.
3 If anyone teach otherwise,
And not consent to these words wise,
The words of our Lord Jesus Christ,
And to the doctrine as sufficed
To godliness, 4 then he is proud,
And does not know anything bowed,
But dotes on questions and on strife
Of words producing no good life,
But only envy, strife, and railing,
And evil dispositions failing,
5 Perverse disputes of men corrupt
In mind, and without truth *uncupped*,
Presuming to gain godliness:
From such withdraw you your address.
6 But godliness with happiness
Is great gain, 7 For we have brought naught
Into this world, and nothing bought
Can be taken out of it sought.
8 And having food and clothing then
Let us be happy *without yen*.

St. Paul requires the single-hearted man
Who is a slave to knuckle to the span
Of master, whether it be yoke in heart
Or drudging in the physical apart.
The status quo's a yolk to those who find
A share of wealth above the deaf and blind
To beat to lather in a cake revealed
By stripes upon the back that go unhealed.
Provoke, Beloved, the token of the oak,
The neck piece firmly set and goad to stoke
The fires that threaten those beneath the
cloak
Of fair-weather oppression drinking coke.

I do withdraw from every sort of peer
That rules the land with subtlety of fear.

9 But those who seek wealth will fall in
Temptation and a snare in bin,
And into many foolish things
And hurtful lusts, which without wings
Drown men in destruction's losings.
10 For love of money is the root
Of every evil, and pursuit
Of it in covetousness brings
Some to err from the faith, and so
They pierce themselves with much sorrow.
11 But you, O man of God, must flee
These doings; and follow and see
The righteous thing, and godliness,
And faith, love, patience, and meekness.
12 Fight the good fight of faith, lay hold
On life eternal, be so bold
As called to a profession told
Before many witnesses gold.
13 I give command in sight of God
To you, who enlivens all sod,
And before Christ Jesus, who came
Before Pontius Pilate in claim
Of witness to confessing fame,
14 That you keep this commandment well,
Without spot, unrebukable,
Until our Lord Jesus Christ come,
15 Who in his times shall show his sum,
Who is the blessed and only great
Ruler, the King of kings in state,
And Lord of lords; 16 who only knew
Immortal being, dwelling true
In light no man can come unto;
Whom no man has seen nor can see,
Be honoured strong eternally. Amen.

The love of money is the root of life,
The welling power that quells the single
 strife,
But in the impact of the social scale
Performs a role that makes the visage pale.
The love of money is the root of evil,
The catalyst of every new upheaval
That turns the field to plough the row again
Among the wheeling crowds of business
 men.
Beloved, I too love money and I reach
For all my plate can hold. That's why I
 preach.
Pilate himself had gall to give a share

And wash his hands after making them bare
To bribery and threats that Caesar might
See through his love of money in the night.

17 Give a commandment to the rich
In this world, so they will not pitch
Themselves high-minded, and not trust
In riches uncertain to rust,
But in the living God, who gives
Us richly all, to each that lives,
18 So they'll do good, and so they'll be
Rich in good works, and so ready
To give to others and freely:
19 Laying up store for themselves so
A good foundation on the go
Against the time to come, so they
May grasp life in eternal sway.

I too trust in the bank account and not
So much in Your good blessing and
 unsought.
The money pays the bills, and what I eat
Is taken from the stores for moneyed treat.
There is a weight upon the soul to find
That banks go broke and pour out the well
 wined,
And where I thought a flood of yield would
 come
A sparsity had landed on the sum.
Beloved, the rich may have a cue at hand,
But still all live upon the fertile land,
Or on the rocky shore. The latter stand
To catch fish rather than wait for the brook
Of what You have to give in smaller nook.
And I myself, though trusting, take a look.

20 O Timothy, keep what is set
To you in trust, avoiding met
Profane and vain in babblings yet,
And oppositions of what's called
Falsely by science' name installed,
21 Which some when they accept *the bald*
Have gone astray from the faith *sprawled*.
Grace be with you *and all the called*.
 Amen.

How many things have been set here
In stone, at least ten such to cheer,
And yet the preachers would behold
The law of God as stuff and sold.
I keep, Beloved, the Decalogue,
I do not eat crayfish or hog,

I close my ear to babblings loud
 That raise the pope in incense cloud,
 I shun the vain philosophy
 That makes You, Dear, one out of three.
 If I alone keep to the faith
 In Your reality, not wraith,
 Then let me stand firm and alone,
 In faith as well as flesh and bone.

The Second Epistle of Paul to Timothy

Just as in his first letter, Paul comes in
 To remind Timothy of churchly din,
 And softens it with his own bit of hope
 In hymnic liturgies as fine as pope.
 Both first and second Timothy are more
 Than just descriptions of the churchly floor.
 They make a tiny hymnal on the shore
 Of hymn-writing tradition that would start
 With heresy and how to play its part.
 That's why I myself prefer Psalms alone,
 Or at the most just Scripture to atone,
 Eschewing hymns sung at the divine throne
 Of worship on the Sabbath in my gate.
 If Paul had known the future, he'd berate.

2 Timothy 1

1 Paul who is an apostle of
 Jesus Christ sent down by the *love*
 And will of God, according to
 The promise of life come in view
 In Christ Jesus, 2 to Timothy,
 Dearly beloved son: Grace, mercy
 And peace from God the Father and
 Christ Jesus our Lord *come to stand*.
 3 I thank God, whom I serve from my
 Ancestors with pure conscience nigh,
 That without ceasing I retain
 Remembrance of you to regain
 My prayers both night and day in reign;
 4 Greatly desiring to see you,
 Remembering your tears come due,
 That I may be filled up with joy;
 5 When I call to remembrance' tie
 The unfeigned faith that's in your pew,
 Which stood first in your grand-dam Lois,
 And also in your mother Eunice;
 And I am sure it's in you too.
 6 That's why I want to remind you
 To stir up God's gift that's in you
 By laying of my hands on you.

7 For God's not given us spirit of fear,
 But of power and of love *come near*,
 And of a sound mind *to appear*.

St. Paul tells Timothy to stir the gift
 Up that is in him, not lie in the rift.
 But that gift is not talents lodged for use
 As Milton would have in blindness' abuse.
 It's nothing of the sought-for self-esteem
 That is the catchword of the day and dream.
 Instead, that gift is laying on of hands,
 Whatever blessing comes from rite's
 commands.

Beloved, I lift a hand to You to take
 The blessed universe for dervish sake,
 And with the left, unseen from the right's
 wake,

Dispense the breeze and spirit to the fold,
 The dusty street, the littered cup and old
 That flutters in retreat, having been sold.

8 Don't be ashamed of our Lord's witness,
 Nor of me prisoner *for fitness*,
 But be partaker of afflictions
 Of the gospel *in all its dictions*
 According to the power of God,
 9 Who's saved us and called by the rod
 Of holy calling, and not by
 Our works, but by His purpose nigh
 And grace, which was given us in Christ
 Jesus before the world began,
 10 But is now very clear to scan
 By the appearing of our Saviour
 Jesus Christ, who's abolished death,
 And brought life and immortal savour
 Of light come through the gospel's breath,
 11 To which I'm called to preach and be
 Apostle and teacher's degree
 Among the Gentiles. 12 And that's why
 I also suffer *and I cry*,
 And still I am not ashamed here,
 Because I know whom *without fear*
 I have believed, and so I'm sure
 That he is able to keep pure
 What I've committed to his care
 Against that day *I come to share*.

The point is that Jesus abolished death,
 At least for those to whom he gives his
 breath.

I trow the reason he's left in the lurch
 By every sort of synagogue and church,

Is simply that he was too late on perch.
 Sweet Socrates was swindled of his life
 Some centuries before Christ met the strife.
 And Plato taught us all that death is not
 A thing at all: the soul survives the plot.
 That's why we fear no longer crosses and
 The death that yawns upon us from the
 sand.
 We need no Jesuses who have the drought
 Of heady, deathless soul we always sought.
 We're independently alive and stand.

13 Keep hold of the form of right words
 That you have heard from me in sherds
 In faith and love which is in Christ
 Jesus. 14 That good thing which was
 spliced
 To you keep by the Holy Ghost
 Which dwells in us *and we're his host*.
 15 You know that all those who are in
 Asia are turned away with din
 From me, of whom are Phygellus,
 Hermogenes too *with a fuss*.

St. Paul neglects the truth that underdog
 Is stepped on by the crowd swirled in the
 fog
 Of praise to the victorious and free.
 He should not have written such a decree.
 Now everyone knows his rejection's state,
 And sees him fall from pedestal and rate.
 If he'd not mentioned this, now we'd not
 know
 That he was so unpopular in show.
 If everyone in the church in the east
 Had turned away from Paul, that just
 increased
 The likelihood in human mind that he
 Was not Your preacher preaching
 faithfully.
 Beloved, I don't say so, though, for I see
 Only the crickets hear my prodigy.

16 The Lord give mercy to the house
 Of Onesiphorus and spouse,
 For he refreshed me often and
 Was not ashamed of my chain's band.
 17 But when he was in Rome he sought
 Me diligently until caught.
 18 The Lord grant him that he may find
 Mercy of the Lord in the bind
 Of that day, and in how many

Things he served me at Ephesus,
 You know well and in great degree.

St. Paul keeps up the pretence that his chain
 Brings shame on him from church, not
 wicked stain
 Of preaching against law and circumcision.
 His blindness comes from his own blind
 decision.
 I too am blind. I think that I'm rejected
 For being great and true, and I'm neglected
 Because of competition and the file
 Of jealousy of my great wit and smile.
 Let St. Paul and myself lie wallowing
 In faint conceits and read our Psalms or
 sing,
 While everyone knows our successes ring
 To the extent our advertising sits
 In places visible with power and glitz.
 It's cover picture, not the inside fits.

2 Timothy 2

1 So you, my son, be strong in grace
 That comes before Christ Jesus' face.
 2 And what you've heard from me among
 Manifold witnesses in tongue,
 Commit to faithful men who can
 Teach others also of the plan.
 3 Endure then hardness like a man,
 Good soldier in Jesus Christ's scan.
 4 No man in battle gets caught up
 With this life's matters *and its cup*,
 But pleases the one who chose him
 To be a soldier *on the rim*.
 5 And if a man strives to compete,
 Then he's not crowned, unless replete
 With lawfulness *in his retreat*.
 6 The farmer that works must partake
 First of the harvest in its wake.
 7 Consider what I say and may
 The Lord make you grasp every ray.

Grace does not in the Gospel plot remove
 The soul from battles on the march and
 prove
 The life of indolence to be the share
 Of those who are beneath Your loving care.
 The soldier and the farmer both sit tight
 And lend both eye and arm to harvest right
 And to the winning of the desperate fight.
 Grace merely lays the desperation bare.
 Paul tells good Timothy he must be strong

In grace to oppose every sort of wrong.
Today grace is the pressing proof we need
That strength is the last thing on which to
feed.

Instead grace nourishes the weak resolve,
Belief that no one here need to involve.

8 Remember Jesus Christ's the seed
Of David and raised up indeed
From the dead by my gospel's creed,
9 In which I suffer trouble here,
As a malefactor to appear
In chains, but God's word is not bound.
10 That's why I'm patient all around
For the elect's sake, so they'll get
Salvation in Christ Jesus met
With his eternal glory yet.

To tell the truth I like David the better,
Matter of taste I guess, pointer or setter.
He's charismatic. Jesus holds his own,
But David's rhymes ought to be carved in
stone.

If there could be salvation in the singing
Of Psalms instead of crosses and blood
wringing,
I'd cantillate the Psalms both night and day
And leave Jesus alone that night to pray
That one would watch a while. He's
David's seed,
And so I take the both in awkward greed,
Whether or not I number with elect,
Rich and increased and in my white robe
decked.

Beloved, eternal glory's not my speed,
But if You give it, I'll take as I need.

11 A faithful saying: If we are
Dead with him, then we'll be a star
To live with him. 12 If we are hurt,
We'll also reign with him alert;
If we deny him, he too then
Comes to deny all such of men;
13 But if we don't believe, still he
Remains one faithful, because he
Cannot deny his own decree.

I'm Thomas Doubter, that's a saying too,
And in my case I am afraid it's true.
And yet St. Paul brings comfort to my kind,
Revealing that I may be saved though
blind,

Because the one is faithful and resigned,
Despite my faithlessness here in my pew.
Beloved, despite my doubts, I don't deny
Either You by my words, nor with a sigh
The one You sent below to live and die.
The resurrection seems too much to take,
And doubt forever lingers in my wake,
And yet the promise is not set to be
Contingent on my incredulity.
Alternative's a fiery, burning lake.

14 Remember these things, give command
Before the Lord, so they'll not stand
To argue about words in vain
That subvert hearers for no gain.
15 Try hard to show yourself approved
To God, a workman not behoved
To shame, but in the righteous way
Interpret word of truth in sway.
16 But shun profane babblings in vain,
For they'll increase unto more gain
In their ungodliness *and stain*.
17 Their word will eat like canker sore,
Such as Hymenaeus *in store*
And Philetus *behind the door*,
18 Who have erred from the truth to say
That resurrection's in past day,
And overthrow the faith of some.
19 Still God's foundation stands to come,
Having this seal, that the Lord knows
Those who are his planted in rows.
So let each one who names the name
Of Christ depart from sin and blame.
20 But in a fine house there are not
Just gold and silver in the pot,
But also wood and earthly lot,
Some for display, some chamber pot.
21 If a man then will cleanse himself
From these, he'll be a vase on shelf
Of honour, sanctified, and fine
For the master's use *at his wine*,
Prepared for good use *on the vine*.

Sometimes the chamber pot is of use far
Beyond the pretty vase set on a par.
But when it comes to usefulness or not,
There are still as Paul says some in the plot
Subverting truth and Your established
right.

There are still many walking in the night.
For night-time occupations chamber pots
Are more in use than flowers cut in lots.

Until the time when flowers are cut to be
 The glory of the parlour under key,
 You know the ones planted to grow by
 name,
 To keep their hands and fingers out of
 shame.
 Cleanse me, Beloved, while I still try to
 stay
 Beside the temple fountain on a day.

22 Flee also youthful lusts, but go
 After the righteousness and glow
 Of faith and charity, and peace,
 With those who call on the Lord's lease
 Out of a pure heart *without cease*.
 23 But stay away from questions that
 Are foolish and unlearned fat,
 Knowing that they just give rise to
 The strifes *that separate the pew*.
 24 The slave of the Lord must not strive,
 But be gentle to all the hive,
 Ready to teach, patient to do,
 25 Meekly instructing all those who
 Oppose themselves, if perhaps God
 Will give them penitence in rod
 To admit what is true *on sod*,
 26 So they may get themselves set free
 Of the snare the devil in spree
 Has made them captives in degree.

Beloved, I follow not the counsels here.
 My lusts no longer youthful still appear.
 My heart is never pure and single taught,
 Inventing questions to complain a lot.
 With every fish that targets me with tale
 Of questions, I rise to the bait, no fail,
 And wrangle with the angle, bait gone
 stale.
 I strive and am not gentle with the folk
 Who stand to proclaim falsehood like a
 joke.
 If I instruct at all, no meekness makes
 The penitent admit their true mistakes.
 Beloved, after the snare to spare the spree,
 Look down in the same patience and degree
 Upon Your faithful servant, upon me.

2 Timothy 3

1 Know this too, that in the last days
 Shall come dangerous times and ways.
 2 For men shall love of their own selves,
 Be covetous, boasters like elves,

Proud, and blasphemers, disobey
 Their parents in ungrateful sway,
 Unholy be, 3 without the way
 Affectionate in nature's ray,
 Truce breakers and accusers false,
 Incontinent, and fierce to waltz,
 Despisers of those who are good,
 4 Traitors, heady, high-minded wood,
 Lovers of pleasures more than God,
 5 Having godliness in form shod,
 But to deny its power on sod:
 Turn back from such who meet the clod.

I turn back from all men, Beloved, I see
 Upon the sodden meadow I plough free,
 Who are described by every lusty word
 That You have fastened on the heaving
 herd.
 I turn back on the church and state and flee
 To You and to Your Scriptures' purity,
 And take no doctrine but the honey sweet
 Of Your commandments at the Saviour's
 feet.
 Beloved, I find the power that sits upon
 The throne of humble waiting for Your
 dawn,
 And see the flash of sword glittered and
 drawn
 From Ali's and from David's scabbard neat.
 I turn back from all men upon the seat
 Of their injustice to seek Your last treat.

6 These are the kind who creep inside
 Houses and lead captive to bide
 Such silly women who will hide
 There with their sins, and lead away
 With many kinds of lust in sway,
 7 Always learning, but never come
 To know the truth in all its sum.
 8 Now as Jannes and Jambres came
 To withstand Moses, so the same
 Do these too in resisting truth:
 Men of corrupt minds and uncouth,
 And reprobate from faith for sooth.

Beloved, I see the creepers creeping fair,
 Not just Jehovah's Witnesses to share,
 But every kind of creeper in the vein
 Of printed books and magazines in bane,
 Of internet and television's fane.
 They speak to change both times and laws
 and take

Their silly women into their mistake.
 They preach their Sundays and new moons
 in wake,
 Their trinities and silver spoons in lake.
 Beloved, the pair that withstood Moses
 there,
 Magicians in their right of court and fair,
 Have still their brass descendants on the
 cake.
 I too am always learning, but I've come
 To know the ten commandments are truth's
 sum.

9 But they will get no further on,
 For their own follow shall be drawn
 Before all as has been from dawn.
 10 But you have fully known my word
 Of doctrine, way of life and heard
 The purpose, faith, long-suffering and
 My charity and patient stand,
 11 With persecutions and afflictions,
 Which came to me and by predictions
 At Antioch, Iconium,
 At Lystra, what trials in sum
 I had to endure, but out from
 Them all the Lord saved me *a bum*.
 12 Indeed, and all who'll live godly
 In Christ Jesus shall suffer spree.
 13 But evil men, seducers too,
 Shall just get worse and worse in view,
 Deceiving and being deceived.
 14 But keep on in the things relieved
 That you have learned and been assured,
 Knowing who taught you and who cured,
 15 And that since you were just a child
 You've known the holy Scriptures mild,
 Which can make you wise to salvation
 Through faith in Christ Jesus *in ration*.

My own childhood was marked by
 Scriptures read
 And then recited to me by my bed.
 As I learned twelve verses and could
 repeat,
 My mother read me one tale as a treat.
 Reward for learning Scriptures still
 commands
 My soul to follow on the glowing sands
 Of Hebrew words and letters strung on
 page
 To sing aloud their songs from age to age.
 Beloved, I find You present on the air

Where Your grand dwelling of the Psalms
 sounds fair,
 And as I taste that You are good, I raise
 Another song of penitence and praise.
 And as I taste that You are true, I find
 A healing for the dumb as well as blind.

16 All Scripture's give by inspiration
 Of God, and is for profit's station
 For doctrine, for reproof, and for
 Correction, for instruction's store
 In righteousness, 17 that man of God
 May become perfect under rod,
 Fully endowed with all good works
Above everyone here that shirks.

All Scripture is one thing upon the sod.
 And yet I'm not sure that all leads to God.
 You mark Your passing with a single note,
 A thing from Genesis I've got by rote.
 The great wind on the waters seems to sing,
 And when I listen hard to hear the thing,
 It turns to melody without a sting.
 For doctrine and reproof I need the writing
 Upon the page my soul is always fighting.
 I do not wait to find the Scriptures
 slighting,
 But still am not sure of the building's
 lighting.
 Beloved, look down upon my great inciting
 And see if You're reflected in the pair
 Of books of life my soul has come to share.

2 Timothy 4

1 I command you then before God,
 And the Lord Jesus Christ in prod,
 Who'll judge the quick and dead when he
 Appears in his own kingdom free;
 2 So preach the word, be quick in time
 And out of the right time in rhyme,
 Reprove, rebuke, exhort with all
 Patience and doctrine in the stall.

Beloved, You hear me preaching by the
 wood,
 Beneath the firs and birches as I should.
 You see the birds and moles come round to
 hear,
 And once or twice grasshopper without
 fear,
 And listen to my chiding them for gear,
 And for false doctrine on the itching ear.

You see and hear me preaching in my time
And with my running metres and my
rhyme.

But do you see a single sparrow stay
Before repentant's altar and to pray?
They all fly off, Beloved, and I am left
Before my sermons huffing and bereft.
Send me a congregation where I preach,
And I'll rebuke each nobleman and peach.

3 For time will come when they will not
Endure sound doctrine in their lot,
But after their own lusts they'll heap
Up to themselves teachers to keep
Their itching ears, 4 and they shall turn
Away their ears from truth, discern
Merely the fables that they earn.

I've seen the itching ears and those who do
Not endure the sound doctrine and the true.
The most of men run to the Sunday's rue,
But of the rest who slumber, there are few
Who turn back to the moon to tell them
when

To keep their sabbaths in the witch's glen.
Beloved, I gather with the one or two
Who take the seventh-day set up by You
For worship, and I read Your sacred word,
And never stumble at the things I've heard.
Sound doctrine is left on the drift by all
Who rush about at every whim and call
And fill the many palaces, each hall
Where fantasy's displayed to hide the gall.

5 But watch in all things and endure
Afflictions, do the work and sure
Of an evangelist, and make
Full proof of your ministry's stake.

6 I'm ready to be sacrificed,
And my departure is sufficed.

7 I've fought a good fight, I have come
To the end of my course in sum,
I've kept the faith. 8 From now on there
Is saved up for me righteous share,
A crown, which the Lord, righteous judge,
Shall give me on that day a drudge,
And not to me alone, but to
All those also that love the view
Of his appearing *to the true*.

My ministry is left both high and dry,
Unlike that of poor Noah under sky

Of violence before the Flood came late.
He almost got a shower on his pate.
My ministry is left both high and spy,
Unlike that of poor Paul who came to cry
Aloud to every mariner awake
Not to abandon ship for mercy's sake.
Beloved, I may depart, but I reveal
A life that is deprived of all appeal
Of great success as an evangelist,
As prophet or of fighter with my fist.
My day of judgement finds me with bare
hands,
Except for sonnets praising Your
commands.

9 Try hard to come soon to me here,
10 For Demas left me in his fear
And love of this world present dear,
And has gone to Thessalonica,
Crescens to Galatia to strike her,
And Titus to Dalmatian sphere.
11 And only Luke is with me here.
Take Mark and bring him with you too,
He's beneficial for my cue.

Mark is the one that Paul would leave
behind
And quarrelled with his friend when he
designed
To take the young man back under his
wing.

Paul too can change his mind about a thing.
There are a few that I too think would be
Both beneficial and no threat to me
Who are long lost behind the veils of time
And distances of continent and clime.
Beloved, the love of world may separate
The men from friends upon an outer gate,
But I still have the strong bonds of the mate
Or two or three I knew in youthful crime.
I need not pray that they remember now,
Nor that they come to me again somehow.

12 And Tychicus I've sent unto
Ephesus. 13 The coat that I left
At Troas with Carpus bereft,
When you come, bring, and the books too,
Especially the parchments' hue.

Paul knows what's needful in the earthly
life:

A coat and books, but neither sword nor knife.

I wonder where Paul's old coat disappeared.
No doubt if it were found today unfear'd,
It would be quite a relic of the just,
Even if eaten by the moth and dust.
Beloved, my cousin gave me once a coat,
A denim one with pockets that could float
The snaps the held my treasures like a boat.
I wore it out with wearing after years
And do not know now where it lies in biers.
Perhaps cold Paul was also of the kind
To wear a coat till threadbare to unwind.
Some others buy them faster than designed.

14 Alexander the coppersmith
Did me much wickedness in pith,
The Lord reward him for his works,
15 So you beware too of his quirks,
For he's greatly opposed our due.
16 When I first answered, none in crew
Stood with me, but all men forsook
Me, so God will not let them cook.
17 Despite all that the Lord stood by
Me and strengthened me on the sly,
So by me preaching might be known
Completely and the Gentiles shown,
And I was saved from lion's own.
18 The Lord shall deliver me from
Each evil work that's like to come,
And keep me in heavenly kingdom
Of his, and so be glory then
To him for aye and aye. Amen.
19 Greet then Prisca, Aquila too,
And Onesiphorus' house crew.
20 Erastus live in Corinth's view,
But Prothimus I've left in pew
Of Miletum ill *from his brew*.
21 Try hard to come before it's cold.
Eubulus greets you and is bold,
And Pudense, and Linus, as well
As Claudia, and the brothers swell.
22 The Lord Jesus Christ be again
With your spirit. Grace and amen.

Paul does not hesitate to write a word
About the evil men did and occurred.
He does not shy from cursing men that do
The wicked thing to missionary crew.
Perhaps that's how he assays to obey
The word of Your Christ sent that we
should pray

For enemy and foe among the herd.
If so, that's a prayer that has my heart
stirred.
Beloved, deliver me from every man
And every demon set out in the plan,
And let them fry in hell for what they stake
Against me and those who come and
partake
Of bread and cabbage where I find my
place
Beneath the hill of quartzite, fir and grace.

The Epistle of Paul to Titus

Beloved, the most important lesson yet
In all the book is what St. Paul here set
To Titus: that good doctrine makes good
life,
And godliness and truth bear with the
strife.
There is no godliness in the denial
Of truth, nor is there any fiercer trial
Of teaching true than in the godly way
That the saints are led to live in Your ray.
Beloved, I seek the truth in word and deed,
The doctrine that is taught in double seed
Of every heart, and as I find Your grace
In truth revealed, I pray before Your face
For life imputed and imparted where
Your will is doubled on my hand and share.

Titus 1

1 Paul, slave of God, apostle of
Jesus Christ, by the faith of
The elect of God and the knowing
Of truth which is of godly showing,
2 In hope of the eternal life,
Which God who cannot lie *for strife*,
Promised before the world began;
3 But has in due times manifest
His word through preaching, which in span
Is committed to me as best
According to commandment of
God who's our Saviour, *God of love*;

Before the world began eternal life
Was set for some, both husband and the
wife.
The promise made before creation's knife
Lies dormant, it may seem, before the strife
Of sin and wickedness, of government

And churchly programmes that You have
not sent.

But in that promise I find greater share,
The hope of life eternal I may wear
By grace alone and by no human deed.
I grasp the certainty and not the creed.
Beloved, Your covenant of promise kept
Is bright before my chambered heart
unswept,
And still I set aside my faith and view,
Relying on Your grace, trusting in You.

4 To Titus, my own son in view
Of common faith: Grace, mercy too,
And peace, from God the Father and
The Lord Jesus Christ, Saviour's stand.

5 That's why I left you in Crete, so
You should set in order the row
Of things in lack, and so ordain
Elders in every city's vane,
As I appointed you *for gain*:

6 If anyone is blameless and
The husband of one wife to stand
With faithful children not accused
Of riot or unruly rused.

7 An overseer must be blameless,
As steward of God and not gameless,
Not self-willed, not soon angry, not
Given to wine, no striker, not
Given to filthy lucre's lot;

8 Lover of hospitality,
A lover of good men to be
Sober, just, holy, temperate;

9 Holding fast the faithful word's rate
As he's been taught, so he may be
Able by sound doctrine to see
To exhort and convince the doubters.

10 For there are such unruly shouters
And vain in speech, deceivers of
Especially circumcision's love,

11 Whose mouths must be stopped, who
subvert

Whole houses, teaching things that hurt
For filthy lucre's sake to blurt.

12 One of themselves, a prophet of
Their own, said "The Cretians above
Are always liars and evil beasts,
And slow bellies *come to their feasts*."

13 This witness is true. So rebuke
Them sharply, so without a fluke
They may be sound in faith *like duke*,

14 Not giving heed to Jewish fables,

Commandments of men at their tables,
Who turn from the truth in their cables.

Though You alone decide the fate of all,
And not the works of any to appal,
Still You send Your rebuke to those who
teach

The unsaved to savour what sinners preach.
Though no man can climb from the sin of
greed

Into the light of better, righteous seed,
No matter how he tries sincerity,
The things such do are still iniquity.
Beloved, the chips of marble cast aside
From Your creation of the imaged bride
Are fast determined for the trash heap's
pride.

The statue's made of the same stony flesh,
The same hard core is in the artful mesh,
Your artist's hand makes all the difference
fresh.

15 Unto the pure all things are pure:
But to those who are defiled and
The unbelieving nothing pure;
But even their mind and the stand
Of conscience is defiled in band.

16 They claim to know God, but in works
They deny Him and in their quirks
They are abomination and
The disobedient to stand,
And unto every good work land
As reprobate *on every hand*.

Yet works of goodness, my Beloved, do not
Show whom You have redeemed from
sinful plot.

The good works of depraved men
everywhere

Pretend to make society the share
Of progress and of hope and light to bare.
Some of the saved pass through a barren
life

And do no good thing for praise or for
strife.

The works are not the fruit upon the tree
To show the difference and in degree
Between the saved and lost eternally.
Beloved, the reprobate is always praised
For contribution and for funds he's raised.
Beloved, give me what works You in Your
love

Determined before worlds to fit my glove.

Titus 2

1 But speak now things appropriate
To sound doctrine and heard in rate,
2 Tell old men to be sober, grave,
And temperate, sound in faith's wave,
In love and patience to instate.
3 Old women too should act the part
Of holiness *come from the heart*,
Not false accusers, given to wine,
Teachers of good things *on the vine*,
4 So they may teach young women to
Be sober, to love husbands due,
To love their children, 5 be discreet
And chaste, and keepers on their street
At home, good and obedient to
Their husbands, so God's word and true
Not be blasphemed *by any crew*.

The Old School Baptist that I seem to be
Is sometimes caught in alcoholic spree.
Supporting no Bible society
Nor any mission programmes nor the lot
Of Sunday schools in missionary plot
Goes hand in hand with leaving out in cold
The temperance societies unsold.
But St. Paul says old folks should never
stay
In the control of wine on any day.
If Primitive Baptists must drink and drive,
I'd rather follow Paul and stay alive.
Beloved, I have good evidence that You
Do not engage in whiskey or the brew
While You sit on Your throne by heaven's
crew.

6 Young men likewise exhort to be
Sober minded *and patiently*.
7 In all things show yourself a model
Of good works, in doctrine don't coddle
But uncorrupt in gravity,
Teach all things with sincerity,
8 Sound speech, that cannot be condemned,
So the one who's contrary hemmed
May be ashamed, without a thing
Of wickedness at you to sling.

Sound speech that none can criticise in
word
Is more than I can achieve in the herd.
Each sonnet in ghazal I write to You

Is fraught with double meaning on the dew.
There's hardly any line that cannot be
Misunderstood and misapplied to see
As something to condemn in sinful spree.
So I return ashamed to my own pew.
Beloved, let Titus speak a clear word when
He stands before the church to speak to
men.

I am not welcome in the church at all,
And so I speak to birds and beasts in thrall
Of winter or of summer on the wing,
Or on the scratchy feet of creeping thing.

9 And tell the slave too to obey
Their own masters, and find a way
To please them well in all they say,
Not answering *back to go astray*.
10 Do not purloin, but show good faith,
So they will not follow a wraith,
But decorate doctrine of God
Our Saviour in all *on the sod*.
11 For God's grace that brings saving came
As manifest to all men's *frame*,
12 And teaching us to flee the blame
Of wickedness and worldly lust,
To live in soberness uncursed,
And righteously, and godly too
In this present world and in pew,
13 Looking for that blessed hope as well
As glorious appearing and swell
Of the great God and of *His own*
Our Saviour Jesus Christ *as shown*,
14 Who gave himself for us, so he
Might redeem from iniquity,
And purify himself a folk
Zealous of good works *under yoke*.
15 These things speak, exhort, and rebuke
With all authority for fluke,
So let no man call you a bloke.

The Bible is a book that does not show
The values of this better time in glow,
Now that we understand that slavery's
wrong
And that there are better ways to seem
strong.
Slavery implies the owner will resolve
To care for his own chattel that revolve
About his fields and house the whole day
long.
Now we know to make camps where men
can work

Until they drop, or if they do not shirk,
Prisons long-term where relatives supply
The nourishment for prisoners or try.
An industry in grand monopoly
Can also find ways to deprive the free.
Thank You for alternatives to slavery.

Titus 3

1 Put the folk in mind to submit
To principalities as fit
And power, to obey magistrates,
To be ready in all your states
To do each good work that elates,
2 Not to speak wrong of any man,
Not to be brawlers if you can,
But gentle, showing meekness all
To every man *and every doll*.

The kingdom of Your Christ may well
imply
That earthly kingdoms are only a Satan's
try,
And yet Paul tells Titus to keep the way
That reinstates the magistrates in sway.
A look at Gibbon's Rome's enough to say
That government lacked much in justice
and
Economy plain and simple to stand.
If that was rule to honour, any state
Today is worthy of likeness in rate.
Beloved, I pay my taxes for my share
At least when I have work and such to
spare,
And criticize the president as much
As Briton, German or even the Dutch,
Who blame the rulers who fail to take care.

3 For we ourselves also sometime
Were foolish and sunken in crime,
Deceived, and serving divers lusts
And pleasures, living without trusts
In malice, envy and in hate,
Despising one another's state.
4 But after the kindness and love
Of God our Saviour from above
Toward humankind appeared *at last*,
5 Not by works of righteousness *past*
Which we have done, but according
To His mercy He saved from sting
By washing of rebirth *to sing*,
Renewing of Holy Ghost's *ring*,
6 Which he gave us abundantly

Through Jesus Christ our Saviour wee,
7 That being justified by grace
We should be made heirs in his place,
According to the hope of life
Eternal given without strife.

Eternal life is Your choice for the one
On whom election falls when You have
done.

No act of faith earns life or even stalls
Destruction from the grave's enmarbled
walls.

Eternal life is given in the same
Power of creation's coming like a flame
To wake the clay and breathe the breath of
life

Into the nostrils waiting for the knife.
Beloved, I am Your servant in the sky
Of Your salvation dropping down and nigh,
Or in the depths of hell where You place
me

If that turns out to be Your joy's decree.
I offer nothing in my way to make
A righteous claim upon Your favour's
stake.

8 This is a faithful saying, and
These I hope you can understand
To affirm constantly, so those
Who have believed in God and chose
Might be careful to do good works.
Such good profit no good man shirks.
9 But foolish questions now avoid,
And genealogies employed
With their contentions and their strife
About the law; for they are rife
With vanity and without life.

10 One who remains a heretic
After the first and second trick
Of admonition, such reject,

11 Knowing that such ones now reflect
Their own subversion and their sin,
Condemning themselves not to win.

12 When I'll send Artemas to you
Or Tychicus, keen then in view
To come to me at Nicopolis,
For I'll keep there in winter solace.

13 Bring Zenas the lawyer, also
Apollos on their journey's show,
So nothing be lacking their row.

14 And let ours also learn to keep
To good works for the needed leap,

So they'll not be unfruitful heap.
15 Everybody with me would send
You greetings, so greet every friend
In faith for us. Grace now again
Be with you all, and so amen.

You have created me to do You will,
And that includes good works to my life's
fill.

In doing well I earn no merit here,
But only do according to the fear
For which I was created on the bier.
Beloved, create in me the works that still
Remain to be done by my hand and way,
Give me the strength to live another day.
I have no merit in the faith that I
Place in belief in You before I die,
Nor in the hope of life eternal that
You place within my heart and to combat
The darkness that whirls round the throne
of grace,
That fills the churches here before Your
face.

Philemon

If Paul tells Titus to keep the slaves down
And in submission to owner and crown,
He makes a practical gesture's renown
Against Philemon, slave-owner in town.
If You, Beloved, included in Your book
A letter to affirm slave-owner's hook,
I take it as a freedman and amiss,
Who does not relish any backward kiss.
Truth is the Bible's more salvation for
The pie in sky than in the social score.
The world's an atelier where You plead
gore
Instead of marble chips upon the floor,
And take the images that You choose
where
The life-blood flows out daunting and to
spare.

Philemon 1

1 Paul, prisoner of Jesus Christ,
And Timothy our brother spiced,
To Philemon, dearly beloved,
And fellow labourer and gloved,
2 And to our beloved Apphia,
And Archippus, our mate in claw,

And to the church there in your house:
3 Grace be to you and peace to spouse
From God our Father and the Lord
Jesus Christ *who's also adored*.

One more point chalked up for the church
in house,
Despite the lending of the rat and mouse
Of institutions of the state and king,
The catholic doctrines and everything,
Paul here assumes the house-church on the
wing.

I too prefer the house-church just because
I cannot grapple with the wider claws
Of congregations of a hundred paws.
I'm never welcome under steeple or
Within the parish of official door.
But truth to say, the home-church for its
weal

Is as much woe in practice and in spiel.
That's why, Beloved, I come alone to You
Without a doubt and in an empty pew.

4 I thank my God and speak of you
Always in my prayers in my pew,
5 Hearing of your love and your faith,
Which you have toward the Lord no wraith
Jesus, and toward all saints in view,
6 So that communication true
Of your faith may agitate too
By the acknowledging of each
Good thing which is in you to teach
Of Christ Jesus *in deed and speech*.
7 For we have great joy, comfort too,
In your love, because mercy true
Of the saints is refreshed by you,
Brother. 8 That's why, though I might be
Bold in Christ to enjoin freely
What is convenient now for me,
9 Yet for love's sake I'd rather ask,
As poor old Paul still at the task,
And now too prisoner to bask
In Jesus Christ as my decree.

Paul flatters with praise of Philemon's love
Before he hints a favours hand in glove.
I've noticed with appeal to love is made
There's always an ulterior parade
Of hidden wants and secret hopes unstayed.
At best the lover in cajoling voice
Is asking for a boon, one sweet and choice.
At worst and far more common, I have seen

The loving words to cover hateful spleen
And spoken to divert the target from
The knife in back that is about to come.
Beloved, I doubt not that Your knife will
make

A tender slit in me somewhere in stake,
But let me still be loyal for Your sake.

10 I beg you on behalf of one
Onesimus become my son,
Whom I've begotten in my chains,
11 Who in time past and to your pains
Was one unprofitd, but now
Is benefit to both in brow,
12 Whom I have sent back, so receive
Him as my own beloved in sleeve,
13 Whom I would have kept here with me,
So he might minister freely
To me in your stead, where I stay
In chains yet in the Gospel way.
14 But without your permission I
Will not do that, so you may spy
Some benefit, not forced but by
A willing heart to serve thereby.
15 Maybe he went away a time
So you could get him back from crime
For all eternity and well,
16 Not now as just a servant's spell,
But more than a servant, instead
A brother loved, as by me led,
Both in the flesh and the Lord's head?

Even the Muslim, the one decked in crime
Of terrorism by opinion's mime,
Sets free the slave that's a convert in time
To Islam, or he should, though in these
days

There are reports and even Muslim drays
Are caught and sold in Khartoum for a
craze,
As long as they have dark skins for their
praise.

Paul is an early bird, and has not read
The story of releasing slaves once bred.
Beloved, let me be Your slave unreleased,
Whether or not You give me life increased
Upon the clouds or in the lake of fire,
Make me Your slave and so I shall desire
No earthly praise nor place in earthly quire.

17 So if you consider I am
A mate, then receive back the lamb

As myself coming *to be fed*.

18 If he has wronged you or owes you
Anything, let my count accrue.

19 I Paul have written it with my
Own handwriting, I'll pay and buy,
Though I do not tell you how you
Owe me your very self in pew.

20 Yes, brother, let me have the joy
Of you in the Lord to employ,
Refresh me in the Lord, *my boy*.

21 I trust in your obedience, so
I write to you, and so I know
You'll do more than I say to go.

22 But make a place for me also
To stay, for I trust by your prayers
I'll be brought to you *unawares*.

23 Epaphras greets you, he is one
Prisoner in Christ Jesus done,

24 Marcus, Aristarchus, Demas,
Lucas, my fellow workers fuss.

25 The grace of our Lord Christ again
Jesus be with your mind. Amen.

The practical result is that St Paul
Requires Onesimus, man on the ball,
To make the trip both there and back again
Just to preserve the system among men
Of human chattel in the Roman den.
I fruitlessly too wander in the ways
Of Roman paths beneath my nights and
days,

And find no resting place among the free
Or with the slaves who make my company,
My clothes and meals and serve me under
cloud

Of fair economy that is allowed.
Beloved, see those who wait for food from
hand

Of master and of mistress in the land,
The low invisible under command.

The Epistle to the Hebrews

The argument among men is the writer
Of the epistle to the Hebrew fighter.
I do not care myself if he's a blighter
Or St. Paul in his own handwriting spriter.
The question above all is whether death
Of Jesus is atonement for sin's breath,
Or whether the atonement finds its place
In intercession by Your divine face.

I much prefer the latter, since the crew
Of pagans often take disarming view
That human sacrifice avails in all
Occasions where the needy hit the wall.
But if redemption at the cross is small,
A death of innocent is great in call.

Hebrews 1

1 In many ways and means of old
God to the ancestors once told
Things through the prophets *to be bold*.
2 In these last days He spoke to us
In the Son whom He made *with fuss*
The heir of everything, through whom
He made the ages in their room,
3 Who being the great splendour of
His glory and true image of
His essence, and upholding all
Things by the word of his strength's thrall,
Having made purification
Of our sins through himself to run,
He sat down on the right hand's fly
Of the great Majesty on high,
4 Having become much better than
The angels, inherited span
Of a name grander than they can.
5 For to which angel did He say
"You are My *very* Son, today
I have begotten You"? Again,
"I will be his Father, and then
He'll be a son to Me *and stay*."
6 And once more when He brought the first
Born in to the world *as though cursed*,
He said "And let all angels great
Fall prostrating themselves in state."

The reason, My beloved, the exegete
Can find no place in Tanach for retreat
Where You told angels fall down at his feet
Is simply because the source is not there.
It's quoted in the Qur'an for a share,
But if the reader does not read that book
And find Your words therein, he's stumped
to look.

And that's the very reason why all faiths
Are merely illusions' uncanny wraiths.
There's hardly any man will that the whole
Of sacred books as true, though on the
dole.

I take the Torah, Zabur and Injil
As well as the Qur'an, and so I kneel
Before the Truth that partial books conceal.

7 And as to the angels, He said
"Who makes His angels spirits led,
And His servants of flame of fire,"
8 But to the Son, O Alohim,
Your throne's for ever *and on beam*
A sceptre of uprightness *dire*,
The sceptre of your kingdom's *ire*."
9 You love righteousness and you hate
Lawlessness, because of this state
Alohim your God has set you
Anointed with the oil in view
Of gladness by your fellows too."
10 And "You, Lord, at the start have set
The earth, and the heavens too are met
The works of your hands *without debt*.
11 "They will vanish, but you will stay,
They'll become old like garments fray,
12 "And you'll fold them up like a veil,
And they shall be changed and be stale.
But you remain the same and your
Years shall not fail always to pour."
13 But to which angel did He say
"Sit at My right hand till My way
Is to place your foes at your feet?"
14 Are they not all servants and meet
To serve and sent out to help those
Inheriting salvation's rows?

If You, Beloved, set up the Christ to be
Both this and that, it does appear to me
That he must be a separate one from You,
A bodied image to reveal the true.
The writer writing to the old Hebrew
Flies in the face of Trinity when he
Divides the divine substance into three.
I err. In two. It's so confusing me.
Beloved, I rejoice in all things You do,
Anointing heirs and making sons anew,
Raising above the very angels too.
I prostrate myself at the grand command
To angels to render to him a hand,
What's angelized can also indeed be manned.

Hebrews 2

1 Therefore we ought to give the more
Earnest heed to the things before
That we have heard, lest at some time
We should let them slip *out of rhyme*.
2 For if the word that angels spoke
Was steadfast, and commandments broke
Received a just recompense filled,

3 How shall we escape, if we've billed
Neglect to so great a salvation,
Which at the first began in ration
Of the Lord's speech, and was confirmed
To us by those who heard *unsquirmed*,
4 God also bears them witness and
With signs and wonders in command
Of many miracles in hand
And gifts of Holy Spirit planned
According to his own will's stand?

The argument is that since angels and
The prophets spoke the truth at Your
command,
And heeding that is necessary stand,
If follows it is necessary now
To listen to Christ Jesus with a bow.
Jesus is proven by two things in tow:
Your witness of his baptism not slow,
And all the miracles he came to show.
The miracles do not move me at all,
Since I see Chinese tricksters on the ball.
But any time You speak, I trust I'll take
The word as seriously as I can make.
It comes down to the trust I have or not
In witnesses at Jordan that were caught.

5 For unto angels he has not
Put in subjection the world's plot
To come, of which we speak in lot.
6 But one in a certain place said,
"What is man that You mind his bed,
Or son of man, to take his note?
7 "You made him just a little groat
Below the angels, and you crowned
Him with glory and honour found,
Set him over works of Your hands,
8 "You've put all things under the bands
Of his feet." For in that He put
All things subject to him in foot,
He left nothing not at his root.
9 But we see Jesus, who was made
A little lower in parade
Than angels, so he might be placed
To suffer death and be effaced,
Then crowned with glory and in fine
With honour, that he by God's gift
Should taste of death and so should lift
Up every man. 10 For it was meet
For him, for whom all things and by
Whom are all things, in bringing nigh
So many sons to glory's treat,

To make the captain of salvation
One perfect through his sufferings' ration.

The Word of God that You sent to the
world
In flesh took flesh and blood and so
unfurled
A day of suffering, came specifically
To suffer and to die most humanly.
The lust to taste of death began indeed
As soon as Eve and Adam with their seed
Desired the fruit of death and ate with
speed.
The act of Jesus was the same I trow,
But this time with Your permission in
scow.
It's You who learned, not humankind a bit.
You learned that men will die if they are
fit,
And so You might better give in and say
To them to die and die in sheeply way.
Beloved, can any rise to life for pay?

11 For both the one that sanctifies
And those he puts in holy guise,
Are all of one, for which cause he
Is not ashamed in slight degree
To call them brothers, 12 saying, I
Shall declare your name to the sky
To my brothers, and in the court
Of the called out I shall resort
To sing my praises unto you.
13 Again, I'll put my trust in view
Of him. And once again, behold
I and the children God was bold
To give to me. 14 Since children are
Partakers of flesh and blood's bar,
He also likewise took part of
That same relationship in love,
That through death he might destroy him
Who had the power of death and grim,
That is, the devil, 15 and saved those
Who through fear of death in their rows
Were all their lives in chains and throes.
16 For truly he did not take on
The nature of angels in spawn,
But he took on him Abram's seed.

Ah my Beloved! I'm grateful that the one
You sent to me from heaven was not begun
In such angelic matter that my greed

Could grasp no human sort of passion's
seed.

Not of the fire of heavenly temple nor
The sound of bloodless angels singing
more,

Nor Adam's perfect flesh without the gore,
But of the bone of Abraham that sought
The cool shade of the tent from heavenly
lot

Is the foundation of the Christ I've sought.
Beloved, kiss me again, and with that life
Set me unmoved within the brazen strife,
And so I may or may not enter in
The chambered fortresses outside the din.

17 That's why in all things it was meet
For him to be made head to feet
Like brothers, so he might become
A merciful high priest in sum
And faithful in things of God and
Make reconciliation's *stand*
For the sins of the folk *in band*.

18 Because he himself felt the pain
Of being tempted *to be vain*,
He's able to give helping hand
To those who're tempted *in the land*.

If Your Christ was made in all things the
same

As human brothers without claim or name
Of gross divinity, then Jesus came
A man and no more than a man in flame.
If Jesus is a man among all men
Who clamour at Your gates to find again
The heavenly manna shed abroad, I find
That he's come a blind man to lead the
blind.

But no, Beloved, Your Word when sent
abroad

Shall not return upon the empty sod,
But find the purpose of eternal will,
The grace unmerited to fit the bill.
And so I meet the man of long ago
And find him waiting still for today's show.

Hebrews 3

1 So holy brothers and partakers
Of the celestial calling's makers,
Consider the Apostle and
High Priest of our profession's stand,
Christ Jesus, 2 who was faithful to
Him who created him to do,

As was Moses one faithful too
In all his house, in all his crew.

3 For this one is considered more
Worthy of glory in the store
Than Moses, since who built the house
Has more honour than just the house.

4 For every house has been built by
Someone, but the one from the sky
Who's built all things is God *to spy*.

5 Moses truly was faithful in
All his house, as servant to win
A witness of those things that came
After to be spoken for fame.

6 But Christ is son in his own house,
Whose house we are, both man and spouse,
If we hold fast the confidence
And the rejoicing in defence
Of hope until the end *and fence*.

The writer to the Hebrews clearly makes
Distinction between son and servant's
sakes.

If Moses is a servant and the Christ
Is Son of God, that belies the bespiced
Disarming conclusion that the Acts make
That Jesus is the grand fulfilling stake
Of the great promise made that there should
be

A prophet rising to sit in the see
Of Moses and one like him as a pea.
Myself, I think the verses came to say
That Joshua would come to save the day.
But then the name's the same for both of
them,

Despite the centuries that part the stem.
Beloved, a son or servant, here I stay.

7 That's why as says the Holy Ghost,
Today, if you will hear his boast,

8 Don't harden your hearts, as in crime
Of provocation, in the time

Of desert tempting, 9 when ancestors
Of yours were tempting Me like questers,
And tried Me and saw all My acts
For forty years *and knew the facts*.

10 So I was grieved with that band and
Its generation in the land,

And said "They always make mistakes
In their hearts, and as it betakes
Have not known the ways from My hand.

11 "So I swore in My wrath to stand,
They'll not enter into My rest.

12 "Beware then, brothers, now and lest
 There be in any of you an
 Evil heart of unbelief's span,
 Departing from living God's scan.
 13 "But exhort each other each day,
 While it is called today, and say
 Lest any of you become hard
 In sin's deceitfulness unstarred.

Ha! If I dared exhort any man here
 That weighs upon the earth and without
 fear,
 I'd hear my honour dragged up in the dust,
 And feel the blow of steel upon the crust
 Of cranium before I spoke my lust.
 If I dared on a day and any day
 To speak a word for against any fray,
 There would be many waiting there to say
 I'd better shut my mouth or learn to pray.
 Beloved, sin is deceitful in its course,
 But it's as good a bet as any horse
 For those who lay their money on the
 bourse.
 And every day is called today except
 In Scotland where the article's more ept.

14 For we're made partakers of Christ,
 If we hold the start of the heist
 Of confidence steadfast to end,
 15 While it's said "Today if you'll hear
 His voice, don't harden hearts from cheer
 As in the provocation's year."
 16 For some, when they had heard,
 provoked,
 Yet not all that came out unyoked
 From Egypt by Moses *with fear*.
 17 With whom was He grieved forty year?
 Not with them who'd sinned, and whose
 bones
 Fell among the desert and stones?
 18 And to whom did He swear they'd not
 Enter into His rest as sought,
 But to those that denied His plot?
 19 So we see they could not go in
 Because of unbelief as sin.

Hebrews 4

1 So let us fear, lest promise left
 To go to his rest leave bereft
 Any of you come short of it.
 2 For us the gospel was a hit
 When preached to us as well as them,

But the word preached did not profit
 Them, since they had no faith in hem.
 3 That's why we have believed to go
 Into rest as he said with glow
 Of wrath when sworn, "If they shall go
 Into My rest, and so although
 The works were done from the word go."
 4 For he spoke in a certain place
 Of the seventh day in this trace,
 "And God did rest the seventh day
 From all His works then on display."
 5 And in this text again, "If they
 Shall go into My rest one day."
 6 So since there's still remaining some
 Must enter in, and every bum
 To whom it first was preached in sum
 Did not go in for unbelief,
 7 Again, he set a certain day
 Saying by David *without grief*,
 "Today after so long a time,
 As it is said, today in chime
 If you will hear His voice in rhyme,
 Don't harden then your hearts with grime."
 8 For if good Joshua had come
 To give them rest, then would the chum
 Not afterwards speak of a day,
 Another day and one to come.
 9 So there remains and is to stay
 A rest to God's folk anyway.

If after going to the Promised Land
 The promised rest was still uncut,
 unmanned,
 Then there's a rest remaining in the stand.
 The rest in You, Beloved, is what is meant,
 No doubt, but if Israel had failed to scent
 The Sabbath day, still it remains rest lent.
 The Sabbath commandment is full of greed
 On part of every father in his need,
 And each employer who comes round on
 steed.

The day of rest for donkey and the slave
 Remains despite the cross of pure and
 brave.

Beloved, I grasp the democratic view
 Of temple caught in time to come to You
 And bathe in Sabbath rest here in my pew.

10 Because the one who's come to rest,
 He's also stopped his own works' test,
 As God did from His own behest.
 11 So let us strive to enter in

That rest, lest any man for sin
 Fall after the same pattern kin
 To unbelief in what he's messed.
 12 For God's word's quick and powerful,
 And sharper than any sword full
 For two blades to pierce and divide
 The soul and spirit, and beside
 The joints and marrow, and sees through
 The thoughts and heart intents in view.
 13 There is no creature that is not
 Fully revealed in His sight's plot,
 But all things are naked when sought,
 And opened to the eyes of Him
 With whom we have to do *in trim*.

The rest from sin's one thing, and yet I see
 The rest from righteous works done
 righteously
 As well to find the haven from the spree.
 No creature in six days can raise a plea
 Of deference from You, Beloved, to see.
 After the toil, the human hand must stop
 To find that You're not only on the top,
 But that all is by grace alone in crop.
 I do not make the marble floor with mop.
 That was before my time, prepared and
 done
 By master builder working under sun.
 Beloved, I rest in You alone and find
 That in Your light my heart and hand are
 blind,
 But guided by Your will, I am resigned.

14 Then seeing we've a great high priest,
 Who's passed into the heavens *increased*,
 Jesus, God's son, let us hold fast
 Our faith's profession *in the blast*.
 15 For we've no high priest who cannot
 Be touched with the feeling that's wrought
 By our infirmities, but he
 In all points was tempted like we,
 And yet without sin *in degree*.
 16 Let us therefore come boldly to
 The throne of grace, and in that view
 Obtain such mercy and find grace
 To help in time of need and place.

Despite the cleverness of pope and priest,
 Despite the bishop's wealth and health
 increased,
 Despite the Baptist pastor's fine degree,
 There is no other priest set out for me

But one You sent abroad and then
 reclaimed
 Arisen into heaven and unblamed.
 That's why, Beloved, I come so boldly here
 With all my complaints and mockeries at ear,
 With all my words in sonnetry and gear
 Without a grain of salt, without a fear.
 Beloved, my boldness to join You in
 church
 Comes from the fact I'm always left in
 lurch
 By every human stand upon the perch.
 And so before Your throne I still appear.

Hebrews 5

1 For every high priest taken from
 Among men is ordained *and won*
 For men in things doing with God,
 That he may offer on the sod
 Both gifts and sacrifice for sin,
 2 Who can have compassion *to win*
 Upon the ignorant, and on
 Them who are out of the way *drawn*,
 For he himself too is surrounded
 With such infirmity *and grounded*.
 3 That's why he should, for folk and self,
 Sacrifice for sins *on the shelf*.
 4 And no one takes himself this due,
 But one appointed to the true
 By God, as was Aaron *and crew*.

No one takes on appointment of High Priest
 Of his own power among the great and
 least
 Perhaps but those deprived of health and
 sense,
 Or those who do so for the pounds and
 pence.
 But every first-born son a mother here
 Must so redeem the child set up in fear
 To solemn priesthood and give from her
 gear
 The shekel to the tribe of Aaron so
 They can perform in the sacred fire's glow.
 Not being of the Jewish race and face,
 I've never been redeemed with silver's
 trace,
 And so I'm still responsible in place
 To serve as priest to family for grace.
 Beloved, lift up on me the iron mace.

5 So Christ did not honour self either

To be made a high priest to tithe her,
 But He who said to him, "You are
 My son, today I've sired your star,"
 6 As he says too in some such place,
 "You are a priest for all time's grace
 After the order and the race
 Of Melchisedec's *glave and mace*,"
 7 Who in the days of his flesh, when
 He'd offered up prayers and again
 Strong supplications with the voice
 Of weeping and with tears suffice
 To Him who could save him from death,
 And was here in his fearing's breath,
 8 Though he were a son, still he learned
 Obedience by the things unspurned
 By which he suffered, 9 to be made
 Perfect, he became author stayed
 Of everlasting saving made
 To all of them who obey him,
 10 Called by God a high priest *and trim*
 After Melchisedec's way *grim*.
 11 Of whom we've many things to say,
 And hard to be uttered *in play*,
 Since you're hard of hearing *and limb*.

The reader cannot help but think the feat
 Just an excuse to avoid the retreat
 Before the onslaught of those who repeat
 That Christ is not a priest because he's not
 From Aaron's tribe and family and lot.
 Preventing that cry Hebrews comes to
 show

A better, a more ancient, on the go,
 A priesthood without start or finished row.
 Beloved, keep me from any such in rhyme,
 Petition of the principle in crime,
 Illogic or the circular in time.
 The everlasting priesthood is a thing
 I'm ready and I'm willing now to sing
 As long as heaven is a real sling.

12 For when for the time you should be
 Teachers, you have need in degree
 That some one teach you once again
 The first principles of the things
 That God's revealed in talking springs,
 And you've become like those who need
 Milk and not strong meat *in their greed*.
 13 For every one that uses milk
 Is not skilful *despite his silk*
 In the word of *such* righteousness,
 For he's a baby *to confess*.

14 But strong meat belongs to those who
 Are come of age, who by their true
 Practice of sense discern both good
 And evil *in the way they should*.

These ancient texts are out of date, passé,
 When they speak of both meat and milk
 today.

The vegan diet's all the rage to hear,
 And hopes to show the better way to steer.
 So neither meat not milk is good to eat,
 And neither milk not meat can be a treat.
 I know Your author means the basics first
 Need to be learned and then the folk
 uncursed

Should move into the stronger stuff that
 takes

Them into holiness in wisdom's wakes.
 But everywhere I go the basics get
 More erudite and stranger than I've met,
 Until I think the ten commandment law
 Remains both then and now the better paw.

Hebrews 6

1 So leaving the first things about
 The doctrine of Christ, let's go out
 Into perfection, and not lay
 Again the foundation in sway
 Of our repentance from dead works,
 And faith toward God that's without quirks,
 2 Of doctrine of baptisms and
 Of holy laying on of hand,
 And resurrection of the dead,
 And the eternal judgement dread,
 3 And this we'll do, if God permit,
 4 For it's not possible the fit
 Who were enlightened once to taste
 The heavenly gift, and once were placed
 Partakers of the Holy Ghost,
 5 And have tasted God's good word's roast,
 And the powers of the world to come,
 6 If they shall fall away in sum,
 To bring them back repenting, since
 They crucify without a wince
 To themselves God's son and afresh,
 And put him to open shame's mesh.

At least I now know what the basics are
 According to this letter from a star:
 It's teachings about baptisms in dread,
 And laying on of hands, rising of dead,

And judgement falling down on every
head.
These are the things repentance leads men
too,
And when they're done, to go on to what's
true.
That's clear enough, but what then comes in
view
Is a hard statement to both men and crew.
If any fail the mark, they should not think
To return once again back from the brink,
For doing so is but to crucify
The Christ again and openly defy.
I stand aghast and turn back with a sigh.

7 For the earth that drinks in the rain
That often falls on it for pain,
And brings forth herbs meet for those who
Are made deserving of the view,
Receives the blessing come from God.
8 But that which bears thorns on the sod
And briers is rejected, and near
To cursing, whose end is the bier.
9 But now, beloved, we do believe
In better things or your reprieve,
And things drawn of salvation's peek,
Though these are things of which we speak.
10 God's not unrighteous to forget
Your work and love's labour to fret,
The which you've shown toward His name,
In that you've served the saints of fame,
And still you serve them without blame.
11 And we desire that every one
Of you should show diligence done
To the full certainty of hope
To the end of the time and scope:
12 That you should not be lazy, but
Followers of those who've not shut
Out faith and patience but will gain
The gauge of promises *for pain*.

The book of Hebrews met the pain in view
When the great temple with its porticue
Was thrown down by the Romans come in
crew
And all the worshippers left without pew.
Some thought that loss so great, atonement
made
For sin could no more join in the parade
And all were lost who could not bring a
lamb
To slaughter there to pay for eating ham.

Beloved, Your promise is not set to stand
Or fall upon a marble arch and grand,
But on the faithfulness of Your own heart
No matter what men do in evil part.
And yet I must not take a lazy way
Of resting in Your hope by night and day.

13 For when God made Abraham know
His promise, because He could show
No greater oath, He came to make
An oath by His own self in stake,
14 Saying "Surely blessing I'll come
To bless, and multiply in sum
Of multiplying you." 15 And so
After he patiently held row,
He got the promise for his show.
16 For men truly swear by the great
And an oath affirming in state
Ends all strife for them in their gate.
17 So God, wishing to be by far
Abundant to show heirs and star
Of the promises how He is
Unchanging in counsel and biz,
Confirmed it by an oath in whiz:
18 So by two changeless things in which
It was impossible to pitch
As a lie on God, we might get
A consolation strong and set,
Who have fled for refuge to lay
Hold on the hope set for our prey:
19 Which hope we have as anchor by
The soul, both sure and set in sky
To enter in the veil *and try*;
20 Where the forerunner's entered in
For us, Jesus, made high priest's *win*
For ever after order *set*
Before Melchisedec *when met*.

My temple's not a room set on the mount
In fair Jerusalem beside the fount.
It's not a cross outside the gate where one
Died in the darkness coming down to stun.
My temple is within the heavenly veil
Where true atonement's made with no
blood's wail,
But by the intercession and the prayer
Of innocence and grace upon the stair.
Beloved, my church in fleshly heart and
sky
Needs nothing of the earthy stone and cry,
The temple caught on time instead of space
Will tender day by day the living grace

In Sabbath hours to contemplate the race
From earth into eternity and face.

Hebrews 7

1 For this Melchisedec, the king
Of Salem, priest of most high wing
Of God, who met Abraham when
He came back from slaughter of men
And kings, he blessed him there again;
2 To whom also Abraham gave
A tithe of all, the first name brave
Interpreted is righteous king,
And after that the name to ring
Is king of Salem, king of peace;
3 Without a father to increase,
Without a mother, no descent,
Having neither days to prevent
Nor end of life, but he is made
Like son of God, who always stayed
A priest. 4 Now think how great he was,
To whom even patriarch's claws
Of Abraham gave tithe of spoils.
5 And truly Levi's sons in toils,
Who have the office of the priest,
Have a commandment unreleased
To take the tithes from folk by law,
That is, from their brothers to draw,
Though they come from Abraham's loins:
6 But he whose descent, having coins,
Is not counted from them, received
Tithes from Abraham who believed,
And blessed him with promises cleaved.
7 There's no contradiction when one
Who's lesser is blessed when he's done
By the greater. 8 And mortal men
Receive the tithes, but there again
He did, of whom witness is brought
That he's alive, so we've been taught.

The king of peace or Islam rose to take
The tithes of Abraham after the wake
Of war. In fact a fifth of booty should
Be given to the prophet and not hood.
But Abraham let others take his share.
After the centuries let men beware
Decisions made upon the text that went
Abroad from Sodom's defeat to prevent
The profligate in ancient times and sweet.
Beloved, I hold the tithe, the fifth, and all
The offerings set by alms upon the wall.
The rates and taxes are a needed way
Supporting priests and kings going astray,

But I remain in destitution's treat.

9 And as I may so say, Levi
Too who receives the tithes thereby,
Paid tithes in what Abraham wrought.
10 For he was still in his dad's loins,
When Melchisedec took his coins.
11 So if perfection could come by
Levitical priesthood *on sly*,
For under it the people got
The law, what further need when sought
Was there for still another priest
Should rise after order *increased*
Of Melchisedec, and not be
Called after Aaron in degree?
12 For the priesthood when it was changed,
There must also in the law *ranged*
Come change. 13 For he of whom these
things
Are spoken came *from other rings*
And from another tribe *that sings*,
From which no man came out to serve
Before the altar *and with verve*.

The argument that priesthood was applied
With a new law in Aaron's time and side
And so was temporary gift and weight
Is something I might more simply restate.
Original's not great Melchisedec,
But the first-born from every woman's
beck,
With love and loyalty upon the neck.
The Levite must redeem the firstborn child,
And so the law goes on to this day wild.
If I must be adroitly reconciled,
Let it be on the natural implement,
Let it be on the basis of first-sent.
But if the first-born of both man and God
Suffice, then I shall submit to Your rod.

14 For it is evident our Lord
Sprang out of Judah (though adored),
Of which tribe Moses spoke no word
Concerning of the priesthood stirred.
15 And yet it's far more evident,
For the way that the likeness went
Of Melchisedec, there should rise
Another priest *under the skies*,
16 Who's made, not after the law come
Of a carnal commandment's *sum*,
But after power of endless life.
17 For He bears witness over strife,

“You are a priest forever by
The order of Melchisedec.”

18 For there is truly setting by
Of the command that came to trek
Before for its weakness on deck.

The word for carnal here should be
described
For meaning and for worth among the
bribed.

Contrasted with eternal, it must mean
The temporary sort of place and scene.
Commandment of the Levite law was made
To stay a time, but the real owners paid
To be let off their duties when waylaid,
And the firstborn were given freedom from
The priestly duty of family in sum.
Beloved, today the tribe and church turn
back,

Are lost in war and prosperity's slack.
And so the firstborn must return to take
Responsibility before the rake.
Original returns, carnal must hum.

19 For the law made nothing perfect,
But bringing in a hope select,
By which we come near unto God;
20 And not without an oath in prod.
21 For those priests were made without
oath,

But this one with an oath He quoth
To him, “The Lord swore not to back
Down, that you are a priest in track
Forever in the order's beck
Named and called by Melchisedec.

The law makes nothing perfect. So I guess.
But was perfection of myself in dress
The goal? It seems perfection in the mind
Of men is expectation of a kind
For others rather than the self as blind.
I seek no frail perfection here, instead
I seek to know my own Beloved, be fed
At fountains of Your love, and for that law
Is lovelier than any form of awe.
I find the honeyed words of Your
commands

Better than legislations of all lands,
And touch the goal without perfection's rate
To find eternities not over-rate.
I'm clay soft and imperfect in Your hands.

22 By so much Jesus guaranteed
A better testament decreed.

23 And truly they were many priests,
Because they were not given feasts
To live, but had to die and plead.

24 But this one, since he always stays,
Has unchanged priesthood in his ways.

25 That's why he can save them too to
The uttermost who come in crew
To God by him, because he stands
Alive forever to lift hands
Of intercession for their bands.

26 For such a high priest fits us well,
Who's holy, harmless, and to tell
One undefiled, and set apart

From sinners, and made from the start
Higher than the heavens to dwell,

27 Who does not need each day to make
As those high priests, offerings at stake,
First for his own sins, then the sake
Of the folk too: because he did
This once when he gave his own bid.

28 For the law makes men high priests who
Have weakness, but the word that's true
Oath, which was since the law began,
Makes the son ever set in scan.

The argument that Jesus is a better
Priest because he rose from the grave no
debtor

To death again, but always living now
Is not a bad one to sit on my brow.
I'd rather have a live priest than a dead one,
And that's a fact I still refuse to tread on.
If any find Melchisedec alive,

I think I might find in heart to contrive
A welcome to him also. Still the doubt
Remains whether Christ did without a
shout

Rise from the dead. The soldiers' witness
must

Be taken to account, though one of dust.
The end of all is that a man must trust,
And even then the years may turn to rust.

Hebrews 8

1 Now of the things we've spoken, this
Is the sum: we have not to miss
Such an high priest, who's set beside
The right hand of the throne to ride
The majesty of heaven's tide:
2 A servant in the sanctuary,

And in the true tent of the merry,
 Which the Lord pitched instead of man.
 3 For every high priest in the plan
 Must offer gifts and sacrifice.
 That's why this man must have a slice
 To offer also in a trice.
 4 For if he were on earth, he would
 Not be a priest, since there are good
 Priests that offer gifts by the law:
 5 Who serve as example to draw
 The shadow of celestial things,
 As Moses was warned of the stings
 By God when he started to make
 The tabernacle, no mistake,
 He said, but be sure that you make
 All things according to the plan
 Showed to you in the mountain's span.
 6 But now he has obtained a more
 Excellent service than before,
 By how much too he's mediator
 Of a better treaty in store,
 Set on better promises' floor.
 7 For if that first one had been good,
 And without flaw, then no place should
 Have been sought for a second *door*.

The true priest is not one upon the earth
 To drown the soil with goats' blood without
 dearth,
 But one that's spoken of beyond the skies,
 The arbiter of the good and the wise.
 Atonement's not made with the blood of
 lamb
 Or even with the blood of human slam,
 But by the intercession bold and true
 Before the throne set beyond starry view.
 Beloved, save me from every pagan
 thought
 That hopes to gain the world through nature
 wrought,
 The serving of the moon, the sun, and stars,
 The welcoming of earthly bands and bars,
 And I shall enter inner chamber's way
 And find there harbinger of heavenly day.

8 For finding fault with them, he said,
 See the days come, says YHWH, and
 spread,
 When I will make new covenant
 With the house of Israel extant,
 And with the house of Judah led:
 9 Not by the covenant I made

With their dads in the day I stayed
 To take them by the hand and lead
 Them out of Egypt's land with speed,
 Because they did not keep My pact,
 I showed them no regard to act,
 Says the Lord *in things He decreed*.
 10 For this is the pact I will make
 With Israel's house in those days' wake,
 Says the Lord, I will put My laws
 Into their mind, and write *with paws*
 In their heart, and I'll be to them
 A God, and they'll turn to My hem
 To be My people *and My gem*.
 11 And they shall not teach every man
 His neighbour, as each brother can,
 Saying, "Know the Lord." For each one
 Shall know Me, from the least *when done*
 To the greatest of all *that's won*.
 12 For I'll be merciful to their
 Unrighteousness, and their sins' share
 And their iniquities I'll not
 Remember more *upon their plot*.
 13 By saying a new covenant
 He makes the first one old and scant.
 Now what rots and gets old is just
 Ready to vanish into dust.

The covenant that's new is that one met
 In Jeremiah's words quoted and set
 To harmonies divine, Beloved, and true.
 I love that covenant written by You
 Upon the human heart and not on stone,
 The fleshly tables where Your word alone
 Is hallowed in the actions of elect.
 I turn from fair cathedrals to inspect
 The writing on the wall, the blazing sweet,
 And find there victory none can defeat.
 Beloved, I see the clouds of grief appear
 And dissipate before arising fear,
 I see the morning camp upon the field,
 And know to Your will all things here must
 yield.

Hebrews 9

1 Then truly the first covenant
 Had also ordinances' rant
 Of divine service, and a tent
 Of worldly stature without rent.
 2 For there a tabernacle's made;
 The first, wherein candlestick stayed,
 And table and show bread waylaid,
 Called sanctuary on parade.

3 After the second veil the place
 Called Holiest of all to trace;
 4 Which had the golden censer there,
 And ark of covenant not bare,
 But overlaid around about
 With gold, in which stood up the stout
 Gold pot of manna, and the rod
 Of Aaron that budded for prod,
 And the tables of covenant.
 5 And over it the cherubim
 Of glory kept mercy seat trim;
 Of which we cannot now speak dim.
 6 Now when these things were so ordained,
 The priests went always and arraigned
 Into the first tent, there to make
 The service of the people's sake.
 7 But into the second the high
 Priest only once a year came by,
 Not without blood, when he offered
 For himself and the people stirred.
 8 The Holy Spirit by this meant
 That the way to Most Holy went
 Of all not yet manifest bent,
 As long as the first tent was lent,
 9 Which was a figure for the time
 That then was, in which in their prime
 Were offered gifts and sacrifice,
 That could not make him, nor suffice,
 That did the service perfect in
 His conscience and be without sin;
 10 Which stood only in meat and drink,
 And such ablutions not to stink,
 And carnal ordinance imposed
 On them until reform time closed.

When Daniel speaks of cleansing of the
 room,
 He sets the earthly tabernacle's doom,
 And makes the day of its atonement come
 In anti-type upon celestial hum.
 Most holy place below was a reflection
 Of that above in its holy confection.
 Atonement for sin's made at last before
 The ark behind the veil and painted door.
 Beloved, I follow in behind the man
 Christ where he comes by the eternal plan,
 And find atonement in his prayers above
 And in redeeming and undying love.
 I set aside the death of lamb and goat,
 And set out on high seas in crystal boat.

11 But Christ come as high priest of good

Things to come, by a greater hood,
 More perfect tabernacle, not
 Made with hands, that is one not wrought
 Of this sort of building and plot;
 12 Nor by the blood of goats and calves,
 But by his own blood without halves
 He entered once the holy place,
 Obtaining everlasting grace.
 13 For if the blood of bulls and goats,
 And heifer's ashes spread for floats
 Upon the unclean, sanctifies
 The flesh cleansed beneath earthly eyes,
 14 How much more shall the blood of
 Christ,
 Who through eternal ghost sufficed
 To offer himself without spot
 To God, purge your conscience in plot
 From dead works to serve living God?
 15 That's why he is the mediator
 Of the new covenant instater,
 That by means of death for redemption
 Of the transgressions for exemption
 That sat beneath first testament,
 Those which are called might represent
 The promise of eternal weight
 Of their inheritance at gate.
 16 For where there is a testament,
 There must also be the death sent
 Of the testator when he went.
 17 For a will is in force at last
 After men have died and are passed:
 Otherwise it's of no power while
 The testator remains to smile.

Everyone thinking that the Christ has come
 And died after the orders of the scum
 Who thought that human institutions make
 All good and fine after the royal stake,
 Must find a reason for that death, if such
 Is an atonement or redemption's touch.
 The human sacrifice to me smells more
 Like heathen worship filled with sex and
 gore.
 But who am I upon my northern shore?
 St. Paul or who wrote this must also find
 A reason for the death of Christ unpined.
 His reason is the heirs must wait until
 The death of their ancestor on the hill
 Before they get the treasure on their sill.

18 And even the fer's testament
 Was set with blood in what it spent.

19 For when Moses had uttered all
 The precepts at all the folk's call,
 According to the law he took
 The blood of calves and goats and shook
 With water and with scarlet wool
 And hyssop and sprinkled *in full*
 Both book and people *at a look*.
 20 He said "This is blood of the pact
 Which God's enjoined on you to act."
 21 And still he sprinkled with blood both
 The tent and all the pots unloath.
 22 And almost all things by the law
 Are cleansed by blood, and without claw
 Of shedding blood, there's no release.
 23 It was therefore needful in crease
 That patterns of things in the sky
 Should be cleansed with these passing by;
 But the celestial things themselves
 With better sacrifice *than elves*.

The argument that it is necessary
 For heavenly cleansing of the sweet
 unwary
 Because such happened on the earth one
 time,
 Is so beyond reason to be a crime.
 And yet it shows a modern twist in that
 It's structuralist as well as being fat.
 The pattern of the sky must face the earth
 And so the two must be of equal worth.
 Beloved, I seek no patterns to be true,
 But only wish to recognize in You
 Reality before both earth and sky.
 But if all things must follow patterns, why,
 I shall be patterned by Your hand and eye
 Until time and eternity review.

24 For Christ has not gone in to stand
 In holy places made by hand,
 The figures of the true, but in
 To heaven itself, and now to win
 Before God's eye to beat our sin.
 25 Nor yet that he should give himself
 Up often, as high priest on shelf
 Went in the most holy place each
 Year with the blood of others' reach;
 26 For then he must have often lay
 In suffering from world's founding stay:
 But now once at world's end he came
 To put away both sin and blame
 By sacrificing his own name.

The sacrifice of self opened the way
 Into the holy places and their ray
 Where Christ achieves atonement by the
 prayer
 Of innocence upon the golden stair
 Of one who conquered sin and death to
 bear
 His witness before You that those may
 share
 In life eternal whom You do elect
 And set apart and paint as the select.
 Beloved, in fact I doubt not that the pain
 Tormented that sweet brow in sun and rain
 From the foundation of the wayward earth
 Both in the plenty and in time of dearth.
 But let it be put all away when You
 Put sin away from every righteous pew.

27 And it's appointed unto men
 Once to die, but after again
 To come to judgement: 28 and so Christ
 Was offered once and that sufficed
 To bear the sins of many men,
 And unto them who look again
 For him, he shall appear once more
 Without sin for salvation's store.

This final argument for Christ's own death
 Is that since all men must give up their
 breath,
 His coming as a man implied the same
 Of him with or without the blame and
 shame.
 The reader fails to find this truth, instead
 Takes the appointment of the human dead
 To mean that since all must die, then the
 few

Who escape death must all return in crew
 Upon the earth again to stand before
 The angel of their death come to the door.
 The nonsense of angelic thought is passed
 Only by nonsense of the human caste,
 But I thank You, Beloved, that all things
 stand
 Clear and sure within Your most sovereign
 hand.

Hebrews 10

1 For the law having just the shade
 Of coming good things in parade,
 And not the very substance made,
 Can never with such sacrifice

Which they offered yearly in trice
Make those who come to it as nice.
2 If so, would they not stop their making
Of sacrifices for the taking?
For worshippers once cleansed should not
Thereafter know sin in their lot.

The fact is sacrifice went on below
As habit and tradition in the glow
Of round of life and death, of birth and
flow.

Whether men sin or not, whether they've
found

Perfection or frustration on the ground,
The social institutions and the way
Of sacrifice and prayer always bear sway
Until a social change brings into view
A way that seems more profitable too.
The cease of sacrifice depended more
Upon destruction of the temple door
In fair Jerusalem, than on the great
And loving intercession in the state
Of heaven before the tree of life and plate.

3 But those offerings come to remind
Again each year sins come in kind.

4 For it's not possible the blood
Of bulls and goats should take the flood
Of sins away. 5 So when he comes
Into the world, he says in sums,
"Sacrifice and offering You do
Not want, but a body made true,
6 "In offerings burnt and sacrifice
For sin You find there's nothing nice.
7 "Then I said, 'See, I come at last,
In the volume of the book cast
Is written about me to do
Your will, O God, *and so be true.*"

8 Above when he said "Sacrifice
And offering and burnt offering nice
For sin You do not want, nor find
Pleasure in them, though offered signed
By the law. 9 Then he said, 'Behold,
I come to do Your will as told,
O God.'" He takes away the first,
So He can establish not worst,
10 By which we are sanctified through
The offering of the body too
Of Jesus Christ once brought to view.
11 And every priest stands daily by
To minister the offerings nigh,
And often times the same in cry

Which never can take away sin.
12 But this man, after he had made
One offering sacrifice and stayed
Trespass for ever, he sat down
On the right hand of God *to frown*;
13 From then on waiting till his foes
Be made the footstool *for his toes*.
14 For by one offering he has made
Perfect forever those who stayed
To be sanctified *on parade*.

The offering made was not in Bethlehem,
Nor on the cruel cross, not in the hem
Of seamless garment cast up like a charm.
The offering of the Christ was not in harm,
But in the sitting down upon the throne,
At the right hand of God there to atone.
Beloved, my ways and scenes are manifold,
Just as the explanations of the cold
Are riotous and varying and bold
To say that death is needed to pay off
The divine justice or the devil's scroff.
But whether I find doctrine fair or ill,
The world and heaven above within Your
will
Still turn and ply eternities with skill.

15 The Holy Spirit also comes
To witness to us of his sums
That he had said before, 16 This is
16 The pact that I will make for biz
With them after those days, says YHWH,
I'll put My laws in their hearts too,
And in their minds I'll write them true;
17 And their sins and iniquities
I'll bring to mind no more to please.
18 Now where remission of these lies,
There's no more made sin sacrifice.
19 Having therefore, brothers, boldness
To enter Most Holy's address
By the blood of Jesus, 20 and by
A new and living way to try,
Which he has established for us,
Through the veil, that is, bounteous
His flesh; 21 and having a high priest
Over the house of God released,
22 Let us draw near and with true heart
In full assurance of the part
Of faithfulness, having our heart
Sprinkled from evil conscience' start,
And bodies washed in water clean.
23 Let us hold fast to what we've seen

By faith without a wavering,
For he is faithful who has been
Promising us his redeeming.

The covenant writ on the heart is one
That needs no missionising to be done.
It needs no sacrifice of blood and money
To ride upon a pony and be funny.
Instead You Yourself teach each clever
man

The way to life eternal by Your plan,
And lead into the sanctuary where
The intercession of our lord and fair
Remains to cleanse the troubled heart in
share.

I lay aside all sacrifice for good
As well as malice in my life of hood,
And boldly taste the nectar in the wood
Of Paradise, and sip the silver fruit
On every tree of knowledge to the root.

24 Let us take thought of each one to
Provoke to love and good works too,
25 And not forsaking gathering
Of ourselves together *to sing*,
As the manner of some is now,
But exhorting each other how:
And so much more as you see near
The day of his appearing here.

Beloved, I do not wish in any way
To forsake gathering in group to pay
Your majesty the honour that is due
From every fellow sitting in his pew.
But if there is no gathering below
Except the heathen one of hale and show,
Then let my absence on a day remain
A gift of love to You through my fast pain.
And by contrast when I appear to bow
Within the idol temple and somehow
Seek out Your face behind the bull and
cow,
Then let that too be in Your heart of love
A gift in recompense for earthly shove.
All things come from Your hand barren of
glove.

26 For if we sin on purpose then
After we've known the truth again,
There then remains no sacrifice
More for sins *that we think are nice*,
27 But just a fearing expectation

Of judgement's fiery of indignation,
Which shall devour its enemies' elation.

Is it a thing that can take place, I ask,
To fall away from the hand where I bask,
Since Christ once prayed that all be given
him

And none be lost upon the wicked brim?
Is there a man on earth that ever sinned
On purpose? I refuse the shallow binned.
No man in his full senses takes the rind
And leaves the precious golden chain
behind.

All men work for their weal, and if they
sin,
They do so with a mind that they should
win.

No sacrifice on earth is needed now,
Beloved, since You provide the written
bough
On every fleshly table so men might
Live in Your law and in Your love and
light.

28 The one who ignored Moses' law
Died without mercy at the claw
Of two or three witnesses' crow.
29 Of how much graver punishment,
Do you suppose, shall then be sent
On such as have trod under foot
The Son of God, and so have put
The blood of covenant to soot,
By the which he was sanctified,
Counted unholy, so decried
The Spirit of his grace beside?
30 For we know Him, the One who said
"Vengeance is mine, I shall instead
Repay," so says the Lord. Again,
"The Lord shall come to judge His men.
31 A fearful thing it is to fall
In hands of the living God's call.

Beloved, I take both pagan and the true,
The light and dark, the death and life in
view,
If only I may have presence of You
Within the temple of my stony heart.
I take the airplane and the donkey cart,
The massive highway or the birchen path,
But in my taking flee from divine wrath.
What You do in Your universe and way
Is far beyond my comprehension's sway,

Nor does my faith rise to a starlit ray,
But whatever You do, Beloved, I find
Your doing is both justice and is kind.
Save me upon Your breast eternally,
Or cast me in Your hell fires faithfully.

32 But mind the former days, in which,
After you were enlightened switch,
You endured a great fight in pitch;
33 In part you were made gazing stock
Both by reproach and sorrows' dock,
And in part in that you became
Companions of such used in blame.
34 For you had pity on me too
In my chains, and took joyful view
Of your goods' spoiling, knowing in
Yourselves that you have after din
In heaven a better place to keep
Inheritance both broad and deep.

Inheritance divine is set for those
Who pity underdogs in chains and rows.
The implication of the opposite
Is that hell is reserved for those who sit
In judgement of unlucky men and fit.
If I have taken pity on the small
And on the ones who cannot walk but
crawl,
Then give me the inheritance and ball.
But if I've fawned upon the hand of wealth
And kissed the rings of power set out in
stealth,
Then give me halls of hell and fiery speed
To quench my thirst and assuage evil
greed.
Beloved, the earth is ever set in twain
Between the fellow pleasures and the pain.

35 So don't give up your confidence,
With great reward in recompense,
36 For you need patience so that you
After you've done God's will and true,
You might receive the promise too.
37 For yet a little while and he
Who shall come will come and not be
Late. 38 Now the just shall live by faith,
But if any one trust in wraith,
My soul shall have no pleasure in
That one, *because of all his sin*.
39 But we are not among the kind
Who turn back to perdition blind,
But among those who still believe

To soul's salvation and reprieve.

The faith I live by is the faith that You
Create upon the evil ground the true,
And after failure of my hand You make
A shining mansion for my love and sake.
The faith I live by is that this day may
In course of worldly fancy and sashay
Be the last to grace me and mine in fey.
Your sent one may come on the fragrant
sod

This very morning to see pea in pod,
To smell the violet and wonder why
Only the smell of wind is in the sky.
Beloved, I turn and turn again to find
Salvation, and see that I have been blind
To think that You were somewhere there
behind.

Hebrews 11

1 Now faith is the substance of things
Hoped for *by paupers or by kings*,
The evidence of things not seen
By any king or any queen.
2 For by it the elders obtained
A good report *for what they gained*.
3 By faith we see the universe
Was formed by God's word *without curse*,
So that the things which are seen now
Were not made of things anyhow
Which do appear, *though none the worse*.

The pagan faith is that the things You made
Were made ex nihilo in their parade.
But St Paul or his courtiers waylaid
Report them made of things invisible,
Invisible indeed, but things in full.
I trade Trinity immaterial
For grubby hands and feet that push and
pull
And give the sweet and take away the sal.
Beloved, make by Your Word again today
The beauties of universe on display,
The fir trees and the birches on the morn,
The pines forever and anon newborn,
And I'll step out to find the icy way
Filled with newly created and today.

4 By faith Abel offered to God
A better sacrifice on sod
Than Cain did, by which he obtained
Witness he was righteous unfeigned,

God testifying of his gifts:
And by it he though dead still lifts
His voice. 5 By faith Enoch at last
Was translated without the blast
Of death; and was not found at all,
Because God took him to His hall,
For before his translation he
Enjoyed of this testimony,
That he pleased God *come at His call*.
6 But without faith it cannot be
That we shall please Him in our tree;
For one coming to God must know
Belief that He is and will show
Reward to those who seek His glow.

Faith is the sight that You alone are seen
Both in my own self and the silver sheen
Of every other face that there has been.
Yet Abel and good Enoch share this fate:
That faith in purity is but a bait
For this world's men of fratricide come late.
Can anyone see good in fellowmen
And in himself and live to see again?
The one is killed outright, and so You
learned
To take the sweet Enoch away when
spurned.
The wicked heart cannot abide the true,
And must kill in each man he sees both
You
And brother and his sister for the crime
Of clear sight of divine writ out in rhyme.

7 By faith Noah, when he was warned
Of God of things not seen *but scorned*,
Moved with fear, and prepared an ark
To save his house, by which remark
He had condemned the world and so
Became heir of the righteous row
Which is by faith *and on the go*.

It took a bit more than just faith to make
A ship, when he had never seen the wake
Upon the sea. For Noah had to think
A whole new science and art link by link.
It's so each time I hear the word arise.
Faith always means more work than
otherwise.
It's only in the Lutheran disguise
That faith is separated from the toil
Of making and achieving on the soil.
Beloved, if Noah had such faith to build,

You must admit his preaching was
unskilled,
Since he got no one to come to his church
But family, beasts and birds on their perch.
The man was not a speaker, though faith-
filled.

8 By faith Abraham, he when called
To go out to a place unvalled,
Which he should afterwards receive
For an inheritance in sleeve,
Obeyed; and he went out not knowing
The place to which he had been going.
9 By faith he stayed in promised land,
As in a strange country to stand,
Living in tents with Isaac and
With Jacob, heir with him in band
Of the same promise not at hand.
10 For he looked for a city grand
That has foundations, of which God
Is builder and maker on sod.

This letter's all about the fact that You
Accept atonement for the sins in view
Not by an earthly priesthood's sacrifice,
But by the intercession of the nice,
The lovely Christ that stands upon the
street

Of the celestial city for a treat.
So Abraham in ancient days and gone
Showed faith in hopeful waiting for the
dawn,

The city where atonement of the best
Is made among the angels' singing quest.
Beloved, I join the Abrahamic lore
And spend my faith upon the heavenly
door,

And see beyond the darkness of my room
The splendour of a further range of doom

11 Through faith also Sara herself
Received strength to conceive *like elf*,
And had a baby when she'd passed
The age, because she did not cast
Out her faith, but considered Him
Faithful who promised *to the brim*.
12 That's why there came from one as good
As dead as many as the hood
Of stars above in multitude,
And as the sand beside the sea
Upon a shore's unmeasured lee.

The faith of Sarah was merely to laugh
 At promises You made before her gaff.
 I hate to point out that the promised son
 Was not result of anything she'd done.
 Her rocking in the darkened tent one night
 With Abraham, though no doubt a delight,
 Was hardly contribution to Your act,
 Although it is a funny sort of fact
 That copulation should be called at last
 Faith on the part of woman not outcast.
 A lot of people copulate, I know,
 But none today imagine it a show
 Of faith. Today faith is defined the more
 By singing hymns, not looking at the gore.

13 These all died in faith, did not see
 The promises, except far off,
 And were persuaded not to scoff,
 And so embraced them, and confessed
 That they were strangers on a quest
 And pilgrims on the earth addressed.
 14 For those who say such things declare
 Plainly they seek a country fair.
 15 And truly, if they'd had a mind
 Of that place from which they resigned,
 They could have gone back to the blind.
 16 But now they want a better land,
 That is a heavenly place to stand.
 That's why God's not ashamed to be
 Called their God, for them a city
 He has prepared *eternally*.

The Hebrew letter makes distinction twixt
 The two groups on the earth with
 boundaries fixed.
 The one prefers the earthly love and life
 That comes from human sacrifice and
 strife,
 The worship of an idol and a cross,
 The dream atonement's made where such
 emboss.
 The other loves the heavenly crown and
 scene
 Where intercession is atonement's bean,
 And You forgive because a living Christ
 Stand victor martyr over cross sufficed.
 Beloved, I turn from heathen church and
 crowd
 And sing the songs celestial and aloud,
 Forgetting crucifixes and the mass,
 But rushing out to glory on the grass.

17 Abraham by faith, he when tried,
 Offered up Isaac by his side,
 The one who had received the hope
 Of promise offered up in scope,
 His only son strung *up by rope*,
 18 Of whom it was said in Isaac
 Shall your seed be called without flack;
 19 He reckoned God could raise the dead,
 The which in time he got instead.

The binding of the son was the expression
 Of rite of passage, where each mum's
 confession
 Brought out the first-born to the sacrifice.
 It was a sop to expectations nice,
 And may have saved lives from the
 neighbours twice,
 But hardly showed the faith of Abraham
 That You could resurrect a slaughtered
 lamb.
 Beloved, the misconceptions of Your brood
 Frustrate the love of life that You intrude
 Upon the darkened heart. Open my path
 To the embracing of Your love and wrath,
 And I shall show the faith of Abram's day,
 The hope of resurrection caught in ray,
 The inclination to subvert the way.

20 By faith Isaac blessed Jacob and
 Esau for things to come at hand.

The greatest joy encouraging my soul
 Is that You call the act of Isaac's toll
 To bless Jacob and Esau, act of faith.
 It seems more like manipulation's wraith.
 First Jacob lies and Isaac is well fooled
 And blesses the son he had never schooled.
 Isaac loved Esau, not Your choice at all.
 Is that faith founded in the last recall?
 Then Isaac tries to fix the thing again
 By blessing Esau too among his men.
 Isaac is blind, acts foolishly and wrong,
 And yet You call it faith instead of song.
 I too do all things wrong, and yet I pray
 You call them right upon the judgement
 day.

21 By faith Jacob, he when abed
 And dying, blessed both sons that led
 Joseph to him, and bowed and leaned
 Upon his staff *for those who keened*.

It may be just his own life's path that taught
Jacob to bless the younger in the plot,
Remembering mistakes his father made,
And so he crossed his hands and then he
prayed

The birthright blessing on the younger son,
While Joseph fumed at the injustice done.
To run against the grain society
Sets up may be the faith of all the free.
But then I note that precedence invents
New crimes of habit in the human tents.
Beloved, no matter what men do on earth,
Bless or refrain from blessing sons of
worth,

They cannot be right in the things they do,
And yet You call their sight a faithful view.

22 By faith Joseph, when he too died,
Made mention of the coming tide
The children of Israel to go,
And gave commands for his bones so.

The faith of Joseph was both true and tried.
He looked for a grave on the other side
Of the Nile and the Red Sea's flowing tide.
Without faith he might have seen centuries
More in the desert without hope or breeze,
But he too looked for promised land above,
And rested in his hope and in his love.
Beloved, despite the faith of Joseph's death,
I in my human sort of thought and breath
Would have chosen the great acts of his life
To save his family from hunger rife,
The brother, child and even brother's wife.
I would have chosen his diplomacy,
His rulership, his faithful slavery.

23 By faith Moses, when he was born,
Was hidden three months by his torn
Parents, because they saw him be
A proper child, and they could see
Nothing to fear in king's command.

24 By faith Moses, grown up to stand,
Refused to be called as the son
Of Pharaoh's daughter for a tonne,
25 But chose instead to suffer lot
With God's folk than enjoy the plot
Of sin for a time when he'd done;
26 Considering reproach of Christ
A greater treasure than sufficed
Treasures in Egypt, since he had
Respect to gain reward not bad.

27 By faith he forsook Egypt, not
Fearing the wrath of the king's plot,
For he endured as seeing Him
Who is invisible *and dim*.

28 By faith he kept Passover, and
The sprinkling of blood on the stand,
So the one to destroy first born
Should not touch them *with deathly scorn*.

29 By faith they passed through the Red
Sea

As on the dry, when temptingly
Egyptians tried, they drowned in spree.

The measure of true faith is that the man
Stands in Your presence and beneath Your
scan

As seeing Your form visibly in love,
As seeing visions broken from above.
I know good Freud would have a thing to
say

About the super-ego come to play,
But still I look toward the vast and grey,
The azure emptiness upon my day
And know that if I could in any way
Act as though seeing You before my eye,
I should act with a perfect faith or try.
But that's a vain hope and a vain reply.
Reality is that I am one blind,
And see no gods but emptiness behind.

30 By faith the walls of Jericho
Fell down, after they went round so
For seven days. 31 By faith innkeeper
Rahab did not die with the sleeper
In unbelief, when she'd received
The spies with peace and so relieved.

Rahab did not act as though seeing god
Arise upon the stricken, brick-paved sod.
She acted on the rumour that Your folk
Were all successful down to the last bloke,
And in the fear that Jericho would be
Run over by their hard technology.
Disloyal to her king and her country,
She fed a stranger folk to save family.
If that was faith, I doubt not many more
In every town could muster such a store.
Beloved, I merely wake to dress and eat
With wife and daughter and her son for
treat.

And if that is to act as seeing You,
Then count it as a faithful way to do.

32 What more shall I say? For the time
Would not suffice to tell the rhyme
Of Gideon, Barak, Samson,
Jephthah; David too on the run,
And Samuel of the prophets *spun*,
33 Who through faith subdued kingdoms
won,

Wrought righteousness, obtained promise,
Stopped lions' mouths, *and not to kiss*,
34 Quenched violence of fire, escaped
The mouth of sword, from weakness aped
Were made strong, became valiant men
In battle, turned to flight again
The armies of the nations strapped.

35 Women received their dead to life
Again, and others by the strife
Of torture, would not take freedom,
That they might have a better sum
Of resurrection. 36 Others had
The trial of mocking that was sad
And whippings, even chains and gaol.

37 They were stoned, and sawn up though
hale,

Were tempted, slain with sword, they went
About in sheep and goatskins rent,
The destitute, afflicted, and
Tormented, 28 Of whom the world's stand
Was not worthy, they wandered out
In deserts, and in mountains stout,
And in the dens and caves of earth.
39 All these, having got good report
Through faith, received no promised sport,
40 God having in store better things
For us, that without us in rings
They should not be made perfect *kings*.

Faith is defined as being one who is
Above the worth of earthly power and biz.
The truth is cruelty and greed resolve
In every town with lust more to revolve,
So that the innocent remain aloof,
In poverty and often without roof.
Too good for this world is the only way
To walk in faith and never go astray.
I know some such, and they are close to
me,

Too good for this world and its gross folly.
Beloved, I share the fate of innocent
Despite my greed and lust and further bent
To cruelty, and if I share the fate,

Give me the same grace on my balding
pate.

Hebrews 12

1 Wherefore seeing that we also
Are surrounded with such great glow
Of witnesses, let's lay aside
Every weight, and the sin in tide
That so easily runs us down,
And run with patience for the crown,
2 Looking to Jesus, author and
Finisher of the faith to stand,
Who for the joy set before him
Endured the cross, despised the dim,
And has sat down at the right hand
Of God's own throne *above the land*.

3 So consider him who endured
Such contradiction and uncured
Of sinners against himself, lest
You get too tired and faint to jest.
4 You have not yet resisted to
The blood, striving against sin's cue.

Beloved, does this mean that before
temptation

A man must try not to follow elation
Until the blood pours out of eyes and nose
And runs down from his ears onto his toes?
But let's say one should do this very thing.
Would there be any benefit to sing?
If You have not writ on the fleshly heart
Your law in life extended into art,
You give no credit to the human flight
Of effort and of doing of the right.
But mark my words: those under Islam's
fright

Sometimes may do the good, like Jewish
might,

And still expect reward before the light.
Do You Yourself not assign each his part?

5 And you've forgotten warning sent
To you as to children to vent,
"My son, despise not chastening
Of the Lord, nor faint *on the wing*
When you're rebuked by Him *to sing*.
6 For whom the Lord loves He will warn,
And whip each son He keeps from scorn.
7 If you endure your whipping, then
God deals with you as sons and men,
For what son is there that his dad
Does not whip *when he's feeling sad*?

8 But if you are not whipped at all,
As everyone that's in the hall,
Then you are bastards, not sons' call.
9 Besides that we've had dads of flesh
Who punished us with mace and mesh,
And we respected them for all.
So shall we not much rather fall
Under subjection of the call
Of Father of spirits, and live?

In nations civilized and good today
Fathers do not beat sons sent out to play.
That would diminish the self and
achievement,
No matter what others feel in bereavement.
The lesson's lost, if lesson there may be
In these words of an ancient infamy.
I guess we're all just bastards in this place
Of educated self-esteem for grace.
Beloved, despite the ungore in the land,
I find that I am beaten where I stand
By every wind that buffets small and grand.
It may be a quaint blindness that I make
Your sovereignty a comfort at the stake,
A minding of the sweetness in Your wake.

10 For they truly a brief time spent
In chastening us as they went,
But He for our profit, so we
Might partake of His holy fee.
11 Now chastening now for the time
Seems to be joyous, but a crime,
But afterwards it yields the fruit
Of righteousness in peace to boot
To those on whose back lay the suit.
12 So lift up the hands which hand down,
And feeble knees; 13 around the town
Make straight paths for your feet, lest those
Who are lame be turned from their pose;
But let it rather heal the rows.
14 Pursue peace with all, and withal
A holy way, without which call
No man shall see the Lord at all.
15 Be careful that no one should fail
Of God's grace, lest the root to flail
In bitterness spring woe to you,
And so defile many in pew.
16 Let there not remain among you
A fornicator or the crew
Of the profane, as Esau, who
For one morsel of meat then sold
His birthright *and was in the cold.*

For you know how that after that,
When he wanted the fiefdom fat,
He was rejected, for he found
No place to repent on the ground,
Although he sought with tears around.

Pursuit of peace is a word that's well said.
Maintaining peace is impossible dread,
If one must put out those who make the
path

A crooked way before eternal wrath,
And all defilement of the fornicator,
And every profane man and alligator.
Once such are put outside the congregation,
One might think peace would reign in holy
nation,

But the reality is that the saints
Are also always ready with complaints.
Beloved, I am the proof of every guile:
You can see trouble making at a mile.
No one repents but by Your grace once
given,
Though sought with tears and night-time
angels striven.

18 For you have not come to the mount
That may be touched, and for account
Burned with the fire, nor to the black,
And dark and tempest without slack,
19 And sound of trumpet, and the voice
Of words, which those who heard the
choice

Begged that the word should not be spoken
To them again for any token.

20 For they could not endure command,
And if so much as beast at hand
Did touch the mountain, it should die
By stoning, are with dart on sly.
21 And so terrible was the sight,
And Moses said "I'm in a fright
And quake and tremble in my right."

22 But you have come to Sion's mount,
And to the city and the fount
Of living God, the heavenly town,
Jerusalem without a frown,
And to a multitude in sight
Of angels, 23 to the great condite
Assembly of the called out ones
Of the first-born among the sons,
Which are inscribed in heaven, and to
God Judge of all and to the crew
Of spirits of just men in view

Made perfect, 24 and to Jesus yet
The mediator of the set
New covenant, and to the blood
Of sprinkling that speaks in a flood
Of better things than Abel's mud.

The contrast between Sinai's peek and that
Celestial mount of Sion where has sat
Down David and Your fair anointed still
Is more than just the shaping of the hill.
The one is fear to meet Your shining face,
The other is its seeking for a trace.
The one is hope of fine reward for mace,
The other is assurance of Your grace.
Beloved, write on my heart that covenant
That Jeremiah promised with such cant,
And I shall find the way without a guide
Beyond Your unseen leading at my side.
And if at last I reach the open gate,
The perfect garden shall not find me late.

25 Be careful that you don't refuse
The one who speaks not to accuse.
For if they did not get away
Refusing him who spoke to stay
On earth, much more shall we not find
Escape, if we turn to the blind
Away from Him that speaks from heaven.
26 His voice the shook the earth as in
leaven.

But now He's promised saying "Yet
Once more I'll shake not just earth met,
But also heaven in the set."
27 And this word: "Yet once more to sign
The taking away of the line
Of those things shaken, as of things
That are not made, so that the springs
That cannot be shaken remain."

28 That's why we get a kingdom lain
Which cannot be moved, let us find
Grace by which we may serve in kind
God with the reverence due and more
With godly fear kept up in store.
29 For our God's raging fire to mind.

The kingdom that You rule cannot be
shaken
Because Your sovereignty's never
mistaken.

All men are made of moving, shapen dust
And sink back to primordial sea and rust.
But what is of Your grace in a man's need

Remains untouched, unmoved beyond the
greed
Of rushing to existence. All remains
That is of value on the heavenly plains.
Beloved, I see You still unmoved upon
A throne set on the earth as well as dawn,
And trust the providence eternity
Has seen unfold upon Your sovereignty,
Defining justice in the round of years,
Instilling love upon all human fears.

Hebrews 13

1 Let brotherly love aye remain.
2 Do not forget to entertain
Strangers, for that way some in shares
Entertain angels unawares.
Remember those who are in chains,
As bound with them, and those in blains
As being yourselves in their cares.
4 Marriage is honoured among all,
And its bed undefiled withal,
But whore mongers and adulterers
Will God judges along with their fers.
5 Let your behaviour come to be
Without a covetous degree,
And be content with what you've got,
For He has said in every lot
"I shall not leave you nor forsake."
6 So we may say bold as a rake,
"The Lord's my helper, and I'll not
Fear what man shall do to my plot."
7 Remember those who have the rule
Over you, who have spoken school
To you of God's word: follow on
In their faith and consider drawn
How they behave *when they have gone*.

The ten commandments of St Paul appear
In the last Hebrews chapter without fear.
Like every human expression in mode,
They cannot stand alone nor fill the load
Of truth and what is needed on this star.
And yet they are a practice going far.
First seven commands: one love, strangers
keep,

Remember prisoners and do not heap
Up whoredoms on the sacred marriage bed,
Do not be covetous, content instead,
Remember those who spoke the divine
word,
And follow them faithful to what you've
heard.

Such are commandments of the Gospel sent
Enhancing what the Decalogue had meant.

8 Jesus Christ the same yesterday,
Today, and forever in sway.

9 Do not be carried about by
Divers and strange doctrines to try.
For it's a good thing that the heart
Be set with grace, and not with cart
Of meats, which have not profited
Those who are occupied in bid.

10 We have an altar from which they
Have no right to eat of or slay
Who serve in tabernacle's way.

11 For the bodies of those beasts, whose
Blood's brought to tabernacle pews
By the high priest for sin, are burned
Outside the camp *and so are spurned*.

12 That's why Jesus too, so he might
Sanctify the people aright
With his own blood, suffered outside
The gate. 13 Let us go out therefore
To him outside the camp and store,
Bearing with him reproach and more.

14 For here we have no place to stay
In permanent city and gay,
But we seek one to come some day.

15 By him therefore let's offer well
The sacrifice of God's praise tell
And all the time, that is the fruit
Of our lips giving thanks to boot
To His name constantly to root.

The eighth commandment is to flee all
strange
Doctrines that compete on the earthly range
Of sacrificial hopes, that by some blood
The world may set right all lost in the
flood.

The path to life eternal's out the gate,
Away from temple and the priestly rate,
Away from institutions and the church,
Away from wickedness and evil smirch.
Beloved, I seek the desert on the earth,
Reproach if it must be to find in worth
The great celestial choir, where Your word
rings

In all the praises that an angel sings.
Beloved, I take Your thanks instead of
stings
Upon the lips of those who know but
dearth.

16 But to do good and give alms do
Not forget, for with such a view
Of sacrifices God's well pleased.

17 Obey those who have power greased
Over you, and submit yourselves,
For they watch for your souls on shelves,
As those who must give an account,
That they may do it with joy's fount,
And not with grief, for that is set
Without a profit you may get.

The ninth commandment is to do good and
To give alms to the poor upon the sand.
That's one that You forgot when come to
stand

On Sinai for a spot upon the land.
That may be why so many long ago
Succumbed to hunger in the desert show.
But now that St Paul's spoken in the row,
I guess that problem's gone, since we're not
slow

To feed the hungry everywhere they are:
We have so many people who're a star.
Beloved, I look about for some to feed,
I search for a good word and a good deed,
But I am small and have no stock or seed,
But only pass along little and far.

18 Pray for us, for we trust we've got
A good conscience in all we've wrought,
Willing to live in honest draught.

19 But I beg of you rather do
This, so I may restored to you
Come all the sooner to your view.

20 Now God of peace who brought again
Our Lord Jesus from the dead men,
That great shepherd of sheep through blood
Of eternal covenant's flood,

21 Make you perfect in all good works
To do His will, and not for shirks,
Working in you what pleases Him,
Through Jesus Christ, to whom undim
Be glory always and amen.

The tenth commandment is to pray for
those

Who bring Your word of peace and those
Your chose
To work the shepherd's work until the
close.

The one who prays will hardly stop to talk

About the evil of acquaintance' stock.
 And yet the command is to pray for men
 Who have only good consciences again.
 That may be more than in the righteous
 den,
 Since men are prone to forget what they've
 done,
 And conscience wakens on the lesser son.
 Beloved, though I've got neither conscience
 clean
 Nor patience to pray on from scene to
 scene,
 Give me the grace to pray instead of act
 In vengeance on complacent and compact.

22 I beg you, brothers, let come in
 The word of warning against sin,
 For I've written a letter to
 You in few words to stir your view.
 23 You know that brother Timothy
 Is set again at liberty;
 With whom, if he comes soon I'll be
 Happy again for you to see.
 24 Greet all of those who have the rule
 Over you, and all saints in pool.
 Those who reside in Italy
 Greet you. 25 Grace be with you again,
 With all of you, and so amen.

There are those in the tent who realize
 That all comes from You sitting in the skies
 And none can earn the right behind
 disguise,
 Who might suppose that sin has not a share
 In what the elect come to do and bear.
 Not so: even the lost are duty bound
 To their obedience upon the ground.
 Much more the saved and chosen on the
 round
 Are meant to obey You in sovereign sound.
 If sovereignty is infinite and great,
 Then sin is not alternative in state.
 And so I hear the condemnation found
 Against sin, and I flee its power and hate,
 Elect and chosen, but commensurate.

The Epistle of James

The most Islamic of the Bible text
 The letter of good James to the perplexed

Gives faith and works a chance upon the
 ground,
 And raises up Your praises with the sound.
 No other writing on the earth is found
 So sweet in promises and praise to You.
 Beloved, I take this letter in my pew
 And hold it to the light and in my view,
 See glories of the lowly and demise
 Of those who wear the golden rings to rise
 Upon the upper seats under the skies.
 I follow James more than the other crowd
 And sing the Psalms he sanctifies aloud,
 And find the healing oil on head unbowed.

James 1

1 James, a bond servant both of God
 And of the Lord Jesus Christ too,
 To the twelve tribes scattered abroad:
 Greetings. 2 My brothers, *as you do*,
 Count it all joy when you fall in
 To trials of diverse kinds (*not sin*),
 3 Knowing your faith when tested brings
 Patience. 4 But let patience take *wings*
In perfect work, that you may be
 Perfect, complete, no absentee.
 5 If any of you lacks wisdom,
 Let him ask God, who'll give him some,
 Who gives to all freely without
 Reproach. 6 But let him ask believing,
 With no doubting *of his receiving*,
Of his receiving with no doubt,
 For he who doubts is like a wave
 Of the sea driven and a *slave*
 Tossed by the wind. 7 For let not that
 Man think that he'll receive *the fat*
 Of anything then from the Lord,
 8 *He is* a double-minded ward,
 Unstable in all of his ways.
 9 Let the lowly brother have praise
 In his exaltation, 10 the rich
 By contrast thrown into the ditch,
 Because as a flower of the field
 He'll pass away *without a yield*.

Though I am counted poor here where I
 live,
 And dwell in a house with roof like a sieve,
 While those around me drive in luxury
 And buy new electronics in a spree
 Every Christmas, while I drink water from
 My well and eat the course bread without
 rum,

I still possess more than the mass of men
Who make up Your great kingdom in the
den
Of poverty. Beloved, cast me not out
Into the ditch with Rothschild and the stout
Inventor of bicrocroft in the mill
Of philanthropy to provide a bill
Of no taxes at all where such eat swill.
I know what wealth and trade are all about.

11 For no sooner has the sun risen
With burning heat *above the mizzen*
Than it withers the grass, its flower
Falls, its beauty within the hour
Perishes. So the rich men too
Will fade away in what they do.
12 Blessed *is* the man who endures *hard*
Temptation, for in his regard,
He will receive the crown of life
Which YHWH has promised *without strife*
To all those who love Him *unmarred*.
13 Let no one say when he is tempted,
“I am tempted by God”, exempted
Is God from tempting anyone
With evil, such as He would shun.
14 But each one is tempted when he
Is drawn away *and lustfully*
Enticed by his own desires’ *fee*.
15 Then, when desire has conceived, it
Gives birth to sin, and sin, when it
Is full-grown, brings forth death. 16 Do not
Be deceived, beloved brothers *taught*.
17 Every good gift and every one
That’s perfect is from above *won*,
And comes from the Father of lights,
With whom there are no vain respites,
No change or shadowing of turning,
As in false gods we must be spurning.

Belovèd, every good and perfect gift
Comes down from You. In gratitude I lift
My eye and voice to You, though You
alone
Are Seer, Speaker here. I’m like a stone
For lip and sight. Receive my gentle thanks
For ever-changing gifts in ranks on ranks
Of mornings always new and starry nights
And changing leaf in season and the flights
Of robin and of goose. My hurtling life
Returns to You through all the stinging
strife
To see if there is change in One when all

Is done and every face turns at Your call.
No, when You’re found You are a treasure
still,
Unchanged if hidden or if found at will.

18 Of His own will he brought us out
By word of truth, that we, devout,
Might be some firstfruits of his creatures.
19 My beloved brothers *and beseechers*,
Let every man be swift to hear,
And slow to speak, and slow *appear*
To wrath, 20 for man’s anger *and prod*
Gives forth no righteousness of God.
21 Therefore lay by all filthiness
And overflow of wickedness,
Receive with meekness word implanted,
For saving of your souls is granted.
22 But be doers of the word, and
Not hearers only, out of hand,
Deceiving yourselves. 23 For if any
Is hearer of the word *in many*
And not a doer, he is like
A man who sees the natural *strike*
Of his face in a mirror, 24 for
He sees himself, and goes therefore
Away, and straight forgets what kind
Of man he was. 25 But he, *not blind*,
Who looks into the perfect law
Of liberty, goes on *in awe*,
And hears but does not forget but
Goes on to do the work he’s cut
Out to do, this one will be blessed
In what he does, *and earn his rest*.
26 If anyone among you thinks
He is religious, *(though he drinks)*
And does not bridle in his tongue
But deceives his own heart *full strung*,
This one’s religion *is* useless.
27 Pure, undefiled religion’s *dress*
Before God and the Father’s this:
To visit orphans, widows *kiss*
In their trouble, *and* keep oneself
Unspotted from the worldly *shelf*.

The great service of remembrance is to
Find You, Beloved, in every face You do.
This is the mirror of James and the great
Plain of judgement, the entering at the gate.
Who finds You in the face of poor and
meek,
The lowly in wealth, who no longer seek,
Finds all the wealth of universe beside.

The mirror is no place at all to hide.
 The law of life in Decalogue is set,
 And made the scene and tent of man beset
 As reflected in human face and brow
 Two bow-lengths from eternity to now.
 Beloved, I find You in the mirror's way
 That rises in my eyes both night and day.

James 2

1 My brothers, do not keep the faith
 Of our Lord Jesus Christ like wraith,
 God's glory that shows in all men,
 With a discriminating ken.
 2 For if there comes in congregation
 A man with a gold ring for station,
 In fine clothes, and there comes also
 A poor man in poor clothes to toe,
 3 And you respect the one that wears
 The fine clothes and tell him that shares
 A good place, and say to the poor,
 Stand there or just sit on the floor,
 4 Are you not then partial among
 Yourselves, and become judges flung
 Of evil thoughts, *though yet unstung*?
 5 So listen, my brothers beloved,
 Has not God chosen the ungloved
 Poor of this world though rich in faith,
 And heirs of the kingdom, not wraith,
 Which He has promised to all folk
 Who love Him *as the One who spoke*?
 6 But you've despised the poor. Do not
 Rich men oppression in your lot?
 Don't they bring you to court in plot?
 7 Don't they blaspheme that worthy name
 By which you're called *away from shame*?

The fact is that the rich are all resigned
 To have their reward with the wined and
 dined,
 And are not chosen by Your grace to be
 A part of the heavenly eternity.
 While some poor too may go to hell, the
 rich
 Will without exception join in the ditch.
 Those who possess their millions in the
 crowd
 Rejoice now maybe but will cry aloud
 When judgement pours upon them at a
 stitch.
 Beloved, like the fine man of faith who
 prayed
 Against the publican repentance-swayed,

I too thank You that I've not been waylaid
 By wealth and power among the stied and
 staid.
 I have a chance of Your election paid.

8 If you fulfil the royal law
 According to the Scripture awe,
 You shall love your neighbour as self,
 You do well *sitting on your shelf*.
 9 But if you will discriminate,
 You sin, and are convicted straight
 By the law in transgressors' state.

You just said by Your servant that the rich
 Are out of bounds and lost in black as
 pitch.

And now You hope I don't discriminate
 Against the neighbour coming soon or late.
 No man is able on this earth of brass
 To stop himself from judgement of the
 crass,

But if the judgement's made upon the word
 Of royal Decalogue with a heart stirred,
 That judgement falls on self in judgement
 blurred.

O wretched man I am, says servant Paul,
 And yet James too drives me against the
 wall.

Perhaps I'd better judge not by the law
 But by new fashions, as do hand and claw
 Around me in each tinselled, bangled stall.

10 For one who keeps the whole law and
 Still transgresses but one command,
 He's guilty of the whole to stand.

11 For He who said Do not commit
 Adultery, also said fit
 Do not kill. Now if you commit
 No adultery, and yet you kill,
 You've come to fit transgressors' bill.

12 So speak and do, as such as will
 Be judged by liberty's law's will.

13 For he shall have judgement without
 Mercy, who shows no mercy's grout,
 And mercy rejoices aloud
 Against the judgement *of the crowd*.

14 What does it profit, brothers mine,
 Though a man claim to faith divine,
 And have no works, can faith save him?

15 If brother or sister in grim
 Nakedness lie, and destitute
 Of daily food, *less than the brute*,

16 And one of you may say to them,
Depart in peace, be warmed with gem
And filled, and yet give not to those
The things the body needs, the clothes,
What does it profit, *and what shows?*
17 Even so faith, having no works,
Is dead, being alone in shirks.

The faithfulness of good works in the city
Does naught at all to rouse the divine pity.
You save the one and leave the other ditty.
Neither faith nor good works can save the
day,
And yet You give them both to those who
stray,
When You decide to give grace without
pay.
Though works and faith both profit not at
all,
And though they're both required against
the wall,
It's You alone who have the wherewithal.
Beloved, I praise Your name for secret set,
For providence among both prick and pet,
And still rejoicing sink down into hell
Or at Your call rise up to sing a spell
In heavenly courts and quires I've hardly
met.

18 Indeed, a man may say you've got
Faith and I have works for my lot,
Show me your faith without your works,
And I'll show you my faith that works.
19 If you believe there is one God,
You do a good thing on the sod:
The devils too believe and shake.
20 But will you know, vain man, mistake,
That faith without works is dead flake?

I hope, Beloved, You do not mean that
Jews
And Muslims sitting safely without pews
Are devils when they take the truth in hand
That You are one and only where You
stand.
It seems to my dark heart and vision here
That Trinitarians surely appear
The greater devils, if dogma alone
Determines who and what may not atone.
You save Yourself by Your admission that
They do well who admit no other cat
Is God Almighty on the heavenly mat.

Beloved, I do believe and tremble too,
As well as work away at what to do,
And never stop even to polish shoe.

21 Was not Abraham our ancestor
Justified by works, when a quester
He'd offered Isaac his own son
Upon the altar when he'd done?

Like Paul, James too is far too reticent
To use his reason fully where he's bent.
Abraham was not justified by works
Or by his faith in any sort of quirks.
The man was chosen by election sure,
And by his circumcision was made pure.
That's something in the Christian sort of
way

So many preachers fail to see and say.
Besides that, Abraham just followed rule
Of Canaanite that the first-born in school
Must be a sacrifice to thirsty god.
He managed in the ritual in pod
To satisfy the neighbours with a nod.
But You demand no offering on the sod.

22 Do you see how faith wrought with
works
And by works was faith without quirks
Made perfect? 23 And Scripture fulfilled
That said Abraham was well billed
With righteousness when he believed
God, and was God's friend well received.
24 You see then how that by man's acts
A man is justified in pacts
And not by faith alone in facts.
25 So also Rahab the innkeeper
Was not justified with the sleeper
By works when she received the spies
And sent them out safe to devise?
26 For as the body without spirit
Is dead, so faith without works near it
Is also dead *in heaven's eyes*.

Though Paul and James are read to conflict
in
Theology of faith and works and sin,
Reality is that You do all things,
Beloved, despite all human questionings.
Both faith and works are Yours and not the
pile
Of Paul or James or any other file.
Did Rahab make her own salvation's style,

Or Abraham convince You with a smile?
No, You chose Abraham from Ur one day
And gave him grace to go the better way;
And You chose Rahab on the city wall
To act in favour of the spies to fall.
No man is justified by faith or works,
But only by Your sovereign plan that lurks.

James 3

1 My brothers, don't be many masters,
Knowing that we'll get greater plasters
Of condemnation *by the casters*.
2 For in many things we offend.
If any man does not intend
To offend in word, such a man
Is perfect, and such a one can
Bridle the whole body in span.
3 See, we put bits in horses' mouth,
So they'll obey us north to south,
And we turn their whole body round.
4 See also the great ships and sound,
When driven by fierce winds, are turned
About with a small helm unspurned,
Wherever the pilot finds ground.
5 Even so the tongue is so small,
And boasts great things. And see how tall
A thing a little fire sets light.
6 The tongue's a fire, a world of spite,
So is the tongue among our members
That it defiles the whole thing's embers,
And sets on fire the course of nature;
And it's set by hell's legislature.

For all his lauding works, James fears the
tongue
Has victory over both old and young.
If one cannot control that tiny muscle,
Then what's to do with every other trussle?
Methinks that James with cunning tongue
in cheek
Reminds me how the human will is weak
And all devoid of the good things to seek.
No matter where I climb, I'm on first rung.
Beloved, I too boast many things indeed,
I boast of family and ethnic seed,
I boast of faith and of my better creed,
But in my boasting tongue there is no
power
But what You have vauchsafed to me an
hour.
The boasting fast returns to the sweet dung.

7 For every kind of beast and bird,
And serpent and the things unheard
Within the sea, is tamed and stirred
By humankind: 8 but the tongue can
No man tame, it's unruly span
Of evil filled with deadly rate
Of poison. 9 Therefore we relate
Blessing to God, even the Father,
And with it curse we men for bother,
Which are made in similitude
Of God: *so greatly's the tongue rude*.

It's quite a natural thing to bless the great
And one God there enthroned in heavenly
state

And curse the man made in His image
plain.

It is a thing most human, wise and sane.
The soul sees the divine within and so
Presumes the divine oneness needs the
show

Of her defence against idolatry,
The rival claim to some divinity.
Beloved, teach me the wonder that all men
And women too and children once again,
For all plurality in body host,
Are filled with one divine, not multi-ghost.
Your oneness is the gauge humanity
Is also one, despite the killing spree.

10 Out of the same mouth comes the
blessing

And cursing. My brothers left guessing,
These things ought not to be, but lessing.

11 Does a spring send out at one place
Sweet water and with bitter trace?

12 Can the fig tree, my brothers, bear
The olive berries, or can share
A vine figs? So can no spring yield
Both salt water and fresh unpeeled.

13 Who is a wise man and filled by
Knowledge among you on the sly?
Let him show out of good behaviour
His works with meekness in the saviour
Of wisdom. 14 But if you have bitter
Envying and strife in your fitter
Hearts, do not boast and do not lie
Against the truth *beneath the sky*.

If James can see that the great power of
man

Is simply to make slaves of all he can,

I am surprised he goes on to remark
The more on how the tongue's too hard to
park.

I know, as do all who live by my side
That my tongue is one no one can abide.
Leave off the wonder, and forsake the
pride.

But that all humankind can show before
The fancy gifts of bird and beast and boar,
Is the capacity to enslave more.

I'd rather have the eagle's eye or yet
The dog's good nose to find a finer pet.
Let the tongue go, Beloved, and look
around

To see what other wonders You have
found.

15 This wisdom descends not from high,
But's earthly, sensual, devilish cry.

16 For where there's envy and there's strife,
There is confusion and there's rife
Each evil work. 17 But wisdom's from
Above first pure, peaceful in sum,
Gentle and easy to entreat,
Full of mercy and good fruits meet,
Impartial, no hypocrisy.

18 The fruit of righteousness to see
Is sown in peace of those who make
Peace for the righteousness in stake.

The wisdom of king Solomon is sought
In Proverbs and the other books he
wrought.

But James knows more perhaps in synergy
For finding wisdom in reality.

I've seen the human wisdom in the way
It plays the envy and the strife that stay
In human heart and so confusion's sway
Is over all the human sort of pay.
Beloved, give me the wisdom from above
That's bold to know the gentle peace of
love,

And I shall find both mercy and good fruit
In action and in faith, the both to boot.
And as I sow Islam or peace in heart,
Remind me ever of the better part.

James 4

1 Where do wars come from and the fights
Among you? Do they not by rights
Come from the lusts that war within
Your members *to incite to sin?*

2 You lust, and do not have the gain;
You kill and want to have the vain;
You fight and war, yet you have not,
Because you do not ask a lot.

3 You ask, and still do not receive,
Because you ask amiss, believe,
And that you may consume your strength
Upon your lusts *laid out at length.*

4 Adulterers, adulteresses,
You are, and do you not know dresses
Of friendship of the world is yet
Enmity with the God you've met?
So everyone who'll be a friend
Of the world is God's foe at end.

5 Do you think that the Scripture states
In vain, the spirit that relates
In us lusts to envy's estates?

6 But He gives more grace. Therefore He
Says God resists the proud degree,
But gives grace to humility.

7 Submit yourselves therefore to God.
Resist the devil and his prod
And he will flee from you at last.

Submission to Your sovereignty on earth
Is like to cause me more war than it's
worth.

The envy and the strife of humankind
Perform a honeycomb of power combined,
And so society is stably lined.

The war comes not, Beloved, from selfish
mind,

But from the fact that there are some who
still

Fail to submit to the established hill.
Beloved, breathe no word of this vast
revealing

To any in this world without Your healing.
The non-conformist is enough to hate
Without bringing the anarchist in bait
Before the firing squad to see him late.
Beloved, breathe no word of Your plan and
feeling.

8 Draw near to God, and He will draw
Near to you. Cleanse your hands and paw,
You sinners, and cleanse your heart's awe,
You double-minded *with a claw.*

9 Afflict yourselves, and mourn and weep,
And let your laughter fail to keep
Its joy, but turn joy to a heap.

10 Humble yourselves before the Lord,

And he shall lift you up *adored*.
 11 Do not speak evil each to each,
 Brothers. The one who's out to teach
 Evil of his brother, and judge
 His brother, speaks evil to smudge
 The law, and judges the law too,
 But if you judge the law, then you
 Are not a doer of law true,
 But a judge *sitting in your pew*.
 12 There's one lawgiver, one who can
 Save and destroy, who in your span
 Are you to judge another man?

Advice of James is written the elect,
 And not appeal to sinners to protect
 Their lives and souls in some eternity
 By duty of repentance on the lea.
 There's one lawgiver, who alone can save
 And who alone destroys both good and
 brave.
 Should I presume to save my soul for good
 And doing all the lovely things I should,
 I judge myself as well as other man.
 Beloved, I lie inert beneath Your plan.
 I praise and pray the humble line You give
 And fail not in Your giving me to live.
 At last all faces come before Your throne
 And there's no judgement left except Your
 own.

13 Just keep it up then, you who say
 Today or tomorrow in sway
 We'll go into such a town and
 Continue there a year to stand
 And buy and sell and get our gain;
 14 Whereas you do not know in vain
 What shall be on tomorrow's plane.
 For what is your life? It is just
 A vapour that appears like dust
 A little time, and then is gone.
 15 For what you should say is "If God
 Wills, we shall live upon the sod
 And do this or that thing by prod."
 16 But now you rejoice in your boasting,
 All such glee is wickedness hosting.
 17 Therefore to one who knows to do
 The good and does not follow cue,
 To him it is a sin in view.

In sha Allah, if God wills, is the word
 I hear from every Muslim tongue when
 stirred.

And in that hearing I hear where the faith
 Lies well and increased without need of
 wraith.
 There is no plan that human heart can make
 Except the grace that You give each in
 stake.
 And so my breath returns and so I write
 Another sonnet to my harm and spite,
 But turn the thing back to Your hand of
 right
 And pray the wrong may turn again to
 light.
 Beloved, the song I spurn as of the night
 Resounds a moment in Your sovereign will
 And then returns to fill the lusted bill.
 You know better than I what to fulfil.

James 5

1 Just keep it up then, you rich men,
 And weep and howl for pains again
 That shall come on you *in your den*.
 2 Your riches are corrupted then,
 And your clothes moth-eaten to ken.
 3 Your gold and silver's cankered too,
 And their rust witness against you,
 And they shall eat your flesh like fire.
 You've heaped up treasure for the *dire*
Great punishment of last day's ire.
 4 See how the workers' wages who
 Have reaped your fields, and the which you
 Kept back by fraud, cries out anew,
 And the cries of those who have reaped
 Have entered ear and so have leaped
 Up to the Lord of sabaoth.
 5 You've lived in pleasure on the earth,
 And been wanton; you've nourished your
 Hearts as in day of slaughter's store.
 6 You have condemned and killed the just;
 And he does not resist your lust.

The wealthy in this latter day have spent
 Their darkened hearts attempting to invent
 The neo-pagan way to watch the moon
 And calculate its quarters and to croon
 In awful, heathen gyrations and tune
 That all must leave the Sabbath and to rest
 Upon the lunar quarters and invest
 In losing jobs. So workers will submit
 To the authority of those who sit
 Upon the rich elite whose moons relent.
 Beloved, I flee to You on Sabbath day
 And eat the manna You provide in pay,

And curse the rich in every prayer I say,
Awaiting Christ's appearance and his ray.

7 Be patient therefore, brothers, till
The coming of the Lord with bill.
See now, the farmer waits for fruit
Precious from the earth in his suit,
And has long patience for it, till
He gets the early rain on hill
And latter rain up to the fill.
8 So be you also patient and
Establish now your hearts to stand,
For the Lord's coming is at hand.

The revolution against empires must
Wait for the coming of the Christ I trust,
The mountain of Your sovereignty that
makes
The golden image wondered at to rust,
And turns the brazen empire into dust.
So patience is the watchword at the stakes.
The rise of wicked men enflamed with
greed,
Pretending violence will meet their need,
Is not the sign of Your kingdom eternal,
But war and rumoured war drunk on the
mead
Depriving the poor of both vine and seed.
The image to the government's infernal.
Beloved, I lay hold on the grace You give,
The patience from above that I may live.

9 Do not grudge one another now,
Brothers, you'll be condemned somehow,
See the judge stands before the door.
10 Take now, my brother prophets' store,
Who've spoken in the Lord's name too,
For an example of the true
Suffering affliction and the cue
Of patience. 11 See, we count them glad
Who have endured. You've not been sad
To hear of Job's patience and see
The end of the Lord's fast decree:
That the Lord is most pitying,
Of tender mercy *fall and spring*.

Example of patience divine I see
In every prophet You have faithfully
Sent into this world's wickedness and spree.
I see them rant and fail against the crowd
Of kings usurping empires and unbowed

Changing times and Your laws to sing
aloud
The pagan hymns of Wesley graciously.
The faith is tarnished and dimmed by the
cloud.
Beloved, I turn from Reformation and
The Vatican and every eastern land,
Return to Your own prophets and sing
grand
The anthems that the ancient seers
ploughed.
If ever I may come to faith and grace,
I come by Your own prophets to Your face.

12 But above all things, brothers mine,
Do not swear, neither by the fine
Of heaven, neither by the earth,
Neither by any oath of worth,
But let your yes be yes, and so
Your negating also be no;
Lest you fall in condemning's row.

Non-swearing is the sign to great and small
Before the county courthouse standing tall
That Yours are not the pawn of
government,
Now subjects of the divine laws they've
bent.
Instead, Yours are the ones You've sworn
to You
To rise and obey all You say to do,
So hidden in Your heart that all is true
That comes into imagination's view.
Beloved, I do not swear at all nor lift
Your name as though in offering a gift,
But come repenting to Your throne in rift
With all society and churchly pew.
I do not swear at all, though ay and nay
May pass my lips before the Judgement
Day.

13 Is there among you one afflicted?
Let him pray. Is any convicted
With mirth? Let him sing Psalms *not slow*.

I swear off hymns by any that remain
After the Reformation came to claim
The world for Fanny Crosby and to blame
Those who retreat to praise with Psalms
Your name.
I leave the hymns to others for their gain.

For bad moods prayer alone may save the
day,
For glad moods singing Psalms shall be my
way,
And prayer and singing Psalms shall take
all time
I have to wake or sleep to dream up crime.
Beloved, let my affliction always be
That I stand at Your throne eternally
In prayer when needful in heart's clouded
spree,
In singing of the Psalms when I'm in glee.
Let that, Beloved, be always where I climb.

14 Is any sick among you now?
Let him ask that the elders bow
Of the called out ones, let them pray
Over him in anointing's way
With oil in the name of the Lord:
15 And the prayer of faith and adored
Shall raise him up; and if he's done
Any sins, they're forgiven, won.
16 Confess your faults each one to each,
And pray for each other in reach,
That you may be healed in the breach.
Effectual and fervent prayer
Of a righteous man's great in share.
17 Elias was a man in tow
Of passions like our own in stow,
And he prayed earnestly that it
Might not rain, and it was seen fit
Not to rain on earth for the space
Of three years and six months in race.
18 And he prayed once more and the sky
Gave rain, and the earth which was dry
Brought forth her fruit after the try.

Physicians used to follow in an oath
That kept their patients safely found in both
Good health and joy to pay them for their
growth.

Today the companies that come to make
The drugs physicians peddle for their sake
Care only for the profit that they take,
And willingly infect the populations
In hopes of gains from their further
creations.

Good James looks forward to this time
ungraced

When greed and folly stole science
replaced.

Beloved, I ask my elders for their prayer,

Knowing there is no hope now anywhere
That the physicians come to ply their ware
In cities where integrity's effaced.

19 Brothers, if any go astray
From the truth among you one day,
And one convert him, 20 let him know,
That he which turns a sinner slow
From error of his way to go
Shall save a soul from death and hide
A multitude of sins beside.

Conversion is for those that You have
chosen

Among the evil-hearted and hard-frozen
To grant them grace and life eternal here,
Despite the fall in Eden and the tear.
But it is You, Beloved, who work
repentance

Upon the heart dead under sinful sentence,
And You who grant the faith to all in store,
And You who work works to salvation
more.

Beloved, save every soul loved here below,
Save all or save a few, but be not slow
To hide a multitude of sins I see
And give celestial visions now to me.
Beloved, I here confess my wicked crimes
In deed and thought and also in my rhymes.

1 Peter

There's no question of authenticity.
Peter himself must have written this spree.
The Gospels show him one impetuous,
And this disorganized in omnibus
Shows just the man. Everything that can be
Said in a nutshell appears in degree.
Peter is not my favourite by a shot,
And yet after my reading him a lot,
I think the world would be a dimmer place
If he had never shown his homely face.
Beloved, let Peter live in Rome or here
Within my chambered heart and without
fear,

But let me joy in every word he's said
Despite the night when the disciples fled.

1 Peter 1

1 Peter, apostle of Jesus
The Christ, to the pilgrims that thus

Inhabit the Diaspora
In Pontus, and in Galatia,
Cappadocia, Asia, as far
As Bithynia, 2 elect *star*
According to foreknowledge of
God the Father, and in the *love*,
Sanctification of the Spirit,
For the obeying, and *what's near it*,
Blood sprinkling of Jesus the Christ:
Grace to you and Islam (peace) sufficed.

I am not satisfied with sprinkled blood:
Cain brought the fruit in time before the
Flood
And Abel sacrificed the bleeding lamb
Without command before came Abraham.
It's humankind demand the blood in claim,
It's human hearts that feed on offering's
flame,
And Your command is just to limit all
That human hands slay on the altar's call.
One's sanctified by spirit, not bloodshed,
Though You knew what path in which
would be led

The Christ. So many focus on the red,
Forgetting that the word obeying comes
To set aside the sacrificial sums.

3 Blessed *be* the God and Father of
Our Lord Jesus the Christ, whose love,
Abundant mercy has begotten
Us to a living hope *unsoughten*
Again through resurrection's *stead*
Of Jesus Christ up from the dead,
4 To an inheritance *as sound*
And incorruptible and *found*
As undefiled and that does not
Fade, but reserved in heavenly *plot*
For you, 5 who are kept by the power
Of God through faith *until the hour*
For salvation to be revealed
In the last time *by prophets sealed*.

Salvation is not revealed on a cross
Or any other tree of fatal loss
But in the last time, where the risen Christ
Prays interceding where his prayers
sufficed.

Salvation's heritage is not to dung
That from a bloody torture stake is wrung,
But undefiled and incorruptible
In heavenly places where the thing is full.

My hope is in the penitence I find
Before the Decalogue and unresigned
To satisfaction with a life laid bare
Without obedience to cover care.
Your power, Beloved, is infinite to see
And surely in Your will it can keep me.

6 In this you greatly rejoice, though
Now for a little while, if though
Need be, you're grieved by divers trials,
7 That your faith's purity the whiles,
More precious than perishing gold,
Though tested by the fire *blindfold*,
May be found to praise, honour, glory
At time of revelation's *story*
Of Jesus Christ, 8 whom you've not seen,
And yet you love. Though now the screen
Keeps you from seeing, yet believing,
You rejoice with joy *of receiving*
The inexpressible and full
Of glory, 9 receiving the *wool*,
The end of your faith, *what is more*,
The salvation at *your souls' door*.

Uranium, plutonium at last
Perish after some half-lives have gone past.
But gold and lead, heavy to hand and eye,
Remain millennia beneath the sky.
Beloved, is my faith of more permanence
Than god's flesh that the heathen count in
pence?
Praised be, the night work without dreams
is done,
And the fight of the dusty day is won!
Let patience then reward the stumbling feet
That dance and whirl despite the lost retreat
That beacons always to find hiding place.
Let that place be before Your holy face
Remaining when all gold has turned to
naught,
When all faces return to One unbought.

10 Of this salvation prophets do
Inquire and search carefully, who
Prophesied of the grace *that would*
Come to you, 11 and searching what *could*,
Or what manner of time, the spirit
Of Christ who was in them *or near it*
Was indicating when he said
In witness beforehand and led
The sufferings of Christ and the glories
That would follow *that in their stories*.

The saving that the prophets wrote about
 Was not that of Ashtoreth and the shout
 Of Baal as sun-god in the flaming grave.
 The message was a different one to save.
 You did not accept Baal in former times,
 You do not accept Baal today for crimes,
 But You alone are Saviour of the true,
 The ones who come in faith and come to do
 According to Your Decalogue in grace.
 For faithfulness to Torah Jesus' trace
 Of suffering fell upon the garden ground.
 He was no dupe of Ashtoreth to sound
 In cakes and wine to heaven's queen in fear
 The crops would not grow without his
 death near.

12 To them it was revealed that, not
 To themselves, but to us *untaught*
 They were ministering the things which
 Now have been reported *at pitch*
 To you through those who have been
 preaching
 The gospel to you in the teaching
 Of the holy spirit sent from
 Heaven, things which angels have come
 To desire to look in its *reaching*.

The angels of the skies desire to look
 Into the wonders of Enoch's fair book,
 And they themselves are characters
 unbound

To see the glories of Your throne around.
 The angels of the skies come with the glow
 Of praise to You instead of heathen show
 Of human sacrifice. The one is raised
 Without the sight of death, then be You
 praised.

Beloved, I too desire to see the page
 Of Your salvation and Your heritage.
 I too desire to see the wondered way
 That Enoch took up into heaven's sway
 To see the angels bending in their task
 Of guiding earth in space by sun to bask.

13 So gird up the loins of your mind,
 Be sober, rest *your* hopes combined
 Upon the grace that's to be brought
 To you at the appearing *sought*
 Of Jesus Christ, 14 as obedient
 Children, not conforming to bent
 Lusts, as *once* in your ignorance,

15 But as He who called you *is* holy,
 Be also holy in *your* dance,
 16 Because it is written, "Be holy,
 For I am holy." 17 If you call
 On the Father, who without all
 Partiality judges by each
 One's work (*and not by what they preach*),
 Conduct yourselves throughout the time
 Of your stay *here* in fear of *mime*,
 18 Knowing that you were not redeemed
 With corruptible things *that seemed*,
Like silver or gold, from your aimless
 Conduct *got* by fathers' *not blameless*
 Tradition, 19 but with precious blood
 Of Christ, as of a lamb *in bud*
 Without blemish and without spot.

Good Peter asks that I be sober now
 And obey You with hand and heart and
 brow.

He calls for holiness and not the state
 Of rampage in ecstatic sound and rate.
 He does not ask the gyiring of the dance
 Of Baal and Ashtoreth, the Horus prance,
 But only to obey the Decalogue
 And leave the heathen jumping in their fog.
 If Jesus' blood is precious, it is not
 There to buy off a license in the plot
 Allowing sin and freedom from Your law,
 But there to show the sinfulness in awe
 That humankind sink to before the word
 Made flesh in deed and heart now to be
 stirred.

20 He was in the foreordained plot
 Before foundation of the world,
 But manifest in these last times
 For you 21 who through his *flag unfurled*
 Believe in God, who *for their crimes*
 Raised him from the dead, gave him glory,
 So that your faith and promissory
 Hope are in God. 22 Since you have made
 Your souls pure in the truth obeyed
 Through the Spirit in sincere love
 Of the brothers, fervently love
 One another with a pure heart,
 23 Having been born again, apart
 From seed corruptible, but born
 Incorruptible, through the *sworn*
 Word of God which lives and abides
 Forever, 24 because "All flesh *rides*
 As grass, and all man's glory *slides*

As blossoms of the grass. The grass
Withers, and its flower falls to pass
Away, 25 “But the word of the Lord
Endures forever *like a sword*.”
Now this is the word which by true
Gospel was *taught and* preached to you.

There is no one who’s in the business of
Buying and selling souls from hand to
glove
In exchange for the blood of man or beast,
Or even a god-man to say the least.
But if the evil that men do to reach
A place of power to oppress or to preach
Conflicts with Your word sent to live in
flesh
So that the man dies in the sinful mesh,
Then that redemption proves the glowing
face
Of empire to be lacking in all grace.
Beloved, I come to You alone in faith
Of Your salvation in omnipotence,
And lay aside the saving of the wraith
Or any other who takes recompense.

1 Peter 2

1 Therefore, laying aside all spite,
Deceit, hypocrisy *in sight*,
Envy, and all evil speaking,
2 As newborn babes, desire the *sting*
Of pure milk of the word, that you
May grow thereby, 3 if indeed you
Have tasted how gracious *is* YHWH.

Beloved, I’ve tasted grace from Psalms till
now,
And find the pure milk squirting on my
brow
As I am bold to suckle at the page
Of Hebrew cantillated at my age.
I leave the pagan envy and deceit
Of dying gods and rising to retreat,
I leave the vain hypocrisy and all
The evil spoken against You in stall,
And take the grace that You bring in Your
Word
That speaks of mercy in faith undeterred.
As newborn babe, I lisp the sounds once
more
Of Decalogue and meet You on its shore.
The taste of Your word is sweet to the
tongue

Of one so pure as I and one so young!

4 Coming to him *as to a stone*
Living *and vital*, let alone
Indeed by men, but chosen by
God *and most precious in His eye*,
5 You also, as living stones, are
Being built up a temple far,
A holy priesthood, to offer
Up spiritual sacrifices that
Are acceptable to God at
Jesus the Christ *come up to bat*.

I doubt not that the rams and goats that bled
In old Jerusalem by altar led
Expressed the prayers of saints when they
were fed.

But now I take hold of a better way,
The spiritual sacrifice instead of sway
Of beasts and men led out to die and pray.
If Jesus teaches mankind anything,
As a Messiah or a heavenly king,
It’s that blood shed by beast or man or ring
Of gods and goddesses is of no worth,
But only sacrifices of the birth
Of praise, petition, penitence and plaint
Before Your throne, Beloved, by every
saint.

So shall rise undefiled both heaven and
earth.

6 So it also contained the scroll:
“Indeed, I lay in Zion a toll
Of cornerstone, elect and fine,
Precious beyond both gem *and wine*,
And he who believes on him will
By no means be given shame’s bill.”
7 So to you who believe, he’s worth
Above all, but to those in berth
Of disobedience, “The stone which
The builders had cast in the ditch,
He has become chief cornerstone,”
8 And “A stone of stumbling and groan
Of offence.” They stumble, for they
Are disobedient to the way
Of the word, to which they also
Were appointed *and set in row*.
9 But you’re a chosen generation,
A royal priesthood, holy nation,
His own special folk, that you may
Proclaim the praises of his way
Who called you out of darkness to

His marvellous light *now in view*,
 10 Who once *were* not a folk, but now
 The people of God *anyhow*,
 Who had not obtained mercy but
 Now have obtained mercy *in glut*.
 11 Beloved, I beg *you* as sojourners
 And pilgrims, abstain from the burners
 Of fleshly lusts which will attack
 The soul, 12 having conduct unslack
 In honour among the Gentiles,
 That when they utter *in their guiles*
 Things against you as evildoers,
 They may, by *your* good works *on skewers*
 Which they observe, glorify God
 In the day of coming on sod.

There are two categories of folk here:
 Those who believe and those who will
 appear
 As disobedient upon the row.
 By this Peter comes here alone to show
 That faith and obeying are of one mesh,
 And disobedience unfaithful fresh.
 I can choose to have faith and so obey,
 Or disobey in disbelief to stay.
 There is no option of sweet Christian
 found:
 To disobey and still have one's faith sound.
 I choose Your faith, Beloved, and when I
 find
 The accusations fall about my rind,
 Then I cling to obedience and let
 You compensate the lies that I forget.

13 Submit yourselves to every law
 Of man for the Lord's sake in awe,
 Whether it be to the king great,
 14 Or to the governors of state,
 As unto those who're sent by Him
 For punishment of sinners grim,
 And for the praise of those who do
 The good and keep good in their view.
 15 For so is the said will of God,
 That with well doing *under rod*
 You may put to silence at last
 The ignorance of fools outcast.

The implication's governors of state
 Are fools outcast despite their role in rate
 To punish sinners for their sin and hate.
 They may or may not praise those who do
 well

Under Your law and under Gospel's spell.
 After their term of power, they'll go to hell.
 And yet submission to the power is neat,
 Required beneath imperial retreat.
 Beloved, my will's submitted to Your own
 Until there is no will but Your's alone.
 I take the good sense of beggar of bone
 And give the mugger what he wants in
 stone,
 And so survive to strive a wicked way
 Alive, alive beside my lakeside spray.

16 Though free, not using liberty
 To cover a malicious spree,
 But as servants of God's decree.
 17 Honour all men, the brotherhood
 Love. Fear God. Give king praise as
 should.
 18 Servants, be subject to the will
 Of masters with all fear to fill,
 Not only to the good and sweet,
 But also to the wicked cheat.
 19 For this is thankworthy and meet,
 If a man for conscience to God
 Endure grief, suffer wrong at prod.
 20 For what glory is it, if when
 You're buffeted for faults again,
 You take it patiently? But if,
 When you do well, and suffer stiff,
 And take it patiently, this thing
 Is received with God *who is King*.

Reality is that injustice reigns
 Upon the earth, and so existence pains
 The holy soul more than one who disdains
 Your holy Decalogue of ten chillblains.
 In fact it is a glory if a man
 Suffers in patience punishment in span
 For what he really did. And the one who
 Complains of unjust punishment in pew
 Has got a point. But Peter thinks the rue
 Is bearable if patience seasons stew.
 Do You in fact receive the sacrifice
 As worthy of reward if I am nice
 To those who treat me unjustly in crew?
 I flee back to predestination's view.

21 For even to this very thing
 You have been called, because Christ too
 Also suffered for us in crew,
 Leaving for us example true,
 That you should follow in his ways,

22 Who did no sin, nor was the craze
 Of guile found in his mouth, 23 but who
 When he was reviled, reviled not
 Again, when he suffered from plot,
 He did not threaten, but committed
 Himself to Him who judges fitted,
 24 Who bore his own self our sins in
 His own body on the tree's kin,
 That we, as dead to sins, should live
 Unto the righteousness to give
 The stripes whereby you're healed *from sin*.
 25 For you were as sheep gone astray,
 But now returned into the way
 Of the shepherd and overseer
 Of your souls, *the Lord who is dear*.

Each man and each apostle has a thought
 For why the death of Jesus should be
 sought.

Some say it pays the devil's price to buy
 Back souls from their perdition on the sly.
 Some say it pays You for Your broken law,
 Or wakens love before the rule of claw.
 But Peter sees its value in the way
 The dear lord was so patient night and day.
 Salvation by the patience of the lord
 Is just as good as any theory floored.
 Beloved, if You've set me among elect,
 Then give me patience to be circumspect,
 To round my persecution complex first
 And so remove myself from the accursed.

1 Peter 3

1 Likewise, you wives, subject yourselves
 Under your husbands, *the sly elves*,
 So if any one does not try
 To obey the word, without cry
 Of the word, they may be won by
 The good behaviour of the wives,
 2 As they see your chaste way contrives
 In your behaviour charmed with fear.
 3 Don't let your make-up then appear
 On the outside, with fancy hair,
 And wearing gold, designer wear,
 4 But the inside beauty of heart,
 Which has no corruption in part,
 A meek and quiet spirit's art,
 Which is of great price in God's sight.

Paul's got the reputation of the day
 For chauvinistic male in every way,
 But Peter's just as good when come to say

That wives should submit to their husbands'
 way.

He justifies it by the promise they
 May see the sweetness on the women's tray
 And so be charmed to walk a better path,
 One without sin and also without wrath.
 Beloved, like Gabirol's son I have no
 Beauty upon the sleeve or in the show,
 But beg You that my inner beauty may
 Give me a hopeful and a sweeter ray.
 Depravity's the doctrine come to slay,
 But You elect a living, brighter glow.

5 For this way in the ancient time
 The holy women also climb
 Who trusted in God, to adorn
 Themselves, subjecting *without scorn*
 To their own husbands to be borne.

6 As Sara obeyed Abraham,
 Calling him lord, so you like lamb
 Are her daughters, as long as you
 Do well, and are not scared to view.
 7 You husbands too, live with them too
 According to knowledge, and give
 Honour to the wife as you live
 With weaker vessel, and as being
 Heirs both together and agreeing
 In the grace of life, that your prayers
 May not be hindered *on the stairs*.

The afterthought to husbands is too late.
 Wives have already suffered common fate.
 This is just what I mean by Peter's gait:
 He is not organized in better state.
 If he had spoken first to husbands, then
 Emancipation would have given men
 The right and duty, privilege again
 To honour their own wives in their own
 den.

It is no use, now, my Beloved, to speak
 After the wives have been struck down as
 weak,
 Submitted to their husbands at the cheek.
 But whether Peter utters truth or not
 And in the proper order of things sought,
 I still follow You in diviner plot.

8 At last, be all of one mind and
 Have compassion each for the stand,
 And love as brothers, having pity,
 Be courteous to all *in the city*,
 9 Not paying back the bad for bad,

Or railing for the railing had;
But on the contrary, a blessing,
Knowing you're so called by addressing,
That you should inherit a blessing.

I wonder if Reeves and good Muggleton
Had read this word of God when they'd
begun

To curse the Quakers for the way they'd
done.

I've always admired and envied the gun
Of Muggleton and every sacred son
Whose quaint materialist theology
Made You existent and the devil free.
At least the common mind admits You're
one.

Beloved, there is compassion of the word,
But when the practice comes upon the herd,
I find it lacking. That's because we're flesh
And matter and by evening we're not fresh.
It's You imagine that human frailty
Is choice of matter before hungry tree.

10 For he who will love life, and see
Good days, let him refrain his tongue
From evil, and his lips to be
Speaking no guile *of old or young*.

11 Let him turn from evil, do good;
Let him seek peace well as he should.

12 For the eyes of the Lord regard
The righteous and His ears are starved
To hear their prayers; but the Lord's face
Is against evil-doers' race.

Peter affirms in chapters one to three
Predestination as divine decree,
And then he offers commandment and
choice

As though human hearts really could
rejoice.

Fact is that three commandments can be
done

Only because Your eyes choose when to
run

Upon the human heart: to control tongue,
To turn to good when the heart is still
young,

And to submit to peace or Islam's rung,
All are result of Your eye and Your hand.
The good upon the earth are Your
command.

Beloved, hear my prayer too, though
righteousness
Is not mine or found at my own address,
But is Yours only both to know or guess.

13 And who is he that will harm you,
If you are followers and true
Of what is good? 14 But if you suffer
For righteousness' sake, you're a buffer:
So do not fear their terror or
Be troubled by their evil store.

15 But sanctify the Lord God in
Your hearts, and be ready with din
Always to give an answer to
Every man that may ask of you
A reason for the hope in you,
With meekness and with fear in view.

16 Have a good conscience, so if they
Speak evil of you in their way,
They may be ashamed that falsely
Accuse your good behaviour *free*
In Christ. 17 For it is better, if
The will of God be so, that *stiff*
You suffer for well doing, than
For evil doing *under scan*.

How many read the word out of context,
And cause more trouble for the brief
perplexed!

The answer that Your hope is ready, quick
Is not proof of our prejudices slick.
It's rather to keep You in heart and mind,
So that our response to wicked unkind
Shows that we know no true harm come
behind

Those who are patient and meek fearing
You.

Beloved, give me no answer for my creed,
No justifying argument for deed,
But only the response that shows You true
And my behaviour governed by Your view,
And I shall find Your sovereign throne in
touch
With earth's injustice without needing
crutch.

18 For Christ also has suffered once
For sins, the just for unjust dunce,
That he might bring us back to God
As put to death in fleshly clod,
But quickened by the Spirit's prod;
19 By which he also went and preached

To spirits in prison chains reached,
20 Which were once disobedient,
When the patience of God was rent
Waiting in Noah's days unspent,
While the ark was in preparation,
Wherein few, that is, eight in station
Survived water's annihilation.

21 The same figure baptism takes
To save us now also from stakes,
Not putting off the fleshly dirt,
But giving answer not to hurt
A conscience good toward God alert,
By Jesus Christ in resurrection,
22 Who's gone to heaven for inspection,
And is on the right hand of God;
Angels, authorities, and prod
Of powers made subject to His rod.

The Gospel does not tell us when Your son
Went to preach to the chained Watchers
undone

That Enoch mentions in his book for fun.
The Spirit led him to the wilderness,
It led him from the grave to heaven's
address,

And somewhere in between it led him to
The Watchers chained in anguish in their
pew.

The evidence of this is not that You
Have made the souls immortal all in crew,
But that the Protestants and Catholics hew
The Bible down to books at least too few.
It proves along with Jude that I should take
Enoch as well as Paul for Peter's sake,
And after that abide in Word that's true.

1 Peter 4

1 Forasmuch then as Christ has suffered
For us in the flesh, armed and buffered
Be likewise with the same mind too;
For the one who's suffered in flesh
Has ceased to be in sinful mesh.
2 So he should live the rest of time
No longer in the flesh to crime
Of human lusts, but to God's will.
3 For the time past of our life ill
May be enough for us to fill
The will of the Gentiles in bill,
When we walked in lasciviousness,
In lusts, and in the wine's excess,
In revellings, and banquetings,
And in idolatries' gross flings,

4 Wherein they think it a strange case
That you no longer run their race
In the same riot of excess,
Speaking evil of your address,
5 Who shall give account to the One
Ready to judge the living run
And the dead when the dead are done.

9 Use hospitality within
For one another without grudging.
10 As every man got without fudging
The gift, so minister the same
To one another, as in claim
Of good stewards of glorious flame
Of the grace of God *come in fame*.
11 If any one speaks, let him speak
As oracles of God to seek;
If any one serves, let him serve
As he can by God's gift not swerve:
So God in all things may be praised
Through Jesus Christ to whom be raised
Praise and dominion once again,
For ever and ever. Amen.

It is not strange that some may think it
strange

That my behaviour comes to make a
change

After election and the call in range
Sent out from You and from eternity.
I submit merely to divine decree.
I may have chafed against wages of sin,
I may have stumbled and cursed not to win,
But on a sudden, without merit found,
And without effort to stand on the ground,
I come outside the race to pace the mace,
And live in violence beneath Your grace.
I shall live to give my account to You,
And hear the judgement on the things I do,
But recognize at last all's in Your view.

6 For this cause was the Gospel preached
Also to them that are dead reached,
That they might be judged according
To men in the flesh, but live by
God in the spirit *now come nigh*.
7 But end of all things is at hand;
So be you sober in command
To watch in prayer *on sea and land*.
8 Above all things have fervent love
Among yourselves, for love above
Shall cover multitudes of sin.

The Gospel has been preached for centuries
And to those long dead in the earthly
freeze,

But it remains to require judgement set
By all society upon Your pet.

The Gospel sound stands still to quicken by
Your spirit the men in the flesh who vie
By Your election and Your sovereign will
To cover sin by love, justice fulfil.

Beloved, I've heard the Gospel message
found

Not in the preaching of churches around,
But in the reading of the written Word
That strikes my heart again and my heart's
stirred.

And so I watch and pray, and pray again
For fervent love increased upon my den.

12 Beloved, do not think it thing strange
Concerning fiery trial ranged
To try you, as though some strange thing
Occurred against you *on the wing*.

13 But rejoice rather, inasmuch
As you're partakers of the touch
Of Christ in sufferings; so when shows
His glory, you in joy repose
In gladness exceeding in throes.

14 If you're reproached for name of Christ,
You're happy; for spirit sufficed
Of glory and of God's on you:
For them he's spoken ill of too,
But on your part he's glorified.

At last I find apostle and a man
Who will respect my own thought of Your
plan,

That Jesus suffered death, not in the span
Of punishment or runnishment in tan,
But just participating in the way
That men and women are still pained today.
Participation in suffering's the core
Of Jesus' action all his life and more.

Beloved, I have no choice but to take part
In all punishments that fill human cart,
But if he came from heavenly courts by art
And had a choice, whether to do or not,
Then that was brave of him, kind of Your
plot.

To have choice differs perhaps not a lot.

15 But let none of you suffer for
Murder or theft or evil doer,

Or as a busybody in
Other men's matters *come to sin*.

16 If any as a Christian wait,
Let him not be ashamed of fate;
But let him glorify his God
On this behalf upon the sod.

Beloved, the blessing's granted to the one
Who suffers as a Christian in his run.

But I'm rejected by the Christian crowd,
As for Samaritans, I'm not allowed,

I was not born a Jew, the Muslim race
Would rather never see of me a trace.

I suffer if I suffer as mere man,
And not adherent of the church or plan.

Am I then all excluded from the rate
Of blessing that falls on the other pate?

Beloved, though no church welcomes me in
door,

I love Your Christ more than another chore,
And though I suffer nothing for his name,
I suffer alone with or without shame.

17 For the time's come that judgement must
Begin at the house of God's trust:

And if it first begins with us,
What shall the end be of the dust

That don't obey God's Gospel fuss?

18 If the righteous is scarcely saved,
Where shall the ungodly ones braved
And sinner appear *in the waived*?

19 So let the ones who suffer still
According to the divine will
Commit the keeping of their souls
To Him in well doing *for goals*,
As to faithful Creator's *shoals*.

Some count in hand twenty-three hundred
days

Until the latter year of hope and praise,
And say the judgement started with the
room

Of righteous dead before the coming doom
Of righteous living. So the way appears
That hardly any sinners saved from fears
Can hope for future happiness from tears.
Good Peter's heart goes out to those left by
Without a destined living in the sky.

The only answer is commit to You
And trust the best is just what You will do.
Beloved, though I may run to final death,

I thank and praise You with my every
breath,
And welcome happiness as well as rue.

1 Peter 5

1 The elders who are among you
I exhort, who am elder too,
And witness of Christ's sufferings' view,
And also a partaker of
The glory to be seen *in love*.
2 Feed God's flock which is among you,
Taking the oversight in view,
Not by constraint, but willingly;
Not for the filthy lucre's fee,
But of a ready mind *and free*.
3 Neither as being lords in state
Over the heritage, but wait
As good examples to the flock.
4 And when the chief shepherd shall knock,
You shall receive a glory's crown
Whose fading never shall come down.

The fate of those You chose to join the
crowd
Of the saved is to live in two things loud:
The pain of Christ upon the cross and more,
His glory now and in the future store.
The pain and glory make the chosen shroud
That clothes the chosen ones before Your
door,
And as the storms rush past the sky above,
The earth beneath is glorified by love.
The laurels fade, though lauras more are
made
And heritages still compete for shade.
The chief shepherd may knock and knock
again,
And in the divine will I'll open den,
If I hear the call on the universe,
Election beyond every earthly curse.

5 Likewise, you younger, submit to
The elder ones among the crew.
Indeed all of you be subject
One to another and expect
To be clothed with humility:
For God resists the proud degree,
And give grace to the humble free.
6 Humble yourselves under God's hand
Of might, and He will make you stand
In due time *here upon the land*.
7 Cast all your care on Him, for He

Cares for you *and abundantly*.
8 Be sober, vigilant, because
Your foe the devil with his claws
Walks round like raging lion to
Seek whom he may devour in crew.
9 Resist him in faith steadfastly,
Knowing the same afflictions' spree
Have fallen on your brothers too
That are in the world, *much and few*.
But the God of all grace, who's called
Us to eternal glory halled
By Christ Jesus, after you've been
In pain a while, take you from sin
And make you perfect, set and strengthen,
And settle you *and your life lengthen*.
11 To him be glory and dominion
Forever. Amen *'s my opinion*.

Must the elect and chosen and the called
Also resist the devil and appalled?
It so appears. Beloved, no doubt I fail
In my resistance to the whole and hale.
Resist or not, I cast my bitter care
Upon the Christ who promises to share,
And find the days pass on from grey to
grey
That silvers with the aging of the day.
Beloved, I still await perfection here,
Believing Peter's word of trumpeteer,
That glory and dominion at his face
Suffices to atone and raise to grace.
The son of David and Your son by call
Raises a lantern up against the wall.

12 By Silvanus, a faithful brother
To you, I guess I know no other,
I've written briefly, and with warning,
And testifying this, no scorning,
Is the true grace of were you
Are standing *in the faith you view*.
13 The ones at Babylon elect
Together with you, now expect
To greet you, as Marcus my son.
14 Greet one another when you've done
With a kiss sought in charity.
Peace be with you, women and men,
All in Christ Jesus. So, amen.

The kiss of charity is sacrament forgotten
By nearly all, except by Brethren soughten.
The seven sacraments or mysteries
Of Gospel are the following and these:

The kiss of charity, the washing feet,
The bread and wine delivered for a treat,
The love-feast and baptism three times
down,
The blessing of the children in the town,
And the anointing by the elders' gown.
Beloved, I follow sacraments but rarely,
Just keeping to Your Decalogue and fairly,
But when occasion teaches me a thing
I too come in the holy dancing ring
And reach a hand to You unquestioning.

2 Peter 1

1 Simon Peter, a servant and
Apostle of Jesus Christ's band,
To those who have obtained the like
Precious faith with us through the spike
Of righteousness of God and of
Our Saviour Jesus Christ *above*,
2 Grace and peace multiplied to you
Through knowledge of God come in view
And of Jesus our Lord adored,
3 According as his divine sword
Has given us all things that pertain
To life and godliness *not vain*,
Through knowledge of him who's called us
To glory and to virtue's truss;
4 Whereby are given unto us
Exceeding great, very precious
Promises: that by these you might
Partake of divine nature's right,
Having escaped corruption in
The world through lust *borne out in sin*.

Partakers of nature divine, this verse
Has led me through the darkness and the
curse
Of doctrines and of practices diverse
To know the secret of the universe,
That You, Beloved, look from each human
face,
And all men are the subjects of Your grace.
Some are the fleeting falling stars that trace
The beauty of the night sky as they fall
Into the fires of hell's extinguished call.
Some are the growing lamps that bloom the
more
As time goes on from fretting room to door
To rise into celestial clime and hall.
But the nature divine is given to all
Upon the face of earth, in every stall.

5 Beside this giving diligence,
Add to your faith virtue in sense,
And to virtue knowledge of true,
6 And to knowledge temperance on cue;
And to temperance some patience too,
And to patience godliness 7 and
To godliness, brotherly band,
And to brotherly kindness add
Charity. 8 For if these you've had,
And they abound, they make you not
Barren or unfruitful in plot
Of Lord Jesus Christ's knowledge sought.
9 But one who lacks these things is blind,
And cannot see far off in kind,
And has forgotten he was purged
From his old sins *as he was urged*.
10 So instead, brothers, give good heed
To make your calling sure indeed
And your election done with speak:
For if you do these things, you'll not
Fail from the goal you sought.

The list of things to do is overwhelming
To anyone who tries them at the helming.
The only way to engage the whole ladder
Of Peter is a better way, not sadder,
Which is relying on the calling given
By You, Beloved, rather than what's been
striven.
Sure calling leads to done election too.
And so I climb the ladder up to You,
And find You did the climbing on the way.
I only thought I chose the better pay.
Yet there is truth in that the ladder's sound
Is where all human freedom may be found.
All is determined by biology:
Only Your call, Beloved, makes some men
free.

11 For so an entrance shall be served
To you abundantly unswerved
Into eternal kingdom of
Lord Saviour Jesus Christ *above*.
12 So I will not be negligent
To put you always in mind bent
To these things, though you know them
well,
And be established in the gel
Of present truth. 13 Yes, I think meant
As long as I am in this tent,
To stir you up by putting you
In that remembrance of the due;

14 Knowing that soon I must release
This my tent, even without cease
Our Lord Jesus Christ puts in my view.

I rush into eternal kingdom of
The son of David, the man that I love,
And find the present truth forever shown
Upon the screen of Your creation known.
I put in mind the Psalms and keep their
share

In my remembrance, constant dhikr bear
Across the dergah floor, the slaughter
ground

Where my will's crucified until is found
Your will alone, Beloved, within the tent.
When fleshly tabernacle's struck and rent,
My breath shall fly to You until the day
Of resurrection by grace without pay.
I love the son of David while I'm here,
I'll love him but the more when he'll
appear.

15 So I'll endeavour that you may
Be able after the dismay
Of my decease to have these things
Always in mind's rememberings.

16 For we've not followed cunningly
Devised fables in making see
The power and coming of our Lord
Jesus Christ, but eye-witness scored
Of his being of majesty.

17 For he received from God the Father
Honour and glory, without bother,
When there came such a voice to him
From the cloud of glory not dim,
This is My beloved Son, in whom
I am well pleased *from dawn till doom*.

18 And this voice which came from the sky
We heard, and when we were there by
Him in the holy mount up high.

The vision of Your glory falling on
The Christ and Moses and Elijah's drawn
In sweet remembrance by good Peter's pen.
I wish he'd taken a good look again
To say if Moses was not really that
Enoch who disappeared to where You sat.
The Gospel gives the names no doubt based
at

Assumption of Moses, tractate not flat.
Beloved, I should have though Enoch
would come.

I'll hold my doubts and have faith in the
sum
Of Peter's reckoning. At least he's sure
That Jesus joined the two, and not figure
Of some man unknown to witnesses three.
I'll follow still vision's eternity.

19 We've also got a more sure word
Of prophecy good to have heard,
As to a light that shines in dark,
Until the day dawn with a spark,
And day star rise in your heart's host.

20 Know first, that no prophecy of
The Scripture is of private love
And private interpretation.

21 For prophecy did not come won
In old times by the will of man:
But holy men of God spoke plan
As they were moved by Holy Ghost.

Interpretation of the Word of God
Has been a private thing upon the sod
Since before Protestants rose against Rome
And thought they had monopoly on home.
It led to Zwickaw prophets in address
And all the Protestant confusion's mess.
The private spirit raises head among
The eastern churches too and gives new
tongue

To utterances old as well as young.
Beloved, I seek the knowledge of Your
Word

That is the true and not from my heart
spurred,

The revelation of those holy men
Who spoke moved by the Holy Ghost
again,

Neither by the established nor the wen.

2 Peter 2

1 But there were false prophets also
Among the people long ago,
As there shall be false teachers come
Among you, who privately hum
Damned heresies, and still deny
The Lord that bought them *from the dry*,
And so bring on themselves to fall
A swift destruction *at the wall*.

2 And many shall follow their own
Pernicious ways, and by their loan
The way of truth shall come to be
Evil spoken of *in the spree*.

The Lord's denied in Holy Trinity
 As well as in the Arian sort of spree.
 Pernicious ways are found in those who
 think
 To change both times and laws and at a
 blink
 Reject Your Sabbath day come every week
 Before the pagan's rise and in prayer seek
 The sun on Sunday's orgies of the meek
 And bold followers of Mithra in claw.
 Beloved, instead I shall cling to Your law.
 The swift destruction that I see around
 On every sort of government and ground
 Is the effect of worshiping the round
 Of idols and of setting off the day
 Of sovereignty You bear in shining ray.

3 And through covetousness shall they
 With feigned words make merchandise
 sway
 Of you. Their judgement a long time
 Now does not linger, for their crime
 Their damning does not sleep but climb.
 4 For if God did not spare the true
 Angels that sinned, but cast into
 Hell, and delivered them in chains
 Of darkness, reserved for their pains;
 5 And did not spare the old world, but
 Saved Noah the eighth person shut,
 A preacher of good righteousness,
 Bringing in the flood on the world
 Of the ungodly and unfurled;
 6 And turning cities of Sodom
 And Gomorrah into ash dumb
 Condemned them with an overthrow,
 Making them examples to go,
 To those after to live bad row;
 7 And saved just Lot, vexed with the foul
 Behaviour of the wicked cowl:
 8 For that righteous man lived with them,
 In seeing and hearing condemn,
 Vexing his righteous soul each day
 With their unlawful deeds in sway;
 9 The Lord knows how to save the good
 Out of temptations of the hood,
 And to reserve the unjust to
 The day of judgement for his due:
 10 But mostly those that walk in flesh
 In the rest of uncleanness' mesh,
 And despise discipline to do.
 They are presumptuous and self-willed,

They're not afraid to speak fulfilled
 Evil of dignities as swilled.

Again Apostle Peter quotes the word
 Of Enoch on the watchers who in herd
 Are chained in hell awaiting judgement
 stirred.
 They are set apart not to make their work
 Of ravage on the DNA and shirk
 Their duties to protect the glowing earth,
 But their acts followed on in the same
 worth
 In Sodom and Gomorrah, in the way
 Of heathendom in every age's sway.
 Beloved I lay aside both my self-will
 And my presumption and its speaking still
 And answer the call to election sure
 To enter with the holy and the pure.
 I see before me glowing Sion's hill.

11 Whereas the angels, greater in
 Their power and might, do not bring din
 Of railing accusation on
 Them before the Lord *of the dawn*.
 12 But these, as natural brute beasts seen,
 Made to be taken from between
 And led to their destruction, speak
 Evil of the things they are weak
 To understand; so utterly
 Must perish in corruption's sea;
 13 And shall receive the punishment
 Of their unrighteousness as meant
 Since the take pleasure in the day
 To riot in their wilful way.
 Spots and such blemishes, they sport
 Themselves with their deceiving's fort
 While they feast with you *and cavort*.

Beloved, I'm too intrepid, that is true.
 I ought to follow angels in their view
 Of bringing no speech railing on the pew
 Of the apostate watchers and their crew.
 Beloved, my mouth is covered at the sight,
 Although there is no certainty of right
 But that I may shout at the poor in plight
 And cry aloud to find the recondite.
 Beloved, the fact is I am blind and see
 Not what the angels in their company
 Inspect with burning hearts and silent
 tongue.
 Fact is I am no prophet and too young.
 Hold to my tongue the coal Isaiah felt

Or give me Moses' speech to change in
welt.

14 Their eye full of adultery,
That cannot cease from sin to be
Beguiling some unstable souls:
A heart they've exercised *with coals*
Of covetousness, cursed the foals:
15 They do forsake the righteous way,
And all of them have gone astray,
And followed in the wicked way
Of Balaam Bosor's son, who loved
Wages of unrighteousness *gloved*,
16 But was rebuked for wickedness:
The dumb ass speaking with man's voice
Forbade the prophet's maddened choice.
17 These are wells without water, clouds,
That are carried with tempest shrouds,
To whom the mist of darkness stays
Reserved forever in their ways.
18 For when they speak great swelling
words
Of vanity, they come in herds
Alluring through the lusts of flesh,
Through wantonness, those who afresh
Were clean escaped from those who live
In error *shaking like a sieve*.
19 While they promise them liberty,
They themselves are the servants free
Of their corruption in the spree:
For of whom a man's overcome,
Of the same falls in bondage dumb.
20 For it after they have escaped
Pollutions of the world uncaped
Through knowledge of the Lord and
Saviour
Jesus Christ, they come to behaviour
Once more entangled, overcome,
The latter end worse than in sum
The start *was when they were a bum*.
21 For it had been better for them
Not to have known the way of gem
In righteousness, than, after they
Have know it, to turn from the sway
Of the holy commandment's way
Deliver to them *on that day*.
22 But it has happened on their score
According to the proverb's store,
The dog's turned to his vomit's stench,
The sow that was washed by the wench
To wallow in the mire the more.

Those who have kept Your Sabbath every
week

As the week circle on the world they speak,
Only to change the divine worship's store
To follow sun and moon upon the floor
Are those who slip in empty clouds and go
Down to perdition, yea, they go not slow.
They follow filthy lucre at the call
Of Balaam, but receive naught but the pall
Of tyranny and poverty at last.
Beloved, enlighten them or leave outcast.
Let me never forsake the righteous way
That You have shown in Decalogue in
sway
To lead me to a lighter, brighter day
By Your Word shining with a better ray.

2 Peter 3

1 This second letter, now, beloved,
I write to you, with hand ungloved,
To stir your pure minds by the way
Of some remembrance come to stay:
2 That you be mindful of the words
Which were spoken before the herds
By holy prophets, and commands
Of us apostles *in our bands*
Of the Lord and Saviour *of lands*.
3 Knowing this first, that there shall come
In the last days scoffer and bum,
Walking after their own lusts too,
4 And saying "Where is promise true
Of his appearing? For since time
Ancestors fell asleep *for crime*,
All things continue as they were
From creation's beginning stir."
5 For this they willingly forget
That by the word of God well met
The heavens were of old and earth
Stood out of the waters for worth:
6 Whereby the world that then was made,
Being overflowed by unstayed
Water, perished *in the parade*.
7 But heavens and earth, the which are
now,
By the same word are kept somehow
In store, reserved for fire to come
On day of judgement and to hum
Perdition on ungodly bum.
8 But my beloved, do not be dumb
And ignorant of this one thing,
That one day is with the Lord come
As a thousand of years in ring,

And a thousand years as one day.

The expectation of coming of lord
And fire upon the earth of the adored
Is central to the doctrine and the word
Preached by apostles to the faithful herd.
I come each Sabbath eve to find Your
throne
Set up against the sky and on earth's groan,
That waits the sight of consummation's
own,
And know that one day all things shall be
flown.

There is no peace of empires waiting near,
There's only suspension before the fear,
And lulling to a sleep forgetting tear.
I work as though I had a thousand years
And pray as though the grinding of my
gears
Was on their last day ever to be shown.

9 The Lord's not slack in promise ray,
As some count slackness as they stray;
But is longsuffering to us here,
Not willing that any for fear
Should perish, but that all should come
Back to repentance, every bum.
10 But the day of the Lord will come
As a thief in the night, and then
The heavens shall pass away from men
With a great noise, and elements
Shall melt with fervent heat, condense
The earth also and the works to
That are in it burned up in view.
11 Then all these things shall be dissolved,
So what manner of men resolved
Ought you to be in what you do
In holy and in godly crew?
12 Look for and haste the coming day
Of God, wherein the heavens in sway
Being on fire shall be dissolved,
And elements melt as revolved
In fervent heat in burning ray.
13 So we according to his promise,
Look for new heavens, no doubting
Thomas,
And a new earth, in which shall dwell
The righteousness of all things well.

The advent hope is burning in my breast,
The seed placed their by ancestors at rest,
And nurtured by the angels of Your song,

Elected by eternal plan along
The margins of celestial war and wrong.
I tremble with anticipation here
To see the melting elements appear
And fervent heat burn all the dross away.
I rest and work in hope of coming day.
Beloved, let the millennia pass by,
The generations rising on the sly,
But as they pass, keep me within Your
care,
As I hope in the message that You bare
To heaven and earth and star and
everywhere.

14 So now, beloved, seeing that you
Look for such things, beware in pew
That you may be found here in peace
By him, no spot, no blame in crease.
15 Consider patience of our Lord
Is our salvation, as adored
Our brother dear, Paul, in accord
Of wisdom given to him did write
To you; 16 as also in all he
Wrote in his letters spoken free
Of these things, in which some things are
Hard to be understood by far,
Which the unlearned, unstable wrest,
As they do also Scriptures' best,
Unto their own destruction's quest.
17 So you, beloved, seeing you know
These things before, beware also,
Lest you be led astray and go
With error of the wicked row,
Fall from your own steadfastness' show.
18 But grow in grace and knowledge of
Our Lord Saviour Jesus Christ's love.
To him be glory now again
Forever and ever. Amen.

Paul's writings are still wrested by the ones
You've not elected to faith and their sons.
I mourn the marble chips upon the floor
Of Your workshop, Beloved, and see the
door
Closed on the beautiful and on the rich,
On those who rule the boost and hit the
pitch.
I see their glory tumbled in the ditch.
Both Peter and Paul write to fire the faith
Of faithful and to turn to writhing wraith
The empires of the earth. They dare to
speak,

And yet they find the stubble burns the
peak.

Beloved, I still submit my gloried crown
To the impostors who walk on the town,
But know my lord's arisen from the frown.

1 John

There are many indications to suggest that this letter comes from the same source as the Gospel and the other letters bearing the name of John. One of these is the rather unique use of the term Son of God as applied to Jesus. Other sources use the term uniquely in a technical sense synonymous with the term promised Messiah. The Johannine source equates the term Son of God with life-bringer, and this is one of the central themes of these writings. The first epistle concentrates on this theme more than any other. The expansion of the concept son of God to all believers in 1 John 3:1,2 et al. prevents it from being an indication of Trinitarian doctrine. Trinitarian doctrine is quite simply a later development historically speaking and is not found in texts written before its appearance. Even later textual adjustments do not actually intrude the doctrine into the text.

The foremost textual proof for the Trinity in Scripture is 1 John 5:7, which is also the text having the most convincing evidence of having been interpolated by a later hand. The fact that it was added to the Bible strongly suggests that those who invented the doctrine of the Trinity knew very well that the Bible taught no such doctrine. Otherwise, there would be no reason to tamper with the text. And yet even that addition comes nowhere near adequately proving the Trinity. The existence of the Father, the Word and the Holy Spirit in heaven and their oneness do not imply that there is one God eternally existing in three co-equal persons. Despite all vain human efforts to corrupt the text of Scripture, the divine message remains intact. If the strongest textual evidence for the Trinity, 1 John 5:7, fails, then all other grasping at straws to buttress this satanic

invention on the basis of Scripture is an exercise in futility.

1 John 1

1 That which was from the first, which we
Have heard, which we have seen to be
With sight, that we have looked upon,
Our hands have handled, *though he's gone*,
About the Word of life, 2 the life

Was manifested, and we've seen,
And we bear witness, *without strife*,
And we declare to you *and mean*
That life eternal with the Father
And which was shown to us, *we'd rather*,
3 That which we have seen and heard we
Declare to you, that you may be
Also in fellowship with us,
And truly ours, *and without fuss*,
In fellowship *not only* with
The Father and His son (*no myth*)
Who is his servant the Messiah.

4 *And this is surely no pariah*,
These things we write to you that your
Joy may be full *and even more*.
5 This is the message which we've heard
From him declaring you *his word*,
That God is light, and in Him is
No dark at all *in Him and His*.
6 If we say we have fellowship
With Him, and walking *still we dip*
In darkness, we lie and do not
Practice the truth *as we've been taught*.

7 But if we walk in light as He
Is in the light, then surely we
Have fellowship with one another,
And then the blood of Christ *our brother*,
Jesus His son *and servant* cleanses
Us from all sin *beneath His lenses*.

The light You are, Beloved, is justice that
You call me to walk in, while darkness at
My feet is when I fail to practice what
You preach. I think I have not overshot
The definition. If I walk with You
In light, John promises what I misdo
Is cleansed by Jesus' blood. Conditions met,
However, seem to indicate that yet
There would be no sin there to cleanse.

Who walks
Within the practice of the truth and stalks
No fruit prohibited is without sin.

And if he does not walk that way John's
promise
Does not apply. I guess I'm doubting
Thomas.
Beloved, I walk with You through thick or
thin.

8 If we say that we have no sin,
We do deceive ourselves indeed,
And the truth *of God's* not within.
9 If we confess our sins *decreed*,
He [God] is faithful and just forgiving
Us *our* sins and cleansing us *living*
From all unrighteousness. 10 If we
Say that we have not sinned, then we
Make Him a liar, and His word
Is not in us *and has not stirred*.

Ah, my Beloved, I shall not say that I
Have never sinned, but You know by the by
Better than I what motive guides my action,
My errors of addition and subtraction.
But here the lovely promised thing is clear,
That one who does confess his faults, no
fear,
Receives from You his cleansing and his
pardon.
That's all it takes to get back in the garden.
That's not cheap grace but absolutely free.
You're faithful and You're just to pardon
me.
You would not be more just to sacrifice
A son or servant for their bloody price.
Condition there may be, but only one,
Confess my errors now and then be done.

1 John 2

1 My little children, these things I
Write to you, so you may not *fly*
To sin. And if anyone sins,
We have a comforter *who wins*
With the Father, Jesus Christ, just.
2 And he himself's the one *who must*
Come to appease for our sins, and
Not just ours but the whole world's *strand*.

I thank You, my Beloved, that You have
here
Beside You one to comfort You. The fear
That veils create upon the faces of
Illusion also cloud and hide Your love.

I thank You, my Beloved, that You have
sent
Appeasement for the sins of incident
That I act on my blindness to Your face.
Your image made in flesh for time and
space
Appeases for the fact that You're not seen
And light enlightens empty where You've
been.
Appease the logical agnostic thought,
Appease the desperate in atheist.
I thank You most of all as pietist
To read this means I sin no more nor ought.

3 And by this we know that we know
Him, if we keep His commandments.
4 He who says, "I know Him," *below*
And does not keep His commandments,
Is lying, and the truth is not
In him. 5 But whoever keeps His
Word, truly the love of God is
Perfect in him. By this we
Know that we are in Him. 6 *But* he
Who says he abides in Him ought
Himself walk as he [Jesus] walked *and*
taught.

Can any man know You, Beloved, who are
Without form, vision, limit, way or star?
To know You is the goal of every search,
The hope of fame, the strength of wealth,
the perch
Of power. All that men do has that one
goal.
There is no other thirst of human soul.
To know You, infinite in grace and power,
Is not the product of a single hour.
Yet know You fully, truly does the one
Who keeps the ten commandments once
begun
On Sinai. That is the criterion
That can be always truly counted on.
To know is to obey and so I know
Obeying is to know in dark and glow.

7 Brothers, no new command I write
To you, but an old law in sight
From the start. That ancient command
Is the word that you hear first hand.
8 Again, a new commandment I
Write to you, which thing is true by
Him and by you, because the dark

Passes away, and the true *spark*
Of light already shines. 9 He who
Says he is in the light, and *who*
Hates his brother, is in the dark
Until now. 10 He who *in remark*
Loves his brother abides in light,
There's no stumbling-block in his *sight*.
11 But he who hates his brother is
In darkness and he walks in his
Darkness, and does not know where he
Goes, since in the dark he can't see.

The old commandment stands, the one was
heard
On Sinai, one that in beginning stirred
The heart of Adam, guided Noah in
His walk with You, his walking without sin.
No new commandment is there nor can be
Since perfect law reigns on eternally.
The new commandment is one from
beginning,
Without which keeping law was just more
sinning.
Moses himself said love as self the
neighbour,
And leave no one unloved for wealth or
labour.
But new it is with every new awareness
That strikes it bright on inner chamber's
bareness.
I love You, my Beloved, the Self alone
Who is one Self in all selves flesh and bone.

12 I write to you, children, because
You are set free of sins by means
Of His [God's] name *and before all laws*.
13 I write to you, fathers *of teens*,
Since you've known Him [God] from the
beginning,
And knowing Him keeps you from sinning.
I write to you, young ones, since you
Have overcome what wicked do.
I write to you, children, because
You've known the Father [God] *and His*
laws.
14 I write to you, fathers, since you
Have known Him from the start *who's true*.
I write to you, young men, since you
Are strong, God's word abides in you,
You've overcome what wicked do.
15 Do not love the world or the things
In the world. If one loves the *things*

Of the world, the Father's love's not
In him. 16 For all in the world *taught*,
The lust of the flesh, lust of eyes,
And pride of life, *which is not wise*,
Is not of the Father but of
The world *and comes not from above*.
17 And the world is passing away,
And *with it its lust and its way*,
But he who does God's will abides
Forever *and does not take sides*.

The world of falsity, illusion is
Made up of one great trinity, a whiz
At fine seductions: lust of flesh and lust
Of eyes, and pride of life that truly must
Be last but far from least. The human eye
Fails to distinguish lust of flesh or try.
The false religion binds men from right
doing,
And blames the duty and the pleasure, ruing
The right and viewing it as lust. So guard
Me, my Beloved, from false asceticism,
As well as from eye-ful aestheticism.
The only thing the eye finds not so hard
Is pride of life. Let me take pride unmarred
In You alone and all else disregard.

18 Little children, it's the last hour,
As you've heard Antichrist *in power*
Is coming, even now many
Antichrists have come, by which we
Know that it is the last hour. 19 They
Went out from us, *indeed*, but they
Were not of us, for if they'd been
Of us, they would have, *without sin*,
Continued with us, but that they
Might be made manifest, that none
Of them were of us, *when all's done*.
20 But you have an anointing from
The Holy One, you know the sum.
21 I have not written you because
You do not know the truth *and laws*,
But because you know it, and that
No lie is of the truth *out flat*.
22 Who is a liar but who denies
That Jesus is the Christ? *Despise*
Antichrist who denies the Father
And the Son. 23 Whoever might bother
To deny the Son does not *know*
The Father either, but he who
Has Son has the Father also,
Who has the Father has Son too.

Truly, among the Jews of John's day those
Who followed the Messiah also chose
The God Almighty of Creation and
The mighty Strengtheners of Abram's hand.
Truly, the promised one sent down to guide
All Israel to the right path and right side
Was gauge of truth that You are one, no
doubt.

But since that day the heathen had it out,
And so I say who has the trinity
Has neither Son nor Father but degree
Of heathen, pagan faith of Canaanite.
If he's a liar who will deny the right
Of Jesus as Messiah Christ, then he
Is also liar who says he's one of three.

24 You then what you heard from the start
In you let stay, if by your *part*
It stays what from the start you heard,
You also in the *Son preferred*
And in the Father you'll abide
Forever by the Father's side.

25 And this is the promise that He
Has promised us eternally:
Life. 26 These things I have written you
Concerning those who'd deceive you.

27 And you anointing have received
From Him in you to stay, *reprieved*,
And you have no need that someone
Teach you, but as the same anointing
Teaches you about all things *done*,
And it is true, *not disappointing*
And not a lie, and as taught you,
You will abide in Him *who's true*.

What is that great anointing that was heard
From the beginning of the sacred word
That must protect believers and frail saints?
What is that inner life that never faints
Nor needs a teacher nor a guide beyond
The ever present spirit to respond?
It is the one great sermon preached by You,
Beloved, one day on Sinai, what is true.
When that abides from day to day and night
To night, no false thing can emerge in sight.
Ah, my Belovèd, let me contemplate
That purifying law with love and hate,
Love to You only and hate for all else,
In such love and such hate my hard heart
melts.

28 And now, children, abide in him,
That when He appears *at the rim*,
We may have confidence and not
Be ashamed before Him *we've sought*
At His appearing. 29 If you know
That He is righteous, then you know
That all who do things righteously
Are born of Him *eternally*.

Ah, my Beloved, I see now how it is
That You beget a son or daughter whiz.
When any one of Your created ones
Does righteously, he's numbered in Your
sons.

By living, acting by the law You gave
On Sinai once, a man becomes Your slave,
Your servant, and Your son: so You beget
Good works in all those faithful folks who
let

Your will shine in the gloom of desert
night,

Of city life, in hiding or plain sight.
Beget me too this day and I shall be
Your son and servant, and also be free.
To be Your child is freedom at its best,
Obeying Your commands is freedom's vest.

1 John 3

1 See what love has given us the Father,
That children of God we be called
And that's why the world does not bother
To know us, *for it being stalled*
Does not know Him. 2 Beloved, now we
Are children of God, what we'll be
Has not yet been revealed, but we
Know that when He's revealed, we'll be
Like Him, for we shall *surely* see
Him as He is. 3 Who has this hope
In Him of all *can surely cope*,
Purify self as pure as He.

Beloved, what love comes from You free
and fast!

That love is all that there is hope to last.
A child of God is one whom You, Beloved,
Love despite that the darkened hurt and
shoved

In their unknowing. Yet I do not know
The depths of love remaining still to show,
But have the confidence that in my row
Of firm obedience one day I'll see
The thing prepared in love that time to be.

What is a child but loved, obedient?
I purify my ways in what You sent,
Ignore the claims and clamours that deny
That You, Beloved, without gain of the sky,
Are near me now to love and by and by.

4 Who commits sin also commits
Lawlessness, which is where sin sits.
5 And you know that he was made seen
To take away our sins' *demesne*,
And in him there's no sin at all.
6 Whoever abides in his *thrall*
Does not sin. *But* whoever sins
Has neither seen him nor *begins*
To know him. 7 Little children, let
No one deceive you *that you've met*.
He who does righteousness is right,
Just as he is righteous, *polite*.
8 He who sins is the devil's own,
For the devil has sinned *and grown*
From the beginning. That is why
The Son of God, *Messiah nigh*,
Was manifested, that he might
Destroy the devil's works outright.

Beloved, You sent Your "Son" that is the
one
Who wholly obeys You like father won
And was promised to show Your will to all
Who should answer divinely proffered call.
As he obeys You as his Father so
I too make You my Father as I go
Out to obey Your sweet commands, what
You
Proclaimed on Sinai what all men should
do.
And so abiding in Messiah's way,
And in Your heart from dawn of every day,
I too like Your Messiah cannot sin,
Because in his guidance all men must win.
Beloved, I cling to Your Word once
revealed,
And in Your Christ I find I'm sinless
sealed.

9 Whoever has been born of God
Does not sin, for his seed *on sod*
Remains in him, he cannot sin,
And that is because he has been
Born of God. 10 In this difference
Children of God *of heaven* are known
Distinct from devil's children shown.

Who does not practice righteousness
Is not of God, nor *to assess*
Is he who does not love his brother,
Or honour father and his mother.

To be born of You, my Beloved, is not
To come from sperm and ovum You've
begot,
But to practice the righteousness revealed
In Your Word's statutes and never to yield
To the devil, who cunningly comes in
To whisper disobedience is not sin.
Messiah is Your son, and I am too,
When we conform to think and speak and
do
According to commandment righteously.
From bastardhood Your law has set me free
As well as Jesus, once accused to be
Son of Mary's supposed adultery.
I rush to do Your will's express command
And thus find sonship and Your freedom's
land.

11 For this is the message that you
Heard from the beginning *to do*,
That we should *all* love one another,
12 Not as Cain of the wicked one
Who murdered his own father's son.
And just why did he murder him?
Because his works were bad *and dim*,
And his brother's were righteous *acts*.
13 Don't marvel, my brothers, *if facts*
Shows that the world hates you *and him*.

Who claim to be Your own, Beloved, hate
me
Because I cling to Your commandment's
word
As read, obeying Your law I am free.
I'm free from serving the opinion of
The neighbour and his ruler and the turd
Of state that would deny the divine love
That spoke on Sinai. For that I am hated.
Of twenty thousand church'd all are fated
To deny the clear meaning of statute
Stated in Decalogue, Sabbath to boot.
I'm hated that I proclaim You are one
By the first commandment that's there to
stun.
I'm hated for the Sabbath that I keep
To find You where most others fail to weep.

14 We know that we have passed from death

To life, who love *not Ashtoreth*
But the brothers. He who does not
Love *his* brother stays in *the plot*
Of death. 15 Whoever hates his brother
Is murderer *of every other*,
And you know that eternal life
Is found in no murderer's strife.

16 By this we know love, just because
He laid down his own life for us.

And we also ought to lay down
Our lives for brothers *in the town*.

17 But whoever has this world's goods,
And sees his brother *in the woods*,
In need, shuts up his heart from him,
How does the love of God *grow dim*
And fail to stay, abide in him?

18 My little children, let us not
Love in word or in tongue, but taught
In deed and in truth. 19 And by this
We know that we are of truth's *bliss*,
Assure our hearts before His *kiss*.

It is not certain, my Beloved, that he
Who is murdered is the one in the right.
Who murders has in truth done wickedly,
But the victim may also in Your sight
Be sinner and lost in an evil plight.
What's certain is that killers are in wrong
Despite their singing patriotic song.
Just as rejection of Your unity
And breaking Your Sabbath show faithfully
How many are lost in illusion's dark,
So killing in or outside Eden's park
Shows just as faithfully the straying path.
Outside of Your commandment's only
wrath.
Love finds in Your law ways to see and be.

20 For if our heart condemns us, God
Is greater than our heart *by prod*,
And knows all things. 21 Beloved, if our
Heart does not condemn us *an hour*,
We have confidence toward God's *power*.
22 And whatever we ask we get
From Him, because we *don't forget*
To keep His commandments and do
All those things pleasing in His view.

Who in illusion's veils wander desert
Rely on human heart to know and spurt.

The human heart does not condemn the
crime

Of loving one with feelings and in time
Hating another for the difference
Of being, word or even colour skin.
To follow heart is to follow nonsense,
For You, Beloved, are greater than heart's
sin.

I flee to You, Beloved, from what I think
Is true and right and what I eat and drink.
I flee to You, Beloved, from clarity
Of faith and judgement of the heart set free.
I flee to You, Beloved, from all that finds
A place beneath the sun, behind the blinds.

23 And this is His commandment *too*:
That we should believe on the name
Of His Son Jesus Christ *who came*
And love one another, as he
Gave us commandment. 24 And now he
Who keeps His commandments abides
In Him, and He in him *besides*.
And by this we know He abides
In us, by spirit *that resides*
In us whom He has given us
To show us truth in all the fuss.

I know that Jesus is the one You sent
Because he in his coming would prevent
The heart departing from Your revealed
word
Set down on sapphire table, heart be stirred.
So I lay my belief and trust in him
Who handed out Your law and was not dim
In its upholding despite temple crowd
That wanted to define what was allowed.
By loving one another I find that
Each I-ness is a place where You have sat,
A treasure to be found, but pitied when
Each I recedes behind the veils of men.
The spirit, my Beloved, states what is true:
There is no I existing here but You.

1 John 4

1 Beloved, do not believe each thing
That comes to you to preach and sing,
But test the spirits, whether they
Are of God, because *in the way*
Many false prophets have gone out
Into the world *to pray and shout*.
2 By this you know God's spirit: each
Spirit that has come here to preach

That Jesus Christ has come in flesh
Is of God, 3 and each spirit fresh
That does not Jesus Christ confess
As come in flesh, *don't stay to guess*,
Such one is not of God. And this
Is *spirit* of the Antichrist,
Which you have heard was coming, and
Now's already on earth to stand.

The great criterion of keeping law
You have established already with awe.
The second litmus test to validate
A claim to prophethood or head of state
Is bowing to authority of Christ
Come in the flesh, and these two things
sufficed
To proof the witness to be come from You
If he believe and do these things as true.
Christ in the flesh refers they say to one
Docetic doctrine affirmed under sun.
Our heresies today are subtler built
And laid up with the centuries of silt.
And yet it is still proof of right and main
Who both commandment and Your Christ
maintain.

To declare and believe the Christ has come
In human flesh is merely to succumb
To the commandment first proclaimed as
right:
That there is no god but You in Your might,
And that You are no man, and so Christ too
Is no God since he is a man in view.
To declare and believe Christ's flesh and
bone
Redeem for sins in sacrifice atone
Is to deny the mercy and the grace
That You have in abundance in this place,
To which nothing can add and none
subtract,
Your grace is infinite and still intact.
Beloved, indeed, Jesus is in the flesh
And as a man no God comes out afresh.

4 Little children, you are of God,
And have overcome them *with rod*,
Because He who is in you is
Greater *far* than the one who is
In the world. 5 They are of the world.
Therefore they speak *as* of the world,
And the world hears them. 6 We're of God.
He who knows God *too* hears our *prod*,

He who is not of God does not
Hear us. By this we know the spirit
Of truth and spirit of error *near it*.

You are, Beloved, in every humble child,
In every adult too, both ripe and wild,
In consciousness of I-ness in creation
Which is reflection of Your divine station.
That I-ness turns the soul back to Your
own,
Or else lets illusion come break the stone,
But all are alike brought before Your throne
With either dread of judgement or elation.
The world, Beloved, does not hear of my
voice
Because I make You, You alone my choice,
But proof is not in hearing or to stop
To spin again the whirling, whirling top.
Proof is that children still come to
remember
The heavenly grace of which they are a
member.

7 Beloved, let us love one another,
For love is of God, *and the brother*,
And everyone who loves is born
Of God and knows God, *not for scorn*.
8 He who does not love does not know
God, for God is love, *not for show*.
9 In this the love of God appeared
To us, that God has sent *unfeared*
His only generated son
Into the world, so we have won
Life through him. 10 And in this is love,
Not that we loved God *from above*,
But that He loved us, sent His son
Propitiation for sins *done*.
11 Beloved, if God so loved us, we
Also should love each other, see.
12 No one has seen God any time.
If we love each other in time,
God dwells in us, and His love is
Been perfected in us, *just His*.
13 By this we know we stay in Him,
And He in us, because *undim*
He's given us of his Spirit,
That witnesses Him where we sit.

The bright Christian says Jesus is Almighty
God since he's called Your son. Such talk is
flighty.

The Muslim rejects the Bible because,

Despite the confirmation of the laws
 Of the Qur'an, it calls Jesus Your son.
 And knowing You beget not nor when done
 Are You begotten, they eschew the word.
 What Bible calls son Qur'an undeterred
 Calls servant. Truly, either metaphor
 Can be trained on truth or on straying door.
 He calls all men to love You and receive
 Obedience to Your will and reprieve,
 Instead of arguing the weight of words
 Along with other filth and other turds.

14 And we have seen and testify
 That the Father has sent foreby
 The son *as* saviour of the world.
 15 Whoever confesses unfurled
 That Jesus is the son of God,
Which means Messiah on the sod,
 God dwells in him, and he in God.
 16 And we have known and have believed
 The love that God's for us *conceived*.
 God is love, and he who abides
 In love abides in God, besides
 And God in him, *so we've believed*.

Abide in me, Beloved, and so You do
 Since I cannot escape the cockatoo
 Within me that calls me "I" every day
 I wake up to awareness of the way.
 I confess that Jesus is Your son meant
 Born without divine penises and sent
 As Your servant into the world, Messiah
 To save us from ourselves and each pariah
 Of false religion that men seek to make
 To escape duty and for fleeing's sake
 From Your face where are all men called to
 keep
 The vigil of wonder that in all sleep
 The image of divine Creator's love.
 That must be the thing that You're talking
 of.

17 Love has been perfected among
 Us in this *thing as we have sung*:
 That we may have boldness in that
 Day of judgement, *where He has sat*,
 Because as He is, so are we
 In this world, *and shall always be*.
 18 There is no fear in love *at all*,
 But perfect love casts out fear's *thrall*,
 Because fear involves torment, but
 He who fears has not been made what

Is perfect in love. 19 We love Him
 Because He first loved us *not dim*.
 20 If someone says, "I love God," and
 Hates his brother, he *out of hand*
 Is a liar, for he who does
 Not love his brother whom he was
 Seeing, how can he love God whom
 He has not seen *till day of doom*?
 21 And this command we have from him:
 That he who loves God *must* love him
 Who's also *in his brother's room*.

Ah, my Beloved, here You give great
 command
 To carry out the contemplation grand
 Of human face, and in that loving find
 The love to love You even though I'm
 blind.
 Ah, my Beloved, I seek divinity
 In every passing human that I see,
 And in faith look beyond the sordid act
 And word and find the one created fact
 That there is I in every form I meet
 In wood and desert, on the crowded street,
 And that I is but One in all things cast,
 The I of You from all things first to last.
 Ah, my Beloved, I bless Your written word
 And revel in its sounds as I have heard.

1 John 5

1 Who believes Jesus is the Christ
 Originates in God *sufficed*,
 And everyone who loves Him who
 Produced also must love him who
 Was produced by Him. 2 By this we
 Know that we love the children *free*
Or followers of God, when we
 Love God and keep His commandments.
 3 For this is the love of God's sense,
 That we keep *all* His commandments.
 And his commandments are not hard.
 4 Whatever's produced *without guard*
 From God overcomes the world's *sway*.
 This is the victory *each day*
 That has overcome the world's *sway*
Even our faith. 5 Who is he who
 Overcomes the world, but he who
 Believes that Jesus is God's son,
That is, Messiah, when all's done?

John meets the heresy on early times,
 The one called docetism in most rhymes,

By making an appeal to three great words:
That Jesus is the Christ and all his herds
Must love You and keep Your
commandments well.

That triad ought to hold the fort a spell.
In fact, it still holds true: criterion
Of keeping the commandments under sun
When added to belief that You sent one,
And that we ought to love You for the gift
Is full and free enough, no need to shift.
Beloved, I lay hold on Your Christ anew,
And in his grace keep Your commandments
too,

While both of these lead me to love of You.

6 This is who came by water and
By blood, Jesus Christ, not *to stand*
Only by water, but also
By water and blood, whom will show
The spirit witness, since it is
The truth. 7 For there are three that bear
Witness in heaven: the Father there,
The word, and holy spirit, and
These three are one, *in witness stand*.
8 And there are three that bear witness
On earth: the spirit, water, and
The blood, and these three bear witness
As one. 9 If we receive of men
Their witness, God's witness is then
The greater, for this is witness
Of God which He has testified
Of His son *who was glorified*.

If there's beside You in Your heaven a
word,
And yet a spirit when the word's interred,
That makes a triple in reflection of
The witness of Your Christ You hold in
love.

All men on earth are made of water and
Of blood and spirit, foot and head and hand.
The consciousness of I-ness bears witness
That You descend in word and spirit bless,
But even greater than the witness found
Within the human soul upon the ground
Is that divine revealing from above
That fills the air of Sinai with Your love
And there proclaims for all to see and hear
The word and glory and the things men
fear.

10 He who believes in son of God,

Messiah, has witness *to prod*
In himself, who does not believe
God has made him one to deceive,
Because he's not believed what God
Gave testimony of His son.
11 And this is the witness of God:
That God has given us, *all things done*,
Eternal life, life in His son,
That is, the Christ, or the Messiah.
12 Who has the son has life *and nigh her*,
Who has not God's son *or Messiah*
Does not have life. 13 These things I've
written

To you who believe and are smitten
With the name of God's son, *Messiah*,
That you may know you have that life
Eternal, and may *without strife*
Believe *still further* in the name
Of God's son, Christ, *and without shame*.

Who has the witness of the three: belief
That You have sent Your Christ for our
relief,
And love to You informs the things we do
According to Your brief commandments,
few;
That one has life eternal and to spare.
I look around the ice-paved street beware
And see that spring is rising everywhere.
I see return of spring, eternal spring,
But that is just reflection of the thing.
I turn to You, Beloved, and find such life
Original and uncreated rife.
The veils that catch Your glories in my
sight
Grow older, weaker with the coming night,
And yet with that I'm closer to the right.

14 Now this is the confidence that
We have in Him, *that where we've sat*,
If we ask a thing in His will,
He hears us. 15 And if we know still
That He hears us, what thing we ask,
We know that we have every task
That we have asked of him. 16 If any
Sees his brother sinning *for penny*,
A sin *which does not lead* to death,
He'll ask, and He will give him breath
For those who commit sin not *leading*
To death. There is sin *that's conceding*
To death. I do not say he should
Pray on behalf of that or would.

17 All unrighteousness is sin, and
There's sin not to death, *understand*.

A simple question rises from the word
That some sins are to death for every bird,
While others are not to death on the road.
How shall I know the which is which
bestowed?

The answer's just as simple: watch the load.
What's mentioned in the Decalogue is such
When unobserved leads to death for as
much.

What's mentioned not in the
commandments ten
Is found in mouth of prophet and such men
To support the divine law set up true.
To fail in those is not to drink the rue,
But opens one to failures in the blue.
Beloved, I flee from sins that lead to death,
And take the others as from breath to
breath.

18 We know that who is born of God
Does not sin *at all* on the sod,
But he who has been born of God
Keeps himself, and the wicked one
Does not touch him *with hand or gun*.

19 We know that we are of God, and
The whole world lies in wicked hand.

20 And we know that the son of God,
Christ and Messiah's come with rod
And given us an understanding,
That we may know Him who's true
standing,

And we are in Him who is true,
In His son Jesus Christ, as crew.
Here is the true God, life eternal.

21 Little children, keep from infernal
Idols *that have led astray men*
And women from the truth. Amen.

Who's born of God (who does not wield
male tool)

Is one kept by Him from playing the fool
And sinning with sinners on the bar stool.
Who's born of God is not thereby divine
In twosome or in threesome on the vine.
True God is one, and Jesus is another,
Not God himself, but Christ and human
brother.

In this is life eternal, though I die
Beneath the firs and pines, beneath the sky,

Above the frozen sods and apple trees
Just waiting for the passing of last freeze.
Let me awake, Beloved, today and then
To bear a witness as to earthly men
That You are One and living as You please.

2 John

1 The elder, to lady elect
And her children, whom I select
To love in truth, not only I,
But also all those who comply
With the truth, 2 because of the truth
Which dwells in us, *sincere and ruth*,
And will be with us always: 3 Grace,
Mercy, *and* peace be in your place
From God the Father and from lord
Jesus Christ, Father's son *adored*
In truth and love. 4 I rejoiced greatly
That I've found of your children stately
Walking in truth, as we received
Command from the Father, believed.

The truth! Al-Haqq! Indeed it dwells in
those
Who have and do Your laws, and those who
chose

To walk according to the awesome sound
Of Your voice rolling on Sinai's bare
ground.

Who comply with the truth, reality,
Are those who hear the word and also see
That outside its obedience there lies
Only the fields of what's determined, skies
And seas, the law of nature's round that
sends

The grouse to drum, and in the sedgeweed
blends

The colours of the marsh hen by Your will.
But humans can choose freedom in the still
Small voice that since that day repeats the
slate

That made Moses and all who followed
great.

5 And now I plead with you, lady,
Not as though I wrote a *shady*
And new commandment to you, but
That which we have had from the start,
That we love one another. 6 This
Is love, that we walk *in that bliss*
According to His commandments.
This is the commandment *with sense*,

That as you have heard from the start,
You should walk in it, *not depart*.

How many speak of love these days and tell
How love is everything that treats life well.
The Sufi lover loves her own hearthstone
As long as rank agreement leaves alone
The divine law. The advertiser will
Give love enticing pictures live or still.
But You, Beloved, give quite another scent:
For You love's quite a different thing that's
meant

To walk according to commandments' law
That once was proclaimed on Sinai with
awe,

And then embodied in the one You lent
To earth to lead the righteous where they
went.

Beloved, I love as I enter once more
Into You commandments at this day's door.

7 For many deceivers have gone
Out into the world, *night and dawn*,
Who do not confess Jesus Christ
As coming in the flesh *sufficed*.
Such is deceiver, antichrist.

8 Look to yourselves, that we do not
Lose those things we worked for *and
taught*,

But may receive a full reward.

9 Who transgresses *except by sword*
And does not stay in Christ's teaching
Does not have God within reaching.
He who abides in Christ's teaching
Has both the Father and the son.

10 Who comes to you and on the run
And does not bring this doctrine *sweet*,
Do not receive in house or greet
Him, 11 for he who greets him shares in
His evil deeds *and in his sin*.

How many feet come trampling through my
door

And settle in my house to eat a score
Of bread and pickle out of doom resigned.
I cannot keep, it seems, my hut confined.
Though I see You beyond the face of all,
I find but few who on Your names will call,
And of those few, how few Your doctrine
treat

As well revealed in Jesus' hands and feet.
I greet the vain desires that come my way

As people crowd my paths from day to day,
But cross my fingers like a child at play,
Because they reject Christ who do not stay
To keep Your law upon the holy path.
I greet them with a smile, please hold Your
wrath.

12 With many things to write to you,
I did not wish *so to construe*
With paper and ink, but I hope
To come to you and speak *and cope*
Once face to face, that our joy may
Be full. 13 The children *in the way*
Of your elect sister greet you,
Who are of the path of Christ true. Amen.

Beloved, my joy is never full as I
Look out upon a clear and cloudless sky,
On woods of fir and pine, by birches' day
And fragrant nights upon wild cherries'
sway.

My joy is never full with veils between
My face and that face that cannot be seen.
The veils are torn, and yet I still see here
The same twigs swollen with the spring of
year.

No change at all reflects my joy grown full,
The harpist still grabs on the horns of bull.
The veil is rent, but all stands as it was:
The melted snow runs on its errands' pause,
All things remain, all things that hid Your
face,

Become the light by which I find Your
grace.

3 John

1 The elder, to beloved Gaius,
Whom I love in truth *without fuss*:
2 Beloved, I pray that you may prosper
In all things *prettier and wasper*,
Flourish in health bodily as
Your soul *also mightily has*.

Body and soul prosper as one, it seems,
In truth alone, and so I leave my dreams
And seek reality to choke to veil
That clogs the letters I find in the mail.
Let me also love not only the truth
But the face that's beloved beyond the
couth.

I pray too for the bright prosperity

Of bodies and souls caught among the
 spree.
 May all things prosper here within Your
 will
 And I shall keep my clamour and be still.
 Who seek health seek a sooner day's
 salvation,
 And Christian and New Ager find their
 station.
 I leave their dreams as well as mine to
 wager
 On You, Beloved, instead of an engager.

3 For I rejoiced greatly when brothers
 Came and witnessed of one another's
 Bearing the truth *that is* in you,
 Just as you walk in truth, *so do*.
 4 I have no greater joy than hearing
 That my children walk *nothing fearing*
 In truth. 5 Beloved, you do *right well*
And faithfully to deal and tell
 To the brothers and strangers too,
 6 Who have borne witness of your love
 Before the group of called out ones.
If you send them forward as sons
 On their journey done worthy of
 God, you will do both well and true,
 7 Because they went forth for His name,
 Taking nothing from Gentiles' *frame*.
 8 We therefore ought to receive such,
 That we may be fellows as much
 Workers for the truth *to our gain*.

I whirl in truth and recite all Your names
 Except the one name You kept out of
 games,
 And so I welcome all workers for weal
 And stamp them with approval and with
 peel
 Of oranges sealed sweet till judgement day.
 Kiss me if You meet me upon the way.
 I whirl in truth and as I whirl recite
 Your names as lovely things under the
 night,
 And rejoice that my feet echo not bare
 Alone upon the dergah for my share,
 But join the feet of countless ones not seen
 Because the darkness covers opaline.
 Beloved, I whirl in truth and as I turn
 I say Your names before my whirlings burn.

9 I wrote the group of called out ones,

But Diotrephes, who loves buns,
 To have pre-eminence among
 Them, does not receive us *in tongue*.
 10 Therefore, if I come, I will call
 To mind the deeds making him fall,
 Prating against us with such words
Maliciously spoken like turds.
 And not content with that, he does
 Not receive the brothers *as was*
Our wont, and forbids those who wish
 To *accept them*, but puts their dish
 Outside the door of the group of
 Called out ones. 11 Now you whom I love,
 Don't imitate evil action,
 But what is good *and to be done*.
 He who does good is of God, but
 He who does evil has been shut
 From seeing God *and knowing what*.

The words of every prophet say that You
 Cannot be seen by men whate'er they do.
 The word of every preacher says we must
 Love neighbour like the self, unless the dust
 Of power clothe him from president's seat,
 And then we must honour, obey and treat
 The man like God Himself or better such.
 But You, Beloved, proclaim discrimination
 To judge the other by good is the ration
 By which it's possible to see Your face,
 Perhaps not in nature, by special grace.
 I do good then, follow ten words of law
 Expecting to sit back and see in awe
 The divine body and soul in this place.

12 Demetrius has *good* witness
 From all, and from the truth to bless.
 And we also bear witness, and
 You know our true *here and at hand*.
 13 I had many things I would write,
 But do not wish with pen and ink
 To write but rather in our sight
 14 To see each other in a wink,
 And shortly comment face to face.
 Peace to you. Our friends greet *with grace*.
 Greet the friends by name *in that place*.

The pen and ink of Scripture is a veil
 That separates the vulgar from the mail.
 Yet pen and ink flow down from point to be
 The penetrating sword of names for Thee.
 Beloved, I lay the veil of ink aside
 And set the reed pen off, and turn to hide

The pipes that cantillate with breath Your
 name,
 And in empty silence I make no claim.
 Yet in a wink We see each other there
 And rise to embrace above the cold air
 That touches heart and lip with peace again
 And then turn and once more, as men to
 men,
 Greet and appear and disappear to be
 A whirling spark through Your eternity.

Jude

1 Jude, servant of Jesus the Christ,
 Brother of James, to those enticed
 And sanctified by God the Father,
 Preserved in Jesus Christ *the rather*:
 2 Mercy, peace, and love multiplied
 Be to you. 3 Beloved, while I was
 Most diligent to write your cause
 Concerning our common salvation,
 I found it necessary station
 To write to you exhorting you
 To contend earnestly *to do*
 For the faith which was once for all
 Delivered to the saints *by call*.
 4 For certain men have crept in it
 Unnoticed, who long ago fit
 Were marked out for this condemnation,
 Ungodly men, who turn the *ration*
Of the grace of our God into
 Lewdness and deny only *true*
 Lord God and our Lord Jesus Christ.
 5 But I'd remind you *paradised*,
 Though you once knew this, that YHWH,
 having
 Saved the people out of enslaving
 Of Egypt's land, later destroyed
 Those who did not, *though once employed*,
 Believe. 6 And the angels who did
 Not keep their domain limited,
 But left their own estate, he has
 Reserved in everlasting *razz*
 Chains under darkness for the day
 Of the great judgement coming way,
 7 As Sodom and Gomorrah, and
 The cities round them *in the land*
 In similar manner to these,
 Having given themselves *to please*
In sexual immorality
 And gone after strange flesh *and fee*,
 Are set forth as example, see,
 Suffering vengeance: eternal fire,

A punishment extreme and dire.

8 So also these dreamers defile
 The flesh, rejecting *with a smile*
 Authority, speaking evil
 Of dignitaries *of good-will*.

The chaining of the angels in degree
 Of hell is something that you never see
 In Bibles Protestant of any kind.
 It's in the book of Enoch for the blind.
 When Jude quotes Enoch, he does not relate
 A pagan text or some side issue's rate,
 But recognizes it to be the great
 Book of the prophet before times of late.
 Beloved, I love the book of Enoch too,
 I love its pages and its message true
 That leave an open gate to heaven's view.
 Beloved, I take the book of Enoch now
 And read its words as my sight does allow
 And pluck the bolden fruit from off its
 bough.

9 Yet Michael the archangel, when
 Contending with the devil, when
 Disputing for the body of
 Moses, *a man in Lord God's love*,
 Dared not to bring an accusation
 Against him a reviling station,
 But said, "The Lord rebuke you *now!*"
 10 But these speak evil anyhow
 Of whatever they do not know,
 And whatever they truly know,
 Like brute beasts, in these things they do
 Corrupt themselves. 11 Woe to their *stew!*
 For they have gone the way of Cain,
 Run greedily in error *vain*
 Of Balaam for a profit, and
 Perished in the rebellion *grand*
 Of Korah. 12 These are spots among
 Your love feasts, they've feasted and sung
 With you without fear, they just serve
 Themselves, *they're* clouds without *reserve*
Of water, driven by the wind,
 Late autumn trees *undisciplined*
 And without fruit, twice dead, pulled out
 By the roots, 13 raging waves about
 The sea, foaming up their own shame,
 Wandering stars for whom is a claim
 Reserved in black darkness for aye.
 14 Now Enoch, seventh from *the high*
 Adam, of these did prophesy
 Also, saying "Indeed, the Lord

Comes with ten thousands *and a sword*
 Of his saints, 15 “and to execute
 Judgement on all, *and not refute,*
But to convict all those who are
 Ungodly of the popular
 Of all their ungodly deeds which
 They have committed in *the ditch*
 In an ungodly way, and of
 All the harsh things which the *above*
 Ungodly sinners have spoken
 Against him.” 16 These are of such sin:
 Grumblers, complainers, walking in
 Their own lusts, and they utter great
 Proud things, and flatter folks to rate
 Advantage. 17 But, beloved, you mind
 The words spoken before in kind
 By the apostles of our lord
 Jesus Christ: 18 how they *without sword*
 Told you how in the last time there
 Would be mockers walking on air
 In their own ungodly lusts’ share.

In the last time the book of Enoch and
 Assumption of Moses will come to stand
 In witness against all the rich and grand
 Who think their wealth and power to set the
 mail

Also determines what is true and hale.
 The scoffers may prevail and little time,
 But soon the saints appearing on a dime
 Will shout them down for every wicked
 crime.

Beloved, when the foul air is filled with
 smoke

And stench of burning flesh and oak
 When Your Messiah shall step out to find
 The righteous and the good, the pure and
 kind.

I walk out on the cinders and I see
 The glories of the Messianic spree.

19 These are sensual persons, who
 Cause divisions, not having *clue*
Of the Spirit. 20 Beloved, but you,
 Building yourselves upon your most
 Holy faith, in the Holy Ghost
 Praying, 21 keep yourselves in the love
 Of God, looking for mercy, love
 Of our Lord Jesus Christ unto
 Eternal life. 22 And on some do
 Have compassion, distinction making,
 23 But others save with fear, and taking

Them out of the fire, hating even
 Garment defiled by flesh *bereaven.*
 24 Now to Him who is able to
 Keep you from stumbling, even to
 Present *you* faultless before presence
 Of his glory exceeding pleasure,
 25 To God our Saviour, who alone
 Is wise, *be glory to atone*
 And majesty, dominion and
 Power, now and ever *to command.* Amen.

Beloved, my God, when You inspired Jude
 To write this bright epistle it caused feud,
 Division among men. Jude quoted one
 And called his writing prophecy when done.
 That one he quoted is Enoch. Now see
 If Book of Enoch where quotation be
 Is found between the covers of the book
 They call Your word. Belovèd, take a look!
 Dear God and Father of mankind, I pray
 That You will not let me too go astray
 To deny Your word and fail to obey.
 I turn from false religion back to You
 And read the words of Enoch, since they’re
 true,
 And not read only, but assay to do.

The sensual faith of Canaan and of Baal
 Is heard in every Sunday church’s wail.
 The Trinities of love gods and their curse
 Are on the land and heart of every nurse
 Who suckles the born and the dying god
 That rises, by the myth, up from the clod.
 Jude says that You, Beloved, are Saviour
 God,

And none but You have saving power to
 trod

The floors of judgement and lift up from
 hell.

Instead of bloody power to save in sin,
 You give the power to live right lives and
 win.

Present me too, Beloved, and faultless when
 You bring Your glorious presence before
 men,

To justify Your Decalogue again.

The Book of Revelation

The Book of Revelation was originally a
 liturgical prophetic text that prepared a

persecuted faithful to face the ravages of the establishment. But because of its colourful apocalyptic language, it has been susceptible to many far-fetched interpretations, very possibly my own included. The Ethiopian church has seen it as a symbolic representation of the course of events in the world from creation to the day of judgement, with each slot in the several cycles of sevens representing an era. This fairly early Christian view that the chronology begins anew with each cycle of seven is at the basis of the historicist interpretation. The historicist interpretation was emphasized by the Protestant Reformation in justification for its divorce from the Roman Church, and thus is tainted at the outset by impure motivations and a lack of objectivity. It is further weakened by its arbitrary chronology in following some but not all of the cycles of seven, departure from the stated geography of the book, and failure to focus on the religious events of Jerusalem specifically and the Middle East in general. The method is further marred by its arbitrary expansion of allegorical interpretation, even when the text does not require a symbolic understanding.

The Preterist interpretation, which relates the events in the book to the beginnings of Christianity, was used by the Jesuit Alcazar in the seventeenth century in order to counteract the Protestant attack on Rome. As such, it cannot be considered seriously as an objective attempt to understand the book, despite the advantage of giving a largely contemporary application and thus dispensing with the need to rely on confidence in prophetic revelation of the future. Needless to say, the latter advantage is quickly grasped by the liberal scholar who wishes to read Scripture without reference to divine intervention.

The Futurist interpretation relegates nearly everything to the future. It is fostered by Evangelical Christianity, although it is also a historical Roman Catholic attempt to deflect Protestant criticism of Rome by focusing on the future. Of course Rome is right in objecting

to the Protestant views. After the fall of the Roman Empire it is of little significance to the religious situation of the Middle East, and thus of prophetic books concerned with the state of Jerusalem. The book of Revelation does not mention the Papacy at all, simply because it is part of the polytheistic pagan tradition outside both the relevant geographical area and the development of Middle Eastern monotheism. The Reformation had no effect on this at all, and merely affirmed and continued the non-Biblical tradition despite its claims to *sola scriptura*.

Christians who despair of clarity on the morass of bias often appeal to a spiritual interpretation. While the spirituality of the book cannot be denied, it is also statedly a book of prophecy and ought to be conceived as such.

Despite the enormous amount of commentary that has been done on the Book of Revelation from the faith perspective, little of it is of consequence because of the lack of systematic hermeneutical principles. Such cannot be said of academic study of the book, however. Much of linguistic and cultural relevance has certainly been discovered. But few have had the courage to look at the book from a faith perspective and apply a rigid and systematic set of interpretive principles to the text. What follows is based on such an attempt to be as systematic as possible.

The commentary below takes conscious consideration of the following reasonable principles. 1) While the book is obviously liturgical, it also intends to be prophetic and to reveal the things shortly to come to pass. 2) The events portrayed as future to the writer should be found to occur after his time in the geographical areas mentioned in the book itself, and not in fancifully suggested other areas of the world. 3) The book should be taken in order and assumed to be chronological, except where the context is clear in making a temporary flashback or flash forward, only to resume its historically consistent time-line. 4) The book should be interpreted literally where possible and

symbolism only appealed to when the context demands it. The objective reader will immediately understand the advantage of these principles. They are simple and reasonable. When the book speaks of a place by name, the primary significance of the passage must be that place and not Rome, Russia or the United States in arbitrary order. The simple assumption that what comes first in the book comes first in time, and what comes later in the book comes later in time, is obviously far superior to the arbitrary application of one passage to one time and another to another, just because it seems to fit the news of the day. The objective reader will immediately understand that falling into the practice of giving symbolic meaning to words when the text does not require it cannot fail to create chaos. The failure to apply these simple principles, along with the clear biases and political motivations of Christian interpreters of all stripes, is the reason for the chaotic misunderstanding of the Book of Revelation, and not the difficulty or obscurity in the text.

The book is structured around cycles of seven, but there are interpolations of other material as well. Furthermore, the number symbolism of the book is far more complex than that, building in addition to 3 + 4, also on 3 x 4 and half of seven in various expressions. This numerical symbolism goes back to the first chapter of the book of Genesis. All numbers in the book of Revelation should be seen as consistently symbolic when they are situated in this system. The system is symbolic, and one does not have the right to pick one area of it for literal interpretation and another for symbolic.

The book is also structured around two different figures: 1) the glorified human figure of Jesus Christ and 2) the theriomorphic figure of a lamb. Christian interpretation has conflated these figures into one and referred both to Christ on the basis of John 1:29 et al. This, however, is not valid, as the Greek text uses two distinct words for the lamb here, words that could conceivably even have been used of different species in the common speech of

the time and place, and the connexion can only be made in translation, where both Greek words are collapsed into the one word lamb. The Jesus passages are 1:1-3:22; 12:17; 19:10; 20:1-21:8; 22:16-21. The figure of Jesus is always associated with the word of witness or martyrdom. The boundaries of the internal passages are unclear, especially in 20:1-21:8. Since the beginning and the end of the book are armed with these passages, it is possible that they are the products of a second editing, and that the original book consisted of the lamb passages while these are additions. Thus two visions may be collapsed into one writing, with the integrity of the original largely preserved.

The book presents a coherent whole, however, and this is made all the more coherent by the martyred Jesus passages. The first Jesus passage situates the rest of the book as chronologically arising in the aftermath of the apostasy of Christianity described in chapters two and three. Although the seven "churches" must be seen as literal, they also represent in their literal character the progress of Christianity towards apostasy. It is anachronistic, however, to speak of Christianity at all. The Book of Revelation only recognizes Jews of the synagogue of Satan and "true" Jews of the "churches" or groups of called out ones as the literal Greek implies, from the synagogue of Judaism, and perhaps metaphorically from the heathen world. There is no full-fledged Christianity at all, merely groups of called-out ones who preserved the message of Jesus to varying extents until they became the pallid last representatives in the Laodicean church. Apostate Christianity passes out of relevance to the book of Revelation and becomes a part of paganism with its polytheism and human sacrifice.

The new divine revelation, of which the Book of Revelation is the prophecy, appears as a book in 5:1. A new figure, the Lamb, opens this book for the world. The only relevant religious movement in the Middle East at the time of the period of Christian apostasy is of course Islam, and the book is the Qur'an. The Lamb is the

The players in the drama, especially those of significance to the faithful, are obscure in human history, so that the details of their activities as portrayed here are not easy to disengage from historical sources. The fate of the mother of the Master of the Age in chapter twelve, for example, is much more clearly described in prophecy than in history. Few have been interested in the figure of Narjis, but her claims to fame are well delineated in the record books of God.

2

And yet I set myself upon Your word
Against beliefs beloved by common herd
It's only right the Jew hates me because
I love both Jesus and Muhammad's claws.
It's only right the Christians hate me for
My praise to the Qur'an in holy store.
It's only right the Muslims hate the way
I let Christ die and resurrect in clay.
I only wonder at the Catholic crowd
Who love to read my scattered words
aloud.

04

and true forms. The failure of the Christian Church to do so, and the incorporation of other liturgies in place of the Book of Revelation, is part of its apostasy.

Revelation 1

1 The Revelation of the Christ
Jesus, which God gave him, *bespiced*,
To show his servants what comes soon.
He sent and signified *its tune*
By angel to his servant John,
2 The one who bore his witness on
The word of God, and martyrdom
Of Jesus Christ, all that had come.

Beloved, You send Your universal word
By hand of Christ, angel, and prophet
stirred,
To show Your servants what will happen
soon.
Without such witnesses I bow at noon
To find not public messages You share
With humankind through ages everywhere,
But whispers loving to my ear alone
Unheard by any other flesh and bone.
And yet those messages of word of God
And martyrdom bring tears and joys to prod
My soul to that oneness Your words imply.
I lift my soul up to the empty sky
To bring down once again earth's words of
life
Before I step out into raging strife.

3 Blessed *is* the one who reads and those
Who hear the words these lines propose,
And keep those things that here appear
Wrote down, because the time is near.

In olden times readers were few and far
And had to function like an honoured star.
The books were also scattered on the hills
And rare indeed was that letter that kills.
A blessing You, Beloved, pronounce on
those
Who have the book and share the word it
shows.
This is liturgy more than prophet's look
At future things to write down in a book.
The faithful servants gather on a day
To hear one read what they can only say.
Such worship gathered on the sacred word

Raised hearts in love, and souls were deeply
stirred.
I too seek here the reader's promised
blessing
And bow with hearers in blessing's
confessing.

Worship consists from the beginning of
Hearing the divine voice of You in love,
Even if my soul still hides in the garden.
I seek Your mercy and Your offered pardon
In prayer, sacrifice, circumambulation,
But still the heart of worship's reading's
ration
And hearing of Your Scriptures and their
heeding.
I fought my way with guile, begging, and
pleading,
And recitation of the Qur'an till
I walked free and abluted on the hill
Of the dome and Al-Aqsa and found there
The same sweet worship surrounded by
prayer,
The reader of the Scriptures sitting still
And those who hear surrounded to the fill.

4 John, to the seven groups of called
Out ones in Asia: Grace be thrall'd
To you and peace from the Existing
God who was and comes *still persisting*,
And from the seven spirits who
Are before His throne *at their cue*.

There are just seven valid churches in
The holy land of Asia without sin,
Now huddled in the vastly state that's now
Called Turkey by the low- and the
highbrow.

The many ways and means around the earth
That search to find the spiritual in berth
Are futile now that e-mail makes the search
Alive to every bird upon its perch.
Beloved, I bow where true faith still is
found,
And find it on my whirling round and round
The steeps of Anatolia and ground
Where Hasan Dede used to raise the sound.
I step no more in search, Beloved, for You
Stepped out of Turkey and into my view.

5 And from Jesus Christ, faithful witness,
The firstborn from the dead with *fitness*,

And ruler of the kings of earth.
To him who loved us *for our worth*
And loosed us from our sins in his
Own blood, 6 and made us kings *that is*
And priests to his God and his Father,
To him *be* glory and power *rather*
Forever and ever. Amen.

Witness and martyr are one word in Greek,
And Jesus is both of these things men seek.
There seems to be no wish so prominent
Among this humankind where I am sent
As looking for the proof of what one knows
Or thinks one knows, and looking for the
glows
Of fire that burns the bodies of one's foes.
Give me the grace and peace, Beloved, You
share

With seven groups of people in the air,
And seven spirits burning at Your throne,
And the one martyred son You call Your
own.
Thus I shall join the thousand thousand
throng
That are kings and priests with a holy song
To You, his God and Father come along.

This text's the only construed reference
To death of Jesus to wash sins' suspense
Away in blood to be found in this book.
There's very little explanation's rook
In these words, perhaps because at the time
There was no thought of an atonement's
rhyme

Nor any care to deny or defend
The fact historical of the death send.
The words prevent the masses now from
knowing
What this book's message may be in the
showing,
Since those who must have human sacrifice
And blood atonement find their desires
nice,
And those who deny Jesus' death abuse
To read anything but their own short fuse.

Truth is that Peter set the pace when he
Announced to Jewish folk jubilantly
That they were guilty of the blood of Christ.
It was surprising for those intersticed
With Roman rule. The fact is Romans
willed

Those who were killed when righteous
blood was spilled.

But proclamations of what such neglect
To save their own meant in guilt so select
Was shocking enough for some to repent,
And that is what both Peter and John meant,
Not that the slaying was a sacrifice,
But that the death of good men should
suffice

To make all people everywhere stop short
And turn to You, Beloved, from wicked
sport.

7 Truly he comes with clouds again,
And every eye will see him then,
Even the ones who pierced him, and
All tribes of earth will mourn *in band*
Because of him. Even so, Amen.

The promise when Christ left to go to You
Couched in the words of angels sent on cue,
Was that he would appear once more to be
The king in sight of every eye to see.
The one who thrust the spear in sacred side
Is wakened from the dust to see astride
The rushing clouds the one they crucified.
They see Your sent one once again to
mourn
And wish that he or they had not been born.
I too shall raise my eyes to see that form
Revealing to the human eye Your norm,
And pray that when I do I shall not fail
To find joy in the visage and the gail.
Let me laugh last with nothing to bewail.

The question in my mind is that the cross,
Or torture stake if we must check the boss,
Is matter merely of old history
And cuts no ice whether true or falsely.
But I would suggest this verse does not
right

Oppose the Qur'an in the bookish fight
By saying Roman soldiers pierced the
wight.

In any case the Jews that taunted those
Poor Christians before Muhammad's bare
toes
Did not kill any Christ despite their boasts.
They all can rest on laurels and on toasts.
Let those who pierced him see the fearful
sight
Of him returning to judgement's delight

And even if mere myth regret the night.

8 “I’m the alpha and omega,
The start and finish,” says Lord God,
“Who is, who was and who for a’
Shall wield all power by My rod.”

The concept of divinity is sound
It seems no matter where one treads the
ground.

The older revelation has a view
Less tri-part in the time it takes to do.
Besides Your being almighty in power,
The word finds You to be more than an
hour.

Eternity is not here seen as void
Or wandering among the asteroid.
Instead it follows merely dot and line
From past to now to future carabine.
Even my own poor soul is well aware
That time is just a cloak, Beloved, You
wear
When You show presence to the praying
soul.
Time is Your servant too, and not Your
goal.

9 I, John, both your brother and friend
In tribulation *to the end*
In kingdom and patience of Christ
Jesus, was on the isle *surplised*
That’s called Patmos and for God’s word
And for the testimony *spurred*
Of Jesus Christ. 10 The lordly day
I was under the spirit’s sway,
And heard behind me a loud voice,
As of a trumpet, 11 saying choice,
“I am the alpha and omega,
The first and the last *and no beggar,*”
And, “What you see, write in a book
And send it *out for them to look*
To the seven groups of called out ones
Which are in Asia *on their buns:*
To Ephesus, to Smyrna, and
To Pergamos, Thyatira’s *land,*
To Sardis, Philadelphia’s *stand,*
And to Laodicean *band.*”

What lordly day was that, my Dear, that he
Heard the loved voice behind him in the
lee?

I seek that day, whether the Sabbath rest

Or the great day of Judgement of the
blessed,

Or any day on which Your name’s
confessed.

The place I know, but that will make no
show,

It is a very weary way to go.

My feet are too frail to conquer aquatic.

To meet You on a day’s more democratic,

It takes no travel in a world not static.

But time nor place have no hold on the bar,

The spirit is the thing that near or far

Recites the voice I long to hear from You,

At mouth of Christ, or in the steady pew.

A visit to any of these fair towns

In Turkey now still filled with their
renowns

Will bring the soul into touch with the faith

That still burns brightly witness against
wraith.

In Ephesus today, in Sardis too,

In any of the seven to be true,

A man can find a representative

Living nearby to show the way to live.

Beloved, I trek the villages that greet

The eye in search of beauty and I meet

In every place a fount to wash my feet,

A carpet where to lay my head in prayer,

The sound of the muezzin high on the air,

The hope of holiness’ scent everywhere.

12 Then turned to see the voice that spoke

With me, and having turned I *woke*

To see seven golden lampstands there,

13 Among the seven lampstands *fair*

One like the son of man, and dressed

With garment down to *his* feet *blessed*

And girded round the chest with band

Of gold. 14 His head and hair *untanned*

Were white like wool, as white as snow,

His eyes like fiery flame did go,

15 His feet *were* like fine brass, refined

In a furnace, his voice combined

As sounds of many waters *rushing,*

16 He had in his right hand seven *crushing*

Stars, and out of his mouth went sharp

Two-edged sword, and on epicarp

His countenance *was* like the sun

Shining in its strength *on the run.*

I follow in the image of the Christ,

The living Master once emparadised.
I have not reached the level of the sun
That shines out from my countenance or
bun.

Too many colours disappear from sight.
But I have finally achieved the white
Or almost white of sacred beard and hair.
I have no sharpened sword to spar and
scare,

Nor star nor lampstand, golden belt or robe.
But I have grizzled hair upon my globe.
I follow Your sent one among the stars
And walk with him where lampstand
avatars

Awaken me to hear reciting voice
Sword-sharp regale me with room to
rejoice.

17 And when I saw him, I fell down
At his feet as dead *on my crown*.
But he laid his right hand on me,
Saying to me, "Fear not decree.
I am the first, I am the last.

18 "I *am* he who lives, though in past
Was dead, and indeed, I'm alive
Forevermore, *I do not jive*.

Amen. And I have Hades' keys
And Death's keys *also, if you please*.

19 "Write down the things which you have
seen,
And the things which are, *and have been*,
And the things coming after this.

Your sent one speaks in very words You
use
To show the deity by which You choose
To touch my mind. He speaks as though the
life

That You are from beginning of the strife
To end is also coursing in his veins.
Your giving him Yourself is his self-gains.

The first and last are not to You alone
Or to him limited in flesh and bone,
But also come to play upon the sheep
And goats before Your judgement hold and
keep

Where first shall be last and the last shall be
First, Beloved, through Your love's
eternity.

When once unlocked, it seems that death's
dread door

Has no more power to strike one to the core.

He claims that he was truly dead and done
After the Roman spears went through his
bun.

He says he conquered death and rose again
To bring the keys of hell safely to men
And fill the heart with hope, even the heart
That stands before the threat and evil part
Of martyrdom. And so significance
Of death and resurrection to the dance
Of the cosmos or Roman street or sound
Of New York is that fear's thrown to the
ground.

Beloved, whether I fear that death or not,
I do not seek the martyr's blessed plot.
I seek Your face and leave the promise bare.
I live to find Your presence everywhere.

20 "The mystery of seven stars' *bliss*
Which you saw in my right hand, and
The seven golden lampstands *grand*:
The seven stars are messengers
To the seven groups of called out fers,
And the seven lampstands which you saw
Are the seven groups called out *in awe*.

I stepped into a world full of surprise
That held up mysteries before my eyes.
A simple lamp, a sword or star in sky,
A golden belt, a woollen cloak, a sigh,
All hold in common places in the dark
A glowing meaning for those in the park.
I take both star and hand and in my left
I thus empower Self not the bereft.
Beloved, as I step in the rampant row
Of growing lights upon the ground below,
I find that my bare feet in coolness show
More mysteries yet than the books bestow.
Book, vision and the common, shallow treat
All fill with mystery my brazen feet.

Revelation 2

1 "To the messenger to the group
Of called out ones, Ephesus' troupe,
Write, 'These things says the one who holds
The seven stars *with hots and colds*
In his right hand, who walks among
The seven golden lampstands *sung*:

2 "I know your works, your labour, and
Your patience, that you cannot stand
Those who are evil, and you've tried
Those who say they are sanctified

Apostles and are not, and found
 Them liars, 3 “and you have come round
 And borne aloft, and laboured for
 My name’s sake and have not *footsore*
 Been weary. 4 “Yet I have a *thing*
 Against you, that you’ve left the spring
 Of your first love. 5 “Remember then
 From where you’ve fallen, *and like men*
 Repent and do first works *again*,
 Or else I’ll come to you right soon
 And take your lampstand *golden hewn*
 From its place, except you repent.
 6 “But this you have, I do relent,
 That you hate Nicolaitans’ deeds,
 Which I also hate, *and their creeds*.

The people of Asia drew the complaint
 From self-styled apostle and sinner saint,
 The man Saul of Tarsus, that they did not
 Accept his claims to apostolic plot.
 Whether he is the grand prevaricator
 That is counted here among gnome and
 satyr

I cannot say, perhaps You in Your sight
 Know Paul better than I or any wight.
 If Paul affirms Your covenant and word
 Once sounded on fair Sinai and that stirred
 Hearts then as mine is now, then I accept
 Him as a truthful son and an adept.
 But if not, then I take Ephesian crown
 And tumble him and every prophet down.

I turn my spirit and my foot toward
 Ephesian lights above the prophet’s sword,
 And find the first and greatest of true
 churches
 That binds the heart of all men on their
 perches
 To You, Beloved, since the day Ali came
 To wash the body of the prophet’s fame.
 The faith that rose with fair Muhammad’s
 brood
 And spread with the folk of the house that
 stood
 Beneath the mantle of the prophet’s care
 Is still found bowed three times a day in
 prayer.
 Beloved, I rush into the mosque and seek
 The treasures of Your justice and a peek
 At twelve imams who whirl upon the day
 And on the night with everything You say.

7 “He who has an ear, let him hear
 What the Spirit says *for their fear*
 To the groups of the called out ones.
 To him who overcomes *in runs*
 I’ll give to eat from tree of life,
 Which is *planted and without strife*
 In midst of Paradise of God
Above the river on the sod.”

Beloved, the Nicolaitans are a thing
 That has been centuries for wondering
 Of who they are, and yet I think the word
 Is clear not who but what they do’s inferred.
 Let me know what evil things such folk did
 That You despise their works unspirited.
 They followed Balaam’s trail in worshiping
 Idols and meat offered in idols’ name,
 And committing acts of nakedness’ shame.
 Beloved, may I respect the marriage vow
 And avoid eating the unclean somehow,
 So You will not despise my act and deed.
 Beloved, I come to You for plough and seed
 And planting time and watering for feed.

The group of called out ones at Ephesus
 Existed at the time and without fuss
 Despite the fatal loss of their first love.
 But Ephesus is more than the above.
 It represents the followers of Christ
 At earliest days when their pure faith
 sufficed.

It represents the first step down the road
 To an apostasy that would corrode
 The faith until the government stepped in
 To define and to force them into sin.
 Do not, Beloved, look harshly on that
 crowd

Who left Your faith in procession allowed
 Over five centuries, the Muslims took
 Only an afternoon, prophet forsook.

8 “And to the messenger sent to
 The group of called out ones, *the few*
 In Smyrna write, ‘These things says he
 Who’s first and last *and faithfully*,
 Who was dead, and came back to life:
 9 “I know your works, *I know* your strife,
 And poverty (but you are rich),
 And *I know* the blasphemous *pitch*
 Of those who say that they are Jews
 And are not, but *sit in the pews*
Of Satan’s synagogue and views.

And yet do not, Beloved, blame Muslims
 over
 Harshly for their apostasy in rover.
 The Christian world was first a called out
 race
 From synagogue of Satan to the place
 Of "true Jews" after which they gain no
 grace
 Of their own epithet before the dance
 Apostate entered in and closed their chance.
 There never was a pure faith Christian
 known
 Between the true Jew and the gnawing bone
 Of Islam. Its descent into the false
 Started in second century with a waltz
 While they were still known as Jews of a
 sort.
 Forgive, Beloved, the human cast of sport
 That leaves You bereft of prayer and alone.

 I whirl about the Turkish ways to find
 The church of Smyrna in sweet things
 combined
 And find the breath of Sabbetai Zvi is still
 Scented upon the Smyrnan grove and hill.
 The Doenme still cast up their secret
 prayers
 In holiness upon the sea's affairs,
 And still confess the mystery of life
 Before the evil world of sin and strife.
 Beloved, I call a blessing on the few
 Who remain true to that faith and to You
 And wend their silent ways unseen by crew
 Of state or merchant, tourist, man with
 knife.
 And as You bless Your own, Beloved, arise
 To write their faithful name upon the skies.

 10 "Do not fear any of those things
 Which you will suffer in the rings.
 Indeed, the devil soon will throw
Some of you into prison stow,
 That you may be tested *and tried*,
 And you will have trouble to bide
 Ten days. Be faithful until death,
 And I will give you *in one breath*
 The crown of life. 11 "Who has an ear,
 Let him hear what the spirit *dear*
 Says to the groups of called out ones.
 He who overcomes *in his runs*
 Shall not be hurt by second death.""

The ten days of the Diocletian reign
 Of terror were so done with crush and pain
 The echoes filled distraught patmotric brain
 And taught the tongue to prophesy not vain
 The coming of destruction and insane.
 The ten days of the Diocletian wrath
 Come just before the stepping from the path
 Into the irrevocable reward
 Of empire and the preaching of the sword
 Instead of gatherings in homes to read
 The book of Revelation and not creed.
 Beloved, the emperor for ten days tried
 To kill the body, then he set aside
 That to destroy the soul in false faith's tide.

If Diocletian set the warning pace
 Of persecution of Your folk and race,
 It reached as far as Doenme in the trace,
 As far as the expulsion of the one
 Who spoke Your name despite Rabbinic
 dun.
 Ten years upon the face of hidden fame
 Your blessed son took a humble sort of
 claim,
 But left a place of visitation's flame,
 A tomb, a mountain fastness and a name.
 Beloved, I follow the ten silent years
 Of desecration of Your love and fears
 And while so many still revile the man,
 Though sleeping in a doubtful tomb, I can
 Find gaps torn by his life in the veil's span.

 12 "And to the messenger sent out
 To the group of called out devout
 Pergamos write, 'Now these things are
 What he says who has scimitar
 Of sharp two edges: 13 "I know your
 Works, and where you live *at the door*
 Where Satan's throne *is*. And you hold
 Fast to my name, and you were bold
 For my faith even in the days
 In which Antipas *man to praise*
Was my faithful martyr, though killed
 Among you, where Satan's *wrath swilled*.

This era of the called out ones of Christ
 Is that of when the government has sliced
 Into the congregation, taken over,
 Set up its church councils where now the
 clover
 Is carpet on Nicaea's church's floor

And broken walls stand where was once the
door

By which king Constantine came to restore
The unity of empire with the help
Of those martyrs maimed by the Caesar's
whelp

A decade gone. Beloved, I too sit here
In Satan's seat beneath the Roman gear
That's raised each Sunday with never a fear
That You will step in and say now's enough
Idolatry, polytheistic stuff.

14 "But I've a few things against you,
Because you've there those who hold true
The doctrine of Balaam, who taught
Balak to put a stumbling blot
Before Israel's folk, and to eat
Things sacrificed at idols' *feet*,
And to fornicate *for a treat*.

15 "Thus you also have those who hold
The Nicolaitans doctrines *bold*,
Which thing I hate. 16 'Repent, or else
I'll come to you quickly *for welts*
And fight against them with the sword
Of my mouth *and the righteous Lord*.

The fornication was not just the run
Of striptease or what one-night stands get
done

After the bar, it was a sacred state,
A rite to make the crops grow and the mate
Of cattle fertile, and it had its clue
In empirical, scientific view.

Your faith ignored the scientific plot
And left the faithful lost in their own
thought

That babies came from You, and prayer was
better

Way to get pregnant than Balak's free setter
Of princess and Israelite man who went
To copulate under a sacred tent.

Beloved, I do not reject science when
I choose You alone in the face of men.

If Abdul Sultan Balim came to cast
An allegory and ungrateful mast
Before the place of gallows and repent,
I still must protest here, Beloved, the rate
Of accusation on his people's state.
The candle is not blown out so they mate
With partners indiscriminate as said
By neighbour and by enemy unled.

That calumny of fornication rises
From wicked heart alone for shame
despises.

Beloved, I take hold of the blessed name
Of Hajji Bektash Wali and I claim
For him if not for each that gives him
shame

The blessings of abundance and surmises.

17 "Who has an ear, let him hear what
The spirit says to groups *astrut*
Of called out ones. To him who wins
I'll give hidden manna *from bins*
To eat. I'll give him a white stone,
And on the stone new name alone
Written which no one knows except
He who's received *the stone and kept*."

The first Bektashis were Jacob and his
Uncle Laban who raised white stone for kiz
Who claimed to be without idolatry.
That guard stone was there for all folk to
see

That Jacob and Laban's musahiblik
Was ancient and always managed to stick.
When Hajji Bektash multiplied the wheat
He gave the hidden manna from his seat,
And when he took the Bektashi stone white
He crowned it with a new name and a light
That still remains the secret of the night.
Beloved, I take the gulbent and the stone
Twelve-fluted and bowing before Your
throne

Find that You are Allah and You alone.

18 "And to the messenger sent nigh
The group of called out ones in Thy-
Atira write, 'These things says son
Of God *Messiah*, he's the one
Who has eyes like a flame of fire,
And his feet like fine brass *and wire*:

19 "I know your works, love, service, and
Your faith and patience *to command*,
And *as* for your works, the last *are*
More than the first *to shine as star*.

Here is one of the rare occasions when
Your messenger calls Christ not son of men
But son of God, whereby the clear sense
rises

That he's Messiah that the world despises.
A technical term for Messiah taught

To priest and demon and at long last sought
By John, though not by others, it reveals
Jesus who conquers death and with life
heals.

And yet John himself shows in Gospel rate
That Jesus was anointed on the pate
Not with anointing oil but with the dove
Of Your spirit alone and with Your love.
So technically he's not even messiah
Since then existed no anointing fire.

20 "Nevertheless I have a few
Things against you, and because you
Allow that woman Jezebel,
Who calls herself prophetess, well
To teach and seduce my servants
To commit fornication's dance
And eat things sacrificed to idols.

The beginning age of church music starts
To appal John who hears the flash and farts
Within the church walls built to gather in
The crowds to hear the priest encourage sin,
Adultery of worshipping in din
Of sensual display the Trinity.
Since Charlemagne there has been unity
On the platform of gross idolatry
By which three gods are all given one name
And take the throne and sceptre of Your
fame.

The cults of Baal and Jezebel revive
In every sort of Christian now alive
Who mucks his way through drumset to the
jive,
Contemporary Christian music's hive.

21 "And I gave her the time *in bridals*
To repent of her fornication,
And she did not repent *fixation*.
22 "Indeed I will cast her into
A sickbed, and *also* those who
Commit whoredom with her into
Great tribulation, unless they
Repent of their deeds *of the day*.
23 "I will kill her children with death,
And all the groups called out *by breath*
Shall know that I am he who searches
The minds and hearts *of folk and churches*.
And I'll give to each one of you
According to your workings' due.

No one ever repents of an addiction,

And Baal worship is that sort of affliction.
The way that Jehu dealt with Baal worship
Was not to missionise with hand on hip
And exhort them to give up fiery sip
Of wine of fornication at the lip.
He did not come to reason with the crowd
And priest who dealt in pseudo-science
loud,

But rather used deceit to bring them all
Under one roof and to a fraudulent call
To worship Baal. And when he had them
there,
He ordered men to kill them and not spare.
A Christian rock rave's what we need now
where
The whole crowd is laid down to
slaughter's share.

24 "Now I say to you and the rest
In Thyatira of the best
Who do not have this doctrine, who
Have not known Satan's depths *of stew*,
As they say, I will put on you
No other burden. 25 "But hold fast
The things you have until the last
And I come. 26 "He who overcomes,
And keeps my works *at premiums*
Until the end, to him I'll give
Power over the nations to live.
27 "He shall rule them with iron rod,
They shall be dashed *down to the sod*
In pieces like the potter's crock.
As I've also received from my
Father, 28 "and I'll give *by and by*
To him the morning star. 29 "He who
Has ear, let him hear what the true
Spirit says to called out ones *few*.""

Even in those days when the papacy
Was taking the inheritance and see
Of Rome to establish the heathen state
Of forced worship before the ruined fate
Of faith, even in those days of the past
There were some faithful in the wicked
blast.

There were some honest ones who came to
You
Alone and did not worship pagan crew
Of trinities with wild rite and with mock
Human sacrifice on the altar block.
Even in those days there were faithful few,
Beloved, but what of now, tell me, be true,

Is there any who with a heart unstained
In innocence worships You unrestrained?

The Sunnite empire thrust along the shore
Of Turkey as far as Sudanese gore
May give a sop indeed to Jezabel
And follow Aysha's blood-curdling in
spell,

But You Yourself must once admit it's true
That Hanafi madhhab turns from the view
Of ahadith and flees back to Your Word,
The Qur'an recited holy and stirred.
So Thyatira to this very day
Has those who rise to follow You and say
Now La ilaaha illallaah and pray.
I hear the call to prayer and rise to go,
Beloved, before the righteous and the show,
And stand upon the straight line, bow and
know.

Revelation 3

1 "And to the one sent to Sardis
To the group of called out ones this
Is what to write, 'These things says he
Who's got the seven Spirits of God
And seven stars *above the sod*,
'I know your works, a name to be
Alive, but you are dead. 2 "Take care,
And strengthen what remains your share,
That is ready to die, for I've
Not found your works perfect *alive*
Before God. 3 "So remember how
You received and heard, hold fast *now*
And repent. Therefore if you'll not
Watch, then I shall come to your plot
As a thief, and you will not know
What hour I shall break in your show. 4 "You have a few names even in
Sardis who have not spoiled with sin
Their garments, and they'll walk with me
In white, for they're surely worthy. 5 "Who overcomes shall be clothed in
White garments, and I'll not begin
To blot out his name from the Book
Of Life, but *still I undertook*
To confess his name before my
Father, before His angels *fly*. 6 "Who has an ear, let him hear *then*
What spirit says to groups of men
Called out *to serve the Lord again*.'" "

When pagan polytheists make the claim

To represent You by sacrifice shame
To re-enact the Roman deed of blame
Upon the mythic cross, I wonder that
Any can be blinded to believe scat.
The Roman soldier thrust the lance to kill
The prophet set up on the gallows hill,
And then the Roman priest comes in his
place
And takes the lance up there before Your
grace,
And there are still crowds who see ne'er a
trace
Of blasphemy in that. I hide my face
For wary shame. Beloved, I turn to You
And to the recitation of the true
To find pure faith in simple grass and dew.

The Alevi steps quietly upon
The sound and scent and light of breaking
dawn

And follows the rays to the sudden tomb
With its green dome giving the saint his
room.

The sacrifices of the little goats
Stir up the heart to dance beneath where
floats

The purple sky where Abraham once
walked,
And where the prophet Job remained and
talked.

Beloved, grant blessing on the faithful few
Who rise from circle prayer to give Your
due,

And overlook neglect of any law
They may forget to perform in Your awe.
The heart is true, the hand is for each guest:
Of faiths the Alevi's among the best.

7 "And to the messenger vouchsafed
To the group of called out ones *strafed*
In Philadelphia now write,
'These things says he who is a *wight*
Holy and true, 'He who has key
Of David, he who opens *ley*
And no one shuts, and shuts and no
One opens *the shut door*': 8 "I know
Your works. See, I have set before
You an open and not shut door,
And no one can shut it, for you
Have a little strength, have kept due
My word, and not denied my name.

9 "Indeed I will make *those who are*

Of Satan's synagogue, who claim
 To be Jews and are not *the star*,
 But lie, indeed I'll make them come
 And prostrate at your feet *like scum*,
 And to know that I have loved you.
 10 "Because you've kept my command cue
 To persevere, I'll keep you too
 From hour of trial which shall come on
 The whole world, to test those who live
 On the earth. 11 "Indeed, I am drawn
 To come quickly! Hold fast, don't give
 Up what you have, that none may take
 Your crown. 12 "Who conquers *for my sake*
 I will make him a pillar in
 The temple of my God *begin*,
 And he shall go from thence no more.
 And I will write on him *in score*
 The name of my God and the name
 Of the city of my God's claim,
 The New Jerusalem, which comes
 Down out of heaven from my God's *sums*.
 And *I'll write on him* my new name.
 13 "Who's an ear, let him hear what *fame*
 The spirit says to the groups of
 Called out ones *to enjoy my love*.""

The true Jew and true Christian (though the
 name
 Never rose up to height of righteous claim)
 Is the one who walks through David's vast
 door
 Open into the Psalms to sing the store
 Of love and light and faith to overcome
 The foe that slinks into the tent with scum
 Of sacrifice to Molech, David's son
 Himself brought in the trip, and yet he gave
 The best greetings to Ahmed from the pave
 Of pearl and beryl. I know yet to save
 Only the ten commandments and the throne
 That seats You surely and casts bleary bone
 Of swine out to the dogs whose only treat
 Is to lick Jezebel's blood under feet.

14 "And to the angel of the group
 Of called out ones *that do not stoop*
 Of the Laodiceans write,
 'These things says the amen, the right
 Faithful and true witness martyr,
 Start of God's creation, the fer:
 15 "I know your works, that you are not
 Either cold or *even too hot*.
 I could wish you were cold or hot.

16 "So then, because you are lukewarm,
 And neither cold nor hot *in form*,
 I'll vomit you out of my mouth.
 17 "Because you say 'I'm rich *in drouth*,
 Have waxed increased in goods, and need
 Nothing,' and yet do not take heed
 That you're wretched, miserable, poor,
 Blind, and naked, 18 "so I adjure
 You to buy from me gold refined
 In the fire, that you may be rich,
 And white garments, that *in the stitch*
 You may be clothed, *well wined and dined*,
 That shame of your nakedness may
 Not be revealed *along the way*,
 Anoint your eyes with *my eye salve*,
 That you may see. 19 "Those that I have
 Loved, such I shall rebuke and chasten.
 Therefore be you zealous and hasten
 To repent. 20 "Indeed, I stand at
 The door and knock. If any's *at*
 Home and hears my voice, opens door,
 I will come in to him, *what's more*,
 And dine with him, and he with me.
 21 "To him who overcomes in fee
 I'll grant to sit on throne with me,
 As I also conquered and sat
 On the throne where my Father's at.
 22 "He who has an ear, let him hear
 What the spirit makes to appear
 In hearing of the groups called out
 To worship God with prayer and shout.""

In Konya I turned out before the shrine
 To find the mosque of prayer before I dine.
 And as I turn I hear behind my ear
 The ney in melodies of love and fear.
 The last of true faiths on the earth appears
 While Shams ud-Din turns back on helps
 and tears,
 And slays the sun-god with hammer on
 brass
 To walk out on the shimmering, singing
 grass.
 Mevlana's breath still heals though quietly
 And without any sort of pageantry,
 And You, Beloved, still honour every foot
 That turns upon the wooden floor to put
 A step between the soul and wickedness
 With love of universe to Your address.

At this day and age of which Your Christ
 speaks

The group of called out ones no longer
seeks

You, but is neither hot with zeal to strike
Down idols in the temples of the shriek,
Nor cold toward the pagan trinities
That wave their golden flags upon the
breeze.

The day has come for You to send again
A prophet to reform the faith of men.
The last call to repent goes here unheeded,
The last door of mercy closed and receded.
The world is poised to see the vision clear
Of Your throne and of Your Lamb sent and
dear.

Beloved, I wait with bated breath to find
The book opened before the wino and
dined.

Revelation 4

1 After these things I looked, indeed,
A door open in heaven's *mead*.

I rush to enter in the open door
Of David's proclamation to restore
His tabernacles in the cantillation
Of Your sweet name in every place and
station.

The secret of the ages lies enfolded
In David's Psalms, the Sabbath Psalms
blindfolded

In every age to miss the guidance set
That people should disbelieve the word met
At Ahmed's lips. Beloved, I rush to keep
The sacred prophecies and not to sleep
Upon the duty to believe and follow
While institutions founder, sink and
wallow.

An open door to heaven shows a book
Sealed with seven seals, I come to take a
look.

And the first voice of which I heard
Was like a trumpet speaking word
With me, *and* saying, "Come up here,
And I'll show you things to appear
After this." 2 And suddenly I
Was in the spirit *in the sky*,
Indeed, a throne set in the sky,
And *One* sat on the throne *foreby*.

The vision of the throne I set before
My face to overprint the rightful score

Of birch and fir and aspen here that grace
The stony worlds that make my living
place.

I do not rate creation poor because
I need a vision of celestial laws,
But that I find a unity to bind
The seen and the unseen to human mind.
Beloved, I set the throne before my face
Not just to praise Your sovereignty a space,
But also with a curious ear to hear
What things You propose to reveal as near
In their fulfilment. What is great enough
To set out in advance and in the rough?

3 And He who sat there was like to
A jasper, sardius stone in hue,
A rainbow was around the throne,
Like to an emerald ingrown.

There are a lot of people on the stir
Who claim to love the rainbow and infer
From seven colours how the world is made
To revolve in a new age for waylaid.
There are some people who chose Noah's
laws

Despite ambiguity at the claws
Of rabbit not content to let us pass
Beneath the Decalogue as clear as glass.
I choose the rainbow merely for the scent
Of new rain on the cloud and willow spent,
And for the swish of water on the road
And for the lady's mantle in new mode.
I did not dream the rainbow made your
throne
A part of the dew sparkle in my zone.

4 Around the throne *were* twenty-four
Thrones, and on the thrones seen before
Twenty-four elders sitting *there*,
Clothed in white robes, and they had *fair*
Crowns of gold on their heads. 5 And from
The throne proceeded lightnings, *rum*
Thunderings, and voices. Seven lamps
Of fire *were* burning *off the damps*
Before the throne, which are the seven
Spirits of God *set up in heaven*.

The sons of Jacob and the loving sons
Of Ishmael come to lift their corns and buns
To rest on heavenly thrones, all quarrels lost
Because they had better things for the
tossed.

The twenty-four meet on the redeemed bank
 To don gold crowns and white dishdashas'
 rank
 To listen to the music of the thunder,
 You can't have rainbows without such, no
 wonder
 The voices spring to seek the lamps and
 earn
 A light and spirit from You where they
 burn.
 Beloved, the twenty-four blessed elder's
 wait
 Beside the visions of the golden grate,
 And find the key to turn both voice and
 sound
 Toward the well-garmented and the
 crowned.

6 Before the throne *there was* a sea
 Of glass, like crystal. On the lee
 And in the midst of the throne, and
 Around the throne, *were set in hand*
 Four living creatures full of eyes
 In front and in the back *as wise*.
 7 The first living creature *was* like
 A lion, and the second *strike*
Of living creatures like a calf,
 The third live beast had face *not half*
 Like a man, and the fourth live beast
Was like flying eagle *at least*.

The way to produce visions is not to
 Wait for the voice and sight to fall in view
 On Patmos or in any wooded place.
 It is enough to choose Ezekiel's race
 And bend the figures in a new mould till
 The seraphim and cherubs foot the bill.
 How often have the four faces inspired
 The prophet and the lesser guide and fired
 With words to catch the symbols of the past
 And paste them on the future with a blast.
 Four angels or four men of the redeemed,
 The colours weave and frazzle on what
 seemed
 Until the crystal sea rises in tide
 Of hurricane refreshing after tried.

8 *The* four living creatures, each had
 Six wings, were full of eyes *not bad*
 Around and within. And they do
 Not rest day or night, *but on cue*
 Sing: "Holy, holy, holy, Lord

God Almighty, who was *implored*
 And is and is to come!" 9 And when
 The living creatures give *like men*
 Glory and honour and thanks to
 Him who sits on the throne *on cue*,
 Who lives forever and ever,
 10 The twenty-four elders *prefer*
To fall down before Him who sits
 On the throne and *with all their wits*
 Worship Him who lives forever
 And ever, cast their crowns before
 The throne, saying *on every score*:
 11 "You are worthy, O Lord, to get
 Glory, honour and power yet,
 For You created all things, and
 By Your will they exist and stand
 And were created *by Your hand*."

Ezekiel may suffice for winter store
 Of figures to illuminate the door,
 Iconostasis and the bleating shore,
 But for the songs to rise Isaiah must
 Be quoted from the throne vision to dust
 The memories of saints who find the wings
 Of seraphim burn bright as questionings.
 Some men must sing a new song every day
 So boredom does not come to wail and
 sway.

But angels find glories enough to rate
 The singing of a single song of fate.
 Beloved, all liturgies begin with these
 Bright holies and end in the arbour'd frieze
 Of fire on altars, thrones, and rainbow
 breeze.

Revelation 5

1 I saw in the right *hand* of him
 Who sat on the throne *bright and grim*
 A scroll writ inside and on back,
 Sealed with seven seals *not to lack*.

A book, a book, Beloved, held in Your hand
 About to be released upon the band
 Of faithful and unfaithful of the earth,
 A book of revelation of such worth
 That none before's predicted to have come
 From Your hand on Your throne to Your
 kingdom
 On earth. A book, a book, well sealed and
 taught
 The secrets of the truth in what men
 wrought

As well as the divine secrets above
The universes made for human love.
Beloved, I take the book unsealed and tried,
Recited for the bitter rate of pride,
And tasted like new wine along the ride
Of late summer when vintage reaches glove.

2 Then I saw a strong angel *stand*
Proclaiming with a loud voice *grand*,
“Who is worthy to open out
The scroll and loose its seals about?”
3 And no one in heaven or on earth
Or under the earth was found worth
To open the scroll, or to look
At it. 4 So I wept much *and shook*,
Because no one was found of worth
To open and read *on the earth*
The scroll, or to look at it there.

There’s cause to weep indeed that none is
found
In heaven and earth to equal Ahmed’s
bound,
And who refuses to believe his word
Is left bereft of even that word stirred
In Torah, Psalms and Gospels. With eyes
blurred
I look upon despair and see its while
Rage in newspapers and in tv smile,
Eternally confronting the debate
On how to find justice in such blind fate.
The book is sealed and none can open it
But the one You have tried and have found
fit.
I weep that every fit man’s shunted round
And left out of the place where he’d be
found
Alone worthy to raise the precious sound.

5 But one of the elders *and fair*
Said to me, “Do not weep. Indeed,
The Lion of Judah’s tribe’s *seed*,
The Root of David, has prevailed
To open the scroll and unveiled
To loose its seven seals *regaled*.”
6 And I looked, and indeed, between
The throne and the four beasts was seen,
And in the midst of elders, stood
A Lamb as though slain *for the good*,
With seven horns and seven eyes,
Which are seven spirits of God *and wise*
Sent out and into all the earth.

7 He came and took the scroll of worth
Out of the right hand of him who
Sat on the throne *for worship’s due*.

The lamb here is arnion quite a bit
Different from St. John’s amnos which with
wit
Is proclaimed son of God and loved as well.
This lamb arises after quite a spell,
After the called out groups that followed
Christ
Have sunk into apostasy surpliced.
This lamb is one come in the ordered time
After the seven “churches” reached their
prime.
Another messenger sent from Your hand
To break the seals that hold back and in
band
Hide the reforms needed to bring the folk
Back into Your fold from Satanic yoke
Denying on one hand Your unity
And on the other straying from Your fee.

8 Now when he had taken the scroll,
The four living creatures in roll
And the twenty-four elders fell
Down before the Lamb, each with *well-*
Tuned harp, and golden bowls filled up
With incense, which are the prayers’ *cup*
Of the saints. 9 And they sang a new
Song, saying “You are worthy to
Take the scroll, and to open its
Seals, for you were slain *by half-wits*,
And have redeemed them to *our* God
By your blood *spilt upon the sod*
Out of every tribe, tongue, and folk
And nation, 10 “And have *in one stroke*
Made them kings and priests to their God,
And they shall reign upon the earth.”

The lamb of the throne vision is obscure.
It’s certain what the book is, no book pure
Exists arising from that century
Except the holy Qur’an. But the free
Expected the lamb by the throne to be
Muhammad, till these words surprise the
soul
That climbed the whirling stair to reach the
goal
And found Judah’s lion to be none other
Than Ali cousin, Ahmed’s foster brother.
Ahmed was poisoned by the horrid flight

Of one who jealously saw him in sight,
 But Ali was the one who gave his blood
 Spilled on the masjid's floor and in a flood
 Of martyrdom that made us king and priest
 Who find in him the Qur'an's seals
 released.

11 Then I looked, and I heard the birth
 Of many angels' voices round
 The throne, the living creatures' *sound*,
 And the elders, their numbers found
 To rise to ten thousand times ten
 Thousand, thousands of thousands then,
 12 Saying with a loud voice, "The Lamb
 Who was slain *is an oriflamme*,
 Is worthy to receive the power
 Riches and wisdom *in the hour*,
 And strength and honour, glory too
 And blessing *from many and few!*"
 13 And every creature which is in
 Heaven and on the earth *without sin*
 And under the earth and such as
 Are in the sea, and all it has,
 I heard them saying "Blessing and
 Honour, glory, and power *stand*
 To him who sits upon the throne,
 And to the Lamb, forever *shown!*"
 14 Then the four living creatures said
 "Amen!" And the twenty-four *led*
 Elders fell down and worshipped him
 Who lives forever *and not dim*.

See here, Beloved, You have revealed to
 men
 That even those whose glory shines again,
 You give their blood to fertilize the grace
 Set on human hearts blinded in this place,
 Even the greatest of men are at last
 Not worshipped, but you only at the cast.
 Beloved, I honour Christ the witness of
 The victory over death and grave's glove,
 I honour the one by whose mouth revealed
 The holy Qur'an, and him who unsealed
 The meaning of Your revelation's yield.
 Jesus, Muhammad and Ali are steered,
 But You alone, Beloved, I find in field
 Worthy of worship, and enthroned above.

Revelation 6

[632-634 C.E.]

1 I saw when the Lamb opened one
 Of the seals, and then I heard one

Of the four living creatures saying
 With a voice like thunder *obeying*,
 "Come and see." 2 And I looked, indeed,
 A white horse. One sat on the steed
 With bow in hand, and given crown,
 He went out to conquer *the town*.

The start of the Islamic conquest takes
 The on-looker beyond what Ahmed makes
 To see Abu Bakr send general
 To the attack. Descent ephemeral
 Takes Bahrain, Oman, Yemen to return
 With Halid on to Syria and yet
 Beyond to Persia with its drawn lines met.
 A bow and crown are taken from the lamb
 And given to the rider on the scam,
 The fastest of apostasies that woke
 When any prophet died beneath the yoke.
 The caliphate was won with horse and rider,
 The father of Aisha stands beside her.

[634-644 C.E.]

3 When he opened the second seal,
 I heard the second living peal,
 Saying, "Come, see." 4 Another horse,
 Fiery red, went out *on the course*.
 And it was granted to the one
 Who sat on it to *stop the fun*
 And take peace from the earth, and that
 They'd kill one another *and spat*,
 And there was given him a great sword.

The same chief of the army that sat down
 With Abu Bakr to divide the crown
 Sits with Omar for decade of renown
 To take Damascus first for glamour town,
 And then defeat the Persians at Yarmak
 Before Kadesia broken in the sack.
 When Ktesefon surrendered, Kufa placed
 Itself beneath the Muslim rule effaced:
 Jaffa, Jerusalem, Aleppo and
 Antioch within four years of the stand,
 On to Egypt, and Isfahan and land
 Of Farsistan and Kushistan until
 The empire waited glowing on the hill.

[644-656 C.E.]

5 When he opened the third seal's *cord*,
 I heard the third living beast say,
 "Come and see." So I looked *that way*,
 And indeed, a black horse, and he
 Who sat on it had *wonderfully*

A pair of scales held in his hand.
6 And I heard a voice *of command*
Among the four living beasts saying,
“A quart of wheat for dinar paying,
And three quarts of barley for such,
And do not harm the oil *at all*
Nor the grape juice *upon the wall*. ”

Uthman gave the command to save the toil
Of everything that grew up in the soil
And not to destroy the earth when they rode
Out to the conquest of heathen abode.
The era of the black horse came to lie
Against all Persia and the northern sky
Of Africa until they too were torn
From heathendom and cast beneath the
thorn

Of those who usurped from the prophet all
As soon as his cold body hit the stall.
Beloved, I see the whirlwind conquest boil
Across the evening sky in chain and coil
Until the fateful day when Uthman caught
Assassin’s achievement of evil plot.

[656-661]

7 When he opened the fourth seal, I
Heard the voice of the fourth *reply*,
The living creature saying, “Come
And see.” 8 So I looked *at the chum*,
Behold, a pale horse. And the name
Of him who sat on it was Death,
And Hades followed his *hot breath*.
And power was given to them *for fame*
Over a fourth of the earth’s *claim*,
To kill with sword, hunger, and death,
And by the beasts *of Ashtoreth*.

The era of Ali when seen from view
Of the four caliphs is a dismal cue.
What waste of faith and teaching to set out
Against the Lord’s anointed with a doubt
To craze the land with civil war that burns
The innocent along with that which earns
The condemnation of both man and beast!
What waste of years in war that never
ceased!

Beloved, the pale horse that Ali must ride
Into the battle for the righteous side
Still glows upon the earth with dismal light
Since the great teaching’s rarely kept in
sight.

The white she-camel herself balks and brays

In horror of her mistress and her ways.

9 When he opened the fifth seal, I
Saw under the altar thereby
The selves of those who had been slain
For the word of God and *His reign*
And for the testimony which
They held in martyrdom’s *bewitch*.
10 And they cried with a loud voice, saying
“How long, O Lord, holy and true,
Until You judge *them for our slaying*
And avenge our blood on those *due*
Who live on the earth?” 11 Then a white
Robe was given to each *in sight*,
And it was said to them that they
Should rest a little longer day,
Until both the *number of* their
Fellow servants *should come to share*
With their brothers, who would be killed
As they *were*, till it was fulfilled.

In so few lines the great event that sacked
The world with darkness to awaken fact
Of righteousness is set out to be seen.
Karbala is the subject of the lean
Verses that tersely meet the clamour for
Justice that never yet came to the door.
Who indeed shall avenge Karbala’s blood?
The roses rise up like a drop in bud,
Burst open, sing a while and then are strewn
About the dry earth of Karbala soon
To fade forever. Still justice awaits
The coming of another, opened gates
Towards a city where the throne is set
And all the prophets and divine guides met.

12 I looked, he opened the sixth seal,
And indeed, there was *woe for weal*,
A great earthquake, the sun became
Black as sackcloth of hair *by name*,
And the moon became like to blood.

13 And the stars of heaven fell *in flood*
To earth, as fig tree drops its late
Figs when it’s shaken by a *great*
And mighty wind. 14 Then the sky rolled
Back like a scroll turned *in the cold*,
And every mountain, every isle
Was moved out of its place *awhile*.

15 And the kings of the earth, great men,
The rich, the rulers, and *again*,
The mighty, every slave and free,
Hid themselves in the caverns’ lea,

And in the mountain rocks to hide,
 16 And said to the mountains and rocks,
 "Fall on us and *do not abide*,
But hide us from the face *that shocks*
 Of Him who sits upon the throne
 And from the wrath of the Lamb *shown!*
 17 "For the great day of His wrath's come,
 And who can stand *millennium?*"

The sixth seal opens up the skies above
 To reveal what reaction comes of love
 To see the martyrdom upon the plain
 Of Karbala in destruction insane.
 The very stars are shaken with the wrath,
 The sun turned from its ever naked path,
 The moon turned hot and cold before the
 swathe
 Of slaughter at Karbala without gain.
 I see the lowering sky, I see the rain,
 I hear the cry despairing of the throats
 That drank a day in Karbala with gloats
 Only to rue their part until the day
 They call the mountains to fall and to sway
 And cover them from evil of their way.

Revelation 7

1 After these things it was I saw
 Four angels standing at *the draw*
Of the four corners of the earth,
 Holding the four winds of the earth,
 That the wind should not blow on earth,
 On the sea, or on any tree.

The effects of Karbala's slaughter wore
 Upon the heavens a sight like awl to bore,
 But still the aftermath rained on the earth
 And brought its winds to heel before the
 dearth
 Of righteousness until the time could show
 What men who see and do beneath the glow
 Of Karbala before the winds could blow.
 Beloved, I turn about the earth again
 In whirling to find out the names of men
 As well as those who call upon Your name.
 I see the four winds held as though in
 shame.
 Beloved, send angels still upon the ground
 To keep the strife from quenching faith in
 sound
 Of cantillation of Scriptures around.

2 I saw another angel fly

Ascending from the eastern sky,
 Having the seal of Living God.
 And he cried with a sounding prod
 To the four angels to whom it
 Was granted to harm earth befit
 And the sea, 3 saying "Do not harm
 The earth, the sea, or cause alarm
 To the trees till we've sealed the lot
 Of our God's servants *on a spot*
On their foreheads." 4 And then I heard
 How many on whom were conferred
 The seal: one hundred forty-four
 Thousand of all the tribes *ashore*
 Of Israel's children *got the score*.

When I was young there still were people
 who
 Spent sleepless nights in anguish over
 whether
 They numbered in the blessed throng and
 few.

The present generation altogether
 Could hardly care if they all went to hell.
 It's not for me to criticise or swear,
 Since I pretend to neither clientele.
 The worried ones need not have wasted
 prayer,
 Since all the sealed come from the chosen
 tribes.

But if there is salvation of the soul,
 Instead of thinking how so many scribes
 And Pharisees will fit so small a hole,
 I ask where in the whole world's population
 We're like to find so large a righteous
 nation.

5 Of Judah's tribe twelve thousand sealed,
 Of Reuben's tribe twelve thousand sealed,
 Of tribe of Gad twelve thousand sealed,
 6 Of Asher's tribe twelve thousand sealed,
 Of Naphtali twelve thousand sealed,
 Of Manasseh twelve thousand sealed,
 7 Of Simeon twelve thousand sealed,
 Of Levi's tribe twelve thousand sealed,
 Of Issachar twelve thousand sealed,
 8 Of Zebulun twelve thousand sealed,
 Of Joseph's tribe twelve thousand sealed,
 Of Benjamin twelve thousand sealed.

Ha! Now we count the tribes with Joseph as
 One tribe instead of two, just as twelve has!
 And yet the prophecy of Jacob's felt

Greatly enough to give a rose and welt,
 Rose to Ephraim for being younger son,
 And welt to Mannaseh for what he's done
 In being born the first. Ah well, just wait
 A verse or two and we shall not be late
 To see Joseph divided once again
 To have a double portion among men.
 Count me as one or two, Beloved, but be
 My only self to hide behind the tree
 Of my descent. Count twelve souls in my
 self
 And leave them all to rest upon the shelf.

9 After these things I looked, indeed,
 A great crowd which none could succeed
 In counting of all nations, tribes,
 Peoples, and tongues, *as one describes*,
 Standing before throne and before
 The Lamb, in the white robes they bore,
 And with palm branches in their hands,
 10 And crying out their loud commands,
 "Salvation *belongs* to our God
 Who sits on throne *above the sod*,
 And to the Lamb!" 11 The angels stood
 All around the throne *as they could*
 And elders and four living creatures
 All fell upon their faces' features
 Before the throne and worshipped God,
 12 Saying "Amen! Blessing and glory
 Wisdom, thanksgiving *auditory*
 And honour, power, and might *be* to
 Our God forever. Amen *due*."

Not only one hundred and forty-four
 Thousand of Israelites came in the door
 Of Your salvation at the call of blood
 Shed by the Euphrates as though in flood.
 A mighty crowd of people joined the race
 To worship You alone, before Your face
 To stand in the light shed by sacrifice
 Of self and family before the vice
 Of Yezid and the armies of the cool
 Who follow anyone who's got a tool.
 Beloved, let me be of that crowd of men
 Who stood up once entranced to find again
 That You had sent Your divine guide to find
 A way to human hearts, even the blind.

13 And one of the elders answered,
 Said to me, "Who are these preferred
 In white robes, and whence did they come?"
 14 And I said to him, "Sir, *the sum*

You know." So he said to me, "These
 Are the ones who came out of ease
 Into great tribulation, and
 Washed their robes and made them *in hand*
 White. 15 "Therefore they are there before
 God's throne, and serve Him by day's *score*
 And night in His palace's *store*.
 And He who sits on throne will live
 Among them 16 "and will never give
 Them hunger any more nor thirst,
 The sun shall not strike them, nor burst
 Upon them any heat. 17 "The Lamb
 Who's in the midst of the throne's *jamb*
 Will shepherd them and lead them to
 Living fountains of waters *new*.
 And God will wipe away each tear
 From every eye *and all their fear*."

Ali meets every martyr on the path
 To paradise a fleeing from the wrath
 Of persecutor to hold out a cup
 Of green and alabaster, hold it up
 Filled to the brim with nectar and the dew
 Of Kauthar, enough for many and few.
 Beloved, let me be of the crowd that finds
 The way to that place where no hunger
 binds,
 And where the sun shall never strike again
 The thirsty children and the thirsty men.
 Let me be of those who serve at Your
 throne
 Without the memory of tiring bone
 Before the battle on Karbala shown.
 Beloved, wipe Karbala's tears away then.

O seventh son and bright eternal day,
 Rest and reward that shines out from the
 throne,
 Beloved, feed me, lead me to my own,
 Where it may be, however long the way.
 Dumb lamb and day and hour of silent
 grief,
 Let my tears now be shed in penitence,
 A Sabbath night-work done in my defence,
 Beside the thorn and flower, the fruit, and
 leaf.
 In judgement, when it comes, wipe out my
 tear
 With morning light, clear Sabbath Day and
 bright,
 Beyond the storm and into the full fight
 That overcomes eternally this fear.

And I shall stand in middle places bare
And look on all around me everywhere.

Revelation 8

1 When he opened the seventh seal,
There was silence in heaven, no peal
For half an hour or so. 2 And I
Saw seven angels who stand by
God, and to them were given horns
Seven in number for their bourns.

The effects of Karbala's sacrifice
Are seen not only in the skies a trice,
Nor among the faithful of men on earth.
The effects go beyond the heat and dearth
To touch those too who fail to follow You,
Beloved, in what they know, believe, and
do.

The seven trumpets lifted in the sight
Of humankind leading to Husayn's plight
And following his death before the row
Will sound and resound in the world
somehow
Until the traitor and usurping brow
Is buried in the depth of judgement's night.
Beloved, hasten the day when all are
brought
To judgement and the punishments are
sought.

3 Another angel, one who had
A golden censer *unforbade*,
Came and stood at the altar. He
Was given much incense *for free*,
That he should offer *it* with prayers
Of all the saints upon the *stairs*
Of golden altar there before
The throne *at heaven's open door*.
4 The smoke of incense, with the prayers
Of saints, ascended *unawares*
Before God from the angel's hand.
5 Then the angel took *in his hand*
The censer, and filled it with fire
From the altar, and threw *with ire*
Upon the earth. And there were sounds
Thunderings and lightnings *making rounds*,
And an earthquake. 6 And the angels
Seven in number who blew spells
On seven trumpets stood to sound
With trumpet blasts on earth around.

The sound of the angelic trumpets brings

The faithful to their prayers for all the
things

The din of horns cause on the earth where
they
Still live to fast, give alms, and hope and
pray.

The timing of the trumpets comes about
The massacre at Karbala in rout,
It gives the prologue to the crime and then
Delineates the perpetrating men
And those who follow in the wake to make
Umayyad empire strong for evil's sake.
Beloved, I see the history written out
In the prophetic word, and hear the shout
Of rise and fall before the wicked clout
Of caliphs that come in Karbala's wake.

[661-680 C.E.]

7 The first angel sounded: and hail
And fire followed, mingled with *grail*
Of blood, and they were thrown to earth.
And a third of the trees in worth
Were burned up, and all green grass too
Was burned up. [680-683 C.E.] 8 Then
upon his cue

The second angel sounded: and
Like a great mountain burning brand
Was thrown into the sea, a third
Of the sea became blood *conferred*.
9 And a third of the living creatures
In the sea died *and all their features*,
And a third of ships were destroyed.

Some say the burning brand was the Qur'an
Sent out to light the world by divine plan.
It was indeed sent out upon the sea
To fill the world with prose and poetry.
But when the sweet words had been spoken
free

Against Monophysitic heresy,
They returned from the noble air to fall
Into the clutch and Ummayyidic pall.
Like Bible, the Qur'an became the sword
That once softened with hope but turned
and gored

In hands of tyrants. O my loving Lord,
Take back Your books and Your commands
from me
And show me once Your kingdom as
restored,
Your throne high above earth, and You
adored.

The first angel blew warning trumpet and
Mu'awiyah came out to rule the land
And slaughter a third of the earth in band.
He poisoned holy Hasan grandson of
The prophet and the one he held in love,
Chewed for the babe in arms the full date
meat

And gave it to the child to taste a treat.
That child Mu'awiyah instead of date
From the lips of the prophet, in his hate
Fed poison, may a curse lie on his head.
Beloved, I weep to think that hand that
spread
With tiny fingers the prophet's beard, lay
Still in death from the poison's wicked way,
Despite the blood that flowed in him as late.

The second angel blew a warning blast
That water should turn to blood from the
mast.

Yezid stepped in to rule instead
Of his evil father upon the spread
Of earth, and set destruction of the true
And faithful to relieve the threat that due
Justice might fall upon him. Let him drink
Blood since he kept the water from the
brink

Of Hussein and his followers and slew
The best of humankind with devilish crew.
Indeed he is a man of blood, the horn
That shows a sea of blood of the forlorn
Exaggerates in nothing. Beloved, lay
A curse upon his head then and today.

[684 C.E.]

10 Then the third angel trump employed:
And a great star fell from the sky,
Burning like a torch falling by
A third of the rivers and springs
Of water. 11 And the star's name rings
Out Wormwood. A third of the waters
Became wormwood *and wormwood's*
daughters,

And many men died from the waters,
Because it was made bitter there
And poisoned both their drink and air.

What guiding, shining star did You raise
high,
Beloved, to shine above and in the sky?
Muhammad, the Qur'an, the Ahlilbayt?

See how brightly in heaven is their rate,
And how when they appear upon the earth
Men turn all hope and glory into dearth.
The water of Islam is bitter now,
The people of Islam are still somehow
In poisoned reaches, despite the great fact
That teaching of Islam is closer act
To Your word than the Christian comes to
sell.

Beloved, the wormwood worship that befell
The world after Muhammad's still a spell.

The third angel blows warning blast to
show

The second Mu'awiyah on the go,
A drunkard and a profligate was he,
And yet retained the name and fame and fee
Of caliph and commander of the free
And faithful, such was his great blasphemy.
Give him to drink the wormwood with his
wine,

Beloved, when he comes in the tent to dine,
And let its poison corrupt every vein
And cell from his toe to his pickled brain.
Beloved, cast every curse on caliph set
Before the faithful to persecute yet.
One Mu'awiyah should have been enough
To beat and slaughter and to give the cuff.

[684-685 C.E.]

12 Then the fourth angel winded trump:
And a third of the sun with bump
Was struck, a third of the moon, and
A third of the stars *in command,*
So that a third of them were dark.
A third of the day too was *stark*
Within the veil of the night's park.

Though Marwan lived to reign another year
Beyond the months of Mu'awiyah's fear,
He was no better than his predecessor
Who drank his liquor before the confessor.
His reign was reign of darkness and the
thrall

Of hopelessness to everyone and all
Except the faith sparked by Hussein rose up
To bring a fragrance to the bitter cup.
Beloved, I too live in a dark fed world
Where violence in every flag's unfurled.
I turn to you with hope the divine seat
Will bring into judgement the strong and
meet.

Then Marwan's kind will be turned back
again
From leading from faith into sin all men.

13 And I looked, and I heard *once more*
An angel fly from heaven's *door*,
Saying with a loud voice, "Woe, woe,
Woe to the dwellers on earth's row,
Because of the remaining blasts
Of trumpets of three angels' casts
Who are about to sound contrasts!"

Revelation 9

[685-705 C.E.]

1 Then the fifth angel sounded: and
I saw a star from heaven's hand
Fall to the earth. To him they gave
The key to the bottomless grave.
2 And he opened the great abyss,
And smoke arose up out of this
Pit like the smoke of a great furnace.
So sun and air were dark *to churn us*
Because of the smoke of the pit.

The final prophet rose to heaven's height,
And took the lion's ring in forty's sight,
Then fell down to the earth as though in
fright
To bring Your mighty word and heaven's
light.
He opened the fair desert gates to fill
The earth with truth and hope and fervour
still,
And sent his messengers to every land
To bring the Qur'an's message to each hand.
But what is this! The quick apostasy
As soon as prophet died, the false decree
Went forth to make Abu Bakr to be
The leader of the faithful Muslim folk.
And so the burning fire turned choking
smoke
From Axum to Jerusalem in cloak.

When Abdul-Malik rose in the minbar
To abuse Ali, though Your greatest star,
He opened the abyss and let the smoke
Out to choke every Sunnite wench and
bloke.

Beloved, since that day cinders come to fall
Around the world creating such a pall
That few can find their way along the track
Of the Imamate to guide people back

To the faith once revealed to Abraham,
To Adam, Noah, Moses' anagram,
To David, Jesus and Muhammad when
The pinnacle of faith came down to men
And Ali opened up the mysteries
Of the last book of revelation's fees.

3 Then out of the smoke locusts *fit*
Came upon the earth. And to them
Was given power *in stratagem*,
As scorpions on earth have power.
4 They were commanded at that hour
Not to harm the grass of the earth,
Or any green thing, tree of worth,
But only those men who do not
Have the seal of God *on a spot*
On their foreheads. 5 And they were not
Given *authority* to kill
Them, but to torment them *at will*
For five months. Their torment *was* like
The torment when the scorpions strike.

The conquests of Abdul-Malik were like
The torment of scorpions when they strike,
And month after month armies went their
way
Like locusts on the fields of green and day.
You gave the power to men to fashion thus
Their destiny, and kings will always fuss
To run themselves to hell. Beloved, the
green
Thing in the offing always leaves the scene
When locusts have relentlessly in cloud
Alighted on the sod in swarming crowd.
I look about me for the seal of God
Set on the forehead that has met the sod
In prayer, and know that You are still here
to
Raise up in power and bring down to the
dew.

6 In those days men will seek death and
Will not find it *with fire-brand*,
They will desire to die, and death
Will flee from them *at every breath*.

7 The shape of the locusts was like
Horses prepared for battle-strike.
On their heads were crowns of something
Like gold, and their faces *looking*
Like faces of men. 8 They had hair
Like women's hair, and their teeth's *share*
Was like the lions'. 9 And they had

Breastplates like iron breastplates bad,
 And the sound of their wings *was* like
 The sound of chariots *and pike*
 With horses running into war.
 10 They had tails like scorpions' *store*,
 And there were stings upon their tails.
 Their power to hurt men *overveils*
 Five months. 11 And they had as a king
 Over them messenger coming
 Up from the bottomless pit, whose
 Name in Hebrew's Abaddon's *crews*,
 But in Greek he's called by the name
 Apollyon *which indeed's the same*.
 12 One woe is past. Behold, still two
 More woes are coming in their due.

The Arab hordes that came out to the fray
 Of the Umayyad bid to rule the day
 Indeed rode like the wind and set their hair
 To blowing long behind them black and
 bare.

The lovely horses were a charming sight
 And the brave riders churning in the light.
 But they unfortunately joined the fight
 Under Abaddon, the Destroyer's night.
 Beloved, I see the cloud of men stung still
 To the quick hoping for death to fulfil
 Desires of life, but one man found the door
 Into the hereafter from poisoned store
 Of Abdul-Malik, and his song on scene
 Remained silent for Zeynul-Abiddin.

[705-715 C.E.]

13 Then the sixth angel winded horn
 And I heard voice *on the air borne*
 From four horns of the altar golden
 Which is before God *to embolden*,
 14 Saying to the sixth angel who
 Had the trumpet, "Release the crew
 Of four angels whose hands are tied
 At Euphrates great riverside."
 15 So the four angels, who had been
 Prepared for the hour *and the scene*,
The day and month and year, were set
 To kill a third of mankind yet.

Restraining winds at last were set upon
 The river of Euphrates, and the dawn
 Of the Umayyad power turned into noon
 When Walid the First came without a boon.
 The full force of the hurricane of fate

From Abu Sofyan's loins came down with
 hate
 Upon the human fortress and estate,
 The winds came loose upon that fateful
 date.
 Beloved, Your hand controls the times of
 men
 And gives to each the choice of right again
 Or wrong, and each lifts heart and hand to
 do
 According to the reward of the true
 Or for the punishment chosen in bait.
 Beloved, Your calendar is never late.

16 The number of the army of
 The horsemen two hundred above
 Millions, I heard their number spoken.
 17 And thus I saw the horses' token
 In the vision: those who sat on
 Them had breastplates upon them drawn
 In fiery red, hyacinth blue,
 And sulphur yellow *shining too*,
 And the heads of the horses *were*
 Like the heads of lions *with fur*,
 And out of their mouths came fire, smoke,
 And brimstone *like enough to choke*.

The very colour of the soldiers' cloak
 Stands here by Your prophetic word that
 spoke
 Your Messiah to angel and to send
 To John to write to all who would amend
 Their ways and hear Your word that brings
 life to
 Both martyrs and the faithful living crew.
 Ummayad armies filled the river land
 And spread through Middle East and to
 expand
 Throughout the north of Africa and yet
 Into Andalusia where was met
 The highpoint of the European set.
 Beloved, even the unfaithful that stand
 Beneath the Qur'an's banners lend a hand
 To civilized attractions that they get.

18 By these three a third of mankind
 Were killed: by fire and smoke in kind
 And the brimstone which came out at
 Their mouths. 19 For their power and
 strength sat
 In their mouth and for their tails sakes,
 For their tails *indeed are* like snakes,

With heads, and with them they do harm.
 20 But the rest of the human farm,
 Who were not killed by these plagues'
 bands,
 Did not repent works of their hands,
 That they should not worship demons,
 And idols of gold, *or their sons*
Of silver, brass, stone, and wood, which
 Can neither see nor hear *a stitch*
 Nor yet walk. 21 They did not repent
 Of their murders, *did not relent*
 From their sorceries or their lewd
 Fornications or thefts in feud.

The plague of the Ummayad's brought
 about
 The knowledge of Your revelation stout
 In the Qur'an, and yet men did not rise
 To repent of their evil in the eyes
 Of God, but still in all sorts of disguise
 Continue their idolatry to make
 The last great faith a mockery at stake.
 Beloved, make me one faithful to the lamb
 And to the book unveiled before the scam
 Of this world's kingdoms. Let me the words
 take
 Upon my tongue to cantillate and then
 Obey each glowing syllable again.
 No matter what the others do or try
 Reprove me of idolatry thereby.

Revelation 10

[702-765 C.E.]

1 I saw yet one more angel come
 Down from the sky's exordium,
 And clad in cloud with rainbow on
 His head and with a face like sun,
 And feet like pillars of fire run.
 2 He had a booklet spread in hand,
 And set his right foot on the sea
 And *his left foot* upon the land,
 3 And cried with a loud voice, and see
 As *when* a lion roars. When he
 Cried out, seven thunders gave voice.

Muhammad Baqir is not mentioned here,
 Nor is the one who poisoned him in fear.
 Instead the word rushes on to the fame
 Of Ja'fer As-Sadiq, whose blessed name
 Is noted for the bringing of right law
 In the voice of a lion and the claw
 Of seven thunders kept in secret till

He should stand with foot upon both hill
 And sea. Beloved, the rainbow at his head
 Reflects the throne upon which You instead
 Are seated rather than the kings that fell
 When the Ummayads went down into hell.
 Beloved, the thunders now are clear to tell
 In what the Truthful one rang like a bell.

4 Now when the seven thunders' choice
 Of words was said, I thought to write,
 But I heard a voice from heaven *quite*
 Saying to me, "Seal up the things
 Which the seven thunders' voice sings,
 And do not write them." 5 Then the grand
 Angel standing on sea and land
 I saw raised up to heaven his hand
 6 And swore by Him who lives to be
 Forever and eternally,
 Who created heaven and the things
 That are in it, the earth and things
 That are in it, the sea and things
 That are in it, that there should be
 No longer time, 7 but in the days
 The seventh angel's sounding sways,
 When he's about to sound, the sum
 Of God's secret would then be done,
 As He declared to prophets *true*
Who were of old His servant crew.

The law is now perfected in the book,
 The little book from Ja'fer's glowing nook,
 And time there is no longer, none to raise
 A new law or a prophet in our days.
 The secrets are revealed, all time has gone,
 The revelation met both noon and dawn,
 And now is only to hear what You bade
 Both men and women to do on parade,
 And now is only to follow the craft
 Of Ja'fer who is the last one who's laughed.
 Beloved, I look above the sea and land,
 I see the splendoured rainbow on the sand,
 And take the little book to heart and mind
 And learn the lessons of the pure and kind.

8 The voice which I heard from the sky
 Spoke to me again and said *nigh*,
 "Go, take the little book that's by
 The angel open, and who stands
 Upon the sea and on the lands."
 9 So I went to the angel and
 Said to him, "Give the book *in hand*."
 And he said to me, "Take and eat,

In stomach bitter, but as sweet
As honey in your mouth *for treat.* ”

10 Then I took the little book out
Of the angel’s hand, *looked about,*
And ate it, and it was as sweet
As honey in my mouth *for treat.*
But when I’d eaten it, I found
My stomach bitter *all around.*
11 And he said to me, “You must still
Prophesy again to fulfil
To many peoples, nations, and
Tongues, and kings *at the Lord’s*
command. ”

Though time of revelation’s at an end,
It does not mean there’s nothing left to
spend
In suffering. There is still to follow on
The course of the true law from dawn to
dawn,
There’s still to cantillate the honeyed words
And find the application among birds
Is bitter in the belly when the weight
Of the world goes against Your command’s
freight.
There’s still to stand before nations and
kings,
The Abbassids have not yet taken wings,
And many martyrs still await their death
Despite the fact Hussein is out of breath.
Beloved, I eat the book to taste the sweet
And find the bitter waiting at my feet.

Revelation 11

1 Then I was given a *singing* reed
Like measuring rod. And *then indeed*
The angel stood, saying “Rise and
Measure God’s temple *by command,*
The altar, and who worship there.
2 “But leave the outer courtyard bare,
And do not measure it, for it
Has been set to the Gentiles’ fit,
And they will tread the holy site
Underfoot forty-two months’ right.

The treading of Jerusalem in night
Is found in the days that the dome in light
Was build upon the holy temple site.
The measuring of those who worship there
Goes on with Muhammad Baqir for share
And with Ja’fer as-Sadiq who delight

In Your law, My Beloved, though nations
fight

To tread the holy place under their feet.
Beloved, I come to You with what is meet,
And enter in the sacred room for treat
And see the people bowing to Your name,
And gaze at the dark red columns of fame,
One man of treading nations as though I
Had lived under Imam Ja’fer’s clear sky.

3 “And I will give *power* to my two
Witnesses, and they will come to
Prophesy one thousand and two
Hundred and sixty days, clothed in
Sackcloth *to cover their bare skin.* ”

The many days here are merely the half
Of seven, as is forty-two month gaff
When every month has thirty days, it seems
Symbolic calendar contains the dreams
Of only three hundred and sixty days.
The two witnesses are also waylaid
By symbolism soon set on parade.
Beloved, let me too be a witness for
The prophesying of Your Word in store
As I cantillate Hebrew flights that soar
Above the din of pagan worship’s clown,
As I recite the Qur’an to the town
That turns its face to partying instead,
Since alcohol goes faster to the head.

4 These are the two olive trees and
The two lampstands before the hand
Of the God of all of the earth.

5 And if any *person of girth*
Wants to harm them, fire proceeds from
Their mouth devouring *all the scum*
Of their foes. And if anyone
Wants to harm them, he must be done
In by this manner. 6 These have power
To shut the sky, so that no rain
Falls in the days *and in the hour*
Of their prophecy, and they’ve power
Over the waters to turn them
To blood, and to strike the earth’s *hem*
With all plagues *by their stratagem.*

The Bible and Qur’an bear up the weight
Of the Four Books installed and fraught
with fate
Of olive trees to give the oil to burn

And two lampstands revealing what they
earn.

The book unsealed stands here to witness
well

In the street of Jerusalem to tell

The confirmation of the witness brought
Of Jesus who was sent to those unbought
By Roman threat and greed and failed to
make

Peace with idolatry for Your One's sake;
The confirmation of the witness told
To Abraham and Moses and the bold
David who sent back to the humble fold
Of Bethlehem to get a drink of cold.

7 When they have finished their witness,
The beast ascending from abyss
Will make war on them, overcome,
And kill them. 8 And their corpses' sum
In the great city's street that's known
As the spiritual Sodom
And Egypt, where also was shown
Our Lord crucified. 9 Then *those* from
The peoples, tribes, and tongues, and
nations

Will see their corpses *in their stations*
Three and a half days, and not let
Their corpses be put in graves yet.

10 And those who live on earth will joy
Over them, make merry, employ
Gifts to each other *for their sake*,
Because both of these prophets make
Torment for those who live on earth.

Two prophets rose after Muhammad's time
According to this word of truth and rhyme,
And yet they do not foil the seal once set
Upon Muhammad's words to be one met
The last prophet upon earth's face and
clime.

They are the prophets of Bible and that
Book You Yourself held out to what lamb
sat

Alone worthy to unseal and to make
Known to the world the final divine stake.
Two prophets rise and still meet those who
claim

To love You and rejoice upon Your name
And yet cut down the one or other or
Both to burn in the refuse of the shore
Of doubt and ridicule. Beloved, no more.

11 After three and a half days' girth
The breath of life from God returned
To them, and they stood on their feet,
And great fear fell on those *and burned*
Those who saw them *in their retreat*.

12 And they heard a loud voice from
heaven
Saying to them, "Come up to heaven."
And they ascended to the sky
In a cloud while their foes stood by.

Beloved, You have received up in the sky
The books and prophets from the evil fly
That would destroy them publicly or by
The secret undermining of their truth
To teach wickedness to both old and youth.
How few retain the blessing of Your word
In every place that blessing has occurred!
I stop to sip the fresh and healing balm
Of Torah, Gospel, Qur'an and of Psalm,
And find in all Your Decalogue is meet
To resound for both law and for a treat.
Beloved, I find the dear letter is filled
With breath of life, though many times it's
killed

By priest, rabbi and mullah for the swilled.

13 In the same hour there was a great
Earthquake, and fell tenth of the state.
Seven thousand folk in the quake
Were killed, and the rest *for their sake*
Were frightened and gave glory to
The God of heaven *as is due*.

Before the birth of the Mahdi there came
A warning earthquake in Quds in his name
To show that cataclysmic power confounds
The din of false worship where it resounds.
With seven thousand deaths attention to
The birth of the Mahdi is soon in view,
And those who would oppose his new estate
Sent to their graves and barzakh to be late
Upon the day of judgement when Your call
Shall return to memory the works of all.
Beloved, the earthquake sent upon the town
To cleanse it from false worship and
renown

Of Abbasid and Umayyad still speaks
To every soul that innocently seeks.

14 The second woe is past. Indeed,
The third woe's coming here with speed.

15 The seventh angel sounded loud:
And there were loud voices to crowd
The sky, saying "The kingdoms of
This world have become *kingdoms* of
Our Lord and of his Christ, and he
Shall reign on them eternally!"

The seventh angel proclaims the last birth
Of any sent by You of greater worth,
Predicting that the Mahdi would be soon
Born on the earth and so provide a boon.
With his birth all is finished and the crown
And kingdom is made up in every town,
And You have Your Christ and in great
renown

Your Mahdi to join the heavenly estate
Of Enoch and Elijah and the rate
Of prophets and divine guide who await
The resurrection for Your kingdom's date.
Beloved, I rejoice in the trumpet sound
That proclaims Your beloved upon the
ground
And seek him and his will where he is
found.

16 And the twenty-four elders who
Sat before God on their thrones too
Fell on their faces in prostration
Before God, 17 saying *in their station*:
"We give You thanks, Lord God Almighty,
Creator without one to fight You,
The One who is and who was and
Who is to come, because You stand
In Your great power and reign. 18 The
nations
Were angry, and Your wrath *in rations*
Has come, and the time of the dead,
That they should be in judgement led,
And that You should reward the ones
Who serve You as prophets, *not sons*,
And the saints, and whom fear Your name,
Small and great, and destroy the same
Who destroy earth." 19 In heaven above
The temple of God *and His love*
Was opened and for all to see
Appeared ark of testimony
In His temple *eternally*,
And there were lightnings, noises, and
Thunderings, and an earthquake, and
Great hail *cast out upon the land*.

I see the heavenly temple open wide

And I see there what shall for ever bide,
The ark of covenant and sealed within
The Decalogue that tells me what is sin
And what is righteousness and what is joy
To find You on the Sabbath to employ
Your healing names in recitation till
The temple of my heart begins to fill
With lightnings, noises, thunderings and yet
And earthquake and great hail on all things
met.

Beloved, the message of the Mahdi still
Resounds in every place affirming all
That's written on the tablets to recall
The golden letters engraved on the wall.

Revelation 12

[869-876 C.E.]

1 A great sign appeared in the sky:
A woman clad in the sun's eye,
Moon under foot, and on her head
A diadem twelve stars *embed*.
2 Being with child, she cried in pain
And labour to give birth *in vain*.

Some say the woman is the church of God.
I say there is no such thing on the sod,
But all reject at least one command set
Upon the table of stone and well met.
Some say the woman is Mary the wife
Of Joseph after she had born for strife
The holy child Jesus who came to make
Your Decalogue on tables for flesh' sake.
But he was born eight centuries before
The rising of this vision on the shore.
Narjis alone fulfils the complement
Of signs here written and of signs down
sent.

Beloved, I seek the son of Narjis still
And find him speaking to me with a thrill.

3 Another sign in heaven appeared:
Behold a great red dragon seared
With seven heads and ten horns, and
Seven crowns on his heads command.
4 His tail drew out a third of stars
From heaven and threw them *down like jars*
Upon the earth. The dragon stood
Before the woman when she should
Give birth to eat up her child soon
As it was born *and she aswoon*.

Abbasid caliphs also knew to hate

The truth and those who honour it in state,
And came always with poison but not
sword

Like the Umayyads who dreaded no horde.
Satanic dragon comes down to inspire
The beastly states of earth and to admire
Their wickedness upon those sent from
You.

And so the red dragon came into view
In person to devour the child anew.
The caliph could not find the hidden one,
But there was a Satan who would have done
Directly, except that You send a wave
Of salvation to keep him from the grave.
Beloved, I curse the dragon and his son.

5 She gave birth to a man child who
Should rule all nations *when he grew*
With rod of iron. And her child was
Caught up to God and throne *from jaws*.

Some say that Jesus Christ was born and
then
Was caught up alive in the sight of men
And missed the cross that took another life
To end the persecution and the strife.
Some say that Jesus met his death at last
And never lived again once die was cast
For the white tunic seamless that he wore.
Some say he slept within the broken shore
Of the new tomb to waken at the song
Of the archangel and the singing throng.
It seems that no one knows what really fell
Upon Your prophet, son and servant shell,
Messiah to the final breath and bell.
But here he is caught up alive, do tell.

The fact is this woman is not the great
And famous Mary, but one come too late
To share such glory on the earth and sky.
The woman's Narjis, the date does not lie.
Jesus was born eight centuries before:
Now the Mahdi's turn to enter the door.
He is the only famous one to fit
The prophecy in time and circumstance,
The events with cave, birth, and horse and
wit.

All others circle the words in a mocking
dance.

Beloved, let me live still to follow all
The words of the Mahdi and hear his call,
While others run to fetch the dragon's mane

And pray and peregrine for greater gain.

6 The woman fled into the wild,
Into a place *and undefiled*
Prepared by God, that they should feed
Her there as long as she might need
It was one thousand two hundred
And sixty days *that she was fed*.

Beloved, let me be one of those who sought
Their refuge in the wilderness and bought
In silence and in meditation rare
The sight of You in all Your glory fair.
With Kelpius I make my humble way
Along the streams that glint with light of
day,

One of the women of the desert's call
To keep Your ten commandments though
I'm small.

The Wissahickon now is overgrown
With other ways and means to meet Your
throne,

But where I stand by lichen on the stone
I keep within my burning heart the dance
Of spirit through the forest gleams askance
To live within the righteous crumbling
manse.

What saved the Mahdi's mother when he
fled

Into Your palaces there to be fed?
History tells little of that brave wife's reign
And how she lived a widow without gain,
And sought her bread within the wilderness
Where secretly her son sent her address
A piece of bread, a bag of dates, a note
Telling how much he loved her as he wrote.
Few think how homeless and alone the two
Once separated became for the vile
Opposing of the commander a while
Of the faithful in title usurped till
The day of judgement reveal all Your will
And reunite mother and son for quill.

If we count day for year, prophetic time,
We see the start and end of wicked crime:
Twelve hundred sixty years passed by in
grief

From the day that Mu'awiyah in brief
Began his awful reign, year six six one,
To when Transjordan slid out of the fun
Of rule and school and pool of Ottoman

In the year nineteen twenty-one when done.
Beloved, the fast was long, the empires
 grand
Fulfilled the running of the flood and sand,
But as the time of ending all returns,
I rush into the coming fire that burns
All needless and superfluous from me
To step at last into eternity.

7 And war broke out in heaven above:
Michael and his angels *with shove*
Fought with the dragon, and the beast
And his angels fought *not the least*,
8 But they did not prevail, nor was
A place found in heaven for their claws.
9 So the great dragon was cast out,
That serpent of old, called *in rout*
The Devil and Satan, the one
Who deceives the whole world *begun*,
He was cast to the earth along
With his angels *to sing their song*.
10 I heard then a loud voice to say
In heaven, “Salvation’s *come to stay*,
And strength and kingdom of our God,
The power of his Christ on the sod,
For our brothers’ accuser’s cast
Down, who accused them to the last
Before God day and night. 11 “And they
Overcame him by the blood’s *sway*
Of the Lamb and by the word of
Their martyrdom, they did not love
Their lives to the death *in the way*.

As described in the holy book of Job,
Satan that wily old serpent to probe
Once could enter into the heavenly scene
And the angelic council’s boisterous lien.
But now with the birth of the final man,
Awaited longest in the faithful scan,
The devil’s power is shut down at a draw
And he is fenced on earth alone with claw
Bent to the soil. No longer can he foil
The faithful with accusing rant and coil.
The martyrdom of Ali and Hussein
Grant grace and victory over the pain
That one can inflict on the earthly plain,
While heavenly kingdom opens at the toil.

12 “Therefore rejoice, O heavens, and you
Who live in them! But woe unto
The dwellers on the earth and sea!
For the devil’s come down to you,

With great wrath, for he knows *it’s true*
That he has but an hour or two.”

13 Now when the dragon saw that he
Had been cast down to the earth, he
Persecuted the woman who
Gave birth to the man child with crew.

The persecution of Narjis is known
But little among those before Your throne,
While those who write the books of history
Ignore the lady who gave wondrously
Birth to the son who should bring justice to
The world and set all men to worship You.
The dragon’s wrath is clear in all the world
Where the flag of violence is unfurled,
And pretence of faith brings the multitude
Into the unity of evil crude
Under the smile of pretence and the wealth
Of gold and oil, of marbled halls and
 stealth.

Beloved, I wait that hour or two to find
The coming of the Mahdi to the rind.

14 But the woman was given two wings
Of a great eagle, *of all things*,
That she might fly into the wild
To her place, where she unbeguild
Is fed for a time, *two* times and
A half of time, from before hand
Of the serpent. 15 The serpent spewed
Water out of his mouth *like stewed*
After the woman, that he might
Cause her to be borne from her right
By the flood. 16 But the earth came to
The woman’s rescue, opened too
Its mouth and swallowed up the flood
Which the dragon had spewed *like blood*
Out of his mouth. 17 The dragon’s rage
Was kindled at the woman’s *wage*,
And he went out to make a war
With the rest of her offspring’s *score*,
Who keep God’s commandments in sum,
Having Jesus Christ’s martyrdom.

Narjis is rescued by the wondered act
That You produced to fulfil the earth
 cracked

To take the flood of abuse that was poured
Upon her when her son left unadored
Was separated from the mother’s stored.
No human hand came to help in her need.

The earth was filled with false faith and
with greed.

With wings divine she finds a refuge in
The desert where she's hidden from the sin
The priest and caliph, such as claim to be
Your representatives upon the lea.
Beloved, let me join her in her retreat,
Let me sink to kiss Narjis' bleeding feet,
And comfort her that her son's gone and
free.

The word for martyrdom is witnessing,
A bearing testimony to the thing.
It is no death, but rising up to see
And tell the world of Your eternity.
The woman in the wilderness became
The mother of myself and those whose
fame

Is covered with the secrets of the wood.
I might say who they are, but if I should
The public cry would follow them again
And try to slay the remnant of such men.
I take hold of the ten commandments proud
And wrap me in the flowing witness shroud
Of Jesus Christ and say Your name aloud
While hidden in the woman's holy glen.

Revelation 13

[876-1258 C.E.]

1 Then I stood on sand of the sea,
And saw a beast rise up to be
Out of the sea, having seven heads
And ten horns, and upon his heads'
Horns ten crowns, and on his heads name
Of blasphemy, a name of shame.

The Abbassid empire broke into pieces
Expressed in ten heads and the crowns it
leases

To seven. So we find fragmented where
Umayyads ruled the land and sea and air.
Though broken, the heads of the beast are
clear

In following the commands laid for fear
By the dragon to persecute and hate
The followers of the Mahdi in state,
The woman of the wilderness and late
Messiah Jesus come to rule their fate.
Beloved, I see the beast continue on
Despite Your kingdom's flourishing at
dawn.

I turn to You from earth's vain faiths and
froth

And meet in You Your love instead of
wrath.

2 Now the beast which I saw was like
A leopard, *one about to strike*,
His feet were like *the feet of bear*,
And his mouth like the mouth beware
Of lion. The dragon gave him
His power, his throne, and his great vim.

The caliphate continued in the steps
Of the beasts Daniel saw for kingdoms'
reps:

The kingdom of Rome and of Greece to fail,
The golden lion of Babylon's tail,
The Medes and Persians coming without
grail,

And at last the beast finds the seat of power
Given at Baghdad for a time and hour.
The caliphate incorporates the hate
And strength of every kingdom come of late
To pretend to the faith of God and home
And yet is no better than pagan Rome.
Beloved, I see the awful heathen will
That tainted governments and their kings'
chill

With falsehood and with power on plain
and hill.

3 And one of his heads as if it
Had been mortally wounded *fit*,
And his deadly wound had been healed.
And all the world marvelled and reeled
After the beast. 4 So they bowed down
Before the dragon who gave crown
To the beast, and bowed to the beast,
Saying, "Who's like the beast? At least,
Who's able to make war with him?"

Many vicissitudes came marching on
The Abbassids, not only from the dawn
But from the west, the Fatimids and spawn,
Before the hordes of Mongols struck the
blow

Fatal to Baghdad and caliphate's show.
But nothing stopped the mastery of fate
To pretend to be ruler of the state
Of heaven and earth and representative
Of You, Beloved, to all who die and live.
Beloved, I know no earthly kingdom can

Represent You before the holy span
Of heavenly throne, and so I take my place
In hiding before Abbassidic race.
I hide in You, Your mercy and Your grace.

5 And he was given a mouth and grim
Speaking great things and blasphemies,
And he was given power to please
For forty-two months. 6 Then he set
His mouth in blasphemy *to fret*
Against God, to blaspheme His name,
His tabernacle, and *for shame*
Who live in heaven. 7 It was granted
To him to make war with saints *planted*
And overcome them. And the power
Was given to him *in that hour*
Over every tribe, tongue, and nation.
8 All who live on the earth *and station*
Will bow to him, whose names have not
Been written in the Book *and plot*
Of Life of the Lamb slain as far
Back as foundation of world's *star*.
9 If anyone *but* has an ear,
Then let such a one *rise and* hear.
10 He who leads to captivity
Shall go into captivity,
He who kills with the sword must be
Killed with the sword. Here patient *stand*
The saints in faith *upon the land*.

Ah my Beloved! Despite the splendour of
The power of Baghdad, sceptred golden
glove,
Despite prostration of all nations round,
There is a sword to kill those when they're
found
Who killed with the sword. Yet I'll say a
word
In favour of beast above dragon turd.
Umayyads came bravely to kill with sword
The Imams as they strove to their reward.
Abbassids are a slicker race to feel
The diplomatic workings of the heel.
They always killed Imams with poisoned
bread
And tried to pretend they acknowledged
head,
But they too met their fate, since they
instead
Served mammon and not You when they
were fed.

[1289-1924 C.E.]

11 Then I saw another beast come
Up out of the earth, *venturesome*,
And he had two horns like a lamb
And spoke like a dragon *for sham*.
12 He wields all the power of the first
Beast in his presence *for the worst*,
And causes the earth and those who
Dwell in it to give worship due
The first beast, whose deadly wound's
healed.
13 And he performs great signs *revealed*,
Even to make fire come down from
The sky upon the earth in sight
Of men. 14 And deceives those who come
To live on the earth by the right
Of those signs he was granted might
To do in the sight of the beast,
Telling those who lived *and increased*
On the earth to make image to
The beast who was wounded, it's true,
By the sword and lived. 15 He was granted
To give life to image *enchanted*
Of the beast, that the image of
The beast should both speak and above
Cause those who would not worship it,
The image of the beast *unfit*,
To be killed. 16 And he will cause all,
Both rich and poor, and great and small,
And free and slave, to take a mark
On their right hand or on their *stark*
Foreheads, 17 and that no one may buy
Or sell except one notify
One has the mark or has the name
Of the beast, or the number's *claim*
Of his name. 18 Here is wisdom. Let
Him who has understanding get
By calculation number set
Upon the beast, for it's the number
Of a man: *and this is* his number
Six hundred sixty-six, *don't slumber*.

The mystic number of the beast is found
Among the thirty-six sultans renowned
Of Ottoman fame. I can now proclaim
This secret of infamy since the same
Have been lost from their power so many
years.

I speak aloud now after all the fears.
The pope and United States have no place
In prophecy, they're of the heathen race.
But Caliph and Sultan had the Qur'an

And divine guidance to rely upon,
And yet were lost in drunken rites of power.
Beloved, the beasts have fallen in an hour,
And I look to the dawn of a new day
When the Mahdi shall rise and take the
 sway.

Revelation 14

[still future]

1 Then I looked, and behold, a Lamb
Stood on Mount Zion *without sham*,
With him one hundred forty-four
Thousand, having his Father's *score*
And name written on their foreheads.
2 I heard a voice from heaven's spreads,
Like many waters' sound, and like
The voice of loud thunder *to strike*.
I heard the sound of harpers playing
Their harps. 3 And they sang *without*
 swaying
As it were a new song before
The throne of God, *also* before
The four live creatures, and the old
Ones, and no one could be so bold
To learn that song except the one
Hundred forty-four thousand *done*
Who were redeemed from off the earth.
4 These are the ones who were seen worth
And not defiled with women, for
They are virgins. In guarantor
These are the ones *devotedly*
Who follow the Lamb where he be.
These were redeemed from *among* men,
Firstfruits to God and Lamb again.
5 And in their mouth there was not found
Deceit, for they're without false ground
Before God's throne and all around.

Three hundred and thirteen join in the hope
When the Mahdi appears within the scope
Of Mecca at the Kaaba to go out
To conquer all the world with just a shout.
When that arrive upon the sacred hill
Of Zion to the fortress to fulfil
The prophecy, see how many have come
To swell the army to the fullest sum.
Beloved, though I may be too old to cast
My hand in with the faithful ones at last
Or shall perhaps on that glad day rest in
The comfort of my grave though without
 sin,
I pray my blessings on the holy one

Who shall appear on Zion and be done.

6 Then I saw another angel
Fly in the midst of heaven *a spell*,
Having everlasting gospel
To preach to those who live on earth,
To every nation, tribe *of worth*,
And tongue, and people *without dearth*.
7 Saying with a loud voice, "Fear God
And give Him glory *on the sod*,
For the hour of His judgement's come,
And *in prostration* worship Him
Who made heaven and earth *not dim*,
Sea, springs of water, *all in sum*."

The only place, Belovèd, in Your book
Of revelation, hard as I may look,
Tells what the content of the Gospel is.
A hundred times the word appears but fizz
Is all that floats upon the Gospel glass.
The Gospel is just three commands that
 pass

On two explanatory words. Fear God
Alone and not the neighbour's wife, and
 trod

The way in gratitude to Him, so when
The judgement comes all things shall be
 well then.

The third command is that we pray to You
In earth prostration since the thing is true
That You have made all things, alone
 Creator,
And not space, time, nor any other satyr.

Beloved, bless Your sent one, the Mahdi
 when
He shall appear to angels and to men
Restoring the witness and good news word
That has been everlastingly one heard
For righteousness and faith: see there are
 two

Points of doctrine and three things there to
 do.

Fear God alone and not the neighbour's
 wife

And say Subhan Allah in glory's strife,
Because You come to judge both great and
 small,

And that's the first two commands and the
 wall

Of explanation why we should do so.

The last command is to pray in prostration,

The duty of every man, woman, nation,
Because You are Creator, You alone,
And You sit Sovereign on a heavenly
throne.

8 Another angel followed, saying,
“Babylon’s fallen, fallen, *swaying*
That great city, because she made
All nations drink of the wine *paid*
In the wrath of her fornication.”

The proclamation comes from the Mahdi
To everyone in the world he can see
That Babylon’s beasts have fallen and he
Comes to renew the covenant and power
Of the eternal Gospel in an hour.
The caliphs have all fallen in the wake
Of the hordes of the Mongols, for the sake
Of internal corruption sultans stand
Conquered by their own people in the land.
The freedom that seems to cover the earth
Cloaks but the attempts of heathen of mirth
Who seek the gold and oil and touch no
thing
But join them to Babylon and its ring.
But soon the Mahdi’s call will change its
worth.

9 The third angel followed in station,
Saying with a loud voice, “If any
Worship the beast and *give a penny*
To his image, and take *his* mark
On his forehead or on his hand,

10 “He himself shall *outside the park*
Also drink wine not to withstand
The wrath of God, which is poured out
Unmixed in the cup of his stout
Wrath. He’ll be tormented with fire
And brimstone in the *great and dire*
Presence of holy angels and
Before the Lamb upon the land.

11 “And the smoke of their torment goes
Up ever and forever *shows*,
And they have no rest day or night,
Who worship the beast and *the fright*
Of his image, whoever gets
The mark of his name.” 12 Now here sets
The patience of the saints, here *are*
Those who keep God’s commandments’ bar
And have the faith of Jesus’ *star*.

I lay hold on the Decalogue whose sweet

Words guide and command even Mahdi’s
feet

And are the basis of the verdicts spoken
By all twelve divine guides in holy token.
I lay hold on the faith of Jesus sent
In purity wherever Ahmed went,
And proclaimed aloud and in secret word
By the Imams who saw the truth unblurred.
With the commandments ten and with the
hand

Of witness of Jesus upon the land
I join the Mahdi’s army to withstand
Both beast enlightened by Qur’an’s great
light
And pagan Christian lost in heathen night.
Beloved, I wait Your coming ones as
planned.

13 I heard a voice from heaven saying
To me, “Write: ‘Blessed *are* those they’re
slaying

Who die in the Lord from this time.”
“Yes,” says the spirit *in the prime*,
“That they may have rest from their work,
And their achievements follow them.”

14 Then I looked, and behold *in gem*,
A white cloud, and upon the cloud
Sat *one* like Son of Man *in shroud*,
Upon his head a golden crown,
And in his hand in sharp renown
A sickle. 15 And there came out then
Another angel from the den
Of the temple, to cry aloud
To him who sat upon the cloud,
“Thrust in your sickle now and reap,
For the time’s come for You to reap,
For the harvest of earth is ripe.”

16 So he who sat on the cloud’s *stripe*
Thrust in his sickle on the earth,
And the earth was reaped *in its girth*.

After the Mahdi comes again to share
Eternal Gospel with the faithful there,
Jesus Christ will appear from his estate
To help him reap the wicked world for fate
Of the destruction they have earned because
They refused to honour and keep Your
laws,

Even the ten were less than any set
By wicked faiths and governments they
met.

Let Jesus strike the earth with sickle and

Reap the harvest of faithful from the land
To pray behind the Mahdi in a band.
I join this Jesus Christ, Beloved, and tell
The sweet words of prostration at the well
And find the comfort of the warning bell.

17 Then one more angel came out from
The temple that's in heaven in sum,
And also had a sickle sharp
To play upon instead of harp.

18 Another angel came out from
The altar, who had power come
Over the fire, and he cried out
With a loud cry to him *with clout*
Who had the sharp sickle, and said,
"Thrust in your sharp sickle *of dread*

And gather the clusters of grapes
From the vine of its earthly shapes,
For her grapes are now fully ripe."

19 So the angel thrust in the stripe
Of his sickle into the earth
And gathered the vine of the earth,
And threw *it* in the great winepress
Of God's wrath *and without redress.*
20 And the winepress was trampled down
Outside the city *of renown,*
And blood came out of the winepress,
Up to the horses' bridles' dress,
One thousand six hundred furlongs
So long's the reaper sings his songs.

Who fail to hear the Mahdi's spoken word
Of faith to repent of their sins occurred,
Who will continue in the fond address
Of power and oppression meet duress.
The blood of the oppressor and allies
Shall run beneath the iron and brazen skies
Up to the horses' bridles till the foe
Of saint and goodness shall have lost the
show.

Beloved, I wait the events of the one
That You have still in store though many
shun
The hidden Mahdi who will soon appear
And strike the wicked down in abject fear.
Beloved, let me be one of faithful then
If I am still alive among earth's men.

Revelation 15

1 I saw in heaven another sign,
Great and marvellous in design:
Seven angels having seven last plagues,

For in them God's wrath's taken legs.

It's difficult enough to recognize
Reality when it's before one's eyes.
So what can I say of the future thing?
The plagues seem like the very present
sting.

Will there by something new in horror
coming?

I do not know, You know, Beloved, the
summing.

I look towards the morning sky and see
The frozen landscape of eternity
Before my window, passing in a breath,
And wonder there can be plague beyond
death.

The course of the Mahdi is present, yet
The visible of plagues once they are set
Before the human soul may bring a trace
Of violence that bright reveals Your face.

2 And I saw *something* like a sea
Of glass mingled with fire *freely,*
And those who have the victory won
Over the beast, over the gun
Of his image and over his
Mark *and* over what number is
His name, standing upon the sea
Of glass, with harps of God *to see.*

3 They sing the song that Moses won,
The servant of God, *not the son,*
The song of the Lamb, saying "Great
And marvellous Your works' estate,
Lord God Almighty! Just and true
Your ways, O King of the saints! 4 "Who
Shall not fear You, O Lord, and give
Glory to Your name? For *You live*
Alone holy. For all nations
Shall come and worship *in their tonnes*
Before You, for Your judgements are
Manifested *like shining star.*"

The song of Moses and the Lamb is set
Here in a few lines that in glory met
Your holy heart and proclaimed judgement
yet

To come upon the earth, all nations and
All things created upon loving land
To bow before you in prostration, stand
In holy awe before the rainbowed throne.
The song of Moses begins with the great
And marvellous of Your creation's state

And in a word progresses to the bone
Where the Lamb strikes the light of
judgement known.

Beloved, let me sing that great anthem that
Is not heard in any temple where sat
The bishop and the mullah on the mat.

5 After these things I looked, indeed,
The temple of the witness tent
In heaven was opened. 6 And *with speed*
Out of the temple came the sent
Seven angels having the seven plagues,
Clothed in pure linen on their legs
And bright, and having girded chests
With golden bands *upon their crests*.

7 Then one of the four living beasts
Gave to the seven angels *of feasts*
Golden bowls seven full of wrath
From God who lives *upon the path*
Forever and forever *more*.

8 The temple was filled with *the store*
Of smoke from God's glory and from
His power, and no one then could come
Into the temple till the seven
Plagues of the seven angels from heaven
Were completed and found their sum.

The plagues in golden bowls are not in hand
Of angel to pour out upon the land
Until one redeemed of the sons of men
Takes up the vial to pour it out again.
The plagues may seem a supernatural dole,
But they arise from actions of the soul
Of humankind, the fatal result of
The cause that came without the divine
love.

Beloved, let every action of my doing
Be made within the divine love in viewing,
And let my feet run to commands unheard
Except before the still small voice and
word.

And so I shall not contribute to that
Great mercy of the plagues where humans
sat.

Revelation 16

1 Then I heard a loud voice come out
From the temple speaking about
To the seven angels, "Go and pour
Out the bowls of God's wrath *and more*
On the earth." 2 So the first went and
Poured out his bowl upon the land,

And a foul and loathsome sore came
Upon the men who had the shame
Of the mark of the beast and those
Who bowed down at his image *close*.

The seven plagues of the Mahdi approve
As though they came from Egypt in the
groove

Of Moses, and that's why, it seems, the
song

That precedes them, though it is hardly
long,

Is the song of both Moses and the Lamb.
I reach back to the faith of Abraham
And grasp the promise of the covenant
That he will be a father and Imam
To all who love and worship You extant
And come to Your obedience and balm.
The loathsome sore comes on those who
hold dear

The pagan faith beneath the thin veneer
Of submission to You, but yet rejecting
Commandment and divine guidance
inspecting.

3 The second angel then poured out
His bowl on the sea, without doubt
It became blood as of the dead,
And every living creature *bred*
In the sea died. 4 And then the third
Angel poured out his bowl *unstirred*
On the rivers and springs of water,
And they became blood *like the slaughter*.

The angels do not forget how the blood
Of Hussein flowed down and joined like a
flood

The river Euphrates and thus was brought
By sea and river to the whole world taught.
There is no dust to eat but that which stays
From the blood and body of martyrs' days.
There is no drink but has the blood-stained
mote

Both sanctifying and defiling boat
Of faith and false faith on a world set loose
Without engine or freight, only caboose.
Beloved, I turn from slaughter ground
Refusing the blood in my water found,
And find a Kauthar from the martyred hand
That blesses me upon a heavenly land.

5 I heard the angel of the waters

Saying after all of these slaughters,
“You are righteous, O Lord, the One
Who is, who was, who will be done,
Because You have judged these things so.
6 For they have shed the blood *below*
Of saints and prophets, and You’ve given
Them blood to drink, *since they have*
striven,
For it is their just due.” 7 And I
Heard one more from the altar nigh
Saying “Be so, Lord God of power,
True and righteous Your judgements’
hour.”

You are righteous, Beloved, that You send
down
The stinking blood to those beneath Your
frown
You sacrifice anew Your martyrs in
The church and altar of heathenish sin.
It’s not enough the evil crew of Rome
Came to kill Your Christ on the ivory
throne.
It’s not enough Yezid ran out to fight
The guided one with deceit and not might.
But every evil soul must clamour more
To re-enact the wickedness in store,
Delighting in the killing of the good
By those who know better, at least they
should.
To drink the cup of wine is to take part
In martyring the loved and blessed heart.

8 Then the fourth angel poured out his
Bowl on the sun, till power is
Given to him to scorch men with fire.
9 And men were scorched with the great
fire,
And they blasphemed the name of God
Who’s power over these plagues *by rod*,
And they did not repent and give
Him glory. 10 Then the fifth *to sieve*,
The angel poured out his bowl on
The throne of the beast *overdrawn*,
His kingdom was full of darkness,
And they gnawed their tongues to confess
Their pain. 11 They blasphemed heaven’s
God
Because of their pains *on the sod*
And their sores, and did not repent
Of their deeds *on the path they went*.

The wicked are staunch in their wickedness
Before the plagues that come to their
address.
To harden heart against the call of love,
The Scriptures cantillated by the dove
And by the silver serpent with the tongue
Of every heavenly glory in the rung,
Is to make heart so hard that pain cannot
Come penetrate the wall and cut the knot.
Beloved, I see the many and the few
Turn from Your law and love and seek the
pew
Where Your divine guide does not lead the
way,
And so they harden heart with crooning
sway.
Let me be strong to follow Your love’s will
So that I need not feel the wrathful bill.

12 Then the sixth angel poured out his
Bowl on great river Euphrates,
And its water was dried up, so
That the way of the kings might go
From the east might prepare to show.

The lamblike beast with two horns has set
up
A dam capable of reducing cup
Of the Euphrates to a dry-bed stream.
It is no longer an unfavoured dream
Of John but what the hand of power can do
Within an hour with electronic screw.
The drying up of the great river can
Come by the time I turn around to scan
The clouds for sign of rain, the clouds for
dew.
Beloved, I see that what You said was true,
Although when John said that, no one could
find
The strength to believe what he had in
mind.
The great Euphrates was a stream whose
might
Was above any other stream in sight.

13 And three unclean spirits like frogs
I saw *come* out the mouth *like bogs*
Of the dragon, out of the mouth
Of the beast, and out of the mouth
Of the false prophet. 14 For they are
Spirits of demons, making signs,
Which go out to the kings’ aligns

Of the earth and of the whole world,
 To gather them to battle *furled*
 Of that great day of God Almighty.
 15 “Indeed, I’m coming like thief *flighty*.
 Blessed is he who watches, and keeps
 His garments, lest he walk *the deeps*
 Naked and they see of his shame.”
 16 And they gathered them *all by name*
 Together to the place called in
 Hebrew *language*, Armageddon.

The unclean frogs the Umayyads set out
 In doctrine to make all the people doubt
 The divine guidance and the Lamb who
 stood
 Upon the word to make prophecy good,
 The unclean frogs the Abbassids required
 To make their deceitfulness seem inspired,
 The unclean frogs spewed by Ottoman
 power
 To rule the world for an unflavoured hour,
 All are the spirits of a demon tower.
 The proof of such civilized hand is seen
 In how the Christian world has taken bean
 From the medieval pinnacle of kings
 To set them out in greed of oil and things.
 The fighting will not end, I watch their
 rings.

17 Then the seventh angel poured out
 His bowl into the air, and shout
 Came out of heaven’s temple, from
 The throne, saying “It’s done *in sum!*”
 18 And there were noises, thunderings
 And lightnings, and there were *the stings*
Of great earthquake, and such in might
 A great earthquake as not in sight
 Since men were on the earth. 19 And then
 The great city was *set again*
 Divided into three parts, and
 The cities of the nations fell.
 And great Babylon *there at hand*
 Was remembered before God *well*,
 To give her the cup of the wine
 Of the fierceness of His wrath’s *sign*.
 20 Then every island fled away,
 And the mountains were gone astray.
 21 Great hail from heaven fell on men,
 A talent’s weight *each stone and wen*.
 Men blasphemed God because the hail
 In plague was very great and hale.

As in Egypt the hail shall come to find
 A world destroyed already by the blind
 Who do not follow what You say in kind,
 The simple ten words that should always
 bind.

The faith that replaces the Decalogue
 With the scourge of false doctrine in a frog
 Shall fall before the lightning and the fog
 Of earthquake set on Babylon and Rome
 And on Baghdad, the dragon’s seat and
 home.

While men blaspheme who claim that You
 are one,
 And men blaspheme who claim that three is
 done

In Your glory and essence, I have won
 By laying hand on the one sermon You
 Once set before all men in good to view.

Revelation 17

1 One of the seven angels who
 Had the seven bowls then came out to
 Talk with me, saying to me, “Come,
 I’ll show you the judgement *in sum*
 Of the great harlot who sits on
 Many waters, 2 “on whom *they fawn*,
 And kings of the earth fornicate,
 And earth’s dwellers were put in state
 Of drunkenness and with the wine
 Of her fornication’s *design*. ”

When I consider what I’ve seen on earth
 Of the oppression the harlot in girth
 Has foiled, the blood she’s drunk not only
 in

The mocking sacrifice of Christ for sin,
 But in the blood of martyrs, widows and
 The orphan in a wasted, barren land,
 I think that I should shout for joy to see
 The judgement on the whore of mystery,
 The corporate state of the Roman field,
 The wealthy sinners of the oil-field’s yield.
 But I am squeamish, though I know the fate
 Of those tortured in past as well as late,
 And so I’m glad Your hand comes to the act
 To bring judgement upon the whore in fact.

3 He carried me away in spirit
 Into the wilderness *or near it*.
 I saw a woman sitting on
 A scarlet beast *on which was drawn*
 The names of blasphemy, with seven

Heads and ten horns *and under heaven*.

The seven heads no doubt represent all
The countries and kings left under the pall
Of Babylon and her suburb in Rome.

The ten horns are their powers upon the
loam

To oppose each of Your ten words and
make

A blasphemy of Your law for Your sake.
For every government beneath the sun
Opposes Your law with another done
In injustice to the poor and in showing
Acknowledgement to rich lobbies and
growing.

Beloved, I flee to You to know what grace
Of justice is right and what's the wrong
trace,

And see that none is righteous in the face
Of temptation to power and wealth and
mace.

4 The woman in purple arrayed
And scarlet, *colour of her trade*,
Adorned with gold and precious stones
And pearls, and having in her *bones*
Of hand a golden cup full of
Abominations, filthy love.

5 And on her forehead a name writ:
Mystery, Babylon, to wit,
The great, the mother of all whores,
And of the earth's most shameful stores.
6 I saw the woman, drunk with blood
Of the saints, also with the blood
Of the martyrs of Jesus. And
When I saw her, I marvelled grand
Amazement *all around the land*.

The beast of Babylon has drunk the blood
Of martyrs from the time that in its bud
It went against Jerusalem to kill
Those who rebelled against Babylon's will.
The beast came out to glory in the sun
And find who was the thirsty one when
done.

Blood is the drink of all in Babylon,
Whether soldier of Yezid on the run
Or celibate of priests who carry on
The ancient faith of beastly Babylon
In every templated church where Your
name's held
In blasphemies and hymnodies unquelled.

Beloved, I see and marvel too that man
Can be so blind to seek that woman's span.

7 But the angel said to me, "Why
Did you marvel? I'll testify
To you of the woman's mystery
And of the beast where she makes free,
Which has the seven heads, the ten horns.

8 "The beast that you saw was in bournes,
And is not, and will ascend out
Of the abyss, go to perdition.

And those who live on earth's admission
Will marvel, whose names are not writ
In the Book of Life *known as fit*
From the foundation of the world,
When they see the beast that was *curled*,
And is not, and yet is *once more*.

9 "Here is the mind with understanding:
The seven heads are mountains standing
In number seven on which sits
The woman *alone or in fits*.

10 "There are also seven kings. Five
Have fallen, one is *and alive*,
And the other has not yet come.

And when he comes, he must *make rum*
A short time. 11 "And the beast that was,
And is not, is himself *to pause*
Also the eighth, and of the seven,
Shall go to perdition, *not heaven*.

Even after the return of Mahdi
There shall arise a king so to make free
As to oppose Your will, the mystery
Of wickedness is never done until
The day of judgement comes all to fulfil.
Let my name be writ in the book that You
From the foundation of the world in view
Have set upon the tablets of the race
Above and beyond hills that come to trace
Babylon in their artificial way
To pretend to the heavenly, hopeful day.
Beloved, the made-made mountains that
possess

The world in wonder I come to confess
Are but the idols of those who oppress.

12 "The ten horns which you saw are ten
Kings who have received not again
As yet the kingdom, but receive
Authority one hour's reprieve
As kings with the beast. 13 "And these are
Of one mind, give their strength and star

To the beast. 14 "And these will make war
With the Lamb, and the Lamb will win
Over them, for he's lord of lords
And king of kings *and without sin*,
And those *who are* with him *with swords*
Are called, chosen, and faithful *wards*."

15 He said to me, "The waters which
You saw with harlot in the ditch,
Are peoples, multitudes, and nations,
And languages set in their stations.

16 "And the ten horns which you saw on
The beast, these will hate the whore's dawn,
Make her desolate and naked,
Eat her flesh and burn her with fire.

17 "For God's put in their hearts wicked
To fulfil His purposed desire,
To be of one mind, and to give
Their kingdom to the beast *to live*,
Until God's words are *all* fulfilled.

18 "And the woman whom you saw *drilled*
Is that great city which rules all
The kings of the earth *under thrall*."

The ten kings of the beast who ruled a while
Are given just an hour to see the guile
Of the beast and the harlot in her stile.
Too late the come repudiate the song
Without repudiation of the wrong.
All nations that admire the iron hand
Built up from the Umayyad to the land
Across the western see, the civilized
Guided by the beast of the unrevised
Shall come to know that force is never
right.

Too late they come to stand before Your
sight.

The choice is made today, the book is
signed

From the foundation of the world, designed
To show the universe both day and night.

Revelation 18

1 After these things I saw one more
Angel coming down from *the door*
Of heaven, with great authority,
And earth lighted with his glory.

The message of the angel is that all
The kings and presidents of earth appal
In that they wag the whore by their greed
and
False faith in religion and in the stand

Of commerce where by advertisement they
Cheat and keep the poor in oppression's
sway.

The worshippers of Baal beneath the green
Groves copulated till sweat's glistening
sheen

Gave faith the fields would ripen to the
store

And cattle reproduce finely what's more.
Since then that fatal faith of science lore
Pretends sophistication, but its root
Is rotten and condemned down to the boot.
Beloved, judge both the past and present
gore.

2 And he cried mightily with shout,
Saying, "Babylon the great's out,
Is fallen, fallen, and become
A dwelling place of demons *dumb*,
A prison for every foul spirit,
And a cage for all things *to leer at*,
Every unclean and hated bird!

3 "For all the nations have *been stirred*
To drunkenness by her wine's wrath
Of fornication in her path,
The kings of earth have fornicated
With her, and earth's merchants instated
Have become rich through abundance
Of her luxury." 4 And *in trance*
I heard one more voice from the sky
Saying "Come, come out of her, my
People, lest you share in her sins,
And lest you receive of her wins
In plagues. 5 "For her sins have reached to
Heaven, and God's remembered due
Her wickedness. 6 "So render to
Her just as she rendered to you,
And repay her double according
To her works, in her cup *of lording*
Which she has mixed, mix double share.

7 "In the measure that she did there
In glory to herself and lived
Luxuriously *and negated*,
In same measure give her torment
And sorrow, for she *'ll not repent*
Saying in her heart, 'I sit queen,
And am no widow, have not seen
Sorrow.' 8 "Therefore her plagues will
come

In one day, death, mourning in sum
And famine. And she will be burned
Outright with fire *for what she spurned*,

Strong *is* YHWH God who judges her.
 9 “The kings of the earth who confer
 To fornicate and live with her
 Delicately, weep and lament
 For her, seeing *without relent*
 The smoke of her burning, 10 “and stand
 Afar off fearing her torment,
 Saying ‘Alas, alas, that *land*
And great city of Babylon,
 That mighty city! For in one
 Hour your judgement has come *to keep*.’
 11 “And merchants of the earth will weep
 And mourn for her, for no one buys
 Their merchandise now, 12 “merchandise
 Of gold and silver, precious stones
 And pearls, fine linen, purple *sewns*,
 Silk and scarlet, *and* every kind
 Of citron wood, and every kind
 Of thing in ivory, every kind
 Of thing in precious wood *refined*,
 And bronze, and iron, and marble, 13 “and
 Cinnamon and incense *at hand*,
 And fragrant oil and frankincense,
 Wine, oil, fine flour and its contents
 Of wheat, and cattle and sheep, horses
 And chariots *rushing in courses*,
 And bodies and the souls of men.
 14 “The fruit your soul longed for *again*
 Has gone from you, and all the things
 Which are rich and have splendid *wings*
 Have gone from you, and you shall find
 Them no more ever. 15 “The merchants
 Of these things, her rich *elephants*,
 Will stand afar for fear of her
 Torment, weeping and wailing *stir*,
 16 “And saying ‘Alas, alas, that
 Great city that was clothed *and sat*
 In fine linen, purple, scarlet,
 And adorned with gold and inset
 With precious stones and pearls! 17 ‘For in
 One hour such great riches have been
 Brought to nought.’ Every shipmaster,
 All who travel by ship *and stir*,

The pearls! The precious pearls are cast out
 now
 That the whore turns into a bleeding sow.
 Alas indeed, and yet my heart rejoices
 To waken to the sound of human voices
 At last renouncing what they always took
 For truth and honour while in fact forsook

Your law and Your commandments, ah so
 few.

Beloved, I joy to see the end in view.
 Give me the power and courage day to day
 To keep Your law and find in Your law’s
 way
 My joy and comfort under guidance’ sway.
 Find me at sunrise by the window set
 Against the east beneath the birches met
 With aspens under snow to love You yet.

Sailors, and as many as trade
 On the sea, stood afar unmade
 18 “And cried out when they saw the smoke
 Of her burning, saying ‘What *stroke*
Is like this great city?’ 19 “They threw
 Dust on their heads and cried *anew*,
 Weeping and wailing, and saying,
 ‘Alas, alas, that great town spring,
 In which all who had ships on sea
 Became rich by her wealth *and spree!*
 For in one hour she’s desolate.’
 20 “Rejoice over her, heaven, and *great*
 Holy apostles and prophets,
 For God’s avenged you where she *sits!*”

The din of Baal worship in every place
 I turn to find You in this wicked race
 Arises from the bar and concert hall,
 The church of every Peter and of Paul,
 And even in the synagogue and mosque
 I find the heathen sounds or record kiosk
 Beating out like a washing machine’s
 tumble

The trapset’s call to both the great and
 humble
 To frolic and to rave in loving rate
 Pretending to be free of vice and hate.
 Beloved, I’m glad to see that noise is turned
 Into the wail and weeping of the spurned
 Who first despised Your law until they
 learned
 That shipping slaves is wrong though done
 of late.

21 Then a mighty angel took up
 A stone like a great millstone *cup*
 And threw *it* into the sea, saying,
 “Thus with violence *not allaying*
 The great city Babylon shall
 Be thrown down, and it no more shall
 Be found. 22 “The sound of harpers and

Musicians, flutists *by command*,
And trumpeters shall not be heard
In you *forever* any more.
No craftsman of any craft *stirred*
Shall be found in you any more,
And the sound of a millstone shall
Not be heard in you prodigal.

Both industry and the great business of
Music so-called based on its sensual love
Will disappear before contortion's weight,
The logical result of sale and hate.
Though craftsman fail, and I must say it's
true,
One cannot find today people who do
A decent job of work, the prophecy
Is echoing before its time to be,
Though craftsman fail and singers get sore
throat,
And sailors find no ship or sunken boat,
I still come with a slender voice to You
To praise in cantillation in review
Creation from Your hand and judgement
set,
Both life and death in the new deal they've
met.

23 "The light of a lamp shall not shine
In you any more, and the sign
Of bridegroom's voice and bride shall not
Be heard in you again for nought.
For your merchants were the great men
Of the earth, for by regimen
Of your sorcery all the nations
Were deceived *to partake her rations*.
24 "And in her was found prophets' blood
And that of saints poured *out in flood*,
And of all who were slain on earth
From great to small of every worth."

The prophets' blood is found in stinking
belly
Of the sweet Christians that perform on
telly
Pretending to evangelize the world
With sexy songs and ditties new uncurled.
The prophets' blood is found in mart and
store
To be bought for a delicacy's roar,
And drunk in every conference room that
meets
To find a better way to get more treats.

Climbing on dead men's bones passes for
feats.

Beloved, the light goes out, the city's dim,
The time has come at last for faces grim,
While merchants fling the ill-got coin to
him

Who tempted to the treachery to give
A prophet up so that nation might live.

Revelation 19

1 After these things I heard a loud
Voice in the heaven of a crowd
Saying "Alleluia! Salvation,
Glory, honour, and power's *the station*
Of YHWH our God! 2 "For true and right
Are His judgements, because *on site*
He's judged the great whore who corrupted
The earth with her unclean erupted,
And He's avenged on her the blood
Of His servants *shed* by her *stud.*"

I praise Your name, Beloved, not that You
love
Unconditionally all the above,
But that in wrath Your hand appears in
power
To wield a greater sword than nuclear
Weapons thrust by the US and the fink
Upon the river Euphrates to drink
The poisoned sand where death comes up to
stink.
I praise Your name, Beloved, because You
judge
The wicked in wickedness who'll not budge
From violence in weapon and on paper
To define the poor poorer with a caper.
Babylon and Rome join with New York's
sun
To corrupt earth from Paris to London.
I praise You because You've already won.

3 Again they said, "Alleluia!
Her smoke goes up forever awe!"
4 And the twenty-four elders and
The four living creatures *at hand*
Fell down and worshipped God who sat
Upon the throne, saying "Amen!"
And "Alleluia!" after that.
5 Then a voice came out from the throne,
Saying, "Praise to our God *alone*,
All you His servants and those who
Fear him, both small and great *for true!*"

The sons of Ishmael and of Jacob come
 To prostrate before You and venturesome
 Raise praises to Your name, the living four
 With face of eagle, ox, lion and store
 Of human heart, the occulted who make
 Their home with You forever in the wake
 Of their flight from the earth to heaven's
 dome,
 All worship You as God and turn from
 Rome.
 Beloved, besides these divine guides that
 rate
 The living at You throne, both small and
 great
 Also come to serve You, and come not late.
 I thank You that I too may be included
 In that number of great or small deluded.
 If small I be, still I am not denuded.

6 And I heard, as it were, the voice
 Of a great multitude *of choice*,
 As many waters' sound and as
 The sound that mighty thunder has,
 Saying "Alleluia! For YHWH
 God Omnipotent reigns *as due!*
 7 "Let us be glad, rejoice and give
 Him glory, for the *amative*
 Marriage of the Lamb has come, and
 His wife's made ready *and at hand.* "

The Lamb is Muhammad, Ali, the Lamb
 Is every divine guide in his time's jamb,
 And here the Lamb has come as the Mahdi,
 The guided one to guide humanity.
 Beloved, let Your sent one guide me also
 Into the bridal chamber and the glow
 Of faith, away from Babylon and her
 Evil and wicked woman on the stir
 Who represents false faith upon the beast
 Of worldly kingdom's violence increased.
 Let me be ready to enjoy the presence
 Of the reward to elephant and pheasants,
 The creation redeemed and taken in
 By the Mahdi forever without sin.

8 And to her it was granted to
 Be arrayed in fine linen, *true*,
 And clean and bright, because the fine
 Linen's the righteous works of saints.
 9 Then he said to me, "Write *and sign*:
 'Blessed *are* those who *without complaints*

Are called to marriage supper of
 The Lamb!'" And he said *as above*
 To me, "These are true sayings of
 God." 10 And I fell at his feet to
 Prostrate before him. But in due
 Recourse he said to me, "*See that*
You do not do that! I am sat
 As fellow servant with you, and
 Of your brothers who have command
 And witness of the martyrdom
 Of Jesus. Worship God *in sum!*
 For witness of Jesus consists
 In spirit of prophecy's *lists.* "

I too once walked in white and I was seen
 To be Your guest upon the marble sheen
 Around the Kaaba, between the two hills
 That with their history send down cold
 chills
 On the spine of the one whose memory
 Turns to the bloody time Muhammad free
 Ran there to proclaim of Your unity,
 To the time when Ishmael was left while
 she
 Ran hopeless searching for water to drink.
 I too once walked in white and on the brink
 Of faith and love and doubt beneath the
 stars
 To witness martyrdoms among the cars.
 Beloved, I too once walked in white and
 still
 Hope to walk so again, promise fulfil.

11 Now I saw heaven opened, and
 Indeed, a white horse by command.
 And he who sat on him *was* called
 Faithful and True, and *unappalled*
 In righteousness he judges and
 Makes war. 12 His eyes *were* like a flame
 Of fire, and round his head *did frame*
 Many crowns. And he had a name
 Written that no one knew except
 Himself. 13 And he *was* clothed *and kept*
 With a robe dipped in blood, his name
 Is called The Word of God *in fame.*

I see the blessed Jesus by command
 Come riding on the white horse to the hand
 To the Lamb and the Mahdi with mandate
 To judge in righteousness and not be late
 To make war on those who oppose Your
 name

And struggle against You, Your law, Your claim.

His eyes are like a flashing fire and he
Is crowned with diadems to grant the free
Life in his martyrdom, his name is called
The Word of God before all the appalled
To see him coming on the skies and on
The white horse that prevents the rosy
dawn.

Beloved, I lift my eyes in faith to one
Called Jesus, the blessed martyr's benison.

14 And heaven's hosts, all clothed in fine
Linen, white and clean, there resign
To follow him on horses white.

15 Out of his mouth there goes a *bright*
Sharp sword, that with it he should strike
The nations. And he will take pike
To rule them with an iron rod.
He himself has the winepress trod
In fierce wrath of Almighty God.

King David, prophet of the sweet voice, laid
A hymn of tribute to the iron made
The rod to rule the world by Your anointed,
To still the tumult of the beast appointed.
Let him strike down the nations and the
crowd

Of all who stand before altar allowed
To sacrifice to Caesar and to Baal.
Let him strike the world down to hear them
wail.

Let Your fierce wrath appear before the
wine

Of the blood of those who come in to dine
With Belshazzar and see the fatal sign.
Beloved, I hear the sharp sword singing still
And ringing on my ears, my heart to fill
With hope bows down to You: let the sword
kill.

16 And he has on robe and on thigh
A name written: king of kings high
And lord of lords. 17 And then I saw
An angel stand in the sun's *awe*,
And he cried with a loud voice, saying
To all the birds that fly *obeying*
Up in the air, "Come gather here
Together for the commandeer
Supper of the great God *in fear*,
18 "That you may eat the flesh of kings,
The flesh of captains *without wings*,

The flesh of mighty men, the flesh
Of horses and of those afresh
Who sit on them, and of the flesh
Of all, free, slave, both small and great."

19 And I saw the beast *in his state*,
The kings of the earth, and their hosts,
Gathered together *in their boasts*
To make war against him who sat
On the horse and against out flat
His army. 20 Then the beast was taken,
And with him false prophet *forsaken*
Who worked signs in his presence, by
Which he deceived those who stood by
To receive the mark of the beast
And those who bowed down at the least
Before his image *at his feast*.

These two were cast alive into
The lake of fire burning with *brew*
Of brimstone. 21 And the rest were killed
With the sword from his mouth which
spilled,

Who sat upon the horse. And all
The birds were filled with their flesh maul.

When I was just a child I once was taken
To where the fires burned the wastes that
were shaken

From house and hauld, and where the
stench was great

Beneath a smoky sky of brass and hate.
I saw the vultures chew the carrion,
I saw their great wings spread against the
dawn

Of fiery sky and cloud, I saw it all
With heart gone fast against the pulsing
wall.

Beloved, the amplified reward that comes
To those who oppose You and Your laws
sums

Leaves that quick vision in a pall of dust.
Beyond the melodies faintly in hums,
I only see and know the simple crust.
I want the conflagration, not the rust.

Revelation 20

1 Then I saw an angel come down
From heaven, having key to *the town*
Of the abyss and a great chain
In his hand. 2 He laid hold a-main
Of the dragon, serpent of old,
Who is *the* Devil, Satan bold,
And bound him for a thousand years,

3 And he cast him down in *the fears*
Of the abyss, and shut him up,
 And set a seal upon his *cup*,
 So that he should deceive the nations
 No more till the thousand years' *rations*
 Were finished. But after these things
 He must be released *to the kings*
 For a short time. 4 And I saw thrones,
 And they sat on them, and judgement
 Was given to them. Then *were sent*
 The souls whose heads had been cut off
 For their witness to Jesus' *soph*
 And for the word of God, who had
 Not bowed down there before the bad
 Beast or his image, and had not
 Received *his* mark on foreheads' spot
 Or on their hands. And they lived and
 Reigned with Christ for a thousand years.
 5 But the rest of the dead *on land*
 Did not live again *for their fears*
 Until the thousand years were done.
 This *is* the first resurrection.
 6 Blessed and holy *is* he who's won
 Part in the first resurrection.
 Over such ones the second death
 Has no power *over life and breath*,
 But they shall be priests of God and
 Of Christ, and reign with him thousand
 Years. 7 Now when the thousand years end,
 Satan will be released from fend
 8 And will go out to deceive *all*
 The nations that are in *his thrall*
In the four corners of the earth,
 Gog and Magog, *and from its girth*
 To gather them together to
 Battle, whose number *is not few*
But as the sand upon the shore.
 9 They went up on the breadth before
 Of the earth and surrounded where
 The camp of the saints *and the fair*
 And the beloved city was there.
 And fire came down from God and out
 Of heaven and consumed them *in rout*.

The start of judgement day is but the dawn
 Of a millennium of thrones whereon
 The righteous see the history of the world
 Cast down upon the empty screen unfurled.
 The day rises and waits a thousand years
 Before the cataclysmic fire and fears
 Destroy evil and wickedness and make
 All souls alive and righteous for Your sake.

Beloved, I trow that day is one both blessed
 And bright for those who enter Sabbath rest,
 And dark and filled with smoke for those
 who wait
 Upon Satanic justice for their fate.
 Beloved, I tremble with both fear and hope
 To see the day approach and fill my scope.

When dear Muhammad said he was the city,
 And Ali was the gate, he knew no pity
 For either beast or the false prophet that
 His followers would make him when they
 sat
 Saqeefa bani Sa'idah to make
 Imposters to follow him in his wake.
 Beloved, take note of that fatal mistake
 That turned the message raised against the
 great
 Monophysitic heresy in state
 Into the very false prophetic mate
 Of the beast to at last flounder and sink
 Beneath the lake of fire, and their last drink.
 Beloved, take note and write it in the book
 Where men and angels come to take a look.

10 The devil deceived them, was cast
 Into the lake of fire *at last*
 And *lake of* brimstone where the beast
 And the false prophet *are at least*.
 And they will be tormented day
 And night forever *in its sway*.

Does this false prophet have a name now
 known?

False prophets have been many on the
 throne.

Which of these many is the one that's
 thrown

Into the lake of fire to learn of grace
 Appearing once at last before Your face?
 It cannot be just one of those appearing,
 But is defined as with the dragon fearing
 And the beast, one of three, and one time
 met

As the lamblike beast with two horns to get
 A kingdom and an empire and be set
 At the time that the Ottomans rose up
 To power usurping and to take the cup
 Of Ali and the Lamb. Beloved I find
 Chills of revulsion darken eye and mind.

11 And then I saw a great white throne

And him who sat on it *alone*,
 From whose face earth and heaven fled.
 And there was found no place for them.
 12 I saw the dead, small and great, led
 To stand before God *at His hem*,
 And books were opened. And one more
 Book was opened *to read the score*,
 Which is *the Book of Life in store*.
 And the dead were judged by their works,
 By the things *and by all their quirks*
 Which were written on the books' *pages*.
 13 The sea gave up the dead *of ages*
 Who were in it, Hades and Death
 Delivered up the dead with breath
 Who were in them. And they were judged,
 Each one by how his works *were smudged*.
 14 Then Death and Hades were cast out
 Into the lake of fire *with shout*.
 This is the second death *and rout*.
 15 And anyone not found inscribed
 In Book of Life was cast *unbribed*
 Into the lake of fire *with clout*.

I praise Your name, Beloved, to see these
 things,
 Death and Hades themselves cast in the
 wings,
 And only life and truth and hopefulness
 Remain in heaven and earth and all things
 bless.
 The stench of scorch is threatening the sky
 Over the inner chamber where I cry,
 And flames burn from the soul the will to
 do
 Anything that is not according to
 Your divine will, until nothing is left
 Of evil in the evil camp bereft.
 The silence before storms straightens the
 gate:
 The cosmic soul and single soul await.
 I lend my heart and will to join with yours
 And see the rising on eternal shores.

Revelation 21

1 Now I saw a new heaven and earth,
 For the first heaven and the first earth
 Had passed away. Also there was
 No more *that sea to foam and buzz*.

Beloved, I waken day to day to find
 New heavens and earth before my
 wondering mind.

The sun creeps out shy and new from Your
 hand
 And blesses for the first time lake and land
 And every island that arises from
 The icy foam or from the waters come
 To fill the world around me with address
 Of birch and pine as well as rough caress
 Of fir spread westward from the land of
 bears
 And bright horizons caught beneath the
 snares
 Of teeming life and empty tundra far
 Until the new born ocean raises bar.
 Beloved, each morning I seen new worlds
 made
 Below the gloried window where I stayed.

2 Then I, John, saw the holy town,
 The new Jerusalem, come down
 Out of the sky and sent from God,
 Prepared as a bride on the prod
 Adorned for her bridegroom. 3 And I
 Heard a loud voice from heaven reply,
 "Indeed, the tent of God's with men,
 And He will live with them *again*,
 And they shall be His people then.
 God Himself will be with them *and*
Be their God throughout all the land.

As the sun rises on my wakened life
 To quell the worried dawn with broken
 strife,
 I see the heavenly city in the sky
 Awakened with the brightness and the cry
 Of all the winged angels in my keep:
 The twittering and summered ones that
 peep,
 The black-eyed beauties of the winter's
 store,
 I see them all beneath the pearly door.
 Beloved, as daily I find heaven above
 I turn my soul to that goodness that strove
 To turn the evil of the cosmos and
 The singly frightened soul in every manned
 Body upon the soil back to Your heart.
 I daily find after judgement Your part.

4 "And God will wipe away each tear
 From their eyes, there shall be no *fear*
Again of death, sorrow, nor crying.
 There shall be no more pain nor sighing,
 For former things have passed away."

5 He sat upon the throne to say,
 "Indeed, I shall make all things new."
 And he told me, "Write, these words true
 And faithful." 6 And He said to me,
 "It's done! I am the Alpha and
 The Omega, beginning and
 The end. I will give of the fount
 Of the water of life's amount
 Freely to him who thirsts. 7 "He who
 Overcomes shall inherit due,
 All things, and I will be his God
 And he shall be my child *unshod*.
 8 "But cowardly and unbelieving,
 Abominable, and the *deceiving*
 Of murderers, and fornicators,
 And sorcerers, and *among satyrs*
 Idolaters, and all liars shall
 Have their part in the great canal
 Which burns with fire and brimstone, which
 Is the second death *in the ditch*."

Beloved, cast all the cowardice in me
 Into devouring flames of fire and free
 My hand and heart from unbelief and all
 Abomination, murder, and the thrall
 Of fornication, sorcery and call
 Of smug idolatry that lies that it
 Is true faith representing You and fit.
 Beloved, cast all this wickedness from my
 Soul, hand and heart and lift me to the sky
 Of Your obedience. Then I shall try
 A newborn foot upon the golden floor
 Where there shall be no crying any more,
 And pain and sorrow's left both flesh and
 mind
 And there remains only You left to find.

9 One of the seven angels who
 Had seven bowls filled with the due
 Seven last plagues came to me and
 Talked with me *so I'd understand*,
 Saying "Come, I'll show you the bride,
 The Lamb's wife *to stand by his side*."

I look upon the mirror cast above
 The world where I am turned about in love
 Led by the angel of wrath and of tears
 Who once was minister to all my fears,
 And see that those fears that had been my
 fate
 Where but the gargoyles gazing down in
 hate

Above the marbled and carven estate
 That brought me to the bright celestial gate.
 I look upon the cosmic mirror set
 Above Your divine throne and there I get
 The vision of the mystery of all:
 The miracle hid in eternal rate,
 The secret is my own soul cleansed in wall
 And hearth and chamber for the
 bridegroom's call.

10 And he carried me then away
 In the spirit to a great way
 And a high mountain, and showed me
 The great city and the holy
 Jerusalem, descending out
 Of heaven from God, *and with a shout*,
 11 Having God's glory all about.
 Her light *was* like a precious stone,
 Like a jasper stone *on a throne*,
 Clear as crystal. 12 Also she had
 A great and high wall which was clad
 With twelve gates, and twelve angels at
 The gates, and names upon them sat,
 Which are the twelve tribes of the sons
 Of Israel: 13 three gates toward the sun's
 Rising, three gates on the north, three
 Gates on the south, and three gates *free*
 Toward the west. 14 The city wall
 Had twelve foundations *all in all*,
 And on them were the names of twelve
 Apostles of the Lamb *to delve*.

I count the gates, I count foundations' way
 And my heart rises to greet heaven's day
 With the names of the twelve on lip and
 tongue:
 I see the ancient pattern become young.
 The seven days hinge on the words that
 rung
 From Sinai in number of ten to strike
 The hymns resounding all around and like
 The thunder till the number counted out
 Was twelve upon the folk gathered in doubt.
 The twelve is doubled and resounds again
 In righteousness and glory before men
 To see the city of the bride and groom,
 The place awaited and the sacred room
 At once revealed to topple every doom.

15 And he who talked with me had reed
 Of gold to measure the *decreed*
 City, its gates, and its wall there.

16 The city is laid out in square,
 Its length is as great as its *bare*
 Breadth. And he took the city's sound
 With reed: there were twelve thousand
 found
 Of furlongs. Its length, breadth, and height
 Are equal *on the glorious site*.
 17 Then he measured its wall *again*:
 One hundred forty-four *impen*
Of cubits, by measure of men,
 That is, of an angel *in ken*.

The holy number twelve comes out at last
 To be the measure of the city vast,
 The number of the army gathered round
 The Lamb who came to Zion where he
 found
 The battle and the victory resound.
 The three days turn to four and to a week
 And multiplied in everything I seek
 Become twelve sons of Ishmael to reduce
 All after sons and glories to their use
 In Jacob and in Jesus and at last
 In those twelve who remain and have not
 passed.
 I seek the stays, the sons, the divine guides
 And follow them all through the rising tides
 Until You rise in all things, all besides.

18 The wall was built of jasper stone,
 The city *of* pure gold alone,
 Like clear glass. 19 The foundation stone
 Of the wall of the city *was*
 Adorned with stones *of padishahs*:
 The first foundation jasper, and
 The second sapphire *blue and grand*,
 The third chalcedony, the fourth
 An emerald *green shining forth*,
 20 The fifth sardonyx *followed by*
 The sixth sardius *to glorify*,
 The seventh chrysolite, and then
 The eighth a beryl *halogen*,
 The ninth topaz, the tenth *a stone*
 Of chrysoprase, eleventh *known*
As jacinth, and the twelfth *at last*
 An amethyst *of purple cast*.

The twelve stones that lie on the high
 priest's chest
 Reflect in the foundation stones that rest
 Beneath the golden walls that shine among
 The stars above the firmament that sung

When You created universes with
 Reality brighter, as bright as myth.
 Beloved, I count the stones and touch their
 joy
 In colours red and green and to employ
 The frozen rainbow set above the throne,
 I touch the mystic number set in stone.
 The simple stony chamber of my heart
 Lit only by a candle for its part
 Against the glistening drab of wall and
 earth
 Expands into a universe of worth.

21 The twelve gates *were* twelve pearls:
 each one
 Was of one pearl. And the street done
 In the city *was* purest gold,
 Transparent like glass *to behold*.
 22 But I saw no temple in it,
 For YHWH God Almighty *was fit*
 And the Lamb to be temple *there*.
 23 The city had no need *in air*
 Of the sun or of the moon fair
 To shine in it, for God's glory
 Illuminated it freely.
 And the Lamb *is still* its light *there*.

Above the walls of Babylon, above
 The domes of Rome and market-strutting
 dove,
 The sun stands as though justifying glove
 Of tyrant with face set benignly wrong
 To hear the pleasures of ungodly song.
 Above Mecca's sweet streets and fragile
 trees
 The moon looks down on nonexistent seas
 To bless the circumambulation of
 Those who worship You only, not the love
 Of any heavenly body that obeys
 Your divine commands in its orbits' ways.
 The Kaaba of my heart that stands before
 The judgement seat and city on that shore
 Needs neither sun nor moon to sound Your
 praise.

24 The nations of those who are saved
 Shall walk in its light *golden paved*,
 And the kings of the earth bring their
 Glory and honour into it.
 25 Its gates shall not be shut *to wit*
 At all by day, while there's no night.
 26 And they shall bring the glory sight

And honour of nations to it.
27 But there shall enter by no means
Anything that defiles its *scenes*,
Or causes an abomination
Or a lie, but only the nation
Written in the Lamb's Book of Life
Has right to enter without strife.

Beloved, what miracles of love and grace
I see on the last pages of the face
Of revelation, Your revealing's power:
There are some kings to face that awful
hour
And live and walk that street of gold and
shower
With glory and honour the new-sprung
trace.
Beloved, that kings also should enter in
The chamber of righteousness without sin
Is cause above all others for surprise
And marvel in the human-guided eyes.
I praise You that the humble and the meek
Abound among the victors that I seek,
But more for the one lost than ninety-nine:
A king, a king set to appointed wine!

Revelation 22

1 And he showed me a river pure,
Water of life *that will endure*,
Clear as crystal, proceeding from
The throne of God and of the Lamb.
2 In the midst of its street *to come*,
And on each riverside to dam,
Arose the tree of life to yield
Twelve fruits, each month a fruit revealed.
The leaves of the tree for the healing
Of the nations *were there concealing*.

The twelve Imams are the twelve fruits
descended
From dear Muhammad when his life had
ended.
The first was Ali come with drinking bowl
Of rare green alabaster to give soul
Of every man and woman a pure draught
Of Kauthar springing from Your crystal
throne,
The same waters hidden that desert taught
To furnish tree of life with leaf and tone.
As the Islamic apostates ran free
In their oppression of posterity,
The tree of life bears its fruits quietly

Beside the hidden stream with humble fare.
Month by month age to age the cycles share
Divine guidance and healing everywhere.

3 And there shall be no more a curse,
But the throne of God *to disburse*
And of the Lamb in it *rehearse*,
And his servants shall serve him *there*.
4 They shall see his face, and his *fair*
Name *shall be* on their foreheads *bare*.
5 And there shall never be night there.
They need no lamp nor light of sun,
For YHWH God gives them light *to run*.
And they shall reign forever *done*.

Let every curse fail from my sluggish
tongue,
I'm weak to curse the evil in the rung,
And now rejoice the need shall one day pass
Before Your throne and on the crisping
grass
Of the Lamb and Mahdi, Ali with his
Alabaster bowl filled with Kauthar's fizz.
Let every darkness fail from my suspense,
And take a way the lamp that I for sense
Keep burning in my darkened chamber
here.

I have no longer need of spark and fear
Who enter in the glory of the day
That never fails of summer's shining way.
For You give light without a gleaming
show,
And You are the end of the path I go.

6 Then he said to me, "These words *are*
Faithful and true *and like a star*."
And YHWH God of the prophet saints
Sent His angel to show *in paints*
To His servants the things that must
Soon come to pass. 7 "Indeed, I come
Quickly! Blessed is he who *lifts thumb*
To keep prophetic words of trust
In this book." 8 And now I, John, saw
And heard these things *out of the law*.
And when I heard and saw, I fell
Down before the feet of angel
In worship to whom showed me these.
9 Then he said to me, "*If you please*
See *that you do not do so*. For
I'm your fellow slave *at the door*,
And of your brother prophets here,
Of those who keep what words appear

In this book. Worship God *in fear*."

10 And he said to me, "Do not seal
What this book's forecast words reveal,
For the time is at hand. 11 "He who
Is unjust, let him still pursue
Injustice, he who's filthy, let
Him wallow in his lewdness yet,
He who is righteous, let him be
Righteous still, he who is holy,
Let him be holy still *and free*."

Before the time pronouncing the set fate
Of evil and the good in judgement's rate,
Let evil depart from my hand and foot,
Set life and good upon me and then put
Me in the garden of the city where
There is no evil anywhere to share.
Beloved, I choose the right as You describe
It in Your one sermon come to abide,
The Decalogue, I choose not to deride
With killing or with stealing on the side,
With lying tongue and covetous heart bred,
With idol and many gods that are fed
In every church for pagan's helping hand.
Beloved, set my heart good beneath Your
band.

12 "And indeed, I'm coming quickly,
And my reward *is come* with me,
To give to every one by what
He's done *before mercy's door shut*.
13 "I'm Alpha and Omega, *stand*
Beginning and *the End* to stand,
The First and the Last *in command*."

Come, my Beloved, You who are never far
From me, not farther than a guiding star,
Your light years are a blink, so near that I
Cannot focus upon Your divine eye.
Come, my Beloved, indeed there is no
where

For me to be outside Your love and care,
There is no place existing outside You
You have no bounds nor limits in the True.
Reward me with extinction of my trust,
Reward me with returning to the dust,
Reward me till there's nothing left that must
Not return to the hand and heart that made
Me from the sod and breath of life and
stayed

To call my name upon a garden's crust.

14 Blessed *are* those who do His
commands,
That they may have the right to bands
Of the tree of life, and may go
Through the gates in the city's *glow*.
15 But outside *are* Sodomite whores,
And sorcerers, fornicators,
Idolaters, and those who love
To practice lying *hand in glove*.

Happy are they who do what You say to,
Happy are those who know the purpose true
That You once proclaimed on Sinai to few
And many brought out from the servitude
Of Egypt to rise upon quaint and crude.
Blessed indeed is the hand that does Your
will

According to the commands from that hill.
Beloved, I rush to find the ten words here
Where they resound upon my lip and ear,
And find their duty sought and done as I
Lift thought and act upon my hand and eye.
Beloved, the gate of pearl, the tree of life,
Seduce my senses in the earthly strife,
And I turn to obey You without fear.

16 "I, Jesus, have sent my angel
To witness to you these things well
In the groups of the called out ones.
I am the root of David's sons,
The bright and morning star *that runs*."
17 The spirit and the bride say "Come!"
And let the one who hears say "Come!"
And let the one who's thirsty come.
Whoever wishes, let him take
The water of life for his sake.

Jesus speaks once more at the end of this
Grand prophecy taken from the fair bliss
Of Your heart and mind to recount the true
And what would happen to the godly few
Who stood beneath the iron hand to see
The coming of the beast and dragonly
Oppression from Abu Sufyan's family,
And every tyrant set to defy what
You commanded humankind in the rut.
The bright star of the morning, David's root
Reminds me of Your coming and Your suit.
I answer the cry with a welcome now
Despite the worry on my wrinkled brow,
Hoping that Your name is read there
somehow.

18 For I bear witness to all men
Who hear this book's forecast again,
If anyone adds to these things,
God will add to him what plague sings
Written in this book, 19 and if one
Takes away from the book's words done
In forecast, God shall take away
His part from the Book of Life's sway,
From the holy city, and *from*
The things which are written *to come*
In this book. 20 He who testifies
To these things says *and never lies*,
"Surely I come quickly." Amen.
Even so, come, Lord Jesus, then!
21 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ
Be with you all. Amen *sufficed*.

Let me not add to this no more than I
Would add to the Torah where is the spy
First written in a curse to those who add.
I see every tradition is the sad
Result of adding to Your sacred word.
That is the root of all evil occurred.
Each church has more rules on record than
ten,
All more difficult to acquire for men,
And often in conflict with what You gave.
Religions would reduce the soul to slave.
So I shall add no more to this book's tone
Than that I, Loved, would bow to You
alone.
Come quickly with Your book of judgement
writ
To sanctify the temple where I sit.

